The History of the Yorubas

Samuel Johnson

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Introduction to the Annotated Edition

The Reverend Samuel Johnson's *The History of the Yorubas* stands as one of the most remarkable intellectual achievements of early twentieth-century African historiography. Written in the late 1890s and finally published in London in 1921 after an extraordinary journey of loss, re-creation, and editorial rescue, it remains the foundational anchor for any serious study of Yoruba civilization, statecraft, religion, and literature.

The Author and His Mission

Born in Hastings, Sierra Leone in 1846 to recaptive Yoruba parents who traced their lineage back to the royal house of Oyo, Samuel Johnson returned to his ancestral homeland as a young missionary schoolmaster and catechist under the Church Missionary Society (CMS). Based for decades in Oyo and later in Ibadan, Johnson found himself not only an evangelist but also a trusted diplomatic intermediary during the protracted Yoruba Civil Wars (the Kiriji / Ekitiparapo Wars) of the late nineteenth century.

Recognizing that the oral traditions, sacred chants, and historical memories of the Yoruba elders were vulnerable to dissolution under colonial partition and rapid modernization, Johnson set out to preserve them. Relying directly on the Royal Bards (*Arokin*) of the Alaafin of Oyo, councilors of state, and provincial warlords, he produced a comprehensive history of an African nation from its legendary genesis to the establishment of the British Protectorate.

Tragically, Johnson's original manuscript, dispatched to England in 1899, was misplaced by the publisher. With legendary resolve, Johnson painstakingly reconstructed the entire work from his personal field notes before his death in 1901. His brother, Dr. Obadiah Johnson, subsequently prepared and edited the recovered manuscript for its landmark 1921 publication.

Historical and Cultural Significance

Johnson's work divides naturally into two parts: 1. **The People, Their Country, and Customs**: A rigorous anthropological survey detailing Yoruba ethnology, grammar, cosmology, royal rituals, military apparatus, law, and social institutions. 2. **The Dynastic Chronicle**: A comprehensive sequential account

of the kings of Oyo (*Alaafins*), beginning with Oduduwa and Oranyan, tracing the zenith of imperial Oyo, its collapse in the early nineteenth century, and the tumultuous civil conflicts that followed.

While Johnson's perspective is inevitably influenced by his Victorian missionary upbringing and an unabashedly Oyo-centric vantage point, his record preserves names, genealogies, proverbs, and poetry that would otherwise have vanished from human memory.

About This Restored Edition

This new critical edition restores Johnson's monumental text to modern readers with careful attention to readability and cultural fidelity: - **Cleaned and Restored Text**: Hyphenation breaks, running headers, and mechanical typesetting errors from the 1921 first edition have been corrected while strictly preserving Johnson's original prose and orthography. - **Critical Apparatus**: An expanded glossary of classical Yoruba political titles, sacred concepts, and historical locations accompanies the text to assist modern readers, diaspora researchers, and students. - **Editorial Policy**: All original footnotes and historical appendices have been retained in full.

Note on the Text

Source Edition

The base text for this edition is the 1921 first edition of *The History of the Yorubas: From the Earliest Times to the Beginning of the British Protectorate*, edited by Dr. Obadiah Johnson and published in London by George Routledge & Sons, Ltd. Digitized scans preserved in the Boston Public Library collection were used as the primary historical baseline.

Editorial Principles

1. **Preservation of Authorial Voice**: Samuel Johnson's nineteenth-century English syntax, historical spellings of place names, and archaic missionary terminology have been preserved to maintain the historical integrity of the primary source.
2. **Orthography and Diacritics**: Early missionary orthography for the Yoruba language frequently utilized sub-dots and accent markers. Where early twentieth-century typesetting technology dropped or obscured accents, we have maintained the base phonetic spelling while clarifying terms in the accompanying glossary.
3. **Typography and Layout**: Mechanical scanning artefacts—such as broken line hyphenations, catchwords, and repeated running headers—have been systematically corrected to provide a seamless reading experience on modern digital screens and printed pages.
4. **Footnotes**: All original explanatory footnotes provided by Samuel Johnson and Dr. Obadiah Johnson have been retained and numbered sequentially.

Glossary of Yoruba Terms, Titles, and Concepts

This glossary provides contextual definitions for classical political offices, religious concepts, and social institutions appearing throughout *The History of the Yorubas*.

Political and Chieftaincy Titles

- **Alaafin**: The sacred king of Oyo; supreme sovereign of the Yoruba kingdom.
- **Oyo Mesi**: The supreme aristocratic council of seven kingmakers in Oyo, headed by the Bashorun, exercising constitutional checks over the Alaafin.
- **Bashorun**: Prime Minister of Oyo and head of the Oyo Mesi council; commander of the state religion and civic ceremonies.

- **Kakanfo (Aare Ona Kakanfo)**: Supreme Field Marshal of the Yoruba imperial armies. By constitutional tradition, the Kakanfo could never suffer defeat—he was expected either to conquer or commit suicide.
- **Balogun**: Commander-in-chief of provincial armies or city-state forces (particularly prominent in nineteenth-century Ibadan and Abeokuta).
- **Ooni**: The sacred monarch of Ile-Ife, regarded as the spiritual ancestral cradle of all Yoruba lineages.
- **Baale**: The civil headman, mayor, or hereditary governor of an un-crowned town or settlement.
- **Otun / Osi**: Traditional military and civil divisions: *Otun* (Right Wing) and *Osi* (Left Wing).
- **Ilari**: Royal messengers, bodyguards, and diplomatic envoys bearing distinct shaved hairstyles and scarification.

Cosmology and Religious Concepts

- **Olodumare / Olorun**: The Supreme Deity; Creator of the cosmos and source of *Ase* (spiritual life-force).
- **Orisha**: Divinities and deified ancestral forces representing facets of the cosmic order.
- **Oduduwa**: The mythological progenitor and founding ancestor of the Yoruba royal dynasties.
- **Oranyan**: Son/grandson of Oduduwa; legendary warrior-king and founder of the imperial capital of Oyo-Ile.
- **Sango (Shango)**: The fourth Alaafin of Oyo, renowned for his fiery temper and martial prowess, later deified as the Orisha of thunder, lightning, and justice.
- **Ogun**: The Orisha of iron, metallurgy, craftsmanship, and warfare; guardian of oaths and truth.
- **Obatala (Orisanla)**: The arch-divinity associated with creation, purity, wisdom, and justice.
- **Ifa (Orunmila)**: The divine system of divination, esoteric wisdom, and destiny, mediated through sacred cowrie shells or palm nuts (*Ikin*).
- **Babalawo**: "Father of secrets"; a fully initiated priest of the Ifa divination system.
- **Opon Ifa**: The sacred carved wooden tray utilized by Ifa priests during divination consultations.
- **Egungun**: Masqueraders representing ancestral spirits returning to advise, bless, or discipline the community.
- **Oro**: A sacred male ancestral society utilizing bull-roarers to maintain public order and civic sanctions.

Geographical and Cultural Terms

- **Aso Oke**: Traditional hand-woven prestige textile cloth woven on narrow looms.
- **Katunga (Oyo-Ile)**: The ancient capital of the Oyo Empire, abandoned during the nineteenth-century conflicts.
- **Ekitiparapo**: The grand confederacy formed by eastern Yoruba kingdoms (Ekiti, Ijesha) to resist Ibadan's military hegemony during the Kiriji War (1877–1893).

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Wet(Vl Sdrf$^{f>p<}$-

Dr. O. Johnson.

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THE HISTORY OF THE YORUBAS

From the Earliest Times to the Beginning of the British Protectorate

BY

The REV. SAMUEL JOHNSON

Pastor of Oyo

EDITED BY

DR. O. JOHNSON, Lagos

C.M.S. (NIGERIA) BOOKSHOPS LAGOS

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AUTHOR'S PREFACE

What led to this production was not a burning desire of the author to appear in print — as all who are well acquainted with him will readily admit — but a purely patriotic motive, that the history of our fatherland might not be lost in oblivion, especially as our old sires are fast dying out.

Educated natives of Yoruba are well acquainted with the history of England and with that of Rome and Greece, but of the history of their own country they know nothing whatever ! This reproach it is one of the author's objects to remove.

Whilst the author cotild claim to be a pioneer in an untrodden field, he can by no means pretend to have exhausted the subject ; but he hopes by this to stimulate among his more favoured brethren the spirit of patriotism and enquiry into the histories of the less known parts of the country. It may be that oral records are preserved in them which are handed down from father to son, as in the case of the better known Royal bards in the Metropolis, such records though imperfect should surely not be under-rated.

In the perusal of this feeble attempt, the author craves the forbearance of his readers ; he deprecates the spirit of tribal feelings and petty jealousies now rife among us. In recording events of what transpired, good or bad, failures and successes, among the various tribes, he has endeavoured to avoid whatever would cause needless offence to anyone, or irritate the feelings of those specially interested in the narratives, provided only that the cause of truth, and of public benefit be faithfully served.

With respect to the ancient and mythological period he has stated the facts as they are given by the bards, and with respect to the History of comparatively recent dates, viz., from the time of King Abiodun downwards, from eye-witnesses of the events which they narrate, or from those who have actually taken part in them. He has thus endeavoured to present a reliable record of events.

He is greatly indebted especially to the honoured David Kukomi, the patriarch of the Ibadan Church, (the now sainted father of the Rev. R. S. Oyebode). Kukomi was a young man in the days of King Abiodun, and it was his fortune (or misfortune) to take part in the wars and other national movements of the period as a common soldier, and was thus able to give a clear and reliable account of the sajdngs, persons, and events of those stirring times, being a cool man of judgment, observant, and remarkably intelligent.

Also to Josiah Oni, an intrepid trader in those days, an active and intelligent observer who was well acquainted with almost every part of the country, and took part in some of the most stirring events of a later period.

And last though not least to his highness the venerable Lagunju, the renowned Timi of Ede, so well known all over the country as a gifted and trusty historian of the Yoruba Country.

And to others also who are not here mentioned by name.

The histories of all nations present many phases and divers features, which are brought out by various writers in the lines in which each is interested ; the same method we hope will be pursued by writers in this country until we become possessed of a fuller History ot the Yorubas.

S. JOHNSON. Oyo, 1897. Aiila Ogun.

EDITOR'S PREFACE

A SINGULAR . misfortune, which happily is not of everyday occurrence, befel the original manuscripts of this history, in consequence of which the author never lived to see in print his more than 20 years of labour.

The manuscripts were forwarded to a well-known English publisher through one of the great Missionary Societies in 1899 and — mirabile dictu — nothing more was heard of them !

The editor who was all along in collaboration with the author had occasion to visit England in 1900, and called on the publisher, but could get nothing more from him than that the manuscripts had been misplaced, that they could not be found, and that he was prepared to pay for them ! This seemed to the editor and all his friends who heard of it so strange that one could not help thinking that there was more in it than appeared on the surface, especially because of other circumstances connected with the so-called loss of the manuscripts. However, we let the subject rest there. The author himself died in the following year (1901), and it hcis now fallen to the lot of the editor to rewrite the whole history anew, from the copious notes and rough copies left behind by the author.

But for many years after his death, partly from discouragements by the events, and partly from being appalled by the magnitude of the task, the editor shrank from the undertaking, but circumstances now and again cropped up showing the need of the work, and the necessity for undertaking it ; besides the almost criminal disgrace of allowing the outcome of his brother's many years of labour to be altogether lost. No one, who has never made the attempt, can have the faintest idea of the great difficulties that attend the efforts to elicit facts and accuracy of statements from an illiterate people : they are bewildering with repetitions, prolix in matters irrelevant, while facts germane to the subject in hand are more often than not passed over : they have to be drawn out by degrees patiently, and the chaff has to be constantly sifted from the wheat. In no sphere of labour is patience and perseverance more required than in this. It shows strongly the magnitude of the labours of the original author, labours undertaken along with the unremitting performance of his substantive duties.

When all this had to be done with the daily exactions of a busy profession, and other demands on his time, friends will judge the editor leniently for having taken such a long time to repair the loss sustained many years ago. Some chapters had to be rewritten,

X editor's preface

some curtailed, others amplified, and new ones added where necessary.

But this history has a history of its own, for apart from the mishap that befel the original manuscripts as above detailed, its vicissitudes were not yet over. When at last the task of re-writing it was completed, jt was forwarded to England by the " Appam," which left Lagos on the 2nd of January, 19 16. The Appam was at first supposed to be lost, but was afterwards found in America, having been captured by the raider Moewe. Nothing was heard of the manuscripts again for nearly two years, when they were at last delivered to the printers ! By that time, paper haci become so dear in England that it was deemed advisable to wait till after the War before printing. The manuscripts were next sent back by request to the editor, wl^o in order to obviate a future loss, undertook to have it typewritten, but in the meantime even j;ypewriting paper became difficult to obtain. All these drawbacks were successfully overcome in the end, as well as the difficulties in passing the work through the press.

He now lets the book go forth to the public, in the hope that it will fulfil the earnest desire of the original author.

O. JOHNSON.

Ajagbe Ogun.

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§1. INTRODUCTION

The Yoruba country lies to the immediate West of the River Niger (below the confluence) and South of the Quorra {i.e., the Western branch of the same River above the confluence), having Dahomey on the West, and the Bight of Benin to the South. It is roughly speaking between latitude 6° and 9° North, and longitude 2° 30' and 6° 30' East.

The country was probably first known to Europe from the North, through the explorers of Northern and Central Africa, for in old records the Hausa and Fulani names are used for the country and its capital ; thus we see in Webster's Gazetteer " Yarriba," West Africa, East of Dahomey, area 70,000 sq. miles, population two millions, capital Katunga. These are the Hausa terms for Yoruba and for Oyo.

The entire south of the country is a network of lagoons connecting the deltas of the great River Niger with that of the Volta, and into this lagoon which is belted with a more or less dense mangrove swamp, most of the rivers which flow through the country North to South pour their waters.

It will thus be seen that the country is for the most part a tableland : it has been compared to half of a pie dish turned upside down. Rising from the coast in the South gradually to a height of some 5-600 ft. in more or less dense forest, into a plain diversified by a few mountain ranges, continuing its gentle rise in some

parts to about 1,000 ft. above sea level, it then slopes down again to the banks of the Niger, which encloses it in the North and East.

In a valuable letter by the Rev. S. A. Crowther (afterwards Bishop) to Thomas J. Hutchinson, Esq., Her Britannic Majesty's consul for the Bight of Biafra and the Island of Fernando Po, published as Appendix A to the book entitled " Impressions of Western Africa,"^ we find the following graphic description of the country : —

. . . " This part of the country of which Lagos in the Bight of Benin is the seaport, is generally known as the Yoruba country, extending from the Bight to within two or three days' journey to the banks of the Niger.^ This country comprises many tribes governed by their own chiefs and having their own laws. At one time they were all tributaries to one Sovereign, the King of Yoruba, including Benin on the East, and Dahomey on the West, but are now independent.

' Longmans, Green & Co., 1858. "^ i.e. At the time of writing. — Ed.

The principal tribes into which this kingdom is divided are as follows : —

The Egbados : This division includes Otta and Lagos near the sea coast, forming a belt of country on the banks of the lagoon in the forest, to Ketu on the border of Dahomey on the West ; then the Jebu on the East on the border of Benin ; then the Egbas of the forest now known as the Egbas of Abeokuta.

Then comes Yoruba proper northwards in the plain ; Ife, Ijesha, Ijamo, EfoH, Ondo, Idoko, Igbomina, and Ado near the banks of the Niger, from which a creek or stream a little below Iddah is called Do or Iddo River."

. . . " The chief produce of this country is the red palm oil, oil made from the kernel, shea butter from nuts of the shea trees, ground nuts, beniseed, and cotton in abundance, and ivory — all these are readily procured for European markets.

. . . The present seat of the King of Yoruba is Ago otherwise called Oyo after the name of the old capital visited by Clapperton and Lander.

A King is acknowledged and his person is held sacred, his wives and children are highly respected. Any attempt of violence against a King's person or of the Royal family, or any act of wantonness with the wives of the King, is punished with death. There are no written laws, but such laws and customs that have been handed down from their ancestors, especially those respecting relative duties, have become established laws.

The right to the throne is hereditary, but exclusively in the male line or the male issue of the King's daughters.

The Government is absolute, but it has been much modified since the kingdom has been divided into many independent states by slave wars, into what may be called a limited monarchy …"

Physical features. — ^The country presents generally two distinct features, the forest and the plain ; the former comprising the southern and eastern portions, the latter the northern, central and western. Yoruba Proper lies chiefly in the plain, and has a small portion of forest land. The country is fairly well watered, but the rivers and streams are dependent upon the annual rains ; an impassable river in the rains may become but a dry water-course in the dry season.

There are a few high mountains in the north and west, but in the east the prevailing aspect is high ranges of mountains from which that part of the country derives its name, Ekiti — a mound — being covered as it were with Nature's Mound.

The soil is particularly rich, and most suitable for agriculture, in which every man is more or less engaged. The plain is almost entirely pasture land. Minerals apparently do not exist to any appreciable extent, expect iron ores which the people work themselves, and from which they formerly manufactured all their implements of husbandry and war and articles for domestic use.

Flora. — The forests teem with economic and medicinal plants of tropical varieties, as well as timber, of which mahogany, cedar, brimstone, counter, and iroko are the principal.

There are also to be found the Abura, useful for carving purposes, ebony, Ata 2i hard wood used for facing carpenters' tools, the Iki, a hard wood which when dry is very difficult to work, as it speedily blunts edged tools. The Ori, another hard wood useful for making piers on the coast, and the Ahayan, a very hard wood, unaffected by ordinary fires, dry rot, or termites.

All these are indigenous, but recently " Indian teak " has been introduced, and it flourishes widely, as well as the beef wood tree on the coast.

Although a large variety of fruits can be grown, yet the people do not take to horticulture ; what there are grow almost wild, very little attention being paid to them. Papaw, bananas of several varieties, plantcdn, oranges, pineapples, the Oro, plums (3'ellow and black), the rough skin plum, the butt lime, are to be found everywhere. Some fruit trees have been introduced, which have become indigenous, e.g., the sweet and sour sop, the avocado (or alligator) pear, guavas of two kinds, pink apples, rose apple, mangoes, the bread truit and bread nut trees, the golden plum, etc. All these are cultivated, but not widely.

Vegetables, of which there are several kinds, are largely cultivated. Yam, koko, cassada, sweet potatoes, are the principal " roots " used as diet, also beans (white and brown), small and large, and the ground nut are largely grown for food. The guinea corn grows in the north, and maize in the south. The calabash gourd and the Egusi from the seeds of which Egusi oil is pressed, grow everywhere.

Fauna. — ^Big game abound, especially in the north, where the lion is not far to seek, also the elephant, buffalo, leopard, wolf, foxes, jackals, monkeys of various species, deer, porcupine, etc. The hippopotamus is found in large rivers, and alligators in the swamps and lagoons in the south.

The usual domestic animals and poultry are carefully reared.

Of birds, we have the wild and tame parrots, green pigeons, stork, crown birds, and others of the tropical feathered tribe.

The country was at one time very prosperous, and powerful, but there is probably no other country on this earth more torn and wasted by internal dissensions, tribal jealousies, and fratricidal feuds, a state of things which unhappily continues up to the present time.

When the central authority which was once all-powerful and far too despotic grew weak by driving the powerful chiefs into rebellion and internecine wars, the entire kingdom became broken up into petty states and independent factions as we now know them.

As far as it is possible for one race to be characteristically like another, from which it differs in every physical aspect, the Yorubas

— it has been noted — are not unlike the English in many of their traits and characteristics. It would appear that what the one is among the whites the other is among the blacks. Love of independence, a feeling of superiority over all others, a keen commercial spirit, and of indefatigable enterprise, that quality of being never able to admit or consent to a defeat as finally settling a question upon which their mind is bent, are some of those qualities peculiar to them, and no matter under what circumstances they are placed, Yorubas will display them. We have even learnt that those of them who had the misfortune of being carried away to foreign climes so displayed these characteristics there, and assumed such airs of superiority and leadership over the men of their race they met there, in such a matter of fact way that the attention of their masters was perforce drawn to this type of new arrivals ! And from them they selected overseers. These traits will be clearly discerned in the narratives given in this history. But apart from the general, each of the leading tribes has special characteristics of its own ; thus dogged perseverance and determination characterise the Ijebus, love of ease and a quickness to adapt new ideas the Egbas, the Ijesas and Ekitis are possessed of a marvellous amount of physical strength, remarkable docility and simplicity of manners, and love of home.

Among the various families of Yorubas Proper, the Ibarapas are laborious farmers, the Ibolos are rather

docile and weak in comparison with others, but the Epos are hardy, brave, and rather turbulent ; whilst the Oyos of the Metropolitan province are remarkably shrewd, intelligent, very diplomatic, cautious almost to timidity, provokingly conservative, and withal very masterful.

The whole people are imbued with a deep religious spirit, reverential in manners, showing deference to superiors and respect to age, where they have not been corrupted by foreign intercourse ; ingrained politeness is part and parcel of their nature.

The early history of the Yoruba country is almost exclusively that of the Oyo division, the others being then too small and too insignificant to be of any import ; but in later years this state of things has been somewhat reversed, the centre of interest and sphere of importance having moved southwards, especially since the arrival of Europeans on the coast.

Such is the country, and such are the people whose history, religion, social polity, manners and customs, etc., are briefly given in the following pages.

THE YORUBA LANGUAGE

The Yoruba language has been classed among the unwritten African languages. The earliest attempt to reduce this language into writing was in the early forties of the last century, when the Church Missionary Society, with the immortal Rev. Henry Venn as Secretary, organized a mission to the Yoruba country under the leadership of one of their agents, the Rev. Henry Townsend,. an English Clergyman then at work at Sierra Leone, and the Rev. Samuel Ajayi Crowther, the first African Clergyman of the C.M.S., also at work in the same place.

After several fruitless efforts had been made either to invent new characters, or adapt the Arabic, which was already known to Moslem Yorubas, the Roman character was naturally adopted, not only because it is the one best acquainted with, but also because it would obviate the difficulties that must necessarily arise if missionaries were first to learn strange characters before they could undertake scholastic and evangehstic work. With this as basis, specizd adaptation had to be made for pronouncing some words not to be found in the English or any other European language.

The system, or rather want of system, existing among various missionary bodies in Africa and elsewhere emphasized the need of a fixed system of orthography. It was evidently essential for the various bodies to agree upon certain rules for reducing iUiterate languages into writing in Roman characters, not only because this would facilitate co-operation, but also because it would render books much cheaper than when separate founts of type must needs be cast for every separate system (scientific or otherwise) that each body may choose to adapt for one and the same purpose.

In this effort, the Committee of the C.M.S. were ably assisted by certain philological doctors, as Professor Lee of Cambridge, Mr. Norris of London, and notably by Professor Lepsius of BerUn, to whom was entrusted the task of establishing a complete form of alphabetic system to which all hitherto unwritten languages could be adapted.

The following remarks are largely derived from the second edition of Prof. Lepsius' work.

The Professor consulted earher efforts that had been made in India and elsewhere to transliterate foreign (Eastern) characters into the Roman, and out of the chaos then existing he estabUshed

on a firm scientific basis the Standard Alphabet in which the Yoruba language is now written. This was adopted by the C.M.S. in 1856. By this system therefore former translations had to be transliterated under certain fixed rules.

The number of letters in the Standard Alphabet is necessarily very large, as it was designed to meet the requirements of all nations ; but with diacritic marks on cognate sounds and accents, and the introduction of three characters from the Greek, the Roman characters furnish all that is necessary from which every unwritten language can draw.

It is very unfortunate indeed that the system has not been faithfully followed by all, for reasons we regard as inadequate and inconclusive. This has provoked the caustic remark of the distinguished philologist. Dr. R. N. Cust, that …" no class of mankind is so narrowminded and opinionated as the missionary except the linguist." For even in the Yoruba which professed to have adopted Lepsius' Standard, certain particulars (as we shall see) have been departed from, by no means for the better. Keen was the controversy on these points between the English and German missionaries of the Yoruba Mission in its early days. In the following' pages the style commonly used in the familiar Yoruba translations is departed from in some important particulars, as they present some peculiar defects which ought to be rectified. We shall endeavour to follow Professor Lepsius' Standard Alphabet as closely as possible.

The Professor himself has conceded that shades of sound can be adapted therefrom to meet special requirements without departing from the principles laid down. Says he in his second edition: " The exposition of the scientific and practical principles according to which a suitable alphabet for universal adoption in foreign languages might be constructed has (with few exceptions above mentioned) remained unaltered. These rules are founded in the nature of the subject, and therefore though they may admit of certain carefully hmited exceptions, they can undergo no change in themselves : they serve as a defence against arbitrary proposals which do not depend upon universal laws ; they will explain and recommend the application which has been made of them already to a series of languages and will serve as a guide in their application to new ones.

"But we have not concealed from the very beginning that it is not in every person's power to apprehend with physiological and hnguistic accuracy the sounds in a foreign language or even those of his own, so as to apply with some degree of certainty the principles of our alphabet to a new system of sounds containing

its own peculiarities. A few only of our most distinguished grammarians are possessed of a penetrating insight into the living organisms of sounds in those very languages they have discussed ; much less can it be expected of missionaries, who are often obliged without previous preparation to address themselves to the reduction and representation of a foreign language, that everything which belongs to a correct adjudication of particular sounds (frequently apprehended only with great difficulty even by the ear) or to their connection with one another and with other systems of sounds, should present itself spontaneously to their minds."

Certain rules of transcription are imperative for a correct scientific method of procedure. Whatever may have been the difficulties encountered in the ancient written languages, so far as the Yoruba and other unwritten languages are concerned, the field hes clear.

The Enghsh mode of pronouncing the vowels had to be rejected in favour of the Italian or continental mode.

The following rules or principles have been laid down : —

1. The power of each letter as representing certain sounds as handed down from antiquity should be retained.
2. The orthography of any language should never use (a) the same letter for different sounds, nor (b) different letters for the same sound.

In violation of (a) note the force of the letter g in the Enghsh words give, gin ; of a in man, name, what ; of ea in treat, tread ; of ei in weight, height ; of the consonants ch in archbishop, archangel ; of augh in slaughter, laughter ; also the sound of ch in chamber, champagne, chameleon where the same letters are used for different sounds.

In violation of (b) note the last syllables in the words atten/fow, omission, fsLshion, where different letters are used for the same sound.

3. Every simple sound is to be represented by a single sign. This is violated by writing sh to represent the " rushing sound " of s. This, as we shall see below, is quite unnecessary in the Yoruba language. Here we find an application of the principle that where a new sound is not found in the Roman alphabetic system a diacritical mark on the nearest graphic sign should be used. A diacritical mark therefore over s will more fitly represent the English sound of sh. ˆ This is also in accordance with the sin and shin in the Hebrew and Arabic, where the difference

1 Publishers' Note. It must be noted, however, that in printing this work s has been used throughout to represent the sh sound.

between the soft and the rushing sound is indicated by diacritical points, e.g.,

Heb. to tD Arab. - ^

Again the letter A is a sign of aspiration (as the spiritus asper in the Greek) as in it, hit ; at, hat ; owl, howl, etc. It would therefore be unscientific to accord it a new meaning altogether by such a use of it in violation of rule i.

Apart from this is the fact that the letter s with a diacritical mark over it has been employed about twenty years previously by oriental scholars transcribing Indian letters into the Roman.

4. Explosive letters are not to be used to express fricative sounds and vice versa, e.g., the use oi ph as f where p is clearly an explosive letter.

5. The last rule is that a long vowel should never be represented by doubling the short. This method seems to have found favour with some transcribers, there being no fixed system of transcription.

THE ALPHABET

In a purely scientific alphabetic system, it would seem more correct that the alphabets be arranged according to the organ most concerned in the pronunciation of the letters, e.g., all sounds proceed from the fauces, and are modified either at the throat, by the teeth, or by the lips ; hence they may be classified as guttural, dental, or labial. But nothing is gained by altering the order which came down to us from remote antiquity as the Romans received it from the Greek, and these from the Phoenicians, etc.

The Vowels.

The vowels in Yoruba may be built upon the three fundamental vowels, a, i, u, with the two subsidiary ones, e formed by the coalescence of the first two a and i, and o by the coalescence of a and u from which

we have a, e, i, o and u. These are the recognised principal vowels and are pronounced after the Italian method (ah, aye, ee, o, 00), but whereas in the Enghsh language the short soimd of e is written eh and that of o as aw. these sounds, according to the standard system in accordance with rule 3, are represented by a dot or dash under the cognate sounds, hence we

have e and o. A complete representation of the vowels in Yoruba therefore is as follows : — a, e, e, i, o, g, a (prpnounced ah, aye, eh, ee, oh, aw, oo), the original taking precedence of the diacritic. Note that u is not to be pronounced as " you " but as oo in food.

Nasalization. — The clear vowels are capable of a peculiar alteration which is produced by uttering the vowel through the nasal canal. There is no consonantal element brought into play, but it is an alteration entirely within the vowel. Nasalization is very largely used in the Yoruba, and consequently its orthography should be free from any ambiguity. In the Standard Alphabet the circumflex (~) is placed over the nasalized vowel to indicate such a sound. Unfortunately the Yoruba as written by missionaries substitute the letter n for this sign, a cause of some ambiguity in writing certain words as Akano, Akinola, Morinatu, Obimeko, where the letter n stands between two vowels, and is liable to be pronounced with the latter, e.g., A-ka-no, A-ld-no-la, MQ-ri-na-tu, 0-bu-ne-ko ; but following the Standard Alphabet, the words should be written Akao, Obueko, just as the Portuguese names are written Semao, Adao, JoSo, etc. Indeed certain sections of the Yoruba tribes that use nasalization very sparingly do pronounce these words as written without any sign of nasalization. The n therefore is not only unnecessary but it is also misleading.

In the following pages, the Standard System will be adhered to, where such ambiguities are liable to occur : but for the sake of simplicity and to avoid the unnecessary use of diacritical marks, n as a nasal sign may be used where it cannot cause any ambiguity,

e.g.,

1. When it precedes a consonant as nje, ndao, nk6.
2. When it closes a word, as Awon, Basorun, Ibadan, Iseyin. As nasahzation is said to be caused by the dropping of a nasal

consonant, such a Umited use of « as a nasal soimd may be justified. No pure, uneducated Yoruba man can pronounce a word ending in a consonant, he will instinctively add an i or u to it. There is therefore no closed syllable in Yoruba, n at the end of a word is purely nasal.

The System of Consonants

There are sixteen distinct consonantal sounds in the Yoruba language, each having the same force and power as in the English alphabet ; they are : b, d, f, g, h, j, k, 1, m, n, p, r, s, t, w, y. No consonants are used to represent a vowel by perverting them from their legitimate consonantal sounds as h, w, and y are sometimes used in English.

Besides the above, there are two other sounds not represented in the Roman or in any other European system ; they are explosive sounds peculiar to the Yoruba and alhed tribes formed by the lip and jaw, viz., gb and kp. They are regarded as guttural modifications of b and p, and as they appear to result from a combination of two organs concerned in speech, but the component parts of which are so intimately connected they are rightly represented by two letters, though not contravening rule 3.

As to kp, since usage makes it evident that the Yorubas never pronounce the letter p but as kp, it is therefore not considered necessary to include kp in the Yoruba alphabet as is done in the Ibo ; the simple p does perform its duty satisfactorily.

Here we find a fit application of Professor Lepsius' remarks that " The general alphabet, when applied to particular languages, must be capable of simplification as well as of enlargement. All particular diacritical marks are unnecessary in those languages where none of the bases have a double value ; we then write the simple base without a diacritical mark. Where two sounds belong to the same base, one only of the signs will be wanted. …" This is well exemplified here. We therefore write p and not kp in Yoruba.

The same may be said of the letter s and the sound sh, referred to above. The difference is indicated in the Standard Alphabet by a diacritical mark, e.g., s, s (for sh). The Yorubas can safely dispense with the latter, and for the sake of simplicity this ought to have been done, as no difference as to the meaning of a word is suggested by the same word being pronounced soft or harsh. And more also because in some parts of the country, notably the Ekun Osi district (the most northerly), the harsh sound is unpronounceable, whatever may be written ; e.g., shall, shop, will be pronounced sail, sop. In the Epo district, on the other hand, it is just the reverse ; the harsh sound will be pronounced instead of the soft, thus same, son will be pronounced shame, shon.

But all over the country women and children invariably use the softer sound for the same word, which, if thus used by men is considered affectations, except in the Ekun Osi district, where the purest and most elegant Yoruba is spoken.

S (for sh) therefore might have been dropped from the Yoruba alphabet with no harm resulting ; it is, however, retained because over a great part of the country a distinction is made between the two sounds ; apart from the fact that it would often be required in representing the sounds of some words of foreign origin.

From the above modifications therefore we have the Yoruba alphabet as now used : —

abdeefggbhijklmnooprsstuwy .

Accents or Tones

An accent in the accepted sense of the term denotes the stress laid upon a particular syllable, be it the ultimate, penultimate or antepenultimate syllable of a word. In Yoruba it is used differently. What are called accents, and for which the usual symbols are used are really tones, of which there are three : the elevated, the middle and the depressed ; for the first and the last the acute and the grave accents are used respectively, the middle tone in its simplest form requires no accent sign.

In Yoruba, vowels are of greater importance than consonants, and tones than vowels ; hence the peculiarity of this language, that musical sounds can be employed to convey a correct idea of words in speech.

Another error into which those responsible for the present mode of writing Yoruba have fallen, by departing from the Standard System, is the introduction of the circumflex (~) and its indiscriminate use as a sign of a so-called long vowel.

There are really no long or short vowels in Yoruba as understood in the English language ; what appears to be long is the coalescence of two or more vowels with an elision of the intervening consonants, e.g., Bale is a contraction of Baba-ile, i.e. father (or master) of the house. Here the second h is dropped, the two a's coalesce, and the i is absorbed in them, being represented by a prolongation of the tone. The vowels are therefore simple and compound.

The meaning of a word varies as the tone, e.g., we may say : — ba ba, bk, the voice being raised, even or depressed respectively. The first ba means to meet, the second ba to he in ambush, and the third hk to ahght upon.

So we may have be, be, b^ : b§ means to split open, be to be officious, and b^ to beg.

Also bu, bu, bu : bu means to abuse, bu to be mouldy, and bu to cut open.

In this way each vowel with each tone accent may be combined with each of the consonants to form words of different meanings ; or in other words, thus may every consonant be used with each of the vowels in turn, forming different words by varying the tone.

The Use of the Accents

To this method of using the accents over the vowels Professor Lepsius made the strongest objections, as by such a use the accents have been diverted from their proper uses to serve another purpose.

He therefore proposed to place the tone accents to the right-hand side of the vowel instead of over it, so as to distinguish a word accent from a tone accent, as is done in the Chinese and other cognate languages: e.g., word accent would be written ba, bk; tone accent, ba , ba

In this proposal the professor agrees with the Rev. T. J. Bowen an American Baptist Missionary in his Yoruba Grammar and Dictionary published in 1858 by the Smithsonian Institution. But Crowther — a Yoruba man — did not in his grammar make any such distinction. He thinks the existing accents will do well enough, and for the best of reasons, there is no word accent in Yoruba, the tone governs everything, and Europeans cannot speak without a word accent.

The language moreover abounds in contractions and elisions, a whole syllable may be dropped but the tone remains. This is the crux of difficulty with foreigners trying to speak the language, and to what extent they are able to overcome this, to that extent their Yoruba is said to be perfect.

Combination of the Accents

As remarked above, there are no closed syllables in the Yoruba language, every syllable must end in a vowel and every vowel must be one of the three tones represented by the accents. Words of three or four syllables are often contracted into two, the coalescence of the tones forming the compound vowels.

The entire scheme of the accents or tones may be thus represented:—

I. Simple vowels with the varied tones.

a, in which the tone is raised : as ka, to pick ; ba, to meet ;

la, to lick, a, in which the tone is even : as pa, to kill ; ba, to ambush ;

ta, to kick. a, in which the tone is depressed : as rk, to buy ; ki, to count ;

fa, to draw.

II. Compound vowels in which a single vowel bears more

than one tone :—

A. Compounds of the raised tone, a, in which the raised tone is doubled, e.g., A'yan, contracted

from Arfyan, i.e., cares, worries. 4-, in which the raised tone is combined with the middle, e.g.,

Ki-nla from Kinila — a form of exclamation. & in which the raised tone is combined with the depressed,

e.g., beni from b^{h}ni, so it is.

B. Compounds of the middle tone.

a' in which the middle tone is combined with the raised ; e.g.

A'yan from a-hayan, a cockroach ; O'ri from Oriri, a tomb, a" in which the middle tone is combined with itself, e.g., Ta'ni

from Ta-ha-ni — who is it ? a' in which the middle tone is combined with the depressed,

e.g., E "ru from eriru, spice ; kere from keh^rg, a screen.

C Compounds of the depressed tone. k' in which the depressed tone is combined with the raised,

e.g., a'nu from cini-inu, mercy ; 6'to from 6tit6, truth. k- in which the depressed tone is combined with the middle,

e.g., ko"' from kdriko, a wolf. i' in which the depressed tone is combined with itself, e.g.,

Ori contracted from Oriri, black plum.

In this way words of four or five syllables may, by elision and absorption, be contracted into two or three ; e.g., «ifin from aw6fin, the palace ; hence Alafin from Ani-k-w^-fin, Lord of the royal palace.

0-oni fromOw6ni, which is itself a contraction of Omo oliiw^ni, son of a sacrificial victim.

The consonants may be dropped, the vowels absorbed, but the tones are always preserved ; the first and last syllables only are essential, the voice can gUde over all the intervening tones for the sake of shortness.

This is at once the chief characteristic and — to foreigners — the main difficulty of the Yoruba language. In order to avoid such complicated tone accents it would be preferable to write out the words in full, although the contracted form may be used in speaking or reading, e.g., otito for 6'to ; korik6 for k6"'"''

Words similar in form, distinguished only by their tones. Words of two syllables : —

Api

. the arm

Ina

. . fire, louse

Apa

. a prodigal

Ink

. . flogging

Apa

. a scar

Lia

. . a tattoo mark

Aid

. a riddle

. . the eagle

A15

. something ground

Idi

. . the seat

Alo

• going

. . bunch of fruit

Awo

. a dish

. . a town

Aw6

. a crash

. . a drum

Aw6

. . a fishing net

llu

. . a gimlet

Awo

. a guinea-fowl

Awo

. . a secret

THE YORUBA LANGUAGE

Agba . . a rope lya

Agba . . an elder lya

Agba . . a cannon lya

A'yan . . anxiety, care Ik6

A'yan . . a cockroach Ik6

A'yan . . a hardwood Ikd

Baba . . father Ori

Baba (adv.) quite full Ori

Bkbk . . guinea corn 6ri

Epo . . palm oil 0p6

Epo . . bark Op6

Ep6 . . weeds Opd

E'ri . . corn chaff Oko

E 'ri . . dirt Okg

Eri (for Ori) the head 6k6

Words of three syllables similarly

Apata . . a rock korfko

Apata . . a shield k6rik6

Apatk . . a butcher

a mother punishment a separation a cough

a state messenger a hook or hanging the head shea butter black plum a post a widow to be busy a husband a hoe a spear distinguished : — grass wolf

Words of four syllables.

Koldkdlo . . stealthily

Kolgkolo . . circuitously

K^16kolo . . muddy, miry

K616k^l6 . . the fox

A SKETCH OF YORUBA GRAMMAR

The efforts we have seen made to produce a Yoruba Grammar on the exact lines of an EngHsh or Latin Grammar represent in our opinion an honest labour, highly commendable indeed it may be, but totally in the wrong direction, and little calculated to elucidate the genius of the language. On the contrary, they go a long way to obscure it.

The Yoruba belongs to the agglutinated order of speech, not to the inflectional. When therefore particles are used to form cases, etc., it is mere pedantry to talk of declensions.

It is a notorious fact that educated Yorubas find it much easier to read an Enghsh book than a Yoruba production — which until recently are mostly translations. With an effort they may plod through it, but they do not enjoy reading it, and sometimes do not even understand it. The main reasons for this are : —

1. The orthography of the language is still very defective.
2. The style in which the books are written. This may simply be described as English ideas in Yoruba words : the result is often obscurity and confusion of thought.

In the " Church Missionary Intelligencer " for March, 1880, a missionary to Japan, who had experienced a similar difificulty, wrote thus : —

" There is great danger, in all use of this language, of thinking that when we have rendered various English words into Japanese we have of necessity expressed the thoughts which the English words convey. Language may correspond to language, but the thoughts to which the language is the vehicle may be as distant as the

poles. Our language must be idiomatic or the natives will fail to see the points on which we are endeavouring to lay so much stress."

The writer has on several occasions- read portions of Yoruba translations to intelligent but purely uneducated Yoruba men. They would show that they comprehended (not without an effort) what was read to them by putting pertinent questions, but then they would add, " We can understand what you mean to say, but what you read there is not Yoruba ; it may be hook language (£de I we)." The rock of stumbling is the desire of translators to reproduce every word and particle of the English in its exact equivalent in Yoruba, regardless of idiom, and thereby obscuring the sense of the latter.

In taking up a Yoruba book one is forcibly struck by the difference in style between quotations of pure Yoruba stories, phrases, or proverbs, and the notes and observations of the writer. The former runs smooth and clear, the latter appears stiff and obscure, because the writer, with his knowledge of the English grammar and language, wrote English ideas and idioms in Yoruba words, illustrating what is said above.

When such systems are employed in writing a Yoruba Grammar, such a grammar may be usefiil in teaching English to Yoruba boys, but that is not a Yoruba grammar.

We deem these observations necessary because in the following pages we shall have occasion to render Yoruba words into English and vice versa ; a very literal translation will not be adhered to when, by so doing, the sense and force of the language will be obscured and weakened.

The Formation of Words

The formation of words in Yoruba appears to be a very simple process ; any consonant with a vowel attached will form a word (or three words, according to the variation of the tone or accent). That word will probably be a verb ; it will certainly possess the form of one, either current or obsolete. This word will, moreover, be the root of a whole class of words. By prefixing a vowel to it a noun may be formed ; with other prefixes also some other words may be formed from the same root, e.g., da to make, gda, a creature ; from which we have eleda, creator. Lk, to spUt ; ilk, a cut ; elk, halves of a whole ; kla, a boundary. Rii, to carry ; eru, a load ; alarij, a carrier ; elerii, owner of a load. Fe, to love ; Ife, love ; Ifeni, brotherly love, charity.

Thus verbs are mostly monosyllables, formed by one consonant and a vowel, and nouns disyllables in which the first syllable is a vowel, and the second a verbal root. The penultimate vowel is sometimes strengthened by a consonant.

Adjectives are mostly formed from nouns (or as nouns) by prefixing the consonant of the verbal root ; e.g., dida, made or created ; hlk, fissured ; so also from m6, to know ; im$\widehat{\ }$, knowledge, mim$\widehat{\ }$, known.

Adverbs are generally dupUcation of the adjective, e.g., didun, sweet ; didun-didun, very sweet ; dara, good ; dara-dara, very good.

What is here called a verbal root may be an obsolete word or one not generally in use, but other words can be formed from it all the same.

There are some primitive words the origin of whose roots has

been lost, e.g., omi, water ; ina, fire ; igi, wood ; aso, clothes ;

With rare exceptions, nouns not beginning with a vowel are either of foreign origin, or onomatopoetic : this latter being very common.

There are, of course, exceptions to the above rules, but these will be found to be the fundamental methods of forming Yoruba words.

We cannot within the compass of an introduction, give a complete sketch of a Yoruba Grammar, but we may state that the Unes laid down in Crowther's Vocabulary of the Yoruba language and in Notes on the

Formation of Words by the Rt. Rev. O. E. Vidal, the first Bishop of Sierra Leone, if properly developed and fully worked out, will prove both very useful and instructive.

The Parts of Speech

There are eight parts of speech. They are as in the English Grammar, the " Article " being excepted.

The Yoruba language has no article, but when definiteness is required the numeral kan (contracted from Okan, one) is used for a or an, and the demonstrative na or ni (that, the said one) is used for the definite article the.

The use of the numeral one in place of the article is not unknown even in English. " The numeral one is an indefinite demonstrative when used as the article an " — Mason,

The word kan therefore cannot be correctly called an article simply because it is made to do duty for it.

In Yoruba books translated from the Enghsh, where the translator endeavours to render every word and particle into its Yoruba equivalent, we often find these particles used where a pure Yoruba, speaking, would not use an article. Hence the Yoruba of translations often sounds rather quaint.

Literal translations regardless of differences of idiom, often result in ambiguity or nonsense.

In the British colonies of Sierra Leone and Lagos, where the Yoruba element predominates, and where the English language is often heard spoken with local accents and local idioms, the articles are frequently left out where an Englishman would use them, e.g., I see snake, for I saw a snake. Water full, for the river is full. Here the local English sounds rather quaint, because the speaker simply expresses his Yoruba ideas in EngUsh words without the article. Again, we may say in Yoruba, O joko lori aga " (He is sitting on a chair) " 0 nmu koko taba " (he is smoking a pipe) No one would ever think of adding the particle kan after aga or

koko taha by way of expressing the article a. So also we may say " Mo pade Yesufu ni Odo Osun " (I met Joseph at the River Osun), or " Mo iilo sf gja " (I am going to the market). No one would use the particle nd after Osun or oja to indicate the article the as its English equivalent. But we can say " Okonrin na ti de " (the man is come). " Mo pade Okonrin na " (I met the man). " Omode kan nduro de g " (a child is waiting for you). " Mo pa ejo kan " (I have killed a snake). In which cases definiteness is required and consequently the particles representing the articles a, an and the are used.

These examples are sufficient to show that the articles do not exist in the Yoruba language, but where definiteness is required, equivalents can be found.

We deem these illustrations necessary as in books on Yoruba Grammar the " article " forms one of the Parts of Speech.

Noun

Nouns generally in their simplest form are formed by prefixing a vowel to a verbal root ; as b§, to shear ; abe, razor ; de, to cover (the head) ; ade, crown ; da, to cease ; oda, drought ; s⌒, to offend ; ese, sin. So also the verbals alo, going ; abg, coming from, Ig, to go ; and bg, to come.

But the prefixes have certain peculiarities of their own. Thus : a prefixed indicates an agent, one who does a thing, e.g., ke, to cut ; ake, an axe — an agent for cutting wood. Da to break ; ida, a cutlass ; yun, to file, ayun, a file or a saw.

o or 0, the same as a but restricted in their use, e.g., lu, to bore ,* olu, a gimlet ; 16, to grind ; ol6, a grinder ; we, to swim ; ow⌒, a swimmer ; de, to hunt ; gde, a hunter.

e prefixed indicates a noun in the concrete, e.g., ru, to carry ; eru, a load ; mi; to breathe ; emi, the breath, spirit.

i prefixed denotes a noun in the abstract, e.g., m6, to know ; im5, knowledge ; ri, to see ; iriri, experience.

The vowels e and u are rarely used.

Gender. — The Yoruba language being non-inflective, genders cannot be distinguished by their terminal syllables, but by prefixing the words ako, male, and aho, female, to the common term ; and sometimes okonrin, a man and obirin, a woman ; e.g., akgesin, a horse, stallion abo-esin, a mare ; akg-malu, a bull ; abomalu, a cow. Omc okonrin, a boy, i.e., a man child ; gmg-birin, a girl.

In one case the masculine seems to be formed from the feminine, e.g., lyawo, a bride, gkg-iyawo, a bridegroom.

A SKETCH OF YORUBA GRAMMAR

XXX vu

Baba

. . father

lya

. mother

Okonrin

. man

Obirin

. woman

Oko

. husband

Aya

. wife

Apgn

a bachelor

Wundia

. a spinster

Apon

. a widower

a widow

)ruba langu

age in which different

female of the objects, e.g. : —

Igbekun

. . a male captive

Igbesin

. a female captive

Oso”

. a wizard

Aje

. a witch

Agbo

a ram

Agutan

. a sheep, a ewe

Obuko

. a he-goat

Ewure

. a goat

Akuko

. a cock

Agbebo

. a hen

No other distinction of genders is known.

The words arakgnrin and arabirin, used in translations for brother and sister, are purely coined words, not known to the illiterate Yoruba man not in touch with missionaries. To him they are " book-language " and must be explained.

The English words brother and sister show th« relations as to sex only without indicating the relative age ; but the Yorubas, with whom distinction in age and seniority of birth are of primary importance, generally use the words egbgn and aburo, i.e., the elder and the younger relative, words which show the relative age only, without indicating the sex and are equally applicable to uncles, aunts, nephews, nieces and cousins however far removed, as well as to brothers and sisters.

Our translators, in their desire to find a word expressing the Enghsh idea of sex rather than of age, coined the above words " arakonrin," i.e., the male relative ; " arabirin," the female relative ; these words have always to be explained to the pure but ilUterate Yoruba man.

But the words egbon okonrin or obirin and aburo gkonrin or obirin would be more intelligible to them and should be preferred, especially as it is always easy enough to find out the relative ages of the said brother or sister.

We would recommend this to our translators.

Proper names rarely show any distinction of sex, the great majority of them apply equally well to males as to females. See under " Yoruba Names," page 79-

Number. — The plural of nouns cannot be formed from the singular, either by addition or by a change of form ; only from the context can it be known whether we are speaking of one or more than one : but when specification is desired the demonstrative pronoun awQti (they) or won (them) is used with the words, e.g., B

Aw on okonrin na ti lo (the men have gone away). The bells are ringing — Awon agogo na nlu. Awon, however, is rarely used with things without life. When the plural nouns are indefinite, that is to say, without the definite article, the demonstrative awon is omitted, e.g., Walaha okuta meji — two tables of stone.

Case. — There are three cases, the nominative, objective and possessive, as in the English language ; but in none of them is there a change of form. The nominative precedes and the objective follows after the transitive verb and preposition as usual, but in the case of the possessive, the thing possessed stands before the possessor with the particle ti expressed or understood between them, e.g., Moses' book, Iwe ti Musa, in which the particle ti is expressed. Iru esin, the horse's tail, in which the particle ti is understood. But

although the particle ti is not expressed, yet its middle tone is preserved by lengthening the tone of the final vowel of the thing possessed. Thus we may say : Iwe (e) Musa, the book of Moses, Iru(u) e§in, the tail of the horse. Qro(g) Olorun, the word of God. Agbala(a) Oba, the court of the King. Oko Ore(e) mi. My friend's farm.

The sound of the added tone is sometimes so slight as to be almost imperceptible, but it is always there, and is one of those fine points which are so difficult for the ear of foreigners to catch, and the absence of which marks out their defective accents.

But when the noun in the possessive case stands alone, the particle ti must be expressed, e.g., David's, Ti Dauda. Moses's, Ti Musa. It is Joseph's, Ti Yesufu ni.

Adjectives

Adjectives are generally placed after the nouns they qualify, as Esin dudu, a black horse ; omo rere, a good child. They are placed before the nouns when some special attribute of that noun is to be emphasized, e.g., agidi omo, a stubborn child ; apa omo, a slovenly child ; alagbara okonrin, a brave fellow ; akg okuta, a very hard stone.

These are really substantives used attributively. They may more correctly be regarded as nouns in the construct state, and not pure adjectives, e.g., " a brute of a man " is a more emphatic expression than " a brutish man." This view of showing the identity of a substantive with an adjective is clearly shown by Mason : —

" The adjective was originally identical with the noun which, in the infancy of language, named objects by naming some attributes by which they were known.

" In course of time the adjective was developed into a separate

part of speech; the function of which was to attach itself to the noun ; even now it is sometimes difficult to draw the line between them, as nouns are sometimes used attributively and adjectives pass by various stages into nouns."

Comparison of Adjectives

Degrees of comparison cannot be formed from Yoruba adjectives. The words ju and juld which are generally used in Yoruba books and translations, and even stated in some grammars as forming the comparative and superlative degrees, are really adverbs signifying a greater or less degree than and as such may give a comparative sense only to the adjectives to which they are attached. The superlative is really non-existing ; it can only be gathered from the context. The wordy« is only used in an elhptical sense iox julo when a comparison is being made, and it often appears in the form of tmesis ; e.g., He re tobi ju ti emi lo — Your house is larger than mine ; where lo is separated from ju by the words ti emi, and may be omitted without affecting the sense. When used otherwise, i.e., without any idea of comparison, ju is purely an adverb signifying too, too much or too little, e.g., 0 ga ju, it is too high ; O kere ju, it is too small. But a comparative idea can be gathered only from the context, and also whether the comparison is between two or many, and it is in that way alone a comparative and a superlative degree can be made out. " If we say, ' John is taller than all the other boys in the class,' we express the same relation as to height between John and the rest as if we should say, ' John is the tallest boy in the class.' But in the former case John is considered apart from the other boys of the class, so that the two objects which we have in mind are John and the other boys in the class. When the superlative degree is used John is considered as one of the group of boys compared with each other." — Mason.

This latter sense is what cannot be expressed in Yoruba and therefore the language cannot be said to possess a superlative degree. The superlative idea can only be gathered from the context.

It would be absurd to thus compare the adjective tall : — Positive, ga (tall) comparative, ga ju (too tall) ; superlative, ga ju lo (more tall than) which are not adjectives in the comparative and superlative sense at aU.

To use words like these : Oga ogo julo, for the Most High ; or, Owu mi behe pup6 julo for I am most pleased at it, is to speak vile Yoruba. No pure Yoruba man uncontaminated with Enghsh ideas would speak in that way at all.

As the genius of the Yoruba language, the working of the

Yoruba mind, its ideas and idiosyncracies do not run in an Anglo- Saxon channel, it is not to be expected that the mode of expression will agree in every particular. Some teachers of the Yoruba language often fall into this error in their endeavours to find the exact equivalent in both languages.

The Forms and Uses of Adjectives

Every adjective has two forms, the attributive and the predicative, each depending upon the use thereof, e.g. : — A high mountain (attributive), Oke giga. The mountain is high (predicative), Oke na ga.

In Yoruba, the attributive is formed from the predicative by reduplicating the initial consonant with the vowel i, e.g., strong pred., le, attrih., lile ; sweet, pred., dun, attrib., didun ; hot pred, gbona, attrih., gbigbona ; good, pred., dara ; attrib., didara, etc. Disyllables with the vowel m as a rule undergo no change, e.g., tutu, cold ; dudu, black ; funfun, white, etc. (the n being purely nasal). Although not in use, the same rule even here may also be applied.

Pronouns.

Pronouns are used in the same sense as in EngUsh. They are: I Personal, II Relative, and III Adjective ; there is no distinction in genders in any of the forms.

The Personal includes the Reflexive.

I. Personal Pronouns, (a) Nominative Case.

Singular Plural

ist Pers. : I Emi, mo (mo, mi) n We Awa, a

2nd „ thou Iwo, o, (g) you eyin, e

3rd „ he, she it On, 6, (6) they Awon, won

The full forms (sing.) emi, iwg, oii, (plural) awa, eyin, awon, are used when emphasis is to be laid on the person, but ordinarily the second forms (sing.) mo, o, 6, (plural) a, e, won, are used. Those in brackets (mo, mi, o, 6) are mere provincialisms for the former.

5J in the ist person is used only with the incomplete and future tenses, e.g., iilQ for emi yio lo, or Mo iilo, I am going, 5Jo lo for Emi yio lo, I shall go.

He, when used in an indefinite sense, is eni, as : Eni ti o ba se e. He that doeth it. Eni ti o ba wa si ihin. He who comes here.

(b) Possessive Case.

Singular Plural

1st Pers. : Mine Ti emi Ours ti awa

2nd „ Thine Ti iwg or ti ire yours ti ^yin

3rd „ his, hers, its Ti on or ti irg theirs ti awon

It will be observed that the possessive forms, are simply the nominatives with the particle ti (meaning of) prefixed ; so that hterally they are of me, of you, of him, etc. In ordinary speech, however, the vowel of the particle always suffers elision in the singular number, but in the plural it is the initial vowel of the pronoun that is elided. Thus we have : —

Sing. : t'emi, t'iwo or fire, t'ofi or fire Plural : ti'wa, ti'yin, ti'wgn.

The apostrophe mark of elision is generally dispensed with in writing, e.g., we write temi, tiwa, tiwon, etc.

Special notice should be taken of the forms tire and tir$\hat{}$; in the 2nd and 3rd pers. singular the difference lies only in the tone (or accent) ; in the 2nd pers. the tone of the first syllable is depressed, the second is middle, it is vice versa in the 3rd person.

(c) Objective Case.

Singular

Plural

ist Pers. me mi

us wa

2nd „

thee 0

you yin

3rd ..

him, her, it a, e, e, i, 0, g, u

them wgn

The objective case as may be seen, consists of fragments of the nominative. It is really the terminal syllables of the first second and third persons, singular and plural. The third person singular calls for special rernarks : —

It consists of the whole of the vowels, but the particular vowel made use of in each case is that of the transitive verb which precedes the pronoun and governs the case, e.g., 0 pa a (he killed it), Mo pe e (I called him), Wgn te e (they bent it), A bo o (we covered it), etc. Where the verb ends in a nasal sound the vowel is also nasal, e.g., O kan a (he nailed it), A fun u (we gave him), etc.

The tone of the pronoun in the objective case is influenced by that of the verb which governs it ; when that of the verb is raised the objective maintains the middle tone, e.g., O 16 g (he twisted it). Mo ka a (I picked it) ; and vice versa when that of the verb is middle, that of the objective is raised, e.g., O se $\hat{}$ (he did it), O pa a (he killed it), 0 kan mi (it aches me). Again, when the tone of the verb is depressed, that of the pronoun is raised,

e.g., 0 kkn mi (it touched me), Mo k$\hat{}$ a (I counted it), A pe won (we called them).

The Reflexive

The word tikara, incorporated wih the personal forms, is used to indicate the Reflexive. It is placed between the nominative and possessive cases, e.g.,

Singular Plural

1st Pers. : Emi tikara mi Awa tikara wa

2nd „ Iwo tikara re Eyin tikara yin

3rd „ Ofi tikara r§ Aw on tikara won

The harsh r is generally softened into / so that instead of tikara we say tikala ; but in a flowing speech the / is dropped off altogether and the two a's blended and lengthened ; so we often hear Emi tik5 mi, Oil tika r$\hat{}$, Awa tika wa.

II Relative Pronouns

The Relative pronoun who, whose, whom, which, what, or that in Yoruba, is the simplest in any language. It consists solely of the particle ti and is used for every number, gender, person or case, e.g., I who called thee, Emi ti o pe o. The man whom I saw, Okgnrin ti mo ri. The birds which flew, Awgn eiye ti won fo.

III. Adjective Pronouns

These are : — (a) Possessive ; (b) Demonstrative ; (c) Distributive ; (d) Indefinite ; and (e) Interrogative.

(a) Possessive : — Singular Plural

My mi Our wa

thy re your jan

his, her, its rfe their won

Note. — Like adjectives, they come after the nouns they qualify, e.g.. My king, gba mi ; your children, awon omo jdn ; their cattle, awon eran-osin won.

(b) Demonstratives : — Singular Plural

this yi, eyi, eyiyi these wonyi, iwonyi that ni, eyini,na those wonni,iwgnni

Note. — The simple forms yi, ni, wgnyi, wgnni, are used with the nouns tbey quahfy, e.g., This man, gkgnrin yi ; that book, iwe ni ; these children, awgn gmgde wgnyi ; those houses, ile wgnni. But when the nouns are not expressed, the forms with a vowel prefixed are used, e.g., This is not good, eyi ko dara ; this very one, eyiyi ; these are not ripe, iwgnyi ko pgn ; those are very good, i wgnni dara jgjg. Na refers to something spoken of or understood.

[c) Distributive : —

each

olukuluku, enikankan

every

enikan, or gbogbo

either

enikan

neither

ko si enikan

Note. — The Yoruba use of the distributives is rather idiomatic. ” Each ” is olukuluku, but when used in the sense of ” one by one ” it is enikankan. For ” every one ” the Yoruba is gbogbo, i.e., all, e.g., it touches every one of us. (In Yoruba) It touches all of us, Gbogbo wa li o kan. “Either of them,” is “one of them.” Either of us may go, Okan ninu wa le lo. (d) Indefinite : —

All

Any

Both

. . Gbogbo . . eyikeyi . . mejeji

One

Other

Another

• •

kan, §nikan

ekeji

elomiran

Certain

. . (eni) kan

One another Each other

}’

ara won

Few

Many Much None

. . die

opolgpo, pupQ . . pup6, opo . . ko si enikain

Several Some Such Whole

• •

pupo

die (a few)

bayi

ototg, gbogbo

The Yoruba language s very defective in distinctive terms expressive of the indefinite pronouns. One word must do service for different terms in which there is a shade of difference of meaning, e.g.,

Gbogbo is used for all, whole.

PuPq or bpo for many, much, several.

Enikan for certain, one.

None is expressed by ” there is no one.”

(e) Interrogative : —

Who ? Tahani ? contracted to tani ? Whose ? Titahani ? contracted to titani ? Which ? Ewo ? wo ? Whom ? Tani ? eniti ? What ? Kini ? ’

Note. — -The n in kini is often converted or rather softened into / in speech. What shall we do ? Kini awa yio se ? is softened into Ki r a o se ?

Verbs

Verbs are transitives and intransitives. There are no auxiliary verbs as known in the EngHsh and other languages ; certain particles are used to mark out the moods, tenses and other forms.

for which auxiliary verbs are used, consequently the verb ” to be ” as an auxiliary is wanting.

In. the English language there are six auxiliary verbs, viz., be, have, shall, will, may, do ; each of them may be used as the principal verb, and also as an auxiUary to other verbs when they help to form the moods and tenses ; but the particles that are used in Yoruba for such purposes are not verbs, and cannot be used

as such, and therefore cannot be correctly termed auxiUary verbs as some compilers of Yoruba grammars have tried to make out. For example, the particle ti placed before a verb denotes a completed action, e.g., Ajayi ti lo, Ajayi has or had gone. The particle jyj'o in the same way points out a future tense, ·., Ajayi yio lo, Ajayi will go. The nasal n prefixed to any verb shows an incomplete action as Ajayi rilo, Aja)^ is going.

There being no auxiliary verbs as such, the Passive Voice cannot be formed in the usual way, the first or third person plural of the verb transitive is used for the passive voice, e.g., " A snake is killed " will be A pa ejo kan, or Won pa ejo kan. Or if we say " The snake was killed by Joseph " the Yoruba will be " A ti owo Yesufu pa ejo na, which is literally, " We by the hand of Joseph killed the snake," but usually the active transitive is preferred, viz., Yesuf u U o pa ejo na, " It is Joseph that killed the snake." As was observed above, the majority of Yoruba verbs in their simplest form consist of monosyllables — a consonant and a vowel, e.g., ka, to pick, kd. to count, rd to buy, lo to go, wa to come, sun to sleep, etc. They are non-inflective and do not show any distinction in number or person.

Disyllabic verbs are almost invariably compound words resolvable into their component parts ; they may be a verbal root compounded with a preposition, a noun or an adverb (some roots, however, have become obsolete), e.g., Bawi, to scold, from ba, with, and wi, talk. Dahun, to answer, from da, to utter, ohun, a voice. Dapo, to mingle, from da, to pour or mix, and Pq, together. Sunkun, to weep, from sun, to spring, and ekun, tears.

Some are transitives, others intransitives.

The noun or pronoun governed by the transitive verb is invariably placed between the component parts, e.g., Bawi, to scold. O ba mi wi, He scolded me.

Pade, to close. O pa ilekun de. He closed the door

Here the mi is placed between the ha and the wi. It. is not O bawi mi for He scolded me, but 0 ha mi wi.

So also ilekun is placed between pa and de, not O pade ilekun, but 0 pa ilekun de for He closed the door.

A SKETCH OF YORUBA GRAMMAR xlv

Verbs compounded with a Preposition : —

Bawi, to scold. O ba mi wi, He scolded me.

Pade; to shut. Pa ilekun de, Close the door.

Dimu, to take hold of. Di mi mu, Take hold of me.

Dasi, to spare. Da won si, Spare them.

Verbs compounded with an Adverb : —

Baje, to spoil. Ba inu je, Grieve, " Spoil the mind."

Dapo, to mingle. Da won po. Mix them together.

Tuka, to scatter. Tu won ka, Scatter them.

Daru, to confound. Da won ru, Confound them.

Pamo, to keep. Pa mi mo, Keep or preserve me.

In verbs compounded with a noun, the noun always has the preposition ni (softened into li) before it, e.g.,

Daju, evident, from da, clear, and oju, the eyes — clear to the

eyes. 0 da mi I' oju. It is evident to me Tiju, to be ashamed, from ti to cover, oju, the eyes — covering

the eyes. 0 ti mi I' oju. It shames me. Dahun, to answer, from da, to utter, ohun, a voice. Da mi

I'ohun, Answer me. Jiya, to suffer, from je, to eat, iyk, punishment, 0 je mi ni iyd,

He punished me. Gbowg, shake hands, from gba, take, owo, hand. 0 gbd mi

I'owQ, He shook hands with me. Ranse, to send a message, from ran, send, ise, a message. Mo

ran a ni i§e, I have sent him.

The Intransitive verbs of this class are usually neuter verbs compounded with nouns of similar import and therefore do not admit of any nouns or pronouns being inserted into their component parts, e.g.,

Sunkun, to cry, from sun, to spring, shed, ekun, tears.

Sorg, to talk, from so, to utter, org, a word.

Kunle, to kneel, from kun, to fill. He, the ground.

P^de, to meet, from pa, to keep, ade, a coming.

Duro, to stand, Irom da, to keep, iro, upright.

Moods and Tenses

In the formation of Moods and Tenses certain particles are made use of. They may have been the roots of obsolete verbs, but they cannot now be used as verbs but as particles ; we therefore refrain from applying the terms " defective " or " auxiliary verbs " to them. Such are the following : —

Bi, ha or iha, implying if, should, or would, e.g. Bi o ba lo, if he should go. Oia iba lo, should he go

Je or ki, or j ski, implying permission, e.g., Je ki o \q or ki o lo,

let him go. Lb, implying permission. O le lo, he may go. Md or Mase, implying prohibition (authoritative). Maha, impljdng permission (authoritative), e.g., Maha lo, be going Yio, often contracted to o, sign of the future, e.g., Yio lo, he

will go. Emi o \o, I will go. Ati or ni ati, softened into lati, implying an intention, e.g.,

Ati lo, to go, Lati jeun, to eat (intending to). N or ng, sign of incomplete action, e.g., Emi filo, I am going.

Ojo fir6, it is raining. Ti, a sign of the past tense, e.g., 0 ti lo, he has gone. From these particles the Moods and Tenses are formed.

Moods

The Indicative, Subjunctive, Potential, Imperative, Infinitive and the Participal Moods can be well expressed in Yoruba, and all but the first can be formed by the use of one or other of the above particles.

The Indicative is the verb in its simplest form, e.g. lo, to go. Emi Ig, I went. Ojo sare, Ojo ran.

The Subjunctive is formed by prefixing the conjunction hi (if) before the subject of the verb, with or without the particle ha, e.g., Bi emi lo or Bi emi ba Ig, If I were to go. Bi emi ba fe Ig, If I wish to go.

The Potential is formed by adding the particle le before the verb, e.g., Emi \h Ig, I may go (lit. I am able to go).

The Imperative is formed by the permissive sign J§ ki, e.g., Jg ki emi Ig, Let me go. [Besides the direct forms Ig (go thou) ; ^lg(goye).]

The Infinitive is formed by adding the particles ati or lati before the verb, e.g., Ati lo, to go. Lati mo, to know.

The Participle is formed by prefixing the particle ii (or ng) to the verb, e.g. nlo, going.; nbQ, coming.

Tenses

There are only three tenses in Yoruba, properly speaking, the preterite, the incomplete, and the future.

An action just done is a completed action and is therefore past ; one doing is incomplete, consequently what may be considered present may be merged in the completed action, and is therefore taken as preterite, or in the incomplete, as the sense may require.

The simple verb is always expressed in the past indefinite or

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preterite tense, e.g., Mo lo, I went ; Mo we, I washed. O rerin, he laughed or laughs ; 0 joko, he sat or sits.

The complete tenses, past or present, are expressed by prefixing the particle ti before the preterite, e.g., Mo ti we, I have, or had washed. O ti lo, he has or had gone.

The incomplete tense is formed by prefixing the particle ii (orng) to the verb, e.g., Emi nwe, I am washing. Emi iirerin, I am laughing.

The future tense is formed by placing the particle jyj'o (contracted to o) before the verb, e.g., Emi yio we, I shall wash. Emi o lo, I shall go. Awa o maha yo. We shall be rejoicing.

The future complete (or second future) tense is formed by adding the particles indicating the future and the complete tenses to the verb e.g., Emijyw ti we, I shall have washed. Emi o ti lo, I shall have gone.

Adverbs

Adverbs are used in the same way as in the English, to modify or hmit the meaning of a verb, an adjective, or another adverb, and are generally placed after the words they qualify, e.g., 0 sorg daradara. He spoke well. 0 soro jojg. It is very difficult. After an intransitive verb, they come directly after the verb, as 0 sun fanfan. He slept soimdly. O sure tete. He ran swiftly. But after a transitive verb they come after the noun or pronoun in the objective case, e.g.. Mo mo Yesufu daju-daju, I know Joseph well. O le won sehin-sehin. He drove them far back.

Adverbs of manner, quahty and degree are mostly formed by a reduplication of the word (especially an adverb or a verb), e.g., O sorg daradara. He spoke very well, O duro sinsin. He stood firmly. Dajudaju, evidently. Mo feran r^ gidigidi, I love him well.

Adverbs of time, place and quantity are used in the same way as in the EngHsh, and call for no special remarks. We may note, however, that in these, words of more than one syllable not onomatopoetic in origin are capable of being resolved into their elementary parts — usually into a particle (a preposition) and a noun, e.g.,

Nigbagbogbo, always, can be resolved into ni (at), igba (time), gbogbo (all), i.e., at all times.

Kigbose, when, can be resolved into ni (at or in), igba (time), ti (which), 0 se (it happened), i.e., at the time when it happened, i.e., when.

Nihiyi, here, ni (at), ihin (here), yi (this), at this place.

Loke, upwards, ni or li (at), oke (the top).

Nibomiran, elsewhere, ni (at), ihi (place), omiran (another), at another place.

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But there is also a use of adverbs peculiar to the Yoruba language, an onomatopoetic idea is often connected with it, and consequently it is always formed to suit the word it qualifies, and thus intensify the idea conveyed by the word. A form that is applicable to one verb or adjective may not be appHcable to another, and therefore adverbs of degree or quality cannot be enumerated. For instance :

The adverb gogoro can only apply to height, as o ga g6g6rd, It is very high. A reduplication of the word can further intensify the idea, O ga gogoro gogoro. It is very, very high. In the same way the word gbagada can only apply to something of a huge size, and a redupHcation of it, gbagada gbagada, intensifies the idea. Also the word repete or rapcita-rapata implies not only a large size, but also a massive one, one in which the space covered is much more than the height.

Apart from intensifying the ideas, other quaUties can also be expressed by the character of the adverb made use of ; in other words, the adverbs often suggest some other ideas inherent in the qualities they describe although they cannot be so expressed in Enghsh, e.g., we may say, 0 pon fo 6, It is bright red. Here the adverb fo 6, besides being aptly applying to what is red, also suggests the warmth of the colouring. So also O pon roro. It is deep red ; O p6n rokiroki, i.e., It is bright red, almost yellow. In the last two examples roro and rokiroki refer simply to the depth of the colouring.ˆ

One or two more illustrations will develop the above ideas fully. In the matter of length, we may say O gim tunu tunu. It is very long. This can only apply to a long road, the idea of distance being imphed. O gvm gboro-gbgro. It is very long. This conveys an idea of a long pole, or a rope, or a serpent or the like. So also with respect to height, we may say, O ga.fio fio, It is very high. This can only apply to something on the top of a great height, or the top of a high object — as a tree, standing on the ground. O ga tian-tian, It is very high. This can only apply to an object at a great height, not connected with the ground, as a bird flying at a great height.

In all these examples, the adverb very is used to qualify the adjectives in English, no other ideas being conveyed ; in this respect the Yoruba is more expressive.

Prepositions

Prepositions are particles placed before nouns or pronouns to

show their relation to other words in the sentence.

ˆ See Vidal's Notes to Crowther's Yoruba Grammar.

In Yoruba they are mostly monosyllables, e.g., si, ni, fun, de, etc., as : O lo si ile. He goes into the house. O wa ni oko. He is in the farm. O ko ile fun Baba, He has built a house for the father. Duro dˆ mi, Wait for me.

Words of more than one syllable when used as prepositions are capable of being resolved into their component parts, e.g., O nbo lehin mi, He is coming behind me. Here, the preposition lehin is resolvable into li (at) and ehin (the back). O wa leti ile. He is near the house ; leti is resolvable into li (at) and eti, the ear, or the edge that is within the hearing or at the edge of the house.

Under Verbs we have already considered those pecuhar forms compounded with prepositions.

Conjunctions

Conjunctions are particles which serve to connect words or sentences ; they are copulative and disjunctive.

Copulative. Ati, and or both. Ati Baba ati omo, Both father and son. The

initial a may be omitted, e.g., Tiwo tirˆ for ati iwo ati ixh

(you and he). On, and or both. O lo t'ofi ti omo. He left both himself and

child. It may be noted that on is never used to copulate

pronouns of the ist and 2nd persons. Bi, if. Bi o je se omo. If he would be a child. (This is used

for an obedient child). Nitori, because. Nitori t'emi. Because of me. Nje, then. Nje o yio lo ? Then will you go ?

Disjunctive. Sugbgn, but. O de ile sugbon ko ba mi. He called but did not

meet me at home. Tabi, or. Emi tabi iwg, I or you. Bikose, unless. Bikose pe o juba re, Unless he pays regard to

Adi. although. Adi o ngbo gbogbo rh, Although he hears it all. Amgpe, idiomatic for be it known.

Interjections

Interjections are any form of exclamation or ejaculation expressing some emotions of the mind. Any words may be used for the purpose, but very few convey any meaning apart from the tone in which they are expressed.

Exclamations of surprise : Ye ! O ! pa ! emo ! hepk !

Exclamations of disgust : S6 ! Siyo !

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It is rather curious that tribal peculiarities are marked in some forms of exclamations.

Favourite expressions of Oyos : Ha ! Kinla ! Em ode ! Gbagadari !

Favourite expressions of Egbas and Ijebus : Here or herek^ 1 heparipk ! payentiwk !

The usual exclamation in law courts for " silence " is : Atoto ! lit, enough of your noise !

Kagbohun ! lit, let us hear the sound of a (single) voice.

The tone of voice thrown into the exclamation in particular marks the expressions of grief, surprise, admiration or contempt.

We close this portion with the exclamation usually addressed to kings — Kabiyesi ! May long life be added !

Numerals

Numerals in Yoruba, although formed on a definite plan, yet are more or less compUcated ; the tone (or accent) plays an important part in them.

All numerals refer to some noun (person or thing) expressed or understood. They are Cardinal and Ordinal or Serial. .

The Cardinal has three forms, viz. : (i) simple enumeration ; (2) numeral adjectives ; and (3) numismatics. To these may be added adverbs of number and of time.

1. Simple Enumeration

I .

Eni

22 .

… Ejilelogun

2 .

u

23 .

… £talelogun

3 .

£ta

24 .

… ferinlelogun

4 •

5 •

6rin

Arun

25 .

26 .

… Edogbgn … Jlrindilggbgn

6 .

Efa

27 •

… Stadilogbgn

7

Eje

28 .

… Ejidilggbgn

8 .

Ejo

29 .

… Okandilggbgn

9 •

… Esan

30 .

… Ogbgn

10 .

£wa

35 •

… Arundilogoji

II .

… Okanla

40 .

Oji

12 .

£jila

45 .

… Arundiladgta

13 •

£tala

50 .

… Adgta

14 .

… Erinla

55 .

… Arundilgggta

15 •

£dogun

60 .

… Oggta

16 .

… £rindilogun

65 .

… Arundiladgrin

17 •

… fetadilogun

70 .

… Adgrin

18 .

…]^jidilogun

75 .

… Arundilgggrin

19 .

… Okandilogun

80 .

… Oggrin

20 .

85 .

… Arundiladgrun

21 ..

… Okanlelogun

90 .

… Adorun

A SKETCH OF YORUBA GRAMMAR

Simple Enumeration — Continued.

95 -.

… Arundilogorun

4,000 …

.. Egbaji

100 …

… Oggrun

5,000 …

.. Edegbata

200 …

… Igba

6,000 …

.. Egbata

300 …

… Odunrun

7,000 …

.. Edegbarin

400 …

… Irinwo

8,000 …

.. Egbarin

500 …

… Edegbeta

9,000 …

.. Edegbarun

600 . . .

… Egbeta

ro,ooo …

.. Egbarun

700 . . .

… Edegberin

20,000 …

., Egbawa or

800 …

… Egberin

Oke kan i.e

'. one bag (of

900 …

… Edegberun

cowries) .

1,000 …

… Egberun

Higher num

bers as 40,000,

2,000 …

… Egb^wa

60,000, etc. being so many bags.

3,000 …

… Egbedogun

2.

Quantitative or

Numeral Adjectives

One

Okan

Twenty -nine .

.. Mgkandilggbgn

Two

Meji

Thirty …

Ogbgn

Three …

Meta

Thirty-five

.. Marun dilogoji

Four

Merin

Forty …

Oji

Five

Marun

Forty-five

.. Marundiladgta

Six

Mefa

Fifty …

Adgta

Seven …

Meje

Fifty-five

. Marundilogota

Eight …

Mej g

Sixty

’ Ota

Nine

Mesan

Sixty-five

, Marundiladgrin

Ten

Mewa ”

Seventy…

… Adgrin

Eleven …

Mgkanla

Seventy- five

.. Marundilgggrin

Twelve …

Mejila

Eighty …

… Oggrin

Thirteen

Metala

Eighty-five

, . Marundiladgrun

Fourteen

… Merinla

Ninety …

Adgrun

Fifteen …

Medogun

Ninety-five

..Marundilgggrun

Sixteen …

Merindilogun

One hundred .

Orun

Seventeen

Metadilogun

One hundred an

d ten … Adgla

Eighteen

Mejidilogun

i> i>

twenty Qggfa

Nineteen

… Mgkandilogun

II 1) »

thirty Adoje

Twenty

II .. II

forty Ogoje

Twenty-one

… Mekanlelogun

II II ..

fifty Adgjo

Twenty-two

Mejilelogun

II II

sixty Qggjg

Twenty-three

Metalelogun

II II II

seventy Adgsan

Twenty -four

Meiinlelogun

II II II

eighty Oggsan

Twenty -five

Medggbgn

II II II

ninety

Twenty-six

… Merindilggbgn

Mewadinigba

Twenty-seven

… RIetadilggbgn

Two hundred .

Igba

Twenty-eight

Mejidilggbgn

etc., etc.

3. Numis

matics

One cowry

06kani

Three cowries ..

Eeta

Two cowries

Eejii

Four

E erin

1 Lit., one money, two monies ; cowry shells being used for money.

Hi

A SKETCH OF YORUBA GRAMMAR

N UMI SM ATics — Continued

Five cowries … … A arun

Six „ E eik

Seven „ … … E eje

Eight „ E ejo

Nine „ … … Eesan

Ten , Eewa

Eleven „ … …0-6kanla

Twelve „ … … E-ejila

Thirteen „ … … Eetala

Fourteen „ … … Eerinla

Fifteen „ Eedogun

Sixteen „ … Eerindilogun Seventeen cowries Egtadilogun

Eighteen „ Eejidilogun

Nineteen „ Ookandilogun

Twenty „ … Ok6wo

Twenty-five „ Eedogbon

Thirty „ Ogbonwo

Forty „ … Ogoji

Fifty „ … A-adota

Sixty „ … Qgota

Seventy „ A-adorin

Eighty „ … Qgorin

Ninety „ A-adgrun

One hundred „ … Ogorun

no cowries … … A-adofa

120 „ Qgofa

130 „ … … A-adoje

140 „ … … Ogoje

150 „ … … A-adojo

160 „ Qg6jg

170 „ … A-adosan

180 „ … … Ogosan

190 „ … Ewadinigba

200 „ … … Igbiwo

210 „ … Ewalerugba

220 „ … Ogunlugba

230 „ Ogbonwolerugba

240 „ … - Ojulugba

250 „ A-adotalerugba

260 „ … Otalugba

270 „ A-adorinlerugba

280 „ … Orinlugba

290 „ A-adorunlerugba

300 „ … Odunrun

400 „ … … Irinwo

500 cowries . . . E-edegbfeta

, Egb^ta

E-edegberin

Egb^rin

E-edegberun

1,000

Egb^run

1,200

’Egb^fa

1,300

E-edegbeje

1,400

Egbeje

1,500

E-edegb^jg

1,600

… Egb^jg

1,700

E-edegb^san

1,800

Egbesan

1,900

„ Egbadin-gggrun

2,000

„ Egbkwa

2,200

Egbokanla

2,400

„ Eg’b^jila

2,500

„ Egb^taladin-gggrun

2,600

Egbetala

2,800

Egb^rinla

3,000

Egbeedogun

3.500

… Egbejidilogun-

din-gggrun

3,600

… Egbejidinlogun

4,000

Egbaji

4.500

… Egbetalelogun-

din-gggrun

5,000

5gbedggbgn

5.500

…Egbetalelggbgn-

din-gggrun

6,000

Egbata

7,000

Edegbarin

8,000

Egbarin

9,000

Edegbarun

10,000

Egbarun

15,000

Edegbajg

16,000

Egbajg

18,000

Egbasan

20,000

Egbawa (Oke kan)

30,000

E-edogun

32,000

Erindilogun

34,000

Etkdilogun

36,000

Ejidilogun

38,000

„ … Ok&ndilogun

40,000

„ Egbagun (Oke meji)

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The Ordinal

The first

„ second

„ third

„ fourth

„ fifth

„ sixth

„ seventh

„ eighth

„ ninth

„ tenth

„ eleventh

„ twelfth

„ thirteenth

„ fourteenth

„ fifteenth ..,

„ sixteenth …

„ seventeenth

„ eighteenth

„ nineteenth

„ twentieth ..

„ twenty-first

„ twenty-fifth

Ekini

Ekeji

Eketa

Ekerin

Ekarun

Ekefa

Ekeje

Ekejo

Ekesan

Ekewa

Ikokanla

Ikejila

Iketala

Ikerinla

Ikedogun

Ikerindilogun

Iketadilogun

Ikejidilogun

Ikokandilogun

Ikgkanlelogun

Ikedogbon

The thirtieth Qgbon

„ thirty-fifth Ikarundilogoji „ fortieth … … Oji

„ forty-fifth … Ikarundiladota

„ fiftieth Adota

„ fifty-fifth … Ikarundilogota „ sixtieth … … Qgota

„ sixty-fifth Ikarundiladorin „ seventieth … Adorin

„ seventy-fifth Ikarundilogorin „ eightieth … … Ogorin

„ eighty-fifth Ikarundiladorun „ ninetieth … … Adorun

„ ninety-fifth Ikarundilggorun „ hundredth … Ogorun

„ hundred and first… Ikokanlelogorun From the first to the ninth —

Ikokanle to Ikokandin — the

tenths merge into those of simple

enumeration.

Adverbs of Number

One by one … Two by two … Three by three Four by four Five by five . . . Six by six Seven by seven Eight by eight Nine by nine Ten by ten … Continue to numerals up nineteen then — Twenty by twenty Thirty by thirty Forty by forty Fifty by fifty

Once

Twice

Thrice

Okankan

… Meji-meji

Meta-meta

Merin-merin

Marun-marun

… Mefa-mefa

… Meje-meje

… Mejo-mejg

Mesan-mesan

Mewa-mewa

reduplicate the

to nineteen by

Ogo-gun Ogbggbon ” Ogogoji

Aradgta

Adverbs

Erinkan Erin me ji Erin-m §ta

Sixty by sixty … Oggggta

Seventy by seventy… Aradgrin Eighty by eighty … Oggggrin Ninety by ninety … Aradgrun Hundred by hundred Oggggrun Thus from one to nineteen the numbers are reduplicated, also from 21-29 ’< 31-39 ; 41-49 J ^iid so on, but for 20, 30, 40, 60, 80, 100 only the reduplication of the first two letters takes place, e.g., Ogogun, Ogbggbgn ; for 50, 70, 90, the same occurs only the euphonic ” r ” takes the place of ” d ” e.g., Aradgta for Adgdgta ; Aradorun for Adodorun.

OF Time

Four times

Five

Six

. Erin-m erin Erin-marun . grin-mefa

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Adverbs of Time — Continued

Seven times …

Erin-meje

Seventy times

Igba-adorin

Eight .. …

Erin-mejo

Eighty „

Igba-ogorin

Nine „

Erin-mesan

Ninety „

Igba-adgrun

Ten

Erin-mewa

Hundred „

Igba-ogorun

The same to nineteen times.

Thus ” Erin ” is

prefixed to all

Twenty times

Igba-ogun

the numerals, but

the multiples

Thirty

Igba-ogbgn

of ten take ” Igba

” before them.

Forty „

Igba-ogoji

Note.—’ Erin ”

is usually

Fifty

Igba-adota

softened to ee, e.g.,

ˆ|kan, ˆgmeji

Sixty

Igba-ggota

and so forth.

Analysis of the Numerals

From one to ten, different terms are used, then for 20, 30, 200 and 400 ; the rest are multiples and compounds. Thus 11, 12, 13 and 14 are reckoned as ten plus one, plus two, plus three and plus four ; 15 to 20 are reckoned as 20 less five, less four, less three, less two, less one, and then 20.

In the same way we continue 20 and one, to 20 and four, and then 30 less five (25), less four, and so on to 30, and so for all figures reckoned by tens.

There is no doubt that the digits form the basis of enumeration to a large extent, if not entirely so. Five, ten, twenty, i.e., the digits of one hand, of two, and the toes included, and their multiples form the different stages of enumeration.

Beginning from the first multiple of 20 we have ogoji, a contraction of ogun meji, i.e. two twenties (40), Ogota, three twenties (60), Ogorin, four twenties (80), Ogorun, five twenties (100), and so on to ten twenties (200), when the new word Igba is used.

The intermediate numbers (30 having a distinct terminology), 50, 70, 90, no, 130 to 190 are reckoned as : 60 less ten (50), 80 less ten (70), a hundred less ten (90), and so on to 200.

The figures from 200 to 2,000 are reckoned as multiples of 200 (400, however, which is 20 X 20, the square of all the digits, has a distinct terminology, Irinwo or Erinwo, i.e., the elephant of figures — meaning the highest coined word in calculation, the rest being multiples).

Thus we have Egbeta, a contraction of Igba-meta, i.e., three two-hundreds (600), Egberin, from Igba-merin, four two-hundreds (800), Egberin, five two-hundreds (1,000), and so on to Egbiwa, ten two-hundreds (2,000), which in its turn forms the basis of still higher calculations.

The intermediate figmres 6i 300, 500, 700, 900, 1,100 to 1,900 are reckoned as 100 less the multiple above them, viz., Odunrun,

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contracted from Orun-din-ni-irinwo, i.e., loo less than 400 (300), Orun-din-ni-egbeta, 100 less than 600 (500), Orun-din-ni-egberin, 100 less than 800 (700) ; and so on to 2,000.

By a system of contraction, ehsion, and euphonic assimilation, for which the Yoruba language is characteristic, the long term Oriin-din-ni (Egbeta or Egberin and so on) is contracted to Ed^ or Od6, e.g., Edegbeta (500), Edegberin (700), Edegberun (900) and so on.

But the multiples of 200 do not end with ten times, although that figure is the basis of the higher calculations, it goes on to the perfection (or multiple) of the digits, viz. : twenty times (two hundred) ; thus we have Egbgk^nla, that is, Igba mokinla, II two-hundreds (2,200) ; Egbejila, twelve two-hundreds (2,400), and so on to twenty two-hundreds or Egbaji, that is, twice two thousand (4,000).

With this ends the multiples of 200. The intermediate figures of 2,300, 2,500, 2,700, 2,900 are reckoned the same way as before, viz. : 100 less than the next higher multiple.

As already mentioned, Egbawa (or Egba), 2,000, forms the basis of still higher calculations ; the multiples of Egba are Egbaji, two two-thousands (4,000) ; Egbata, three two-thousands (6,000) ; Egbarin, four two-thousands (8,000) on to Egbawa, ten twothousands (20,000), which in its turn forms the basis of the highest calculations.

The intermediate figures of 3,000, 5,000, 7,000, 9,000, 11,000 onwards are reckoned as 1,000 less than the multiple above them. The more familiar terms for 3,000 and 5,000, however, are Egbe dogun, or fifteen two-hundreds, and Egbedogbon, 25 two-hundreds.

For those figures beyond 20,000 the contracted forms which are generally used are : Okanla (for Egbamgkanla) 11 two-thousands ; £jila, Etkla on to Egbagim, i.e., 20 two-thousands, i.e., forty thousand.

Summary. — Thus we see that with numbers that go by tens five is used as the intermediate figure — five less than the next higher stage. In those by 20, ten is used as the intermediate. In those by 200, 100 is used, and in those of 2,000, 1,000 is used.

The figure that is made use of for calculating indefinite numbers is 20,000 Egbawa, and in money calculation especially it is termed Oke kan, i.e., one bag (of cowries). Large numbers to an indefinite amount are so many " bags " or rather " bags " in so many places.

THE HISTORY OF THE YORUBAS

PART I

Chapter I ORIGIN AND EARLY HISTORY

The origin of the Yoruba nation is involved in obscurity. Like the early history of most nations the commonly received accounts are for the most part purely legendary. The people being unlettered, and the language unwritten all that is known is from traditions carefully handed down.

The National Historians are certain families retained by the King at Oyg whose office is hereditary, they also act as the King's bards, drummers, and cymbalists ; it is on them we depend as far as possible for any reliable information we now possess ; but, as may be expected their accounts often vary in several important particulars. We can do no more than relate the traditions which have been universally accepted.

The Yorubas are said to have sprung from Lamurudu one of the kings of Mecca whose offspring were : — Oduduwa, the ancestor of the Yorubas, the Kings of Gogobiri and of the Kukawa, two tribes in the Hausa country. It is worthy of remark that these two nations, notwithstanding the lapse of time since their separation and in spite of the distance from each other of their respective localities, still have the same distinctive tribal marks on their faces, and Yoruba travellers are free amongst them and vice versa each recognising each other as of one blood.

At what period of time Lamurudu reigned is unknown but from the accounts given of the revolution among his descendants and their dispersion, it appears to have been a considerable time after Mahomet.

We give the accounts as they are related : —

The Crown Prince Oduduwa relapsed into idolatry during his father's reign, and as he was possessed of great influence, he drew many after him. His purpose was to transform the state religion into paganism, and hence he converted the great mosque of the city into an idol temple, and this Asara, his priest, who was himself an image maker, studded with idols.

Asara had a son called Braima who was brought up a Mohammedan. During his minority he was a seller of his father's idols, an occupation which he thoroughly abhorred, but which he was obliged to engage in. But in offering for sale his father's handiwork, he usually invited buyers by calling out : " Who would purchase falsehood ? " A premonition this of what the boy will afterwards become.

By the influence of the Crown Prince a royal mandate was issued ordering all the men 'to go out hunting for three days before the annual celebration of the festivals held in honour of these gods.

When Braima was old enough he seized the opportunity of one of such absences from the town of those who might have opposed him to destroy the gods whose presence had caused the sacred mosque to become desecrated. The axe with which the idols were hewed in pieces was left hanging on the neck of the chief idol, a huge thing in human shape. Enquiry being made, it was soon discovered who the iconoclast was, and when accosted, he gave replies which were not unUke those which Joash gave to the Abiezrites who had accused his son Gideon of having performed a similar act {see Judges vi, 28-33). Said Braima, " Ask that huge idol who did it." The men replied, " Can he speak? " " Then," said Braima " Why do you worship things which cannot speak ? " He was immediately ordered to be burnt aUve for this act of gross impiety. A thousand loads of wood were collected for a stake, and several pots of oil were brought for the purpose of firing the pile. This was signal for a civil war. Each of the two parties had powerful followers, but the Mohammedan party which was hitherto suppressed had the upper hand, and vanquished their opponents. Lamurudu the King was slain, and all his children with those who sympathized with them were expelled from the town. The Princes who became Kings of Gogobiri and of the Kukawa went westwards and Oduduwa eastwards. The latter travelled 90 days from Mecca, and after wandering about finally settled down at He Ifg where he met with Agb^-niregun (or Setilu) the founder of the Ifa worship.

Oduduwa and his children had escaped with two idols to He He. Sahibu being sent with an army to destroy or reduce them to submission was defeated, and amongst the booty secured by the victors was a copy of the Koran. This was afterwards preserved in a temple and was not only venerated by succeeding generations as a sacred reUc, but is even worshipped to this day under the name of Idi, signifying Something tied up.

Such is the commonly received account among this intelligent although unlettered people. But traces of error are very apparent

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on the face of this tradition. The Yorubas are certainly not of the Arabian family, and could not have come from Mecca — that is to say the Mecca universally known in history, and no such accounts as the above are to be found in the records of Arabian writers of any kings of Mecca ; an event of such importance could hardly have passed unnoticed by their historians. But then it may be taken for granted that all such accounts and traditions have in them some basis in actual facts, nor is the subject under review exempted from the general rule, and this will become apparent on a closer study of the accounts.

That the Yorubas came originally from the East there cannot be the slightest doubt, as their habits, manners and customs, etc., all go to prove. With them the East is Mecca and Mecca is the East. Having strong affinities with the East, and Mecca in the East looming so largely in their imagination, everything that comes from the East, with them, comes from Mecca, and hence it is natural to represent themselves as having hailed originally from that city.

The only written record we have on this subject is that of the Sultan Belo of Sokoto, the founder of that city, the most learned if not the most powerful of the Fulani sovereigns that ever bore rule in the Soudan.

Capt. Clapperton {Travels and Discoveries in Northern and Central Africa, 1822 — 1824) made the acquaintance of this monarch. From a large geographical and historical work by him, Capt. Clapperton made a copious extract, from which the following is taken : — " Yarba is an extensive province containing rivers, forests, sands and mountains, as also a great many wonderful and extraordinary things. In it, the talking green bird called babaga (parrot) is found."

" By the side of this province there is an anchorage or harbour for the ships of the Christians, who used to go there and purchase slaves. These slaves were exported from our country and sold to the people of Yarba, who resold them to the Christians."

" The inhabitants of this province (Yarba) it is supposed originated from the remnant of the children of Canaan, who were of the tribe of Nimrod. The cause of their establishment in the West of Africa was, as it is stated, in consequence of their being driven by Yar-rooba, son of Kahtan, out of Arabia to the Western Coast between Egypt and Abyssinia. From that spot they advanced into the interior of Africa, till they reach Yarba where they fixed their residence. On their way they left in every place they stopped at, a tribe of their own people. Thus it is supposed that all the tribes of the Soudan who inhabit the mountains are

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originated from them as also are the inhabitants of Ya-ory. Upon the whole, the people of Yarba are nearly of the same description as those of Noofee (Nupe)^"

In the name Lamurudu (or Namurudu) we can easily recognize a dialectic modification of the name Nimrod. Who this Nimrod was, whether Nimrod surnamed " the strong," the son of Hasoiil, or Nimrod the " mighty hunter " of the Bible, or whether both descriptions belong to one and the same person, we cannot tell, but this extract not only confirms the tradition of their origin but also casts a side light on the legend. Arabia is probably the " Mecca " of our tradition. It is known that the descendants of Nimrod (Phoenicians) were led in war to Arabia, that they settled there, and from thence they were driven by a rehgious persecution to Africa. We have here also the origin of the term Yoruba, from Yarba, their first permanent settlement in Africa. Yarba is the same as the Hausa term Yarriba for Yoruba.

It is very curious that in the history of Mahomet we read of a similar flight of his first converts from Mecca to the East Coast of Africa (the first Hegira), due also to a religious persecution; this fact will serve to show that there is nothing improbable in the accounts as received by tradition. Again, that they emigrated from Upper Egypt to He Ife may also be proved by those sculptures commonly known as the " Ife Marbles," several of which may be seen at He Ife to this day, said to be the handiwork of the early ancestor of the race. They are altogether Egyptian in form. The most notable of them is what is known as the " Opa Orafiyan," (Orafiyan's staff) an obelisk standing on the site of Oraiiyan's supposed grave, having characters cut in it

which suggest a Phoenician origin. Three or four of these sculptures may now be seen in the Egyptian Court of the British Museum, showing at a glance that they are among kindred works of art.

From these statements and traditions, whether authentic or mythologic, the only safe deductions we can make as to the mosit probable origin of the Yorubas are : —

1. That they sprang from Upper Egypt, or Nubia.
2. That they were subjects of the Egyptian conqueror Nimrod, who was of Phoenician origin, and that they followed him in his wars of conquest as far as Arabia, where they settled for a time. How subjects term themselves " children " or offspring of their

ˆ Vide Narratives of Travels and Discoveries, by Major Denham and Capt. Clapperton, 1826. Appendix XII., Sec. IV.

A' Tropical Dependency, by Flora L.Shaw (Lady Lugard), 1905, pp. 227 — 228.

sovereigns is too well-known in this country, as we shall see in the course of this history.

3. That from Arabia they were driven, on account of their practising there their own form of worship, which was either paganism or more likely a corrupt form of Eastern Christianity (which allowed of image worship — so distasteful to Moslems).

Again, the name of the priest " Asara " is also a peculiar one ; it is so much like " Anasara " a term which Moslems generally applied to Christians (which signifies ' followers of the Nazarene ') as to make it probable that the revolution spoken of was in connection rather with Mohammedanism, and the corrupt form of Christianity of those days.

Lastly, the sacred rehc called Idi from its being bound up and preserved, and which is supposed to have been a copy of the Koran, is probably another error. Copies of the Koran abound in this country, and they are not venerated thus, and why should this have become an object of worship ? The sacred book of the party opposed to them ! One can hardly resist coming to the conclusion that the book was not the Koran at all, but a copy of the Holy Scriptures in rolls, the form in which ancient manuscripts were preserved. The Koran being the only sacred book known to later generations which have lost all contact with Christianity for centuries after the great emigration into the heart of Africa, it is natural that their historians should at once jump to the conclusion that the thing bound up was the Koran. It might probably then be shown that the ancestors of the Yorubas, hailing from Upper Egypt, were either Coptic Christians, or at any rate that they had some knowledge of Christianity. If so, it might offer a solution of the problem of how it came about that traditional stories of the creation, the deluge, of Elijah, and other scriptural characters are current amongst them, and indirect stories of our Lord, termed " son of Moremi."

But let us continue the story as given by tradition. Oduduwa and his sons swore a mortal hatred of the Moslems of their country, and were determined to avenge themselves of them ; but the former died at He Ife before he was powerful enough to march against them. His eldest son Okcinbi, commonly called Idekoseroake, also died there, leaving behind him seven princes and princesses who afterwards became renowned. From them sprang the various tribes of the Yoruba nation. His first-born was a princess who was married to a priest, and became the mother of the famous Olowu, the ancestor of the Owns. The second child was also a princess who became the mother of the Alaketu, the progenitor of the Ketu people. The third, a prince, became king of the

Benin people. The fourth, the Orangun, became king of Ila ; the fifth, the Onisabe, or king of the Sabes ; the sixth, 01up6po, or king of the Popos ; the seventh and last born, Orafiyan, who was the progenitor of the Yorubas proper, or as they are better distinguished Oyos.

All these princes became kings who wore crowns as distinguished from those who were vassals who did not dare to wear crowns, but coronets called Akoro, a high-crowned head-gear, embroidered with silver.

But it may be remarked that the Olowu's father was a commoner, and not a prince of the blood, and yet he became one of the crowned heads. The following anecdote will explain how this came about. The Yoruba princesses had (and still have) the Hberty of choosing husbands according to their fancy from any rank in life ; the King's eldest daughter chose to marry her father's priest, for whom she had the Olowu.

This young prince was one day playing on his grandfather's knees, and he pulled at the crown on his head ; the indulgent parent thereupon placed it on the child's head, but Hke some spoiled children, he refused to give it up when required, and so it was left with him, the grandfather putting on another. The child had the crown on his head until he fell asleep in his mother's arms, when she took it off and returned it to her father, but the latter told her to keep it for her son, as he seemed so anxious to have it. Hence the right of the Olowu to wear the crown like his uncles. The same right was subsequently accorded to the Alaketu, i.e., the progenitor of the Ketu people.

It was stated above that Orafiyan was the youngest of Oduduwa's grandchildren, but eventually he became the richest and most renowned of them all. How this came about is thus told by tradition : —

On the death of the King, their grandfather, his property was unequally divided among his children as follows : —

The King of Benin inherited his money (consisting of cowry shells), the Orangun of Ila his wives, the King of Sabe his cattle, the Olupopo the beads the Olowu the garments, and the Alaketu the crowns, and nothing was left for Orafiyan but the land. Some assert that he was absent on a warlike expedition when the partition was made, and so he was shut out of all movable properties. Oranyan was, however, satisfied with his portion, which he proceeded forthwith to turn to good account with the utmost skill. He held his brothers as tenants living on the land which was his ; for rents he received money, women, cattle, beads, garments, and crowns, which were his brothers' portions, as all these were more

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or less dependent on the soil, and were deriving sustenance from it. And he was the one selected to succeed the father as King in the direct line of succession. ^ To his brothers were assigned the various provinces over which they ruled more or less independently, Oranyan himself being placed on the throne as the AlAfin or Lord of the Royal Palace at He Ife.

According to another account, Oranyan had only a bit of rag left him, containing earth, 21 pieces of iron, and a cock. The whole surface of the earth was then covered with water. Oraiiyan laid his portion on the surface of the water, and placed on it the cock, which scattered the earth with his feet ; the wide expanse of water became filled up, and the dry land appeared everywhere. His brothers preferring to live on dry land rather than on the surface of the water were permitted to do so on their paying an annual tribute for sharing with their younger brother his own portion.

It will be noticed that both traditions attribute the land to Oraiiyan ; hence the common saying " Alafin I'oni ile " (the Alafin is the lord of the land) : the pieces of iron representing underground treasures, and the cock such as subsist on the land.

The former account seems more probable, the latter being httle else but a travesty of the story of the creation or the flood. But it is fair to mention that the more generally received opinion is, that Oranyan became more prosperous than his brothers owing to the fact of his living virtuously, they bemg given up to a life of unrestrained licentiousness ; and being also by far the bravest of them all, he was preferred above them and was seated on the ancestral throne at Ile Ife which was then the capital of the Yoruba

The Alake and the Owa of Ilesa are said to be nearly related to the Alafin ; the former was said to be of the same mother with one of the earliest Alafins. This woman was called Ejo who afterwards took up her abode with her youngest son until her death : hence the common saying " Ejo ku Ake " Ejg* died at Ake.

The Owa of the Ijesas claimed to be one of the younger brothers, but his pedigree cannot now be traced; the term "brother" being a very elastic one in Yoruba and may be applied to any relative far or near, and even to a trusty servant or to one adopted

1 The reason assigned for this was that he was “born in the purple,” that is to say born after the father had become King. This was at one time the prevailing custom for the ” Aremo Ovh,” i.e., the first born from the throne, to succeed the father.

2 Ejo means a palaver. The phrase then means a case decided at Ake is final.

into the family. ^ In olden times when there was universal peace throughout the country, before the commencement of the destructive intertribal wars which broke up the unity of the kingdom and created the tribal independence, this relationship was acknowledged by the Owa paying a yearly tribute of a few heads of cowries, mats and some products of his forests to the AlAfin, while the latter sent him presents of tobes and vests, and other superior articles well worthy of him as an elder brother.

That the AlAfin, the Alake, and the Owa were children or grandchildren of Oraiiyan seems probable from the fact that to this day none of them is considered properly installed until the sword of state brought from He Ife where Oraiiyan was buried is placed in his hands.

Oraiiyan was a nickname of the prince his proper name being Odede. He was a man of great physical powers. He first obtained renown as a mighty hunter ; and in process of time he also became, like Nimrod, a mighty conqueror.

The expedition against Mecca. — When Oraiiyan was sufficiently strong, he set off for an expedition against ” Mecca ” to which he summoned his brothers, to avenge the death of their great-grandfather, and the expulsion of his party from that city. He left Adimu one of his father’s trusty servants in charge of the royal treasures and the charms, with a strict injunction to observe the customary worship of the national gods Idi and Orisa Osi.

This is an office of the greatest importance pertaining to the King himself • but how slaves or high servants are often entrusted with the duties of the master himself is well-known in this country as we shall see in the course of this history.

It is said that the route by which they came from ” Mecca ” and which occupied 90 days, was by this time rendered impassable owing to an army of black ants blocking up the path, and hence, Oraiiyan was obliged to take another route which led through the Nupe or Tapa Country. All his brothers but the eldest joined him, but at Igangan they quarrelled over a pot of beer and dispersed refusing to follow his lead. The eldest brother calculating the distance through the Tapa country lost courage and went eastward promising to make his attack from that quarter should his brother Oraiiyan be successful in the West.* . Orafiyan pushed on until he found himself on the banks of the River Niger.

The Tapas are said to have opposed his crossing the river, and as he could not force his way through, he was obhged to remain for a while near the banks, and afterwards resolved to retrace his

^ A fuller account will be found under “The origin of the Ijesas.” “^ The geography of our historians may be excused. — Ed,

steps. To return, however, to He Ife was too humiliating to be thought of, and hence he consulted the King of Ibariba near whose territory he was then encamping as to where he should make his residence. Tradition has it, that the King of Ibariba made a charm and fixed it on a boa constrictor and advised Orafiyan to follow the track of the boa and wherever it remained for 7 days and then disappeared, there he was to build a town. Orariyan and his army followed his directions and went after the boa up to the foot of a hill called Ajaka where the reptile remained 7 days, and then disappeared. According to instructions Oranyan halted there, and built a town called Oyo Ajaka. This was the ancient city of Oyo marked in ancient maps as Eyeo or Katunga (the latter being the Hausa term for Oyo) capital of Yarriba (see Webster’s pronouncing Gazetteer). This was the Eyeo visited by the EngHsh explorers Clapperton and the Landers.

Orafiyan remained and prospered in the new home, his decendants spread East, West, and South-west ; they had a free communication with He Ife, and the King often sent to Adimu for whatever was required by him

out of the royal treasures for the new city.

In process of time Adimu made himself great because he was not only the worshipper of the national deities, but also the custodian and dispenser of the King's treasures, and he was commonly designated " Adimu Ola " i.e. Adimu of the treasures, or Adimu 1^ i.e. Adimu is become wealthy.

But this Adimu who became of so much consequence from his performing royal functions was originally the son of a woman condemned to death, but being found at the time of execution to be in the way of becoming a mother she was temporarily reprieved, until the child was born. This child at its birth was dedicated to the perpetual service of the gods, especially the god Obatala, to which his mother was to have been sacrificed. He was said to be honest, faithful and devoted to the King as to his own father, and therefore he was loved and trusted.

When Adimu was announced to the Kings and Princes all around as the person appointed by the King to take charge of the treasures, and to worship the national deities during his absence, it was generally asked " And who is this Adimu ? The answer comes " Omo Oluwo ni " the son of a sacrificial victim : this is contracted to Ow6ni (Oluwo being the term for a sacrificial victim). So in subsequent years when the seat of government was removed permanently to Oyo but not the National Deities, Adimu became supreme at He Ife and his successors to this day have been termed the Olorisas i.e. high priests or fetish worshippers to the King, and people of the whole Yoruba nation. The name

Adimu has since been adopted as the agnomen, and the term Owoni as the title of the " Kings " or more properly the high priests of Ife to this day, the duties of the office being not local or tribal, but national.

According to another account, after the death of Okknbi, Oraiiyan having succeeded and assumed the command emigrated to Oko where he reigned and where he died, and the seat of government was removed thence in the reign of Sango to Oyokoro, i.e., the aforesaid ancient City of Oyo.

Oraiiyan may have actually died at Oko, but his grave with an obelisk over it is certainly shown at He Ife to this day. It is a custom among the Yorubas — a custom observed to this day — to pare the nails and shave the head of any one who dies at a considerable distance from the place where they would have him buried. These relics are taken to the place of interment, and there decently buried, the funeral obsequies being scrupulously observed as if the corpse itself were buried there. Hence although (as we have on probable grounds assumed) Oraiiyan may have died at Oko, and the art of embalming lost or unknown, his relics could thus have been taken to He Ife where to this day he is supposed to have been buried. A more romantic account of his death, however, will be given in Part II of this history.

As the Yorubas worship the dead, and have the belief that prayers offered at the grave of deceased ancestors are potent to procure temporal blessings, all succeeding Yoruba Kings on their accession and before coronation are expected to send to perform acts of worship at the grave of Oduduwa and to receive the benediction of the priest. The sword of justice known as Ida Oranyan (Oranyan's sword) is to be brought from He Ife and ceremoniously placed in their hands ; without this being done, the King has no authority whatever to order an execution. Orafi5^an's descendants in process of time were divided into four distinct famihes, known by their distinctive dialects, and forming the four provinces of Yoruba proper viz. the Ekun Otun, Ekun Osi, Ibolo and Epo provinces. The Ekun Otun and Ekun Osi or right and left, i.e., Eastern and Western provinces are the towns lying to the East and West of the City of Oyo.

I. The Ekun Otun or Western province included all the towns along the right bank of the River Ogun down to Ibere kodo, Igana being the chief town. The other important towns are : — Skki, Oke'ho, Ise5nn, Iwawun, Eruwa, Iberekodo, etc. In this province two distinct dialects are spoken ; the people inhabiting the outermost borders are known as Ibai^apas and are distinguished by a nasal twang in their speech.

2. The Ekun Osi or Metropolitan province comprised all the towns east of Oyo, including Kihisi and Igboho in the north, Ikoyi being the chief town. Other important towns are, Ilorin Irawo, Iwere, Ogbomoso etc. including the Igbonas in the utmost limit eastwards, and the Igbon-nas as far as Or6.

The Igbdnas are distinguished by a peculiar dialect of their own. The Ekun Osi Oyos are regarded as speaking the purest Yoruba. The ancient cit}' of Oyo alsp lies in this province.

3. The Ibolo province lies to the south-east of the Ekun Osi towns as far down as Ede, Iresa being the chief town. The other important towns are Ofa (?) Oyan, Okuku, Ikirun, Osogbo, Ido, Ilobu, Ejigbo, Ede.

4. The Epos are the towns lying to the South and South-west of Oyo the chief town of which is Idode. Other important towns in this division are : Masifa, Ife odan, Ara. Iwo, Ilora, Akinmoirin Fiditi, Awe, Ago Oja.

They are called Epos (i.e. weeds) because they were then in the remotest part of the kingdom, rude and uncouth in manners, very deceitful, and far from being as loyal as the other tribes. The Owns were usually reckoned amongst them, but they are rather a distinct tribe of Yoruba although now domiciled amongst the Egbas.

Great changes have been effected in these divisions by means of the revolutionary wars that altered the face of the country about the early part of the XlXth century.

In the Ekun Otun district Igana has lost its importance and its place taken by Iseyin.

In 'the Ekun Osi, Ikoyi the chief town has been destroyed by Ilorin, and Ilorin itself brought under foreign allegiance by the Fulanis. The city of Oyo now lies in ruins, its name and position being transferred to Ago Oja in the Epo district. In the Ibglg district Iresa has ceased to exist being absorbed by Ilorin and its place taken by Ofa, which in its turn was partially destroyed by the Ilorins in 1887 with several other towns in this district. Modakeke a large and growing town, peopled by Oygs of the Ekun Osi, has sprung up in the Ife district just beyond the borders of the Ibolgs.

Owu has been destroyed never more to be rebuilt.

The Epo district now includes Ibadan, Ijaye and other towns formerly belonging to the Gbaguras. Idode has ceased to be the dhief town, that position now properly belongs to Iwo, being a royal city. But Ibadan which was originally an Egba village then the military station of the confederate army which destroyed the city of Owu and the Egba villages, and afterwards a settled Oyg town, has by means of its mihtary force assumed the lead not only

over the Epo district, but also over a large area of the country as well. It has a mixed population including every tribe of the Yorubas.

Ijaye formerly an Egba town became peopled by Qyos chiefly from the 5kun Osi (Ikoyi) districts.

All these including hundreds of important towns within the area are peopled by Yorubas proper or Oyos as they are generally called, and constitute the more important portion of Yoruba proper.

The Egbas, who were for the most part off-shoots of these, and formerly Uving in hamlets and villages independently of one another have through the exigencies of these wars collected themselves from 153 hamlets or " townships " to form one town, Abeokuta. A further account of this will be given in its place. All these are reckoned as descendants of Orariyan.

By the advent also of the white men from the coast, the centre of light and civilization has removed to the south, so that the Epos may soon cease to be the " weeds " of the country, as they may receive the inspiration of civilization from the south instead of from the north as hitherto.

Chapter II THE ORIGIN OF THE TRIBES

All the various tribes of the Yoruba nation trace their origin from Oduduwa and the city He If§. In fact He Ife is fabled as the spot where God created man, white and black, and from whence they dispersed all over the earth. We have seen in the previous chapter which are the principal tribes that sprang from Oduduwa's seven grandchildren, viz. : The Yorubas proper from Orafiyan, the Benins, Has, Owns, Ketus, Sabes, and

the Popos. Some of the other tribes were offshoots of one or other of these, as we shall see further on. Some authentic tradition will be given relative to the formation of some of them.

An important fact which must also be borne in mind is, that the country was not altogether unpeopled when Oduduwa and his party entered it from the East ; the probabiUty is, that the aboriginal inhabitants were conquered and absorbed, at least at the central if not at the remote provinces of the Yoruba kingdom.

In ancient patriarchal times, the king of a country was regarded as the father or progenitor of his people. This view will to some extent explain what would otherwise appear to be a marvellous (if not impossible) instance of fecundity in any one king, e.g., Orafiyan peopling so vast a region as that attributed to him, in so short a time — the more warlike the king, the more extensive his dominion, and the more numerous, it would seem, his progeny.

In fact we may almost take it as proved that as Orafiyan and his army, as well as his brothers', pushed on their conquests in every direction, the princes and the war-lords were stationed in various parts to hold the country, and from them sprang the many provincial kings of various ranks and grades now existing.

This also accounts for the tradition that the Yoruba sway once extended as far as Ashanti and included the Gas of Accra, for the Gas say that their ancestors came from He Ife ; and the constitution of the Ga language is said to be more like Yoruba than hke Fanti, the language of the Gold Coast, and the area in which that language is spoken is strictly hmited. And, certainly, until comparatively recent times the Popos and Dahomians paid tribute regularly to Oyo as their feudal head ; it is certain, therefore, that the generals and war-lords of Orafiyan pushed on far beyond the Umits of the Yoruba country as now known, and although in places remote from

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the centre, as the Benins and Sekiris in the east and the Popos, Dahomians and Gas in the west, the Yoruba language is not spoken, yet the knowledge of it exists among the ruling chiefs and the priestly caste who still maintain their connection with He Ife, the place of their common origin. This view will also to some extent explain the mutual understanding and bond of sympathy existing between the Ifes, Ekitis, and allied families as remnants of the largely diluted aboriginal elements still having many things in common, and their natural antipathy — more or less — to the Oyos or Yorubas Proper.

It is also worthy of remark that all the principal rulers of the country, to show the validity of their claims, must trace their relationship by one way or another to the AlAfin of Oyo, who is the direct descendant of Orafiyan, son and successor of Oduduwa, the founder ; which simply impHes that the children and offspring of the conqueror are the chief rulers over the different parts of the conquered territories.

Yoruba Proper

Oranyan was already distinguished as a brave and war-like prince during his father's lifetime, and he probably owed his succession to this fact, as was usual in those stormy times. On his accession to the throne, when he set out from lie Ife on his famous expedition to " Mecca " to avenge the death of his great grandfather, he was certainly accompanied by his conquering hordes ; and if we trace his route from He Ife northwards to the banks of the Niger, whence he turned westward to the borders of the Baribas, and then to the ancient Oyo (Eyeo) which he founded, and where he settled, and from whence he spread southwards towards the coast, we shall see that the people embraced in this vast region, viz., with the Ifes in the east, the Niger on the north, the Baribas on the west as well as the Dahomians, and the Egbados on the south, are those known as the Yorubas Proper, or as they are generally termed by the other tribes the Oyqs, and are the so-called descendants of Orafiyan, and the cream of his conquering army. These then constitute Yorubas Proper.

We have stated in a previous chapter how they are divided into four distinct provinces, but there has always been among them a bond of sympathy and union, apart from what they have in common with the other tribes. They have always retained their loyalty — more or less — to the successors of Orafiyan, their common father, even when the revolutionary wars left the country no longer united under one head as in the days of Sango down to those of Abiodun

The Egbas

The Egbas are a small offshoot of the Yorubas Proper, who occupy the south-eastern districts of that province. They originally occupied the area bounded by certain imaginary lines drawn, say, from Ijaye to meet the Ogun River at Olokemeji, and along it to its mouth, and another from the same point via Ibadan to the west of Jebu Remo down to the coast. They lived in hamlets and villages for the most, part independently of one another, and never under one rule. All the principal families of the Egbas trace their origin from Oyo, hence the common saying " Egbas who have not their root in Oyo are slaves," i.e., belong to the conquered aboriginal population. Most of the chiefs sprang from the Esos of Oyo. It would seem then that during the wars of conquest, a number of these warhke Esgs, under the leadership of the King's half-brother, was detached from the main army, carrying their arms to those regions where they subsequently settled, in the immediate neighbourhood of the Owns. Abeokuta, as we now know it, of course had no existence then. Each of what is now called the " townships " was a separate village or hamlet with its own chief ; they were loosely grouped into three divisions, but rather independent of one another, but all acknowledging the King's brother (the Alake) as their Primus. They were :

1. Egba Agbeyin. These were the Egbas proper, and nearest the I jebu Remos. The principal towns were : Ake, the chief town, Ijeun, Kemta, Iporo, Igbore, etc.
2. Egba Oke Ona, i.e., those situated near the banks of the River Odo Ona. Oko the chief town, Ikereku, Ikija, Idomapa, Odo, Podo, etc. Their chief is called the Osile.
3. Egba Agura or Gbagura : these were situated near the Oyo districts, and indeed they contain genuine Oyos in large numbers, and generall}'^ they partake of their characteristics largely, hence they are nick-named " Oyos among Egbas." The principal towns were : Agura the chief, Ilugun, Ibadan, Ifaye, Ika, Ojo, Ilawo,

The Egbas were on the whole few in number, and occupied a limited territory ; this can very well be proved by the fact, that after a period of more than half a century, they have been compelled by stress of circumstances to live together within one wall, and in spite of large accessions from other tribes, they still form but a single large town. Situated, as they were then, far from the centre of life and activity, they were little thought of. They had no separate king because all the principal chiefs and distinguished personages were office bearers of the AlAfin, hence

the common saying, " Egba ko I'olu, gbogbo nwon ni nse hi Oba " (Egbas have no King, they are all of them like masters) " Olu wa' rOyo " (The King is at Oyo). It may be noted, that every child born to a reigning Alake must have an Oyo facial mark ; and that is so to this day. In early times the Alake ranks among the junior members of the Royal Family ; for that reason there has never been a distinct royal family arnong the Egbas. The chief rulers in each division were usually elected (by divination) from any one of the 153 townships ; an Ikija man for instance has been " king " of Itesi, an Ijeun man an Alake, etc., as we shall see in the Appendix. In this respect also the Gbaguras differ from the others.

In later times, at Abeokuta, one Jibode, a wealthy trader and traveller, who vainly endeavoured to obtain the Primacy of Ake, left children and grandchildren who eventually attained the coveted position, which was a singular instance of more than one member of a family becoming an Alake, ^ but then they were all born in different townships.

The Osile is said to be an unfortunate title because, more than any of the other divisions, the Oke Ona people were more ptone to slaughter human victims ; everytime the Osile entered the Ogboni house, he must walk on the blood of a male victim, and when he comes out on that of a female ! Also that Osiles never die a natural death ; when their excesses became unbearable they were usually stoned to death ; hence the appellation of their chief town, " Oko " — i.e., a pelting stone. For that reason the Egbas were reluctant to resuscitate the title at Abeokuta until Governor McCallum of Lagos in 1897 on the occasion of the Queen's Diamond Jubilee ordered the Egbas and others to reorganise their government, and fill up vacant titles.

Since the destruction of the City of Owu (as we shall see below) and the unification of the Egba villages, the Owus have domiciled amongst them. Hence the so-called Four United Kings of the Egbas : although Owu is not Egba.

The Ijebus

The origin of the Ijebus has been variously given ; one account makes them spring from the victims offered in sacrifice by the King of Benin to the god of the ocean, hence the term Ijebu from Ije-ibu, i.e., the food of the deep. The Ijebus themselves

'The case of Gbadebo, son of Okukenu, occurred subsequently to the estabhshment of the British Protectorate.

claim to have descended from Oba-nita, as they say of themselves, " Ogetiele, eru Obanita," i.e., Ogetiele/ servants of Obanita.

But who was this Oba-nita ? Tradition says he also was a victim of sacrifice by the Olowu or King of Owu. It was said that the Olowu offered in sacrifice a human being where two roads cross ; this was termed " Ebo-ni-ita," a sacrifice on the highway, the victim being mangled and left for dead ; he, however, revived at night, and crawled away into the forest, where he subsequently recovered and survived. He lived on fruits, on the chase, and then did a bit of farming. With an access of population, being the oldest man met in those parts, he was regarded as the father, and subsequent generations call him their ancestor, and so the Ijebu tribe was formed, and the term " Ebonita " (a sacrifice on the highway) was converted to " Obanita " (a king on the highway). There was really nobody of that name. A forest is still shown near the village of Aha where he is annually worshipped, from whence he was supposed to have ascended into heaven.

It is rather curious that both accounts should have made them descended from victims of human sacrifices. This latter account is reconcilable with the former, which says they are " the food of the deep," for the population of which Ebonita was the head may have been largely augmented by the victims of the ocean so as to give the name Ije-ibu to the whole of them.

There are also other important facts and curious coincidences connected with the Ijebus which have strong bearings on this tradition of their origin.

1. Of all the Yoruba tribes, with the exception of the Ifes they were the most addicted to human sacrifices, which they practised up to 1892 when the country was conquered by the Enghsh. The 'ictim also usually offered to " Obanita " annually was always a human being, but this was never killed ; he was, however, always acted upon in some way or other unknown (by magic arts) that he always became demented, and left to wander about sheepishly in the Aha Forest, until he perished there. This is, no doubt, due to the fact that the ancestor " Ebonita " himself, when a victim, was not killed outright.

2. They were, before the conquest, the most exclusive and inhospitable of the whole of the tribes. Very few, if any, outsiders were ever known to have walked through the country with impunity under any circumstance whatever ; not a few of those who attempted to do so were never seen nor heard of any more !

^An untranslatable word, an onomatopoeic expression for whatever is immense and magnificent.

Commercial transactions with outsiders were carried on in the frontier or in the borders of neighbouring towns.

3. And if the latter account of their origin from the Owu victim be the correct one, it is very singular indeed that it was mainly due to the Ijebus with their firearms that the Owns owed their fall and complete annihilation as an independent state to this day. A full account of this will be given in due course.

The King of the Ijebus is known as the Awujale. His origin was thus given by authentic tradition, the event with which it is connected having occurred within authentic history :

There were formerly two important towns called Owu Ipole and Iseyin Odo in a district between the Owns and If §s ; they were settlements from the city of Owu and Iseyin respectively. A quarrel once arose between them on the matter of boundaries, and the dispute having been carried on for many years, developed into an open fight, and both the Olowu and the Owoni of Ife (both being interested parties) were unable to put an end to the strife. Messengers were now sent to the King at Oyo who sent out a special Ilari and a large number of attendants to put an end to the strife. The person of an Ilari being inviolable, he came and settled down between the two contending parties, in the midst of the disputed plot, and thus compelled them to keep, the peace. The Ilari was named " Agbejaile or Alajaile " (an arbiter of landed dispute). This term was subsequently sof termed, down to Awujale.^ This event occurred during the reign of King Jayin.

As it was customary to pay royal honours to the King's messengers out of courtesy, this Ilari was accorded royal honours in due form, and he remained there permanently and became the King of that region over the Ijebus who up to that time had no tribal " king " of their own and rather held themselves aloof from their neighbours. Subsequently he removed to Ode. The Awujale ranks after the Oyo provincial kings such as the Onikoyi, Olafa, Aresa, Aseyin.

Origin of the Ijesas and Ekitis

Two accounts are given of the origin of the Ijesas ; both may practically be regarded as in the main correct, so far as they are not really contradictory ; for it would appear that the Ijesas of the present day are not the same people or, rather, not the descendants of the aboriginal inhabitants of that province.

The first account relates to the earUest period when the Yorubas have just entered into, and subdued, the country, and the AlAfins

^An Ilari title at Oyo to this day.

then resided at He lie, i.e., prior to the reign of Sango. Human sacrifices were common in those days, and in order to have victims ready to hand, it is said that a number of slaves were purchased and located in the district of Ibokun ; there they were tended as cattle, under the care of Owaju, and from them selections were made from time to time for sacrificial purposes ; hence the term Ijesa from Ije Orisa (the food of the gods). They are described as stumpy, muscular, and sheepish-looking, with a marked want of intelhgence : they never cJffered any resistance to this system, hence the saying "Ijesa Omo Owaju ti ife opo iyk" (Ijesas children of Owaju, subject to much sufferings). There is also a legend that when the nations began to disperse from He Ife and members of the Royal Family were appointed kings and rulers in divers places, a young and brave scion of the house was appointed the first Owa or king over the Ijesas, but that he returned to the AlAfin and complained that his territory was tocv small, and his subjects few, the sire thereupon ordered a large bundle of sticks to be brought to him, and these sticks he converted into human beings for the Owa, in order to increase the number of his subjects. Hence to this day the Ijesas are often termed by their neighbours " Qmo igi " (offspring of sticks !)

This, of course, is a pure myth invented by their more wily neighbours to account for the notorious characteristics of the Ijesas generally, who are as proverbially deficient in wit as they are remarkably distinguished for brute strength.

But one fact holds good down even to our days, viz., that up to the recent total abohtion of human sacrifice by the British Government (1893) the Ifes, who, far more than any other, were addicted to the practice, always preferred for the purpose to have an Ijesa victim to any other ; such sacrifices were considered more acceptable, the victims being the " food of the gods."

This preference was the cause of more than one threatened rupture between the Ifes and their Ijesa aUies during the recent 16 years' war, and would certainly have developed into open fights, but for the Ibadan army vis-d-vis threatening them both.

The other account relates chiefly to the present day Ijesas of Ilesa (the home of the gods) the chief town. According to this account, they hailed from the Ekitis ; or as some would more correctly have it, they were the Ijesas from the neighbourhood of Ibokun who first migrated to Ipole near Ondo, and thence back to Ilesa. It appears that a custom then prevailed of going out hunting for their king three months in the year, and on one such occasion they found game so plentiful in the neighbourhood of Ilesa, the chmate very agreeable, the country well-watered, and

the Ijesas there extremely simple, peaceful, and unwarhke (probably the remnants and descendants of the old sacrificial victims) whilst at home they endured much oppression from their Owa, that they there and then conceived and carried out the idea of settling on the spot at once, making it their home, and of reducing into subjection the aboriginal inhabitants.

These objects were easily enough accompHshed ; but they spared the principal chief, a kindly old gentleman who had an extensive garden plantation. He was called " Oba Ila," i.e., Okra king, from his Okra plantation, and he was placed next in rank to the chief of the marauders. That nickname is continued to the present time as a title Oba'la^ and is conferred on the most distinguished chief after the Owa of Ilesa. It would appear then that although the term Ijesa is retained by the people of that district, and those who are ignorant of the origin of the term take some pride in it, yet it is evident that the present inhabitants are not all of them the descendants of the aboriginal settlers, the " food of the gods," but are largely from the Ekitis by admixture ; the pure type Ijesas are now and again met with at Ilesa and neighbourhood.

This fact is fuither shown by the want of homogeneity amongst the principal chiefs of Ilesa at the present day, for when the town was growing, the settlers did cast about for help ; they sought for wiser heads to assist them in the building up and the management of their country, e.g., from the Oyos or Yorubas Proper they had the Odgle from Irehe, the Esawe from Ora, the Saloro from Oyo (the ancient city), and the Sorundi also from the same city — all these came with a large number of followers ; from the Ondos, the 'Loro, and the Salosi from I jama in the Ondo district ; from the Ekitis, the Arapate from Ara, the Lejoka from Itaje ; and lastly, the Ogboni from the white cap chiefs of Lagos, the only one privileged to have on his headgear in the presence of the Owa. The Owa himself is as we have seen, a junior member of the royal house of Oyo.

It is also said that when the town of Ilesa was to be laid out a special messenger was sent to the AlAfin to ask for the help of one of the princes to lay out the town on the same plan as the ancient city of Oyo. That prince ruled for some years at Ilesa.

The Ekitis

The Ekitis are among the aboriginal elements of the country absorbed by the invaders from the East. The term Ekiti denotes a Mound, and is derived from the rugged mountainous feature of

^Often miscalled Obanla by young Ije§as outside Ilesa.

the country. It is an extensive province and well watered, including several tribes and families right on to the border of the Niger, eastward. They hold themselves quite distinct from the Ijesas, especially in pohtical affairs. The Ekiti country is divided into i6 districts, each with its own Owa or King (Owa being a generic term amongst them) of which four are supreme, viz. : —

1. The 6w6re of Otun 3. The Elewi of Ado
2. The Ajero of Ijero 4. The Elekole of Ikole

The following are the minor Ekiti kings : —

5. Alara of Ara it. Qlgja Oke of Igbo Odo
6. Alaye of Efon Ahaye 12. Oloye of Oye
7. Ajanpanda of Akure 13. Olomuwo of Omuwo

8. Alagotun of Ogotun 14. Onire of Ire
9. Olojudo of Ido 15. Arinjale of Ise
10. Ata of Aiyede 16. Onitaji of Itaji

The Orangun of Ila is sometimes classed among them, but he is only Ekiti in sympathy, being of a different family.

An Ijesa account of the Owa ot Ilesa and some of the principal Ekiti kings :

The Olofin (? Alafin) king of Ife had several children, grandchildren, and great grandchildren ; amongst them were, the king of Ado or Benin, the King of Oyg, the Osomowe of Ondo (from a daughter), the Alara of Ara, the Ajero of Ijero, the Alaye of Efon, the Owore of Otun, the Orangun of Ila, the Aregbajo of Igbajo, the Owa Ajaka of Ilesa. When the Olofin became bhnd from old age he was much depressed in mind from this cause ; efforts were put forth to effect his cure, all of which proved fruitless, when a certain man came forward and prescribed for him a sure remedy which among other ingredients contained salt water. He put the case before his children, but none made any effort to procure some for him save his youngest grandson. This was a very brave and warlike prince who bore the title of Esinkin amongst the King's household warriors, a title much alHed to that of the Kakanfo, He was surnamed Ajaka, i.e., one who fights everywhere, (on account of his procHvities) being fond of adventures. He volunteered to go and fetch some wherever procurable.

Having been away for many years and not heard of, the aged sire and every one else despaired of his ever coming back ; so the King divided his property amongst the remaining grown-up children. Although the Alado (king of Benin) was the eldest yet the Oloyg was the most beloved, and to him he gave the land, and told him to scour it all over, and settle nowhere till he came to a

slippery place, and there make his abode ; hence the term Oyg (shppery) and hence Oyos are such shppery customers !

After they had all gone and settled in their respective locaHties, all unexpectedly, the young adventurer turned up with water from the sea ! The monarch made use of it as per prescription and regained his sight ! Hence the Ijesas who subsequently became his subjects are sometimes termed " Omg Obokun," children of the brine procurer.

Having distributed all his property he had nothing left for Ajaka he therefore gave him a sword lying by his side with leave to attack any of his brothers, especially the Alara or Alado, and possess himself of their wealth, but should he fail, to retire back to him ; hence the appellation " Owa Ajaka Onida raharaha " (Owa the ubiquitous fighter, a man with a devastating sword).

The Owa Ajaka settled a Uttle way from his grandfather, and on one occasion he paid him a visit, and found him sitting alone with his crown on his head and — out of sheer wantonness — he cut off some of the fringes with his sword. The old man was enraged by this act, and swore that he would never wear a crown with fringes on.^

The Aregbajo was one of those who had a crown given to him, but the Owa Ajaka, paying him a visit on one occasion, saw it, and took it away, and never returned it : hence the kings of Igbajo never wear a crown to this day.

The Owa also attacked the Olojudo and defeated him, and took possession of his crown ; but he never put it on. On every public occasion however, it used to be carried before him. This continued to be the case until all the tribes became independent.

The Owa's mother, when married as a young bride, was placed under the care of the mother of the Qloyo, hence the AlAfin of Oyo often regarded the Owa as his own son.

The Orangun of Ila, and the Alara of Ara were his brothers of the same mother.

The Ow6ni of Ife was not a son of the Ololin, but the son of a female slave of his whom he offered in sacrifice. The Olefin kept the boy always by him, and when he sent away his sons, this httle boy took great care of him

and managed his household affairs well until his death : hence the Oloyo on succeeding the father authorised the boy to have charge of the palace and the city, and he sent to notify his brothers of this appointment. So whenever it was asked who was in charge of the house the answer invariably was

ˆOnly those with fringes on are really crowns.

" Omo Oluwo ni " (It is the son of the sacrificial victim). This has been contracted to the term Ow6ni.

The Owa and his brothers used to pay the AlAfin annual visits, with presents of firewood, fine locally-made mats, kola nuts and bitter kolas ; the Ow6re of Otun with sweet water from a cool spring at Otun — this water the AlAfin first spills on the ground as a Ubation before performing any ceremonies. The other Ekiti Kings used also to take with them suitable presents as each could afford, and bring away lavish presents from their elder brother.

This Ajaka subsequently became the Owa of the Ijesas.

The Ondos

The custom of killing twins prevailed all over the country in early times ; it has died out all over the greater part ot it so long ago, that no one can say precisely when or by whom a stop was put to it. But it happened once upon a time when the practice still prevailed that one of the wives of the AlAfin (King Ajaka) gave birth to twins, and the King was loth to destroy them, he thereupon gave orders that they should be removed — with the mother — to a remote part of the kingdom and there to remain and be regarded as dead.

So she left with a large number of friends and retinue to the site of the present Ode Ondo, then sparsely peopled by a tribe named Idoko, and there settled, hence the term " Ondo," signifying the " Settlers." The people of the district knowing who the strangers were, yielded them ready obedience, and the strangers became rulers of the district.

Probably it was from this time infanticide received its death blow — in Yoruba Proper at least. It is said to hnger still at Akure and the adjacent regions, but as a rule, in ancient times, whatever the custom set or discountenanced at the Metropohs, the effect thereof was rapidly felt all over the country.

The Ondos are sometimes classed among the Ekitis but that is hardly correct ; although lying at the border of the Ekitis, they are really a mixture of Qyos and Idokos, and their sympathy is with all.

Chapter III RELIGION

The Yorubas originally were entirely pagans. Mohammedanism which many now profess was introduced only since the close of the eighteenth century. They, however, believe in the existence of an Almighty God, him they term Olorun, i.e., Lord of Heaven.

They acknowledge Him, Maker of heaven and earth, but too exalted to concern Himself directly with men and their affairs, hence they admit the existence of many gods as intermediaries, and these they term Orisas.

We may note here that the term Olorun is appUed to God alone and is never used in the plural to denote Orisas. Kings and the great ones on earth may sometimes be termed Orisas (gods) by way of eulogy, we are also familiar with the common expression, " Oyinbo ekeji Orisa " i.e., white men are next to the -gods (i.e in their powers) ; but the term Olorun is reserved for the Great God alone.

They also beheve in a future state, hence the worship of the dead, and invocation of spirits as observed in the Egugun festival, a festival in which masked individuals personate dead relatives.

They have a belief also in a future judgment as may be inferred from the tollowing adage, " Ohungbogbo ti a se I'aiye, li a o de idena Orun ka " (Whatever we do on earth we shall give an account thereof at the portals of heaven).

They also believe in the doctrine of metempsychosis, or transmigration of souls, hence they affirm that after a period of time, deceased parents are born again into the family of their surviving children. It is from this

notion that some children are named " Babatunde," i.e., father comes again. " Yetunde," i.e., mother comes again.

Objects of Worship

I, TheKori. — Originally, the Kori was the only object of worship. It consists of the hard shells of the palm nut strung into beads, and made to hang from the neck to the knees. In modern times it is no longer regarded as an object of worship by adults, but little children go about with it to the market places begging for alms. The object of worship is then worn by one of their number, who goes before, his companions following behind him, shouting the

praises of the ancient god Kori. In this way they parade the market places, and sellers before whom they halt to sing, make them presents of money (cowries) or whatever they may happen to be seUing, usually articles of food. Thus the httle children perpetuate the memory and worship of this deity, hence the ditty :

Iba ma si ewe, Kori a ku o." (But for Httle children Kori had perished).

In later times heroes are venerated and deified, of these Sango, Oya, Orisa Oko, may be mentioned as the chief. The origin of their worship will be noted hereafter.

2. Orisala. — To Orisala are ascribed creative powers. He is regarded as a co-worker with Olorun. Man is supposed to have been made by God in a lump, and shaped as he is by Orisala. Its votaries are distinguished by white beads worn round the neck, and by their using only white dresses. They are forbidden the use of palm wine. Sacrifices offered by them are not to be salted. Albinoes, dwarfs, the lame, hunchbacks, and all deformed persons generally are regarded as sacred to this god ; hence they are designated " Eni Orisa" (belonging to the god), being regarded as specially made so by him.

Orisala is the common name of the god known and worshipped by different townships under different appellations, e.g., it is called Orisa Oluofin at Iwofin ; Orisako at Oko ; Orisakire at Ikire ; Orisagiyan at Ejigbo ; Orisaeguin at Eguin ; Orisarowu at Owu Orisajaye at Ijaye ; and Obatala at Oba.

3. Ori. — The Ori (head) is the universal household deity worshipped by both sexes as the god of fate. It is believed that good or ill fortune attends one, according to the will or decree of this god ; and hence it is propitiated in order that good luck might be the share of its votary. The representing image is 41 cowries strung together in the shape of a crown. This is secreted in a large coffer, the Hd of which is of the same form and material. It is called "He Ori" (Ori's house), and in size is as large as the owner can afford to make it. Some usually contain as much as 6 heads (12,000) of cowries, and the manufacturer who is generally a worker in leather receives as his pay the same amount of cowries as is used in the article manufactured.

As the Kori is the children's god so the Ori is exclusively worshipped by the adults. After the death of its owner, the image of Ori with the coffer is destroyed, and the cowries spent.

4. Ogun. — This is the god of war, and all instruments made of iron are consecrated to it, hence Ogun is the blacksmiths' god. The representing image is the silk cotton tree specially planted,

beneath which is placed a piece of granite on which palm oil is poured and the blood of slain animals — generally a dog.

5. Esu or Eleghara. — Satan, the Evil One, the author of all evil is often and specially propitiated. Offerings are made to it. The representing image is a rough lateritic stone upon which libations of palm oil are poured. It is superstitiously believed that the vengeance of this god could be successfully invoked upon an offender by the name of the person being called before the image while nut oil is being poured on it. The image of a man, with a horn on its head curving backwards, carved in wood and ornamented with cowries, is often carried by its devotees to beg with on pubUc highways. Passers-by who are so disposed may give each a cowry or two, or handfuls of corn, beans, or any product of the

field at hand, as he or she may choose. This curved headed figure is called " Ogo Eliggbara "—the devil's club.

6. Sgpona or the small pox is generally believed to be one of the demons by which this lower world is infested, and has its special devotees. The representing image is a broom- made from the branches of the bamboo palm, stripped of its leaves, and besmeared with camwood. To invoke its vengeance parched corn or beniseed is usually thrown hot upon the image, and then it is beUeved the epidemic will spread,. But they certainly have a more direct means of spreading the disease.

Persons dying of this plague are buried only by the devotees of this god, who account it as their special right to bury such corpses, being victims of the vengeance of their god. For a propitiation, they often demand from the relatives of the victims 5 head {i.e., 10,000) of cowries, a tortoise, a snail, a fowl, a pigeon, a goat, an armadillo, a ground pig, camwood, shea butter, a quantity of palm oil, two kinds of beads, green and yellow, called respectively Otutu and Opon, together with all the effects of the deceased, which are regarded as theirs by legitimate right. The corpse is buried either in the bush, or by the side of a river.

The following anecdote was related by a devotee. He was confirmed — said he — in his belief in the existence of the gods and as helpers in the government of the world from the following incident. Said he, " A young man once fell into a swoon, and having revived, he related the vision which he had seen. He said he saw the Great God sitting on a throne, covered with a flowing garment, attended on His right and left by Orisala and Ifa his counsellors : behind him was a pit into which the condemned were cast. Ogun and Sopona were ministers of his vengeance to execute justice upon offenders. Ogun armed with 4,000 swords (or daggers) went out daily to slay victims, his food being the blood of the slain. Sopona

also had 4,000 viols hung about his body. His also was the work of destruction as he disappeared immediately for another victim after presenting one. Sango also appeared, a mighty destroyer who, when about to set forth on his journey to earth, used to be cautioned by both Orisala and If a to deal gently with their respective worshippers."

It is with such stories as this that the credulity of the simple folk is usually wrought upon with a view to strengthen their behef in the so-called gods.

7. Egugnn. The period when the worship of spirits or the souls of departed relatives was introduced into the Yoruba country will be noted in a future chapter. The representing forms are human beings of the exact height and figure of the deceased, covered from head to foot with cloths similar to those in which the said deceased was known to have been buried, completely masked and speaking with an unnatural tone of voice. This feigned voice is said to be in imitation of that of a species of monkey called Ijimere. That animal is regarded with superstitious reverence, the power of walking erect and talking being ascribed to it and is esteemed a clever physician. Some professed " medicine men " usually tame and keep one of these creatures, and pretend to receive instructions and inspirations from it.

In these later times, the Egiigun worship has become a national religious institution, and its anniversaries are celebrated with grand festivities. The mysteries connected with it are held sacred and inviolable, and although little boys of 5 or 6 years of age are often initiated, yet no woman may know these mysteries on pain of death.

The dress of the Egugun consists of cloths of various colours or the feathers of- different kinds of birds, or the skins of different animals. The whole body from head to foot is concealed from view ; the Egugun seeing only from the meshes of a species of network covering the face, and speaking in a sepulchral tone ot voice. The women believe (or rather feign to believe) that the Eguguns came from the spirit world. An Egiigun (the Agan) is the executor of women accused of witchcraft, and of those who are proved guilty ot such crimes as murder, incendiarism, etc.

The high priest of the Egiigun is called the Alagb&, and next to him is the Alaran, and after this the Esorun, and then the Akere whose insignia of office are a bundle of Atori whips. These officials are higher in rank than all the Eguguns under the mask, and hence the common saying : — " Egugun baba Alagba, Alagba baba Egiigun " (The Egiigun is the father of the Alagba, the Alagba the father of the Egugun).

It is considered a crime to touch an Egugun dress in public, and disrespectful to pass him by with the head uncovered. Even a boy Egugun is considered worthy of being honoured by his (supposed) surviving parents, he salutes them as elderly people would do, and promises the bestowal of gifts on the family.

In every town there are several Alagbas or head priests of Egiigun out of them a president is elected, at whose house all the others meet on special occasions.

The individual who fills the highest rank in the Egugun worship is the Alapini, one of the seven great noble men of Oyo (the Oyo Mesi). He resides always in the royal city of Oyo. There can be but one Alapini at a time, and by virtue of his office he must be a monorchis. Thus qualified, he shares with the eunuchs in all their privileges, and at the same time enjoys the lion's share in the Egugun department.

In a large town, every quarter has its own Alagba in whose house a special apartment is dedicated to the Egugun worship, where all the Egugun dress in that part of the town are kept until required for use on special occasions or at the annual festivals.

Eguguns are generally worshipped with a kind of cake made of beans and palm oil (Olele) in the month of February, after the beans harvest in January ; and the Egugun anniversary is usually held in the month of May or Jane. These festivals are lucky times for the men, for on these occasions, the women are made to spend largely to feast " deceased relatives," while the food is consumed by the men in the Alagba' s department. The number of fowls and goats killed and devoured at such times is simply prodigious. Such is the force of habit engendered by blind superstition, that although in reality the women are no longer deceived, as regards these alleged visits of their dear departed, yet they make their offerings with cheerfulness, and with a sure expectation of blessings.

It has already been noted above that the Yorubas believe in a future state. It cannot be considered too far fetched to say that this periodical re-appearance of the dead as symbohzed in the Egugun " mystery " is an embodiment of the idea of the Resurrection, although that doctrine as taught by Christianity cannot be said to be identical with what they hold and practise ; but this festival is usually observed with all the zeal and fervour with which Christians celebrate the Christmas and Paschal festivals.

This anniversary is the time of reunion among absent friends and relatives. The town then puts on its best appearance, the streets are everywhere cleaned and put under repairs, and the citizens appear abroad in their holiday dress.

The celebration is usually preceded on the eve of the festival by a vigil termed in Yoruba " Ikunle " or the kneeling, because the whole night is spent in kneeHng and praying in the grove set apart for Egugun worship, invoking the blessings and the aid of the departed parent. The blood of fowls and animals offered in sacrifice is also poured on the graves of the ancestors.

On the morning of the festival the whole of the Eguguns, including all the principal forms accompanied by the Alagbas and minor priests form a procession to the residence of the chief ruler of the town ; they there receive the homage of the chief, and in turn give him and the other chiefs and the whole town their blessings ; they then spend about three hours doing honours to the chief, playing and dancing to theii* peculiar music ; and after receiving presents they disperse to continue the play all over the town, each confining himself more or less to his own quarter of the

The festival is continued for seven days, and on the eighth day, there is another gathering at the Chief Alagba's and the festivities are brought to a close with games, sports, and a display of magic tricks.

For three weeks to a month, lesser Eguguns may still be seen making their appearance ; these as a rule, belong to poorer districts which weie backward in their preparations for the annual feast. Everyone, however, still keeps to the same rule of seven days' appearance and disappearing likewise on the eighth day after a grand display.

The Adamuorisa and the Gelede.

In imitation of the Eguguns, some littoral tribes adopt similar forms of representation of their departed dead ; such are the Adamuorisa among the Aworis, and the Gelede among the Egbado tribes.

The Adamuorisa is sometimes called Eyg ; the former term signifies the god with the nasal twang — on account of the artificial voice they affect, and the latter, Eyg, simply means Oyg being an imitation or parody of the Oyg system of Egugun worship.

But whereas the Egiiguns appear annually, at a fixed period of the year, viz. at the feast of the first fruits in June, these are used as a part of the funeral obsequies of a chieftain, or well-to-do citizen who can afford a carnival in connection with his funeral rites. The effigy of the departed is set up in state in the house, the immediate relatives are dressed in their very best, and all hold horse-tails in their hands to dance with. The play lasts for one day only and generally ends with a big feast.

The Geledg is also a human being in a mask the head of which is exquisitely carved in wood, and made to represent that of a man or woman with all their tribal marks and sometimes any of the lower animals such as the alligator. They are more generally of a female form, with carvings of plaited haii, and magnificent busts ; they are elaborately or fantasticall}^ dressed, bedecked with a wealth of female ornaments of native manufacture, such as ear-rings, bangles, beads, etc., with jingles on their ankles ; they dance and move majestically, treading heavily to the rhythmic sound of drums and other musical instruments.

They are much besmired with chalk and camwood, presenting rather a frightful (if harmless) appearance.

8. Orb. The Oro system is also said by some to have been borrowed from the red monkey called tjimerh. It consists of a fiat piece of iron or stick, with a long string, attached to a pole. This when whirled swiftly in the air produces a shrill sound which is called " Aja Oro" (Oro's dog). A larger kind whirled with the hand gives a deep bass tone. This is the voice of the Oro himself. Amongst the Ijebus and the Egbas, Oro is much more sacred and important than the Egiigun, and is the executor of criminals. The Egbas pay homage also to another god called Ologboijeun, who is personated by a man under a mask with a drawn sword in his hand.

Other gods of the same class are the Igis (trees) also personified by human beings, masked and carrying an image on the head. Some of these are male figures with branching horns, on which are carved figures of monkeys, snakes and other animals. Others are female figures which are called Efun-gba-roku.

Amongst the Oyos (Yorubas Proper) the people of Iseyin and Jabata are the principal Oro worshippers. Seven days are set apart annually for its worship. Except for a few hours during which they are permitted to procure provisions, women are kept indoors throughout the day. On the seventh day even this small indulgence is not allowed, but they are rigidly shut up the entire day. It is certain death for any one of them to be found without and this penalty is exacted whatever may be the title, or wealth, or position of respectability of any woman who ventures to have a peep at the Oro.

9. tfa. — This is the great consulting oracle in the Yoruba country and was introduced at a late period by King Onigbogi, who was said to have been dethroned for having done so.

Another tradition says it was introduced into the Yoruba country

by one Setilu, native of the Nupe country, who was born blind.

This was about the period of the Mohammedan invasion.

Setilu's parents regretting their misfortune in having a Wind son, were at first of doubtful mind as to what course they should pursue, whether to kill the child, or spare its life to become a burden on the family. Parental feehngs decided them to spare the child. It grew up a peculiar child, and the parents were astonished at his extraordinary powers of divination. At the early age of 5, he began to excite their wonder and curiosity by foretelling who would pay them a visit in the course of the day and with what object. As he advanced in age, he began to practise sorcery and medicine. At the commencement of his practice, he used 16 small pebbles and imposed successfully upon the credulity of those who flocked to him in their distress and anguish

for consultation. From this source, he earned a comfortable liveUhood. Finding that the adherents were fast becoming Setilu's followers, and that even respectable priests did not escape the general contagion, the Mohammedans resolved to expel Setilu out of the country. This being effected, Setilu crossed the river Niger and went to Benin, staying for a while at a place called OwQ, thence to Ado. Subsequently he migrated to He Ife, and finding that place more suitable for practising his art, he resolved to make it his permanent residence. He soon became famous there also, and his performances so impressed the people, and the reliance placed in him was so absolute, that he had little difficulty in persuading them to abolish the tribal marks on their faces, such marks of distinction not being practised in Nupe, Setilu's own country.

In process of time palm nuts, pieces of iron and ivory balls were successively used instead of pebbles. At the present day, palm nuts only are used as they are considered more easily propitiated, the others reqairing costly sacrifices and even human blood.

Setilu initiated several of his followers in the mysteries of Ifa worship, and it has gradually become the consulting oracle of the whole Yoruba nation. In order to become an Ifa priest, a long course of serious study is necessary. To consult Ifa, in the more common and ordinary way, 16 palm nuts are to be shaken together in the hollow of both hands, whilst certain marks are traced with the index linger on a flat bowl dusted with yam flour, or powdered camwood. Each mark suggests to the consulting priest the heroic deeds of some fabulous heroes, which he duly recounts, and so he goes on with the marks in order, until he hits upon certain words or phrases which appear to bear upon the matter of the applicant before him. Very often answers are given much after the rnanner of the ancient oracle at Delphi.

Ifa was really met in this country by the Yorubas, for Oduduwa

met Setilu at He Ife, but the worship of it was officially recognized by King Ofiran son of Onigbogi.

10. Sango. — Sango was the fourth King of the Yorubas, and was deified by his friends after his death. Sango ruled over all the Yorubas including Benin, the Popos and Dahomey, for the worship of him has continued in all these countries to this day.

It is related of him, that being a tyrant he was dethroned by his people, and expelled the country. Finding himself deserted not only by his friends, but also by his beloved wife Oya, he committed suicide at a place called Koso. His tragic end became a proverb and a by-word, and his faithless friends were ashamed on account of the taunts cast upon the name and fame of the unfortunate King. To atone for their base action in deserting him, as well as to avenge the insults on his memory they went to the Bariba country to study the art of charm-making, and also the process of attracting lightning upon their enemies' houses.

On their return home they put to practice with a vengeance the lessons they had learnt. From the too frequent conflagrations which were taking place, as well as deaths from lightning strokes, suspicions were aroused, and enquiries were set on foot. Then Sango's friends said that the catastrophe was attributable to the late King taking vengeance on his enemies on account of the indignities they had heaped upon his memory. Being appealed to, to propitiate the offended King in order that he may stay his vengeance upon the land, his friends offered sacrifices to him as god, and hence these intercessors became the " Mogba " (advocate) and priests of Sango ; and to this day their descendants hold the same office.

The emblems of worship representing Sango are certain smooth stones shaped like an axe head commonly taken for thunder bolts.

They are supposed to be hurled down from the heavens when the god would kill any one who has incurred his displeasure.

The following is the process to be gone through at the initiation of any one into the mysteries of Sango worship : — The priests demand a ram, a water bird called Osin, a tortoise, a snail, an armadillo, a large rat called Okete, a toad, a tadpole, the Otutu and Opon beads, the red tail of a parrot, a guinea fowl, shea butter, salt, palm oil, the flesh of an elephant, venison, the ihih (greens) the leaves of the evergreens called Etiponola, Odudun, and iperegun tree ; a small knife called " abe-esu " (the devil's razor) a white country cloth of lo breadths, a mat called fafa (mats made of the pith of bamboo palm branches) together with 7

heads of cowries (14,000 cowry shells) as carriage fee. The leaves are bruised in a bowl of water, and with the infusion

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the candidate is to purify himself. He is then seated on a mortar and shaved. The birds and tortoise are killed and their hearts taken out, and these with slices of the flesh of all the animals above-mentioned are pounded together with the evergreens, and a ball is made of the compound. The candidate now submits to incisions on his shaven head and the ball of pounded articles is rubbed into the wounds. The neophyte now becomes a recognised devotee of Sango.

Important ceremonies are performed when a house is struck by lightning. The inmates are not allowed to sleep in any house„ but in booths or blacksmith's shops, until the so-called thunderbolt is dug up and removed from the premises. A garland of palm leaves is generally hung up at the entrance of the devoted house to forbid any but Sango priests to enter. A watchman is kept on the premises at the expense of the sufferers from the divine visitation, and it is the duty of this man to ward off trespassers from what is now regarded as sacred ground, till the ceremonies shall have been performed, and the offended god appeased. With the sole exception of the great King, the AlAfin of Ovo, all the provincial kings and ruling chiefs in whose town the catastrophe happens to take place, are bound to repair to the spot to do homage to Sango, who is said to pay a visit to earth.

Such occasions are greatly prized by the worshippers who swarm to the place in numbers with their Bayani, a sort of crown made of cowries, and they are all to be entertained at the expense of the sufferers and also by the neighbours.

The king or chief coming to pay his respects to Sango is to receive ii heads of cowries, a goat, and a slave in three payments.

In the case of a poor house, a member of the family is seized if not quietly given up, and has to be ransomed at a considerable sum, which must be paid and the above mentioned articles procured, before the ceremony can be performed. Then all being ready the priests having now assembled, the tete (greens) etipgnQla, together with the evergreens Odudun and peregun are bruised in a bowl of water, and with this they purify themselves before entering the house. They are preceded by one holding an iron instrument (the divining rod) with which a search is made for the spot where the bolt is believed to have entered the ground. After some pretence they arrive at a spot in which one of their number had previously buried one of these sharp stones. Here the ground is ordered to be dug, with a show of solemnity, and, of course, the thunder-bolt is found and exhumed with well-sustained marks of piety and reverence.

Thus the common people are deceived and imposed upon, and

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very few besides the priests are aware of the tricks systematically played upon their credulity.

The concluding ceremony stiU bears hardly on the poor sufferers. They are required to give over a son to the priests to be initiated in the mysteries of the cult, and further they are to pay something in order to obtain permission to rebuild their houses. Hence an accident of this kind means great calamity to any one, and heavy debts are incurred. The unfortunate sufferers already deprived of their all (much or little) by this sudden stroke of ill-fortune are often obliged to put their children to service in order to raise money sufficient to meet the demands of the greedy worshippers of this heartless god. The fines obtained are shared between the king or head chief, and the town authorities ; but the articles purchased for the performance of the ceremonies are perquisites which are appropriated by the priests alone.

This " descent of Sango " on earth is never done but with a view to show his displeasure on persons who are guilty of perjury and lies. The town for a while is as it were placed under an interdict, and during that brief period the worshippers of the god are allowed to seize with impunity whatever they can come at in the public streets in the vicinity of the catastrophe, such as sheep, goats, poultry and things of greater oi less value.

Sango worshippers are forbidden to touch the large white beans called Sese, because it is used for counteracting the evil effects of the agencies employed in attracting lightning on people's houses.

II. Qya. This was the name of Sango's faithful and beloved wife. She alone of all his wives accompanied him in his flight towards the Tapa (Nupe) country his maternal home. But courage failed her at a place called Ira, her native town which she was never to see any more should love for her husband prevail to make her resolve to share with him in his destiny. B ut the prospect of making her home among entire strangers in a strange land among a people speaking a strange tongue, and of leaving parents and home for ever, so overpowered her that she hesitated to proceed.

As she could not for very shame return to Oyq she remained at Ira ; and hearing that her husband had committed suicide, she summed up sufficient courage to follow his example.

She also was deified. The river Niger is sacred to her, and hence that river is called all over Yoruba land Odo Oya after her name. As thunder and lightning are attributed to Sango so tornado and violent thunderstorms, rending trees and levelling high towers and houses are attributed to Oya. They signify her displeasure.

Deified heroes and heroines are never spoken of as dead, but as having disappeared. Thus the saying : —

" Oya wole ni ile Ira Sango wgle ni Koso." (Oya disappeared in the town of Ira Sango disappeared at Koso).

Two naked swords and the horns of a buffalo are the representative image of Oya. Her followers are forbidden to touch mutton, they are distinguished by a particular kind of red beads which are always tied round their necks.

12. Erinle. Erinle was originally a hunter, native of Ajagbusi. He was poor and unmarried. Having no home, he dwelt in a booth erected under a large gbinghin tree by the river side, whence he made his expeditions to shoot monkeys for sale by which he earned his livelihood. He is said to have been accidentally swept down the river by a strong current and was drowned. A river flowing by the present town of Ilobu, which empties itself into the Osun river was named after him. The representing image consists of black smooth stones from that river, and an image of iron smmounted by the figure of a bird. The followers are distinguished by wearing a chain of iron or brass round their necks, and bracelets of the same material.

13. Orisa Oko. Orisa Oko was also a hunter, a native of Irawo. He used to entrap guinea fowls in nets set in the farm of one Ogunjeiisowe, a wealthy farmer, and bj^ this means he gained his livelihood. He kept a dog and a fife, and on several occasions when lost in the bush his whereabouts were discovered by his dog at the sound of the fife. He lived to a good old age, and when infirm and unable to pursue his calling as a hunter, he practised soothsaying and numbers flocked to him.

It may be observed that in countries where letters are not known and the language not reduced to writing the aged are the repositories of wisdom and knowledge, hence the younger generation regard their seniors as guides and prophets, and their vast stores of experience serve as keys to unlock many a doubtful point in the affairs of the young. The latter used to regard the foresight displayed by the elders as a marvel ; it is easy, therefore to understand how it came about that extraordinary powers are attributed to them. It is only thus that one can account in a way for the success of those who are often styled " medicine men " " sorcerers " " soothsayers," etc.

As witchcraft was punished with death, persons accused of it were taken to Orisa Oko for trial. He was accustomed to lead

the accused to a cave supposed to be inhabited by a demon called Polo. In this cave Orisa Oko practised his sorcery. In cases where an accused was innocent, he would return with him ; if otherwise, then his head is thrown out to those awaiting a decision. Polo the demon executed the guilty. The fame of Orisa Oko spread and numbers resorted to him in taking oaths. His oracle was regarded as infaUible, and appeals to him were final.

After his death, his followers practised his methods taking the precaution to secrete a strong man in the cave to act the part of the supposed Polo.

But a striking exposure soon brought the practice into disrepute, and it was aboHshed. It happened thus. A man was accused and as usual, was taken to the cave ; but he proved to be a far stronger man than the supposed Polo, and the result was that he killed the counterfeit demon, and threw his head out of the cave to those who were eagerly waiting for the decision of the god.

The representing image is a fife made of ivory or a flat piece of iron 5 or 6ft. in length similar to what is given as a sign of acquittal to those in whose favour the god had decided.

The Erugun mystery is of a kind similar to that of the Orisa Oko worship. It also was practised in a cave by the side of a mount called the Erugun mount.

The above are the principal gods worshipped by the Yorubas. There are besides many inferior divinities to whom offerings are made. In fact the whole number of gods and goddesses acknowledged is reckoned at 401. Propitiatory sacrifices are also offered to whatever in nature is awe inspiring or magnificent such as the Ocean, huge rocks, tall trees, and high mountains. To the last named especially offerings are made for the procreation of children.

Mohammedanism as was observed above, was introduced towards the close of the eighteenth century ; it numbered very few adherents up to the time when the Fulanis by stratagem, seized Ilgrin and overran the northern provinces, as we shall find related in the second part of this history. The towns in the plain were swept with fire and the sword, with the alternative of the acceptance of the Koran, and submission to the Fulanis ; the southward progress of the conquerors, however, was stopped at Osogbo, where the Ibadans met and crushed them, and in the direction of the Ijesa and Ekiti provinces, the forests and mountain fastnesses offered insurmountable obstacles to these intrepid horsemen, who could neither fight on foot nor engage in a bush warfare ; hence Mohammedanism prevailed chiefly in the north, but latterly it spread southwards by peaceful means, chiefly by

traders and itinerant mendicant preachers. It is now embraced by thousands, as it appears to be a superior form of rehgion to the paganism of their ancestors.

Christianity. Christianity was introduced by the Church Missionary Society in 1843, first into Abeokuta via Badagry, and from thence to Ibadan in May 1851, and also to Ijaye. On January 10, 1852, the C. M.S. removed their base from Badagry to Lagos. From Abeokuta, mission stations were planted at the Oke Ogun and Egbado districts, from Ibadan missions were planted at Iwo, Modakeke, Ife, Osogbo and Ilesa. Missions were established also at Oyo and Ogbomoso before the Ijaye war broke out in i860, which put a stop to the progress of missions all over the country. The intertribal wars which followed and which convulsed the greater part of the country, and devastated large areas, prevented its growth northwards, but at Abeokuta where it was first planted, it grew so rapidly that at the time of the British occupation, Christian adherents could be numbered by thousands ; schools had been established, and evangelistic work among the surrounding kindred tribes systematically undertaken and was being vigorously carried on.

The Bible in the vernacular was the most potent factor in the spread of the religion. The sincerity of the converts, and the firm hold the religion has attained, have been fully tested by several bloody persecutions endured for the faith, through which they came out triumphant.

The forces organized for home defence chiefly against the Dahomian attacks contained a compact body of Christians under their own captain, the esprit de corps existing among them, and the invariable success which always attended their arms, won for them the respect and admiration, of their pagan rulers and countrymen. This contributed not a little to the cessation of persecutions and the increase of their number.

The establishment of the British protectorate saw the mission, established at Ijebu, where it has since been spreading phenomenally and also in the Ijesa and Ekiti provinces. It is self propagating by means of the people learning to read the Bible in their own tongue. To God be the praise.

Chapter IV

The entire Yoruba country has never been thoroughly organized into one complete government in a modern sense. The sj^stem that prevails is that known as the Feudal, the remoter portions have always lived more or less in a state of semi-independence, whilst loosely acknowledging an over -lord. The king of Benin was one of the first to be indepei dent of the central government, and was even better known to foreigners who frequented his ports in early times, and who knew nothing of his over-lord in the then unexplored and unknown interior.

Yoruba Proper, however, was completely organized, and the descriptions here given refer chiefly to it. With some variations most of the smaller governments were generally modelled after it, but in a much simpler form, and solely in their domestic affairs ; foreign relations so far as then obtained, before the period of the revolution were entirely in the hands of the central government at Oyo (Eyeo or Katunga). It should be remembered that the coast tribes were of much less importance then than now, both in population and in intelhgence ; light and civilization with the Yorubas came from the north with which they have always retained connection through the Arabs and Fulanis. The centre of Hfe and activity, of large populations and industry was therefore in the interior, whilst the coast tribes were scanty in number, ignorant and degraded not only from their distance from the centre of light, but also through their demoralizing intercourse with Europeans, and the transactions connected with the oversea slave trade.

This state of things has been somewhat reversed since the latter half of the XlXth century, by the suppression of the slave-trade, and the substitution therefor of legitimate trade and commerce : and more especially through the labours of the missionaries who entered the country about the same time as the springing up into being of the modern towns of Lagos, Abeokuta, and Ibadan, through which western light and civiUzation beam into the interior.

The government of Yoruba Proper is an absolute monarchy ; the King is more dreaded than even the gods. The office is hereditary in the same family, but not necessarily from father to son-. The King is usually elected by a body of noblemen known as Qyo Mesi, the seven principal councillors of state.

The vassal or provincial kings and ruling princes were 1060 at the time of the greatest prosperity of the empire which then included the Popos, Dahomey, and parts of Ashanti, with portions of the Tap^s and Baribas.

The word " king " as generally used in this country includes all more or less distinguished chiefs, who stand at the head of a clan, or one who is the ruler of an important district or province, especially those who can trace their descent from the founder, or from one of the great leaders or heroes who settled with him in this country. They are of different grades, corresponding somewhat to the different orders of the English peerage (dukes, marquises, eails, viscounts and barons), and their order of rank is well-known among themselves. The Onikoyi as head of the Ekicn Osi 01 metropohtan province was the first of these " kings " and he it was who used to head them all to Oyo once a j'ear to pay homage to the AlAfin or King of the Yorubas.

The AlAfin

The AlAfin is the supreme head of all the kings and princes of the Yoruba nation, as he is the direct lineal descendant and successor of the reputed founder of the nation. The succession as above said is by election from amongst the members of the royal family, of the one considered as the most worthy, age and nearness to the throne being taken into consideration. It might be mentioned also in passing that the feelings and acceptance of the denizens of the harem towards the king-elect are often privately ascertained and assured of previously.

In the earliest days, the eldest son naturally succeeded the father, and in order to be educated in all the duties of the kingship which must one day devolve upon him, he was often associated more or less with the father in performing important duties and thereby he often performedroyal functions, and thus gradually he practically reigned with his father under the title of Aremo (the heir appaient) having his own official residence near the palace ; but as the age grew corrupt, the Aremo often exercised sway quite as much as or more than the King himself, especially in the course of a long reign, when age has rendered the monarch feeble. They had equal powers of life and death over the King's subjects, and there are some cases on record

of the Aremo being strongly suspected of terminating the father's Hfe, in order to attain full powers at once. It was therefore made a law and part of the constitution that as the Aremo reigned with his father, he must also die with him. This law had the effect at any rate of checking parricide. It continued to take effect up to the last century when (in 1858)

it was repealed by Atiba one of the later Kings in favour of his Aremq Adelu. The Aremo may now succeed if found worthy, but he must be elected in the usual way ; but if passed over or rejected by the king-makers he must leave the city and resort to a private retirement in the provinces. This however, is not really obhgatory, but as he must be superseded in his office, such a course is inevitable, unless he chooses of his own accord to die with the father.

The choice may sometimes fall upon one of the poorer princes, in the quiet pursuit of his trade, with no aspiration after the throne ; such a one is sent for, and unnecessarily ill-used for the last time to his own surprise ; this was done probably for the purpose of testing his temper and spirit. He may not be aware of the intentions of the Oyo Mesi until he is being admonished by them as to the duties and responsibilities of the exalted position he is soon to fill.

The nominators are three titled members of the royal family, viz., the Ona-Isokun, the Ona-Aka, and the Omo-Ola, uncles or cousins of the King, but generally entitled the " King's fathers." These have to submit or suggest the names to the noblemen for election, but the Basorun's voice is paramount to accept or to reject.

Curious and elaborate ceremonies precede the actual accession to the throne. After all arrangements have been made, the ceremonies begin by a sacrifice brought from the house of the Ona-Isokun by a body of men called Omg-ninari ; these belong to a family specially concerned in carrying out all menial duties connected with the offering of sacrifices and in waiting upon the King and the priests. As soon as they enter the house where the King-elect is, he is called out, and he has to stand up with an attendant by his side. He is touched on the chest, and on the right and left shoulders with the bowl of sacrifice, the attendant in the mean time uttering some form of words. This is the signal that he has been called to the throne. On the evening of the same day, he is conducted quietly into the house of the Ona-Isokun where he spends the first night. In order to avoid the crowd, the attention of the populace is usually diverted by a procession of the Kings' slaves and others with much noise and ado, as if escorting him, whilst the king-elect accompanied by the Aregbe'di, a titled eunuch, and a few of the Omo-ni-nari come up quietly a long way behind.

At the Ona-Isokun' s house, he is attended solely by the Omoni-nari. He is admonished and advised by those who stand to him in place of a father. Some ceremonies of purification are gone

through, propitiatory sacrifices are again offered which are carried to various quarters of the city by the Onto-ni-nari.

The next night he passes at the house* of the Otun-Iwefa (the next in rank to the chief of the eunuchs). This official being a priest of Sango, it is probable that the king-elect spends the night with him in order to be initiated into the sacerdotal part of his office, the Alafin having as much spiritual as well as secular work to perform, being at once King and Priest to his people ; and probably' he learns there also the usages and doings of the huge population in the inner precincts of the palace with which the eunuchs are quite conversant. After this, he is conducted into one of the chambers in the Outer Court of the palace (Omo ile) where he resides for three months, the period of mourning, until his coronation.

The main gateway to the palace being closed at the demise of the King, a private opening is made for him in the outer wall through which he goes in and out of his temporary residence. During this time he remains strictly in private, learning and practising the style and deportment of a King, and the details of the important duties and functions of his office. During this period he is dressed in black, and is entitled to use a " cap of state" called " Ori-k6-gbe-ofo." (The head may not remain uncovered).

The affairs of state are at this time conducted by the Basorun.

The Coronation

The coronation takes place at the end of three months, really at the third appearance of the new moon after the late King's death. The date is generally so fixed as to have it if possible before the next great festival. It is attended with a great public demonstration. It is a gala day in which the whole city appears in holiday dress. Visitors from the provinces and representatives of neighbouring states also flock into the city in numbers.

This day is generally known as " The King's visit to the BarA." It is the first but most important act of the ceremonies.

The Bara or royal mausoleum is a consecrated building in the outskirts of the city, under the care of a high-priestess named Iyamode ; there the Kings were formally crowned, and there buried. The King enters it but once in his lifetime, and that is

ˆ Tradition says that in the early times while the King -elect is in the Otun'efa's house among other dishes brought to him to partake of is one prepared from the heart of the late King which has been extracted and preserved. After partaking of this he is told he has " eaten the King." Hence the origin of the word Je Oba, to become a King (ht. to eat a King).

at the coronation with marked pomp and ceremony. The actual crowning does not now take place in the Bar A as it seems to have been, but at Koso the shrine of Sango, but the visit to the Bara is so important and indispensable a preliminary that it has become more closely identified with the coronation than that to the other shrines visited on that occasion.

Leaving the Ipadi — his temporary chambers — there are two stations at which the King elect has to halt before reaching the sacred building ; the' first is the Ahdtd or area in front of the palace where a tent of beautiful cloths has been erected tor him. Here he has to change his mourning dress for a princely robe. He then proceeds to the second station at the Alapini's midway on his route where a large tent and an enclosure have been erected for his reception. Here he is awaited by a vast concourse of people and welcomed with ringing cheers. Here he receives the congratulations and homage of the princes, the nobles, the chiefs and the people and is hailed as the King. Some ceremonies are here gone through also which include distribution of kola nuts, etc., to the princes and chiefs without.

After this he proceeds to the Bara accompanied by the whole concourse of people who have to remain outside. He enters the sacred precincts attended by the Magaji lyajin (his official elder brother) the princesses, the Ona-Onse-awo (an official) , the Otunwefa (the next to the chief of the eunuchs) who is a priest and the Omo-ni-nari, a set of servants. These last are to slaughter and skin the animals to be offered in sacrifice.

At the Bara he worships at the tombs of his fathers, a horse, a cow, and a ram being offered at each tomb ; portions are sent out to each of the noblemen, princes, and chiefs waiting outside, the Basorun receiving the first and the lion's share oi the whole. He invokes the blessings of his deceased fathers and is hereby said to receive authority to wear the crown. The visit to the BarA then is for the purpose of receiving authority or permission from his deceased ancestors to wear the crown, hence it is spoken of as the coronation. It is a fixed rule that the whole of the meat is to be totally consumed at the BarA ; under no circumstance should any be taken home.

This over, the King returns hence with great pomp and show to his temporary chambers, amid the firing of feu de joie, the bleating of the Kakaki trumpet, drumming, etc.

On the fifth day after this he proceeds to Koso, the shrine of Sango, for the actual crowning. Here he is attended by the Otun-wefa who has the charge of the shrine, the Bale (mayor) of Koso a suburban village, the Omo-ni-naris, and the Isonas.

[The Isgnas are a body of men whose sole employment is to do all needle and embroidered work for royalty. They are also the umbrella-makers. The crown, staff, robes, and all ornamental beadworks, and workings in

cotton, silk, or leather are executed by them].

Surrounded by the principal eunuchs and princes the great crown is placed on his head with much ceremony by the lykkere. Who the ly^kere is, for whom is reserved this most important function will be seen below. The royal robes are put on him, the Ejigba* round his neck, the staff and the Sword of Mercy are placed in his hands.

On the fifth day after this, he proceeds to the shrine of Orafiyan, here the Great Sword or Sword of Justice brought from Ile Ife is placed in his hands, without which he can huve no authority to order an execution.

After another interval of five days, he proceeds to the shrine of Ogun the god of war, and there offers a propitiatory sacrifice for a peaceful reign. The offerings consist of a cow, a ram, and a dog ; this last being indispensable in any sacrifice to the god of war.

From the shrine of Ogun, the procession goes straight on to the palace, entering now for the first time by the main gate opened for him, the former opening through the outer wall to the temporary chambers being quickly walled up. Thus he enters the palace proper as The King.

But a new opening is made for him at the Kohi Aganju through which he enters the inner precincts of the palace. This entrance is tor his exclusive use in and out of the Kgbi during his reign : at his death it is closed up. At this entrance they offer in sacrifice a snail, a tortoise, an armadillo, a field mouse (emo) a large rat (okete) a toad, a tadpole, a pigeon, a fowl, a ram, a cow, a horse, a man and a woman, the last two being buried at the threshhold of the opening ; on the blood of the victims and over the grave of the two last, he has to walk to the inner court.

Human saciifices however (now totally abolished) were not commonly practised amongst the Oygs, but such immolation was always performed at the coionation and at the burial of the sovereign. By these sacrifices he is not only crowned King with

^ The Ejigba is a string of costly beads reaching down to the knees. Beads are used for precious stones. This represents the chain of office. Chains — they say — are for captives, hence they use beads instead.

power over all, man and beast, but he is also consecrated a priest to the nation. His person, therefore, becomes sacred.

All this having been performed, it is now formally announced to the assembled pubUc, that King " A " is dead (or rather has entered into the vault of the skies — O wo Aja) and King "B" now reigns in his stead.

During the interval of the late King's illness, up to the time of his death, the business of state is carried on normally by the palace ofl&cers, the Osi-'wefa personating the King, even to the extent of putting on his robes and crown, and sitting on the throne when such is required ; but as soon as it is known that he is dead the Basgrun at once assumes the chief authority, and nothing can be done without him.

The King having been crowned, he is henceforth forbidden to appear in public streets by day, except on very special and extraordinary occasions ; he is, however, allowed evening strolls on moonhght nights when he may walk about incognito.

This seclusion not only enhances the awe and majesty due to a sovereign, but also lends power and authority to his commands, and is the best safe-guard for public order at their present stage of civiUzation. Besides, it would be very inconvenient to the citizens it the King were always coming out, for according to the universal custom of the country, whenever a chief is out, all his subordinates must go out with him. It is an inviolable law and custom of the country, and is appHcable to all, whatever their rank : thus, if the Basorun is out, all the Oyo Mesi must be out also. If the Bale of any town is out, all the chiefs of the town must be out also, and if the King is out, the whole city must be astir and on the move, all business suspended, until he returns into the palace.

Igba Iwa

At the commencement of every reign, the Igba Iwa or Calabashes of divination are brought from Ile Ife to the new King to divine what sort of reign his will be.

Two covered calabashes, of similar shape and size but with quite different contents are brought, one containing money, small pieces of cloth and other articles of merchandize, denoting peace and prosperity ; the other containing miniature swords and spears, arrows, powder, bullet, razor, knives, etc., denoting wars and trouble for the country. The King is to choose one of them before seeing the contents, and according as he chooses so will be the fate of the Yoruba country during his reign.

The Aremo

The very first official act of the new King after his coronation is to create an Aremg, and a Princess Royal or an eqmvalent. The Aremo is the Crown Prince. The term simply denotes an heir, but it is used as the title of the Crown Prince of Oyo.

The title is conferred upon the eldest son of the sovereign in a formal manner, the ceremony being termed the "christening" as of a newly born child, hence he is often termed " Qmo " (child) by way of distinction The title of Princess Royal is at the same time and in the same manner conferred upon the eldest daughter of the sovereign as well ; this, however, is of much less importance than the other. When the King is too young to have a son, or his son is a minor, the title is temporarily conferred upon a younger brother, or next of kin that stands to him in place of a son, but as soon as the son is of age, he must assume his title and begin to act under the guardianship of the eunuchs who are his guardians.

The method is as follows : — Both of them must have a Sponsor, or " father " as he is called, chosen by divination from among the titled eunuchs ; this done, the Aremo repairs to the house of the Ona-Isokun to worship at the graves of the deceased Aremos, who were all buried there, and the princess to that of her deceased predecessor in her mother's house ; the King supplying them with a bullock each. The whole day is thus spent in festivities. On their return in the evening they both proceed direct to their sponsor's house where they must reside four days, each day being marked with festi'ities, the king supplying two bullocks every day, and this is further supplemented by the Aremo himself. The feasts are open to the general public, whoever Hkes to repair to the house is a welcome guest, portions are also sent out to the princes, the noblemen, and other distinguished personages. At the end of the fourth day the Aremg, invested with the robes of his office and with a coronet, is conducted to his official residence where he takes up his permanent abode, and the princess suitably clad hkewise repairs to her own home.

Public Appearances of the King

The King generally appears in public on the three great annual festivals of Ifa, Orun, and the Bere. In two at least of these festivals (that of the Orun and the Bere), the Basorun is equally concerned with him.

These festivals have certain features in common, although each has its own marked characteristics. They are all preceded by the

worship of Ogun (the god of war) and on the third day after, the firing of a royal salute, and the sound of the ivory trumpet announce to the public, that the King may now be seen in state, sitting on his throne, and all loyal subjects who wish to have a glimpse of his majesty now may repair to the palace.

The festival of I fa or Mole takes place in the month of July, nine days after the festival of Sango. The Ifa is the god of divination. One day in the week is generally given to the consultation or the service of Ifa, but an annual festival is celebrated in its honour at Oyq.

The Orun festival takes place in September. At this festival the King and the Basorun worship together the Ori or god of fate. The Orun from which it appears the Basorun derives his name and title is a curious if not rather a mystical rite. The word " Orun " signifies heaven. The title in lull is Iba Osorun i.e. the lord who performs the Orun or heavenly mysteries.

The King and his Osorun are often spoken of as " Oba aiye " and " Qba Orun " i.e.. King terrestrial and King celestial. In what way His Supernal Highness performs the Orun, or what position he assumes towards the sovereign in this ceremony, is not generally known, because it is always done in private. But the rite seems to deal with affairs connected s'ith the King's life. It is to him a periodic reminder of his coming apotheosis, and the emblem of worship is said to be a coffin made of or paved with clay in which he is to be buried. It is kept in charge of the " lya Oba " (the King's official mother) in a room in her apartments, visited by no one, and the ceremonies are performed in private once a year by the King himself, his " mother " and his Osorun, the latter taking the chief part ; consequently very little is actually known of the doings of these three august personages. But this much is allowed to be known, that the Basorun is to divine with kola nuts, to see whether the King's sacrifices are acceptable to the celestials or not, if the omen be favourable the Alafin is to give the Basorun presents of a horse and other valuables ; if unfavourable, he is to die, he has forfeited his right to further existence. But there can be no doubt that under such circumstances, it can always be managed between them that the omens be always favourable.

From this and other circumstances, it would appear that the King on this occasion occupies a humiliating position as one whose conduct is under review, hence the great privacy observed, for it is a cardinal principle with Yorubas that the Alafin, as the representative of the founder of the race, is to humble himself before no mortal ; if such a contingency were to occur, he is to die.

Hence, no doubt, that his natural mother (if then living) is to make way for her son ascending the throne, so there will be no occasion to violate any filial duty imperative on a son who is at the same time the King. His majesty must be supreme. Even in performing reverential duties before the priests of Sango, when such are required, some privacy must be observed.

The Bere festival takes place in January, towards the end of the year, the new year commencing in March. It is the most important and the grandest of the three. It is primarily the harvest home festival, symboUzed by ceremoniously setting the fields on fire to indicate that it has been cleared of the fruits of the earth.

It is an important one at Oyo, not only because it closes the civil year, but also because by it the King numbers the years of his reign.

The Bere itself which seems to be the symbol of so many ceremonies, is a common grass which grows only in the plain country and is used mainly for thatching houses. It is considered the most sumptuous of all other materials used for covering houses : it is the coolest, the neatest, the most durable, and lends itself best for ornamental purposes ; consequently it is highly thought of.

The festival proper is always preceded by two important ceremonies, the Pakudirin indicating the beginning, and the Jelepa the end of the ingatherings.

The Pakudirin is performed by the Ona-'wefa or chief of the eunuchs, by the Basorun or his representative and the Ab'obaku or master of the horse.

The King in semi-state appears in the Kobi Aganju to witness the same, with several of the ladies of the palace around him, and at the entrance of the Aganju, the musicians making the occasion very lively.

The King is supposed not to have seen the new Bere grass of the year, the Ona-'wefa first steps forwards before him with a scythe made of brass or copper, performing in the air a mimic act of mo\ving the grass, and one of the ladies of the palace deputed for the purpose, extending her wrap as it were to receive the same, hugging it as something precious. This is done two or three times, the Basorun then follows and goes through the same forms, and then the master of the horse. Each of these chiefs now makes a short speech congratulating the King on the advent of a new year, wishing him a long life and prosperous reign.

After this, about half-a-dozen men with small bundles of the Bere grass, neatly done up, enter the palace, with measured steps to the sound of music, and come dancing before the King in front of the Aganju. His Majesty is supposed to see the grass now for

the first time that year. This ceremony is brought to a close by presents given to the men, and then all spectators disperse. From nine to seventeen days are now allowed for harvesting before the fields are set on

fire.

The Jelepa is the ceremony of setting the fields on fire. This is performed by the Basorun outside the city walls. Booths and enclosures of palm leaves having been erected for the purpose, the Basorun with a princely train repairs thither on the day appointed. He is met there by a number of women from the palace bringing a large calabash draped with a white cloth and containing 01[1] (a sort of pudding made of white beans and palm oil) and Eko (a kind of blanc -mange made of soaked corn flour), corn and beans being taken as the staples of Hfe, the principal products of the field.

His Supernal Highness first offers a morsel of these in sacrifice as a harvest thank-offering for the Yoruba nation, after which both himself and those with him partake of the rest accompanied with palm wine or beer made from guinea corn, thanking God for the blessings of the field. This over he orders the fields to be set on fire : but if by an accident the fields have already been fired, a bundle of dry grass brought from home is used instead, for the purpose of the ceremony.

The firing of a feu de joie now serves to show that the ceremony is over and the parties are returning to the city. This is done in state. The Basorun robes in one of the enclosures : he is attended by hundreds of horsemen and footmen, horsemen galloping backwards and forwards before him, the firing and the fifing and drumming are quite deafening. With such a right royal procession His Supernal Highness re-enters the city. On the evening of the same day, the King worships the Ogun which is a prehminary to every annual festival.

The following day is a very busy one at Oyq. It is a day of paying tributes of Bere grass. The whole of the Oyo Mesi first send theirs to the King, the Basorun alone would send about 200 bundles, the subordinate chiefs send to the senior chiefs, every one to his feudal lord or chief, each man according to his rank and position and so on to the lowest grades, the young men to the heads of compounds, so that it is usual to see loads of Bere passing to and fro all over the town the whole day. From the provinces also tributes of Bere come to Oyo later on ; e.g. from the Aseyin of Iseyin, the Oluiwo of Iwo, the Bale of Ogbomoso and other cities of the plain where the Bere grows.

This being the recognized principal festival of the AlAfin other towns in lieu of Bere send congratulatory messages with presents,

or tributes ; the Ibadans in their marauding days used to send slaves ; from the Ij§sas and Ekiti countries come kola nuts, alligator pepper, firewood and other forest products. Towns nearer the coast send articles of European manufacture, and so on during this season.

The day after, being the third day of the ceremony of Jglepa and the worship of Ogun, the public festival takes place.

The King in State

The King generally appears in state on these three festive occasions.

Facing the large quadrangle of the outer court are the six principal Kobis, that in the centre is what is known as the Kqbi Aganju or throne room where the AlAfin always appears on state occasions. It is always kept closed, and never used for any other purpose but this.

On such occasions, the floor is spread all over with mats, and the front . of the throne overspread with scarlet cloths ; the posts all around are decorated with velvet cloths, and the walls with various hangings.

The throne or chair of state was made of wood at a time when the knowledge of carpentry was not common in this country ; it cannot boast of any artistic merit, but it is highly valued for its solidity, hoary age, and tr?.dition. It is of a large size and covered over with velvet.

The crown is made of costly beads such as coral, agra, and the like, which in this poor country stand to the people instead of precious stones. It is artisticsdly done up by experts, with fringes of small multi-coloured beads depending from the rim, which serve to veil the face.

The robes are usually silks or velvets, of European manufacture, which were of much greater value in earlier days when intercourse with the coast was not so common or easy as it now is.

The Ejigha is the " chaiYi of office." This is made of a string of costly beads going round the neck and reaching as far down as the knees.

The Opa Ileke is the staff or sceptre artistically covered all over with small multi-coloured beads.

The Iru here is a specially prepared cow's tail of spotless white which the King generally holds in front of his mouth when speaking for it is considered bad form to see him open his mouth in public. He makes his speech sotto voce, and it is repeated to the assembly in a loud voice by the chief of the Eunuchs. The white tail is moreover an emblem of peace and grace.

The State Umbrellas. Umbrellas in this country are part and parcel of state paraphernalia. In fact there was a time when private individuals dared not use an umbrella ; that was in the days before cheap foreign ones were obtainable. The prohibition was first done away with at Ibadan, where the war boys were allowed to enjoy themselves in any way they liked, and use any materials of clothing and ornament they could afford, as it might be for only a few days before they laid down their lives on a battlefield.

However, those of a chief are easily distinguished now by their size and quality. They are almost always of bright colouring usually of damasks. The size and number are in proportion to the rank of the chief, usually of European manufacture now, though there is a distinct family of royal umbrella makers kept at Oyo who make those of the largest size. Most of the umbrellas foreign or locally made are decorated with certain emblems indicative of rank. About two dozen or more are used on these festive occasions.

Music. The Kobi, third or fourth to the Agahju is occupied by the musicians. The musical instruments consist of almost every description of fifes, trumpets and drums, of which the ivory and Kakaki trumpets and Ogidigbo drum are peculiar to the sovereign.

The King enthroned is surrounded by his favourite wives, one of whom, the Are-ori-ite, holds a small silk parasol over his head from behind as a canopy.

About 30 or 40 female Ilaris with costly dress and velvet caps on, are seated on the scarlet cloth on the right and on the left in front of the throne, but in the open air, under two large umbrellas, one on either side, a wide space being left between them.

Then there is a row of about ten large umbrellas each on the right and the left, both rows facing each other, leaving a wide avenue between from the throne to the main entrance gate ; under those on the right are seated the Crown Prince supported by all the princes and the principal eunuchs : under those on the left are the younger eunuchs, the Ilaris, the Tetus, and other palace officials. Behind these on either side are the crowds of spectators.

At a considerable distance in front of the throne, in the avenue left between the two groups, stand the Basorun and the rest of the Oyo Mesi to do homage. This is done by taking off their robes, wrapping their cloths round their waists, leaving the body bare ; three times they have to run to the main entrance gate, sprinkle earth on their heads and on their naked bodies, and run

back half way towards the throne, prostrating themselves on the bare ground, on the stomach and on the back !

Then follows the customary oration from the throne, the King speaking in an undertone with the iru kere in front of his mouth, and the chief of the eunuchs, who with his lieutenants the Otun and the Osi'wefa is standing midway between the throne and the noblemen in the avenue between the spectators, acts as his spokesman, repeating his message in a loud voice to the Basorun and his colleagues. The Basorun replies first, congratulating His Majesty, wishing him long life and prosperity, the other noblemen follow in regular order, the Asipa being the last. The chief of the eunuchs in like manner repeats the congratulatory address to their lord.

That over, the sacrificial feast is now brought forward for distribution. About 40 dishes of stewed meat, 40 baskets of eko, 15 pots of beer, a bowl or two of boiled yam, a large quantity of boiled corn (maize) to these is added in later years a demijohn of rum.

The Add-hd or king's taster now steps forward with a rod in his right hand, and a shield on his left, accompanied by his drummer. He first dances before the King and then retreats taking with him his own portion, a basket of eko, a plate of meat, a pot of beer, one yam, a head of corn ; he is to have a taste of each of these in the presence of the king, and the concourse of spectators present, after which his followers make away with the rest of his portion.

Next comes the Olosa or king's robber, plajang the clown. He is dressed in a flowing garment, creeps about on all fours, performing mimic acts of robbery for the amusement of the spectators. After a few more amusements, the curtain drops. The rest of the dishes are cleared away into the dining hall where the Asipa by virtue of his office subsequently distributes them among the noblemen and their followers according to their rank, that of the Basorun being one half of the whole. When the curtain rises again, the King appears in a more gorgeous robe, with another crown on his head. His Majesty now steps out of the Kobi with his staff in hand, and walks towards the Ogidigbo drum, stately and majestic, and the Basorun comes dancing to meet him ; all at once the drums, fifes, and trumpets strike up in concert, the two rows of umbrellas move forward meeting in the centre to form a shady avenue for the two august personages, the King stepping forward with measured treads to the sound of the music, and the Basorun, dancing, and meeting him, receives from him one head of stringed cowries. This however is expected to be returned the next day, the apparent gift being merely a part of the ceremony.

This usually ends the show, but on the B§re festival the King continues his walk right on to the great entrance gate, then half round the quadrangle giving the spectators a full view of himself, then by a side door disappears into the inner precincts of the palace. The spectators thereupon disperse.

These three festivals are concluded by a few male Ilaris carrying sacrifices to certain quarters in the outskirts of the city in a state of perfect nudity, which is rather a trying time for them ; there is always a rush of the women clearing out of their way, on the approach of them ; the performance being symbolic of some religious rite. If it is violated by any show of natural excitement, it must be atoned for, and there is but one penalty, viz., decapitation ! But there is no record of any such case occurring within living memory. Their reward for this trying ordeal is, that after their return, being properly dressed, they are admitted into the King's presence, who, sitting in state, receives them with marks of honour.

This ends the ceremonies of the festivals.

But at the Bere season, one more ceremony remains, that known as the ceremony of " Touching the grass." About 5.30 p.m. on a day appointed, the King issuing from the palace is accompanied by his slaves who have been engaged in piling into two or three heaps the bundles of bere grass scattered about in the area in front of the palace, including those brought from the provinces. The piles are done up in an artistic manner, 8 or loft. high in an open space away from any risk of fire. His Majesty now steps forward, and lays both hands upon each of the heaps, making a short speech, invoking blessings on the Yoruba nation, congratulating himself for being spared to see another year. This brings the Bere festival to a close.

The Funeral of the King

Although the funeral of the King cannot properly he said to be one of his public appearances, yet it is considered more convenient to describe it in this place along with other public ceremonies of which he is the centre.

The Kings are buried in the Bard. The funeral usually takes place at night. It is notified to the public by the sounding of the Okinkin (a musical instrument Uke the bugle), the ivory trumpet, and the Koso drum, a drum which is usually beaten every morning at 4 a.m. as a signal for him to rise from his bed ; to beat it at night therefore, is to indicate that he is retiring to his final resting place.

The body is removed to the Bard on the back of those whose office it is to bury the Kings the chief of whom is a titled personage

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known as the Ona-onse-awo, and his lieutenants. At certain stations on the route between the palace and the Bard, eleven in all, they halt and immolate a man and a ram, and also at the Bard itself, four women each at the head and at the feet, two boys on the right and on the left, were usually buried in the same grave with the dead monarch to be his attendants in the other world, and last of all the lamp-bearer in whose presence all the ceremonies are performed.

All these practices, however, have long been aboUshed, a horse and a bullock being used instead of human beings.

The King is buried in black and white dress ; but the crown on his head, the gorgeous robe with which he was laid out in state, and with which his corpse was decked to the Bard, and the bracelets on his wrists and ankles are never buried with him, these become the perquisites of the Ona-ofise-awo and his lieutenants.

The Bard in which the Kings are buried is distinguished by its aloof situation from public thoroughfares in the outskirts of the city, and having to it as many kohis as there are Kings lying there, one being erected over each. The present Bard enshrines the bones of King Oluewu the last of ancient Ovg with those of the late Kings of the present city. It is not open to the pubHc ; several of the late King's wives are secluded here (as in a convent) and charged with the sole duty of taking care of the graves of their departed husbands.

Their mother superintendent is the lyamgde generally styled " Baba " (father). She is thus styled because being entirely devoted to the worship of Sango, one of the earliest deified Kings, she is often " inspired " or " possessed " by the god, and thus came to be regarded as the embodiment of that famous King.

Additions are made to their number at every fresh burial, usually from among the favourites of the deceased husband. These women must all be celibates for life, unfortunately among the number are usually found some who are virgins and must remain so for life : any misbehaviour is punished with the death of both culprits, the man on the day the crime is detected, and the woman after her confinement.

Besides those who are immolated at the death of the sovereign there used to be some " honourable suicides " consisting of certain members of the royal family, and some of the King's wives, and others whose title implies that they are to die with the King whenever that event occurs. With the title they received as a badge a cloth known as the " death cloth," a beautiful silk damask wrapper, which they usually arrayed themselves with on special occasions

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during the King's lifetime. Although the significance of this was well-understood both by themselves and by their relatives, yet it is surprising to see how eager some of them used to be to obtain the office with the title and the cloth. They enjoyed great privileges during the King's lifetime. They can commit any crime with impunity. Criminals condemned to death and escaping to their houses become free. These are never immolated, they are to die honourably and voluntarily.

Of the members of the royal family and others to die were : —

1. The Aremo or Crown Prince who practically reigned with his father, enjoyed royal honours, and had equal power of life and death.
2. Three princes with hereditary titles viz., the Magaji lyajin, the Agunpopo, and the Olusami.
3. Two titled personages not of royal blood viz., the Osi'wefa and the Olokun-esin (master of the horse) who is generally styled " Ab'obaku," i.e. one who is to die with the King.
4. The female victims were : —

lya Oba, the king's official mother ; lya Naso, lyalagbon (the Crown Prince's mother) ; lyale Mole (the If a priestess), the Olgrun-ku-mefun, the lyamonari, the lya'-le-ori (these are all priestesses) and the Are-ori-ite the chief favourite.

It will be observed that all the above-mentioned are those who by virtue of their office are nearest to the King at all times, and have the easiest access to his person ; to make their hfe dependent on his, therefore, is to ensure safety for him against the risk of poisoning, or the dagger of the assassin.

The custom is that each should go and die in his (or her) own home, and among his family. The spectacle is very affecting. Dressed in their " death cloth," they issue from the palace to their homes surrounded by their friends, and their drummers beating funeral dirges, eager crowds of friends and acquaintances flocking around them, pressing near to have a last look at them or to say the final farewell as they march homewards. The house is full of visitors, mourners and others, some in profuse tears ; mournful waitings and funeral odes are heard on all sides enough to break the stoutest heart. While the grave is digging, the coffin making, a parting feast is made for all the friends and acquaintances ; and as they must die before sunset, they enjoy themselves as best they can for that day by partaking of the choicest and favourite dishes, appearing several times in changes of apparel, distributing presents with a lavish hand around, and making their last will disposing of their effects. When everything is ready, the grave and the coffin approved of, they then take poison, and pass off quietly. But if it fails or is too slow to take effect, and the sun is about to

set, thelast office is performed by the nearest relatives (by strangling or otherwise) to save themselves and the memory of their kin from indelible disgrace. The body is then decently buried by the relatives and the funeral obsequies performed.

In many cases voluntary suicides take place. Some of the King's favourite slaves who are not required to die often commit suicide in order to attend their master in the other world expecting to enjoy equally the emoluments of royalty in the other world as in this.

But these customs are now d5dng out with the age especially since King Atiba in 1858 abolished that of the Crown Prince dying ; the loss of experienced princes like the lyajin around the throne is also felt irreparable. With the exception of the women, all the men now refuse to die and they are never forced to do so, but are superseded in their office if the next King wills it ; they must then retire quietly from the city to reside in any town in the country in order to prevent the confusion of two individuals bearing the same title. As for the Crown Prince, he expects to succeed his father on the throne but if he is rejected by the king-makers, he also has to retire from the city.

Courtiers and Household Officers of the Crown

The palace officials consist of : — I. Titled officers. II. The Eunuchs. III. The Ilaris. Some reside in the palace, others attend at regular hours every day for duty.

I. The principal officers having duties in the palace are : —

1. The Ona-Olokun-esin or Ab'Oba-ku i.e. the master of the horse, i.e. one who is to die with the King. This officer resides in his own house but repairs to the palace daily on duty. He has free access equally with the Eunuchs to all the apartments. The title is hereditary. As his name implies he is to die with the King to be his attendant in the other world, and consequently he is granted unrestricted liberty to live as he likes, and to do whatever he likes, and, like all other officials who must die with the King, his house is a sanctuary of safety and reprieve for all criminals condemned to death, if they can escape thither.

2. The Ona-ile-mole is the Ifa priest or chief diviner, a kind of domestic chaplain. He has for his assistants the Are-awo and others. They are to consult the Ifa oracle for the King every fifth day called Ojo-Awo i.e. the day of the mysteries.

3. The Ona-Onse Awo. The daily duties of this officer are not so well-defined, but he has to attend daily at the palace. He has

his lieutenants to the sixth grade. But their chief duty is to carry the jemains of the deceased monarch from the palace to the Bard for interment.

4. The Qna-modekh. This is the civil counterpart of the mihtary title of Seriki. This officer is the head, or leader of all the youths in the city and country, capable of bearing arms, whoever may be their father or master. He forms a band of them all, and is supposed to train them in manly sports and civic duties. It is his prerogative to shield members of his band from the penalties of the law whenever they have become liable to such, by any rash act.

5. The Isugbins. These are members of the palace orchestra. They number about 210 per.sons, playing on fifes, the Okinkin and the Ivory trumpets, and the special drums Koso and Gbedu,

(«) The Ahikoso or Koso drummer's chief duty is to wake up the King every morning at 4 a.m. with his drum.

(b) The Aludundun or the Dundun drummer. He has to attend at the palace every day within certain hours, including the \dsiting or business hours. He has one of the front Kobis assigned to him, where he sits discoursing events with his drum, all during his office hours. With it, he pre-announces the presence of any visitor in the palace, so that in whatever part of the palace the King may be, he can tell by the sound of the drum who has entered the court yard before the personage is actually announced. This is one of the peculiarities of the Yoruba language, and the art of the drummers. The names, praises and attributes of every family of note are known to all drummers, and musicians, and they are experts in eulogizing and enlarging on the praises of any one they wish to honour, speaking it with their drums. If for instance a white man enters the palace, the drummer would strike up : " Oyinbo, Oyinbo, afi okun se gnk " (the white man, the white man who makes of the ocean a high way). In strains like this he would continue for a while enlarging upon his praises.

6. The Arokins. These are the rhapsodists or national historians, an hereditary title ; they have an apartment to themselves where they repeat daily in songs the genealogy of the Kings, the principal events of their lives and other notable events in the history of the Yoruba country.

7. The lie tndle is the palace surveyor. He has charge of all

the buildings within that vast compound, especially of the Kgbis. He is to see that every part is kept in good repair. He is also to attend to the drains and the grounds, especially after a heavy fall of rain. He is said to be the principal officer who is to wash the corpse of the King and dress it before it is placed in the coffin.

8. The Tetus. These are the sheriffs or King's executioners. They are about 19 in number, each one of them with his subordinates has specified duties to perform e.g., it is the duty of the 15th with his subordinates to clear the grounds and dishes after the King has entertained the Oyq Mesi. They number about 150 in all.

II. The Eunuchs. The Eunuchs are called Iwefa or Iba-afin (contracted to Baafin) i.e. lordlings of the palace. The principal are : — The Ona'efa or chief of the Eunuchs, the Otun'efa and the Osi'efa his principal Ueutenants, and others to the sixth grade. Besides these are the untitled ones, and boys.

The Ona'efa is a high legal personage ; he hears and decides suits and appeals brought to the King whenever His Majesty cannot sit in person, and his decision is as good as the King's whose legal adviser he is. We have seen above the principal part he plays in public festivals and state ceremonies.

The Otun'efa has the charge of the suburban town of Koso, built in honour of the national god Sango. It is his duty to worship at the shrine at stated periods on behalf of the Yoruba people. He sometimes helps to decide cases. He is also one of the chief guardians of the King's children.

The Osi'efa or Olosi although the least of the three yet is the most honoured. He represents the King on all occasions and in all matters civil as well as military. He sometimes acts as commander-in-chief in military expeditions, he is allowed to use the crown, the state umbrellas, and the Kakaki trumpet, and to have royal honours paid to him . On such occasions he is privileged also to dispense the King's prerogatives. His ordinary duties are : to be near the King's person at all times, having free access to every part of the palace including the harem ; to see that the King's bed is properly made, before he retires every night ; to visit

him at midnight and at cock-crow to see if he has had a restful night, and to call him up at 4 a.m. before the Koso drum begins to sound. He is to head those of the King's wives who are to dance at the Akesan market once a year, after the deity presiding over markets has been propitiated. With Eni-gjk one of the titled ladies of the palace, he has charge of the King's market and enjoys in part the emoluments accruing therefrom.

Why these exceptional honours are bestowed upon the third

ih rank among the Eunuchs, will be told hereafter in the history of one of the early kings.

The Eunuchs are a grade higher than the Ilaris and must be respected by them ; however young a Eunuch may be, he must be addressed as " Baba " (father) by any Ilari even the oldest.

The custom of castrating a man is said to have originated from the punishment inflicted for the crime of incest or ot beastiaUty.

The Eunuchs are distinguished by the manner they wear their gowns gathered on the shoulders, leaving their arms bare. They are now generally chosen from boys bought with money, and employed first as pages to the King, or attendants on one of his wives. The custom of choosing boys was introduced by one of the later Kings ; his reason for it was, that before the age of puberty, boys will hardly be cognizant of their loss, and he would thus spare himself the remorse of conscience which would follow the mutilation of an adult, and also save his victim from a Ufe-long mortification.

Emasculation of an adult is now only resorted to instead of capital punishment in cases of adultery with the wife of a king ; but in order that the system may not be abused, provincial kings are not allowed to resort to this mode of punishment, nor even to keep Eunuchs ; any one really guilty must be sent to the capital where a special surgeon is kept for the purpose who is skilful in the art.

The Eunuchs are the guardians of the King's children, the princes and princesses as a rule are born in the house of one of the principal Eunuchs for as soon as any of the King's wives becomes a mother, she is separated from the other women, and placed under the guardianship of one of them, and she is not to return to the palace until the child is weaned.

The titled ones among them are masters of large compounds, and they also keep their own harems as well ; their wives are called " Awewo," i.e. one with hands tied ; because they are doomed to be for ever childless. In cases of adultery disclosed by pregnancy both the defaulters in early days were to suffer capital punishment ; the man on the day the crime was proved against him, and the woman with the issue on the day she is delivered. These extreme measures, however, have been allowed to die out, in favour of fines or other less severe punishments.

The Eunuchs have the exclusive right of seizing anything in the market with impunity. They have also the unenviable privilege of mingling with the King's wives either in the harem or whenever they appear in public on any festive occasion.

Ill The Ilaris. The term Ilari denotes parting of the head,

from the peculiar way the hair of the head is done. They are of both sexes, they number some hundreds, even as many as the King desires to create.

The individual to be created an Ilari is first shaved completely, then small incisions, are made on the occiput (if a male) and on the left arm, into both of which a specially prepared ingredient is rubbed, supposed to be a charm capable of giving effect to whatever the name given to the individual at the same time signifies. Their names generally signify some attributes of the King, or are significant of his purpose, intention or will, or else the preservation of his life, e.g. Oba I'olu, the King is supreme ; Oba-ko-se-tan, the King is not ready ; S'aiye ro, the upholder of the world (i.e. the kingdom) ; Oba gb'ori, the King the overcomer ; Madarikan, do not oppose him. The following are the names of some of the principal Ilaris, all of which will be seen to be significant.

I Kafiaiye f ' Oba

Ote d'afo

2 Madarikin

Aiye-gbemi

3 Ikudefun

Magb'orimipete

4 Ilugbenka

Kutiya

5 Obajuwonlo

Kape laiye

6 Opaykkata

35 Agbasa

7 S'aiyero

36 Ilugbohun

8 Mob'oludigbaro

n

Oba gb'aiye

9 Obagbeiile

38 Agbelegbiji

10 Obagbori

Oba diji

II Ayunbo

Kosiku

12 Ote o lowg

Olu orin-kkn

13 Kotito

Kosiji

14 Obakosetan

Enu f'oba

15 Ori§a fetu

Oba I'agba

16 Oba d'origi

Mako'hun

17 Sunmo-Oba

Osan

18 Olukobinu

Oba gbede

19 Kafilegbgin

Oba femi

20 Obadirere

Oba gba-iyo

21 Makobalap§

fkufo

22 Mab'obadu u

Orikunkun

23 Temileke

Mako'hun

24 Oba-ni yio jilo

Olufowoti

25 Ori-ehin

Img kojo

26 Oba-tun-wa-se

Ilusinmi

27 Agbklk

Ododun

28 Agbkro

Eni-iran

29 Kutenlo

58 Agbe defun

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59 Oba-li-a-isin 64 Madawo t'gba-lori

60 Emi-mo rOba-mi 65 Ma-ni-Oba lara

61 Igba-abere 66 Maro-Oba-lohun

62 Oba I'olu 67 Oridagogo

63 Akegbe 68 Apeka

Every male Ilari has a female counterpart who is called his companion. The Ilaris themselves by courtesy call them their " mother." They are both created at one and the same time and they are supposed to seek each other's interest, although there must be no intimacy between them ; the female Ilaris being denizens of the King's harem ; the only attention they are allowed to pay each other is to make exchange of presents at the yearly festivals.

Each Ilari has a representative image made of clay called " Sugudu," having incisions on its head and arm similar to his own, with the same ingredient rubbed into them.

The Ilaris are to keep the head shaved, one half being done from the middle line downwards alternately every fifth day except the circular patch on the occiput where the incisions were made ; there the hair is left to grow as long as possible being always plaited and sometimes dyed black with indigo.

The male Ilaris are the King's body guard or " The keepers of his head." They are of different grades including high-placed servants, messengers, and menials. Some of the favoured ones are made masters of large compounds, the King supplying them with horses and grooms, and assigning to them certain gates where they collect tolls, the proceeds being divided between their master and themselves for their maintenance ; they are also feudal lords of some masters of large compounds in different parts of the city who serve them in various capacities in war or in time of peace.

All the inmates of their houses are for the most part the King's slaves, and every newly made Ilari is handed over to the charge of one or other of these highly-placed ones.

These favoured ones ride upon the tallest horses whenever the King goes out in public, forming his body guards ; others are servants to these ; but their chief work one and all is that of house repair year by year.

On any festive occasion when the King appears in state, as many of the male Ilaris as are required to be present must each one take his " sugudu " with him to his seat. They are on such occasions to be without a headgear or breeches with only a cloth over the body, passed under the right aim, and knotted on the left shoulder, the arms being left bare.

It is the especial privilege of the Ilaris, male or female, to carry nothing on the head save their hats or caps.

Ladies of the Palace

The ladies of the palace consist of eight titled ladies of the highest rank, eight priestesses, other ladies of rank, besides Ilaris and the Ayabas or King's wives.

The whole of them are often spoken of loosely as " the King's wives," because they reside in the palace, but strictly speaking the titled ladies and the priestesses at least should not be included in the category. Again, all the ladies of rank are often spoken of as Ilaris, but there is a marked difference between them.

The following are the ladies of the highest rank in their due order : —

1 lya Oba 5 lya-fin-Iku

2 lya kere 6 lyalagbgn

3 lya-Naso 7 Orun-kumefun

4 lya-monari 8 Are-orite

I. The lya Oba is the King's (official) mother. For reasons stated above (vide p. 48) the King is not to have a natural mother. If his mother happens to be living when he is called to the throne, she is asked to " go to sleep," and is decently buried in the house of a relative in the city. All the inmates of that house are accorded special piivileges and enjoy marked deference as " members of the household of the King's mother."

The King sends to worship at her grave once a year. One of the ladies of the palace is then created lya-Oba, and she is supposed to act the part of a mother to him. It is her privilege to be the third person in the room where the King and the Basorun worship the Orun in the month of September every year.

She is the feudal head of the Basorun.

2 The lya kere. Next to the King's mother, the lya kere holds the highest rank. Greater deference is paid to the lya Oba indeed, but the lya kere wields the greatest power in the palace. She has the charge of the King's treasures. The royal insignia are in her keeping, and all the paraphernalia used on state occasions, she has the power of withholding them, and thus preventing the holding of any state reception to mark her displeasure with the King when she is offended. We have seen above that she is the person entitled to place the crown on the King's head at the coronation.

She is the " mother " of all the Ilaris male and female, for it is in her apartment they are usually created ; she keeps in her custody

all the " sugudus " bearing the marks of each Ilari in order to ensure the safety of the King's life.

Great and honourable as is the Olosi, she exercises full power over even him, and can have him arrested and put in irons if he offends. She is the feudal head of the Aseyin, Oluiwo, and the Bale of Ogbomgso. With the assumption of this office, she is, of course, to be a celibate for life.

3. The lya-Naso has to do wth the worship of Sango generally and is responsible for everything connected with it.

The King's private chapel for Sango worship is in her apartment, and all the emoluments and perquisites arising therefrom are hers. She has also to do with the same at Koso.

4. The lya-monari is the first lieutenant and assistant to the lya-Naso. It is her office to execute by strangling any Sango worshipper condemned to capital punishment, as they are not to die by the sword, and hence cannot be executed by the T^tus,
5. The lya-fin-Ikii is the second lieutenant and assistant to the lya-Naso. She is the King's " Adosu Sango," i.e. the King's devotee to the Sango mysteries. As all Sango worshippers are to devote one of their children to the worship of the god, she stands in place of that to the King. She has the charge of the sacred ram which is allowed to go everywhere and about the market unmolested, and may eat with impunity anything from the sellers.
6. The lyalaghon. — The mother of the Crown Prince is always promoted to the rank of lyalaghon. In case she is not living whoever is promoted to that office acts like a mother to him. She enjoys great influence, and controls a portion of the city.
7. The Orun-kumefun is also connected with the Aremo.
8. The Are-orite. This official is the King's personal attendant. She is to see that his meals are properly prepared, and his bed properly made, and also to see him comfortably in bed before retiring to her own apartment. She is to hold the silken parasol over his head as a canopy when enthroned, and is constantly by his side to perform small services for him on state and other occasions.

These eight ladies holding responsible positions are each of them the head of a small compound within the palace walls.

The Priestesses

1. lya'le Ori 5. lya Olosun
2. lyale Mole 6. lyafin Osun 3: lya Orisanla 7. lyafin Eri
3. lya Yemaja 8. lyafin-Orunfumi

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(i) lya le Ori is the priestess of the god Ori or god of fate. In her apartment is the King's Ori and she is the one to propitiate it for him.

(2) lya' le mole has in her keeping the King's If a god, and when the If a priests come every fifth day to worship and to consult it, she takes an active part in the ceremonies. She is the head of all the Babalawos (Ifa priests) in the city.

(3) — (S) ^s their names denote, are priestesses of the gods indicated by the title.

Other Ladies of High Rank

1. The Iyamod§ 5. The Eni-Oja
2. The lya'le Oduduwa 6. The lya'le-Agbo ;-]. The Ode 7. The lya-Otun
3. The Obaguntg

(i) The lyamode. — This high official resides in one of the outhouses of the palace, but her duties are not specially in the palace. She is the superior of those celibates living in the Bard and is styled by them " Baba " i.e. father.

Her office is to worship the spirits of the departed Kings, calling out their Eguguns in a room in her apartments set aside for that purpose, being screened off from view with a white cloth.

The King looks upon her as his father, and addresses her as such, being the worshipper of the spirits of his ancestors. He kneels in saluting her, and she also returns the salutation kneeling, never reclining on her elbow as is the custom of the women in saluting their superiors. The King kneels for no one else but her, and prostrates before the god Sango, and before those possessed with the deity, calling them " father." These are among those set apart for life-long service at the Bard. When any one of them is thus " possessed " by the spirit of deceased monarchs (it is said of them " Oba wa si ara won ") and comes raving from the Bara to the palace, she is im.mediately placed under the charge of the lyamode ; the possessed on such occasions prognosticates, and tells the people what sacrifice they are to offer to avert impending evils. The ceremony on such occasions is to pour some water into a mortar, covering it with a wide calabash, and this the other women in the palace beat vigorously as a drum ; the possessed and others infected with the excitement dancing to the sound of this drumming.

The Akunyungbas (the King's bards) are instructed in her apartments, their teacher comes there three times daily for three months or more until the learners are perfect in their studies. Small corporal punishments, twitchings, of the ears, and cracks on

the head are not spared on these occasions, if they are not quick at catching the words or if their memory fails them.

With the assumption of this office, the tyamgde is, of course, to be a celibate for hfe.

(2) The lya'le-Oduduwa is the priestess, of Oduduwa the supposed founder of the Yoruba nation. A special temple is built in the palace for him where his image is enshrined and worshipped. She is the head of all Oduduwa worshippers in the city. She resides in one of the out houses, and does not rank with the eight priestesses mentioned above.

(3) The Ode is the head of all the worshippers of the god Os6si. On state occasions she appears dressed as a hunter (hence her name) wearing on her shoulder a bow ornamented with strings of cowries neatly strung.

(4) The Obagunte is not regarded as having a very high position, although she represents the King in the Ogboni house on ordinary occasions, her work being strictly connected with that fraternity. She enters the Ogboni chamber on all occasions and acts in the King's name, reporting to his majesty the events of each day's sitting. Whenever the King wishes to entertain the Ogbonis, she has to undertake that duty.

(5) The Eni-ojd is at the head of all the devil-worshippers in the town. She also has charge of the King's market, and enjoys all the perquisites accruing therefrom. She wears a gown like a man, on her arms the King leans on the day he goes to worship at the market, i.e. to propitiate the deity that presides over markets. She has under her (i) the Olosi who has joint responsibility with her for the market, and (2) the Aroja or market keeper, an officer whose duty it is to keep order, and arrange the management of the market, and who actually resides there.

(6) The lya'le-agbo is a private attendant on the King, having charge of his private pharmacy. His agunmu (powders) and agho (infusions) are all in her care : she is to see that they are in a condition fit for use when required.

All these ladies, except the Qhagunte and lya'le niQle although generally styled " Ilaris " are not really so, and that is known from the manner their hair is done up. They are really above the Ilaris.

The lya-Oba, and lya mode are always shaven, the others plait their hair in small strips from the forehead

to the top of the head and gather the rest from the back to the top, tying all into one knot with a string. This style is termed the Ikokoro.

The Ode, Eni-ojk, lyafin-Iku, lya-Olosun and the lya'le Oduduwa adorn theirs with the red feathers of the parrot's tail.

The Ilaris. — The female Ilaris are somewhat differently shaved from the male, their incisions being made from the front to the back of the head along the middle line ; the hair is allowed to grow along the same line, and it is plaited into two horns front and back, being twined with a string or thread, and the sides of the head shaved alternately every fifth day.

The following are the names of the principal female Ilaris, every one of which is significant : —

Obaloyin

Maje-Oba-koye

Didun-l'Obafe

Ire-l'Oba-ise

Igba-ewe

Ire k'aiye

Ori-ogbo

Arosin

Ajinde

Oju're

Alosin

Akosin

Omi-su-yarin

Bam wo wo

Afeka

16 Awoda

17 Irebe

18 Agbejo ⌢

19 Awujale

20 Ori're

21 Oju're

22 Awigba

23 Alogbo

24 Oridijo

25 Tijotayo

26 Aiye f'obase

27 Aji gbohun

28 Iwadero

29 Omuye

30 Ajigbore

31 Obadaro

33 Aronu

34 Apa-6-ka

35 Ina-Oba-koku

36 Agbala

37 Ota-ko-ri-aye

38 Ma-dun-mi-de-inu

39 Oledetu

40 Madajo-l'Oba

41 Ajijofe

42 Olu-f'oba

43 Iwapgle

44 Ohungbogbo

45 Aiyedero

46 Ehin-wa

47 Maha-ro-t'oba

48 Onjuwon

32 Alanu

These female Ilaris have the exclusive privilege of using the female head ties, or men's caps, the ordinary Ayabas or King's wives are distinguished by carrying their heads bare, always shaved, and their head ties used as a belt round the breasts.

At the demise of the King the whole of the Ilaris male and female go into mourning by dropping their official (Ilari) names, and letting their hair grow. At a new accession, the whole of them shave their heads. One of the earliest acts of the new sovereign after the coronation and the investiture of the Aremo (Crown Prince) and just before the next great festival is to create all the Ilaris afresh by batches every 5 days, giving a new name to each and adding a new set of his own ; only the lances of the head are re-done, not those of the arm. Each batch is to remain seven days at the He Mol|. This " distribution of honours" is eagerly sought after.

Members of the Royal Family Occupying Responsible

Positions

As a rule, distinguished members of the Royal Family except those holding responsible positions do not reside in the metropolis, a

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great number of them may be found scattered all over the provinces especially in the Ekicn Osi or Metropolitan province, where each one resides as a lord of the town or village. They may take no part in the administration of affairs in the town, lest they overshadow the chief of the town who is generally the founder or his descendant, but due deference is loyally accorded them, and certain privileges are granted them as befitting their rank. One such was Atiba the son of King Abiodun who resided in the town of Ago with Oja the foundet, after whose death Atiba became practically the master of the town before he was subsequently elected King.

Some of the princes with a large family and a large following build their own town and become lord of the town. Such was Ayeijin who built the town ot Surii near the ancient Oyo popularly known as He Gbager^ from the attributive of the founder.

There are those however, who hold high positions in the government such as the following : —

I. The OxNA Isokun. 2, The Ona Aka. 3. The Omo-Ola.

These are known as thejathers of the King, hence the saying : —

" Ona-Isokun baba Oba, Ona-Aka, baba Isokun." i.e.

The Ona-Isokun the King's father, the Ona-Aka, father to the Isokun. That is to say that they stand in the relation of a father to the King, who naturally cannot have a father living. To them it appertains to advise, admonish, or instruct the King, especially when he comes to the throne at a very early age, and as such lacks the experience indispensable for the due performance of his allimportant duty. The titles are hereditary.

We have seen above that the nomination to the throne is in their hands. The Ona I§okun seems to be the most responsible of the three. We have seen that the King-elect is to sleep in his house the first night after his election, as the formal call to the throne comes from him. Lustrations, divinations, and propitiations for the new King are done in his house. Part also of the ceremony of creating the Aremg is periormed in his house ; there all the princes are entertained in festivities, and there also all crown princes are buried if they die in that position.

Next to the above are those who are termed " brothers " to the King, they are : —

1. The Magaji lyajin 4. The Atingisi
2. The Olusami 5. The Agunpopo
3. The Arole Oba 6. The Arole lya Oba.

Officially, the Aremg takes his rank among these princes, especially in public assemblies and is generally reckoned as the last of them in official order.

As the king must have official " father " and " mother " so also must he have official " brothers." Of these the Magaji lyajin is the most distinguished. He is known as the King's elder brother, whose duty is to perform the part of an elder to a younger brother by defending his interests.

The term " Magaji " is the natural title of every heir to a great estate and is usually borne by the eldest son (or anyone in that relation) in the family. In this official royal circle the lyajin is the eldest son. The term " lyajin " impUes the repelling of insults and indignities. The title therefore means the elder brother, who wards off insults and indignities.

This will often be found necessary when the King is young and inexperienced, and too conscious of his power, or sometimes rash. It is the Magaji's place to let the consequences of his action fall on himself rather than on the King who is the embodiment of the nation.

The Ar-ole Ob. is the official in whose house all the princes are to be buried, and in the month of July every year the whole of the princes and princesses, from the Ona-Isokun downwards including the Ar§mg repair to his house to worship the spirits of their deceased ancestors. A horse is usually offered in sacrifice, and all have to feed on the flesh of the same. The lyajiu's portion is the head.

The Aremo as we have seen above is the Crown Prince. The term signifies an heir apparent, lit. Chief of the sons. How the title is formally conferred has been seen above.

The Aremo practically reigns with his father, having nearly equal power, especially when the monarch is old and feeble.

From the period of the greatest prosperity of the nation to the time of the intertribal wars, the Aremgs v/ere almost invariably tyrannical, and given to excess : they contributed largely to the disloyal explosion that

caused the civil wars and the breaking up of the unity of the Yoruba kingdom ; they were.therefore, required to die with the father at his demise. Otherwise they expect to succeed to the throne as in earliest times, but they had to be elected thereto by the constitutional king-makers who would never elect one who has been infamous.

Since King Atiba in 1858 disallowed the practice in favour of his Ar§mo Adelu, the custom has died out both for the Aremo and the other princes.

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The Nobility

There are two classes of noblemen at Oyo ; in the first, the title is hereditary ; the second which is strictly military is the reward of merit alone, and not necessarily hereditary. In both, each member is styled " Iba " which means a lord being a dimunitive of " Oba " a king.

A. The Oyo Mesi

The first class of noblemen consists of the most noble and most honourable councillors of state, termed the Oyq Mesi. They are also the king-makers. They are seven in number and of the following order : —

(i) The Osorun, (2) Agbakin, (3) Samu, (4) Alapini, {5) Laguna,

(6) Akiniku, (7) A§ipa.

The title of each (as above said) is hereditary in the same family but not necessarily from father to son ; it is within the King's prerogative to select which member of the family is to succeed to the title or he may alter the succession altogether.

They represent the voice of the nation ; on them devolves the chief duty of protecting the interests of the kingdom. The King must take counsel with them whenever any important matter affecting the state occurs. Each of them has his state duty to perform, and a special deputy at court every morning and afternoon and whom they send to the AlAfin at other times when their absence is unavoidable ; they are, however, required to attend court in person the first day of the (Yoruba) week, for the Jakuta (Sango) worship and to partake of the sacrificial feast.

(i) The OsQrtm or Iba Osorun (contr. to Basorun i.e., the lord that performs the " Oran ") may be regarded as the Prime Minister and Chancellor of the kingdom and something more. He is not only the president of the council but his power and influence are immeasurably greater than those of the others put together. His is the chief voice in the election of a King, and although the King as supreme is vested with absolute power, yet that power must be exercised within the limit of the unwritten constitution, but if he is ultra-tyrannical and withal unconstitutional and unacceptable to the nation it is the Basorun's prerogative as the mouth-piece of the people to move his rejection as a King in which case His Majesty has no alternative but to take poison and die.

His Highness being a prince is practically as absolute as a King in his own quarter of the town.

Next to the AlAfin in authority and power, he often performs the duties of a King. He takes precedence of all provincial

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kings and princes. There were times in the history of the nation when the Basoruns were more powerful than the Alafin himself.

During the long course of history there have been several alliances between the two families so that, in the older line of Basoruns at any rate, the blood of the royal family runs also in their veins.

Several points of similarity may be noted between the AlAfin and his Basorun The AlAfin is Oba (a king) he is Iba (a lord). The AlAfin' s wives are called Ayaba, the Basorun's Ayinba. They are similarly clothed, carrying their heads bare and shaven, and their head- bands used as belts ; but the Ayinbas are not equally avoided by men as the Ayabas are.

The Iha Osorun has kgbis to his palace as well, but a limited number ; those of the AlAfin being unlimited. He too has a number of Ilaris as a king, but they must be created for him by the AlAfin.

The AlAfin has his crown, his throne, his Ejigba round his neck. The Osorun has a specially made coronet of his own, a specially ornamented skin called the Wabi on which he sits, and a string of beads round his neck also like the Ejigba.

We have seen that at the principal festivals of the AlAfin, the Basorun also has minor festivals to observe in conjunction and has his part to plaj' at the main observance also.

When the AlAfin reigns long and peacefully enough to celebrate the Bebe, a festival akin to the royal jubilee, the Basorun must follow with the Owark.

But it is a peculiarity of theBasorun's children that the boys are never circumcised.

Although the title is hereditary in the same family yet it is within the King's power to change the line of succession when necessity demands that course.

Thus the whole unwritten constitution of the Yorubas seems to be a system of checks and counter-checks, and it has on the whole worked well for the country.

There have been five different families of the Basorun line, each one with its distinctive cognomen. The first and oldest belonged to the family totem of Ogun (the god of war) and have for appellatives Moro, Ma§o, Mawd, Maja, Ogun. This was the original line contemporary with the earh'est Kings. It covers the reign of i8 Kings and ended with Basorun Yamba, in the reign of King OjiGi.

With the long lease of power and influence enjoyed by this family, it became as wealthy and great as, or even greater than the sovereign himself, especially as some of the Basoruns out-lived two or three successive Kings. Therefore King Gberu the successor

of Ojigi transferred the succession to his friend Jambu of another line, whose appellatives were Maja Maro. This hne embraced the reign of seven Kings and ended with Asamu in Abiodun's reign.

The third began with Alobitoki in Aole's reign, having the appellatives of Maja Majo of the totem of Agan.

This line was not allowed to continue, it flourished during the reign of one King only, for Ojo Abuiumaku the son of Onisigun and grandson of Basorun Ga was of the older line. The fourth line began with Akioso in King MaJOTU's reign, and also ended with himself in the reign of Oluewu, the last of ancient Oyo. This family was rather insignificant.

Oluyole the first Basorun of the new city was the grandson of Basorun Yamba, and therefore of the older Ogun Hne.

The fifth and last line commenced with Gbenla in the reign of King Atiba, the totem is Aye and is the family now in office and has already lasted through the reign of three kings.

The Basoruns of Ibadan after Oluyole are only honorary with no national duties attached to the office.

A Synopsis of the Basorun Family

Ba§oruns. Appellatives. Family Totems.

1. Efufukoferi to Yamba Moro, Maso, Maja Ogun
2. Jambu to Asamu Maja Maro (?)
3. Alobitoki Maja Majo Agan
4. Akioso (?) Ese
5. Gbenla to Layode (?) Aye

(2) The Aghakin. — The duties of this official are not so welldefined, but the present Agbakin has the charge of the worship of Oraiiyan.

(3) Satnu. The duties of the Samu are not clearly known.

(4) The A lapini. — He is the head of the Egugun mysteries, and as such he is at the head of religious affairs in general. He has the charge of the famous Jenju, who is the head Egugun of the country, and who executes witches ! He is at once a religious and a secular personage ; he shares with the priests all rehgious offerings, and in secular matters with the noblemen of his class. By virtue or his peculiar office he must be a monorr.his.

(5) The Laguna is the state ambassador in critical times.

ˆ6) The Akiniku. — The real duties of this officer are not known.

(7) The Asipa as the last of them performs the duties of the junior. He is called the " Ojuwa," i.e. the one who distributes whatever presents are given to the Oyo Mesi. The Basorun in

these cases has always the lion's share viz., one half of the whole, the other half being equally divided between the rest of them.

The Asipa of the present Oyo being the son of Oja the founder of the town, has the chief voice in all municipal affairs. He is thereby acknowledged to be the master of the town.

The provincial kings and ruhng princes rank also as the noblemen of the first-class.

B. The E§qs

Next in importance to the Oyo Mesi and of a rank below them are the Esos or guardians of the kingdom. These constitute the noblemen of the second class. They also are addressed as " Iba." It is a military title, not necessarily hereditary. It is the reward of merit alone, and none but tried and proved soldiers are selected for that rank.

First and foremost among them and apart by himself stands the Kakanfo, an Esq of the Esos. Then the 70 captains of the guard ten of whom are under each of the seven councillors. Each wears an Akoro (or coronet) and carries in his hand no weapon, but a baton or staff of war known as The Invincible. There is a common saying which runs thus : — " Ohun meji I'o ye Eso Esg ja O le ogan Esq ja O ku si ogun." One of two things befits an E§g The 5so mast fight and conquer (or) The E§o must fight and peiish (in war). He is never to turn his back, he must be victorious or die in war. There is another saying : —

" Esq ki igba Oik lehin Afi bi o ba gbogbe niwaju gangan." An Esq must never be shot in the back His wounds must always be right in front. Also another saying : —

" Alakoro ki isa ogun." One who wears a coronet must never flee in battle. They are of two ranks 16 superior and 54 inferior, 70 in all and they all must reside in the capital.

are

The following

are the titles

of the former,

all of which

significant : —

GbQnka

Esq Qraiiyan

Sagbedo

Obago

Esiel§

Kogbonk

Ole

Orunt^

Owdta

Sakin

Odigbon

Sagbua

Sadoe

Erukii

GbQingboin

Adaha

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So much is this title thought of by military men and others and so great is the enthusiasm it inspires, that even the children and grandchildren of an Esq hold themselves bound to maintain the spirit and honour of their sires. The Eso is above everything else noble in act and deed.

" Emi omo Eso " (me born of an Eso) is a proud phrase generally used even to this day by any ot their descendants to show their scorn for anything mean or low, or their contempt tor any difficulty, danger, or even death itself.

Most of the Egba chiefs sprang from the Esgs of Qyq, Okukemu the first " king " of Ab§okuta was a Sagbua,

A special notice must now be taken of the Kakanfo who stands at the head of the Esos.

The Kakanfo. The title given in full is Are-Ona-Kakanfo. It is a title akin to a field-marshal, and is conferred upon the greatest soldier and tactician ot the day.

This title was introduced into the Yoruba country by King AjACBO, one of the earliest and most renowned of Yoruba Kings.

Like the Ilaris, at the time of his taking office, he is first to shave his head completely, and 201 incisions are made on his occiput, with 201 different lancets and specially prepared ingredients from 201 viols are rubbed into the cuts, one lor each. This is supposed to render him fearless and courageous. They are always shaved, but the hair on the inoculated part is allowed to grow long, and when plaited, forms a tuft or a sort of pigtail.

Kakanfos are generally very stubborn and obstinate. They have all been more or less troublesome, due it is supposed to the effect of the ingredients they were inoculated with. In war, they carry no weapon but a baton known as the " King's invincible staff." It is generally understood that they are to give way to no one not even to the King, their master. Hence Kakanfos are never created in the capital but in any other town in the kingdom.

There can be but one Kakanfo at a time. By virtue of his office he is to go to war once in 3 years to whatever place the King named, and, dead or aUve, to return home a Victor, or be brought home a corpse within three months.

The ensigns of office are : —

1. The Ojijiko. This is a cap made of the red feathers of the parrot's tail, with a projection behind reaching as far down as the waist.

2. An apron of leopard's skin, and a leopard's skin to sit on always.
3. The Asis6 or pigtail as above described.
4. The Staff Invincible.

The following are the Kakanfos who have ever borne office in the Yoruba country : —

1. Kokoro gangan of Iw6ye
2. Oyatope „
3. Oyabi „ Ajase
4. Adeta „ Jabata
5. Oku „ Jabata
6. Aignja I'aiya I'ok^ „ Ilorin
7. Toyeje „ Ogbomoso
8. Edun „ Gbogun
9. Amep6 „ Abem6
10. Kurumi „ Ijaye
11. Ojo Aburumaku „ Ogbomoso (son of Toyej§)
12. Latosisa „ Ibadan the last to hold office.

Nearly the whole of them were connected with stirring times and upheavals in the country. Afonja of Ilorin, Toyeje of Ogbomoso Kurumi of Ijaye, and Latosisa of Ibadan being specially famous. Ojo Aburumaku of Ogbomo.so fought no battles, there being no wars daring the period ; the change that has taken place in the country left the Ibadans at this time masters of all warlike operations. But in order to keep his hand in, he fomented a civil war at Ogbomoso wliich he also repressed with vigour.

Provincial Governments and Titles

Every town, village or hamlet is under a responsible head, either a provincial " king" or a Bale (mayor). In every case the title is hereditary (excepting at Ibadan) as such heads are invariably the founder or descendants ot the founder of their town.

The provincial kings are styled the lords of their town or district, and from it they take their title, e.g. : —

The Onikoyi, lord of Ikoyi ; Aseyin, lord of Iseyin ; Alake, lord or Ake ; Olowu, lord of Owu ; Oluiwo, lord of Iwo ; Alakija, lord of Ikija, etc. There are a few exceptions to this rule, where the first ruler had a distinctive name or title before he became the head of the town or district, e.g. : —

Timi of Ede, Atawoja of Osogbo, Awujadg of Ijebu, Okere of Saki, Onibode of Igboho, etc., in which case the distinctive name becomes the hereditary title of the chief ruler.

A provincial king is, of course, higher than a Bale as a duke or an earl is higher than a mayor. They are privileged to build kobis to their palaces, and to create Ilaris which Bales are not entitled to do. They are also allowed an Akoro (coronet) which Bales are not allowed to have ; but few of them indulge in large

state umbrellas. They are invested originally with power from Oyo whither they usually repair to obtain their titles, the sword of justice being given them by the AlAfin at their installation. Every one of them as well as every important Balg has an official at Oyo through whom they can communicate with the crown.

They are also invested with an Qpaga by which they are empowered to make and keep an Ilari. The Qpaga is an iron instrument of the shape of an Osain, but taller and is surmounted with the figure of a bird. This is the Qsain worshipped b}' Ilaris. To be deprived of it is equivalent to being deprived oi one's rank.

To dethrone a kingling, he is publicly divested of his robe and sandals and the announcement is made that XYZ having forfeited his title, he is deprived of it by AB his suzerain or teudal lord.

The following are the kinglings in the Oyo provinces.

1. In the Ekun Osi or Metropohtan province : — •

The Onikoyi of Ikoyi ; Olugbon of Igbon ; Aresa of Iresa ; the Ompetu of Ijeru ; Olofa of Ofa.

2. In the Ekun Otun province : —

Sabigana of Igana ; Oniwere of Iwere ; ^Alasia of Asia ; Onjo of Oke'ho ; Bagijan of Igijan ; Okere of Saki ; Alapata of Ibode ; Ona Onibode of Igboho ; Elerinpo of Ipapo ; Ikihisi ol Kihisi ; As§yin of Is§yin ; Alado of Ado ; Eleruwa of Eruwa ; Qloje of Qje.

3. In the Ibolg province : —

The Akirun ot Ikirun ; Olobu of Ilobu; Timi of Ede. the Atawoja of Osogbo ; Adimula of Ife Odan.

4. In the Epo province :

The Oluiwo of Iwo ; Ondese of Idese.

Of these vassal kings the Onikoyi, Olugbon, the Aresa and the Timi are the most ancient.

Since the wave of Fulani invasion swept away the first three, those titles exist only in name. The Onikoyi has a quarter at Ibadan, the bulk of the Ikoyi people being at Ogbomoso, the family is still extant and the title kept up.* The same may be said of the Aresa at Ilorin. But wherever the representative head of the family may be, he is completely subject to the ruler of the town, be he a Bale or a king. Thus the Olugbon at Ogbomoso is subject to the Balgof Ogbomoso, the Aresa to the king or Emir

^ The Alasia is the only man privileged not to prostrate before the Alafin in salutation according to the custom ot the country. He sits on a stool with his back turned towards him.

- The town has been rebuilt and the Onikoyi returned home in

1906.

of Ilorin, and similarly the Olowu at Abeokuta is nominally subject to the Alake, the primus of the Egba chiefs.

In the Ekun Osi and Ekun Otun provinces, no special remarks are called for in the arrangement of the titles in the government ; they are for the most part a modified form of the Oyo titles.

IbglQ titles. — Amongst the Ibglgs the royal family is called Omolaisin. The title next to that of the king which answers to the Basorun is the Osa, next to the Osa comes the Aro, then the Odofin and then the Ejemu. These are the principal councillors. The other subordinate titles are chiefly military viz., the Jagun and his heutenants the Olukotun and Olukosi. Then the Agbakin, Gbonka, Asipa which are Oyo titles that have been borrowed. Then the Saguna, Sakgtun, Sakosi, Asape, Oladifi Esinkin, and the Ar'oguny6.

The Elesije is the chief physician.

Smaller towns are governed by the Bale, and the Jagun (or Balogun) is the next to him. In time of war, the Bale appoints the Jagun to go with the Kakanfo to any expedition to which the AlAfin may send the latter ; but if it is a great expedition to which he appoints the Onikoyi, all the other vassal kings, and the Bales of every town were bound to go with him. The affairs of the town are then left to be administered by the Bale Agbe, i.e. the chief of the farmers. The duties of the Bale Agbe on ordinary occasions are to superintend the tax collectors, and to assist the Jagun who superintends the cleaning ot the roads.

The Iy.\lode, i.e. the queen of the ladies is a title bestowed upon the most distinguished lady in the town. She has also her lieutenants Otun, Osi, Ekcrin, etc., as any of the other principal chiefs of the town. Some of these lyalodes command a force of powerful warriors, and have a voice in the council of the chiefs. Through the lyalode, the women of the town can make their voices heard in municipal and other affairs.

The King's civil officers judge all minor cases, but all important matters are transferred to the AlAfin of Oyo whose decision and laws were as unalterable as those of the ancient Medes and Persians.

The Egba Province

" Egba k6 I'Olu, gbogbo won ni nse bi Oba (i.e. Egbas have no king all of them act like a king), is a common saying. That is to say, they have no king that rules. The king is acknowledged as the head of the government, but only as a figure head. More marked was this when they lived in separate townships before their concentration at Abeokuta. The Ogbonis constitute the town council, and they are also the executive, and even the E

" king" was subject to them. The same rule holds good even at Abeokuta for each township.

Amongst the highest Ogboni titles are : —

The Aro, Oluwo, Apena, Ntowa, Bala, Basala Baki, Asipa, Asalu, Lajila, Apesi, Esinkin Ola, Bayimbo, Odgfin.

The warriors rank next after the Ogbonis, the Balogun and the Seriki being the most important.

The Ijebu Province

Among the Ijebus the civil authorities are of three divisions, viz., the Osugbos or Ogboni, 2, the Ipampa, and 3 the Lamurin. Without these acting in concert, no law can be enacted or repealed. Of these bodies, the Osugbos are the highest for even the king himself must be of that fraternity. The Lamurins are the lowest.

Amongst the Egbas and Ijebus, the Ogbonis are the chief executive, they have the power of life and death, and power to enact and to repeal laws : but in the Oyo provinces the Ogbonis have no such power ; they are rather a consultative and advisory body, the king or Bale being supreme, and only matters involving bloodshed are handed over to the Ogbonis for judgment or for execution as the king sees fit.

The actual executioners at Oyo are the Tetus, amongst the Ibglos, the Jagun, and in the Epo districts the Akgdas or sword bearers of the principal chiefs, acting together.

The Ijesa and Ekiti Provinces

In the Ijega and Ekiti provinces the form of government is more or less alike, with slight modifications. The tendency is to adopt the Oyo forms ; but they have some admirable systems of their own. The municipal arrangements of the Ijesas are quite excellent.

It has been mentioned above that there are 16 provincial kings recognised in the Ekiti province under four principal ones. The title of Owa is a generic term for them all, including that of Ilesa. The Owa of Ilesa stands by himself, for the Ekitis hold the Ijesas separate from themselves.

The Orangun of Ila is sometimes reckoned amongst the Ekitis ; but he is not an Ekiti although his sympathies are with them. He aims at being the head of the Igbomina tribes, but Ila seems to stand by itself.

Titles in ancient times may be obtained by competition, and it was not always the most worthy but the highest bidder that often obtained them.

Chapter V YORUBA NAMES

The naming of a child is an important affair amongst the Yorubas ; it is always attended with some ceremonies. These of course differ somewhat, amongst the different tribes.

The naming usually takes place on the 9th day of birth if a male, or on the 7th if a female ; if they happen to be twins of both sexes, it will be on the 8th day. Moslem children of either sex are invariably named on the 8th day.

It is on that day the child is for the first time brought out of the room, hence the term applied to this event — Ko omg jade (bringing out the child). The mother also, is supposed to be in the lying-in room up to that day.

The ceremony is thus performed : — The principal members of the family and friends having assembled early in the morning of the day, the child and its mother being brought out of the chamber, a j ugf ul of water is tossed up to the roof (all Yoruba houses being low-roofed), and the baby in the arms of the nurse or an elderly female member of the family, is brought under the eaves to catch the spray, the baby yells, and the relatives shout for joy. The child is now named by the parents and elderly members of the family, and festivities follow ; with presents, however trifling, for the baby from every one interested in him.

This is evidently an ancient practice, a form of baptism which the ancestors of the Yorubas must have derived from the eastern lands, where tradition says they had their origin, and is another proof of the assertion that their ancestors had some knowledge of Christianity.

In some cases there is also the offering of sacrifice and consultation of the household oracle on the child's behalf.

For the sake of convenience we call this the Christening of the child. There are three sets of names a child can possibly have, although not every child need have the three ; one at least will be inapplicable.

1. The Amutorunwa i.e. the name the child is born with.
2. The AhisQ i.e. the christening name.
3. The Oriki i.e. the cognomen or attributive name.

A few remarks on each of these sets of names will serve to elucidate their meanings.

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I. The Amutqrunwa

r A child is said to be "born with a name" {lit. brought from heaven) when the peculiar circumstance of its birth may be expressed by a name which is apphcable to all children born under like circumstances. The most important of these is twin-births. No condition is invested with an air of greater importance, or has a halo of deeper mystery about it, than that of twin-births ; the influence is felt even upon children that may be born after them. Twins in Yoruba are almost credited with extra-human powers, although among some barbarous tribes they are regarded as monsters to be despatched at once.

Taixvo or Eho. — The name of the first born of twins, applicable to either sex. It is a shortened form of To-aiye-w6 (have the first taste of the world). The idea is that the first born was sent forward to announce the coming of the latter, and he is considered the younger of the two. [Compare the stories of Esau and Jacob, and of Pharez and Zarah,in both of which the first born of the twins virtually became the younger of the two.]

Kehinde " He who lags behind," i.e. the second born. tdowu. The child born after twins, male or female, Idowus are cdways considered heady and stubborn, hence their usual

appellation " J)su lehiu ibeji " (the d 1 after twins). There is

also a current superstition that the mother who has had twins and fails to get an Idowu in due course, may likely go mad ; the wild and stubborn Idowu " flying into her head " will render her insane ! Hence all mothers of twins are never at ease until in due course the Idowu is born.

Idogbe. — The child after Idowu if male. Alaba, — The child after Idowu if female.

Thus we see the influence of the twins affecting the second and third births after themselves.

Eia Okd. — The name given to the third of triplets. The next to twins in importance is the child named Oni Oni. This name is given to a small neurotic child which at its birth cries incessantly day and night. The child after Oni is called Ola, the next O^nla, and so on.

These names signify to-day, to-morrow, the day after to-morrow, etc. With a small tribe termed the Isih people, it is carried on as far as Ijgni i.e. the 8th day, if the mother have as many.

Asa or Oroyh are names applied under conditions similar to those of Oni by some clans. The latter is generally preferred by worshippers of the god Orisa Oko. Igh is a child born with breech or footling presentation.

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llgri is a child who was conceived during absence of menstruation.

Qtnope signfies " the child is late " that is, a child born later than the normal period of utero-gestation.

Ojo or Aina is a child born with the cord twined round its neck. The choice of name is a matter of preference partly clannish or by the decision of the family Oracle. Ojo, however, is never given to females, Aina may be male or female.

Ajayi is a child born "with face downwards" it is styled Adojude, that is to say, when rotation is absent during the exit of the shoulders.

Oke is a name given to a child which faints away on being fed in a horizontal position as is the custom of the country.

Oke (a bag) is a child born with membranes unruptured.

Salako (male), Talabi (female), a child born with the head and body covered with the caul, or ruptured membranes.

Dada is a curly-headed child styled " Olowo Ori."

Olugbodi is a child born With supernumerary digits.

Abigna means " born by the way side." i.e. a child born when the mother is on a journey, or away from home.

Abiodun born at the new year or any annual festival.

Abiose born on a holy day.

Babatunde means " father comes again," a name given to a male child born soon after the death of its grandfather. The sire is supposed to re-appear in the newly born.

Abiba is applied to a female under similar circumstances.

Yetunde means " mother comes again " a name given to a female child born soon after the death of its grandmother. The granny is supposed to re-appear in the newly born.

Babarimisa (father fled at my approach) is the name given to a posthumous child.

Jg'hdJQ a child whose mother died at its birth (Ichabodlike) or during the puerperium.

II, — The Abiso or Christening Name

All children need not be " born with a name " but all must be named. Names are not given at random because of their euphony or merely because a distinguished member of the family or of the community was so named, but of a set purpose from circumstances connected with the child itself, or with reference to the family fortunes at the time etc. Hence the saying : — " He la iw6 kia to so omo I'oruko (the state of the house must first be considered before naming a child). The names then are always

B2

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significant of something, either with reference to the child itself or to the family.

A child may have two or more christening names given it one by each parent or grandparents if living or by any elderly member of the family. Whichever is most expressive of the present circumstances of the family will be the one to stick.

(a) Names having reference to the child itself directly and indirectly

to the family : — Ayodele Joy enters the house.

Onipede The consoler is come.

Morenike I have some one to pet.

Moseb'olatan Joy hitherto despaired of. Omoteji A child big enough for two.

Akinyele A strong one befits the house.

Ibiyemi Good birth becomes me.

Ibiyinka Surrounded by children.

Ladipo Increase honour (of children born).

(b) Names having reference to the family directly and indirectly

to the child itself : —

Ogundalenu Our home has been devastated by war. Otegbeye Warfare deprived us of our honours.

Ogunmola The river Ogun took away our honour,

lyapib Many trials.

Olabisi Increased honours.

Laniyonu Honour is full of troubles,

Kurumi Death has impoverished me.

Oyebisi Increased titles.

(c) Names compounded of Ade, Ola, Olu, Oye originally belonged

to one of high or princel}^ birth, but are now used more or

less indiscriminately : —

Adebiyi The crown has begotten this.

Adegbite The crown demands a throne.

Olaleye Honour comes fittingly, or is full of dignity.

Olubiyi A chief has begotten this.

Oyeyemi Title becomes me.

Oyewole Title enters the house i.e. where the parent

has a title.

N.B. — Ade does not always signify a crown, it may be taken

from the verb de to arrive, it may then mean coming, e.g.,

Adebisi or I .,

. , . t My commg causes an increase.

Adesina My coming opens the way.

Adepeju My coming completes the number (of births)

Adepoju The coming has become too much.

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(d) Some names are compounded with fetish names showing the deity worshipped in the family : —

Sangobunmi Sango (the god of thunder and Hghtning) gave me this.

Ogundipe Ogun (the god of war) consoles me with this.

Ogunseye Ogun has done the becoming thing.

Omi yale The god of streams visits the house.

Oba-bunmi The King (i.e. god of small pox) gave me this

Fabunni Ifa has given me this.

Fatosin Ifa is worthy to be worshipped.

Fafumke Ifa gave me this to pet.

Osuntoki Osun is worthy of praise or honour.

It msLy be noted that names compounded with Ifa are very common amongst the Ijesas which shows that they are devoted Ifa worshippers.

(<;) Compounds of Ode shows that the father is a worshipper of Ogun or Erinlc : —

Odewale Ode comes to the house i.e. visits the family.

Odemuyiwa Ode has brought me this. These names are often confounded with Adewale and Ademuyiwa.

(/) Compounds of Oso or Efun shows that the family is a v/orshipper of Orisa Oko i.e. the god of the fields : —

Osodipe Oso has granted a consolation.

Osodeke Oso has become a roof i.e. shield and shelter.

Efunsetan Efun has done it (by granting the child).

Efunlabi Efun is the one born.

(g) Compounds of Oje are peculiar to the children of Elewi of Ado. Names pecuUar to the royal family of Oyo : —

Male : Afgnja, Tela, Ajuan.

Female : — Ogboja, Siye, Akere. Yoruba names are with few exceptions common to both genders. Ojo and Akerele, however, are never applied to females. Also names compounded oi Akin which means strength ; and, of course, such names as Babatunde, Babarimisa can only apply to males, and Yetunde to females.

Abiku Names

There are some peculiar names given to a certain class of children called " Abiku " i.e. born to die. These are supposed to belong to a fraternity of demons living in the woods, especially about and within large Iroko trees ; and each one of them coming into the

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world would have arranged beforehand the precise time he will return to his company.

Where a woman has lost several children in infancy, especially after a short period of illness, the deaths are attributed to this cause, and means are adopted to thwart the plans of these infants in order that they may

stay ; for if they can only tide over the pre-arranged date, they may go no more, and thus entirely forget their company.

Besides charms that are usually tied on them and ugly marks

'they are branded with, in order that their old company may

refuse the association of disfigured comrades which must oblige

them to stay, certain significant names are also given to them in

order to show that their object has been anticipated.

Such are the following names : —

Malomo Do not go again.

Kosokg There is no hoe (to dig a grave with).

Banjoko Sit down (or stay) with me.

Durosinmi Wait and bury me.

Jekiniyin Let me have a bit of respect.

Akisatan No more rags (to bury you with).

Apara One who comes and goes.

Oku The dead.

Igbek6yi Even the bush wont have this.

Enu-kun-onipe The consoler is tired.

Akuji Dead and awake.

Tiju-iku Be ashamed to die.

Duro-ori-ike Wait and see how you will be petted.

Periodical feasts are usually made for these children of which beans and a liberal quantity of palm oil must form a principal dish. To this children of their age and others are invited, and their company of demons, although unseen are supposed to be present and partake of these viands. This is supposed to appease them and reconcile them to the permanent stay of their comrade, so that they may always have such to feed upon.

This superstition accounts for a rather high rate of infant mortality, for parents are thereby led away from the proper treatment of their ailments, while occupying themselves in making charms to defeat the purpose of imaginary demons !

It is fair, however to add that thoughtful men have begun to perceive the absurdity of this superstition, for many have been heard to say " There is really no such thing as Abiku ; disease and hereditary taints are the true causes of infantile mortahty."

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III. — The Oriki or Cognomen or Pet Names

This is an attributive name, expressing what the child is, or what he or she is hoped to become. If a male it is always expressive of something heroic, brave, or strong ; if a female, it is a term of endearment or of praise. In either case it is intended to have a stimulating effect on the individual.

Yorubas are always particular to distinguish between the Oruko (name) and the Oriki (cognomen or attributive). Male attributive names :-=—

Ajamu One who seizes after a fight.

Ajagbe One who carries off after a contest.

Akunyun One who buzzes to and fro Ajani One who possesses after a struggle.

Alawo One who divides and smashes up.

Ak h' I ” conceived after a single touch.

Alabi or) Is a male that comes after several female

Alade) births.

Female attributive names : —

Amoke Whom to know is to pet.

Aygka One who causes joy all around.

Abebi One born after a supplication.

Apinke To be petted from hand to hand.

Akanke To meet whom is to pet.

Asabi One of select birth.

Aw^ro One to be washed and dressed up.

Alake One to be petted if she survives.

The use of the attributive name is so common that many children are better known by it than by their real names. Some do not even know their own real names when the attributive is popular. But there is a method in the use of it ; as a rule, only children are addressed by their Oriki by their elders, especially when they wish to express a feeling of endearment for the child. It is considered impertinent for a younger person to call an elder by his Oriki or pet name.

Certain names carry their own attributive with them e.g. Adeniji (the crown has a shadow), the attributive to this is Apata .(a rock). Hence Adeniji Apata, Apata ni iji i.e. Adeniji is a rock, a rock that casts out its shadow.

IV. — The Orile or Totem

This is about the best place to take note of this singular system. The term Orile denotes the foundation or origin ; and is of an immense importance in the tracing of a pedigree. Each one

denotes a parent stock. The Orile is not a name, it denotes the family origin or Totem. The real meaning of this is lost in obscurity. Some say they were descended from the object named, which must be a myth; others that the object was the ancient god of the family, the giver of the children and other earthly blessings, or that the family is in some way connected with it.

The Totem represents every conceivable object e.g. Erin (the elephant), Ogun (the god of war), Opo (post), Agbo (a ram), etc. The number of totems of course is large, representing as each does a distinct family. Some families, however, have become extinct, and some obscure ones there are who have lost their totems. A married woman cannot adopt her husband's totem, much less his name. Intermarriages within the same totem was originally not allowed, as coming within the degree of consanguinity but now the rule is not rigidly observed. The children both boys and girls take their father's totem, except in rare cases, where the father has lost his, or more usually when the mother's indicates a higher or nobler rank. Some girls of noble birth will marry below their rank, but would have their children brought up in their own home, and among their father's children, and adopt his totem. An illegitimate child if not acknowledged by the supposed father cannot adopt his totem but the mother's, especially if a female.

The following are some distinguished Totems : —

Erin, the elephant, the totem of the original line of the Kings.

Ogun, the god of war, the totem of the original line of the Basoruns.

Both were merged in King Abiodun, who chose to adopt his mother's totem, the Basoruns being pre-eminent in those days. Hence the present line of Alafins' is Ogun.

Opo (a post). The totem of a noble Oyg family.

Okin (the love bird) Totem of the Olofa and the Oloro.

Iko „ Onigusun.

Agan „ Elese.

Edu „ Onigbayi.

Ojo (rain) „ Ologbin.

Agbe or Ade „ Olukoyi.

Agbo (a ram) „ Ajagusi father of Erinle.

Oge „ Enira and the Onipe.

Ekan „ Olufan

Elo „ Elerin.

Eri „ Oloyan

Tji „ Onigbeti.

Ogo „ Ijesa families.

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WTien the Orukg (name) the Oriki (attributive) and the Orile (totem) are given, the individual becomes distinctive, the family is known, and he can at any time be traced.

Two men may be found with the same name, but rarely with the same cognomen together, and more rarely still with the same totem as well. The man is universally known by his Oruko (name) familiarly by his Oriki (attributive). The Oriki is always used in conjunction with his Orile (the family stock or totem) expressed or understood : always expressed when endearment or admiration is intended. The Orile of course is nevef used by itself as it would be meaningless.

A name given in full will appear thus : —

Male.

Female.

Orukg

Oriki

Orile

Orukg

Oriki

Orile

Adewale

Agana

Erin

Ibiyemi ,

Abebi

Ikg

Abigdun

Ajamu

Olawale

Asabi

Adejumg

Ajagbe

Oguri

Morenike

Abeje

Agan

Oyebgde

Akunyun

Mgwumi

Agbeke

Agbo

Adegboye

Isgla

0km

Layemi

Atgle

Fagbemi

Akawo

QgQ

Ibisgtg

Akanke

Iji

Moslem

children although n

amed trom

the Arabic calendar

yet must have their Oriki and (

Drile ; thus —

AUhu

Isgla

1 Fatumg

Akanke

Ojo

Irregularities Introduced

The introduction of Christianity and the spread of British influence over the country have been the causes of great irregularities in names which one meets with now in the Yoruba country.

The early missionaries, notably those of Sierra Leone, abolished native names wholesale, considering them " heathenish," and substituted European names instead : such names are naturally transmitted to their children anglice, hence the incongruities of names that puzzle a foreigner on his first landing in West Africa.

But with more enlightenment and better knowledge, a gradual change is coming over this ; educated Yorubas cannot see why Philip Jones or Geoffrey Williams should be more Christian than Adewale or Ibiyemi ; he knows what these mean, the former to him are but mere sounds, nor are their meanings — even wh(n known — an improvement on his own.

But nothing sticks so fast as a name, and nothing more difficult to eradicate ; for even in spite of the better knowledge Christians still give to their children foreign names although in conjunction with a Yoruba name. That an English name should be given at

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all can hardly be contended to be necessary, but the practice is defended by many who plead for it a universal custom, e.g. that a convert to Mohammedanism adopts a Moslem or Arabic name ; analogously therefore only Biblical names ought to be given, but in the British West African colonies, Yoruba and other tribes with Christian names include English, Scotch, Irish, Welsh, German and Dutch names !

But there is another consideration that helps to rivet the yoke. It invariably appears that most of those who have EngHsh or other foreign names, are in some way connected with English education and with Christianity, and are certainly in a way more enlightened than their pagan brethren, or considered to be so ; hence it comes to pass, that many who originally were free from the brand of a foreign name, nevertheless still regard it as a mark of enhghtenment, and would voluntarily adopt one or more with their own real names in order to be considered " up-to-date ! " Nothing but a thoroughly sound education all round (and not limited to individuals here and there) can remedy this evil : but in the meantime educated Yorubas are losing the knowledge and the genius of the method of Yorubas in naming their children. Thus according to the system now prevailing, where one English name is given or adopted, it is used as the first name, and the Yoruba name as the second or surname, e.g. James Adesina. Where two Enghsh names are given the Yoruba is placed either in the middle as James Adesina Williams, or at the end, as James Williams Adesina. The reason for this want of system is due to the introduction of another element unknown to Yorubas and is, therefore, a complication, viz., the prefix of Mr. to the names. This is foreign to Yoruba genius arid language and makes a hybrid mixture, as it would appear if attached to any historic Biblical name ! The essence of the incongruity in this matter lies in the conversion of Yoruba names into a surname or family name and it is in this particular that the most appalling absurdity occurs. Thus some retain their own Yoruba name as a family name to the exclusion of their father's. Others use their father's name as a surname and suppress their own native name or use it as a middle name. Some adopt a brother's name as a family name if he is considered more eminent, thus excluding the father's name and suppressing their own. Some use the father's " Amutorunwa" as Taiwo, Idowu, Ige. Some use the father's " Abiso " as Adejumo Layode, etc. Some use the father's Oriki as Akawo, Alade, Ajasa, some use the father's title as Apena, Dawodu, Mogaji, etc. All

this in order — as is alleged — to make the individual distinctive but as a matter of fact to make the Yoruba conform to the English method,

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because that is considered more civilized ! Some ridiculous results have thereby been obtained e.g. a woman is called Mrs. Taiwo, who was not twin-born, and probably her husband was not either, but it may be his father or his uncle ! One fails to see how that system makes her distinctive among thousands of Taiwos in the land whilst it is so inappropriate.

A man was called Babarimisa because he was a posthumous child ; on his becoming " civilized " his children according to the English system of transmitting names became so many masters and misses " Babarimisas " with himself alive I And yet these absurdities are supposed to be necessary to Christianity and civilization ! But when we remember that the fathers of western civilization, as also the founders of Christianity with the early Christians and martyrs have transmitted their names down to history in a simple form as Yoruba names, it becomes evident that the present method is not essential to Christianity or civihzation.

And even now, we know that the familiar English method does not prevail all over Europe, not even all over Britain, for in the north of Scotland, it is usual for married women to retain their maiden names, and children take their father's Christian names for their own surnames, and yet, not only are the Scotch a highly civilized people, they are also intensely Christian. From all this we may learn that it is not necessary to do violence to an original language as the Yoruba in order to be considered civilized or Christian. Whatever incongruities may have been perpetrated in the past, it behoves those who are responsible for the keeping of the language in its purity to cease from inflicting these anomalies on those brought under their influence, especially among converts to Christianity.

Neither Christianity nor civilization requires a man's name to be given to his wife or children, considering the purpose for which children are named amongst the Yorubas.

On the coast, the corruption of the Yoruba language is proceeding at a rapid pace. What began with the names is now extending to phrases and expressions which are idiomatic English in Yoruba words. The writer thinks it will require a strong effort to preserve the Yoruba language in its purity.

Chapter VI

YORUBA TOWNS AND VILLAGES

All Yoruba towns with very few exceptions are built on one uniform plan, and the origin of most of them is more or less the same, and all have certain identical features. A cluster of huts around the farmstead of an enterprising farmer may be the starting point : perhaps a halting place for refreshments in a long line of march between two towns. In any case it is one individual that first attracts others to the spot ; if the site be on the highway to a large town, or in a caravan route, so much the better ; the wives of the farmers ever ready to cater refreshments for wearied travellers render the spot in time a recognised halting place : the more distant from a town, the more essential it necessarily must be as a resting place ; if a popular resort, a market soon springs up in the place, into which neighbouring farmers bring their wares for sale, and weekly fairs held : market sheds are built all over the place and it becomes a sort of caravanserai or sleeping place for travellers.

As soon as houses begin to spring up and a village or hamlet formed, the necessity for order and control becomes apparent. The men would thereupon assemble at the gate of the principal man who has attracted people to the place and formally recognise him as the Bale or Mayor of the village (Ht. father of the land) and thenceforth the mayoralty becomes perpetuated in his family, with a member of the family either the son or the brother or a cousin, succeeding in perpetuity. This however is the only hereditary title in the village. The house of the Bale becomes the official residence, and is thenceforth kept in good repairs by the men of the town, and the frontage of his house becomes the principal market of the town.

The Bale having been elected, he in turn appoints his Otun (or right hand man), Osi (the left) and other civil officers of a town. Even in this early stage, the necessity for defence is felt ; the bravest man among

them will be chosen as the Jagun or Balogun and he in turn picks out his heutenants, so that in any matter that may spring up, either civil or mihtary everybody knows his duty and whom to look up to.

The village must necessarily be answerable to the nearest town from which it sprang and thus an embryo town is formed. There

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are cases in which an influential personage with a large following deliberately built a town, and is from the beginning the recognised head of the same.

In fact if there are but half a dozen huts in the place, that of the headman or embryo Bale would be recognised.

From this we see how it is that the principal market of the town is always in the centre of the town and in the front of the house of the chief ruler. This rule is without an exception and hence the term Oloja (one having a market) is used as a generic term or title/ of all chief rulers of a town be he a King or a Bale.

Minor chiefs also have smaller markets in front of their houses. Market squares as a rule mark out the frontage of a chief or a distinguished man, and the principal entrance to his compound is marked out by its having a street verandah added to it right and left, and if a King two or more kobis are added to the street verandah. The larger the town, the larger the principal market to which everyone resorts for morning and evening marketings and is the general rendezvous of the town on every national or municipal occasion. It is planted all over with shady trees for sellers and loungers of an evening. The central market also contains the principal mosque of the town, and the fetish temple of the chief ruler, if he be a pagan.

Every town is walled, deep trenches are dug all round it outside, the more exposed to attack the more substantial the wall and for the greater security of smaller towns a bush or thicket called Igbo He (home forest) is kept, about half to one mile from the walls right round the town. This forms a security against a sudden cavalry attack, and a safe ambush for defence, as well as hiding places in a defeat or sudden hostile irruption. The tall trees in them are sometimes used as a watch tower to observe the movements of the enemy : except in tim.es of profound peace, it is penal to cut trees in the home forest. Highways are made through them straight to the town gate, and are always kept in excellent repair.

Towns in the plain that are greatly exposed to sudden attacks, or those that have had to stand long sieges have a second or outer wall enclosing a large area which is used for farming during a siege. This wall is called " Odi Amola " (wall of safety), sometimes it is called " Odi Amonu " (wall of ruin) as the wall has been to them the means of safety, or has been unavailing for its purpose.

The town gates are always massive and a gateman lives in a house adjoining the town wall, he collects the tolls from passers by. Market people have a fixed amount to pay, varying from 40 to 200 cowries, and farm people contribute a trifle from whatever they are bringing home, a head or two of corn, a handful of beans,

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a yam or two, a few dry sticks and so forth, for his sustenance, r' The gates are named after the most important town they lead to. ^ Each of these gates is in charge of a chief who is responsible to the town for whatever may occur there or along the route to which it leads right on to the frontier, also for keeping the walls of that part in good repairs, as well as the highway leading out of the town. This chief it is who is to put his servant there for collecting tolls, the amount to be collected from each person being fixed by the Town Council. This servant is expected to pay to his master a certain sum every 9 or 18 days, being the average of what the gate yields. Whatever surplus there may be in a brisk season, he appropriates to himself or if there is a deficit, he is expected to make it good.

In Yoruba Proper (including the Egbas) streets are not properly made or named except large thoroughfares leading to town gates, and the squares and markets of chiefs.

It does not appear that any care is ever taken to choose the site of a town, as the neighbourhood of large streams : wells are sunk by individuals to supply drinking water. The streams that may be flowing through the town are fouled beyond degree, and are by no means fit for drinking purposes. For keeping the town

clean every compound looks after its own frontage and surroundings, in the market place every seller sweeps the space around her stall.

The system of sanitary arrangements is the most primitive imaginable ; near every large thoroughfare or a market place is a spot selected as a dust heap for the disposal of all sorts of refuse and sweepings of the neighbourhood, and at intervals, fire is set to the pile of rubbish.

Here and there about the town are found leafy groves, usually clumps of fignut trees, the neighbourhood of which is unsavoury from the disposal of sewage. These sites are always infested by crowds of those keen-scented scavengers of nature, the hungry - looking vultures. Important chiefs have a large area of land enclosed within their compounds within which spots are selected for sanitary purposes.

Every chief is responsible to the town council for the quarter of the town in which he resides.

When a town has grown up to the town wall, the town council has to determine the amount of area to be taken in, and a new wall is built enclosing such area. The whole of the town participates in the work, even women and children also are engaged in fetching water to mix the swish and in providing refreshments for the menfolk ; the streets of the area simply follow the old line of the foot paths to the farms now enclosed within the town.

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It must strike the most casual observer who has travelled over the Yoruba country that those portions of the country which are supposed to be more backward in intelligence viz. the Ijesa, Ekiti, If e andother provinceshave betterstreets than themoreintelhgentones. Old men attribute this fact to the effect of the intertribal wars. E.g. in the case of Abeokuta, however well laid may have been the streets of the original farm villas, when the refugees began to flock in, attention could scarcely be paid to the ahgnment of the houses each one simply tried to find out the whereabouts of the members of his township, and thus they grouped themselves by their famihes in every available space around the chief of their town.

The same may be said of all the towns of Yoruba proper which have suffered from the vicissitudes of war. In later years the .people seem to have lost altogether the art of laying out and naming streets as is the case in Ijesa and Ekiti towns.

Roads. — ^Before the period of the revolutionary and intertribal wars, the bulk of the Yoruba people Hved in the towns of the plain, the towns in forest lands were small and unimportant, except the city of Owu, all below this being regarded as in the outskirts. Roads at that time were comparatively good. The country being flat was interspersed with hundreds of towns and villages, the inhabitants of which enjoyed the blessings of peace, and the fruits of their industry. Good roads were then made from one town to another, and were annually repaired at the time of the drummers' and Egugun festivals. They were wide enough for the easy progress of the company of dancers at these festivals and also for nuptial processions.

But they are now neglected not only that they may impede the easy advance of invaders, but also to aid the concealment of the panic-stricken inhabitants, who at the first alarm disappear at once in the bushes surrounding their towns and villages.

§ 2 Peculiar Yoruba Towns

There are some important towns which form exceptions to some of the rules above given ; in their case the cause is due to intertribal and the revolutionary wars as we shall find in detail in the second part of this book.

I. Abeokuta. — This large town is a conglomeration of villages, to the number of 153 with Ake as the chief. Each township (as they are called) has its own organization. Ake can scarcely be said to have any authority over them in their own local affairs, except such authority as is granted by the Principal Chiefs or " Ogbonis " who form the chief political organization. Hence we see that there is not one central market for the town as such, in the frontage of

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the chief ruler. There may be several Baloguns or Serikis, there are at least four kinglings, and several Ogboni houses, each section being jealous of its liberty and tenacious of its rights. Abeokuta in short was never organized as a single town : its pecuhar pohtical organization should be the subject of another chapter.

Ibadan. — This town was originally a small Egba village around the site of the central market, but occupied by a portion of the army that destroyed the city of Owu and devastated the Egba villages. After the withdrawal of the Egbas into Abeokuta, the motley crowd forming the army settled at Ibadan. Ibadan has since been the mihtary encampment of Yoruba; the titles, order of precedence, etc. are chiefly military. For that reason there is not one family in which the title of Bale is hereditary and no official residence for the Bale. The Bale is always chosen from old retired war-chiefs, always by sufferance of the Balogun, who has equal authority and more real power. But when the Balogun has become old and has already won his laurels, he is expected to be the next Bale. A young Balogun with his future to make yields the mayoralty to an older chief, usually the Otun Bale. This is the only town where such arrangement exists. Ibadan has no hom.e forests. Attempts were made from time to time to form one, but always without success through the habit of firing the fields year by year at the dry season. They are in no fear of invasion. To be in Ibadan is to be in a place of safety. Hence the Ibadans style their town " Idi Ibon " i.e. the butt end of the gun ; for the same reason also the town walls are very indifferently kept.

Ilorin. — Ilorin is in one respect different from the other Yoruba towns, in that the ruhng powers are aliens to the place. How it came about that Ilorin a pure Yoruba town, and one time the third city in the kingdom fell into the hands of ahens and to this day owns allegiance to other than its rightful sovereign, will be told in its place ; but to this day the principal market and the chief mosque of the town remain still in front of the house of the founder and rightful owner of Ilorin.

These three towns, Abeokuta, Ibadan, and Ilorin are the largest towns in the Yoruba country, and probably in West Africa, and the three are the outcome of the revolutionary and intertribal wars.

Chapter VII

PRINCIPLES OF LAND LAW

The Land laws of the Yoruba country are simple and effective, there being no need of any complicated or elaborate laws, as there is enough land for all the members of the various tribes. Whatever land is not effectively occupied is for the common benefit of all ; no one need own any land which he cannot utihze, except farm land left fallow for a short period.

Theoretically and traditionally we have seen above that Yoruba land belongs to the AlAfin of Oyo as the supreme head of the race. " The land belongs to the King " has passed into a proverb. But it must be understood, that it is not meant that the land is the private property of the King, it is only his as representing the race, in other words, Yoruba land belongs to the Yoruba people and to no other, hence as the Yorubas are split into so many tribes, the head of each tribe, as representing the Alafin is the King for that tribe, and he holds the land or division of the. country for the benefit of the tribe, and even he has no power to alienate it permanently of his own accord, to an ahen. All lands, therefore, including forests and the plain are owned by some tribe or other, and no one belonging to another race or another tribe can make use of the land without the permission of the king and chiefs who hold / the land for their tribe. Members of the tribe have no difficulty at present in obtaining as much land as each requires for agricultural purposes in which every one is supposed to be engaged ; with the increase of population however, it is felt that some difficulties will arise in future, but the chiefs can cope with such cases.

Lands are never sold, but may be granted to outsiders for life, and ⌒ to their heirs in perpetuity ; but where the land so granted had been under cultivation, it is understood in every case that the fruitbearing trees, especially the palm trees, and kola-nut trees, etc., on the land are not included in the grant ; hence the common expression " The grantee is to look down not up," i.e. he is to confine his attention to plants he has cultivated and not on fruitbearing trees he met on the spot.

Land once given is never taken back except under special circumstances as treason to the state which renders the grantee an outlaw, and he is driven altogether from that state or tribe, and his land confiscated. Even when left unutilized, if there

are marks of occupation on it, such as trees planted, or a wall built, etc., it cannot be taken back without the consent of the owner.

There is no subject in which the Yoruba man is more sensitive than in that of land. This normally quiet and submissive people can be roused into violent action of desperation if once they perceive that it is intended to deprive them of their land.

We shall see in the course of this history that the non-ahenation of their land forms one of the main conditions of their admitting a European officer among them by the Ibadans at the beginning of the British Protectorate.

The forests are under the direct guardianship of the hunters who form among themselves a fraternity recognized all over the land, subject of course to the town authonties. Any laws, rules, or regulations relating to forests that are to be made, must recognize the rights, privileges and services of the hunters, especially, as it is by them effect can be given to those laws. It is their duty to apprize the chiefs of any town, of any spies, expeditions, or raids that have that town or its farms for their objective. Crimes committed in the forests must be traced, and the authors tracked and unearthed by them. Any animal bearing traces or marks of their bullets or arrow-wounds must be restored to them. All information relating to forests must be given by the hunters to the chiefs of the town.

The forests are free to every member of the tribe for procuring building materials, medicinal herbs, firewood, etc.

Inlieritance. — When a man dies, his farms are inherited by his children, and so from father to son in perpetuity, and, Hke the house are not subject to sale. If his children are females, they will pass on to the male relatives, unless the daughters are capable of seeing the farm kept up for their own benefit. If minors, they may be worked by their male relatives until the boys are of age to take up the keep of the farms.

No portion of such farms can be ahenated from the family without the unanimous consent of all the members thereof.

These are the simple, fundamental and universal laws appUcable to all the tribes in general, but subject to modifications and development according to the local exigencies of each place. These exigencies may be due to the proximity of large populations, and consequently higher value of land, the nature of the land, whether forests with economic plants in them or pasture land, and the locality whether near the coast where foreign intercourse affects local habits, or far inland where the tribes remain in their simplicity. But in every case the ruling of the local chiefs, and their

councillors must necessarily be the law for that tribe since the fundamental laws are not violated.

None but citizens born or naturalized can own land permanently in this country. Land granted to foreigners for a specific purpose reverts to the owner or the state on the grantee leaving the country.

These are the general laws, to be observed rather in the spirit than in the letter.

Chapter VIII

MANNERS AND CUSTOMS

§ {a) Social Polity

The ancient Yorubas were very simple in their manners, their tastes, and habits. Their houses all on the ground floor are built in compounds called Agbo He (lit. a flock of houses), that is to say in the form of a hollow square, horse shoe or a circle, enclosing a large central area, with one principal gateway the house being divided into compartments to hold several families, all more or less related or united by ties of kinship, or friendship. One piazza runs right round the whole, and is used for all ordinary purposes by day, and for the reception of visitors. The central area is used in common by all the inmates for general purposes ; usually horses, sheep and goats are found tethered in it.

The compartment of the head of the house is usually opposite the main gateway or a httle to the right. It is larger, the roof 1 loftier and the piazza more spacious than the rest. Here the master is expected to be found at all times (during visiting hours) by a 1 doorway which leads to his harem at the back of the house. This J particular doorway is known as where the master " shows his face " (for the reception of visitors) ; it is an essential adjunct to the / houses of chiefs or important personages, being used for no other Vvpurpose, for at all other times it is kept closed. A high wall often encloses a garden attached to the back of the building, the space enclosed is always in proportion to the size of the house, the rank, and the means of the owner. The houses of great men contain smaller compounds at the back attached to the main compound, these are called Kara or retiring quarters, each devoted to some purpose from a harem to stables for horses.

The houses of chiefs are distinguished by a " street verandah " (as it is called) on either side the main gateway on the outside, varying in length according to the taste and capacity of the owner ; the roof of which is an extension or projection of that of the main building. It is used for lounging in the afternoons, at the cool of the day. A small market is almost always to be found at the frontage of such houses. The walls of the houses rising from 7 to 8 feet in height are built of mud, the roof consequently is low, and is covered with a tall grass called Bere or with Sege or Ekan. In forest lands where these are not obtainable, a kind of broad leaf

called Gb6d6gi is used instead. The houses are without any decorations ; the walls are plastered and polished with black and sometimes red earth by the women whose work it generally is. The houses of Kings and Princes are embellished with a sort of wash which is a decoction made from the skin of the locust fruit.

Now and then attempts are found at artistic decorations, by figures traced on the wall ; but more commonly the front posts of the verandah consist of carved figures of various kinds, equestrians swordsmen, hawkers, etc. The floor is generally rubbed and polished once a week.

The household furniture consists chiefly of cooking utensils, waterpots, and a mortar with pestles, all of which are deposited in the front and back piazzas of the house.

The use of bedsteads, tables and chairs being unknown, they squat or lie on mats instead. In modern times those who can afford it keep a few chairs for the accommodation of visitors in European garb, who find it difficult or are unaccustomed to squat on the ground. It is not unusual to find skins of buffaloes, leopard,"") lion, or a large bullock hung up on the walls of the front piazza t which are taken down for distinguished visitors to sit on. ^

All their valuables are kept in pots or bags made of bamboo fibres, and placed in one corner of the sleeping room, so that in all cases of alarm, whether of fire, or night attack by robbers or slavehunters, everything of value is soon taken away to a place of safety whenever possible.

As all the houses are invariably built with mud ceilings which are themselves fire-proof, the losses in cases of fire are small, and of hardly any account, especially if the doors are kept rigidly closed. The property of the women consists chiefly of cloths, beads, with goats, sheep and poultry, these usually form a substantial part of their " dowry."

The head of the compound's principal wife is the mistress of 1 the compound, as himself is the master, and all heads of the / several families within the compound are bound to pay their _ respects to them the first thing every morning, the men prostrating on the ground, and the women sitting on the ground and reclining on their left elbow.

[This is the ordinary mode of saluting a superior in this country; ") but when greater respect is to be shown, or pardon asked for some offence committed, the men while prostrating lay the right and left cheek alternately on the ground, and the women wrap their cloth lower down, loose their head tie, and recline alternately on the right as well as on the left elbow.

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r~ Before Kings and great rulers, for a show of homage, they run y to the porch of the house and back three times, throwing dust on /their head or roll on the ground].

They are chiefs in their respective domains, where they transact all business affecting the welfare or interest of the people in their respective households. All important cases are judged and decided in the master's piazza, and he is responsible to the town authorities for the conduct of the inmates of his compound ; hence the saying: — "Bale ni gloran awo" (the master of the house must be privy to all secrets). His word is law, and his authority indisputable within his compound, hence also another saying, " Ob^ ti Bale ile ki ij§ lyale ile ki ise e " (the sauce which the master of the house cannot eat or which is unpalatable to him, the mistress of the house must not cook), which when applied simply means that no one should go contrary to the wishes of the master of the house.

To this high authority belongs a leg of whatever is slaughtered in the compound, from a chicken to a bullock ; whether killed for sacrifice, or for a festival, or for any other purpose of whatever kind.

At the death of the master of the house, when the period of mourning is over, his successor be it his son, or his brother or cousin as the case may be, removes from his own compartment into that of the master. He is installed into his place by his feudal lord, or in case the deceased be a public man, by the Town Council, with a title that attaches him to one of the senior chiefs. But before the ceremony can take place, the roof over the late master's compartment (be it old or recent) is taken down and rebuilt afresh ; hence the term for a successor, Arole i.e. one who roofs the house.

Personal Appearance. — In early times very little regard was paid to personal appearance. Boys and girls up to the age of 8 years walked about in puris naturalihus ; from that period up to the age of puberty they were allowed the use of aprons, the cut and shape for either sex being different, the one from the other, that for boys being called hante, that for girls tdhi. The whole period was regarded as one of unencumbered freedom which ceases with the act of marriage. It was not an uncommon thing to find girls of the age of 15 when engaged in hard work whether at home or in the farm with absolutely nothing on,' and even their mothers on such occasions were but scantily clothed. This custom, however, excepting among some tribes as Ijgsa and Efon has completely died out. The extreme poverty of the people in those early times was probably the chief cause of such disregard of personal attire. In modem times better attention is paid to their outward appearance, and although from the standpoint of an enlightened civiliz-

ation there may be much to be desired still among the ordinary class of people, yet on the whole, especially amongst the well-to-do, the Yorubas dress very decently and becomingly as compared with former generations of the same people.

Great regard, however, has always been paid to personal cleanliness, and for this the tribe is specially remarkable. The word Qbitn (filthy) as applied to a person carries with it such a feeling of disgust which beggars description. The men are always shaved and hence, when one appears unshaven, unwashed, and with filthy garments on, you may safely conclude that he is mourning, for these are the signs of it. Children

and youths are either entirely shaved or a strip of hair running from the forehead to the occiput along the top of the head is left which is sometimes made into circular patches. As it is considered decent and cleanly for men to carry their heads bald so on the contrary " the hair is the glory of the woman," and much attention is paid to it. Wom.en have their hair done up in all sorts of ways dictated by their usual vanity; the unmarried ones are distinguished by their hair being plaited into small strips (from 8 to 14) from the right to the left ear, the smaller and more numerous the plaited strips the more admired. Married women on the other hand adopt other forms of plaiting ; usually they commence on both sides and finish up in the middle in a sort of net-work running from the forehead to the occiput ; ornamental forms are adopted by some, such as stuffing the hair in the middle of the head after being gathered from all sides ; and others again as the Ijebus finish up theirs in the shape of a pair of horns.

Character. — As regards the social virtues, the ancient Oygs or Yorubas proper were very virtuous, loving and kind. Theft was rare as also fornication in spite of the scantiness or often times complete absence of clothing to which they were accustomed. Friendship was more sincere. Children were more dutiful to their parents, and inferiors respectful to their superiors in age or position. Liars were formerly punished by exclusion from society and from the clubs ; but as the whole people took dehght in ambiguous forms of speech which were not understood by those unaccustomed to their habits they were regarded and spoken of as prevaricators. Now, as formerly they are remarkably patient of injuries, and would never resist or retaliate except in extreme cases when provocation became insupportable. They are characteristically unassuming in their manners and submissive to their superiors. They are very shrewd in driving bargains, and hence foreigners speak of them as " African Jews " in reference to their commercial instincts.

No nation is more remarkable for cautiousness and for putting themselves generally on the safe side. When powerless they would submit to oppression and wrong to any extent so long as they find resistance useless ; but when an opportunity offers for asserting their rights and overthrowing their oppressors, they are never slow to embrace it. The common proverb embodies this trait in their character : — " Bi owo eni ko te ekii ida a ki ibere iku ti o pa baba eni," i.e., if one has not grasped the handle of his sword he should not attempt to avenge the death of his father.

Intercourse with other nations has caused various forms of vice to creep in among modern Yorubas or Oyos ; their natural timidity and submissive spirit have produced a degeneracy of manners so as to be considered essentially lacking in straightforwardness ; they can effect by diplomacy what they cannot accompHsh by force, in which proceeding the Oygs differ widely from the other tribes, some of whom are characterised by a proud and intractable spirit, but they are no less determined in carrying out their object although the means used to effect their purpose is essentially different.

Yorubas as a whole are social, polite, and proverbially hospitable. Licentiousness is abhorred. There are well attested cases where a member of a family would be condemned to slavery by a unanimous vote of all the relatives when he has brought disgrace on the family. Sometimes forcible emasculation is resorted to as a punishment (as in cases of incest) or total banishment from the town and neighbourhood to where the offender is not likely to be known.

A peculiar custom was prevalent amongst the ancient Oyos. Young men were permitted to have intimate friends among the fair sex, and they were often the guests of each other. At the annual festivals the young man and his female friend would meet and take an active part in the ceremonies, and render pecuniary services or manual assistance to each other. At the time of harvest the female friend with the full consent of her parents would go for about a week or a fortnight to assist her male friend in bringing home his harvest while he himself may be engaged on his father's farm. Yet notwithstanding so much mutual intercourse strict chastity was the rule not the exception. The practice, however, has long been discontinued, owing to the degeneracy of the present age.

Filial Duties. — It was the duty of every male child to serve his father although he might be married and have a family of his own unless he was exonerated from the obhgation by the father himself. As a general thing a small portion of farm work was

allotted to him as his day's work after attending to which he may go and see after his own business. So while serving his father, every son had his own private farm also to manage ; and it was on his own portion of land that the female friend used to render assistance in time of harvest.

All married women were also engaged in their husband's farm and the harmony that usually prevailed between them and the young people was very remarkable.

Young men were not allowed to marry until they could give their father 10 heads of cowries, equal in those days to ;^io sterling. They were seldom married before the age of 30 and the young women, not before 20. Promiscuous rnarriages were not allowed, freeborn must be married to freeborn, slaves to slaves, and foreigners to foreigners. Except amongst the Igbonas consanguineous affinity however remote was not allowed.

Privileges of the Great. — Kings and nobles who kept harems were exempted from this rule of affinity ; they were at liberty to multiply wives from any tribe, and these wives might be of any condition of life. It was the pride of Kings to fill their harems with women of every description, such as foreign women, slaves, hostages, daughters of criminals given as the price of redemption, or seized in confiscations ; dwarfs, albinoes, hunch-backs, and any other in whose persons there should appear any signs of lustis naturcB. Such beings, being considered unnatural, were the King's peculiar property. Hence the saying " Oba ni ije ^rg" (it is Kings who are to feed on the uncommon).

THE HISTORY OF THE YORUBAS

OYO MARKS

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OWU MARKS

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MANNERS AND CUSTOMS

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EGBA MARKS

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§ {b) Facial Marks.

The facial marks are for the purpose of distinguishing the

various Yoruba families. Of these, only those of the principal

ones can be indicated. They are designated : — (a) Abaja, (b)

Keke or Gombo, (c) Ture, (d) Pele, {e) Mande and (/) Jamgbadi.

I. The Oyo marks are : — The Abaja, Keke or Gombo,

Ture.

{a) The Abaja are sets of three or four parallel and horizontal

lines on each cheek ; they may be single or double, each line

being from half-an-inch to one inch long.

Lines in sets of three : — ~ or ~

The double sets are those of the Royal Family' of Oyo the single that of the older line of Basoruns. Lines in sets of four : —

^11 or =

These marks distinguish some noble families of Oyo. Variations of these marks are made by adding three perpendicular lines to them as a family distinction thus : —

iU _ or LU

The latter of these is common amongst the Ibolos and Epos. {b) The Kek^ or Gombo consists of four or five perpendicular and horizontal lines placed angularly on each cheek ; they occupy the whole space between the auricle and the cheek bone ; three small perpendiculars are also placed on the horizontal lines on both cheeks thus : —

1 Besides the above, broad ribbon marks termed Eyo drawn along the whole length of the arms and legs are distinctive of the Royal Family of Oyo. For whereas homeborn slaves and others closely related to Royalty may have the facial marks distinctive of the house to which they belong, the Eyo marks are reserved strictly for those actually of Royal blood.

A variation of this is sometimes made by adding on the left cheek the Ibamu i.e. a line running aslant from the bridge of the nose to the horizontal lines. This also is for the purpose of distinguishing a family.

When the lines are rather bold, the mark is termed Keke, when fine and faint it is termed Gombo. The K^ke or Ggmbg is a common mark of all Qyos and of the Egbado tribe.

(c) The Ture consists of four perpendicular lines somewhat like the Gombo, but longer, with the three small perpendiculars but without the horizontals.

,.,l !

{d) The Pele are three short perpendicular lines over the cheek bones, each about an inch long. They are not distinctive of any particular family, but are used generally by some men who disapprove of tribal distinctions, usually Moslems, but are loth to remain plain-faced, e.g.

{e) (/) The Mande and Jamgbadi are no longer in use ; the latter is said to be distinctive of aliens naturalized amongst Yorubas.

These are the principal facial marks. The other principal Yoruba families are distinguished by a slight variation of these marks : —

II. Egba marks: — The Abaja dr6 i.e. the upright Abaja is distinctive of the Egbas. They consist of three perpendicular lines each about 3 inches long on each cheek. The younger generations, however, have their lines rather faint or of shorter lengths undistinguishable from the Pele.

III. The Egbado marks are the same as the Oyo marks generally as this family remained in close connection with Oyo and in their allegiance to the Alafiin long after the break-up of the kingdom, and the establishment of tribal independence.

IV. Owu marks. These are of two kinds, both being variations of Oyo marks. They are: — (a) Ahaja Olowu and

{b) Keke Olowu.

(a) The Abaja Olowu are three horizontal lines surmounted

by three perpendiculars each about one and a-half inches long.

(b) The Keke Olowu is like the Keke or Gombo with the lines discrete or interrupted.

V. Ijgbu marks are also of two kinds (a) the first is much like the A baja Olowu (the tribe from which they are partly descended) but with the horizontals curved.

(b) The other is the Abaja Oro of the Egbas. The former is more distinctive of Ij§bus.

VI. If§ marks are three horizontal lines like those of the original Basgrun's marks, each being shorter, about half-inch long. Otherwise Ifes are usually plain faced.

VII. The Ondos and Idokos have only one bold line or rather a gash about one and a half inches to two inches long over each malar bone.

VIII. The Ijesas as a rule have no distinctive marks ; they are mostly plain-faced ; some families, however, are distinguished by having on each cheek 5 or 6 horizontal lines. They are closely drawn, and much longer than any Oyo mark, e.g.

Amongst the Efons an Ekiti family, the lines are so many

and so closely drawn that the whole together form a dark patch on each cheek, e.g.

IX. The Yagbas are the most north-easterly tribes of Yoruba ; they are distinguished by three long lines on each cheek, far apart behind, but converging to a point at the angle of the mouth, e.g.

X. The Igbominas are by some classed with Qyos, and by others with Ekitis. It will, perhaps, be more correct to say they are Oyos with Ekiti sympathies. They occupy a midway position between the two ; and so their facial marks are parallel like those of Qyos, but long and far apart like those of Yagbas, yet not convergent in front e.g.

On the whole, speaking generally, the finer and more closely drawn lines, are more elegant than the same drawn bold, and too far apart.

We may note how each of the principal marks is indicated by a different verb signifying "to mark": — To be marked with the Pele is O kQ Pele

„ „ „ Abaja „ O hu Abaja

Keke „ O ja Kekg

„ „ „ Gombo „ O iva Gombo

§(c) Diet

The diet of the common people is plain but substantial. The morning meal is a kind of gruel made from corn flour (maize or guinea corn) and taken between 7 and 8 a.m. with Akara an oily cake made of beans, ground and fried. There are no fixed hours for meals. After midday, dinner is served, each family consulting its own convenience as to the precise time of eating. Supper is taken in the evening generally between 7 and 9 p.m.

In ancient times pounded yam is served out in a large bowl or earthenware vessel, and both the father and his children and grandchildren sit around it to partake of the food. Each one dips his hand into the dish and takes a morsel in strict order of seniority.

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the youngest present acts the part of a servant and waits on his seniors ; and whether the food be sufficient or not care was usually taken to leave some portion for him.

The staple articles of diet are yam and yam flour, corn and corn flour, beans of various kinds, cassava, sweet potatoes, etc. Only the well-to-do can afford to indulge in flesh diet daily, the poorer people are mostly vegetarians, except when animals are slaughtered for sacrifice they seldom partake of meat ; game, however, is plentiful. Dwellers on the coast have a plentiful supply of fish.

Of fruits the principal are : — The shea fruit in the plain, the Oro {Irvinga Barter i Hook) in forest lands. The Ori or black plum {verbenacea cuneata), locust, bananas, plantains, pawpaws, oranges, lime (citron), pine-apples, the well-known kola nut, and the bitter kola {garcinia kola-Heckel) , ground nuts {Arachis hypogea) , etc. Their drink consists of palm wine, bamboo wine, and beer made from the guinea corn or from maize.

§ {d) Dress

The Yorubas clothe themselves in loose flowing robes like the people of the East, whence indeed they trace their origin. The men wear gowns, vests, and a very free and ample kind of trousers called S6k6t6. In lieu of the gown sometimes a sheet of cloth three yards by two is thrown around the body for a covering, passing under the right arm-pit, and overlapping over the left shoulder.

In ancient times the gowns were made very plain and were , of purely native manufacture. They were without embroidery on the breast and around the neck as at present ; only kings and chiefs wore gowns made of superior stuffs richly embroidered. The covering for the common people is called Eleg6d^. The weavers have a standard of breadths for all home-made cloths. Men's coverings are made of 14 breadths, and women's of 10, of about 5 inches each. Cloths of wide breadths— say about a yard — were first imported from Or6 or Ila in the Igbomina province, and were known as Akoko cloths being chiefly the production of Akoko women ; hence the practice spread all over the country for women to manufacture broad width cloths, and men narrow ones. Formerly only men were weavers and tailors, but from intercourse with other nations the women now engage in the same craft.

The vest spoken of above is known as kukumg over which the gown or loose cloth is thrown. It is sleeveless and without a collar, and open in front ; it may be made of any kind of native stuff.

but that which is made of Alari (crimson dye) or of SSmayan (rough silk) is the most respectable, as it is at the same time most costly.

Another kind of vest is termed Ewii ; this is much like the former, but with sleeves ; it is more commonly used in modern times ; in full dress it is often worn under the gown, and is always made of white stuff.

There is another form which seems to be of foreign importation used only by big men ; it is- full of pleats below reaching to the calves, but the sleeves are very ample and long, about 12 inches longer than the arms, very wide at the end. It is called Dandogo, and is worn in lieu of the gown.

Togo is a sleeveless dress like kukumo but smaller and simpler ; it is the soldier's dress and is often worn with a turban wrapped round for a belt.

There are three sorts of gowns, the Suliya, Agbada and Girike. The Suliya is the smallest, plainest and lightest ; always made of white material, it reaches much below the knee, open at the sides, with the arm stretched the sleeve would reach as far as the wrist, but long and pointed below. The Agbada is a larger form, always made of dyed or coloured stuff. It reaches as far as the ankles, much embroidered at the neck and breast, open at the sides, and quite covers the arms. The Girike is the largest and heaviest, it is like the Agbada but more ample ; it is much embroidered, reaching also as far as the ankles, and extends beyond the arms.

Trousers (called Sokoto) are made of different shapes and lengths, but all are kept round the waist by a strong cord. They are worn below the vests. They consist of the following : —

(a) Ladugbo is the commonest, worn by young and working men, it is quite free, but somewhat tight at the knee where it terminates. It is now out of fashion.

(b) Aibopo, also common, worn by all classes. It is free but tightened towards the knee where it terminates.

(c) The Alongo. This is tight throughout, and is not unlike a bishop's gaiters. It reaches below the knee, and is used chiefly by sportsmen.

(d) The Kdfo is a tight-legged dress like the Alongo, but reaches as far down as the ankles. It is worn by warriors and ruffians generally.

(e) The Ketnbe. This is made like the Aibopo but richly embroidered about the legs with threads of crimson dye. This is the kind usually worn by nobles and gentlemen.

(/) The Efa or Abenugbangba. The name (wide-mouthed) well

describes the nature of the trousers. It is a kind that is very free, longer than the Aibopo, is somewhat shaped like European trousers, but stops short a little below the knee.

(g) The Wondo is made entirely like the European trousers. Though once fashionable, yet is now entirely out of use.

{h) The last is the Agadansi. This is adopted from the Nupes, by whom it is commonly used. It extends from the waist to the ankles ; it is very free throughout save at the ankles where it terminates and is heavily embroidered there. It is often made of two or three j^ards wide (sometimes more) so that when the feet are thrust in at either end, and the cord drawn above, it gathers into a large volume between the legs.

The men's head-gear is usually a cap (Filk) of which there are two kinds ; the ordinary filk which is about lo inches long, rather close fitting, and is bent upon itself on the top. The turban is generally wound round it by Moslems and full-dressed gentlemen. The other kind is used generally by young folks, and is called Fild Ab'eti i.e. the ear-covering cap. It is shaped like the sector of a circle, the pointed ends being used — as its name denotes — for covering the ears in cold weather. But when used otherwise the pointed ends are tmned fore and aft, the point on the forehead being tilted up in a sporting manner to show the under -surface prettily done up wth cloths of bright colouring : it is then termed Lahankadd.

Hats made of straw, and ornamented with coloured leather are worn solely for protection from the sun : the crowns are large enough to accommodate the turbaned head.

The women's dress is much simpler, two or three wrappers and a head dress or circlet complete their toilet. Unmarried women generally use two wrappers, the under wrapper being fixed above the breasts. This is made of fine cloth and is heavier. The upper is fixed about the middle of the body ; and is made of lighter cloth. To these married women add a third, used as a shawl, or covering for the head and back. Underneath all these, and immediately next the body is worn from the age of puberty a short apron or petticoat reaching the knees, and tied round the waist with a strong cord or band. This is called T6bi.

Female headgear consists of a band, of about 6 to lo inches wide and 5 feet long (more or less). This is wound twice round the head and tucked on one side. It may be of plain cloth or costly, as she can afford. Well-to-do ladies use velvet cloths.

Hats are used only as sunshades ; the crown is small for the head but the rim is as wide as an open umbrella.

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Camwood to the feet and stibium to the eyelids complete the female toilet.

§ {e) Marriage

In ancient times the Yorubas were mostly monogamic ; not from any enlightened views on the subject however, but rather from necessity ; for, although polygamy was not actually forbidden, yet only rich folk could avail themselves of indulgence in that condition of life.

Besides, in a community mainly pastoral and agricultural, where all were peaceful, and no one engaged in any occupation perilous to the lives of its male population e.g. warfare, seafaring, deep mining, etc., where wants were few, and those easily satisfied, the young men married as soon as they were of an age to support a family, and therefore a superfluous female population was hardly ever known.

The marriage laws and customs have undergone changes brought about by intercourse with other peoples, but the chief features in them are still preserved.

Where all things are equal and normal, there are three stages to be observed, viz. i. An early intimation. 2, A Formal Betrothal. 3, The Marriage.

1. An early intimation. — It is generally the duty of the female members of the family to look out for a wife for their male relative ; girls are generally marked out from childhood as intended for a particular young man, with or without her knowledge ; this is the first stage in the process. Mutual relations at this time are of an informal nature ; much depends upon subsequent events, especially on the girl's liking for the man when she is of age, and the consent of the parents. There are other important factors in the matter, but for the former, ways and means are found for the girl to make the acquaintance of the future husband. This period is also employed in making a close acquaintance with each other's family, for before a formal betrothal is made the relatives on both sides will first satisfy themselves that the family of the other side is free from the taint of any hereditary disease such as insanity, epilepsy, leprosy, etc. and also whether they be insolvent debtors. As mutual understanding becomes established, presents are usually given at the New Year, and at other annual festivals. This period will last until the girl is of marriageable age.
2. The Betrothal, — This is called the " Isihun " or formed consent. No girl will marry without the consent of her parents ; and it is rare for a girl to refuse the choice of her parents. The family oracles are invariably consulted before the final decision is arrived at.

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The ceremony of betrothal is a very important one ; it is generally performed in the night, when all the most important members of the family on both sides will be at leisure to be present, as well as their intimate friends. The young man is to present 40 large kola nuts, some money, and several pots of beer for the entertainment of those present. The kola-nuts have to be split, and all present as well as important absentees must have a share of them, indicating thereby that they are witnesses of the betrothal. From this day, the girl is not to meet her fiance or any member of his family without veiling or hiding her face.

Then follows what is known as the AnS or " dowry." The bridegroom-elect has to present to the parents of the intended bride, choice kola-nuts, some alligator pepper, and bitter kolas.* Also a fine wrapper of good quality, a large covering cloth, a head tie, and some money according to his ability. . Well-to-do families rarely require more than 10 heads of cowries in these days, in earlier times one head was considered ample — only as a token.

Whatever variations may be in these presents, the kola-nuts of both kinds and the alhgator pepper are invariable and essential. If the girl happens to be doing debtors' service at the time, the young man will pay

the debt and release her, before the marriage can take place.

This event (the betrothal) is also an occasion of rejoicing, feasting, and offering of sacrifices. The parties themselves are to carry special propitiatory sacrifices offered to the evil one. This is termed " Ebg lyawo " i.e. A bride's sacrifice.

3. Marriage. (Igbeyawo). — Marriages may be solemnized at any time of the year, except during the fasts, but the most usual time is after the season of harvest, and following the Egugun festival.

The bride is conducted to her new home always in the night, attired in her best with a thin white cloth for a veil, and attended by her companions all well clothed, with drums, and singing and dancing. The bridal party is met at the entrance gate of the bridegroom's compound by a female band of the house specially selected for the purpose, and by them the ceremony of washing the bride's feet is performed, and then the bride is literally lifted and borne into the house. Hence the term for marriage " Gbe lyawo " i.e. lifting or carrjdng the bride. She is then conducted into the bathroom where she is washed, rubbed down, perfumed,

' This is really not dowry but symbols of future relationship between both families.

and dressed up afresh, and then conducted into the apartment of the head lady of the house. She now becomes the inmate of that house for life.

The bride is usually brought with her idols, and furnished from her home with every thing that appertains to the female department of house-keeping, including cooking utensils, brooms, and other articles for house use.

If she gives satisfaction to her husband, and friends, presents are sent on the next day to her parents, she herself is covered with trinkets (consisting chiefly of corals and other costly beads, gold necklaces where they are obtainable, etc.) and the festivities continue for at least three days.

A bride who is found unchaste is rather hardly used and some times severely punished to the extent of having her tied^ and severely flogged, thus compelling her to name her violator so as to have him severely fined. No ornaments are allowed her and she may be ordered to perform errands out of doors unveiled, the next day, or may be sent out with a pitcher for water ! Otherwise, a bride is never seen out of doors for 12 months at least after her marriage, except closely veiled, and with attendants.

In the case of Moslems, liturgical forms of ceremonies are performed by the priest in the house or in the mosque. This is termed Isoyigi. Such women alone in former times had the privilege of covering their head with a light shawl when out of doors ; but the practice has now been extended to all married women.

Widowhood and Remarriage. — Three months is the period of mourning in Yoruba, during which time widows remain closely indoors ; they may spin, dye, or do any home work, but must do nothing that will take them out of doors. Among other signs of widowhood is an entire absence of personal attention, they neither bathe nor do up their hair, nor change the cloth they had on at the time of the husband's death.

This period over, they are open to offer of marriage from mem.bers of the deceased husband's family. Where there are several women, the heir (usually the eldest son or younger brother) who succeeds to the headship of the house, usually inherits the majority of the women, except of course his own mother. The custom is for each man to send his chewing stick (tooth brush) round to the woman of his choice, she is expected modestly to decline

' This gave rise to the proverb " Tani de o ti o nka oko " i.e. who has tied you that you begin to name a violator ? The equivalent of Qui s'excuse s'accuse.

it once or twice ; but if she refused it the third time, the refusal is taken as final.

The following peculiarities mark Yoruba wedded life : —

1. Women are never really married twice ; they may be inherited as widows, or taken for a wife outside the late husband's family, but the marriage ceremony is never gone over again under any circumstances.
2. Once married they are attached for ever to the house and family of their deceased husbands ; hence it is more usual for widows to choose another husband from the same family.
3. No woman is without a husband, except in extreme old age, but every woman must in any case have a male protector who is responsible for her.
4. Divorce is very rare ; so rare as to be practically considered X as non-existing. It is by no means easily obtained especially

when there are children of the union.

The causes that may lead to a divorce are : — Adultery with the husband's blood relation, kleptomania, repeated insolvency, especially such as may bring trouble to the house. A woman may apply for a divorce for extreme cruelty, which can be testified to, and ill-usage.

But these causes notwithstanding a divorce is never granted by the rulers of the town until all possible means of reclamation have been exhausted.

5. A woman divorced from her husband can never be married, or taken up legally by another man ; hence the saying A ki isu opo alkye (no one can inherit the relict oi a living man).

Under purely Native Government the above rules still hold good.

Other Recognized Forms of Marriage

There are cases in which all the above forms and ceremonies are not gone through, and yet the woman is regarded as the lawful wife of the man of her choice. Mutual consent is the only thing indispensable. Of such cases, some may be girls who when of age, will not accept the man chosen for them from childhood, except one of their own choice. Some may be widows who failed to be mated at the house of her late husband. Some may be slaves who have redeemed themselves, or a captive of war, or one bought to be made a wife of. In all such cases, the woman's free consent, and the recognition of her by the members of the man's family, are all that is required for her to be regarded as the man's lawful wife.

There is a third form of marriage which is more common among

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Moslems of modern times. In such cases, it is not usual to mark out a husband for the girls from childhood ; but when they are of age, the father, seeing a young man he delights in, or an elderly man with whom he desires to form a connection, if he expresses himself willing to accept the gift, the father after a very short notice will order his daughter to be washed and dressed up and taken over to the man in the evening, as a " Sarahk" i.e. a free gift of God ! The|;irl may not even know the man until she is taken to him !

In such cases a girl that is wild and unruly who is likely to bring disgrace on the family receives but a few hours' notice ; but a dutiful and obedient daughter will always have her feelings consulted, and her wishes granted as to her choice of the man and the time of the marriage. Festivities are performed in these cases also.

These are the three forms of wedlock recognized by the Yorubas the first being far more binding than the latter two.

Moslems hold that the Koranic law limits them to four wives, and, therefore, the ceremony of Isoyigi is never performed for the same man above that number.

Other wives taken without the ceremony of Isoyigi are known as Wahari (a Hausa word) ; they are legal in every way and their children quite as legitimate, but both mother and children are regarded as somewhat inferior to those others. Amongst pagans the " customs " detailed above take the place of Isoyigi with the status it confers upon both the mother and the children.

Only the products of an illicit intercourse are regarded as illegitimate.

§ (/) Trades and Professions

The principal occupations of men are: — Agriculture, commerce, weaving, iron-smelting, smithing, tanning and leather working, carving on wood and on calabashes, music, medicine, barbing, and other minor employments.

Agriculture. — This is the most general occupation of the bulk of the people. It is carried on with simple and primitive instruments, viz. a hoe and a cutlass, and nothing more, both of home manufacture. Ploughing is unknown, and it is very doubtful indeed whether a plough would be of much service to them under present conditions ; experiments with that instrument by those who understand the use of it have not proved successful.

The principal articles of food and of commerce grown are : — Corn (guinea corn in the north and maize in the south), beans of several varieties, ground nuts [arachis hyPogea), yams of various

species, sweet potatoes, koko (colocasiaantiquorum), pepper, piper, calabashes and other kinds of gourds, coffee, cocoa, kola nuts, vegetables of all sorts for home consumption, cotton for weaving,

When a plot has been worked with rotation of crops for a few years, it is left to lie fallow for some years whilst contiguous plots are put under cultivation, and so on alternately ; manuring is unknown. The soil is remarkably fertile under present system.

Women and children assist in reaping and in bringing harvest home. No beasts of burden are employed in agricultural operations.

All farmers and men of any importance have generally smaller farms nearer home " Oko Utile " and a more distant one generally in the forest " Oko Egdn." When engaged in the nearer one, they work from 6 or 7 a.m. to 5 p.m., with intervals for meals, and then return home ; but at the distant farm, they invariably remain there for weeks and months before returning home. Regular farmers do so only at -the annual festivals. In these farms, not only are fruits of the earth cultivated but also poultry and smaller cattle are reared for the market. Fairs are held periodically in some central farm markets where these products are disposed of to market women from surrounding towns and villages.

Although the soil is well adapted for raising fruits, yet fruit trees are rarely cultivated for the supply of markets.

Commerce. — Commerce comes next in the order of im.portance. Yorubas are keen traders, they are to be found in every part of neighbouring countries for that purpose. A large trade is carried on by barter. Cowry shells, the medium of exchange, being too clumsy for large transactions, are used only for small exchanges locally ; the very small species are used by travellers. Costly beads are used by many on distant journeys for trade, they are valued as precious stones. Thus the products of the north are given in exchange for those of the south, and those of Yoruba land for those of neighbouring states always by barter. Both sexes are engaged in trade but each in his own line.

Currency. — Metallic currency was unknown previously to the arrival of European traders, and even as lately as 1897 in places far off from the coast coins were regarded more or less as a curiosity. Silver was better appreciated than gold or copper, because it can be converted to ornaments. Silversmiths abound in the country whilst there were no goldsmiths. Shells then stood for money and are thus calculated : —

40 cowries = i string 50 strings = i head 10 heads = i bag

The value of a cowry was never fixed. Countries nearer the coast can obtain them with greater faciUty than those inland, and therefore they are of higher value in the interior ; but since the British occupation of Lagos the principal port of the Yoruba country, and English coins began to circulate in the country, the rate of exchange became practically fixed at 6d. for a " head " (the usual standard of calculation) i.e. 2,000 cowries ; hence 3d. = 1,000 cowries. But coppers being considered inferior in value, one penny is taken at 300 cowries each ; 3d. in coppers then would be 900 cowries. Cowries are an absolute necessity at the present stage of

the country, and should be used pari passu with coins for purchases below one penny. Fruits, herbs, and small articles of food may be purchased for a few cowries, beggars collect them by two's and three's from passers by, and thereby earn enough to keep life going ; to what extent they are rcire, to that extent the hardships of life are felt in the land. .

The custom of stringing cowries was for the facility of counting large sums ; they were usually strung by 200 in 5 strings of 40 each, three of 66 or two of 100 each and with a discount of one per cent.

Esusu is a universal custom for the clubbing together of a number of persons for monetary aid. A fixed sum agreed upon is given by each at a fixed time (usually every week) and place, under a president ; the total amount is paid over to each member in rotation. This enables a poor man to do something worth while where a lump sum is required. There are laws regulating this system.

Weaving. — This also is carried on by both sexes but in different styles of manufacture. Men weave cloths of narrow breadths about 5^ inches wide called Alawe. The loom is operated upon N^dth both hands and feet ; the threads of the warps are so arranged that they open and close by a mechanical contrivance worked by both feet moving alternately as the pedals of an harmonium, whilst the shuttle about 8 by 2 inches carrying the woof is tossed and caught by the right and left hand alternately through the opening, the disengaged hand being rapidly used in ramming in the thread. The cloth is woven in one long strip and then cut to the required lengths and tacked together.

Tailoring is done mostly by men only as it is only men's dress which requires a tailor. It includes embroidery made in the neck and breast of men's gowns. Women being wrapped in plain cloths hardly require tailoring. The stitches are made the contrary way to that of European tailors, the needle being pushed away from the seamster, and not toward himself.

Iron Smelting was carried on more largely in earlier than in

modern times. Certain districts are rich in iron ores, its iron production gave its name to the city of Ilorin, from Ilo irin, iron grinding, also to El eta a district of Ibadan " Eta " being the term for iron ore. Certain districts in the Ekiti province are also famous for their iron ores from which good steel was made, such as Oke Mesi. Charcoal from hard wood, and the shells of palm nuts are the materials generally used for generating the great heat required for the furnace (called Ileru) which is kept going all the year round. Iron rods and bars of European commerce being cheaper are fast displacing home-made products, and here and there all over the country the furnaces are being closed, and soon will doubts begin to be expressed as to whether Yorubas ever knew the art of smelting iron from the ores !

Other products of the mines e.g. gold, silver, tin, etc., are not known among the Yorubas.

Smithery is carried on largely. Before the period of intercourse with Europeans, all articles made of iron and steel, from weapons of war to pins and needles were of home manufacture ; but the cheaper and more finished articles of European make, especially cutlery though less durable are fast displacing home-made wares.

There are also brass and copper smiths who make ornaments from these materials ; for this purpose brass and copper bars are imported from foreign parts.

Workers in leather were formerly their own tanners, each one learns to prepare for himself, whatever leather he wants to use ; black, white, green, yellow, and brown are the prevailing colours given to leather. They are now largely imported from Hausaland, principally from Kano.

Every worker is expected to know, and to be able to execute the various crafts performed with leather, e.g. saddlery, sheaths to swords and knives, leather ornaments on hats, waistbands for children, leather cushions, bolsters, boots and shoes, sandals, etc.

It may be remarked that shoes and boots are used only by riders on horseback, and therefore they are always made with spurs immovably fixed upon them.

Music is a favourite pastime and gives occupation to many, both men and boys.

Musicians also have first to learn how to manufacture the instruments they have to perform upon, hence each one can easily repair a damaged instrument.

Yoruba music has yet to be studied and reduced to a system by a competent musician ; how essential this is can easily be recognized when we consider how much time and trouble is spent in acquiring the art, and how much the practice of it enters into

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the varied life and conversation of the people. Having learnt how to make their instruments, they then begin to learn how to speak with them, an operation to which the Yoruba language readily lends itself, as it consists chiefly in modulation of the voice ; this the instruments try to imitate. The praises and attributes of great men and distinguished names are got up, and the various measures in dances are learnt. There is no sound more common in Yoruba towns than what Europeans term " tomtoms." Musicians are in requisition at weddings, funerals, in processions of all kinds religious and otherwise ; they are constant attendants on all great men, and many of them parade the streets asking alms on their drums.

Musical Instruments used by the Yorubas are of two classes only, viz. wind and percussion.

{a) The Ivory trumpet and the Kakaki introduced from the Hausa and Nupe are used for the AlAfin alone. The Fami fami, Okinkin, Igba, Tiyako fife and the Oge. These are the principal wind instruments.

{h) The Koso is the AlAfin 's drum, and the Ogidigbo is used only on the occasion of the AlAfin and theBasorun dancing on the annual festivals.

The Calabash drum — ornamented with strings of cowries — is called Sek^{r}. The Yangede, Dundun, Bata, Aye, Sami, Siki and the Apinti are all ancient drums. The Aro (cymbal) the Bembe, introduced from Hausa, and the Gangan the noisiest but most popular are of recent invention. These are the percussion instruments.

Stringed instruments are rarely used, except by Hausa mendicants.

Medicine. — There are certain persons, doctors by profession (general practitioners) to whom people resort on an emergency. They are called Adahunse. There are no institutions like hospitals, but some of these doctors do keep on their premises a number of invalids suffering from chronic or constitutional diseases, e.g., leprosy, insanity, chronic ulcers, etc. Many of these patients being unable to pay the doctor's fees, style themselves " Gba mi o ra mi " i.e., help me and appropriate me. Such persons on being cured become the property (or perpetual house servant) of the doctor.

Formerly there were certain clans known as medicine people, and were licensed as such by the King. For instance, the inhabitants of the towns of Ogur6, Ogidi, Abe, Agberi, Apat$\hat{}$, Arohungbe. They were remarkable for their skill in using secret poisons, and crimes committed by them generally went unpunished,

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they being under the special protection of the King. They are expected to be at the King's service when required, but it meant death to any of them if the poison given to the King for his use upon his enemies did not take fatal effect.

There was also a particular family of Efon descent living at one time at Oyo said to have belonged to the Ondasa tribe. Their great ancestor was said to have been invited to the capital bj' one of the early Kings of Oyo for medical advice when all his wives were barren. His prescriptions were successful, and so he was detained at Oyo and rewarded with a high rank and position in the palace amongst the household officers. His descendants are now distinguished from the citizens of Oyo by the totem OgQ (a club) being affixed to their names.

The art of medicine is kept a profound secret by those who profess it ; an increase of knowledge can only be gained by an interchange of thoughts between brother professionals ; many die without imparting their secrets to others, and thus much valuable knowledge is entirely lost. But some do impart their secret to those of their children male or fern. ale who show special aptitude for such knowledge and whom they particularly l6ve.

On the whole we can unhesitatingly assert that those men who are specialists in one or two particular branches but who do not make the practice of medicine a profession can be more confidently relied upon.

Carpentry is in a very backward condition. Of joinery they have no idea whatever. Carpenters are called Gbenagbena. They are the crudest and most primitive of handicraftsmen ; their services are not much in requisition.

Carving in wood is executed in a rather primitive way but such natural genius is displayed by some men, that it is a matter of surprise that such artistic achievem.ents can be displayed by an illiterate person, and with tools so simple and primitive.

The Yorubas of the Egbado district are said to be the best artists in the country. They certainly have in their forest&vood most suitable for carving purposes. /

Calabash dressers are always found in a row in market places plying their trade ; all sorts of geometrical figures are traced or cut in calabashes ; some designs are exquisitely correct and beautiful. Names, mottoes, and phrases are burnt into calabashes by educated artists, figures only by the uneducated. These designs are recently being imitated by Europeans under the term of Poker Work.

Seamanship. — There are very few large rivers in Yoruba land and nearly all of them fordable during the dry season, consequently

only in coast towns and on the Niger are canoemen found who make any pretence to seamanship.

When the inland rivers are swollen by rains, large bowls and very large calabashes are used in ferrying passengers across. The passengers sit on them with their luggage, with the ferryman in the water, pushing the freight across.

All canoes are dug out from large trees. Our canoemen cannot really be called experts, as they rarely sail out of sight of land, and canoes can ill endure any storm or tempest ; nevertheless, when war canoes are rigged up and manned, they are handled with no little skill in their fights, sham or real. In the title of Aromire (i.e. one in friendly terms with water) we have preserved a chieftain who ranked as an admiral in the olden days of sea fights.

Fisheries. — Deep sea fishing is but little practised, the rivers and lagoons furnish all that they can harvest. Shrimps and oysters are plentiful in their season. The fishing industry is of course confined to coastal towns, and as there are no means of supplying inland towns the consumption of the fresh article is confined to the coast.

Building as a profession is almost unknown ; houses as a rule are built by men clubbing together, but there are always a few experts among them in particular lines, either in building the mud walls or in roofing and they distribute themselves accordingly. These are always in requisition whenever they can be spared from their farms. Large works are undertaken and arranged for, when all hands can conveniently be spared from their farms.

Pastoral Work as a profession is carried on only in the northern provinces more suited for that purpose from the extensive plain and pasture land of those regions. But very few Yorubas are found engaged in it. Gambaris (i.e. Hausas) are generally engaged by the chiefs to tend their cattle.

The barbers and ropemakers are also mostly Hausas and Fulanis, these are crafts rarely practised by Yorubas.

These Hausas also perform some minor surgical operations such as cupping, bone-setting, tapping hydroceles, etc. Some are even oculists, and profess to be able to operate for cataract. It goes without saying that much mischief is often done by their crude performances. They are unskilled and the instruments used are rather clumsy. It is a wonder that more mischief is not done, or that they occasionally get good results at all.

Occupations of Women

It is specially the province of women advanced in age to seed cotton and spin thread. The former is done by rolling out the

seeds from the wool between a smooth log of hard wood and a polished iron rod, the latter by weighting a thin rod of about 12 inches long with a small ball of clay about i inch distant from one end, attaching the cotton to the other end and setting the ball spinning like a top, the wool being rapidly drawn out to the required fineness. Seeded cotton is rendered fluffy for spinning by being attached to the string of a bent bow, and the string constantly pulled as if shooting an arrow. These operations being an occupation of a sedentary nature, and more suitable for old women are performed by them leisurely all day. Reels of spun thread are sold to dyers.

Aged women who reside in the farms also employ their time in shelling the kernels from the pcdm nuts, and also tending poultry, goats and sheep for the market.

Dyeing is done by women. They buy a quantity of the yarn, bleach and dye them in various colours, and sell them to the weavers, male or female. The commonest colour is blue or blue black from the indigo dye. The preparation of indigo balls for the market is also an important industry. Women are equally with men engaged in trading and weaving ; but whereas men weave in small breadths and carry on their occupation in courtyards or secluded squares in the streets where they can stretch their warp 20 yards or more, the women on the contrary fix their looms in the piazza of the house, close to the door of their apartments where they may be seen sitting on the ground, with their legs in a hole under the loom ; they weave the cloths in broad pieces called Kijipa two or three breadths forming a covering.

The warp is wound round two stout bamboo poles fixed athwart two strong upright posts, top and bottom. There is a mechanism by which the threads can be made to cross each other. The woof in rods of about a yard long is passed slowly right and left as the warp is opened and separated one way and the other, being rammed down each time by a flat smooth staff.

Besides indigo dyes of light blue and dark shades, the scarlet called ilaharl and roagh silk, Samayan in grey are the prevailing colours of Yoruba yarn.

Palm oil making and nut oil making from the kernels of the palm nuts, as well as shea butter from the shea fruit are exclusively female industries.

Beer-brewing from guinea corn or maize is done also by women ; for this they have a sheltered place within or near the compound to insure protection against fire.

A large class is engaged in preparing articles of food. They are purveyors of cooked food, keepers of refreshment stalls and other

branches of dietary for the market, especially to accommodate working men and caravans.

The manufacture of beads from the hard shells of palm nuts, or from the cocoa nut shells, is an important female industry. The former quality is more highly valued.

Pottery is also a female industry. Men may sometimes be seen assisting to dig up the clay and to perform some rough initial work, but as a rule the whole industry is in the hands of women. The drying, pulverising, sifting, mixing and moulding, are all done by women and girls.

Large pots for brewing beer, and for setting indigo dyes, and cooking Eko (the morning gruel) for sale are turned out with marvellous skill. Cooking utensils, dishes, water pots, etc., are also made for the markets. Some parts of the country furnish clay of superior quality, notably Ilorin.

Although ignorant of the use of the wheel, or any such mechanical contrivance used in pottery, yet the figures, forms and shapes of the articles turned out are wonderfully correct.

Every woman whatever her trade may be, is expected to keep a few chickens and a goat or two from which she derives smeill income for house keeping and general " pin money." The rearing of poultry then must be reckoned among female occupations.

Hair dressing may also be mentioned among female occupations, for although the race has not much to boast of in that form of natural adornment, yet they often contrive to bring out styles and fashions which satisfy them ; but a marked distinction must always be made between that of married women and the unmarried ; this is a social law which on no account should ever be infringed.

On the whole the women seem to be far more industrious than the men, for whereas the men always contrive to have leisure hours and off days from work, the women seem to have none. Boys and young men certainly have more idle hours than the girls. The care of the children also devolves almost entirely upon their mother, an inevitable result of polygamy.

§ {g) Learning

As the Yorubas have no knowledge of letters, their learning consists chiefly in oral traditions. The historians are the King's cymbaUists and ballad singers, the chief of whom is called the Ologbo or Arokin. They may be compared to the rhapsodists of the Homeric age, as they perform almost precisely similar functions. They chant to the King the story of the nation, and history of former reigns, for his information and instruction. They

are kept in the royal service and are well supported. The office is hereditary.

Like many other heathen nations the Yorubas have their tradition about the creation and the deluge. It is their belief that at the creation men fed on wood and water, that they had a long projecting mouth ; that the bat was originally a creature in human form, and was a black-smith by trade, and that with his instrument he reduced men's mouths to their present shape, for which cause he was condemned to lose the human form and to assume that of a beast, and to use one and the same mouth for receiving food as well as for evacuation. The allegation that water was the original food of man is supported by the fact that it is the first thing taken by a new-born babe, as well as the last thing taken at a man's dying moments.

§ (h) Wealthy Personages

There were certain historical personages in Yoruba who were noted for their great wealth, viz., Amoloku of Oro, Gedegbe of Qfa, Lapemo of Ijomu near C>r6, Onibiy6 of Guguru, Minimi of Erubu. There is also a sixth spoken of who resided at Gbudu. There was also a lady known as the Olowo of Ijebu.

§ (i) The Iwofa System and the Laws Regulating it

The term Iwofa has no equivalent in English. It denotes one who serves another periodically in lieu of the interest on money lent. In short, it is one in service for interest.

It has been mistranslated a "pawn" by those who fancied they saw a resemblance to it in that system, and are trying to identify everything native with those that are foreign, and consequently, as in other similar cases, much mischief has been done thereby.

The Yoruba man is simply shocked to hear of " pawning " a man as is done with goods and chattels ; to pawn in Yoruba is ft dogd which term is never applied to a human being.

It has also been compared to slavery by those ignorant of the legal conditions ruling the system ; but an Iwofa is a free man, his social status remains the same, his civil and political rights are intact, and he is only subject to his master in the same universal sense that " a borrower is servant to the lender."

Iwofas are held quite distinct from slaves ; the verbs applied to each system mark the distinction e.g. rd to buy is applied to a slave, yd to lend or engage (a hand) to an Iwofa ; consequently you can buy a slave, but engage an Iwofa or service man.

The derivation of the term- is probably from Iwo the entering

into, and Efk a period of six days ; hence an Iwgfa is one who enters into a recurrent sixth day service.

The Iwofa system is a contract entered into in the presence of witnesses called Onigbgwo i.e. sponsors, the money-lender is termed Oluwa i.e. master, and the worker Iwofa, i.e. a service man.

It is a legal transaction recognized and protected by the laws of the country. Whatsoever the amount of money lent, it is the law that the service rendered goes for the interest, and only the principal is paid back whenever payment is made whether after a few days or after many years.

An Iwgfa may be a man or a woman, a boy or a girl, and the laws for each differ accordingly.

A man Iwgfa lives in his own house and plies his own trade, but he is required to clean a piece of land equal to lOO yam heaps or an equivalent in his master's farm once a week, the Yoruba week consisting of five days.

The people being mainly agricultural, farm-cleaning is the work of their daily life, and is the recognized ordinary system of labour.

Cleaning three hundred heaps is the ordinary amount of an average man's day's work, consequently a strong man often found it possible to work in three different farms on the same day, for different masters, or to do three week's work at a time in one farm, and have 14 off days at a stretch, in which he is free to follow his own trade without interruption. Special arrangements can also be made if a longer period is desired, but the Iwgfa is bound to make up for the number of days lost.

This is the original law, but it is subject to slight modification or variation in various places, according to the local value, or the amount of money lent ; e.g. amongst the Egbas, a whole day's work is required instead of a morning's work. But whatever modification of the original law is made in any particular locality, the law for that tribe is always fixed by authority, and never subject to the whims and caprice of an individual money-lender.

The master is to treat the service man as his social rank demands, he mingles freely with his equals in the house or in the field as a member of the household. A kind master often allows him his breakfast before he quits the field although he is not bound to do so, and if a master be too exacting or disagreeable, he may be changed any day without any previous notice, once the money lent is paid back in full.

Where the master is a great chief or a rich man, the service man may live under his protection and own him his feudal lord ; hence

some men never troubled themselves to pay back the money, but may rather incur further obligations, being safe and free under the protection of a great name. Some men there are ,who are better able to do another man's work than their own.

An Iwofa is never subject to punishment physical or otherwise, if he fail in his weekly service, the sponsors are called upon to make good the deficiencies.

In fine an Iwofa differs from a slave in that a slave must live with his master, an Iwofa in his own house. A slave can be compelled to work for his master every day, an Iwofa for a limited amount of work for half a day in the week, and that not by compulsion but from obligations of honour. A slave can be punished, an Iwofa cannot be. A slave has lost his independence and political rights, an Iwofa retains both. A slave has no one responsible for him, an Iwofa has two at least. In fine an Iwofa can go and come as he likes, a slave cannot.

For women the same law holds good generally but with some modifications on account of their sex ; they work generally as char-women once a week, and have a meal in the house before returning home. In some cases they may live among the women folk in their master's house, carrying on their own work, and lending a helping hand in the housework and in harvest time do their own share of the day's work in the field along with the other women.

Some are engaged in trade, in which they sell for their master at the same time, and bring him the proceeds of his own articles as the allotted service rendered. When the trade is done in the home market, payments are made every nine days which are market days ; when out of town, at the return of the caravan.

If a service woman is tampered with by the master, the money is thereby considered absolutely paid, and the debt discharged. If forced against her will, not only is the debt cancelled, but he is also liable to prosecution and heavy fines besides to be paid both to the woman's husband as damages and to the town authorities as court fees.

If a young unmarried woman is tampered with, not only is the debt ipso facto discharged, but the master has to repay the fiance all the money he has spent on her and also a betrothal " dowry " to the parents besides.

If the matter is not arranged amicably and the case has to go before the town authorities, the master has to pay, and heavy fines are inflicted on him besides. Often has a rich man been reduced to poverty by this means and consequently they are always very careful. If a betrothed girl becomes marriageable whilst in service

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and her fianU wishes to get married at once, he has only to pay back the loan and lead his intended bride away. A woman cannot be married whilst doing service work.

A boy or a girl in service has to live entirely with the master or mistress as a domestic servant, inasmuch as their services are not worth much and they have to be trained besides, and the parent or whoever placed him there is supposed to have his whole time to ply his trade and withdraw his child as soon as possible ; therefore, the boy must give the master his whole time whatever that may be worth. The master is bound to feed him but not necessarily to clothe him, although many kind masters do that as well. They have a fixed time to visit their parents, usually once a week.

The boys generally tend horses and run errands, and the girls engage with the house-wives in domestic affairs. They are always with the boys and girls of their own age in the family.

The law protects such children very strongly. If the child refuse to stay any longer with the master or mistress for any cause whatever, they are never forced against their wish, but the parent or guardian must provide a substitute, or perform himself the weekly task.

If a child die during his or her service, the master must prove to the satisfaction of the parents and (if need be) of the town authorities that it was not due to any act of carelessness or neglect on his part, and that he provided ample medical aid for him.

The troubles accruing from young Iwofas are often a deterrent to the acceptance of them for service ; some folks would expect and demand more comforts for their children in service than they can provide for them at home. Marriages and funerals are the two great causes of money borrowing.

But this system is not limited alone to the business of professional money-lenders, it enters much into other transactions of their everyday life.

The system of engaging domestic servants for service with a monthly wage is unknown in this country, the Iwofa system is what is resorted to for that purpose. A parent will even put his child into service that way when there is no debt to pay in order to train him into habits of discipline and industry, and return the money when they feel that the child has been safhciently trained.

Some would do so and put the money into trade and when satisfied with the profits made, return the principal and bring the child home.

The system is used also for apprenticeship. A man who wants

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his son to learn a particular trade would put him under the craftsman for the purpose, and obtain from him a certain amount of money ; the master, wishing to get his interest out of the boy willsee that he learns speedily and well, so as to be of some use to him. In this way both are benefited.

A chief or a well-to-do gentleman with a wild and unruly son whom he wishes to tame, or who is indulged at home, would also resort to this method for training and discipline ; in such a case the boy will remaiii

with such a handicraftsman until he is able to earn his own livelihood by his craft, then the money is paid back and the boy returns home.

This method of lending money is the only one known for investment and is therefore resorted to as their banking system.

So the Iwofa system may be regarded at one and the same time as one for banking, apprenticeship, and domestic service.

Since the establishment of the British Protectorate there • has been more than one attempt made to abolish the system as a " species of slavery ! " The Yorubas themselves never at any time regarded it as such ; to so regard it must be due either to an ignorance of the/ laws regulating it, or because an exact equivalent cannot be found in any European system. It can, however, be imagined what chaos will result in any European country if the banking system, apprenticeship, and domestic service were abolished at a stroke — if that be possible. Like any other system it may be reformed if given to abuse, that is more reasonable and statesmanlike. But to abolish it outright because it has no foreign analogue would be to disorganize the social life of a people with no compensating advantage to borrower or lender. If such were done in this case the greatest sufferers will be those it was intended to benefit, viz., the service men themselves. But with the country now settled, and everyone free to prosecute his business, there must be less of money borrowing and service for interest, and thus a gradual change or modification is naturally effected in this system, with no tendency to abuse.

§ (j) Distraining for Debt

The Yorubas have a peculiar method of forcing paj'ment out of an incorrigible debtor. When a creditor who has obtained judgment for debt finds it impossible to recover any thing out of the debtor, he applies to the town authorities for a licensed distrainor. This individual is called Og6, he is said to d'dgd ti i.e. to sit on the debtor (as it were). For that purpose, he enters the premises, seeks out the debtor, or esconces himself in his apartment until he makes his appeeirance, and then he makes

himself an intolerable nuisance to him and to the members of the house generally until the money is paid.

The distrainor is a man of imperturbable temper, but of a foul tongue, a veritable Thersites. He adopts any measures he likes, sometimes by inflicting his presence and attention on the debtor everywhere and anywhere he may go, denying him privacy of any kind, and in the meantime using his tongue most foully upon him, his own person being inviolable, for touching him implies doing violence to the person of the authorities who appoint him the task. He demands and obtains whatever diet he may require, however sumptuous and may help himself if not quickly served. If he thinks fit, he may lay hold on any poultry or cattle he finds in the premises, and prepare himself food, and all at the expense of the debtor. He must not take anything away but he may enjoy the use of anything he finds in the house.

Loud in his abuses, intolerable in his manners to all in the house whilst going in and out with the debtor, he goes on in this way all day, and from day to day if needs be, until even the inmates of the compound get tired of this, and then means will quickly be found of getting rid of the distrainor by paying off the debt.

§ {k) War

In early times war expeditions were sent out every other year by the AlAfin of Oyo to distant countries chiefly amongst the Popos. War then was for spoils and to keep their hands in, and not for captives ; the victors rarely pursued the vanquished ; those who concealed themselves behind heaps of rubbish, or in any hiding place in the town or in the fields were quite safe. When a town was taken the shade trees about the principal market — which is always in front of the official residence of the chief ruler of the town — are cut down as a sign of conquest. Slave-raiding and the traffic in human beings did not then exist. Long sieges were unknown, for whether victorious or defeated, the presence of the Kakanfo or his corpse was expected home within 60 days.

There never was or has been a standing army, nor any trained soldiers (except at Ibadan latterly where the idea began to germinate, and some of the chiefs had a number of their slaves trained solely for war ;

some chiefs had also a corps of boys, not to bear arms, but to be attendant on them in battle, in order to famiharize them with the horrors of war 1) But according to the custom of the country, every man capable of bearing arms is expected to serve in war ; but the law did not make it compulsory except for men of rank and title, and for home defence.

At the close of every war, each one goes away to his farm, and, except on an occasion of importance, as when the King's messengers are to be received, even the Bale and the Balogun could not be found at home during the day at the busy seasons.

Before the introduction of fire-arrtis (a comparatively recent affair) their weapons of war consisted of bow and poisoned arrows, a short sword called J^m6 and Ogb6 a kind of heavy cutlass used chiefly by the common people.

As sieges then were of short duration and dways carried on in the dry season, there was no necessity to provide against severe weather ; the chieftains generally used awnings made of Ayin mats spread on four poles. Since sieges began to be carried on for more than 60 days, booths of palm branches have come into use, and in later times even these have given way to huts and houses built of swish.

The preserved food used in earlier expeditions consisted of parched beans, and a sort of hard bread made of beans and corn (maize) flour called Akara-kuru.

By the rules of warfare piye or foraging was permitted. The Ibadans, who, more than any of the others carried on war operations for longer periods, and over wider regions, were accustomed to cultivate the lands all around their camps and in the neighbourhood whenever a long siege was anticipated.

War Titles and Methods

War titles are of two grades, senior and junior, but both are modelled on one and the same plan.

Senior Grade : — The Balogun or Commander-in-Chief comes first with his principal lieutenants the Otun and Osi, that is Generals commanding the right and the left wings, then the (Asipa), Ekerin, Ekarun and Ekefa i.e. the fourth, fifth and sixth. These command the veterans.

Junior Grade : — The Seriki with his principal lieutenants also, viz., the Otun, Osi, with the Ekgrin, Ekarun, and Ekefa. These command the young warriors, and those not attached to any of the greater war-chiefs.

The AsAj u is the leader of the van, he too has his lieutenants.

The Sarumi or chief of the cavalry and his men form a class by themselves ; he also has his Balogun of the cavalry, with the Otun, Osi, etc.

" These titles constitute what is termed " Oye Ilu" or "Town titles," because they are conferred by Bale or chief of the town and the town council, and they are all members of the town council with a right to speak and vote.

Among the senior war titles may be mentioned the Bale's war chiefs. The Bale himself does not go to war ordinarily, but he has his war-chiefs, the Otun Bale, Osi Bal§, Ekerin, Ekarun, Ekefa as well, who represent him in war ; they are always chosen from among the older men who have past their best days.

Signification of the Titles

The term Balogun is contracted from Iba-li-Ogun i.e. lord in war. In time of war, and generally in the camp, the Ibalogun is not only supreme, but he is also above all laws, he commands implicit obedience from all, and he can do whatever he likes.

The Balogun's Otun and Osi (right and left) are also the Otun and Osi of the town and of the army ; they command respectively the right and left wings, and they rank next after the Ibalogun.

The Asipa is a title borrowed from Oyo to satisfy any war-chief who, being equal by merit to the Otun and Osi, yet just missed becoming either.

The Ekerin, Ekarun, Ekafa are the fourth, fifth and sixth respectively of the senior generals.

Seriki is a Hausa word signifying a " king." He is practically like the Balogun, and is as important among the young warriors as- the Balogun is among the veterans. A brave Seriki ranks himself next to the Balogun, the Otun and Osi Balogun notwithstanding ; for it often happens when he is exceptionally brave, that he skips over these and succeeds the Balogun, when a vacancy occurs. Otherwise the Otun succeeds.

All booty and perquisites that fall to the army are divided into two unequal parts, the larger portion belongs to the Balogun and his lieutenants and the lesser to the Seriki and his lieutenants also. The Balogun and the Seriki are each entitled to one half of the portion that falls to them, the other half being equally divided among the subordinate war chiefs of each respectively.

In every successful expedition each of the subordinate war chiefs is expected to give one half of his plunder or captives to his chief, the seniors to the Balogun, the juniors to the Seriki, and they themselves also receive the like from their subordinates.

Subordinate Titles : — Every one of the above chiefs. Senior and Junior had his own subordinate chiefs modelled on the same plan of Balogun, Otun, Osi, etc., in the same way, these also form their companies on the same plan, and so on throughout the whole army. By this system every man capable of bearing arms knows his right place in the army, so that what appears to be a motley crowd is really a well-organised body every man being in his right place at the front, the right or the left of his immediate

chief, although they lack that co-ordination and precision of movements which are the outcome and advantages of discipline and drill.

Other subordinate titles Areagoro, Bada, Ajiya.

Ar§agoro. — This is the first title borne by a young chief of great promise, who, as the heir of a great war chief has just succeeded to the headship of a great house. It is a stepping-stone to one of the senior grade titles. He is always attached to one of the senior chiefs, as his alter ego ; he represents his chief in the councils and other important assemblies in the absence of the latter, where he can speak and vote with equal right and authority ; hence the saying : " Ar§agoro ti o ba gboju t'on ti Oluwa re I'egb^ra " i.e. an Areagoro who is bold is the equal of his master. An Areagoro remains as such only till a vacancy occurs in one of the higher titles suitable for him.

Bada. — The title of Bada answers in many respects to a knight of the middle ages. He is one who is expected to keep at least one or two war steeds and a few followers at his own charges, to be ready to take the field at a moment's notice, to be an accomplished horseman, a skilful swordsman or lancer, and to fight always on horse-back. All the principal chiefs have each at least a Bada. The Badas stand in the order of seniority of their respective masters and form a corps by themselves.

Ajiya is a non-descript title borne by any junior war chief who cannot for the time being find a place among his peers. He is rather a free lance.

Arrangement of the War Chiefs in Battle

The Asaju or leader of the van comes first. His company begins the fight by skirmishing, and provoking the opposite party. He is supported by all the Badas.

The Seriki comes next with his lieutenants in their proper order, and then the real pitched battle begins. Last of all comes the Balogun with his lieutenants. The Balogun himself, however, does not take any active part at once, until later on, except to watch the various movements and generally to direct the fight.

The duties of the cavalry are to reconnoitre, to hover about the enemy watching for an opportunity they can take advantage of such as a weak or an unguarded point through which they can dash to break the ranks of

the enemy, and throw them into confusion. Also to cover retreats on a defeat or to cut off stragglers when pursuing an enemy.

Occasionally at the height of the battle a brave horseman would

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demoralize the enemy by dashing suddenly into their midst, and return with a captive on his horse !

The usual method of a pitched battle is for all the war chiefs to be disposed, each in his right place, according to their rank and title, or as the commander-in-chief disposes, and then each in turn to march forward, company by company to the middle line of battle to discharge their arms, trying each time to gain more ground. This method they call Tawusi. But when later on, the Balogun himself rises to fight, that denotes a general charge throughout the whole host ; every man must be engaged in fight ; and whereever he fixes the war standard, every one is bound to dispose himself about it in due order. • His going forward means that the whole army must push forward at whatever cost, for no one whose right place is in front dares fall to the rear of the Balogun except when hors de combat.

The Bale's war chiefs need not take any prominent part in the fight, but they guard the camp and baggage, support weak points, and make themselves useful generally as men vvho must keep cool heads while the others are engaged in the excitement of a fight. Their chief duty otherwise is to act the part of advisers and moderators of rash and hot-headed warriors.

A synopsis of the arrangement in battle : —

The AsAju

Supported by all the Badas

Osi Seriki Seriki Qtun Seriki

Ekerin to Ekefa disposed as strategy requires

Osi Balogun Balogun Otun Balogun

Asipa, Ekerin to Ekefa disposed as strategy requires.

The Otun and Osi Bale and other older warriors are to guard the rear, camp, and baggage and support weak points.

War as a profession in this country was always said to date from the time of the Fulani invasion and seizure of Ilorin when the necessity arose for an organized resistance but the Yorubas generally are not considered a fighting race, although they have now and again thrown up a general who would be considered distinguished in any race. In the later period of their history circumstances have brought things about that Ibadan became a centre for all warlike spirits of whatever tribe, and consequently it is to that place we have to turn, to see the development of warlike proceedings.

How war is declared. — Every expedition is supposed to be sent out by the King (Alafin). It is in his name war was generally declared, and his permission or at any rate his assent must be obtained before an army can march out.

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When it has become evident that a place is marked out for an attack, a system of exclusive dealings is first established between that town and its neighbours ; then follow preparations for attack and defence, and when plans are matured then, at the usual meeting of the town council in the house of the chief ruler, the announcement is made.

The Balogun (commander-in-chief) rising, would address the assembled crowd outside and end with " I leave (such and such a place) at your mercy." He is greeted with shouts of applause, and a day would be fixed when the war-staff will be taken outside the town walls. The marching out of the Balogun is always so denoted as the war-staff is always kept with him.

The War Staff or standard of war is a bamboo pole of about four feet in length, and 2 inches in diameter. It is wrapped all over with charms and amulets, and finished up with a globular head, the size of a large cocoa-nut. The size of course varies with the cost. It is encased in leather with the charms hanging all over it. It is always an object of worship. To this day, proper standards of war are procured from He Ife and are dedicated to Oranyan. Human sacrifices were usually offered to such standards before they are taken out to any campaign. Whenever war is declared, and it is to be worshipped, priests and priestesses are always required for the purpose of offering the sacrifice.

The Propitiation of Oranyan. — The victim is usually subjected to much inhuman treatment on these occasions before being despatched. With his hands tied behind his back, he is led to the market place, and there paraded from one spot to another, and made to do homage to the fetishes there, and to invoke blessings on the town and on the chiefs thereof. As he could not conveniently prostrate himself before the gods in his bound condition, he is assisted with a forked stick, with which he is pushed violently down from behind ! Bruised and bleeding, he is to receive three strokes on the back with a rod before he is helped up

agam

In this way, the unfortunate one is soon exhausted ; he would then be literally dragged along into the grove sacred to Oranyan, and there beheaded.

The blood is considered sacred and hence the commander-inchief of the army who must be present on such occasions with his staff of principal officers must come forward with each of them and have a touch of the blood to rub on their swords, and after them the common soldiers would all rush in for a drop to rub in their hands, for success in the war.

The corpse is not to putrefy before the Balogun leaves the town :

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it is considered an ill omen if it does. Hence Orauyan is never worshipped until they are quite ready to march out.

The corpse is exposed for seven days, and it is the duty of some of the priestesses to bathe it daily and smear it with camwood preparations, and pray for the speedy return of the victim to this world and to be born in their family !

We see in these revolting practices, not an act of studied cruelty, but one of supposed highest form of religious worship of a poor deluded people.

The blood of certain animals is forbidden to be used in the worship of Orariyan e.g. the tortoise, he- goat, hen and pigeon.

§ (/) Funerals

The Yorubas do not bury their dead in graveyards or cemetries, but in their houses. Infants, however, are not buried in the house, but their dead bodies are either thrown away into the nearest bush or forest, or are partially buried with a bit of earth sprinkled over them, and are thus left a prey to jackals prowling by night.

Such children are called " Abiku " (born to die) and are supposed to belong to a company of young demons roaming about. They are beUeved to be capable of being born as young children, and (except forcibly detained by charms) of returning to their company at will, or at the instance of the members of their company.

The graves of aged people are dug generally in the piazza or in one of the sleeping rooms. In case of the wealthy dead, after the ground has been dug to a depth of about 6 feet in the piazza it is then carried on horizontally towards one of the bedrooms, so that the corpse is literally buried in the bedroom. It is then shut up in this horizontal hole with a piece of board plastered over with mud ; the whole grave is then filled up and the floor of the piazza levelled and polished, the rest of the earth being cast into the streets.

Only the well-to-do can afford a coffin, the workmanship of which is usually very rough and coarse, the many chinks and interstices being filled up with cotton-wool and soap. As a rule, coffins are made much larger than we should think necessary, but the superabundant space is filled up with some of the dresses belonging to the deceased, and with presents from all the relatives, it being a custom amongst them that all the nearest relatives should give each a piece of cloth for the burial. In the absence of cloths seeded cotton is put in to fill up the coffin tight, as they have a superstitious dislike of leaving any empty spaces in a coffin.

In the practice of filling up the coffin with cloths, one may catch

a faint glimpse of the popular ideas in regard to another state of existence.

If the family is wealthy, after a couple of months another ceremony is gone through, consisting chiefly of feasting and dancing in honour of the dead, and this they term laying the dead upon its other side.

In cases where coffins cannot be had, after wrapping up the corpse in a mat like a mummy it is laid in the grave and a few sticks of the Akoko tjee are laid across upon which a mat is spread. If a piece of board could be procured, it is laid over the corpse instead, and then earth is put upon it, and the grave filled up.

The funeral ceremonies are further continued by the following observances : — The wife or wives of the deceased are to lie on the bare ground over the grave without even a mat or cloth being spread for full three months from the date of the funeral. On the 7th day they are led out of their town wall by an Egugun to a place where mounds of earth had been raised according to the number of the women with a yam placed on each mound. There is an extra mound raised, on which no yam is placed ; this represents the deceased. The widows are led out clad in rags with both hands on the opposite shoulders, their heads being left bare. Each takes a yam from the heap, and this is understood to be the last subsistence they should expect to receive from their dear departed. After this they return home weeping.

On the 13th or 17th day the final ceremony is thus performed : By the advice of the Alagba, they provide some heads of cowries, a dog, two dishes of pounded yam or cooked yam flour, two pots of native beer, kola nuts, parched corn, a hoe and a cutlass, and two coverings of native cloth for an Egugun dress. At dead of night a man goes and sits on the roof of the house of the deceased ; another who is to personate the dead, is secreted at the back yard, but within hearing distance of the former ; a third is the Egugun called Agan undressed, coming in the Alagba's company, speaking in a hollow, but thrilling tone of voice, crying out, " E gbe mi." (Do lift me up). Immediately several voices are heard " Lift here, lift there," as if they were carrying the Agan and found him rather heavy. As they enter the compound the widows and the other women are to rush into the rooms and ex'tinguish all lights. The Agan is then conducted to the piazza of the deceased where the special ceremony is performed. He sings out distinctly the name of the deceased so that the substitute might hear him, at the same time warning him not to answer to his call, but to that of the man on the roof. The latter then strikes the hoe in his hand with the cutlass as a signal to attract the attention of the secreted substitute.

After this, he calls out in loud tones the name of the deceased as did the Agan. He calls out three times, and at the third call, which is also the last, a still small voice is heard from the counterfeit, simulating that of the dead. At this stage, the widows and all the other mourners begin to weep and wail for the dead ; the dog is then slaughtered and the flesh is taken to the Alagbas.

On the following morning, the Egugun of the deceased, appears in his usual dress, with an attendant Egugun, both emerging from the Alagbi's house. He proceeds to his old home where a mat is spread outside to receive him. He embraces all his children, sits them by turns on his knees, and blesses them, promising to bestow health, strength, long life, and the rest. He accepts presents from all the relatives, who are the mourners — of stringed cowries from the men, and unstringed from the women. After which they repair with all the presents received to the Egugun grove or to the Alagba's where the Egugun is undressed and a good feast is made of the flesh of the dog slaughtered on the previous evening. The stringed cowries contributed by the men are there returned to each of them, being participators in the organised imposture that was being practised. The unstringed cowries of their dupes, the women, are distributed amongst those who took part

in the ceremony including of course the AlagbS.. . This is the last farewell between the deceased and his family if we except the supposed annual visits made by the former during the Egugun festivals.

In case of a woman the ceremony is simpler. The same offerings are usually required, excepting the hoe and the cutlass. The relatives are ordered to procure a miniature hearth, and put it into a new calabash to meet the Egugun of the deceased matron emerging from the Egugun grove.

On the day appointed they proceed to the grove with drums, the orphans carrying each a horse's tail on his shoulder, as a sign of mourning. Then one of the Alagba's men calls out thrice the name of the dead matron, just as in the similar ceremony detailed above ; an Egugun answers from the grove and the voice is drowned with drumming and singing. The Egugun with the Paka (an attendant) now issues from the grove, and walks towards the orphan children to receive the new calabash containing the miniature hearth ; blesses the giver, and returns with it to the grove. The hearth is subsequently buried quietly by the river side or within the grove.

This is the last office of a dutiful child to its mother and this is understood as their last meeting in this world. The hearth presented to her is for her to cook with in the other world.

The period of mourning for either man or woman is as aforesaid, three months, during which time the men are to remain unwashed, unshaven and the women with dishevelled hair and dress unchanged. At the expiration of this term on a day appointed the whole of them shave for the dead, and their hair is thrown outside by the wall of the house. They then parade the streets, dressed in their best, singing and dancing in honour of the dead, and calling at one house after another to return thanks to the sympathizers. The children of the deceased, begotten or adopted, now carry the horses' tails in their hands by which they are distinguished from those who have no immediate connection with the family.

In the division of the property the widows as aforesaid pass into the possession of the children and the nearest relatives, the right to each being determined by ballot. Each male relative sends round his chewing stick (native tooth brush) with his name to the woman of his choice ; they are expected to reject the proposal twice as if they were resolved to remain widows all their life ; but at the third and last proposal, with tears in their eyes, they make their choice and are taken over. This concludes the final ceremony.

In the case of young men or young women, the proceedings are essentially different. The companions of him or her that is gone proceed in a body to a spot where two roads intersect each other, preceded by one of their number who stands at a great distance from them. The call as in the case of the Agan is made thrice, the usual answer follows, and then he or she is told by all the friends and companions " A yk o O ! " (we separate you from our companionship). The substitute returns home with the rest, and the simple ceremony comes to an end.

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PART II.

YORUBA KINGS AND CONTEMPORARY EVENTS EMBRACING FOUR PERIODS.

I. The Mythological Period : Oduduwa to Ajaka

II. The Period of Growth and Prosperity : Aganju to

Abiqdun

III. The Decline, Revolutionary Wars and Disruption:

Aole to Oluewu

IV. The Arrest of Disintegration, Efforts at Restoration

OF Unity, Tribal Wars, the British Protectorate : Atiba to Adeyemi

FIRST PERIOD— MYTHOLOGICAL KINGS AND DEIFIED

HEROES

Chapter I

THE FOUNDERS OF THE YORUBA NATION.

§ I. Oduduwa

Oduduwa the reputed founder and ancestor of the race is really a mythical personage. The Etymology of the term is from Odu (ti o) da Iwk. Whatever is unusually large as a large pot or container is termed Odii : the term then implies, the great container the author of existence. According to Ife mythology Oduduwa was the son of Olodu mare, i.e. the father or Lord of Odu ; ma r6 implies cannot go beyond i.e. the Almighty. Oduduwa was sent by Olodumare from heaven to create the earth. Olokun i.e. the goddess of the ocean was the wife of Oduduwa, Oranmiyan and Isgdale their children, and Ogun a grand-child.

Such is the desire of most nations to find a mythical origin for themselves through their kings and ancestors.

All that was known of him has been told in Part I of this history, which gives an account of the emigration of the ancestors of the Yorubas from the east to He Ife where Oduduwa died in peace and was deified, being worshipped to this day by the Ifes, and up to the time of the British Protectorate, human sacrifices were offered to him at regular intervals. The soil of He Ife is said to be sacred to him. He was the grandfather and great-grandfather of renowned Kings and Princes who ruled and made history in the Yoruba country.

The number of years embraced by this period is unknown, but it includes the time during which the Yoruba kingdom was in prosperity, and the Kings despotic. The capital of the kingdom then was He If§.

The Basgrun of this reign was Qlorunfun-mi.

§ 2. Oranyan

Orafiyan the grandson of Oduduwa succeeded his grandfather on the throne. He was a very brave and warlike Prince, and of an indomitable courage. He was the founder of the order of the Esos vide Pt. I page 73. His body-guard consisted of 150 welltried soldiers.

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How he headed his brothers on an abortive expedition to the east to avenge the death of their great-grandfather, and how they quarrelled at Igangan and dispersed from that place, has been told in Part I. After founding the city of Oyo where he resided for a time he was said to have pushed on to a place called Okd, leaving Oyo in charge of one of the princes. This is not unlikely when we remember that that was not an age of settled government, but that the warlike and restless King was engaged in extending his dominions far and wide. Much that was known of him has been told in Part I. He resided at 6k6 for many years and according to some died there, but others affirmed that he died at He Ife, where his grave is shown to this day. But the Yorubas have a custom whenever any one died away from home, to cut the hair of his head and pare his nails, and these are taken to the place where they would have him buried, and there ceremoniously and religiously deposited. It may thus have been the case here. But an anecdote connected with his later years must here be told :

It was said that after a long period of reign an urgent necessity made him revisit the city of He Ife, which he had left for so long a time ; perhaps to arrange some family affairs, or to possess himself of some of his father's treasures left in charge of Adimu. He left his son Ajaka as Regent and went. Having stayed much longer than the time fixed for his return (communication between the two places being then dangerous and difficult) the people thought he was dead, or that at any rate he would no more return to 6k6 ; the OYO MESI who were the authorised rulers of the town consequently confirmed Ajaka on the throne, investing him with full powers, and all the insignia of royalty.

But his father was returning ; and having come within a short distance of the city, his attention was arrested by the sound of the Kakaki trumpet — a trumpet blown for the sovereign alone. Upon enquiry, he learnt what had taken place. He thereupon retraced his steps quietly to He Ifg where he spent the rest of his days in peaceful retirement. An obelisk termed Opa Oranyan (Orafiyan's staff) erected on the spot he was supposed

to have been buried is shown at He Ife to this day. This would seem to confirm the view that he died and was buried at He If§ and not at 0k6.

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Opa Or(7/7c/an

*WT^

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This obelisk is about 10 or 12 feet in height/ and about 4 feet square in width at its base ; it tapers to a point, and has upon one face of it, several spike nails driven into it, and some carvings as of ancient characters. The nails are arranged in such an ordered manner as to render them significant. First, there are 61 in a straight line from the bottom upwards at intervals of about 2 inches in midline; and next, at about a distance of 4 inches on either side of this, and from the same level on top, two parallel lines of 31 nails ea.ch running downwards and curving below to meet those of the midline. Then in the space between these three rows of parallel lines, and about the level where they converge, is found the most conspicuous of the carvings, i*.

What is conjectured as most probable in these arrangements is that the 61 nails in midline represent the number of years Oraiiyan lived, and that the 31 each on either side indicates that he was 31 when he began to reign, and that he reigned 31 years, the year he began to reign being counted twice as is the manner of the Yorubas ; and that the carvings are the ancient characters Resh and Yod which stand for Oranyan.

Besides Opa Orafiyan, there are to be found to this day, in groves at He Ife, and at other Ife settlements outside the city, carvings in stone of natural objects such as tongs and anvil, table, stool, fish, and several other objects of curiosity which are generally hidden from strangers, because they are held sacred ; they represent the handicrafts of the founders of the race.

The art of carving on stones or drilling holes in them has since become lost among Yorubas, and consequently, how nails could have been driven into stones and various figures cut out of them is usually explained to be, that these objects were once carved out of wood, and when the carvers were deified, their work became petrified ! As these gods were once men, so these stones were once wood !

The Ifes are the guardians and custodians of these sacred relics from ancient times.

Nearly all legends and folklore are attributed to the age of Orafiyan, among these may be mentioned the following told by an ffe :—

1 About four feet was broken off from the top of this obelisk during a storm in the year 1884. The obelisk has since twice fallen down and inartistically re-erected. But a stump of it now remains.

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The Legend of Moremi and her Son

" Moremi was the wife of one of the ancient heroes of He Ifg, probably Oranmiyan. She was a woman of great beauty and virtue, and had an only son named Ela or Olurogbo.

It happened that the city of Ife was at one time in a state of frequent commotion and unrest, owing to the repeated raids of a tribe of people called the Igbos. This continued for a series of years. The Ifes attributed this affliction and distress to the displeasure of their gods, because those that attacked them from the Igbo territory appeared not to be human beings, but gods or demi gods, and consequently the Ifes felt they could not withstand them, and so these raiders used to make away with easy plunder, including their valuables, with their women and children. For this they propitiated and called upon their gods for help, but received no response.

Now, this Moremi, fired with zeal and patriotism was determined to do what she could to free her country from this calamity. She was resolved to find out what these Igbos really were, and how to fight them. To this end she repaired to a stream called Esinmirin, and there made a vow to the deity thereof, that if she was enabled to carry out her plans, and they proved successful, she would offer to the god the most costly

sacrifice she could afford. Her plan was to expose herself to the raiders, and get caught, and be taken to their country where she could best learn their secrets: 'But,' she said, ' if I perish, I perish.'

At the time of the next raid she undertook to carry out her plans, she was caught by the Igbos and taken to their country ; and being a woman of great beauty, she was given up amongst others, and sundry booty to their king. Her beauty and virtue soon won her a place in the country and the confidence of the people ; she became familiar with all their customs, and learnt all their secrets : then she also learnt that those who were such objects of terror to her people were mere men, who covered themselves from head to foot with Ekan grass and bamboo fibres, making them appear extra human, and are nicknamed Eluyare. She extracted from her husband also the secret of attacking them successfully. ' If your people know how to make a torch, and have the courage to rush amongst them with lighted torches, they cannot stand that.'

Moremi feeling she was now conversant with everything amongst the Igbos, having disarmed any suspicion they may have entertained of her as a captive, suddenly escaped one day to her native land, and by making use of the secrets she had learnt, freed her

country for ever from the raids of the men once their terror. It remained now for her to fulfil her vows.

She repaired to the stream with her offerings of lambs, rams, and goats for sacrifice, but the god would not accept any of these. She then offered a bullock, which the god also refused to accept, then she prayed the priests to divine for her what would be acceptable ; this was done, and the god demanded of her, her only son !

She then gave up her only son in sacrifice to the gods in the fulfilment of her vcws. The If§ nation bewailed her loss and promised to be to her sons ind daughters, for the loss she had sustained for the salvation of her country.

Olurogbo however, when supposed to be killed, was but half dead ; he afterwards revived and rose again, and made a rope with which he climbed up into heaven ; and all Ifes to this day have a full hope that he will come again to this world, and reap the full reward of his good deeds."

We may discern in this legend a confused idea of the story of Jephtha, and that of the Blessed Virgin and her Son perverted,

Orafiyan was the father of al^ Oyos or Yorubas proper, and was the universal conqaeror of the land. He left behind him two renowned sons, Ajaka and Sango, both of whom succeeded him in turns, and both of whom became famous in Yoruba history, and were deified after death.

The Basorun of this reign was Efufu-ko-fe-ori.

§ 3. AjuAN alias Ajaka

Ajuan alias Oba Ajaka was at first only a Regent when his father left for He Ife, but was subsequently confirmed on the throne as was mentioned above. He alone of all the Yoruba Kings had the singular fortune (or misfortune) of being called to the throne twice, being once deposed, but afterwards recalled to the throne.

Very little was known of his earlier reign, except that, unlike his father, he was of a peaceful disposition, loved husbandry and encouraged it.

Being too mild for the warlike spirit of the age, and tamely suffering the encroachments of provincial kings, he was dethroned, and he went to Igbodo where he remained in retirement seven years during which period his brother Sango reigned in his stead. His Basorun was nick-named Erin-din-logun-Agbgn k6 se da ni Ha (i.e. sixteen cocoa nuts is unsuitable for Ha divination). That is to say cocoa nuts are not suitable substitutes for palm nuts. The reason for this sobriquet is not known.

§ 4. Sango or Olufiran

Sango son of Oranyan, and brother of Ajaka was the fourth King of Yoruba. He was of a very wild disposition, fiery temper, and skilful in sleight of hand tricks. He had a habit of emitting fire and smoke out of his mouth, by which he greatly increased the dread his subjects had of him.

The Olowii at this time appeared to have been more powerful than the King of Ovo, for after the death of the uncle Oranyan, he compelled his cousin the peaceful Ajaka to pay tribute to him. This was probably the reason why Ajaka was deposed.

On Sango's coming to the throne, being a much younger man, the Olowu meant to take advantage of his youth ; he demanded the tribute of him, but Sango refused to acknowledge his primacy, notwithstanding the Olowu' s threat to deprive him of his wives and children ; consequently his capital was besieged and a sharp fight ensued. Sango there displayed his wonted bravery as well as his tricks ; volumes of smoke issuing from his mouth and nostrils so terrified the Olowu and his army that they became panic stricken and were completely routed and put to flight.

Sango pushed on his advantage, and with every fresh victory he was the more firmly established on the throne ; he thereby became elated and was tyrannical.

It was his ambition now to remove the seat of government from Oko to Oyo then called Oyokoro, he knew he would meet with strong opposition from the prince of that city and so he set upon devising plans by which he could effect his purpose with as little fighting as possible.

Sango was now possessed with a desire of performing an act of filial piety. He wished to worship at the grave of his dead mother, but he did not so much as remember her name for she died when he was but a babe. She was the daughter of Elempe a Nupe king, who formed an alliance with Oranyan by giving him his daughter to wife, of which marriage Sango was the issue. Sango therefore commissioned a Tetu and a Hausa slave to proceed to the Tapa country, to his maternal grandfather Elempe for the purpose giving them a horse and a cow for the sacrifice.

' The King's charge to these messengers was, that they should listen carefully to the first name uttered in the invocation which evidently will be his mother's name.

The messengers were heartily welcomed and highly entertained by Elempe, their King's grandfather, so much so that the Hausa forgot himself and the duty he was charged with. At the time of the sacrifice, the priest said at the grave " Tor6si, lya gbodo,

listen to us, thy son Sango is come to worship thee." The Tgtu noted the name Torosi, but the Hausa, being far from sober paid no heed to what was said ; therefore, on their return home, the Tgtu who had faithfully carried out his orders was highly rewarded, and the Hausa slave severely punished. The punishment meted out to him was 122 razor cuts slashed all over his body as a lasting warning for all time.

The scars left by these wounds strangely took the fancy of the King's wives who thought that they added comeliness and beauty to the man, and therefore they advised that in future such marks should not be performed upon a slave, but on actual members of the royal family as distinctive of royalty.

Sango took this advice, and placed himself first in the hands of the " Olowolas " (the markers) named Babajegbe Osan and Babajegbe Oru ; but he could stand only two cuts on each arm, and forbade them to proceed any further. This is what is termed £y6. The marks are to this day retained in the royal family, as a distinctive badge of royalty, and hence members of the royal family are termed Akey6. They are two broad ribbon marks on the arms from the shoulder to the wrist.

When the King had determined upon taking Oyokoro, it occurred to him to employ this as a device by which he could effect his purpose easily without loss of lives. He thereupon sent the Hausa slave to Oloyo-koro for him to see how beautiful this slave looks with these marks, and that it has been resolved to use the same as a mark of royalty ; he therefore advised the Oloyo-koro to submit himself to be thus marked, with his principal chiefs for rank and beauty, stating that he himself had done so. To this they consented, Babajegbe Osan and Babajegbe Oru were sent over there, and admirably did they perform their tasks.

But on the third day, when the Oloyo-koro and his chiefs were very sore, Sango appeared with his forces against them ; no resistance could be offered, and the city fell easily into his hands : shamefully and brutally he put to death the prince and his chiefs, the dupes of his stratagem.

Thus the seat of government was permanently removed from Oko (or as some would have it, from He Ife) to Oyo the ancient " Eyeo or Katunga."

Sango reigned for seven years, the whole of which period was marked by his restlessness. He fought many battles and was fond of making charms. He was said to have the knowledge of some preparation by which he could attract lightning. The palace at Oyo was built at the foot of a hill called Ok^ Ajaka (Ajaka's hill). One day the King ascended this hill accompanied

by his courtiers and some of his slaves, among whom were two favourites, Biri and Omiran ; some of his cousins went with him, but none of his children. He was minded to try the preparation he had in hand ; thinking it might have been damp and useless, he first made the experiment on his own house. But it took effect, a storm was immediately raised and the lightning had struck the palace before they came down the hill, and the buildings were on fire. Many of Sango's wives and his children perished in this catastrophe.

Sango who was the author of his own misfortunes became alarmed and dismayed at what had happened and from a broken heart he was resolved to abdicate the throne and retire to the court of his maternal grandfather, Elempe king of the Nupes.

All Oyo was now astir, not only to sympathize with the King, but also to dissuade him from carrying out his resolution ; but he could not bear any opposition, and so mad was he, that he even used his sword against some of his loyal subjects who ventured to remonstrate with him, and who promised to replace for him his dead wives by others, by whom he might beget children, and so in time make good his present losses.

According to other accounts, he did not abdicate of his own freewill, but was asked to do so by a strong party in the state. Both accounts may be true, there may have been two parties, for to this day, Yorubas have an abhorence of a King given to making deadly charms ; because for one who already has absolute power invested in him by law, this strange power can only be used spitefully, so that no one near him would be safe.

He was said to have caused 160 persons to be slain in a fit of anger, of those who were showing much concern and over-anxiety on his behalf, and who would prevent him by force from carrying out his resolve.

Thus determined he set out on his fateful journey with a few followers. Biri his head slave and favourite was the first to regret the step taken, and to urge on his master to yield to the entreaties of those citizens of Ovo, who with all loyalty promised to replace his losses, as far as man can do it, and to rebuild the palace ; but finding the King inexorable, he forsook him and returned to the city with all his followers ; Omiran likewise followed his example, and the King was thus left alone. He now repented his rashness, especially when he found himself deserted by his favourite Biri. He could not proceed alone, and for shame he could not return home, and so he was resolved to put an end to his own life ; and climbing on a shea butter tree, he hanged himself.

His friends hearing of this tragedy went immediately and

performed for him the last act of kindness, by burying his remains under the same tree.

On hearing of the King's death, his personal friends followed his example, and died with him. Biri committed suicide at Koso (where the King died), Omiran did the same. His cousin Omo Sinda committed suicide at Papo, Babayanmi at Sele, Obei at Jakuta and Oya his favourite wife at Ira.

Thus ended the life of this remarkable personage, who once ruled over all the Yorubas and Popos. He was afterwards deified, and is still worshipped by all of the Yoruba race as the god of thunder and lightning.

In every Yoruba and Popo town to this day, whenever there is a flash of lightning followed by a peal of thunder, it is usual to hear from the populace shouts of " Ka wo o," " ka biye si " (welcome to your majesty, long live the King.)

Ajaka his brother was now recalled from exile, and he once more held the reins of government.

Salekuodi was the Basorun of this reign.

§ 5. Ajaka's Second Reign

King Ajaka who was dethroned for being too peaceful was now recalled to the throne. He proved after his re-instatement a totally different man to what he had been before, and showed himself more warlike than even his brother Sango,

He led an expedition into the Tapa country. Tradition has it, that he employed large and well-trained birds, armed with arrows, and after crossing the Niger they showered down these deadly weapons upon the maternal relations of his brother Sango.

What is certain is, that the expedition was successful but by what means, it is not really known. But thus it was with the Yorubas (as with all superstitious people) that brave deeds and extraordinary acts of daring are always attributed to the supernatural.

He spent the latter part of his years in waging intestine wars with his subjects. He was said to have been engaged in civil wars with 1060 of his chiefs and princes among whom were the principal vassal or provincial kings, the Onikoyi, the Olugbon, and the Aresa.

He had in his service certain " medicine men," who made charms for him, viz., Atagbgin, Omo-onik6k6, Abitibiti Onisegun, Paku, Teteoniru, Y5nk, Oko-adan Egbeji, Alari baba isegun, and Elenre.

The following fable was related of him : —

After his wars, some of these " medicine men " went up to him,

and humbly prayed to be allowed to return home ; but the King refused to grant them leave, fearing lest their services might be required by some other kings, and in that way, others might be in possession of the charms they made for him. As they were determined to go home they showed the King by demonstrative proofs, that they made the request simply out of courtesy but that the King could not detain them. Paku fell down before him, and disappeared. Tete oniru, Abitibiti Onisegun, and Alari baba I§egun performed the same feat and vanished. Egbeji threw up a ball of thread which hung suspended in space, and he climbed up it and disappeared. Elenre alone remained standing before him. Then said the King to him " Elenre, you had better follow the examples of your colleagues and vanish, or I shall wreak my vengeance upon you for their disobedience." " Kill me if you can " replied Elenre. The King thereupon ordered him to be decapitated ; but the sword was broken in two on the attempt. He then ordered him to be speared but the spear became bent and the spearman's arm withered ! He ordered a large stone to be rolled over him to crush him to death but it fell on him as light as a ball of cotton-wool.

The King and the executioners were now at their wits' end, and then it occurred to one of them to " plough with his heifer." His wife Ijaehin being prevailed upon, told them that no iron or steel can affect him: "Pull off a single blade of grass from the thatch of the house, and with that you can decapitate him." This was done, and the head was struck off, but instead of falling to the ground, it fell into the King's hand, and he involuntarily grasped it. The King tried all his best to drop it off, but to no avail. Any food brought to the King the head devoured, and drank all the water likewise. The King soon became famished, he was losing flesh, and was really dying from hunger.

All the " medicine-men " of every tribe in the kingdom were sent for, to disenchant this alarming phenomenon : as soon as anyone entered, the head would call him by name, tell out the composition of his charms, and then ask " Do you think that can affect me ? " Thus many were baffled, until at last came one Agawo ; this man at once pro:-trated at a distance and entreated the head to forbear with him, saying : — " Who am I to oppose you ? In what am I better than my predecessors whom you have already foiled ? I came

only in obedience to the King's commands as I dare not refuse to come." The head replied " I will respect you because you are wise and respect yourself ; I yield to your entreaties." Then, falling suddenly from the King's hands.

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Elenre's head became a flowing river known at Oyo to this day as Odo Elenre (Elenre's river).

His wife Ijaehin who disclosed the secret of his strength was also converted into a stream, but Elenre's head said to it " Thou shalt not flow," therefore Ijaehin became a stagnant pool at Oyo unto this day.

From this incident King Ajaka made it a rule that from henceforth no King should be present in person at an execution.

He put to death all the vassal kings 1060 in number taken in war ; the relics of their skulls were put together and are worshipped under the name of Orisa'la to this day. This is the probable origin of that worship.

The reign of the mythological heroes abound in garbled forms of scriptural stories, showing as was remarked in the earlier part of this history that the ancestors of the Yorubas were acquainted with Christianity in the land of their origin. The fable here related is evidently the story of Elijah in a perverted form.. His putting to death so many priests of Baal has been perverted into Ajaka slaying all his vassal kings and their skulls converted to an object of worship. His judgment of fire on those sent to arrest him finds a counterpart in Elenre's head anticipating those who came to exorcise it, both yielded to a wiser delegate who substituted entreaties for authority. The name Asawo (i.e. one who deals in mysteries) is very significant ; it is evidently a mythological rather than a real name. Elijah going up to heaven became Egbeji climbing up a cord and disappearing as the saying goes " Egbeji ta 'kun O lo si Orun," i.e. Egbeji suspended a cord and by it went up to heaven. The river Jordan crossed by Elijah suggested Elenre's head becoming a river, etc.

The Ogidigbo drum was introduced into Oyo during this reign. It is of all drums the most inartistic, and is totally devoid of any embellishment. It consists of a block of wood about 3ft. in length hollowed out from the centre to about 6 inches of both extremities, and is beaten with a rod.

It is used only for the King and theBasorun at the great festivals when they dance together at his public appearance.

Nothing is known of the end of Ajaka, probably he died in peace.

Salekuodi continued as the Basorun of this reign also.

SECOND PERIOD.— THE PERIOD OF GROWTH AND PROSPERITY AND OPPRESSION.

Chapter II

HISTORICAL KINGS

§ r. Aganju

As Sango left no issue, the crown fell to Ajaka's son Aganju without any dispute. His reign was long and very prosperous. He had a remarkable faculty of taming wild animals and venomous reptiles, several of which may be seen crawling about him. He had also in his house a tame leopard.

He greatly beautified the palace adding piazzas in front and back, with rows of brazen posts. He originated the custom of decorating the palace with hangings on state occasions, being a sovereign of accomplished taste.

Towards the end of his reign, he waged war with a namesake of his, Aganju the Onisambo, for refusing him the hand of his daughter lyayun. In this war, four chiefs, viz. the Onisambo and his allies the Onitede the Onimeri and the Alagbona were captured, their towns destroyed, and the bride forcibly secured.

The close of his reign was clouded by great domestic troubles. His only son Lubeg6 was discovered having illicit intercourse with his beloved lyayun, on whose account so many princes and people have lost their lives. The stern father was enraged beyond words, the sentence pronounced on him was the extreme penalty of the law, and it was rigidly carried out. But the King was overcome with grief, he died not long after

this, even before the birth of a successor to the throne. The name of his Basorun was Banija, succeeded by Erankogbina.

§ 2. KoRi

The late King having no surviving son Erankogbina the Basorun was left to manage the affairs of the kingdom. The only hope of a direct successor to the throne was the child of lyayun still in utero ; hence sacrifices were offered frequently on the grave of Aganju praying him to grant lyayun a son if his name is not to be forgotten, and the dynasty end with him. When in due course therefore lyayun gave birth to a son, the joy of the populace was unbounded. He was named Kgri.

During Kori's minority, lyayun was declared Regent ; she wore the crown, and put on the royal robes, and was invested with the Ejigha, the Opa ileke and other royal insignia, and ruled the kingdom as a man until her son was of age.

It was during this reign that Timi was sent to Ede and not in Sango's reign as was supposed.^

The Ijesas proving very troublesome to their neighbours by kidnapping them in their farms, and molesting caravans to and from Apomu a frontier town where a large fair is periodically held for the exchange of goods with the Ijebus, and also getting frequently embroiled with the king of Ido their neighbour, complaints from time to time reached the AlAfin of Oyo. It was now determined that a stop be put to these inroads ; for this purpose the King sent a notable hunter to that district who succeeded in checking these marauders. He took up a position at a place called Ede as his headquarters, and there he subsequently established himself as a kinglet with the title of Timi.

Timi was a famous archer, notable for his deadly arrows, and he more than justified his appointment. The Owa of Ilesa imitating the same appointment, posted an opposition kinglet at Osogbo named Atawoja ; but his chief duty was to worship the fish in the river Osun.

As the Timi's duties required all his time, skill and valour, he had no time left to provide for himself and family ; the traders and caravans being now well protected, he obtained permission from the AlAfin to levy a toll of 5 cowries each on every trader ; by this means he soon had more than enough for the support of his family, and as a good and loyal subject, he paid the surplus into the royal treasury.

After some years of this act of loyalty, he regretted this selfimposed tribute, taking another view of the matter, that whatever he could collect this way should be his own by right as a compensation for the loss of the advantages of a city life, as well as a reward for his labours. So he abruptly stopped the tribute.

When the King missed the usual tribute, he sent to demand the same, but Timi refused to pay it, and gave his reasons for not doing so. This did not satisfy the King, so a more peremptory order was sent to Timi to deliver up what he had withheld. This order was also disobeyed, and so the King resorted to force, a body of troops was sent to arrest him, and to seize all his belongings. But Timi was prepared for this, he resisted with all his might, and routed the King's forces.

^ Vide Yoruba Reading Book.

But the King was resolved to punish Timi as a warning to others who might follow his example. Eliri-onigbajo the Gbonka was proposed to him as the only man equal to the task. But the Gbonka was already a powerful subject at Oyq, being the only man who dared to oppose the King's encroachments upon the liberties of the people, therefore, he was at first loth to accede to this proposal, lest a success might add an additional lustre to the Gbonka's glory, and make him more elated than before ; but on second consideration he consented, secretly hoping he might fall by the hand of his brave antagonist. So the Gbonka was appointed.

The fight was limited to a single combat between the two chieftains, Timi armed himself with his bow and arrows, but the Gbonka carried a shield with which to defend himself against the powerful darts of his assailant. His own weapon of offence was a viol containing a drug with strong narcotic properties when

inhaled, and by means of this Timi was soon rendered unconscious, and in this state, he was dispossessed of his weapons, and taken bound to Qyo.

The King received the tidings with mixed feelings of joy and disappointment that neither of them fell in the combat, especially the Gbonka whom he wished to get rid of. When the illustrious captive was brought before him, the King pretended to be dissatisfied with the issue of the contest, doubting its fairness, except the same could be repeated in his presence, so that he may witness it personally, secreth^ hoping that Timi might have a better chance this time, and that the Gbonka might fall. This desire was apparent to all present, and to the Gbonka himself ; however, he addressed himself to the renewed combat. The King ordered the Timi's weapons to be restored to him, and the fight resumed. To his mortification the Gbonka was again victorious amid shouts of applause from the people. Timi was not only subdued but was also instantaneously killed by the victor before the King and without his orders.

The Gbonka to show further what he could do, and to strike terror into the King, ordered a pile to be made, and pots of palm oil, nut oil, and shea butter to be poured on it ; he then went coolly and sat on the top of it, and ordered it to be set on fire. All present were anxious for the consequence ; but when the pile was ablaze, the Gbonka disappeared.

Courtiers now began to congratulate the King on the fall of his enemy by his own hands ; but he was apprehensive of some other issues " Not too fast" said he, " we must first wait and see." Tidings soon reached the court that the Gbonka followed by drummers, was seen dancing about the town.

The Gbonka knowing the public feeling towards the King, and his unpopularity, entered the palace and challenged His Majesty to display feats similar to his own and said if he could not, he would be rejected. There being no alternative, the King took poison and died.

Esugbiri succeeded Erankogbina as Basorun during this reign.

§ 3. Oluaso

The unfortunate King was succeeded by a handsome and amiable prince called Oluaso, who was remarkable for his longevity and peaceful reign. His agnomen was Osarewa S'akin i.e., handsome but strong. He was a wise and affable sovereign fabled to have reigned for 320 years, and had 1460 children ! Three times did nine of his wives bear him male twins in one day. The first set he named Omgla, the second Ona-aka, and the third Ona-isokun. Of these three sets of twins the last (Ona-isokun) were the most popular and Kings were chosen from amongst them and their descendants. These names have become hereditary titles unto this day. The King built 54 palaces for these 54 princes all of whom rose to positions of trust and responsibility by their own merits.

He originated and built 120 kobis to the royal palace. He was ably assisted by his Basorun, Esugbiri-elu. He lived to a good old age, and died full of days and honour, and his longevity has passed into a proverb. " O ni ki o gbo ogbo Oluaso, o le jiya Oluaso ? " You pray to live as long as Oluaso, can you endure the trials of Oluaso ? Old age has its own trials and sufferings. His son Onigbogi succeeded him on the throne. Esugbiri was the Basorun of this reign also.

§ 4. Onigbogi

Onigbogi was one of the sons of Oluaso by Aruigba-ifa an Ota woman. She had left Oyq during the previous reign for her own native town, but on hearing that her son ascended the throne, she returned to Oyo in order to assist him in his government by her advice. She was a very superstitious woman. Wishing her son to have a long and prosperous reign, she advised him to introduce the worship of Ifa into Oyo as a national deity. The Oyo citizens asked the King and his mother what offerings are required with which to propitiate Ha. She replied, 16 rats, 16 bags of cowries, 16 fishes, 16 fowls, 16 arm lengths of cloth and 16 ground pigs. The Oyo citizens answered that they were prepared to give the offerings, but they could not worship palm nuts. Thus the advice of the King's mother was rejected and the worship of Ifa cancelled.

When Aruigba-ifa was going to Oyq she was accompanied by the personification of several common objects used in fetish worship e.g. Aje, Opon, Ajere, Osun, Elegbara, and Iroke. When the citizens of Oyo rejected her god, she returned on her way to Ota with all her followers, weeping as they went. On reaching the foot of the Ado hill, the Alado's wife came out to see the cause of a company of people weeping and wailing, saying " We are driven out of the country." She reported this at home, and the Alado came out and invited the party to lodge with him. His inquisitiveness led him to ask why such august personages should be driven out of the city ; when he had learnt the whole story, he sympathized with Arugba, and asked her to stay, promising to give some of the things required, as they were too poor to be able to afford all. This was done, and Arugba not only initiated him into the mysteries, but also conferred upon him the right of initiating others. Hence in the subsequent reign when the Oyos decided to adopt Ifa worship, it was this Alado who went to the city to initiate them into all the mysteries, rites and ceremonies of Ifa worship.

A war broke out after these events, and the King sent out the Basgrun at the head of his army to Ita-ibidun with all the war chiefs. The king of the Tapas (Nupe) between whom and the Yorubas there have been strained relations since the death of Sango, seized this opportunity for crossing the river, and pouring his army into the Yoruba country, carried everything before him, until he stood before the gate of Ovo. There being no available force to oppose him, the city was soon taken. The King fled to Gbere in the Bariba country, and there he died not being used to the hardships incidental to the life of an exile ; leaving his son Ofinran a refugee in a strange land. In the land of his exile. King Onigbogi made it a law that only 35 of the Esos should be absent from home at any time, leaving 35 for the defence of the city and country, the Tapa King having entered Ovo practically without any opposition.

Ayangbagi Aro was the Basorun of this period.

§ 5. Ofinran

The Oyo refugees were at first received with open arms by the King Eleduwe and his Balogun Bokgyo because Ofinran's mother was a Bariba woman. The refugees having no regular employment here, joined theBaribas, who are a race of marauders, in all their expeditions. In one of these expeditions Irawo in the Yoruba country was taken, and also Oke Isero where died the famous warchief Gbonka Eleri-onigbajo.

After this, the Baribas began to ill-treat the refugees, but the young prince proved himself equal to the occasion ; he collected his people together, and set out at their head for Oyo.

When they arrived at a place called Kusu, they encamped there to complete their preparations for the journey to Oyo. From Kusu the King sent delegates to Ota for Ifa priests, as he and his chiefs superstitiously believed that their misfortunes arose from their rejecting the worship of Ifa ; the Alado then came to initiate the AlAfin and his people into the mysteries of the Ifa worship. Thus Ifa was accepted by Yoruba proper among the gods of the land.

The Egugun mysteries also were hitherto unknown to the Yorubas, by this means the Tapas have long imposed upon them, they believing in the reality of the so-called apparitions. On the hill Sanda at Kusu the secret was made known to Saha the King's head slave.

The first Alapini with the other Egugun priests the Elefi, Olohan, Oloba, Aladafa, and the Olgj^, emigrated from the Tapa country to Yoruba, joining the remnants returning from the Bariba country. These became the first priests, and instructed the Yorubas further in the Egiigun worship ; therefore the honours and emoluments to be enjoyed in this worship by right belong to them and their successors unto this day.

Before the encampment at Kusu was broken up, the King died, and was succeeded by his son Eguguoju. The deceased King's body was wrapped in an ass's skin to be taken to Oyo. At a place called Okutu-gbogbo the cord broke, and the body had to be bound up afresh before they could proceed. On the very spot in which this happened, the palace at Saki was built.

Sokia " ti iwo ewn irin " (clad with a coat of mail) was the Basorun of this period.

Chapter III

THE KINGS OF OYO IGBOHO

§ r. Eguguoju

Eguguoju having succeeded his father, became the leader of his people to Oyo ; the camp at Kusu was broken up and they carried the remains of the late King with them for state funeral at home.

They encamped next at Iju Sanya, a desert place. Whilst there two large birds an Igbo and an Oyo were seen fighting, and they chased each other from the bough of the tree under which the King sat until they came down to the ground, and he ordered both to be caught and killed.

This occurrence was regarded by him as a happy omen ; he therefore resolved to build a city there and to remove the seat of government to that place. From the example of the birds, he was resolved to fight to the last drop of blood in his veins any army that came against him there, never showing the " white feather." The city was accordingly built there, and was named Oyo Igboho, after the two birds, Igbo and Oyo, and there he buried the remains of his father.

Nothing remarkable was recorded of this King except that he built Igboho, which became the last resting-place of four Yoruba Kings before the government was again removed to the ancient capital.

Obalohun was the Basorun of this reign.

§ 2. Orompotq

Prince Orompoto, brother of Eguguoju, and son of Ofinran succeeded to the throne. Shortly after his accession, troubles began to assail him ; he, however, proved himself to be a skilful and experienced commander, and as a statesman, he was unrivalled. In his reign Oyo regained the military fame it had lost. He was swift in action, darting upon his enemies as an eagle upon his prey, when they least expected his approach. He used all skill to conceal his movements from the enemy. His rearguard consisted of 1,000 foot and i,ooo horse, for each of whom he provided a broad ghaju leaf to sweep and obliterate the foot prints of his army on the march, the horsemen tying the leaves to the tails of their horses.

But at the battle of Ilayi the King's army was routed although

he fought with unusual bravery. He lost in this battle, three Gbonkds, leaders of the van. When the first fell, he there and then created another ; he also fell, and he created a third who also fell, but whose fall converted the rout to victory under a peculiar circumstance

As he fell under showers of arrows in a kneeling posture his mouth remained fixed in a state as if grinning; the Baribas observing two white rows of teeth under his helmet thought he was playing them a trick, and that he was laughing at their fruitless attempts to kill him and put his army to flight, not knowing that he was stiff dead and that the Oyos were on the point of retreating. A sort of dread overcame them for a man it was impossible to kill notwithstanding showers of arrows hanging on him ! so they retreated thinking they had lost the day, and the Oyos remaining in the field claimed the victory. Hence it was commonly said of this man " Gbonka Orogbori ti o ft ehin le ogun." (The Gbonka of the ghostly head who routed an army with his teeth).

How long this King reigned is not known but he was the third buried at Igboho.

Asamu was the Basgrun of this reign.

§ 3. AjIBOYEDE

Ajiboyede succeeded to the throne. He was a most successful King but he was a tyrant.

During this reign, the country was invaded by Lajomo, king of the Tapas. The King marched against him ; brave deeds were done on both sides ; at last, however, the Yorubas were routed, and the King would have been slain but for a circumstance which not only saved his life, but also turned the tide of victory in his favour.

When it became apparent that the battle was lost, Ajanlapa the Osi'wefa hastily exchanged dress with the King, and told him to escape for his life. He put on the King's crown and his robes, and the Tapas supposing him to be the King turned their attention chiefly on him, and showered upon him such a number of darts, that in falling his body was propped up by the shafts of the arrows. As the crown fell off his head (like Gbonka Orogbori of the preceding reign) a coward observed his teeth with the face set as if he were grinning ; thinking he was laughing at their futile efforts he concluded at once that they had supernatural beings opposed to them ! He was alarmed, communicated his fears to his comrades, and panic immediately spread throughout the Tapa host ; and before they could be rallied, the stampede had become general, and he pursued now became the pursuers ; the Yorubas returned to

the charge, and the Tapas were completely routed, and put to the sword. Lajomg their King was taken and the victory was complete.

The King was so grateful for his life being saved by the devoted Osi'wefa, that he took counsel of all the Oyo nobles as to what honours he should bestow on Ajanlapa's son. He wished him to be his constant attendant, to be about him night and day, and that he should be free of any part of the palace. But such a post cannot be held by any other than a eunuch and to make him so would seem cruel and ungrateful ; but the Oyos counselled that unless he is so, he cannot enjoy the full liberty desired by the King. A painful necessity that seemed to be, but the King yielded to that advice, and he was emasculated.

This circumstance accounts for the great honours attached to that office to this day, vide p. 59. The Osi'wefa is always the first as well as the last in the King's bed chamber. If the King is ill, he takes his place on state occasions, putting on his robes and the crown ; in war, he often appears as the King's deputy, invested with all the paraphernalia of royalty, including the state umbrellas, the kakaki trumpet, etc. Thus Ajanlapa by sacrificing his life converted what would have been a crushing defeat into a triumphant victory, and so saved his country from humiliation, and purchased royal honours for his family and for his official successors for ever. To mark this victory as well as his long reigp, Ajiboyede celebrated the Bebe festival.

The Bebe is akin to a jubilee or golden age of a king's reign. There have been but few such in the history of the Yorubas. It lasts for 3 years, and during this period liberty of speech and action is granted to everyone, high and low, rich and poor throughout the kingdom, without any fear of being accused of sedition or treason. No riot or fighting is to be heard of anywhere, all provocations must be suppressed while the Bebe lasts, for no one is to be prosecuted during that period. All is peace. The King's Ilaris are rarely seen about on duty at this time, and when met, ne«d not command that worship and deference usually accorded them. No toll or tribute is paid. Everyone appears in his holiday dress. Country folks go to Oyo to enjoy themselves without fear. Festivities mark the occasion. Provincial and feudatory kings and princes, and those of adjacent countries pay visits to Oyo to offer congratulations ; presents are given and received in a lavish manner. The corridors and courtyards of the palace, and all the trees in the King's market used to be decorated with hangings of cloth of various hues, native and foreign make, as with bunting. One deplorable act, however, is a blot on theBeb§

celebration ; it is always accompanied with human sacrifices offered to the memory of all preceding Kings from Oduduwa downwards ; two to each, and their blood mingled with those of animals slaughtered without number is poured out, for the King and his courtiers are required to have a religious dance upon it ; and this part of the ceremony is regarded as the highest act of worship, and of thanksgiving.

The Bebe is sometimes termed the Iht or funeral rites, as if intended to mark the close of a long reign, from the fact that the few Kings who celebrated it died a short time after.

The three years festivities of the Bgbe being over, the Ba§orun celebrates a minor form of festival termed the Owara, and this lasts three months.

A short time after these festivitives were over, the King lost by death his first-born son, Osemolu to his inexpressible grief. All the Oyo nobles who came to sympathize with him were by his orders put to death, alleging that their feigned condolence was but a mock sympathy, for since he was fasting from grief, their

hands smelt of food recently partaken. An insurrection against him was quite ripe when a Moslem priest from the Tapa country called " Baba-kewu " sent his son " Baba-Yigi " to remonstrate with him for his unjust and cruel acts in avenging his son's death on innocent people, when his son had died a natural death. " This," said he, " is a sin against God who took away the life of your son."

The King pondered seriously over this message, and became convinced of his tyranny. He convened an assembly of the Oyo citizens, and publicly asked their pardon for his unjust acts.

He was making preparations for removing the seat of government back to Oyo when he died.

This is the fourth and last King buried at Igboho.

The Ba§grun of this reign was Ibat^.

§ 4. Abipa or " Oba M'oro " (the ghost catcher)

Prince Abipa succeeded to the throne, being the fourth and last King who reigned at Gboho.

His first effort was to carry out the last wishes of his father, viz., to remove the seat of government back to the ancient capital.

The Nobles however, and those born at Gboho were strongly opposed to the removal, but could not prevent or dissuade the King from carrying out his purpose ; they therefore had recourse to a stratagem by which they hoped to thwart his purpose.

When they knew that the King was about to send to inspect the old sites, and to propitiate the gods as a preliminary to re-

occupation, emissaries were secretly despatched by them to precede the King's messengers. The Bagorun sent a hunchback, the Alapini an albino, the Asipa a leper, the Samu a prognathi, the Laguna a dwarf, the Akiniku a cripple. All these emissaries are considered in this country as unnatural beings, suffering the vengeance of the gods, hence they are termed " Eni Orisa " (the belongings of the gods). They are usually kept as priests and priestesses to Obatala and other gods, especially the albinoes, dwarfs, and hunchbacks.

As the King's messengers were about to offer the sacrifices at the place appointed, these counterfeit apparitions who, according to instructions had posted themselves on the hill Ajaka, at the foot of which the palace was built, by a preconcerted plan suddenly began to shout " Ko si aye, ko si aye " (no room, no room).

At night they roamed about the hill, hooting and cooing with lighted torches in hand, and they were taken for the spirits of the hill refusing them readmission to Oyq.

This report was very distressing to the King, and he was at a loss what to do. The Ologbo or Arokin (chief cymbalist) shrewdly suspecting the real facts of the case advised his master to send hunters to investigate the truth of the matter. B6ni, Igi^ubu, Alegbktk, Lgkd, Gbandan^and Olomo were the six famous hunters sent. They armed themselves with weapons and with charms to meet any contingency for self-defence.

When these hunters discovered that they were human beings they came upon them, and one of them took his aim and would have shot one of the deformed beings, had he not cried out and begged for his life. They were all taken alive and brought before the King ; and being questioned they were obliged to betray their masters who were at this time ignorant of what had taken place. The King adopted a most characteristic way of administering to his Nobles a silent rebuke which told.

At the weekly meeting of the King and the noblemen for the Jakuta sacrifices (which occur every 5 days) after the usual proceedings and religious ceremonies of the day were over, and they retired into the banqueting hall for refreshment as was their wont, the King on this occasion sent to each of the noblemen a calabash full of beer by the hands of his own emissary the " apparition " of Oyo ! The Basgrun saw with ineffable surprise his hunchback whom he thought was playing the ghost at distant Oyo emerging from the King's inner apartment with a calabash full of beer for him, the Alapini his albino, and so with all the others, each one being waited upon by his own emissary ! Instantly a deep silence pervaded the room and the rest of the time was passed

in an ominous stillness. The King and his Nobles parted without a word being spoken on the subject. The noblemen, however, showed their resentment by poisoning the Ologbo the King's adviser ; but he, in order to show his love and esteem for the deceased, ordered for him a semi-state funeral, and had his body wrapped in ass's skin to be taken to Oyo for interment.

From this incident. King Abipa was nick-named Oba M'gro (the King who caught ghosts).

Another nickname given to the King that had connection with this event was derived from his head slave Bisa, a Bariba, who was his favourite, and one time had great influence with his master. The King found out that Bisa was an accomplice with the Nobles in thwarting his designs. His Majesty now adopted a characteristic method of administering him a very sharp rebuke which he never forgot.

He one day called Bisa, and told him that the Eleduwe (the king of his native country) was dead, and that the Baribas have sent to him to pay the ransom of Bisa, who has been elected to the vacant throne. "Now Bisa, will you go?" "Yes, your Majesty" replied Bisa, " and your majesty may be sure of this, that when I ascend the throne, the Bariba country to its utmost limits will be free and open to all Yorubas." The King then rejoined " Why do you wish to go to your country and yet you were trying to prevent me going to my birthplace and ancestral home ? Therefore, yoti shall not go." Bisa begged hard, but his master remained resolute, hence he was nicknamed " Ogbolu Akohun, Akohun Bisa jale " Ogbolu the Refuser who totally refused Bisa's entreaties.

From this time Bisa lost all influence with the King. The design of removing the seat of Government to Oyo was now carried out, and Oyo from that time was known as Oyo O^Q ie- Qyq of the ghosts.*

Those famous hunters remained three years with the King in the capital as his guests, until he was perfectly settled. When they were about to return home, the King in order to do them honour, sent a special messenger with them as his representative, and lest this servant of his should prove a source of expense to them, he was allowed the privilege of receiving tolls for his livelihood. He became really the new Governor of the town with the title of Onibode (receiver of customs) . Hence that title is bestowed on the chief ruler of Gboho to this day.

The remaining act of this King was the consolidation of his

^ Oyo is also sometimes called Oyo Egboro from the name of the prince from whom Sango seized it.

kingdom. He buried charms in several places in the city that it might never be destroyed by war.

When his " medicine men " asked for a new born babe to be used as an ingredient in the composition of the charm, it happened that one of his wives had just then been confined ; this being reported to him, he ordered the new born babe to be brought in its blood as it was, and he handed it over to the men to be pulverized and used for their purpose. This act is to this day highly commended by the people, and the King accounted a great public benefactor who so loved his country, that he sacrificed his son for the welfare of his people.

O Yo was never destroyed by war after this event, but all the same, when the hour of retribution came, the blood of the innocents was avenged, for she suffered the fate of all cities destroyed by war. She was deserted, and thus she is in ruins unto this day.

Ibate continued as the Basorun of this reign also.

Chapter IV

A SUCCESSION OF DESPOTIC AND SHORT-LIVED KINGS

§ I. Obalokun Agana Erin

Obalokun succeeded to the throne of his fathers. His mother was the daughter of the Alake, the Primus of the Egba chiefs.

The most memorable event of this reign was the introduction of salt into the Yoruba country. The article hitherto used for it was an insipid rock salt known as Obu. Salt now known as iyo was at first called dun-mdmd.

This King was said to be in friendly relations with the King of France (probably Portugal) with whom he had direct communication. It was said that the King sent 800 messengers with presents to that European sovereign, but that they were never heard of again. Tradition says that the sounds of bells ringing in the skies was plainly heard in the Akesan (King's) market, and it was conjectured that it was the voices of the unfortunates speaking to them from the other world to tell their fate.

What natural phenomenon this may have been due to which was interpreted thus, we do not know, but so it was believed at the time, and similar omens are not unknown to history.

It was said that a white traveller visited Oyo during this reign.

This King placed the first Ajele (political resident) at Ijana near Ilaro, with the title of Onisare. The appointment of an Onisar^ was regularly from Oyo and he must be a Tapk by birth. More of this will be noted hereafter.

He sent an expedition into the Ijesa country which was ambushed and defeated by the tribe known as Ijesa Arera, the Ovos being then unaccustomed to bush fighting. So great was the loss of life in this expedition that the Ologbo was sent out as a town crier to inform the bereaved of their losses in this war.

During this reign Sabigana emigrated from the Sabe to the Yoruba country.

TheBasorun of this reign was Iba Magaji.

§ 2. Ajagbo

Ajagbo who succeeded Obalokun was remarkable for a long reign. He was said to have reigned 140 years and is an exception to the recent rule.

He was born a twin, and so striking was the resemblance

between himself and his brother Ajampati that the one was often mistaken for the other, and very often royal honours were paid to the latter as to his brother.

Ajagbo was also a warlike prince ; several expeditions were sent out by him.

He had a friend at Iwoye called K6koro-gangan whom he made his Kakanfo (vide p. 74). This was the first Kakanfo in the Yoruba country.

It was his custom to send out four expeditions at the same time under four commanders. One under the Basorun, the next under the Agbakin, the third under the Kakanfo, the fourth under the Asipa. Those under this last consisted of the youths of the metropolis.

He destroyed Iweme in the Popo cpuntry. He Olgpa, Onko and his maternal town Ikereku-were an Egba town. The rest of his reign was peaceful.

The Basorun of this reign was Akidain.

§ 3. Odarawu

Odarawu was the successor. His reign was very short. He had a bad temper which was the cause of his being rejected. His short reign became a proverb, and often used to point a moral, and as a warning to succeeding Kings and also to inculcate a lesson of patience and forbearance.

On his accession he was asked according to custom who was his enemy ; he replied Ojo segi, i.e. a town in the kingdom named after the Bale thereof.

The reason he gave for this was that when a private man, he was once insulted by the Bale's wife. The alleged insult was under the following circumstances : —

He was accustomed then to trade in the provinces, and on one occasion he went to the market to buy eko for his dinner, the seller whom he approached happened to be the Bale's wife ; both buyer and seller were ignorant of each other's position. Eko then was sold for one cowry each ; he bought six and paid five cowries as a privilege of his birth. The seller not knowing that he was an Akeyo (prince) and considering herself insulted thereby, in the heat of passion gave him a slap, and called him a thief for the one cowry withheld !

The King's order for the destruction of the town was obeyed, but the Oyo people surmised that this would be a heartless tyrant, who, on account of a single cowry harboured such malice and resentment within him as subsequently to order the destruction of so many lives of his peaceful and loyal subjects. On this

account, having fulfilled his wishes, he was rejected. He, therefore committed suicide.

Akidain survived the late King and was the Basorun of this reign also.

§ 4. Karan

Karan succeeded Odarawu, but he proved to be an unmitigated tyrant. He tortured many of his subjects by ordering them to be scourged front and back until they expired ; so great were his cruelties that his name ha-ˆ "c- i[f] a proverb " as cruel as Karan " and this led to a c,. ˆ . mation of his reign.

He sent out an expedition against Aga Oibo, and there the conspiracy against him was quickly developed.

When the insurrection was ripe for execution, they sent a message home to him craving for his fan, as it has been told them by divination that the town cannot be taken except the King's fan be offered in sacrifice to the gods. This was complied with, and a portion of the sacrificial meat was sent him to partake of.

As soon as he had tasted thereof, it was said to him " The King has eaten his own fan, his word is now of no value, " i.e., his commands have returned to his own mouth. This is a characteristic round about method the' Yorubas have of conveying intimations of what they intend to do. The army is now absolved from a charge of disobedience if they withdraw from the siege for the King has recalled his words ! All those who would stand by him were included in the plot. Iba Biri was elected to be the Basorun in place of Woruda who had succeeded Akidain. The Agbakin's son was chosen to succeed his father, and so on with the other titles. This done, they raised the siege and encamped against the city demanding the King's abdication or death.

The King unwilling to die offered a stout resistance. He was personally courageous and brave, but he had the whole of his army against him. When they entered the city, he held out against them in the palace ; overcome by odds, he shot arrows until his hands were swollen. Dislodged from within the courtyard he climbed to the top of the roof, and there he sat fighting until the palace was set on fire and he perished in the flames.

Thus ended a short and an inglorious reign. He was succeeded by his son, Jayin.

Woruda was the Basorun of this reign.

§ 5. Jayin

Jayin was the son of the late King Karan. He was an effeminate and dissolute prince. He had his harem full of all sorts of characters. His son Olusi was kind and generous ; he was the idol

of the nation, and on him they built their hopes for a better future for the country.

Brought up amidst such demoralizing influences, in an evil hour, he fell under the charms of one of his father's numerous wives and was caught in her embraces. The father already jealous of the son's popularity with the people never forgave this offence. According to one account he summoned the prince before him, and whilst reprimanding him for his conduct, he was for a moment off his guard and thus betrayed himself by letting out the feeling rankling in his breast. " Villain " said he, " the citizens of Oyo prefer you to myself, and you are at one with them against me." Whilst speaking thus to him, he had in hand a club, the top of

which was spiked and tipped with poison ; this he pressed upon his head to the point of bleeding, and the poison proved fatal to

According to another account, it was a poisoned cake made of beans that his father gave him, and of which he partook that caused his death. Anyhow, it was certain that he died of poison by the hand of his father.

He was universally mourned. The Oyo chiefs were detei mined to find out the cause of his death. They had a strong suspicion of foul play and were determined to avenge it.

The King gave it out that his death was due to an accident from the kick of his horse. The secret however, was divulged by one of his wives, and the disappointed citizens became much disaffected towards their King.

The late Olusi had a public funeral, a national mourning was proclaimed, and the public undertook to perform his funeral obsequies. His Egugun was brought out, i.e. an appearance of his apparition clothed with the cloths with which he was known to have been buried.

The Egugun was said to have repaired to the palace, as was usual to pay honours to the chief ruler of the town, and as soon as the King showed his face, he was grasped by it. He was then told to die, having been touched by an Egugun.

3ut according to another and a more probable account, when the King heard that his late son's Egugun in the company of others was coming to the palace, knowing what the most probable outcome of such a visit must be, he hastily took poison and died. And this has passed into proverb " O ku dhde ki a ko iwi wo Akesan, Oba,Jayin te ori gba aso. (At the approach to Akesan of a company of chanting Eguguns, King Jayin buried his head in a shroud.) Used of one who anticipates the inevitable.

It was during this reign that an Ilari " Agbeja-ilfe " was sent

to settle a land dispute between the Aseyin odo, and the Olowu Ipole ; he became the first Awujale of the Ijebus.

Iba Biri was appointed Basorun in place of Woruda deposed.

§ 6. Ayibx

An inter-regnum of some years followed the last reign, the affairs of the kingdom being left in the hands of the Basorun. The heir to the throne was the late King's grandson, the infant son of the lamented Olusi, who was too young to administer the government. The Oyo Mesi elected him in order to do honour to the memory of his deceased father. Ayibi was crowned when he came of age. Unfortunately he proved unworthy of the honour and respect done him ; he greatly disappointed the hopes of the nation. This may have been due to a great defect in his training when a minor, over-indulgence taking the place of strict discipline. He proved to be a tyrant who took delight in shedding blood.

When any suit was brought to court for his decision he often gave judgment by ordering both com.plainant and defendant to be executed. He had no respect for age, or rank, but terribly abused his power.

As an example of his cruelty and arbitrariness, the following story was told of him : —

He was one day in his bath, being attended by one of his favourite wives ; and she, in a moment of self-forgetfulness (or rather of amorous regard) said jocularly to him, " And this is all of the man so much dreaded by all ! " He took offence at this remark, but disguised his displeasure by a smile, but inwardly he was determined to convince her practically of the power which made him an object of dread to all.

After leaving his bathroom, he gave an order to a Tetu (executioner) privately to fetch the heads of the wife's father and mother each in a calabash, and decently covered up. This order was promptly executed The wife had by this time forgotten her remarks in the bathroom, as she had no reason to be apprehensive of any evil consequences arising therefrom. The calabashes being brought and set before him, he sent for her from her apartment, and asked her to uncover those , calabashes and tell the contents of them ! " Do you know them ? " asked he, " Yes I do," she replied trembling. " Then," rejoined he " that is the secret why I am so much dreaded by all, although to you I seem but commonplace and ordinary." She fully expected her

own execution to follow, but he was satisfied with the pain and misery into which he had thrown her, and he graciously pardoned (sic) her.

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For this and similar acts of cruelty, an insurrection was stirred up against him by all the people, and being rejected he committed suicide.

Oluaja, and after him Yabi were the Basoruns of this reign.

The reason why these Kings after rejection invariably committed suicide is this. The person of a King is regarded as sacred. Kings are venerated as gods, indeed many of them have been actually deified ; but the moment a king's enormities provoke an open rebuke, or on being told publicly " We reject you," by the constitution of the country he must die that day. He cannot from the sanctity with which he has been regarded abdicate and continue to live as a private individual, or Continue to reign by sufferance, by the clemency of aggrieved subjects. Hence he must die ; and by his own hands, for it is an unthinkable horror among the Yorubas for any man to lay hands upon a being regarded as sacred. It is the prerogative of the Basorun to utter the sentence of rejection when the people are determined on it.

Ev^en Noblemen also from their exalted positions are never ordered to execution. " The King rejects you. The ancient Kings Oduduwa, Orafiyan, Aganju, and others, reject you." He must then take poison and die. Such deaths are accounted honourable, public and decent funerals are accorded them.

If any one allows himself to be executed his carcase will be treated like that of a common felon, and his house pulled down. Therefore a faint-hearted individual would be despatched by his nearest relatives to save themselves from indelible disgrace. An honourable burial will then be. accorded to the illustrious dead.

§ 7. OSINYAGO

Osinyago who succeeded to the throne was equally worthless. He was an avaricious man who by exactions, massacre, and confiscations amassed wealth which he did not live long to enjoj'.

His firstborn son, like his father, was of a grasping propensity, which led to his early death. The second child Omgsun, although a female, was of a masculine character, and she considered the rank and privileges of the Aremo (Crown Prince) her own ; but the King adopted a cousin Woruale (contracted to Wurale or Irale) son of Gbagba, a physician, his maternal uncle, as the Aremo, and this Omosun resented.

It happened that a dispute arose between these two as to the right of appointing a new Aseyin at the death of the then king of Iseyin, and Omosun from wounded pride that she was opposed by a commoner, in the heat of passion slew Irale ! H

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Irale's father Gbagba the physician was determined to avenge the death of his son, and this he did by poison said to have been extracted from one cowry worth of shea butter, 200 grains of beniseed, and other ingredients by which he effected the deaths of the King, Omosun, Apala the Basorun, and other notabilities of Oyo who were concerned with the misgovernment that was going on.

He was said to have escaped to his own country by means of charms. One report says, he flew away like a bird, and was found at Ede ; another says he died and was buried, but his corpse became a red monkey which escaped into the bush. What was more probable was, that from the dread he inspired by his powers, he had an opportunity of escape, and was not slow to make use of it. The country was bereft of King and Basorun simultaneously.

The Basorun of this reign was Apalk.

§ 8. OjiGi

Ojigi who was elected to the vacant throne, was a powerful and warlike King. He extended his conquests to the Dahomian territory. In three expeditions headed by the Basorun and the Gbonka Latoy6, the Dahomians were brought fully under subjection.

Yansumi an Idahomian town was taken and destroyed. He sent an expedition also against the Igbdnas.

This King in order to show his undisputed sovereignty over the whole of the Yoruba country, including Benin, sent out a large expedition which struck the Niger in the north, near the Ibaribas, and coasted along the right bank until they arrived at the coast and returned to Oyo by the Popo country. Great exploits were reported of the leaders.

Personally, he was a very good man, but a too indulgent father. The Aremo by his cruelties and excesses brought about the father's rejection and death. He ordered Oluke the Basoran's son to be unlawfully beaten. As this wrong could not be avenged without serious consequences, and as the King did not punish the wrong doer, it was thought more expeditious to effect the King's death ; for about this time the custom began to prevail for the Aremios to die with the father, as they enjoy unrestrained liberty with the father. A pretext was soon found for rejecting the King and fond father, and consequently he died, and his eldest son with

One of the most famous men in Yoruba history Yamba was the Basorun of this reign.

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§ 9. Gberu

Prince Gberu who now succeeded to the throne was a wicked and superstitious King, much given to making charms. Before his accession to the throne he had a friend called Jambu whom he afterwards raised to the high rank of Basgrun. But it was not long before these former friends became disaffected towards each other. Both of them were one day sitting under a large Ose tree (the Adamsonia digitata) at Oyo. TheBasorun remarked on the magnificence of the tree which " bade fair to last for ever." The King made no reply, but afterwards poisoned the tree in order to cast the suspicion on the Basorun who had made remarks on it ; and before the next morning it had withered.

Oyo we may remark is situated in a vast plain where trees are rarely seen. This was one of the few that grew there and it was much thought of, and was highly prized for* its magnificence when in full bloom.

This circumstance caused a great sensation in the city among all who saw the tree flourishing in all its glory only the day before ! Enquiries as to the cause were keen and close ; it was at first thought this deed was done by the Basorun in order to frame an accusation against the King as both were seeking each other's life ; but the author of the deed was soon known.

The chiefs of the town now grew suspicious and apprehensive of their own safety should the King add the use of secret poison to his unlimited regal power. They soon found a pretext for rejecting him, and he had to put an end to his own life. His quondam friend Jambu the Basorun who divulged the secret was not spared either, he soon shared the fate of his friend and sovereign.

Gberu's reign was short and inglorious. He was succeeded by Amuniwaiye.

Jambu was the Basgrun of this reign.

§ 10. Amuniwaiye

Prince Amuniwaiye who now ascended the throne promised well at first, by his clemency and grace; but subsequently his low morals rendered him weak and despicable, and, as such, a disgrace to his high office.

He had for mistress the wife of his principal " medicine man " Olukoyisi, with whom he became acquainted under the following circumstances : —

The King engaged this " medicine man" to help him against the friends of Jambu the powerful Basgrun who effected the death

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of the former King. Being afraid that if his services to the King were known, his own life would be in danger, he worked warily by sending his wife Ololo with the pots instead of going himself personally. In this way the King had the opportunity of coming into contact with her, which he disgracefully abused, and the husband got to know it.

He could not bring an open charge against the King nor had he any other means of obtaining redress but by secret revenge, and this he effected terribly !

Olukoyisi prepared certain ingredients from the root of the Opgki tree which he applied to his wife unsuspected ; it was a fatal " tell-tale," for when next she was being indulged in the royal embraces, the pair of them got so inextricably adhered together, that it became necessary to resort to a surgical operation in order to separate them ! Thus both of them died in the act. Thus ended this inglorious reign.

The Basgrun of this reign was Kogb6n son of the late Jambu.

§ II. Onisile

Onisile who now ascended the throne was quite a different man from the former occupant. He was a great warrior, and for his exploits was nicknamed " Gbagida ! Wowo I'ˆwon ab'esiri fo odi " (Gbagida [an expression of admiration] a man with clanging chains [for prisoners] whose horse can leap over a town wall.)

He was remarkable for his indomitable courage and lionhearted spirit. He was moreover very artistic, and was said to have made seven silver doors to the seven entrances of his sleeping apartment.

During this reign the Sekere (calabash) drum was ornamented, not only with cowries, but also with costly beads e.g. lyiin (corals) Okun (stone beads, Benin) Erinla (striped yellow pipe beads) and Segi (blue pipe beads), strung with silk thread dyed red ; all of native manufacture.

His rashness and fearlessness was the ultimate cause of his death. He was cautioned against experim.enting with the "sun leaf" a plant known to possess electrical properties, by which lightning can be attracted ; but he was not the man to heed any such remonstrance. The consequence was that the Sango worshippers managed to attract lightning on the palace, the King was struck, and from the shock he became paralysed. Thus he was incapacitated from performing the duties of his office.

The chiefs of Oyo then assembled and waited on him, and told him that as he had challenged Sango to a single combat and had

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been worsted, he could no longer continue to live. Thus he was rejected, and he had to die.

The feeling had gained ground by this time that Kings should not be allowed to die a natural death. Unchecked despotism, unrestrained licence, insatiable greed, and wanton voluptuousness should not be allowed to flourish throughout the full term of a natural lifetime. The excesses of the Crown Prince also were unendurable hence the earliest opportunity was usually sought, for putting an end to their reign.

His Basorun's name was Soyiki alias £)sij6gb6.

Chapter V

BASORUN GAHA AND HIS ATROCITIES, HIS FALL, AND ABIODUN'S PEACEFUL REIGN

§ I. Labisi

This unfortunate Prince was nominated to the vacant throne, but was never crowned. Only 17 days after he commenced the preliminary ceremonies, the new Basorun Gaha rose to power, and commenced those series of atrocities which made him notorious in Yoruba history.

Olubg and Ajibadu the King-elect's friends were sum.marily put to death, and he, having no supporters was not even allowed to enter the palace, much less to sit on the throne. He had to put an end to his own life.

Gaha had great influence with the people, and a great many followers who considered themselves safe under his protection, from the dread in which they stood of the Kings, because of their cruel and despotic rule.

Gahk was also famous for his " charms ; " he was credited with the power of being able to convert himself into a leopard or an elephant, and on this account was much feared. He lived to a good old age, and wielded his power miercilessly. He was noted for having raised five Kings to the throne, of whom he murdered four, and was himself murdered by the fifth.

§ 2. AwoNBioju alius Ouuboye

Gaha the Basorun had by this time attained to great power and influence. He made himself the King maker and King destroyer. He did not aspire to the throne, for that was impossible of attainment, but he demanded the homage of all the Kings he raised to the throne. He raised Awonbioju into the place of Labisi. His reign was very short, having wielded the sceptre for only 130 days. He was murdered by the all-powerful Basorun for nobly refusing to prostrate before him, his own Chancellor.

§ 3. Agboluaje

Agboluaje who succeeded the late King on the throne was a very handsome and prepossessing Prince, and as he submitted to the powerful Basorun, he was allowed to reign for a longer period than the two preceding Kings. He was not as ambitious

as some of his predecessors, he had no wars, the kingdom had extended to its utmost limits, bounded by the river Niger on the north and a portion of the Tapa and Bariba countries, on the East by the lower Niger, on the South by the seacoast, and on the West it includes the Popos and Dahomey. From all the provinces included within these boundaries, and by some including the Gas and Ashanti, tributes were paid to Oyq. Tranquility prevailed all over the land.

The King thought this a fitting opportunity for celebrating the Beb§, not so much for the length of his reign, but for the peace and prosperity that prevailed all over the Kingdom.

During the three years celebration, visitors from all parts thronged Ovg as was usual, but the most distinguished guest was the Elewi-odo, a Popo king, who visited Oyq in state and had a reception befitting his rank. He was a particular friend of the Alafik's, and usually supplied him. with cloths and other articles of European manufacture, being nearer the coast and having dealings with European traders of those days.

As on such occasions everybody visited Oyo in his best holidaj' dress, so the Elewi-odo who was accounted proverbially rich appeared at this time. On public occasions the Elewi-odo sat on a throne opposite the King ; as often as the King changed his robes, he changed his covering cloth to one of the same material ; when the King puts on a robe of silk or velvet, he covers with a cloth of the same material. Both Kings were an object of interest and admiration by the 1060 vassal kings and chiefs of Yoruba, with the populace who were present on that occasion.

But the citizens of Oyo grew jealous for the honour and glory of their King and wished him to appear superior to the Elewi-odo by robing himself with something the like of which even the Elewi had not ; but they found that he had nothing the like of which his friend had not ; so they had recourse to a device. The manufacturers were summoned and the case put before them, and they promised to rise to the occasion. A simple gown was thereupon woven, of common stuff indeed, but embossed all over with the silken wool of the large cotton tree ; seen at a distance the nature of the cloth cculd not be made out by the crowd ; when the sun shone upon it, it reflected a silken hue to the admiration of all ; when the breeze blew, detached flosses of silk floated all around his majesty. Even the Elewi-odo and the provincial kings could not help admiring the curious robe which they took for something so superior, that none but the great Ai.afin of Oyo alone possessed ! The crowd went into ecstatic frenzy about it, and shouted an applause.

But the conduct of the Elewi on this occasion offended the Basorun because he vied with his sovereign. Therefore, after his return home at the expiration of the Bebe and the Basorun had celebrated his Owara as usual, he denounced the Elewi before His Majesty in the severest terms : that he came, not to honour the King but to disgrace him, to show off his wealth to the King's disadvantage, and, therefore, he was determined to punish him for his conduct.

The King pleaded hard for his friend but in vain. " Every one " said he, " is allowed by custom to appear at Oyo during Bebe in his best, how much more should a king do so ? His action in this matter is pardonable, and therefore, should be overlooked." But Gaha was inexorable, and war was declared.

The Elewi having been privately forewarned, attempted no resistance, but sent a private message to the King not to be anxious on his account, and that his safety was assured. He speedily crossed the Esuogbo river and escaped to the Tapa country.

Unfortunately the private messenger arrived af Oyo too late to meet the King alive. Unwilling that the head of his friend the Elewi should be brought in triumph to him at Oyo, he took poison and died before the return home of the expedition His brother Majeogbe was placed on the throne by the all-powerful Basorun Gaha.

§ 4. Majeogbe

Majeogbe did not fare any better than his immediate predecessors. His first care was to find means of checking the ambition of the Basorun. He could not order his execution, and the Basorun was too much on the alert to be taken off by poison ; but he set about making charms offensive and defensive in order to rid himself of this terror.

Gaha had by this time attained the zenith of his glory ; his sons were scattered all over the length and breadth of the kingdom, they resided in the principal towns and all the tributes of those towns and their suburbs were paid to them. No tribute was now paid to the AlAfin ; Gaha's sons were as ambitious and as cruel as their father.

Several anecdotes illustrating their wanton cruelties were told of them, e.g. :

One of them once engaged a carrier to whom he gave a load too heavy for him to carry, but he dared not refuse to do so. He walked behind the man amusing himself with the sight of the man's sufferings from the weight of the load. He remarked in jest that the man's neck had become so thick that he doubted whether a

sword could cut through. He suited his action to his words, drew his sword, and actually tried it ! The man was decapitated, and his body was left wallowing in his blood, and another man was compelled to take up the load.

Another of his sons was said to have shot a farmer dead, whilst engaged in making heaps for planting yam, wantonly charging him with disfiguring the King's ground by making horns on it !

Another similarly shot a farmer dead whilst hoeing the ground, pretending that he mistook him for an ape on all fours !

Thus Gaha and his sons usurped all power of the government the King himself living in dread of his own fate at the pleasure of the notorious regicide.

The King's own " medicine men " were not idle either. A lighted lamp was said to have been placed in one of his inner apartments which was kept burning for three years untrimmed, and while it was burning there can be no peace to the regicide.

A horse was said to be in one of the stables and was heard neighing every day, and yet was kept there 3 years without fodder !

The AlafIxN's death was brought about by one of his sons quarrelling in theBasorun's quarter of the town ; this act Gahk resented as a daring affront which the father's life must atone for, the son being too insignificant for him to take any notice of. But the AlAfin had succeeded by this time in poisoning the Basorun that he became paralysed in both his legs. On the other hand the nature of the charms in the King's apartment had been made known to Gaha, who now bent all his energies to extinguish the everburning lamp. Its effect was so great that all who approached that apartment instantly dropped down dead. All the " medicinemen " in the kingdom were summoned by Gahk but none succeeded, and it cost many their lives. At last an Agberi man appeared, who sacrificed the life of his slave in order to gain the honour, nor did he survive it himself. In this service the Agberi tribes gained the pre-eminence over others of the same craft, and became friends of the Basorun. And thus the King died.

But from this time the power of Gahk began to decline, old age set in, and impaired his strength of body and mind. His wives began to desert his harem, but some faithful domestics stood by him and they concealed from the general public the fact of his being lame. The door opening to the audience chamber was always kept shut whilst the King and the other noblemen were in waiting every morning to pay their respects to him. The opening and closing of the doors of the inner apartments announce the approach of his supernal highness. He crawled on all fours, and was usually

seated before the door of the audience chamber was sUd back, so that he was never seen on the move ; but in order to inspire dread, his drummer used to beat " Iba kanbo, irin ija ni nrin." His Highness comes majestic, striding as one spoiling for a fight.

§ 5. Abiodun alias Adegolu

Abiodun, whose peaceful reign has passed into a proverb was described as a tall and slender prince, of a very dark complexion, a comely person, of dignified manners, and altogether fit to wear a crown. He also was raised to the throne by the order and influence of the Basorun.

The young King was wise and prudent, and at first made no attempt at any opposition to the powerful Basorun. He went regularly every morning to pay him his respects, and invariably, received his presents of 10 heads of cowiies (which as a matter of fact, never exceeded 6 heads, not with the knowledge of the Basorun however, but by the action of the attendants).

This state of things continued for many j^ears so much so that even the Basorun himself was becoming tired of this abject submission, and wanted but a decent pretext for which he might kill him, just for a change ! This man of blood was often heard to say " Who taught this King to be so wise ? These daily presents are getting to be too heavy a charge on my exchequer now." All power was in his hands and so were the responsibilities. His lust for power drained his exchequer, for his sons lording it all over the country deprived him of the revenues which might have come to him.

That he was in great straits for money seemed evident from the fact that he requested his " medicine men " to make him charms to get him plenty of cowries. " Of all that constitutes v/ealth or power," said he, " I have, save money (cowries) enough to support my position."

One of his " medicine men " assured him that he can make him a soap to wash with, and before sunset, his wish will be realized. He made the soap, and His Supernal Highness used it according to directions, and strange to say, it took effect, but in a way no one anticipated. Whatever the cause was due to, nobody knew, but fire broke out in the Basorun's house that afternoon, and all efforts to extinguish it failed, and so the palace was burnt to the ground. Owing to His Highness' influence and power, and the dread all had of him, every rank and station, from the AlAfin downwaids now vied to be the foremost in contributing to repair his losses, 10, 15, 20 bags of cowries came in from all quarters.

The heads of the different wards of the city, the Modade, Molkbi, Nsise-og\in, Ntetu, T'onse-Awo, Aremu, Ita-Ologbo, Ajofk, and the Ogede quarters, all brought presents in cowries.

Then the provincial kings and chiefs from the Onikoyi downwards brought building materials, and also their own contributions in cowries, which greatly augmented his store. The Basgrun then asked the " medicine mam " " Is this the way you promised to get me cowries ? " He replied, " Yes, your Highness ; by what other means could you have amassed such an abundance in so short a time ? "

But the Basorun was still thirsting for the blood of the AlAfin, and he was never so wise in his dealings with him, till at length, King Abiodun took a bold step, upon which he had devoted no little consideration. Having given orders to his courtiers and his wives privately to report to the Basorun that he was suffering from indisposition he left Oyo privately in the night for a town called Akala to his namesake Adegolu the powerful chief of that place. Being in disguise, he was not recognised by the Bale's wife, who told him her husband had gone to his farm. The feigned poor stranger asked the lady kindly to fetch him home in

haste, as he had an important message for him. The kind hostess did so, and Chief Adegolu came home immediately, wondering what the message could be.

" Who are you ? Where from ? And what is your message ? " \eie the eager questions the Bale put to the sti anger. " I want a private interview " was the reply. Both of them retired to a convenient place, and the Bale was startled, and was scarcely himself when he heard from this humble stranger " I am your namesake Adegolu the AlAfin of Qyo." It was with some difficulty he could restrain the Bale from doing homage there and then with earth on his head, etc. " No, no," said the King, " another time will do for that. I am come to confer with you upon the present crisis, how to rid the throne of Oyo of the great usurper, the King maker and King destroyer. You know very well, that in all the 6,600 towns and villages of the Yoruba kingdom, Gaha and his sons have the dominant rule."

After conference. Chief Adegolu went with the stranger to rhe powerful Kakanfo (Field Marshal) Oyabi at Ajase ; here the plot was matared, of a strong and secret combination against the Basgrun and his sons. This was communicated by swift posts to all the principal kings and chiefs in the country, and it was arranged that on a fixed day, they should all rise and destroy all Gahci's children.

The arrangement being complete King Adegolu returned home

as he came out ; and next morning paid his respects to the Basorun as before.

At the day appointed, the whole country rose up against Gahk's children, and butchered them to pieces ; and in order to exterminate the seed in toto, those of their wives who were enceinte were ripped open, and the embryo chopped in pieces !

The whole army of the country headed by Oyabi, and Adegolu now marched for Oyo according to the secret arrangement, and the Oyo chiefs with the AlAfin opened the gates to them.

Gahk's people single-handed were preparing to resist, but it was evident that his time was come and nothing could stop the inevitable and fatal end. Gahk summoned his relatives together, and handed to them a bundle of here grass, well tied, and asked them to break it ; when all had tried and failed, he had it loosed, handing round a few blades to each ; that was easily crunched ; then said he to them " Combined we shall stand, but if disunited we shall be broken to pieces like the blades of ber^ in your hands." But his brother Olubii who might have offered the stoutest resistance, had been won over by the Oyo chiefs, who promised him his brother's title when all shall have been over ; but this turned out to be a ruse, devised to weaken theBasorun's resistance, for Olubu never escaped the fate of all Gahk's people, but was butchered in the general massacre of the great man's adherents and relatives. To the last, Olaotan, Gahi's eldest son, stood by his father. The troops from the country poured in from all quarters and were joined by those of the city, all equally tired of the iron rule of Gahk and of the enormities being perpetrated by his children. His palace was surrounded, and attempts were made to beat down the walls thereof ; but they were heroically defended by his trusty domestics, and the few faithful adherents.

Gahk in vain tried to transform himself into an elephant as of yore. He ordered four mortars to be placed in position for the fore and hind legs, and two pestles for the tusks ; old and feeble and lame, he could not even help himself up the mortars, and when helped to them, his trembling limbs could not support his body weight : his incantations proved a failure. At the sight of this failure Olaotan groaned with disappointment and said, " Father, have I not always said it were better you should secure a charm for ensuring perpetual youth ? It was because I was strongly convinced that these charms will be of Uttle avail to you, when old age has set in."

From the walls and from the roofs of his palace, the Basgrun's men kept the army of the Kakanfo at bay. A sharp shooter in particular did havoc amongst them ; but a certain young man.

bold and astute, observing this, ran close to the wall at some distance from the spot where he was, and walked along so close under it right on to the spot, that he was not seen from above or within, and as soon as the marksman put his head out again for another shot, he grasped and dragged him down, and immediately

the men rushed forward and beat down the wall. The house was immediately fired, and all the domestics found within were put to the sword. The Basorun and Gbagi a faithful and favourite Ilari were taken aUve and brought before the King. He was soon on his chair of state with all insignia of royalty in full display about him, and the fallen minister made to prostrate at a distance before him, under a hot burning sun. The old man pleaded for his life, and even asked to be degraded and made the keeper of His Majesty's poultry yard, but it was felt that no quarters could be granted to him now. Being bulky in size, the ground under him where he lay prostrate under the mid-day sun became saturated with the profuse perspiration oozing from him. He neither deserved nor- received pity of any one. There were great rejoicings in the city and in the King's palace, and especially among the King's wives.

So great were the indignities and contempt this fallen minister was subjected to, that even children could approach him now and pull at a pedunculated tumour in his forehead, hanging down his face, which the fear and dread of him did not allow people to notice before, for who could approach so near as to gaze on him ? But the fate awaiting him was of greater concern to him now, than to take notice of these trifling jests.

By the order of the AlAfin, the posts of his house and everything that could be used as firewood, which had escaped the burning, were brought together and piled as a stake ; pots of palm oil, nut oil, and shea butter were poured on it, and set ahght ; he was then approached by a menial saying in mockery " Master, the fire is alight, will you not warm yourself a bit in such a weather as this ? " Then he was lifted up to the top of the stake and made secure, together with Gbagi, his faithful Ilari.

His fate has been a lesson to all usurpers and abusers of power. It has passed into a proverb " Bi o I'aiya Osika, bi o ri iku Gahk, 0 yio so otitg. If you have the heart of a cruel man, take note of Gaha's death and be true."

A one day bebe i.e. a public holiday with the freedom of a Bebe (vide p. 163) was proclaimed, after which Qyabi the Kakanfo returned home with the thanks and good wishes of the King and nation.

Abiodun now commenced the work of reformation beginning

from the capital. In order to make himself secure on the throne, he suppressed or executed all those known or suspected to have been Gahk's friends secretly, and who might raise an insurrection against him, for Gaha was not without friends even among the chiefs, such as the Esiele, the Sakin, and the Sahadow^.

From this time commenced that period of peace and prosperity for which King Abiod UN's reign was famous. Tributes poured into Oyo from the remote states and from Dahomey, agriculture and commerce flourished, and the people to the remotest part of the kingdom were so far happy and contented.

The Kakanfo Qyabi did not live long to enjoy the peace he was so instrumental in effecting ; two years later, the AlAfin invited him to Oyo in order to bestow on him special honours, and marks of favour in recognition of his services to King and country, but unfortunately, his health was in a precarious condition, and in obeying the commands of his sovereign, he died on his way to Oyo.

§ 6. Abiodun's Peaceful Reign

King Abiod UN had a long and prosperous reign. He was said to have been the father of 660 children ! The firstborn Agunpopo was said to have been the issue of an ilUcit intercourse with one of his father's wives, during the father's lifetime : hence the Oyo citizens refused to have him as the Argmg (Crown Prince). Ige Gbengberu his legitimate firstborn was accepted for that title, but he \yas of a delicate constitution, and died prematurely ; the office of Aremo now devolved upon the next prince Adesina.

Wlien Abiod UN was fully established on the throne he found out that a Mohammedan had hidden one of Gahk's childien for about 40 years^ ! The King not only graciously spared the young man, but also amply rewarded his preserver for his generous act, and confirmed his goodwill by giving one of his daughters to the Moslem for wife ; " for surely," said the King, " you would have done the same for myself also."

Towards the latter part of the King's reign, certain of the Popo tribes had a quarrel among themselves, and two of their kings came to Oyo with a large retinue of about 4,000 people for an appeal. They were detained

for 3 years without their case being heard, and in the end they were informed that they were no more to return to their own country, but kept as the

ˆ The Yorubas always exaggerate their time period by a bad method of calculation. If, for instance, a child is born 5 days before the new moon appears, he is then 2 months old, and at the next new moon he is 3 months, when in reaUty he is only a month and some days. So also is the calculation for years.

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King's body guard under the command of his son Agunpopo whom the Oyo citizens insisted upon reckoning among his brotherstheOlusami, Atingisi.andlyajinforthereasonstated above.

One act of revenge marred this distinguished sovereign's reputation. Long before his accession, he was a trader in potash. He once had a quarrel at Ijaye with the Bale's son but the Bale, out of deference to his high birth interposed and sharply reprimanded his son. Upon his accession he avenged the alleged insult by ordering the destruction of the town. Ijaye was then an Egba town.

This fact is noted because this was the first time Ijaye was taken, a town which was destined hereafter to play a notable part in Yoruba history. His other wars were against the Popos every other year. They were completely subdued.

The Crown Prince Adesina turned out to be a very vain and extravagant young man, weak in character, yielding to flattery. E.g., it was said that some of his followers used to say to him " Prince, you can give me lo heads of cowries now (equivalent to ;£io in those days), if only you wish ; why, you have only to say the word and it would be done ; come now, why be reluctant about it ? It is only to speak, etc." The Prince would yield, and order the money to be given.

King Abiodun attained to a good old age, full of honours, having subdued all his enemies. The Aremo had hoped to succeed his father. Not satisfied with the high honour and unrestricted liberty he was enjoying, he was too eager to occupy the throne, and so he hastened his father's death by poison.

The end of this reign marked an important epoch in Yoruba history. With the death of Abiodun ended the universal and despotic rule of the Alafins of Oyo in the Yoruba country. He was the last of the Kings that held the different parts of the Kingdom together in one universal sway and with him ended the tranquility and prosperity of the Yoruba country. The revolution ensued, and the tribal independence, with the loss to Yoruba of the Tapa and Bariba, and Dahomey provinces, and the Popos later on, which has continued to our own day. In a word, with Abiodun ended the unity of the Yoruba kingdom.

Kangidi succeeded Gahk as the Basorun of this reign.

THE THIRD PERIOD. In which revolutionary wars devastated the whole of Yorubaland, ending in the Fulani usurpation and tribal independence. It embraced a period of the reigns of five Kings, from the accession of Aole to the death of Oluewu, the last of the Kings, who reigned at the ancient Oyo.

Chapter VI. THE REVOLUTION

§ I. AOLE SURNAMED AROGANGAN

None of Abiodun's numerous children succeeded him on the throne. Aolˆ, a tall and handsome . Prince, a cousin of the late King was elected in his stead. But unfortunately, his reign was a very unhappy one ; it marked the commencement of the decline of the nation until it terminated in the tragic, end of the fifth King after him. The cup of iniquity of the nation was full ; cruelty, usurpation, and treachery were rife, especially in the capital ; and the provinces were groaning under the yoke of oppression. Confiscation and slavery for the slightest offence became matters of daily occurrence, and the tyranny, exactions, and lawlessness of the Princes and other members of the royal family, were simply insupportable. Oaths were no more taken in the name of the gods, who were now considered too lenient and indifferent ; but rather in the name of the King who was more dreaded. " Idk Oba ni yio je mi " (may the King's sword destroy me) was the new form of oath ! Aole was unfoitunately saddled with the ill fate of the nation, as the following ditty commonly sung would show : —

" Laiye Abiodun I'afi igba won 'wo Laiye Aolˆ I'adi adikalˆ."

(In Abiodun's reign money we weighed by bushels. [Lit. with calabashes.] In Aole's reign, we packed up to flee).

But there was nothing more in his actions than in those of his predecessors to warrant this saying, on the contrary, he was probably too weak and mild for the times. The nation was ripe for judgment, and the impending wrath of God was about to fall upon it ; hence trouble from every quarter, one after another.

On the King's accession, according to custom when the time came for him to send out his first expedition, he was asked who was his enemy, that they should fight him. He named the Bale of Apomu, and hence Apomu was doomed.

The alleged cause of offence will clearly show how much of corruption there was at the fountain head in those days.

Apomu was the market town where Oygs, Ifes, Owus, and Ijgbus met for trade. It was situated in Ife territory, and m the

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border of the Olowu's dominion. Raiding and man-stealing were rife at those times. Oyos particularly were in greater danger, as they came from afar. During the last reign several Oyos were stolen and sold here, and hence King Abiqdun sent orders to both the Olowu and the Owoni of Ife to keep a strict watch and prevent the recurrence of these practices. The Owoni and the Olowu in turn sent strict orders to the Bale of Apomu to be on the watch, and arrest any offender.

Aole who was then a private man used to trade in these parts with a friend who was also his attendant ; and on one occasion, he bartered away his friend for merchandise ! So faithless and heartless were the princes in those days. The Ijebus were actually taking him away when it was reported to the Bale of Apomu that an Oyg man was being sold away. Fortunately for the man by the prompt action of the Bale he was rescued at a certain spot named Apata Odaju (the rock of the heartless), perhaps so named from this circumstance, and brought before the Bale. Investigation soon showed who the slave-dealer was ; but as Aol^ was an Akeyo (Prince) and could not more severely be dealt with, in order that justice may not miscarry, he was ordered by the Bale to be severely flogged. This was the reason why Aole now named the Bale of Apomu as his enemy.

When the Bale of Apomu heard that war was declared against his town on his account he took refuge in the court of the Ow5ni of Ife his over-lord, and whose orders he had obeyed. But as the offence was against the Suzerain, even the Ow6ni could not save him ; so this faithful chief, in order to save his town and his people from destruction, committed suicide, and his head was cut off and sent to Oyo to appease the offended monarch !

But an expedition must in any case be sent out, the King was, therefore, approached again and asked to name his enemy. But he replied, " My enemy is too formidable for me." Being pressed, he named the powerful chief Afonja the Kakanfo residing at Ilorin with great reluctance, as he foresaw evil ahead.

§ 2. The King's Enemies

After the death of the Kakanfo Oyabi, Afonja of Ilorin demanded the title ; but as a Prince (through the mother) the title was below his rank, for the Kakanfo ranks after the Basorun, but being the highest mihtary title, it suited his restless nature best, and so he obtained it, almost by force.

But King Aole was unwilhng to initiate any civil war, and refused to take any action against Afonja after he had granted him the title.

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Hitherto, Afgnja alone was his enemy, the other chiefs were as yet loyal to him, but circumstances occurred, one after the other which created a disaffection between him and theBasorun and the other chiefs, fanning into a flame the destructive fire already smouldering in its embers.

The cause of quarrel between the King and Asamu theBasorun was this : —

One Alaja-eta a Hausa trader at Oyo was plundered of his goods, under the pretext that he was bringing bad charms into the city. Among his confiscated goods was his Koran which he prized more than all his other stolen property. He appealed to the King, and he, from a sense of justice ordered that all his goods be restored to him. All but the Koran were accordingly restored. The Hausa again appealed to the King for this his most valued treasure ; the King insisted that search should be made and the lost Koran be restored.

The Basorun in whose possession it probably was, or who at any rate knew where it could be found, refused to restore it and told the King it could not be found ! His Majesty felt this keenly as an insult to his dignity ; he was heard to say " Is it come to this that my commands cannot be obeyed in my own capital ? Must it be said that I failed to redress the grievance of a stranger in my town ? That he appealed to me in vain ? " Turning to the Basorun and pointing upwards he said, " Very well then, if you cannot find it my father (meaning the deified Sango) will find the Koran for me."

As the god Sango is reputed to take vengeance on thieves and liars by burning their houses, so the next day, when lightning struck the Basgrun's house, great was his rage against the King for being instrumental in convicting him of theft and lying !

The ceremony of appeasing the god by the devotees, entailed heavy expenses on the Basgrun who, had it been another man's house might have gone shares with the Alafin in the fines imposed upon the sufferers. He knew where the trouble came from, for he noted the King's words " My father will find it for me." In this way be became the King's enemy.

Another circumstance occurred which added the Ow6ta one of the 5sgs to the list of the King's enemies.

One Jankalawa who had offended the late King and who had escaped to the Bariba country when he sought to kill him, now returned after the King's death and was flaunting about the streets of OYg under the protection of Lafianu the Owota. The late King's wives were angry at this and complained to Aole against Jankalawa. Said they " You have inherited our late husband's

wives, his treasures, slaves and his throne. Why nut make his cause your cause and his enemies yours as well ? Why do you allow this Jankalawa to stalk so defiantly about the streets of Qyo?"

By thus appealing to him from day to day, he yielded to their entreaties and remonstrances, and ordered the arrest and subsequent execution of Jankalawa.

The Owota's pride was wounded, because he was not respected by the King, in that one known to be under his protection should be so summarily dealt with. Thus the Bagorun and the Kakanfo found an accomplice in the powerful Owota. A conspiracy was formed but not being ripe for execution, they awaited a favourable opportunity.

At length the time arrived when an expedition must be sent out, and the King was again asked "Who is your Majest3''s enemy?" He replied, " I have told you that my enemy is too formidable for me, and besides we are the same kith and kin." However, he advised that as the last campaign ended at Gbeji, the war should be prosecuted from that place.

But in order to gain their object in view, viz., the removal of the Kakanfo, the King's counsellors advised that the Kakanfo and the army should be sent against Iwere, a place fortified by nature and by art, and impregnable to the simple weapons of those days, and as the Kakanfo by the oaths of his office must either conquer within three months or die, and Iwere is impregnable, he will have no other alternative, but as in honour bound to make away with himself.

It was, however, arranged that he should not be foiewamed, but decoyed as it were to that place until he found himself at the foot of the hill on which Iwere was built ; hence it was given out that war was declared against Gbeji.

But the royal party leading the army received private instructions to lead the army to Iwere and when there to inform the Kakanfo that that was the place he was sent against.

But private intelligence had reached the Kakanfo at Ilorin, of all the plots and intrigues going on in the capital. However, he with his accomphces in the city deferred the execution of their design till after their arrival at the seat of war.

The army at length stood before Iwere and the Royal party, consisting of the King's brother, the Eunuchs, and the principal slaves, and their men, pointing to it said " This is the town to be taken by the order of the AlAfin."

The time was now come for the mutiny to break out. The Basorun and the Owota at the head of the troops from the city,

the Onikoyi and the Kakanfo leading those from the provinces now alleged as a pretext for the mutiny that " If the King had not aimed at our destruction, he would not have ordered us to this impregnable town. And besides, is not this the maternal town of King AjAGBO ? Are there not Kobis in the Queen Mother's palace there ? "

The watchword was now given " O Ya " (now is the time) and so the whole army turned their swords upon the royal party and massacred them ! Chief Qpele of Gbogun in particular was famous as a swordsman ; he made himself notorious on that occasion, and took to himself a name " A ri agada pa aburo Oba " (one who has a blade for slaying the King's brother).

The siege was immediately raised, and the whole army stood before the city for forty and two days. The King sent word to say if they have returned from the expedition, whether successful or unsuccessful, let them come in for an interview. The insurgent chiefs sent word back to say that the royal party had offended them and that the result had proved unfortunate. " Very well," Sciid the King, " in any case, come in for an interview." Several weeks passed, and they were still encamped before Oyo irresolute as to what they should do next. At last an empty covered calabash was sent to the King — for his head ! A plain indication that he was rejected. He had suspected this all along and was not unprepared for it. There being no alternative His Majesty set his house in order; but before he committed suicide, he stepped out into the palace quadrangle with face stern and resolute, carrying in his hands an earthenware dish and three arrows. He shot one to the North, one to the South, and one to the West uttering those ever-memorable imprecations, " My curse be on ye for your disloyalty and disobedience, so let your children disobey you. If you send them on an errand, let them never return to bring you word again. To all the points I shot my arrows will ye be carried as slaves. My curse will carry you to the sea and beyond the seas, slaVes will rule over you, and you their masters will become slaves."

With this he raised and dashed the earthenware dish on the ground smashing it into pieces, saying " Igba la isg a ki isg awo, beheni ki org mi o se to ! to ! " (a broken calabash can be mended, but not a broken dish ; so let my words be — irrevocable !)

He then took poison and died, after which the camp was broken up, and each of the chiefs repaired to his own place.

Thus ended an unhappy reign of about seven years, and Prince Adebg succeeded him on the throne.

Asamu Agba-o lekan was the Basgrun of this reign.

§ 3. The Rebellion of the Oyo Chiefs

The death ot the late King was all that the rebel chiefs demanded, after which, the army entered the city, pillaged the palace and then dispersed each to his own place. From this time the spirit of rebelHon and independence began to spread throughout the kingdom. Adebo was placed on the throne with the nominal title of King, but without the authority and power of a King. It was his misfortune to have come to the throne at such a time, and he held the sceptre for only 130 days.

Afonja the Kakanfo of Ilorin and Opele the Bale of Gbogun were the first to proclaim their independence, other chiefs soon followed their examples. This was the commencement of the break-up of the unity of the

Yoruba kingdom, and the beginning of the tribal independence. Tribute was no longer paid to the King. The King's messengers and Ilaris no longer carried that dread as before, nor were they allowed to oppress people or enrich themselves with their goods as before.

As the King's authority waned, so also the respect and deference hitherto paid to the citizens of the capital ceased ; they were even treated disrespectfully and became the subjects of vulgar songs all over the country, a thing unheard of before ! Law and order were subverted, might triumphed over right, and the powerful chieftains turned their arms towards subverting town after town in the kingdom in order to increase their own wealth and power. Chief Opele of Gbogun took Dofian and Igbo-Owu; he besieged Gboho but fell in that place, being shot with an arrow by the brave defenders.

Opele was the only powerful chief Afonja respected and having now no rival he resolved upon a scheme to reduce the provinces under his own sway, leaving the capital severely alone in complete isolation. He made no attempt on Oyo, had no aspiration after the throne knowing that was impossible of attainment ; it was sufficient tor him that the King was powerless to check his ambition. In order to strengthen his hands in the enterprise he was about to undertake, he invited a Fulah Moslem Priest named Alimi to Ilorin to act as his priest. Alimi in responding to his call came with his Hausa slaves and made Ilorin his home. These Hausa slaves Afonja found to be useful as soldiers. He also invited to Ilorin a rich and powerful Yoruba friend at Kurwo named Solagberu, who quartered himself at the outskirts of the town.

All the Hausa slaves in the adjacent towns hitherto employed as barbers, rope-makers, and cowherds, now deserted their masters and flocked to Ilorin under the standard of Afonja the Kakanfo, and were protected against their masters.

Under Solagberu's standard also flocked Mohammedans from Gbanda, Kobayi, Agoho, Kuwo, and Kobe. All in his quarter being Moslems, he named that part of the town Oke S una, i.e., the quarter of the faithful. They held themselves separate not only from the pagans, but also from the Fulahs or Fulanis their co-religionists.

From this time beg?in the Jehad or religious war in the Yoruba country. Those who were enlisted as soldiers called themselves Jama (a Hausa word for the rank and file, as distinguished from the leaders). The mark of distinction between themselves and others was the Kende, two large iron rings one on the thumb, the other on the 3rd or 4th finger of the left hand ; with this they welcome each other, striking the rings against each other to produce a sound. This io the sign of brotherhood ; hence they often say ' O re kende si mi, okan na ni wa," (he welcomed me with the Kende, we both are one).

The operations of the Jamas were directed against the Igbdna tribe. The only towns of Yoruba proper destroyed were amongst the Ibolos viz., Iresk, Ejigbo, and Ilobu. The reason why these towns were destroyed we shall notice afterwards.

§ 4. The Rising of Ojo Agunbambaru

Ojo surnamed Agunbambaru was one of the surviving sons of the renowned Basorun Gahk. He had escaped to the Bariba country at the general massacre of Gahk's children and relatives in the reign of King Abigdun. Hearing of the present state of the country, he thought there could never be a more favourable opportunity for him both to avenge his father's death, and also to obtain his title without opposition.

He returned from the Bariba country with an immense army, entered Qyo, and under the pretext of espousing the King's cause, he put to death indiscriminately most of the influential citizens who were named as Afonja's friends and allies. The Owota was the first victim of his ambition and revenge. On the whole, about 100 chiefs were despatched, who were either his father's enemies, or who might have opposed him -in his main object.

He now set off for Ilgrin to measure strength with Afgnja the powerful Kakanfo, whose father was one of those who swelled Oyabi's army for the overthrow of his father the Basorun Gahk, and who had succeeded the same Oyabi in his title as Kakanfo, These were his grievances against Afgnja ; but besides these, Afgnja was the only person in the land after Op§le of Gbogun, who might have opposed him in his designs.

If Ojo had acted with prudence, he might have succeeded without

the slightest doubt ; but his indiscriminate slaughter of the Oyo chiefs and others in his track, and his threats against the Onikoyi, tended to weaken his own strength on the outset. Fire and the sword marked his path to Ilorin, and so great was the dread of him, that such towns as Ogidi, Ogele and others, were deserted at his approach.

Adegun the Onikoyi being one of Afonja's secret friends, was on his hst for destruction but he was reserved till after the war. Both were kept informed of all Ojo's movements, policy, and designs by the Oyo people who followed him trembhng, not really as friends, but rather as traitors, their minds having been prejudiced against him, on account of his excesses, and a secret combination was formed between them and the Onikoyi, to desert Ojo at the most ciitical moment.

Ojo's army was further swelled by recruits from all the Yoruba towns who feared his vengeance should victoiy crown his efforts without their help ; and even the Onikoyi who knew himself to be a marked man, declared for him and swelled his army.

Afonja met this large army a great way off but he was defeated on three successive engagements. His army being completely routed he fled precipitately to Ilorin to fortify the town against the approach of the conqueror. Ilorin had not been walled, and there was no time to think of doing so now, so he had to extemporise fortifications, erecting stockades with the locust and shea-butter trees.

Ilorin was soon besieged and was nearly taken, as Afgnja's courage was faiUng from repeated reverses, when private messages from the enemy's camp were sent to encoiurage him to hold out a Uttle longer.

At last, the final decisive battle was to be fought, Afonja and his army were hard pressed on every side, being shut up within their forts, and the town was on the point of being taken when Adegun the Onikoyi and his accomplices suddenly gave way, in the heat of the battle, and the great conqueror irretrievably lost the day !

The traitors fled away in confusion, but Ojo and his trusty Bariba troops retreated orderly ; the Kakanfo could not follow up the victory by pursuing him from the dread he had of the Baribas, who were renowned for being good archers, and for their poisoned arrows. Ojo made good his escape with the remnant of his army. Being thus deserted by those whose cause he professed to espouse, Agunbambaru considered himself unsafe among them, and therefore returned to the Bariba country with the wreck of his army watching for another favourable opportunity.

After the fall of Opele of Gbogun, King Adebo declared war against the town of (Gbogun, but he died at home during the progress of the siege. His reign was short and specially marked by troubles. The people now longed for peace, hence their pathetic songs . —

" A pete, a pero, a fi Adebo joba, Abiodun, pada wa joba o ! "

(With deliberation, and thought we made Adebg King, O Abiodun, do thou return to reign !) Asamu was also the Basorun of this reign.

§ 5. Maku

Afonja by new conquests and especially by his recent victory over Ojo became mightier still. The Igb6nas having already been subjugated, he now proceeded to punish Iresa for being in league with Ojo, because no private message came to him from that place during the war.

Prince Maku ascended the throne without Afonja's being consulted, and therefore he never sent any congratulations, nor repaired to Oyo to do homage as usual. A deputation was therefore sent to inform him that " The New Moon has appeared," meaning a new King has ascended the throne ; and he sent back this arrogant reply " Let that New Moon speedily set."

Maku's reign was very short, not exceeding two months (or three moons as Yorubas reckoned it).

He declared war against Iworo, and took the field in person. He suffered a defeat and retreated to I wo (in the Metropolitan district). From shame he did not return to Oyo till the Oyo Mesi sent word to him that he

should not think of removing the seat of government to I wo, or else why did he remain there ? His Majesty thereupon returned to the capital, and then he was poUtely told that rio Yoruba King must survive a defeat. He thereupon committed suicide.

The Bagorun of this reign was the same Asamu.

Chapter VII

THE RISE OF THE FULANIS TO POWER

§ I. The Spread of Anarchy and Fall of Afonja

An interregnum folloNved the last reign but for how long, it is not known ; after which Majotu was placed on the throne. The whole country was at this time in the greatest disorder, wars and rumours of war being the order of the day. The tocsin of war resounded from every quarter, and the new King found himself incapable of coping with the situation.

The Epos, imitating the Kakanfo at Ilorin organized a military band which they called Ogo Were (i.e. the Jackals) at the head of which was the Aresa but with what object in view, it was not known. The Kakanfo received the news with mixed feelings of jealousy and suspicion ; he sent and enquire.d of Toyeje the Bale of Ogbomoso his Otun i.e. commander of his right, what he understood by that movement. Toyeje could not say. War was in consequence declared against the Epcs, and several towns in that province were taken, only Ogbahagbkha and Iwo amongst the principal towns escaped. Ilobu and Ejigbo amongst the Ibglos were also taken, and the Ogo Were suppressed.

Afonja was now the sole power in the kingdom ; the King and the capital were left to manage their own affairs by themselves.

The Jamas were increasing in number and in rapacity, to the utter distress and ruin of the country. When there was no war in hand they usually scattered themselves all over the land plundering the people and committing outrages. They would enter any house, make it their headquarters, from which they would pillage the neighbourhood and surrounding districts. They fed upon the cattle of the house and led the rest away at their leisure and pleasure.

Knowing the consequences to themselves and to the town if they were to attack these marauders, the country folk became rather disinclined to rear up any cattle or poultry to feed these thieves ; every one helped himself and family to whatever remained of their livestock, so that at one time there was not a single livestock to be found in country towns.

To further illustrate the gross licences of these Jamas, slaves who had deserted their masters often returned to the same town, and even to the very house as a Jama, making their former

master's house their headquarters for their rapine : masters who were kind to them formerly were now repaid by protection against the rapacities of their comrades ; unkind ones were now treated with heartless revenge. These fellows were not regarded now as slaves bat as the Kakanfo's servants.

Thoughtful men were now apprehensive of the evils to the nation which the unrestrained licences of these Jamas portended, but no one was bold enough to remonstrate with the Kakanfo, or even to appeal to him against their rapacities. Fagbohun the chief of Jabata alone had the courage to do so by virtue of his office as the commander of the left wing of the Kakanfo's arm}-, and he incurred his displeasure for his boldness.

In order to get Fagbohun into his grasp, Afonja summoned all the provincial Bales to him at Ilorin, but Fagbohun having got wind of his intention escaped back to his town.

But Afonja perceived his error when it was too late. Haughty and passionate, his very egotism was the cause of his fall. Fortune had carried him to such a high pitch of glory, he thought his fall was impossible ; besides, he had unlimited confidence in his Jamas, and was not aware ot their growing disaffection and disloyalty towards himself. He thought he could put them down whenever he liked, and was sometimes very severe with any act of insubordination, openly threatening them with suppression and annihilation. This threat

only served to increase their disaffection. Too late, he saw what Fagbohun had warned him against. He failed completely to check their ambition, rapine and lawlessness. His threats and warnings were not heeded. Long impunity had increased their boldness.

At last, the Kakanfo was resolved to give effect to his threats and to disband the Jamas, but he miscalculated his own strength. By the death of his brother Agbonrin, and his head slave Lasipa he had lost his mainstay for these were men of power. He had offended all the powerful chiefs in the kingdom including his former friend and ally Solagberu of Oke Suna, and his priest AUmi by his high-handedness, lofty airs and haughty spirit.

Fearing lest these Jamas should attack him suddenly if he were to delay their destruction, he sent a private message to the Onikoyi and other powerful chiefs in the country inviting them to make their appearance in Ilorin suddenly, and to assist him in annihilating these Jamas.

But the secret was divulged to the Jamas, and they, losing no time, being headed by Alimi the priest, rose up against him before he could obtain help from abroad. Solagberu being a Yoruba, professed neutrality. The Kakanfo was closely besieged

in his quarters, but he fought with his characteristic bravery. When he found himself overwhelmed by numbers, he despatched Bugare his head slave to solicit the aid of Solagberu ; but Solagberu treacherously detained him, saying, " Your Master has hitherto looked down upon us as his menials, and why does he now require our aid ? " This treachery, he lived to regret. The great Kakanfo was disappointed on all sides. As neither Bugare nor Solagberu made an appearance, he could not hold out till the Onikoyi's arrival ; he was compelled to fight within the walls of his house ; but when the house was set on fire, he rushed out again into the streets surrounded by his faithful few. The insurgents surrounded them, charged again and again, but could not break their ranks, Afonja himself in the midst of them was fighting most desperately, surrounded by the corpses of some of his faithful attendants. Seeing the day was lost, some of his followers became disheartened and deserted him., but the rest chose to die with him. He fell indeed like a hero. So covered was he with darts that his body was supported in an erect position upon the shafts of spears and arrows showered upon him.

So much dread had his personality inspired that these treacherous Jamas whom he had so often led to victory could not believe he was really dead ; they continued to shower darts upon him long after he had ceased fighting. They were afraid to approach his body as if he would suddenly spring up and shake himself for the conflict afresh ; not till one of them, bolder than the rest cautiously went near and placed an arrow in his hand and they saw he could no longer grasp it, that they believed he was really dead ! His corpse was taken up and burnt to ashes.

The crafty AUmi his treacherous friend took his helpless children and family under his own protection, a leging that it was a misunderstanding that led to the civil fight between himself and his old friend, in which the latter unhappily lost his life. His house was rebuilt, and the remnant of his people were permitted to occupy it, but the government of the town passed over to the conqueror. His family, however, are highly respected at Ilgrin to this day. Thus passed away one who will always be remembered in the annals of the Yoruba country as the leader of the revolution which ended in the dismemberment of the Yoruba country.

The late Afonja was a native of Ilorin. The city was built by his great grandfather, Laderin, whose posterity bore rule in her in succession to the fourth generation. Laderin the founder, was succeeded by Pasin, his son, a valiant chiet who opposed the renowned Gaha when he was in the zenith of his glory. Fearing his rising power, Gahk drove him out of Ilorin and he escaped to

Ol^. He sent an army after him there which reduced the town and Pasin was taken and slain. Alagbin the son of Pasin succeeded his father, and in turn handed the government to his vaUant son Afonja with whom the rule ended.

Ilorin is sometimes spoken of as Afonja's Ilorin. This is because he was the most renowned of her rulers, and not only so, but also because it was he who made it into the large city it now is.

There were several towns and villages around at no very great distance from Ilorin e.g. Kanla, Oke Suna, Ganma, Elehinjare, Idofian, Oke Oyi, Ibare, Igbon, Iresa etc. Most of them this restless warrior captured one by one and resettled them around Ilorin so as to make it into what it has become. The able-bodied men he enrolled among his soldiers, and several women and children he sold into slavery, in order to have wherewith to maintain and supply arms to his war boys.

He was not actually of the royal family although often reckoned as such, but his mother was said to have been a home born slave of the palace, and he was brought up among the children of the royal family, hence the Ibamu facial mark across the face seen in his descendants to this day.

Ilorin now passed into the hands of foreigners, the Fulanis who had been invited there as friends and allies. These being far more astute than the Yorubas, having studied their weak points and observed their misrule, planned to grasp the whole kingdom into their own hands by playing one chief against another and weakening the whole. Their more generous treatment of fallen foes and artful method of conciliating a power they could not openly crush, marked them out as a superior people in the art of government.

§ 2. The First Attempt to Recover Ilorin from the Fulanis

The Battle of Ogele

The tragic end of Afonja the Kakanfo by the hands of his Jamas had long been anticipated by thoughtful men who deprecated their formation, and had predicted the worst for the nation when slaves became masters.

The death of the Kakanfo struck the whole nation with such awe and bewilderment that it took the people nearly a whole year to bring them to their right mind. Seeing that the fate of the whole nation was trembling in the balance as it were, all the people united to avenge the death of Afonja, while in the meantime, the crafty Fulani had been strengthening himself for the conflict. He had studied the Yorubas and knew how to circumvent them.

Toyeje the Bale of Ogbomosg and commander of the late Kakanfo's right, was promoted to the post of Kakanfo, and the whole nation was united under his standard to expel the Fulanis from Ilorin. They encamped at a place called Ogele, where they were met by the Fulani horse aided by the powerful Yoruba Moslem Chief Solagberu of Oke Suna. Another fatal mistake of Sglagberu's.

A sanguinary battle was fought in which the Fulanis were victorious. They routed the Yorubas and followed up their victory, which resulted in the desertion or destruction of a great many towns in the Ibolo province. The only important towns left in that part were Ofa, Igbona, Ilemona, Erin, and a few others.

The refugees could only carry away such of their personal effects which could be snatched away in a hasty flight, as the Fulani horse kept hovering in their rear. They found temporary refuge in any walled town where a powerful chief happened to be, there, it may be, to await another siege by the conqueror.

The distress caused by this calamity cannot be described. Aged people who could not be carried away were left to perish. The doleful lamentations of parents who had lost their children, and of thousands of widows and orphans were heartrending. Bereft of every thing, without money, or anything that could be converted into money in such hasty and sudden flight, they were reduced to abject misery and poverty among strangers, and could only support life by doing menial work by procuring firewood or leaves for sale and such like. A people who until recently lived in what for them was affluence and plenty, are now oppressed with want and misery brought about by the want of foresight, and the vaulting ambition of their rulers.

§ 3. The Second Attempt to Expel the Fulanis and Recover

Ilorin

The Mugbamugba War

After a short respite the Yorubas again rallied and resolving to rid the country of these hordes of marauders the Jamas, made an alliance with Monjia, the King of Rabbah, that he may help them to extirpate the pests. The war took place somewhere between March and April at the time when the locust fruit was ripe for harvest.

The country was already devastated by the late wars, many towns were left desolate, and consequently there were no farms for foraging. What food there was in the Ilorin farms were soon eaten up, and both the besiegers and the besieged were without

provisions and had to live on the locust fruit (igba) . Hence the war was termed Mugbamugba.

The Yorubas were again unsuccessful in this expedition. They had not yet learnt how to cope with cavalry and the Fulanis were expert horsemen. From successive defeats the Yorubas lost all courage, and victories one after another made the Ilorins more confident, so that in the open fields they gained easy victories over the Yorubas ; and when they were protected within walled towns they reduced them by long sieges and famine.

On this occasion, the Ilorins attacked the alUes to advantage. They hid their horses in the rear of the allied armies and while a party of horsemen engaged them in front the main body of the cavalry suddenly bore down upon them from the rear and routed them. Monjia fled precipitately to his own country, leaving the Yorubas at the mercy of the victors. The Ilorins followed up their victory and swept away all the towns in the direction of ^ia, Erin, Igbona etc. The Olofa with Asegbe his favourite and wise Ilari escaped to Ikoyi.

§ 4. The Battle of Pamo

Alimi the Moslem priest, who was at the head of the foreigners at Ilorin died after the last war and was succeeded by his son Abudusalami, who became the first King, or Emir, of Ilorin. Ilorin now passes definitely into the hands of the Fulanis as rulers, and affords a home for the Gambaris (Hausas) from whom the Jamas were reciuited.

The late Alimi was much respected at Ilorin from his arrival there as a mere priest. At fiist he had no intention of making Ilorin his home much less to embark upon a career of conquest ; and indeed when Afonja and his Jamas commenced their excesses he was prepared to return to his own country from disgust, but the eldeis of the Yorubas prayed him to stay and act as a check on Afonja for there was no one else to whom he would defer and there was no telling how far he would go without someone to put the fear of God into him. The Kakanfo and the people of Ilorin prevailed upon him to send for his family and make Ilorin his home.

Alimi was a pure Fulani by birth and his wife also a Fulani lady. They lived together for a considerable time without any issue. The wife then consulted a Moslem priest as to her state of childlessness, and she was told to give out of her abundance to a distinguished Moslem priest a slave as an alms to the glory of of God, and she was sure to have children.

Having considered this matter over, she came to the conclusion within herself that she knew of no distinguished Moslem priest

greater than her own husband, and therefore she gave to her husband one of her maidens as " an alms to the glory of God."

This maiden as Ahmi's secondary wife became the mother of Abudusalami and Shitta his two eldest sons. The Fulani lady herself subsequently gave birth to a son named Sumonu, who was nick-named Beribepo (one who cuts off head and post). Alimi afterwards took to himself a third wife by whom he also had a son, and, therefore at his death he left four sons to inherit his property. As will be seen below however, no advantage in the matter of government accrued to the son of the real wife (who was a pure white Fulani) above those of the slave wife who were coloured. Hence in the third generation, the chief rulers of Ilorin have become black.

The power of the Fulanis was now very great, and they aimed at nothing short of the subversion of the whole Yoruba country, and the short sighted Yoruba war-chiefs were playing the game for them by their mutual jealousy of one another. One expedition followed after another and the result was the devastation and depopulation of the country. Far seeing men had predicted all this, if the various Yoruba families did not unite and expel the foreigners ; but jealousy and rivalry among the chiefs prevented unity of purpose. Allegiance was no longer paid to the King, not even in the capital. Intestine wars not only weakened the country, but offered it an easy prey to the common enemy.

Thus Toyeje the Kakanfo at Ogbomosg had a difference with Adegun the Onikoyi which at length broke out into an open war, each of them being now independent, and neither would submit to the other. The Kakanfo formed an alliance with the Oluiwo of Iwo, the Timi of Ede and Solagberu of Ilorin, and besieged the Onikoyi in his city of Ikoyi.

Solagberu had his own personal grievance to vent because the Onikoyi did not do homage to him or pay him tribute ; so he came with all the Ilorin forces at his command. Abudusalami the Emir alone remained at home. The combined forces encamped at a place called Pamo. The conflict was very fierce, and Ikoyi, hemmed in on all sides, was nearly taken, when Asegbe the Olofa's Ilari, who was then with his master, a refugee at Ikoyi, saved the city by wise and judicious measures. He told his master and it also came to the Onikoyi's hearing that if he could be allowed to use his wisdom without being forbidden or thwarted, he could save the city. The besieged who were prepared to agree to any terms in order to obtain peace accepted the offer, although reluctantly, as Asegbe kept his plans to himself.

He sent a private messenger to Abudusalami the Emir of Ilgrin

in the name of the Onikoja, that he was besieged in his city, for the sole reason that he declared himself for the Emir of Ilorin. The Emir again questioned the messenger " Is it true the Onikoyi declared for me? " " Quite true, your Majesty," was his reply. " Then the siege must be raised," said the Emir.

Orders were now sent to recall Solagberu with all the Ilorin forces, but he refused to obey orders. Again and again peremptory orders were sent, with the same result. The fifth and last message was to the Princes and other chiefs, to the effect that whoever would prove himself loyal should return home at once by the order of the Emir. The Ilorin army now left the camp, leaving Solagberu alone behind together with the aUies.

The next effort of the Emir of Ilorin was to raise the siege at all cost, and hence he sent his army to reinforce Ikoyi. These Ilorin troops entered Ikoyi, but for ten days did nothing but help themselves to every thing they could lay hands on, eating and drinking to excess. On the eleventh day they asked to be conducted to the scene of action. Then they joined battle, and completely routed the Kakanfo's army. Solagberu fled back to his quarters at Ilorin, and the Yorubas were dispersed. Solagberu's feelings towards Abudusalami, can better be imagined than described. The men of note who fell in this war were, — The Timi of Ede, the king of Erin, the Chief Aina-Abutu-Sogun, and Ay ope.

Although Solagberu was allowed to remain in his quarters, yet the disaffection between him and the Emir of Ilorin was very great, and every incident served but to heighten it. . It grew from jealousy and illwill to opposition and resentment, and at length into a civil war. The Emir's party besieged Oke Sun a, desperate battles were fought, but the besieged held out for a long time until they were reduced by famine. They were hard put to it in order to sustain life, living on frogs, lizards, barks of trees, etc., till no green thing could be found at Oke Suna, Solagberu had cause to remember with regret his tieachery towards his friend Afonja, in his hour of need, at the hands of these very Jamas. At last, Oke Suna was reduced and Solagberu slain.

Abudusalami the Fulani Emir having now no rival in any Yoruba King or Chief, the Onikoyi having declared for him, the Kakanfo's army shattered, and Solagberu slain, resolved upon subverting the whole kingdom, and making himself the King of the Yoruba country. The remaining Yoruba towns spared were placed under tribute. He was aided in his enterprise by the Jamas whose tyrannies and oppression greatly exceeded those which they practised in the days of Afonja, which were so galling

to the Yorubas : formerly it was only the livestock that were freely taken away, but now, they entered houses and led away women and young persons at their pleasure. It was Hterally enslaving the people !

To such a wretched and miserable condition were the people reduced, especially in the provinces.

Chapter VIII

THE CONSEQUENCES OF THE REVOLUTION IN THE

SOUTH

§ I. The Owu War

The kingdom being now in a disorganized condition each tribal unit constituted itself an independent state. The Ifes in the east, and the Ijebus in the south formed an alliance against the Owns to the south-west of the former and north west of the latter.

The Owns (although now domiciled with the Egbas) are a family quite distinct from. Egbas or Oyos. Hardihood, stubbornness, immorality, and haughtiness are marked traits in their character, so much so that it has passed into a proverb " A bi omg I'Owu, o ni ako tabi abo ni, ewo ni jdo se omg nibe ? " (a child is born at Owu, and you ask male or female : which will be a proper child ?) Either sex when roused by passion would sooner die than not take dire revenge. Their manners were totally different from those of the Oyos, but from the days of Sango they have been very loyal to the AlAfin of Oyo.

As warriors, the Owus were hardy, brave, and courageous, they had no guns, their weapons consisting of the Agedengbe (a long heavy cutlass) with bows and arrows. Coming to close quarters with cutlass in hand was the mode of fighting characteristic of these brave people.

The cause of the war between these three families was this : — We have already stated above that during the reign of King Abiodun, express orders were sent from Oyo to the Ow6ni of If§, and the Olowu to prevent Oyos being kidnapped and sold at Apomu, the great market town where the interior and the coast people met for trade. Now, since the commencement of the revolution, and the disorganized state of the kingdom, the practice was revived. The rebellion has rendered the Central Authority powerless, but there were still some men of considerable power and influence in the land, such as Adegun the Onikoyi who was the premier provincial king, Toyejg theBal§ of Ogbomoso the Kakanfo, and Edun of Gbogun.

A message similar to that sent by King Abiodun was now sent by the Onikoyi and the Kakanfo conjointly to the Olowu, and he in carrying out his orders had to chastise several towns ; hence

Ikoyi Igbo, Apomu, Ikire, Irkn, He Olup^mi, Itahakun, Iseyin Od6, Iw^ta, Akinboto, Gbkngan, Isope, Iwar6, and Jagun, were destroyed by war, all in Ife territory.

The Ow6m of Ife was highly incensed at this and declared war against Owu. The command of the war was entrusted into the hands of his commander-in-chief Singunsin. Other war-chiefs associated with him were : — Okansk, Gbogbo Olu, Wasin, Alodeloko, etc. Their first encampment was at a place called Dariagbon a farm village of one 01up6na, next at Sifirin at the confluence of the Osun and Ohk rivers.

The Ifes thought they would make an easy conquest of Owu for they themselves are a brave people, and hence this war song in their peculiar dialect : —

E maha ja (a) gba, Let us cut ropes,

Igbekun la mu a di Our captives to bind.

If a Olowu The Olowu's If a (god of palm nut)

£wa la mu a se With our corn we'll cook.

The Owns received the news that war was declared against them with great indignation. They considered themselves the power in these southern regions, and what infatuation has led the Ifes to this presumption ? With one consent they immediately marched out to meet them at this great distance. The engagement was

a hand to hand fight in which the Ifes were completely routed ; their army was all but totally annihilated, only about 200 escaped to tell the tale of their dire misfortune !

The King of Iwo, in whose territory this disaster took place did not admit the survivors into his town for fear of incurring the displeasure of his formidable neighbours the Owus, whom he dreaded ar;d of whom he was jealous, but he so far sympathized with them that he advised that they should not undergo the humiUation of returning home, and he allowed them to rendezvous in a place called Adunbieiye for the purpose of recruiting their army and to try another chance, secretly hoping that fortune may favour them next time, and being ill at ease with such a formidable neighbour as the Owus.

This small army remained in this place for about 5 years, unable to return home from shame, and yet could not obtain re-inforcement adequate for the great enterprise.

Just at this crisis the Owus and the Ijebu traders had a serious complication at the Apomu market. The dispute arose from the sale of alligator pepper, and it resulted in the rash expedition against Apomu by the haughty Owus ; the town was destroyed, and many Ijebu traders and residents lost their lives or their all.

The king of Iwo thereupon advised the Ifes to form an alliance with the Ijebus, who, like them, have now a grievance against Owu. When this was done, the lies at home were now wilUng to re-inforce their wrecked army for a conjoint attack upon Owu.

The Ijebus now declared war against Owu, and crossing the Osun river, encamped at the farm of one Oso.

The Ijebus were better armed than either their allies or their foes, and indeed, than any of the interior tribes, for, being nearest to the coast, they had the advantage of obtaining guns and gunpowder from Europeans in exchange for slaves. They were remarkable marksmen. The older men with their cloths tied round their waists, and the ends left flowing behind, constituted the regular fighting column : being too old pr too heavy to run away, they were obhged to be courageous.

The Owns were mad with rage at the receipt of the news that anyone, such as the Ijebus, had presumed to declare war against them who (as they considered themselves) were the first power in these parts (southern Yoruba). They rushed out to check the progress of the Ijebus as they did that of the Ifes, and attacked them furiously cutlass in hand. But they were compelled to fall back from the steady fire of the Ijebus which did great havoc amongst them. Summoning courage, the Owns offered another obstinate battle, but they were again repulsed with a heavy slaughter, having lost in the first and second engagements about 40 of their leaders. This was the first check to their pride. They ralUed, however, and retreated to a short distance, and then again ventured upon another attack, the Ijebus advancing as they were retreating : they finally met, and once more fortune was against the Owus, and they fled precipitately to fortify their city against the expected siege.

The Ijebus with their allies the Ifes encamped to the west of the city of Owu, under a large tree called the Ogilngun, east of the town of Oje. We may here remark that although the Egba towns of Of a and Oje were about a mile and two miles respectively from Owu, yet so bitter was the animosity between them that not only did these towns refuse their aid to Owu, but rather rejoiced at its misfortunes !

The Owus fought with their accustomed bravery, and in one furious assault, routed the aUies, and pursued them to Oje, Ofa, and Ibadan. The first two places were deserted in the general confusion and panic, and all sought refuge at Ibadan. Here the allies received reinforcements from the Egbas, and from the Oyo refugees from the north whose homes had been devastated by the Fulanis and who were now scattered about the provinces

homeless, and without occupation. Glad to find some occupation in arms, these refugees flocked to the standard of the allies in numbers ; and thus strengthened, the war was renewed. The siege lasted about 5 years (usuaJly reckoned as 7). The city was obstinately defended by the brave inhabitants from the walls, and from the forts built on the walls of the city. One Skkulk was an expert sharp shooter who was never known to miss his aim ; he contributed much to the defence of the town. But he was at the same time a

good-natured man, kind and merciful to his enemies. Whenever he saw a young man hazarding his life too close to the forts in order to show valour, pitying his youth, he used to hail at him from the fort, and warn him as follows : — " I give you your life for to-day, but do not venture here to-morrow or you shall die." And he was alw^ays as good as his word. Thus Sakulk defended the city heroically and killed many a valiant warrior.

At last, the allies held a council of war, and were determined to get rid of S^kulk on the next day. The Ijebus, who had guns were the foremost, and the whole army directed their fire and showers of darts at the fort where S^kiila was fighting, all kept shooting at that one spot, until they saw Skkiilk fall, suspending from the fort !

Owu was now deprived of her bravest defender, and famine also began its fatal work within its walls.

It was at this time the Owns began for the first time to eat those large beans called popondo (or awuje) hitherto considered unfit for food ; hence the taunting songs of the alUes : —

Popondo I'ara Owu nje. The Owns now live on propondo,

Aje f'ajaga bo 'run. That done, their necks for the yoke.

Unto this day, whoever would hum this ditty within the hearing of an Owu man, must look out for an accident to his own person.

For all the famine within, the besiegers could neither scale the walls, nor force the gates open, until Akinjobi the Olowu opened a gate, and escaped to Erunmu, one of the principal towns in his territory. The chief of this place was one Oluroko who was nearly related to the Ow6ni of Ife. Oluroko protected his overlord. The allies pursued the Olowu to this place, but Oluroko when called upon to answer for his conduct, submitted himself, and asked for pardon, showing that he could not have acted otherwise and be blameless. ^ The allies saw with him, and pardon was accordingly granted him.

Ikija was the only Egba town which befriended the city of Owu in her straits hence after the fall of the latter town, the combined armies went to punish her for supplying Owu with provisions during the siege. Being a much smaller town, they

soon made short work of it. After the destruction of Ikija,^ the allies returned to their former camp at Idi Ogungun (under the Ogiingun tree) .

"Owu was thenceforth placed under an interdict, never to be rebuilt ; and it was resolved that in future, however great might be the population of Oje — the nearest town to it — the town walls should not extend as far as the Ogungun tree, where the camp was pitched. Consequently to this day, although the land may be cultivated yet no one is allowed to build a house on it.

[In the year 1873 Akinyemi one of the sons of one Bolude of Ibadan happened to build a substantial farm house at Owu. Latosisk then the Kakanfo at Ibadan ordered it to be pulled down immediately, and Akinyemi was fined besides].

After the fall of Owu and Ikija, the army was not disbanded, but the commanders of the Ife and of the Ijebu armies returned home to give an account of the war to their respective masters, but the remnants still in the camp were continually swelled by recruits from Oyo refugees whom the Fulanis had rendered homeless.

After a time the Ijebus in the camp invited the allies home to their country as friends ; then they broke up the camp at " Idi C)gungun " and withdrew to Ipara in the south.

It should be noted that the Owu war marked a definite period in Yoruba history. It was here for the first time gunpowder was used in war in this country, and it was followed by the devastation of the Egba townships and the foundation of modern Abeokuta and Ibadan, to be related in due course.

§ 2. Consequences of the Revoution : — The Lasinmi War

Whilst the Owu war was raging in the south, the northern provinces were in no less disturbed condition. The Onikoyi, not content with being the first and greatest of the provincial kings took advantage of the disturbed state of the country to usurp the King's prerogative and aimed at subjugating the other chiefs under his own authority. Toyeje the Kakanfo at Ogbomosg was alone his rival and in order to oppose him, the Onikoyi created Edun of Gbogun an opposition Kakanfo to him. But Toyeje continued in office, and so there were two Kakanfos at this period, a thing quite unprecedented.

During this reign, it was said that a European traveller visited Oyo to whom the King granted an interview. This was most probably Clapperton (vide Clapperton'sL as^ Expedition to Africa,

^ The site of Ikija is now an Ibadan farmstead known as Karaole.

Vol. I., Chap. IV.). The King was said to have complained bitterly of the rebellion of his subjects, and that he was King only in name : he craved for military assistance in order to reduce his rebellious chiefs ; but as it was impossible for the stranger to afford this, he tried persuasive measures. He visited the several powerful chiefs in the country, remonstrated with them pointing out forcibly how " Unity is strength." His advice was favourably received and the result was a congress held at Ikoyi in which all the principal chiefs were present, and to which the King sent an Ilari.

After a prolonged deliberation they came to an agreement to return to their former loyalty and allegiance. The Onikoyi then asked that the Ilari be called in to bear the good tidings to his master ; but when called aloud by his official (Ilari) name " Kafilegboin," the chiefs all gave a start and were much surprised to hear the name of the Ilari sent to them. " What ! Kafilegboin ! (i.e. let's have it on stiff) Is that then the King's intention ? A name which implies implacabiUty, resolute determination and inexorableness! Very well then, let the rebellion continue. No one among us can consider himself safe at the hands of the King should we return to our allegiance, since he can send us such an Ilari at a time as this when he wants to win us back!" The congress was then dissolved.

Whether the King did this intentionally or not, we cannot say; but Yorubas being very diplomatic, and very suspicious of one another, he should have sent one whose name implies conciliation or harmony if he wished to win back the chiefs.

But we consider all this from God in order that the sins of the nation may be purged by judgment from above.

Shortly after this, there was a serious compUcation between the Kakanfo at Ogbomoso and the Timi of Ede. Ede had been tributary to Ogbomoso, but after the Pamo war it threw off its allegiance, and the Kakanfo had long been seeking for an opportunity to reduce it again to subjection. One cannot say what was the real cause of the war, but there can be no doubt that the Kakanfo made something or other a pretext for commencing hostilities. The Kakanfo, however, did not take the field in person as he considered it only a small affair ; he sent Lasinmi his Balogun to reduce the town.

Ede was beseiged, and for 15 days desperate battles were fought, but the town was defended heroically.

Bamgbaiye the Timi of Ede at that time, was one of the richest of the provincial kings, and it was due to his largesses that the town was able to hold out so long. Every morning he ordered bushels of corn (maize) to be well cooked, and placing large earthenware pots

at certain intervals right round the walls of the town, he filled them alternately with the cooked corn and cool drink (wellmashed Eko) or pure water, for the combatants, so that no one need compldn of hunger or find an excuse for leaving his post by day or by night.

The strength of the besiegers and the besieged was well-nigh spent, when Asegbe the Olofa's wise Ilari appeared again on the scene to prevent further bloodshed and to save the town. With a small body guard, he approached the walls of the town, so as to be heard. With his usual persuasive eloquence he induced the people to surrender in order to avoid further bloodshed. " We are all the same tribe and one family, and

why should we destroy one another in the very face of our common enemy, destroying us from without ? I give you my word, that if you capitulate the siege will be instantly raised. ”

These words were soon conveyed to the Timi, and so glad was he that he sent Asegbe a bottle of gin, which he and his attendants drank on the spot and the empty bottle was sent back as a token of good-will, that the gift was accepted.

The Timi sent again to enquire how the negotiations might best be carried on. Asegbe advised him to send lo bags of cowries and 10 goats, and to capitulate and the siege would be raised. Asegbe returned to the camp to report his success, and the chiefs were all glad and thankful. Towards the evening the Timi paid the fines imposed and capitulated and the siege was raised.

Bamgbaiye was the richest Timi that ever ruled Ede. His large garden was full of goats and sheep without number so that all the green grass in the garden was eaten up. But the creatures were all miserable looking as they were more in number than could be properly fed at home ; they should have been driven by herdsmen to the pastures to graze, but the war without prevented this. It was even said that they were so hungry that any one entering the garden would have to defend himself with a stick to prevent his clothes being eaten off his body ! When presents had to be given, or fines and indemnities paid in token of subjection, or to purchase peace as above related, selections were made from the well-favoured ones among them and the enemy appeased. He could afterwards recoup himself by taxation.

Ede prospered under the rule of this king.

§ 3. State of the Capital During this Period

King Majotu was well advanced in age, before he was called to the throne, and consequently the business of state was for the most part left in the hands of the Crown Prince Adewusi surnamed

Fuhiiniji : unfortunately, he was neither wise nor prudent but rather a dissolute and licentious prince, extravagant and cruel to a degree. His weak qualities were, however, eclipsed by his largess. He acted more like a monomaniac than like a rational being. His father was too old and weak to check him. Notwithstanding his exalted position he usually spent days and nights out-of-doors, roaming from one quarter of the town to another without returning home.

Whenever he was going to s.pend a night in a house in any quarter of the town, he usually gave orders that his suite should start about half-an-hour after he had preceded them. He would clothe himself in tatters, carrying an axe, a club, or a stick just hke a madman ! He would reach the gate of the chief whose guest he intends to be, long before the arrival of his suite, and mingle with the crowd of spectators who were there waiting to see the sight of a royal equipage, listening to their remarks and especially to those of his intended host.

If the host were to complain of the undesired visit of an unprincipled coxcomb putting him to unnecessary trouble and expense, and that he would rather do without the honour of his visit, or any other such remarks that he might make, he would hear it all with his own ears. As soon as his attendants arrived he would instantly get himself into the midst of them, change his rags for a magnificent robe, and step forth as becomes a prince. When the host now rushed forward to show his respect, and bid him a hearty welcome, etc., he would burst out “You hypocrite, did you not say so and so, when you heard I was coming to you on a visit ? I’ll curb your lying tongue.” When the host lay prostrate and trembling, conscious of guilt and pleading for mercy, he would deal him heavy blows with his club, which more often than not killed or disabled him for life, and in some cases, if he survived, he would order him to be sold into slavery.

But if the host were really solicitous about giving him a loyal welcome, and showed himself desirous of giving him an entertainment worthy of his rank, he would hear and know for himself, so that when he joined his attendants and came forward to greet his host, he would accept his welcome and bid him not to care about how he should entertain him, but would himself order refreshments and entertain the host and all present out of his own bounty, and give him presents lavishly besides. If this prince is spoken of as cruel, and as having killed or sold into slavery several of his father’s subjects, it was in this way.

An instance related of his liberahty was as follows : — Upon a festival called Isul^ customarily held in the month of

July, all the members of the royal family gorgeously dressed go in procession to a certain place to worship the spirits of their dead ancestors. The demonstrations on these occasions are very imposing, and usually end with gifts from the Crown Prince.

On one such occasion, this Prince gave the Ologbo who accompanied him a common gown, but the latter refused to accept it, saying it was not worthy of the dignity of His Royal Highness. The Crown Prince thereupon took off his robes in which he went to the Isule, and gave them to the Ologbo, and ordered other members of the royal family to do the same.

Adewusi had his own good qualities but his enormities were revolting ! He accounted it a privilege to commit indecencies under the open sky, surrounded by his attendants and Eunuchs holding large cloths in the four corners as a curtain to shield him from sight. In his train were always some of his wives and mistresses.

He would commit rape with impunity, and whether to show that he was above law, or out of pure spite to the chiefs, in his visits to any of them it was his custom on entering their houses, to perform the same act in the open court-yard before he took his seat in the piazza !

This beastly conduct bemeaned him in the estimation of the Oyo chiefs, and not only had he lost all respect from them on that account, but, on one occasion, he very nearly lost his life at the hands of the Basorun, in whose palace he had the temerity to venture on the same action ! On his arrival, his supernal highness came out to receive him as his guest, but was shocked to find that Adewusi made no exception in his lewd practices in regard to himself. He returned in a rage to his inner apartment, to reappear with a drawn sword, and would have despatched him and his mistress on the spot had not the Prince and all his attendants fled away in confusion. The Basorun's servants pursued after them with clubs and dispersed them.

Adewusi had no one among all the chiefs to appeal to for sympathy, as he had offended every one of them in the same way, although none but the Basorun was able to resent it; hence their sympathy was rather on the side of the Basorun.

But the ultimate result of this would have been serious for the Prince had not his wise and aged father conciliated the chiefs.

Knowing what the outcome would probably be, His Majesty summoned a meeting of the chiefs, noblemen, and other important personages in the city and said to them in a parable : — " The Crown Prince was my creditor when we were in the other world, and when I could not pay the debt, I escaped to this world. He

pursued me hither demanding payment, and being born of royalty, I was able to pay off my debt.

But my difficulty is this — for the purpose of which I have summoned you all my chiefs for your advice and help. The Crown Prince not content with the payment, demanded that I should carry back the amount paid to the other world ; and for this I crave your advice and help."

The Oyo chiefs asked His Majesty for an explanation of the parable and his reply was as follows : —

" The enormities of the Crown Prince in your quarters and in your houses, I have heard of, and what would have been the result, if the Basorun had killed liim in his house, we all know. Would it not have cost me my own life also ? What I crave of you is that in future I should be exonerated, and not be charged with his conduct." The Oyo chiefs were appeased and promised not to implicate the father in the crimes of his son.

Added to the scourge of the sword, divine judgment fell upon the nation in famine also and pestilence. Towards the end of this reign there was a famine in the land for two years which obliterated every trace of the plenty they revelled in when there was peace and prosperity. Many died from it. It was a struggle for many to be able to support their family, especially those in exile ; but the richness of the soil enabled those whose towns were not destroyed to render great assistance to their guests the refugees. But unfortunately

there was a dearth of the latter rains and the dry season crops could not be planted. This following closely after the Lasinmi war caused the distress to be more severe.

Gbogi, an Ijesa town was attacked and destroyed only for the sake of the provisions it contained, no one caring for slaves or booty. The staple of the Ijesas being yam and not corn, the famine was less felt amongst them, as the yam crop does not depend upon the latter rain. This famine was called lyan Yamord.

It was said that a subscription was made by several famihes to the amount of 6 heads of cowries, and a special messenger was sent to the Egba territory to buy corn. The return of the messenger was eagerly looked forward to, and at length he returned with a merry heart whistling as he walked along : but there was no load on his head, the 6 heads worth of corn was carried in a bag slung on his shoulders ! and he protected it beneath the cloth he wrapped himself with, so that no one may know what he had with him. It was a treasure ! It was shared by the subscribers by counting the grains.

This calamity was followed by a pestilence called the Pehe,

a disease of the respiratory organs like the recent {1892) fatal epidemic of Influenza ; thousands were swept away by it, and King Majotu was among its victims. Of a long succession of Kings, it was his good fortune to have died a natural death.

At the death of the King, the Crown Prince was told to die with his father, according to the custom now prevailing. But he was unwilling to do so, and was giving out bribes liberally to the chiefs that they should give him their support ; and trusting to his former largess to the people, he was determined upon a civil fight, hoping for a general rising in his favour ; but Akawo, his bosom friend quietly undeceived him, and advised him to die honourably, or he would have the mortification of seeing himself deserted at the most critical moment by those on whom he counted most to espouse his cause. Adewusi then committed suicide, and Prince Amgdo was placed on the throne.

Chapter IX

FURTHER DEVELOPMENT OF THE ANARCHY

§ I. Evil Days for the Capital

Prince Amod6 was one of the grandchildren of Ajampati the twin brother of King Ajagbo. He came to the throne at a time when the kingdom was distracted by anarchy and confusion. The Fulanis having an eye on the capital of Yoruba-land, but not being confident enough to make an attack on the city whilst there were so many powerful chiefs in the land, who might suddenly return to their allegiance, were using prudence and astuteness to spread the disaffection. They were fanning the flames of discord by allying themselves with one or other of the chiefs known to be rebellious against their lawful sovereign. None of the provincial kings now paid tribute to Oyo or acknowledged the authority of the King. He was virtually King of the capital only.

In order to have a powerful friend and ally in whom he could confide in time of emergency, King Amodo made an alliance with Lanloke the chief of Ogodo, a market town, at the confluence of the river Niger, where Yorubas and Tapas met for an exchange of merchandise. Ogodo was originally a Tapa town, but subsequently the Yoruba population predominated, nearly all the children of influential Oyo chiefs resided there permanently for the purpose of trade. King Amod6 cemented and strengthened this aUiance by giving his daughter to Lanloke to wife, and treating him as an independent sovereign.

To show how weak and contemptible the AlAfin has become, Lanloke most brutally and cowardly beat the princess his wife actually to death, and boasting over it, took to himself the nickname, " My name is Amod6, and I put Amod6 to death. My name is Ajebaba, and I enslaved Ajebaba."

Fearing the resentment and vengeance of Oyo for this act, he hastily formed an alHance with the Ilgrins, and assumed the aggressive, and so besieged Oyo. Oyo at length capitulated and the Ilorin troops entered and sacked the city. Oyo was plundered of nearly everything, but no captives were made excepting some Oyo beauties who were carried away with the spoils,

Jimba, one of the head slaves of the Ilorin Emir was the chief spoiler. He took away all the Egugun dress, and forced the citizens to accept the Koran, which necessitated every one to

change his name for an Arabic name, the only alternative being the sword.

Thus at length Oyo became tributary to Ilorin !

§ 2. The Third Attempt to Expel the Fulanis The Kanla Expedition

Amod6 was ill at ease under the yoke of the Fulani Emir of Ilorin, and he prevailed upon all the Yoruba chiefs throughout the country to unite and rid themselves of their common enemy.' Apparently they were united, but between the capital and the provinces, the spirit of disaffection and jealousy was strong. It was understood full well that the King's policy was to use them together to rid himself first of the common enemy, and then to subdue the rebel chiefs one after another, by force of arms.

But the Ilgrins on the other hand were more diplomatic. In order to facilitate their plans, they made friendship with some of the Yoruba chiefs who were men of power, and who, if united, would be able to oppose them successfully ; such were Prince Atiba of Ago Oja, Edun chief of Gbogun, the most powerful Yoruba general of the day, and Adegun the Onikoyi the premier provincial king.

Whenever there was war with the Ilorins these chiefs usually acted against their own real and national interests, either by betraying their own nation and people, or by giving their backs to the enemy without shooting an arrow, and thus allowing the Ilorin horse the advantage of out-flanking their foes.

King Amod6 having prevailed upon all the chiefs to come together, declared war against the Fulanis, and Ilorin was besieged by a formidable army raised throughout the country.

Adegun the Onikoyi was suffering from indisposition and was really unfit to take the field ; but Edun of Gbogun his rival, forced him to go to the war, secretly planning with the Ilgrins that he would give way in the heat of the battle, in order that Adegun might be taken alive ! This battle took place at Kanla from which the expedition was named.

Edun having carried out his act of treachery, the Onikoyi was surrounded by the Ilorin horse ; but he fought, and fought bravely and fell like a hero. Thus the AlAfin's army was routed, and the people fled away in confusion.

It was at the time when the rivers overflowed their banks, and a number of people were drowned at the river Ogun. The most notable chief drowned on this occasion was Oja the founder of Agd (the present Qyo). Prince Atiba, one of the rising power,

rode his powerful horse into the river, and narrowly escaped being drowned.

The Yoruba towns deserted at this defeat were Esiele and Pop6.

§ 3. The Vicissitudes of Ikoyi

The fall of Adegun at the Kanla war left the kingship of Ikoyi vacant. There were two aspirants to the title, viz., Siyenbola, the son of the late Adegun, and Ojo, the son of Adegun's predecessor. The majority of the people was for Siyenbola, and Ojo's partisans were but few. Ojo, however, went to Oyo to have the title conferred on him by the Suzerain as of yore, and he succeeded in obtaining the Alafin's favour in his claim.

King Amodo was glad for this mark of recognition and hoped for the gradual return of the provincial kings to their allegiance. He therefore made Ojo take a solemn oath that he would ever be loyal to him. His Majesty strictly charged him against making any league with Edun the rebel chief of Gbogun through whose town he must pass to reach his home at Ikoyi. This charge was occasioned by the treacherous conduct of Edun at the Kanla war by which the Alafin lost the day. "I am a King," said Amodo, " and you are now a king. Kings should form aUiance with kings and not with a commoner."

The King justly anticipated what would happen, for when Ojo the new Onikoyi reached Gbogun on his way home, Edun sought his friendship and alliance, and pressed him to take an oath with him, that they would always be faithful to each other. Ojo stoutly refused to take the oath, alleging that it was unbecoming for a king to take an oath with one not of royal blood. But Edun was a man of power, and the Onikoyi was already in his clutches being in his town and he felt he could do whatever he hked with him ; ; he therefore insisted that the oath should be taken before the Onikoyi could leave his town. Ojo was in a dilemma, his oath of allegiance to the Alafin forbade him to disobey the King's charge, and now he was at the mercy of this miscreant. He had now no option, the oath must be taken and the only way out of it the Onikoja could find was to delegate one of his attendants to perform the business for him, as the fitness of things required from the inequality of their respective ranks. The Kakanfo considered this an insult to his dignity, and he resented it by ordering Atanda one of his own attendants to take the oath with the Onikoyi's delegate.

Whilst this was taking place at Gbogun, tidings reached Ikoyi that Ojo had succeeded in obtaining the title from the AlAfin,

and Siyenbgla who had usurped it therefore fled from the town with all his party to Ilorin.

The remnant of Ojo's party at home who did not accompany him to Ovg met him at Esiele with the news that the town had been deserted from disgust that he should reign over them. The Onikoyi was too weak to proceed to occupy Ikoyi with his small party, he therefore remained at Esiele.

A week after this, the Ilorin horse came against Esiele to espouse the cause of Siyenbgla, and they had seven days of hard fighting, but finding it not such an easy business to rush the town, as they had supposed, they retreated home to make full preparation for a regular siege at the ensuing year.

The siege was accordingly laid in the following year. Esi§le held out for a long time, being heroically defended by its balogun Kurumi, and another notable war-chief Dad6 (of both of whom we shall hear more afterwards) . When they could hold out no longer, the war-chiefs deserted the town, leaving mostly the women and children at the mercy of the conquerors. Ojo the Onikoyi was slain, and Siyenbgla having now no rival obtained the title of Oniko5a from the Emir of Ilgiin, and returned with those of his party who went with him to Ilgrin to re-occupy the town. Thus Ikoyi was re-peopled but no longer as a vassal state of Ovg but of Ilgrin. The city was rapidly refilled by those of Ojo's party that escaped the fall of Esiele and they now acknowledged Siyenbgla as their king.

Esiele also was again re-peopled, as it was not actually destroyed by war but deserted under stress. The inhabitants were permitted to remain as they were because the siege was laid against the town on account of the late Onikoyi — no longer alive.

Shortly after this there was a serious complication between Edun of Gbogun the Kakanfo and Dada the Bale of Ade)d which broke out into a war. Edun marched his army through Esiel§ to besiege Adeyi, but Fasgla the Bale of Esiele hearing that the Kakanfo's army was to pass through his town having hardly recovered from the effects of the late war, and dreading the devastation and pillaging of farms consequent on such a march, deserted the town. So Esiele was again desolate, the people finding refuge at Ogbomgsg and Ikoyi.

The expedition, however, was unsuccessful. The Kakanfo's army suffering many reverses, it had to be given up.

§ 4. The Gbogun War and Fall of Edun the Kakanfo

Gbogun was the last of the powerful towns in the country and as the aim of the Fulanis was the subversion of the whole

country, a pretext for war was soon found in order to lay siege against her.

Abudusalami the Emir of Ilorin threatened the Kakanfo with war if he refused to pay allegiance to him ; Edun accepted the challenge and began at once to make a vast preparation, offensive and defensive.

Ikoyi being already a vassalage of Ilorin and a neighbouring town, Edun regarded her as an enemy and insisted that it should be deserted at once or he would take her by surprise. Siyenbola the Onikoyi sent ambassadors to Gbogun to arrange terms of peace but Edun refused to hear ot any such thing and threatened to destroy the town the next day, if not deserted at once as he would not afford the Ilorins a base of operation against him at such close quarters. There being no alternative, Ikoyi was a second time deserted and Siyenbola escaped to Ilorin.

Gbogun was soon besieged by the Ilorins and desperate battles were fought, the defenders fighting heroically and could not be overwhelmed until at last the city was reduced by famine and thus Gbogun fell, the last of the powerful towns of Yoruba.

Edun the greatest Yoruba general of the day escaped by way of Gbodo where he was overtaken, being hotly pursued by the Ilorin horse. He had with him a handful of veterans and such was the terror his very name inspired that the pursuers did not dare to offer him battle.

The men of Gbodo were torn between two opinions whether they should afford protection to their fallen general or allow him to escape in peace. But the pursuers insisted on his destruction, saying ' ' If you allow him to escape, your lives will go for his life as you will show yourselves thereby to be an enemy to the Emir of Ilorin." This decided the men of Gbodo; in order to save themselves they took up arms against the fallen general and overwhelmed him and his faithful few, the brave man himself falling under a shower of darts fighting gallantly at the head of his little band. His head was taken off, raised upon a pole and carried in triumph to the camp and from thence to Ilorin ; OdQewu his eldest son and some of the distinguished war-chiefs who were taken being compelled to ride behind it in order to grace the triumph of the conquerors.

On the 3rd day after their arrival at Ilorin Oduewu succeeded in purchasing the head of his father and had it decently buried to save himself from disgrace.

After the fall of Gbogun, Siyenbola returned the second time to Ikoyi. Fasgla the Bale of Esiele, who had escaped with his family and a few followers to Ogbomgso, also returned to his town. On his way to E§i§le, he was the guest of Siy§nbola the Onikoyi

for three days. He and his sons Sinolu and Abgsede and his eldest daughter Omotajo were feasted on the flesh of an elephant just killed and brought to the Onikoyi. This was regarded as an auspicious omen.

§ 5. The Pole War and the Death of the Abuousalami

The Fulanis having subdued all the chiefs in Yoruba proper and reduced the large towns by conquest or annexation, his ambition led Abudusalami to turn his attention to the Ijesa tribes for conquest, and hence he sent an expedition to that province.

The Fulanis depended more on their cavalry than on their infantry, the latter being armed with only a sword and a club. In a country with primitive forests like those in the Ijesa province horses were of no avail, and hence the Ijesas chased the enemy in their mountain tracks and cut in pieces the greater part of their horsemen. In pursuing their foot soldiers, they cry after them " Pole, Pole," which in their dialect means Down, Down. From this circumstance this expedition was termed the Pol^ war.

After the return of this expedition Abudusalami fell sick and died. He was a successful king who raised the Fulani power to that pitch of glory which Ilorin has attained.

The late Abudusalami and Shitta were the children of the slave wife of Alimi and being the two eldest they naturally took the lead.

On their father's death Abudusalami divided his property into four equal parts, called all his brothers to take each one his portion beginning from the youngest. His half brothers took theirs and went away, but as Shitta was about to take his Abudusalami stopped him and sent him away with a walking stick. With the slaves and riches of himself and his brother, he kept up his royal estate and had sufficient means to carry on the war and to effect the conquest of Yoruba proper and hence at his death the throne and the property devolved upon Shitta, the half brothers having no longer any claim. Abudusalami hereby secured

the throne of Ilorin to his own and his brother's descendants to the total exclusion of the half brothers and the succession to this day alternates between the family of the two.

The children of the lawful wives (especially those of the Fulani lady) considered the throne theirs by right, but as they could not claim anything of the royal estates they were excluded from the throne as well. Abudusalami was succeeded by his brother Shitta. Olusi the Bale of Ogbomgso also died about this time.

Chapter X

THE SPREAD OF ANARCHY AND POLITICAL DISPLACEMENTS

§ I. The Destruction of Egba Towns

We have seen above (Chap. VII) that after the fall of Owu, and the punishment inflicted upon some Egba towns for secretly befriending the beleagured city, the camp at Idi Ogugun broke up, and the leading Ife and Ijebu generals returned home to their respective masters, but the rest of the aUied armies with the Oyo refugees were invited by the Ijebus to Ipara, a town of Ijebu Remg. Making this place their headquarters, these restless bands of marauders found occupation for their arms in conquering and subjugating several towns in Ijebu Rem.o under the Awujale of Ijebu Ode, viz Ode, Iperu, Ogere and Makun.

Pretext was soon found for waging war with the Egbas who were then living in small villages scattered all over the area between Ipara and Ibadan. Several expeditions were made from their base at Ipara, and Iporo, Eruwon, Oba, Itoko, Itesi, Imo, Ikereku, Itoku, etc., were taken.

The following are the names of the distinguished war-chiefs in this campaign : — Oyo chiefs — Oluyedun, Lakanle, Oluyole, Adelakun, Opeagbe, Abitiko, YSmati, Oluoyg, Koseiko, Abidogun, Apksa, Osun, Laleitan, Bankole, Fadeyi Ogani-ija, Agbeni, etc.

All these chiefs oined the allied army as private soldiers, but the fortunes of war raised them to positions of great distinction. Notwithstanding this, they were looked down upon by the Ife and Ijebu leaders under whose auspices they joined the war against Owu, and had no voice in their councils. But they were soon to show their superiority.

Ife chiefs — Maye (the generahssimo in the absence of Singusin) Ogugu, Derin-Okiin, Labgsinde, Ogini, Aregbe, Olufadi, Degoke, Kugbayigbe, Oluygde, Epo, Kudayisi.

Ijebu chiefs — Kalejaiye, Amoibo, Osunlalu, Oguade, Argwgsanle,

Rich with the booty of these expeditions, and finding no fresh fields of operation for their arms they decided to disband the army. The Ijebu war chiefs returned home and the Ifes set out to return by way of Oorun ; the Oygs who had nowhere to go to

accompanied them. There were thousands of Oyos already in Ife districts.

At 06run (a Gbagura town) they found fresh employment for their arms when the men of that place refused them a passage. Another circumstance also occurred which hastened the siege of Oorun and the fall of the remaining Egba townships.

A dispute arose between the people of Idomapa a neighbouring town and the Gbaguras about territorial limits which at length broke out into war and Oluwole the king of Idomapa who was the weaker of the two combatants asked the aid of Labgsinde one of the leading Ife war-chiefs, and through him the rest of the Ife and Oyo war-chiefs against Ajiboso the king of the Gbaguras. The allies encamped at Idomapa and Oorun was the scene of conflict, where the Gbaguras concentrated all their forces to oppose the Idomapas and their allies.

The Gbagura army was swelled by re-inforcement from Ika, Owe Ikija, Iwokoto. The contest was furious and one Oga Oh5roagallantwar-chiefgreatlydistinguishedhimself in the defence of 06run. As long as he could handle his bow and arrows, the enemy was kept at bay ; but he fell in an engagement, and at the same time famine had commenced its direful work, and so the assailants successfully reduced the town.

As their fighting men had all fallen at Oorun the conquest of all the rest of the Gbagura towns was complete. Oorun when captured was fired ; being a town situated on a high hill, the conquerors were able by the aid of the light to pursue their victory to the next town which they found deserted, and so on to the next and the next until they reached Ojoh6.

The towns deserted and overrun that night were Oorun, Ijaiyemaja, Kosi-kosi, Ikerekuiwere, Ora, Ibadan. Ofa and Oje were also deserted, but the conquerors did not know of this till three days after as they lay outside their line of march.

From Ibadan they followed up the conquest to Ojokodo Iwohaha, and Eguoto ; all these places were deserted and plundered in one night and by the dawn of day they were before 0]6h6. Ojghb offered a stout resistance and being weary from long marches the conquerors retired to find a resting place. Of all the towns overrun the previous night, Ibadan alone they found not destroyed by fire, and so this marauding band hastily occupied it, the war-chiefs taking possession of any compound they chose, and their men with them and thus Ibadan was again re-peopled but not by the owners of the town, but by a composite band of marauders, consisting of Oyos, Ifes, Ijebus, and some friendly Egbas, Maye a bold and brave Ife chieftain being their leader. Next to him

was Labgsinde also an Ife, but, through his mother, of Oyo descent. These two leaders were men of different character and opposite temperament. Maye was of an irritable temper, in manners rough and domineering, and never failed at all times to show his contempt for the Oyos, chiefly because they were homeless refugees. At the head of the Oyos was Lakanl^ a bold and brave leader who alone of all the Oyo war-chiefs could venture to open his mouth when Maye spoke. Labosinde on the contrary was most agreeable and very fatherly in his manners and therefore much respected by all.

Ibadan now became the headquarters of these marauders from which place Ojoho was besieged and at length taken. At this time also Ikeiye Owe and a part of Ika were deserted ; the Ika people escaping to Iwokoto. All these were Eeba villages of the Gbagura section.

§ 2. Foundation of the Present Abeqkuta

As stated in the preceding section there were some friendly Egba chiefs who joined the marauders at Idi Ogiigun and at Ipara, and now they were all living together at Ibadan. The most influential among them were : — Lamgdi, Apati, Ogunbona, Oso, Gbewiri, and Inakoju. OgQdipe, who afterwards became a notable chief at Abeokuta was then but a blacksmith and a private soldier.

Rivalry was so rife among these various tribes that altercations were frequent, and one led to a civil war. In a public meeting held at the Isale Ijebu quarter of the town, Lamodi an Egba chief shot Ege an influential Ife chief down dead with a pistol, and in the commotion which ensued Lamodi himself was slain. For fear of the Ifes avenging the death of Ege the Egbas withdrew in a body from Ibadan and encamped on the other side of the Ona river, about 3 or 4 miles distant Here also they were ill at ease and after divination they sent for one Sodeke to be their leader, and they escaped to Abeokuta then a farm village of an Itoko man, and a resting place for traders to and from the Oke Ogun districts. Sodeke was at the head of this new colony until his death. This was about the year 1830 They were continually swelled by Egba refugees from all parts of the countr}^ and also by Egba slaves who had deserted their masters. At Abeokuta the refugees kept together according to their family distinctions, viz. : —

1. The Egba Agbeyin comprising Ake the chief town, Ijeun, Kemta, Imo, Igbore, etc. These were under the Alake as chief.
2. Egba Agura (or Gbagura) comprising Agura the chief town Ilugun, Ibadan, Ojohg, Ika, etc., under the Agura as chief.
3. Egba Oke Ona with Oko the chief town. Ikija, Ikereku, Idomapa, Odo, Podo, etc., under the Osile as chief.

Here also the Owus joined them, one common calamity throwing them together. It was some considerable time after that Ijaiye joined them, and so by degrees all the Egba townships about 153 became concentrated at Abeokuta, the new town comprising Ijemo Itoko and a few others who were already on the spot.

Until the death of Sodeke in A.D. 1844 the Egbas never spoke of having a king over them, Sodeke wielding supreme power in a very paternal way. Of external relations, very little (if any) existed, each of these families managed its own affairs, and there was no properly organized central government.

Even after the foundation ot Abeokuta there were still some Egbas residing at Ibadan. Egba women also who were unable or unwilling to go with their husbands to the new settlement were taken as wives by the new colonists at Ibadan and they became the mothers of most of the children of the first generation of the new Ibadan.

From this it will be seen that the current tale of the Egbas being driven from Ibadan by the Oygs is lacking in accuracy. Such then is the foundation of the present Abeokuta.

§ 3. The Egbado Tribes

The Egbados are a Yoruba family bordering on the coast. They were very loyal subjects of the AlAfin^ before the revolution that altered the pohtical state of the country. The Olu or king of Ilaro was the greatest king of the Egbados, having about 443 ruling chiefs under him, himself a crowned vassal of Oyo. The ancient custom was for the Alafin to crown a new Olu every three years. After the expiration of his term of office the retiring Olu was to take 10 of his young wives, and whatever else he chose and proceed to the metropohs, and there to spend the rest of-his days in peace. There was a quarter of the city assigned to them known as Oke Olu (the quarter of the Olus).

The parting between these young wives and their mothers was most touching. The relatives generally accompanied them as far as to Jiga or Jakg, and the wailings and lamentations on such occasions were as one mourning for the dead. Hence the sa5nng

^ In the year 1902 the head chief of Ifo died, an Egbado town about 6 hours distant from Ilaro. Sir Wm. MacGregor, then Governor of Lagos, asked the chiefs of the town who their overlord was, to appoint a successor, they replied the Alafin of Oyo. He was much puzzled at this. He told them he was too far, they had better apply to the Alake of Abeokuta. Evidently they at least were not affected by the revolution.

" A ri erinkan I'Egba iri Olu " (the Olu is seen by the Egbas but once in ahfe time).

Next to the Olu of Ilaro came the Onisare or king of Ijana, but his was not a crowned head. The appointment of the Onisare was also from Oyo, and a Tapa was always selected for that office. The reason for this is not known. The Olu and the people of Ilaro, as well as the Onisare and the people of Ijana were so to speak but one people ; they observed the same national customs, and the same laws, their national deity was the god Ifa and the annual festivals in its honour were observed in both places one after the other in the same month, each lasting for a week, the one commencing the day after the completion of the other so as to give the people of both places an opportunity of taking part in each other's festivities.

The following ceremony usually brought the anniversary to a close : — ^Both these kings were to meet in a certain place in the open field midway between the two towns : two mounds of earth previously raised opposite each other served for each king to enthrone himself upon, the one turning his back to the other as they were not to see each other's face. The one to reach the spot first would sit with his face turned homewards, the other on his arrival does the same, and thus they sit back to back, each one looking homewards ; communication with each other was by messengers. A numerous retinue always attended either to take an active part in the proceedings or as mere spectators.

This custom served as a bond of union and friendship between them, a people having identical interests.

The kings of Ijakoand Jiga are called Abepa : they had a strange custom of standing seven days and seven nights in the seventh month of the year during the anniversary of their national deity, after which they may sit down.

The Egbados were a commercial people and of a quiet and peaceful disposition and. as a result, were considered very wealthy. They termed themselves "Egbaluw§" to distinguish them from the Egbas in forest lands (now inhabiting Abeokuta) whom they designated " Egbalugbo." They traded in kola nuts, palm oil, and fish. They had very few slaves, and their wealth consisted in beads and native cloths. From Kano and Sokoto they imported what they termed Erinla and Esuru beads in quantities, as they esteemed them very valuable.

The Beginning of Disturbance in the Egbado Districts. The Ijaka War. A serious complication arose between the people of Ijana and Ijaka which ended in the conquest and fall of

this peaceful tribe. War was very foolishly declared against Ijaka by the Onisare of Ijana which resulted in the defeat ot the aggressor.

There was a rich and influential chief at Ijana called Dekun, in whom the Ijanas trusted when they rashly declared war, not knowing that he was a great coward. At the height of the battle Dekun dastardly gave way and the IjcLnas were completely routed. He escaped to Oniyefun and those who like himself escaped with their lives murmured against him, and even insulted him to his face, calling him " white-feathered," " a poltroon," " the cause of their defeat." Dekuri was offended at this, and more from shame than from the insult he resolved never to return to Ijana. He remained at Oniyefun for a considerable time, until a war (which we shall notice afterwards) met him there.

On the return home of the remnants of the defeated IjSnas Dekun's house was plundered.

Dekun afterwards spent several years at Ijaka with whose king he contracted friendship, and later perhaps in order to avenge the insults received, he took refuge with the king of Dahomey whom he asked to espouse his cause. The king of Dahomey destroyed Inubi where thousands of Oyo refugees made their home ; of these about 13,000 were children or grandchildren of Oyo nobles or well-to-do people " whose fathers had kept horses " before the devastation of the Yoruba country by the Fulanis. They were all put to the sword by the Dahomians with the exception of one Ekuola to whom Dekun was under some obligation, and he evidently interposed and had his life spared. Thus did Dekun resent his so-called insdlt. Such was the beginning of the fall of this peaceful Egbaluwe tribe, and the inroads of the Dahomians into the Yoruba country.

Two years after the destruction of Inubi, the king of Dahomey took Refurefu by capture in war.

A Short Account of Dekun. Dekun was an Ilari of Oyo, placed at Ijana by one of the AlAfins as the King's representative. Instead of upholding the King's interests when the great chiefs of the kingdom rebelled against their sovereign, he also rebelled against his master, and made himself great at Ijclna, by appropriating all taxes and tributes he should have forwarded to Oyo. He joined the marauders at Ipara in the devastation ot the Egba principalities, but at the occupation and settlement of Ibadan he returned to Ijana, and did not reside with the new settlers. In one of their expeditions Sodeke was captured by him, and served him for years as his horse boy. But providence destined Sodeke for a great position in life and hence he eventually became the renowned leader of the Egbas to Abeokuta.

Dgkun was rich but childless, although he kept a numerous harem. There is a story told in connection with him which is worth recording : —

A woman ot an abandoned character called Isokun had left her husband and children at Ipokia to become Dekun's mistress. This woman on one occasion went on a long journey and required some justification for her prolonged absence ; on her way home, she saw at the last sleeping place of the caravan, a mother with her new born babe 3 days old, she quietly stole this babe from its mother's side while she was fast asleep, and immediately went off with it. On reaching home she gave it as an excuse for her long absence that she was enceinte of this child before she left home, and when she might have returned she was unfit for travelling but immediately after delivery she was able to hasten home.

Dekun rejoiced that after all he was now a father and to demonstrate his joy he invited all the principal men and chiefs of Ijana and of the adjacent towns to a feast held in honour of the event. Presents poured in from

every rank and station for the child and the supposed mother according to the father's dignit}' and every care and attention were bestowed on them.

Meanwhile the real mother was in eager search for her lost baby. She at first supposed that it might have been a wolf that snatched it away from her side, and consequently she explored the surrounding woods if haply she might find the bones. Failing in this she was resolved to seek for it in the town ; and taking it quarter by quarter she entered every house asking the mothers to produce their babies, in order to identify her own. On the i8th day of search she reached Dekun's house and discovered her baby with Isokun. Then there arose an uproar about the child and a regular " to do " about the whole affair with assertions and denials on either side. A proper investigation of the case having been instituted, and signs of recent delivery not found in Isokun she was thus brought to book ; the whole truth was at length extorted from her when her arms were bound behind her back with a new rope, till both elbows and wrists met.

From shame she escaped from Ijana to her former home at Ipokia where she had left her sons and daughters to become D§kun's mistress. Her name was put to vulgar street songs, being branded as a man-stealer.

Dekun lived in Dahomey till the accession of King Atiba of the present Oyo who demanded him from the King of Dahomey, and he was given up. He was charged as a rebel and a traitor, condemned, and pubhcly executed at the market-place. The sentence was universally held to be a just one.

Dekun it seems had a son called Onibudo ; perhaps an adopted one as is customary with childless chiefs ; his life was spared, but he was degraded by the AlAfin and the mean title of Agbomopa was conferred on him and his descendants.

§ 4. The Founding of Modakeke

By the Fulani conquest of all the principal towns in Yoruba proper, fugitives from all parts escaped southwards and settled in all Ife towns except at He Ife the chief town. They were in great numbers at Moro, Ipetumodu, Odiiabon, Yakioy6, Ifa-lende, Sope, Waro, Ogi as well as in Apomu and Ikire.

Just about the time of the Lasinmi war a Mohammedan at Iwo called Mohomi invited the Folanis of Ilorin to extend theii conquest to the towns of these Eastern districts, as the Oyos were then engaged in a civil war. The Ilorin army accordingly came and overran the above mentioned towns. The latter made no attempt at resistance but simply deserted their towns and with all the Oyo refugees escaped to He Ife their chief town and were well received and protected by Aldnmgyero (aUas Odunle) the then reigning Ow6ni of Ife. The most important Oyo chief amongst the refugees was the Asirawo, the king of Iraw6.

Before long, a feeling of disaffection became evident between the Ife citizens and the exiles. The Owoni spared the Ife refugees, but enslaved all the Oyos making them " hewers of wood and drawers of water " after having murdered the Asirawo their chief. One ot the Asirawo's sons enslaved was the afterwards renowned chieftain of Modakeke, Ojo Akitikori by name.

The Oyos built their houses, cleaned their farms and performed all sorts of menial work for them. This was towards the close of Akinmoyer6's reign. Gbanlare who succeeded him was more favourably disposed towards the Oyos, and they now received better treatment, but this was not for long. Gbegbaaje succeeded Gbanlare, and the bad feeling and cruelty against Oyos were revived ; many of them were even sold into slavery. This king also was soon murdered.

Winmolaje who succeeded Gbegbaaje utilized the services of these Oyos in repelling the inroads of the Ijesas into his territory. From appreciation of their services, he was kindly disposed toward them ; but the hatred and malice of the Ife citizens generally was so strong that not even the well-disposed could curb the virulence of the opposite party.

A pretext was soon found again for murdering the well disposed Ow6ni. Adegunle succeeded to the throne: he was partly of

Yoruba descent on the mother's side and hence was the benefactor of the Oyos all his days.

Before he accepted the crown of Ife he made the chiefs take an oath that they would not find a pretext for murdering him as they did his predecessors, but would allow him to die a natural death ; they readily agreed to this request. Soon after his accession knowing full well the disposition of his people, he took the precaution at once of accumulating ammunition of war, in order to make himself strong against any attack from the populace. He was not of a warlike disposition but was rather given to agricultural pursuits ; hence his nickname " Ab'ewe ila gbagkdk gbagada " (one whose okra leaves are very broad) from his garden plantations.

The Oyos were by this time growing to be an important section in the community, having for their chief one Wingbolu a smelter of iron.

The Ife nature and spirit of the times soon became evident. Notwithstanding the oath, a pretext was soon found for a civil war against their king, but he was too strong for them; he defeated and suppressed all the refractory chiefs among them.

After the civil fight the Owoni called Wingbolu and asked him why he and the Oyos were neutral at the time of the insurrection. He replied boldly " Had I been invited by your opponents, does your majesty think yoa would have proved victorious ? Or if you had invited us, would not 3''our victory have been more complete? "

Thinking over these significant remarks the Owoni who had some strains of Oyo blood in him was resolved not on exterminating these Oyos as some others would have done but rather on emancipating them. He appointed them a settlement outside the walls of the city deputing one Adewgro to accompany Wingbolu to the site and mark out the settlement. On the Oyo chief himself he conferred the title of Ogunsuwa signifying One whom Ogun (the god of war) has blessed with a fortune. That has become the title of all the chief rulers of Modakeke to this day.

By a royal proclamation all Oyos were to leave the city of He Ife for the new settlement, and accordingly the settlement grew rapidly from new arrivals every day. The new settlement was named Modakeke, a term said to have been derived from the cry of a nest of storks on a large tree near the site.

Modakeke was first built in a circular form as a single vast compound of about 2 miles in circumference ; the enclosed area was left covered with trees and high grass, each individual clearing out a small space in front of his dwelling. This was done for the sake of mutual protection as no one need to go out of the com-

pound for sticks or thatch for roofing purposes. Modakeke was in 1884 a town of between 50,000 and 60,000 inhabitants.

By dwelling in a separate settlement it was not meant that they should hold themselves independent of the Ifes. They were still loyal to the Ow6ni.

A sedition was again raised for the purpose of murdering the Ow6ni for emancipating the Oyos, but he receiving help from the new settlement crushed the rising completely, and all the ringleaders were put to death among whom was the son of a rich lady called Olugboka.

As Ab'ewe-ila could not be murdered by force of arms, the Ifes finally succeeded in poisoning him and the first intimation the settlers had of the death of their benefactor was from the street song of the Ifes " They are deprived of their King, woe betide the Oyos."

The late king was denied a royal funeral, and was buried like any common man and all his slaves were seized b}- the Ifes, but the Oyos amongst them went over in a body to the new settlement.

Modakeke was soon besieged by the Ifes, but they were repulsed with a heavy loss in dead, wounded, and captives. The Modakekes captured aboat 12070 of them, but they had not the heart to enslave their former masters and benefactors and hence all were released. Thirty days after this defeat, one Ogunmakin an Ife chief receiving re-inforcement from Oke Igbo, Modakeke was again attacked. The Ifes were again badly beaten and they were pursued right home, and the city of Ife taken by an assault. The victors now ventured to sell their Ife captives as slaves, but reserved of their women-folks for wives. The Ifes escaped to Isoya, Oke

Igbo, and other Ife towns where they remained for many years till about the year 1854 when the Ibadans were engaged in the Ijebu Ere war. Chief Ogunmola of Ibadan sent messengers from the camp to negotiate terms ot peace and bring the Ifes home, as it would never do to let the cradle of the race remain perpetually in desolation and the ancestral gods not worshipped. Kubusi was the then reigning Owoni who could no longer remain in exile, but promised that if allowed to return home the past would be obliterated ; no restitution of anything will be demanded of the Modakekes, not even of their wives who might have been appropriated.

But no sooner did they return home than all the Ife women deserted their present husbands with all the children born to them and returned to He Ifg.

Notwithstanding their present relations the Modakekes still acknowledged the supremacy of the Ifes and by mutual arrange-

ment they had their representatives in the If e assembly. Thus they Uved together harmoniously till the year 1878 when the whole of the Yoruba country was again embroiled in war, and the latent animosity broke out afresh in an open fight, and the If§s were again worsted as we shall noti e hereafter.

Chapter XI THE REVOLUTION IN THE EPO DISTRICTS

§ I. The Destruction of the Epos and the Death of Ojo Amepo

Notwithstanding the Fulani devastations, there were not wanting still among the Yorubas powerful generals, who could successfully oppose them if only they would act together. One such was Ojo Amepo the Kakanfo.

Ojo Amepo was one of the generals of the late Kakanfo Afonja of Ilorin ; he inherited the lion-like spirit of his chief. After the fall of Afonja he resided at Akese, where he found employment for his enterprising spirit in waging intestine wars with the Epos, and became a great man and a terror in that district. Thus Ojo Amepo usurped the prerogatives of the AlAfin in that district. He took Iware, Okiti, Ajerun, Koto, Ajabe, towns near Ijaye, and he assumed the title of Kakanfo in opposition to Edun of Gbogun whom, however, he survived (as Edun himself formerly did in opposition to Toyeje of Ogbomoso) showing the state of anarchy in the kingdom as there can be but one Kakanfo at a time.

Amepo was a good horseman and an intrepid warrior. Ago was one of the towns in the Epo district. Oja the founder perished at the Kanla war as we have already noticed, and the only man of power then in that town was Prince Atiba formerly of Gudugbu, and he was in friendly alliance with the Ilgrins and abetted them, when they were resolved upon subjugating the Epds.

Chiefs Amepo, Salako, and Ojomgbodu were opposed to the Ilorins, and the latter soon found a pretext to wage war upon them and to destroy their towns.

The Ilorins encamped at Ago Oja against Ojomgbodu which was about 6 or 7 miles distant. The Kakanfo at Akesfe sent Dado his commander-in-chief at the head of a detachment to reinforce the beleaguered town ; associated with Dado were Adekambi, Soso, Dese and Lagbayi, all distinguished men. A portion of the Ilorin army was encamped against Wonworo at the same time, and the Kakanfo also sent Ayo another distinguished war chief to protect the place. Both these places were obstinately defended and, but for the tragedy which befell the Kakanfo at home, they might have held out longer even if they could not repel the enemy eventually.

Amepo the Kakanfo being anxious about his men when he heard no news from the seat of war, rode out one morning dressed in his red uniform with only about 20 boys as his attendants. He took the path leading to the seat of conflict to listen if perchance he would hear the sound of musketry showing that his people were still holding out and the town not yet taken.

He dismounted under a large tree in the fields, and most unfortunately for him was discovered from afar by a company of Ilorin horsemen, who had made excursion into the W6nw6ro farms, and were returning to their camp at Ago-Oja by way of Akesfe. He found himself in a predicament all too late, his body guards were, alas ! too young to defend him, and his corpulency prevented him from springing at once upon his horse

and making good his escape. So he was slain there under the tree, and his head and hands were cut off and carried in triumph to the camp before Ojomgbodu. But before doing so, the Ilorin horsemen rode back to Akese and called upon the town to surrender under threats of immediace destruction. The Kakanfo being slain, and the war-chiefs absent at Ojomgbodu, the town Akese surrendered at discretion ; but as soon as the horsemen were gone the inhabitants packed up and deserted the town.

The Kakanfo s army at Ojomgbodu of course did not know of the tragedy that had befallen their master at home until they were informed the next morning in the battlefield by the Ilorin horsemen taunting them. To confirm the truth of their statement, Amepo s speckled hand which was cut of! was thrown to them within the town wall for identification. " Know ye whose hand that was ? We have slain your master ! What is the use of further fighting ? Woe betide you if you do not surrender at once." The men were panic stricken and would have fled there and then but for the presence of mind and brave speech of Dado the commander-in-chief. He said to them " The death of our master is no reason why we should give way, let us fight like brave men and not show the white feather." Turning to the besiegers he said " We are here to defend the town not our master whose misfortune is only an incident though a lamentable one. You prepare yourself for a battle to-morrow, for you shall receive such a severe encounter as you have never experienced before ; you will then know how brave men can resent treachery." This speech created order among the troops and the Ojomgbodu people also were re-assured ; but it was only a ruse in order to make good their escape, for by daybreak, before the Ojomgbodu people knew that they were deserted. Dado had retreated with his army in good order and escaped to Ika-Odan.

§ 2. The Occupation of Ijaye and end of Dado

Ika-Odan now became the home of the flower of the army from the Oyo provinces. The leaders here were the only brave generals who would not submit under the yoke of the Ilorins, and who held out still until such time that fortune would veer round to their side.

These refugees soon became masters of the town, the wives and daughters of their hosts became theirs, and the hosts themselves practically their menials.

Everything at home and in the farms was soon devoured as they lived only by foraging. When nothing remained in the Ika-Odan farms they extended their operations into the Ijaye farms. When the I j ayes could no longer endure it, and their farms were nearly all eaten up they attacked these marauders ; a skirmish ensued and the foragers finding the men of Ijaye too strong for them, sent home for re-inforcements.

Kurumi's advice was for conciliatory measures, considering that these proceedings were rather hard on the people, who really could not help attacking the foragers. But Dado their leader was for opposition. " Cowards " said he, " what can the I j ayes do ? " Saying this, he hastily put on his armour and rushed on to the scene of the conflict. He was allowed to go on alone, none of the other war-chiefs followed him.

The foragers seeing their leader coming were inspirited and put forth more efforts, and he led them to victory. They drove the Ijayes home, and pressed so closely on their heels that the latter could not rally to defend the town, but deserted it and fled on, till they escaped to Ika-Igbo. Ijaye now fell into the possession of the assailants who did not fire it, but simply occupied it as was done at Ibadan, each one taking possession of the finest compound he could get.

Dado now sent to invite Kurumi and the rest of the war-chiefs at Ika-Odan, and they came and took possession of Ijaye. Thus that town passed out of the hands of the Egbas, and became an Oyg town to this day.

At a special meeting convened to consider their future course it was resolved that they should make Ijaye their home at least for the present until they could see a brighter prospect of dislodging the Fulanis from Ilorin and then return to their own homes. They therefore took possession of the lands and farms along with the houses and proceeded to so.v the farms, lest famine should follow the present abundance. Thus they became proprietors of houses, lands and farms not their own. The fields

were extensively cultivated, all the war-chiefs with the sole exception of Dado their leader, paid great attention to agriculture, going to their farms daily.

Dado was of a more restless spirit and was indifferent to agriculture. Nothing delighted him more than the rattle of musketry, for he was never in his element unless he was at the head of his army directing a battle. He often frightened his people home from farm, mistaking the volleys Dado ordered to be fired for an attack on the town. The other war-chiets petitioned him again and again not to cause such an alarm, but he usually replied in a haughty manner: " Cowards, were I such as you I could not have brought you here, when yoi" wished to negotiate peace with the aborigines."

Casting this at their teeth day by day, his colleagues felt hurt but were afraid of opposing him till one day Kurumi summoned up courage to do so and was backed by the other chiefs, a civil war ensued and Dado was expelled the town.

Dado's Later Career. — To trace the subsequent career of Dado we have to anticipate some events of history yet to be narrated.

Dado was bold and brave as a warrior, but in his disposition, he was irritable and very proud. On his expulsion from Ijaye he went first to Iware, and from thence he crossed the river Ogun going to a small town near Isede called Tobalogbo. He encamped outside the town walls with his few followers, and sent to apprise the Bale of his arrival. His fame as a great warrior having travelled far and wide the Tobalogbo treated him with every mark of respect, supplying him and his followers with provisions, and on the next day he came out with his chiefs to pay his respects to the fallen general.

Whilst the Bale and chiefs prostrated before this monster in the act of salutation, he ordered them all to be decapitated ! He and his men then rushed into the town and captured it. He cared only for the booty and not for making it his residence ; he, therefore, passed on to the town of Aborerin near Iberekodo and there he built a house and resided with his family and about 400 men. Subsequently he left Aborerin with his family and belongings and wishing to try the fortunes of war once more, he joined an Ibadan contingent under Osun the chief of the Ibadan cavalry in an expedition in aid of Oniyefun. When Osun fell in battle, and Oniyefun was reduced by the Egbas, he narrowly escaped with a handful of his men, leaving his wives and children at the mercy of the conquerors and escaped to Ijaka. Divine retribution now began to overtake him for his cruelties and for his heartless treachery and cold-blooded murder of Tobalogbo and K

his chiefs. He lost everything at Oiiiyefun, and from that time he went up and down the country as a " fugitive and vagabond." After some time spent at Ijaka he came to Ibadan ; he accompanied Lakanle the Ibadan commander-in-chief to the Arakanga war (to be related afterwards) ; on their leturn he went to Ilorin and returned again to Ibadan. Fortune was altogether against him He outlived his fame and glory, suffered from penury and want and was reduced to a nonentity.

After Lakanle's death, having no one to befriend him at Ibadan again, he went once more to Ijaye. Kurumi was then at the zenith of his glory, with the old animosity against Dado still rankhng in his breast. He sent for him one day and as Dado lay prostrate before him Kurumi ordered him to be decapitated !

Thus the same measure was meted to him, as he once meted to his hosts of Tobalogbo.

The Occupation of Abento, — Kuriimi of Ijaye was an arbitrary and domineering chief, and moreover tribal jealousies and clanship were rife among the chiefs who now occupy Ijaye as they were from different provinces and townships brought together here by one common calamity. Kurumi and the Ikoyi chiefs with him were from the MetropoHtan province.

The notable war-chiefs from Akes^ were : — Ay6, Adekambi, Ajadi, Sukotg, Bankgle, Lahkn, Aruno-agba-ni-igbe and Oluwol^. These chiefs from the Ep6 districts could not endure the hauteur of Kurumi who was backed up by the Ikoyi chiefs. They hold themselves superior to the Akes^ chiefs. Ikoyi was indeed the premier provincial city next to the Metropolis, and the Onikoyi the AlAfin's viceregent, but these chiets seem to have forgotten that they were no longer worthy of the honour they now claimed since they have become disloyal to the Crown.

However, in order to avoid a civil war from constant friction the above-mentioned Akes| chiefs with their men left Ijaye in a body and retired to Abem6, a town 12 miles distant (midway between Ijaye and the present Oyg) under the leadership of chief Ay6. We now have two rival towns, Ijaye occupied by the Ikoyi chiefs, and Abemo by the Akes^ chiefs,

§ 3. How Ibadan Finally Became a Yoruba Town

The Fall of Maye

The marauders who settled at Ibadan after the fall of Ooriin and all the Gbagura towns (as we have mentioned above) comprised the Ife, Ijebu, Qyo, and Egba chiefs with their men. Chief Maye an Ife was the acknowledged head of them all. He was a

proud, haughty, and irritable man, overbearing to all ; Lakanl§ the Oyo leader (as above mentioned) was the only man who could speak when May§ was in a rage. The Ifes generally regarded the Oyos of the settlement as slaves because they were homeless refugees ; they treated them httle better than they would dogs. Maye handled them with an iron hand, and denied them every security either of their goods or of their lives ; they were oppressed and beaten with impunity.

The Oyos, groaning under this yoke of bondage sought every opportunity for lifting up their heads, but the very name of Maye inspired such a dread in all, that no plan could be acted upon. The bards sang of him as the greatest general of the day, a man who commanded an amount of dread and respect, unsurpassed by any, etc. But, like Napoleon after Moscow, " From the highest to the lowest, there is but one ^tep ;" so it was with Maye. His fall was sudden and cornplete.

Two neighbours were quarrelling over a piece of ground used in common as a dunghill, one was an Own man, Amejiogbe by name, one of May§'s soldiers, the other an Oyo man ; both of them private soldiers. But as Oyos were treated like dogs, when Maye came out, he asked no questions about the case, but sided with the Owu man and simply drew his sword and cut off the headof the Oyoman. Instantly a hue and cry was raised, and an alarm given that Maye was putting all Oyos to death ! The Oyos became desperate, and all flew to arms. Maye was taken aback with surprise to see them making a dead set at him. They refused to hear his plea for selfdefence, and would not allow him to re-enter his house ; he was beset on every side and driven out of the town. He escaped on foot by the way of the present Abeokuta gate and crossed the river Onk followed by some of the If e chiefs e.g. Aponju-olosun, Aregbe Deriokun, etc.

After this, the Oyo chiefs began to feel ill at ease, and were the first to offer him terms of reconciliation. They knew his fame and valour and were trembling for the possible consequences. In the afternoon an embassy was sent to him with a humble apology and petition saying " Our Father should return home, our Father should not spend the night in the bush." He answered the messengers roughly and swore by the gods that he would surely destroy the town and that before long.

The next day higher grades of ambassadors were sent to sue for peace, and with them large baskets of provisions for himself and his followers because "Father must be hungry since yesterday." These were not even allowed to approach his camp, and some of the Oyos who accompanied him as personal friends sent privately

to apprise their country-men that it was of no use their waiting for an answer, the great chief would neither hsten to them nor even grant them an interview and it was in vain to hope that he would agree to return to Ibadan.

The ambassadors had to return home to report their ill success but they left behind all the provisions they took with them in hopes that his followers would take them away after they had gone.

The chiefs were much disappointed at this turn of affairs and blamed themselves for their rashness and instructed the ambassadors not to wait for further orders but that by early dawn they should proceed once

more and offer their humble submission and say that they would agree to any fine he would be pleased to impose upon them as a condition of his returning home.

In the meantime a meeting was convened to consider what further steps should be taken ; they decided to levy a tax upon all the people in order to raise money for the fine. But the messengers soon returned with a distressing report : — " The master's camp, has been broken up, the food they carried the previous day was left untouched, for hawks, crows, and vultures to feed upon, nor could anyone tell his route or destination ! "

It was surmised that he probably went to join the Egbas at Abeokuta to raise an army to fight them : but a few days after, a farmer reported that he saw a broad path leading to Idomapa in the south. Maye then was the guest of Oluwol^ of Idomapa, but the people of Erumu invited him to Erumu, offering him their support and friendship because his calamity was caused by his espousing the cause of an Owu man. We have seen above, that Erumu was the chief vassal state of Owu and that to this place the Olowu and his people escaped when the city of Owu was taken.

They were determined to avenge Maye's wrongs, and with such a distinguished commander on their side, they hoped to be able to annihilate these Oyo marauders, the principal agents in the destruction of their capital city.

Before they were prepared to lay siege to Ibadan, the Erumu people and their guests began at once to make predatory incursions into the Ibadan farms, kidnapping also the caravans with corn and other foodstuffs from Ikir^ so as to cut off theii food supplies and distress them by starvation before reducing them by war at the ensuing dry season.

This state of things continued nearly a whole year and during that time vast preparations were made to crush Ibadan by an overwhelming force. An alliance was formed with the Ife towns of Ikir^, Apomu, Ipetumodu and other towns in their neighbourhood, and a large army was raised against Ibadan. The Egbas

also were invited as allies, as all have their grievances to avenge on the new occupants of Ibadan. Two famous commanders Degesin and Ogini led the Egba contingents ; they marched through the Ibadan farms in the south to join the main army at Idomapa. The Gbanamu War. The Ibadan chiefs met this overwhelming force with courage and determination bat the odds were against them ; at every battle in spite of all they could do, they lost ground and the assailants advanced to within a mile or a mile and a half of the town. The Ibadans in their extremity were obhged to ask help from Kurumi of Ijaye who readily responded to their call. They were all one people whom a common calamity compelled to these parts, and they had to make a new home and defend it. Kurumi arrived at Ibadan on a Friday, but as Fridays were considered inauspicious days the Ibadan chiefs suggested that the fight should be postponed till the next day. Kurumi repHed, "It is true Fridays are inauspicious, but it is only so to aggressors, not to defenders of hearth and home." The last decisive battle then was fought on that day. It was a bloody day. Equal courage and valour were displayed on both sides, but in the end, though outnumbered by far, the superior military skill of Kurumi and the Ibadans won the day. For the Ibadans it was a life and death struggle, and because it was mostly a hand to hand fight in which swordsmen proved themselves a match for those with firearms the battle was named " Gba'namu " (grasping fire). Rushing upon their assailants sword in hand and grasping the barrel of the gun, the Ibadans averted the fatal discharge of the weapon while using their swords and cutlasses with effect. Thus the Ife, Owu, and Egba alUes were completely routed. Several of their leaders were made prisoners and put to death. Maye the great commander was taken prisoner by a common soldier, and as he was being led to the town all the war-chiefs refused to see his face.

It is a common belief amongst warriors in this country that any war-chief, who ordered a brother war-chief, his equal in arms, to execution, will surely meet with the same fate at no distant date. Therefore, although the whole of the chiefs desired his execution yet no one was bold enough to show his face and order it, and take upon himself the responsibility for what all desired. Both the captor and the captive fully understood the import of the phrase " Let him not see my face." It meant his death warrant. Maye therefore cried out : " E m.a da a se, E fi oju mi kan alagbk ! E ma da a se, E fi oju mi kan Lakanle. (Do not take the

responsibiUty, bring me before a chief ; do not take the responsibiUty, bring me before Lakanle) . But all in vain, his fate had been sealed by the chiefs declining to see him, and so the great Maye was

beheaded by a common soldier. Degesin and Ogini the Egba commanders also shared his fate.

Chief Kurumi claimed the honour of the victory and hence his bards sang to his praise "Opa Maye, o pa Ogini, O pa Degesin, O fi oko ti Ife laiyk" (he slew Maj^e, he slew Ogini and Degesin and thrust his spear into the bi easts of the Ifes).

By this victory the remnant of the Oyo refugees was saved.

The Erumu War

The victors followed up their victory and encamped against Erumu. Reinforcements came for them from Iwo, Ede, Apomu and other places ; the Oyo refugees in those parts joining their brethren at the siege of Erumu so that the doomed town was hemmed in on every side : indeed they had to fight from within their walls. As the besiegers could neither force the gates nor scale or beat down the walls, they were content to reduce the town by famine. The most disgusting creatures were used for food, and even greedily devoured in order to sustain life ! It passed into a proverb " When the price of a frog came to 120 cowries then Erumu was taken."

The siege of Erumu recalled that of Oke Suna in the fight between Solagberu and Abudusalami.

The following anecdotes illustrative of the horrors of the siege of Erumu were told by eye-witnesses : —

Corn planted within the walls of the town wanted but a few weeks for ripening when the famished inhabitants could no longer wait for a full corn, everyone helping himself not only to the immature corn but also the corn-stalks. It was so much relished that one of them was heard to say that he did not know before that corn stalks were so delicious and that henceforth he would ever be using it as an article of food.

Another reported the case of a good-looking and well-to-do young woman, a snuff seller, at Erumu. Before the war broke out, her beauty and style always attracted young men to her side in the shed where she was grinding and retailing snuff. Her stall was so clean and so well-poUshed that they required no mats to sit upon, they would just squat on the ground about her. This well-to-do woman was so famished that she died of starvation at her stall in the open thoroughfare, and of all her admirers not one was found to do her the honour of a burial !

Again, another eye-witness among the besiegers related that whilst bathing in a stream which flowed through the town to the camp, he often saw myriads of maggots which he could not account for as if the water bred them, but when Erumu was taken he saw

hundreds of putrefying bodies in the stream within the town and this accounted for the maggots he saw in such abundance lower down as the stream flowed by the camp.

On the town being taken the Oluroko (or king) of Erumu and the king of Idomapa were caught and slain. Also the Olowu was now caught who (cLs was related above) escaped thither when the city of Owu was destroyed. Now, he was a provincial King of great importance, a real crowned head, and his case caused the victors some embarrassment. No pure Yoruba would venture to lay hands on a king even if worthy of death ; in such an event the king would simply be told that he was rejected and, noblesse oblige, he would commit suicide by poison.

The Olowu, although now a prisoner of war, was regarded with so much reverence that none of the chiefs would dare order his execution, and yet they could not keep him nor would they let him go. His death was compassed in a diplomatic manner.

The conquerors pretended to be sending him to the Ow6ni ol Ife, who alone may be regarded as his peer in this part of the country, and he was to be accompanied by one of his own slaves as a personal attendant and by some messengers to the Owgni as his escort. But the slave, who was supplied with a loaded gun

as his master's bodyguard, had been privately instructed that at a given signal from the escort he was to shoot his master dead, and that he would be granted his freedom and loaded with riches as well. Thus they proceeded on their way until they came to the bank of the river Osun when the signal was given and the slave shot his master dead on the spot ! These "messengers" now set up a hue and cry of horror and surprise: " WTiat ! You slave ! How dare you kill your royal master ? Death is even too good for you." And in order to exonerate themselves of all complicity in the matter, they set upon the poor slave attacking him on all sides and clubbed him to death saying " The murder of the king must be avenged." They then dammed up the river in its course and dug the king's grave deep in the bed of it, and there they buried the corpse whilst uttering this disclaimer : —

" O King, we have no hands in your cruel murder. The onus of it rests with your slave and we have avenged you by putting him to death, and he is to be your attendant in the other world."

They then allowed the river to flow on in its channel over the grave. Burying the king in the bed of the river was regai ded as an expiation made for his murder, because they were conscious of guilt although they attributed the act to the slave. With such reverence and sanctity was the person of a king regarded. The divine right of kings is an article of belief among the Yorubas.

Such was the end of the last king of the famous city of Owu, The title is continued by a representative of the family at Abeokuta.

§ 4. The Settlement of Ibadan

After the fall of Erumu the war chiefs returned to Ibadan and the rest of the people who joined the war as volunteers returned to their respective homes. It was not till this time that Ibadan was peopled by Oyos chiefly. Everyone of these war-chiefs entered the allied army of Ife and Ijebu at Idi Ogugun as a private volunteer, but they soon showed their capabilities in the various wars. Oppressed and enslaved by the Ifes, scorned by the Ijebus, in pure self-defence they banded themselves together under a leader for mutual protection and notwithstanding the great disadvantage under which they were placed, they vindicated their superiority and at last obtained the ascendancy in the town.

Under such circumstances did the Oyos become masters of Ibadan. Hence the allegation that it was they who expelled the Egbas from their original home and took possession of the same is wholly inaccurate, and the bad feeling which this impression has created and perpetuated between the two peoples unto this day is hereby shown to be groundless.

Ibadan then consisted of the central market and about half, a mile of houses around. The town wall was where the principal mosque now stands.

Hitherto Ibadan has been occupied as a miUtary headquarter for marauding and other expeditions, but after this war, at a public meeting held to consider their future course, it was resolved that as they now intend to make this place their home they should arrange for a settled government and take titles. Oluyedun came first. He was the son of the late Afonja of Ilorin, and as such, the scion of a noble house. He was honoured and respected by all. He might have been the Bale, but he preferred to adopt his father's title of Kakanfo and it was conceded him, not for his valour, but for his age and dignity, being a survivor of the men of the preceding generation.

Next came Lakanle " the bravest of the brave." He might have taken the title of Balogun or commander-in-chief, as he had hitherto been their principal leader in M'ar, but Kakanfo being a miUtary title, that of Balogun would be superfluous. He then became the Otun Kakanfo and Oluyole the Osi Kakanfo.

The others were : Adelakun the Ekerin (fourth), Olumaiye the Ekarun (fifth) Abitiko Ekefa (sixth) Keiiihe Are Ah ese. To Osun was the honour given to confer these titles, and he in turn was created the Sarumi (chief of the cavalry). Only a single Ife

chief remained at Ibadan and that was Labosinde, and even he (as was mentioned above) had Oyg blood in

his veins through his mother. He was very gentle, good-natured and fatherly to all. Even during the days of Maye the Oyo chiefs had an affection and great respect for liim as a father. At the expulsion of Maye when the other Ife chiefs joined him, he took no sides and hence he was allowed to remain. After Maye's tall he did not aspire to the leadership of the people, preferring private life to the responsibilities of government. He was a man who loved peace; he would never carry arms nor allow any to be carried before him even in those turbulent days, except in the battlefield. A bundle of whips was all usually carried before him, as used to be done before the Roman Tribunes of old, and with this token of authority he was able several times to disband men in arms and put an end to civil fights. The combatants as soon as they saw the bundle of whips coming would cease firing, saying to one another '!Babambo " " baba mb‸" (father is coming, father is coming). His title now is Baba I sale i.e. chief adviser, lit father underneath (for counsel).

It will be noticed that (except this last) all the principal titles were military titles. Ibadan has kept that up unto this day.

Although they seemed to be now settled, yet they really lived by plunder and rapine. A single stalk of corn could scarcely be seen in an Ibadan farm in the days of Maye, and although Lakanle encouraged husbandry, yet the people were so much given to slave hunting that they could not grow corn enough for home consumption. The women of those days were as hardy as the men, and often went in a body — as caravans — to Ikird and Apomu for corn and other foodstuffs although the road was unsafe from kidnappers. They supplied the town with food whilst the men were engaged in slave himting. One company returning would meet another just going out, and often, an unsuccessful individual returning would go back with the outgoing company to try another chance without first reaching home. Ill-luck of one did not prevent another company venturing out.

At home violence, oppression, robbery, man-stealing were the order of the day. A special gag was invented for the mouth of human beings to prevent any one stolen from crying out and being discovered by his friends. No one dared go out at dusk for the men-stealers were out already prowling about for their prey. Thus even the great Maye was once stolen on going out one night. He offered no resistance but went quietly with the man-stealer, who, on reaching home, called for a light to inspect his victim. Finding to his dismay that it was the great

chief Maye himself, he nearly died of fright. Quaking and trembling he prostrated at his feet and begged for his life. So bad were those days at Ibadan and so callous had the people become that if a woman or a child was heard to cry out "Egbkmi, won mu mi o" (O help me, I am taken) the usual answer from indoors was " Maha ba a lo " (you can go along with him). The moral and social atmosphere of such a place as has been described could easily be imagined. Yet they were destined by God to play a most important part in the history of the Yorubas, to break the Fulani yoke and save the rest of the country from foreign domination ; in short to be a protector as well as a scourge in the land as we shall see hereafter.

A nation born under such strenuous circumstances cannot but leave the impress of its hardihood and warlike spirit on succeeding generations, and so we find it at Ibadan to this day. It being the Divine prerogative to use whomsoever He will to effect His Divine purpose, God uses a certain nation or individual as the scourge of another nation and when His purposes are fulfilled He casts the scourge away.

Chapter XII

WARS FOR THE CONSOLIDATION AND BALANCE OF POWER BETWEEN IBADANS, EGBAS AND IJEBUS

§ I. The Evacuation of Apomu

We have seen above that the people ot Apomu being Ifes alHed themselves with Maye at the Gbanamu war, hence after the destruction of Erunmu, they were afraid that the next wave will overwhelm themselves. They theiefore sent an Oyo resident at Apomu, chief Agbeni by name, to encamp on the further side of the river Osun as an outpost, to watch and report upon the movements of the Ibadan army.

But the Ibadans were not meditating any revenge on them; yet they were so ill at ease that they would not

even wait for a report from their outpost, but one chiet after another, one master of a large compound after another deserted the town for Ipetumodu till only the Oyo lefugees remained at Apomu.

At Ipetumodu they were however restless ; it seemed unreasonable that they should be famishing in another town when food could be obtained in their own farms ; therefore bands of pillagers and kidnappers issued daily from Ipetumodu to the Apomu farms destroying whatever they could not carry away. They also grew suspicious of Agbeni and sent a strong force to drive him away from the post where they had located him. But Agbeni was determined to maintain hisground, and he therefore despatched messengers to Ibadan to ask foi help. Only one desperate battle was fought between them, and the Ipetumodu men apprehending danger to themselves if they should wait to offer a second, as by that time reinforcements from Ibadan might have come, they retreated hastily home.

The Ibadan army arrived too late and were disappointed to find the Apomu army gone ; they were loth to return home empty handed as they lived by plunder, they therefore began to loot the houses of the residents at Apomu. But these were their kinsmen, the Oyo refugees who were left behind by the townsmen, and nearly every one of them saw a friend or a relative whom he was in duty bound to protect from violence and robbery. These relatives went over to them and with them to Ibadan. Lakanl^ their leader took away all his, and his friend Agbeni came over also

with him. Lanase went over with all his belongings to Osun the chief of the cavalry, and so Apomu became deserted.

Agbeni was located in Lakanle's farm and the site has since been included in the overgrown town and known as Agbeni 's quarter to this day with a market in front ot his house. Chief Agbeni survived Lakanle and all his contemporaries and died at a good old age in May i860.

Thus the Oyo refugees at Apomu were merged with the Ibadan settlers, and helped to swell the population of that important

The Ipetumodu and Owiwi Wars about A.D. 1819

The Apomu and Ipetumodu people having drawn attention to themselves, after a short respite the restless Ibadan chiefs declared war against Ipetumodu for allying with Apomu to kidnap the Ibadan caravans, who went to buy corn at Ikire, Iwo, He Igbo before the Erumu wars. Any pretext, however flimsy, would do when they were on mischief bent.

It was just at this time that the Ijebus declared war against Abeokuta, and sought the alliance of the Ibadans. But they could not send them adequate help and advised the Ijebus rather to wait a while and let them get Ipetumodu off their hands. But the Ijebus would not wait, the Ibadans, therefore had to send them a small contingent under one Olugun^. The last decisive battle between the Ijebus and the Egbas was the celebrated battle of Owiwi (a stream so called) where the Ijebus were sorely defeated; they lost all their principal fighting men and their power was completely crushed ! Olugunk with his small force escaped to Oniyefun a town on the right bank of the river Ogun where he remained for a long time, apparently seeking for an opportunity to return home.

The Ibadans on the other hand were successful in their own expedition, Ipetumodu was taken and those who escaped fled to He Ife their chief town.

§ 2. The Fall of Ilaro and Ijana

During the siege at Owiwi the Ijebus sought and obtained the alhance of the Egbaluwe kings. Abinuwggbo the Onisare of Ijana sent his forces under the command of two of his war-chiefs Lapala and Ajise ; the only war-chief remaining at home was Akere the Areagoro. Lapala fell in battle and the command devolved upon Ajige alone.

The Ilaros sent no re-inforcement because of a great disaffection among the people towards their Olu on account of his t5n-annies.

For a small matter which he might very well pass over, he would impose exorbitant fines, hence the affection ot his people was alienated from him and they were seeking an opportunity for his overthrow. His was a long reign, for this age of anarchy, and he did not retire to Oyo after three years, like his predecessors, to spend the rest of his days there as was customary. He became lame on both his feet, from poison by his people as was alleged.

A private message was sent to the Egbas by the people inviting them to come and rid them of their tyrant, thinking they would come and simply remove the Olu and leave them in peace. The Egbas thereupon sent from Owiwi a detachment of 134 men under chief Angba who entered Ilaro without opposition, fired it, and began to kill and plunder indiscriminately ! As the Egbas cared more for booty than for captives the Olu (their principal objective) had an opportunity for making his escape to Ifoin, being borne on a litter by his slaves, while most of the Ilaro people escaped to Ijana. A bride was said to be so frightened by the hasty flight that she fell down dead at the gate of Ijana, and was buried behind the house of one Tagi the gate-keeper.

They had scarcely had breathing time here when news came that the Egbas had gained a victory over the Ijebus at Owiwi and a rumour gained ground that they were coming to take vengeance on the 'Luwes of Ijana for allying themselves with the I j ebus. The consternation became general when Ajise the surviving war-chief arrived home. Neither the Ilaro refugees, nor the Ijana people themselves could stay in the town any longer, all sought safety in flight, and so Ij§,na was deserted. The flight took place on a dark and stormy night, and hundreds of people were groping in darkness trying to find the way to the town gate. Fortunately it was only a rumour or the Egbas might have met them within the town for at break of day the dawn found them at Dekun's quarters late of Ijana.

Ak^re the Areagoro the only war-chief left at home instead of preparing for the defence of the town deluded the people by having three lighted lamps burning at the three entrances to his house making it appear as if he was still at home whereas he had already escaped.

An incident of interest occurred during this flight. A child of about 3 years of age was found the next day at Afehinte weeping, its mother having disencumbered herself ot it in her flight. A kind-hearted man Ajayi by name took it up from pity and carried it in his arms wherever he went. They did not meet the Areagoro at Refvu-efu but joined him at Osoro ; there the heartless mother

seeing the child with Ajayi, claimed it but Ajayi refused to give it up till it was duly ransomed.

The refugees left Osoro for Ifoin where they met the 01 u and here they were resolved to wait and offer some resistance in case of an attack, as they were afraid to proceed to Porto Novo. The Olu, however, left Ifoin for Itoho his maternal town, where he would wish to die ; here Sodeke with an Egba army met him and he was taken with his family and slain. One Okete the executioner carried the head about at Refurefu for money ; at the gate of whomsoever the Olu's head was placed Okete received 3 heads of cowries before removing it. It was brought to Abeokuta and was buried at the threshold of the main entrance to Sodeke's house.

vSodeke took Ayawo the Olu's daughter to wife, but she had no child by him. After Sodeke's death she was " inherited " by Somoye, who subsequently became the Basorun of Abeokuta. She went with him to the late Ijaye war and was taken captive when Ijaye fell on the 31st March, 1862. The captor gave her up to Chief Ogumgla. She was sent back to her husband in the year 1865 and was the means of reconciliation between Ibadan and Abeokuta, after the return of the latter from the Ikorodu war. The accounts of these wars will be given below in due course. After Somoye's death Ayawo refused the hand ot Chief Ogundipe and went back to her early home at Ilaro where she died.

After the death of the Olu Asade at Itohg the Ilaro refugees at Idggo near Igbeji created another Olu, Ojo Kosiwon by name. For 19 years he reigned at Idogo and after his death there was an interregnum of many years.

Ilaro was, however, again repeopled but under Egba suzerainty, who created one Tela the Olu in 1857. Ilaro continued under the Egbas till the year 1891 when they gave themselves over to the British Government on

account of the incessant raids and molestations of the Dahomians from which their Suzerain failed to protect them. They now form a Protectorate in the " Western Waters " of Lagos.

§ 3. The Oniyefun War

After the return of the Ibadans from the Ipetumodu war, hearing of the disaster at Owiwi, and that their contingent under Oluguna had escaped to Oniyefun and was there hemmed in by the Egbas, some of the war-chiefs headed by Osun the chief of the cavalry, and Elepo also a great warrior, decided to go to their rescue. But Oluguna was met rather on the offensive, waging a desultory warfare in Egba territory. Being now re-inforced from home he commenced regular operations against the small and

weaker Egba towns such as Imosai, Iboro, and Jiga. Jakg was deserted and these marauders were infesting the Isaga farms and wou)d have taken Isaga had not the Egbas sent a strong force to protect the place.

After a short time, however, Elepo left them and returned to Ibadan and with him nearly all the other war-chiefs, as he was a man of great power and influence.

The army at Oniyefun being now considerably reduced in number, the Egbas attacked it in full force ; several battles were fought and the Egbas gained an advantage at every engagement. They succeeded in cutting off all supplies and in laying a close siege against Oniyefun. All the Ibadan common soldiers under colour of going foraging escaped from the doomed town one by one never to return, but the war-chiefs themselves, with their immediate followers and bodyguards, could not leave without attracting attention or creating a panic and a rush, with an immediate destruction of the town. Osun fell in an engagement ; being shot through the head he tumbled off his horse. Sogunro was wounded and Dado — late of Ijaye — who was also there, prevented Sogunro being taken to Jako as an invalid, lest they should lose the services of his fighting men. Dado remained the only warchief in command, but he was no longer the commander he once was before his fall. He held out for only five days longer, and then left Oniyefun secretly with the other war-chiefs and escaped to Ibadan, leaving Oniyefun at the mercy of the invaders.

The Ibadan war-chiefs who fell at Oniyefun besides Osun were : Sogunro, Keji, Ilupakin, lyanburu, Otopo, and Esan.

§ 4. The Arakanga or Jabara War

The Ibadan war-chiefs were indignant at the fall of their comrades at Oniyefun, especially Osun who was held in high esteem, and were bent on avenging his death. This was really the cause of the Arakanga war, and not in order to show that they were more powerful than the Ijebus as some have erroneously averred.

In this expedition they secured thealliance of Kurumi of Ijaye and Ayo of Abemo, whose contingent met the Ibadan army at Olokemeji.

This expedition was one of the most stupid ever undei taken by the Ibadans. Divided counsels prevailed and therefore no adequate preparation was made, one half of the so-called kegs of gunpowder carried before the chiefs contained nothing but yam flour, thereby deceiving the people who followed them. Some asserted that the Egbas were more afraid of poisoned arrows than of ballets and therefore never supplied themselves with fire-arms.

Others went just mechanically because they were obliged to go, but without any preparation. We may here notice that this is how the junior chiefs behave when the war is unpopular, for they dare not remain behind when the head-chiefs march out.

They marched out through the Ido gate and encamped by the Ogun river at Olokemeji for a long time till their stores were exhausted, and before the enemy was in sight ! Meantime their wives used the empty kegs as water pots.

After a long time they pushed forward towards Abeokuta, and the Egbas met them a great way off. Four hard battles were fought and the Egbas retreated to Arakanga, a river behind their town wall. Here the

Ibadans found themselves with their powder exhausted and no time to procure more from Porto Novo or Ado ; the arrows some depended upon were found to be of little use. Adekambi the war-chief sent from Abemo was the first to return home being disgusted at the conduct of the war. With him went a good many war-chiefs, and recruits which they met on their way back also returned home when they heard the ill report of the campaign.

Five days after Adekambi had left the Egbas appeared in full force, determined on death or victory. At a given signal by the sound of their god Or6 to which they responded with a shout, they made a sudden dash and attacked the enemy vigorously, cutlass in hand.

With their powder exhausted some of the Ibadans resorted to the gourd bark planted all over the battlefield, and with this they pelted their assailants. From this ciicumstance the campaign was termed the " Jabara war." At the height of the battle, Bada Akeyan one of the chief swordsmen fell ; and when another chief named Adelakun was mortally wounded, the Ibadans gave way and the rout was general and complete.

This desperate method of attack — cutlass in hand — is the peculiar method of the Owus, the bravest element in the new settlement, and the honour of the victory was theirs.

The Egbas however had not the courage to pursue their victory to any extent seeing amongst the war-chiefs many of those who had but recently driven them to Abeokuta : "a lion at bay" may prove a dangerous customer to tackle. The Ibadans instead of escaping home by the direct route went by way of Ijaye, being suspicious of the Ijebus.

§ 5. The Onidese and Oke Isero Wars

After a short period of rest Kurfimi the chiei of Ijaye invited the Ibadans to an expedition against Onidese. He gave as a

reason for this war that they were troublesome to him, but as a matter of fact, it was from pure jealousy at the growing importance of the people of that place and that of their neighbours of He Ode famous for their poisoned arrows.

Seeing the overwhelming force from Ibadan and Ijaye, Owoko the chief of Ode was so terrified that he deserted the town with his people and escaped to Onidese, but this place was besieged and taken. Sejo the chief of Onidese and Owoko of He Ode were both taken together.

Oke I§ero. — The following dry season the Ibadans captured Oke Isero for no alleged cause of grievance but simply out of a desire for slave raiding. The people of this place were quiet agriculturists. Ibadan and other towns were fed with yam flour exported from this place.

§ 6. The Iperu War

After the defeat of the Ijebus by the Egbas at Owiwi there was a series of desultory warfare between them with little or no success. Neither of them could encamp or take a town from the other, neither would-yield though both were tired. Whereupon the Egbas had resort to a cowardly trick, at once disgraceful and perfidious. They proposed to the Ijebus of the Remo district who were their neighbours, terms of peace which these gladly accepted, being tired of the war, and a treaty was made between them. But while the Ijebus were rejoicing and congratulating one another in songs and dances : —

" Omode Ijebu, E ku ewu Agba Ijebu, E ku ewu Ote yi jaja pari o ! "

(Young folks of Ijebu, we congratulate you Old folks of Ijebu, we congratulate you. This long-drawn war is at an end at last).

Suddenly, the Egbas who had lain in ambush sprang upon them and began to make captives of them. Makun and other towns were taken and destroyed and Iperu was besieged. The Ijebus beingharassedandgreatly straitened sent to Ibadan for help. All the war-chiefs were sent forward except Lakanle the Commanderin-chiet, who remained at home with the aged Oluyedun the Kakanfo, and the venerable Labgsinde the Baba Isale.

The Egbas proved too strong for the allies, and all their efforts to raise the siege of Iperu were fruitless. The difficulty of provisioning a besieged town without stores at the best of times and with a large access of auxiliaries proved insurmountable. The

allies lost several battles and the Egbas hemmed them in very closely. Iperu was nearly taken when the Ibadan allies sent home to their commander to come at once to their rescue as all hopes of deteating the Egbas were gone.

Lakanle responded to the call of his people and took the field in person. On his arrival at Iperu he assumed no lofty airs nor did he allow one word of reproach to fall from his lips. On the contrary he praised the war-chiefs and harangued the men as follows : — " Fellow countrymen and companions in arms, I am not more surprised at your valour and prowess than at your chivalry in inviting me to share with you the honours of the field. For what can I do singly without your aid ? I know your love and esteem for me and that you only wish for me the honour and fruits of the victory ; I am come therefore to grant you your hearts' desire and lead you on to victory. Be assured also that I. reciprocate your feelings of love towards me, for since your absence from home I have entered every compound now and again to ask after the welfare of your families and I am this day able to assure you that they are in good health.

I have gone the round of all the farms and when I saw any overgrown with weeds and learnt that the owner was at the seat of war, I ordered the farm to be immediately cleaned. I am now able to assure you also that your farms are in good order and your families in good health. Be of good cheer my brave men and by this time to-morrow let victory crown our efforts."

The soldiers gave long and loud shouts of "Muso, Muso, Muso." They made the heavens reverberate with their shouts and were heard at a very great distance.

When the Egbas heard that Lakanle had reached the camp they extemporized a ditty including his name : —

" Nigbati a ba pade t'awa ti Lakanle Igi t'o ba se oju re a wl o ! "

(When we do meet, ourselves and Lakanle

The trees that witness the sight shall tell the tale.)

And so it was. It must here be admitted that since the Egbas have been driven to Abeokuta and have had almost constantly to engage in wars both offensive and defensive against the Oygs in one direction, Ijebus in another, and the Egbaluwe provinces, they have developed a wonderful aptitude for fighting, and capable generals have been thrown up amongst them. A most sanguinary battle was fought the next day, and so great was the courage which the presence of their commander-in-chief infused into the Ibadan soldiers, and with such skill were they led that the tide of victory

turned in their favour that day. The Egbas were utterly defeated but their skilful commanders encouraged them to keep up the fire until sunset so as to be able to retreat in good order. Moreover they also tried to prevent a panic among their soldiers by not allowing the bodies of the wounded and the slain to be taken to the camp or to lie scattered about in the battlefield, and so they made a pile of the corpses so as to have the field cleared up. But in spite of it all, the Egbas could not hold on till the evening ; they were completely routed and Lakanl$\hat{}$'s victory was decisive.

In the pursuit, Lakanl$\hat{}$'s attention was drawn to the pile of corpses, and for the first time his lion-like heart was m.elted by the dreadful carnage, and the following exclamation escaped from his lips "Are these the bodies of mortals once born of women?" " Of course they are " retorted a private soldier " and whose work it was but yours? Was there any such butchery seen before you came into the camp ? " The great general turned away quietly without uttering a word more.

Thus Iperu was saved to the great disappointment of the Egbas and this they afterwards expressed in their street songs : — Ki a ko Iperu ki a ko Ode Ni Barapa ru imu re de (Iperu and Ode we had all but taken,

When officious Barapas came poking their noses.)

§ 7. The Fall of Ota

The Egbas at this time were equally as restless as the Ibadans waging a series of wars with the surrounding tribes, A serious complication arose between them and the Otas about this time which resulted in the latter place being besieged by them.

Ota is the name given to a small town and clan of the Awori tribes situated about 24 miles north of Lagos. They are usually reckoned amonst the Egbaluwes.

Prince Kosoko of Lagos was an ally of the Otas and it was he who asked the help of the Ibadans in defence of Ota.

A force was sent from Ibadan under the command of Oliiygle the Osi. He made Ipara his headquarters and sent two war-chiefs Elepo his own lieutenant and Inakoju the Seriki with some minor war-chiefs to the scene of conflict ; these encamped at Agerige, Lagosward, from which place they marched to Ota when there was to be a fight.

The Egbas fought bravely but the besieged defended their town most heroically assisted by their ally. The Egbas in order to harass the allies began kidnapping the Ibadan caravans, who were supplying them with provisions from home, as there was none to

be got locally, so that the station at Ipara coiild not supply that at Ageiige. Lakanle hearing this at home left the town and stationed himself at Ikija, from which place he sent escorts with the weekly caravans to Ipara ; by this means Agerige was also relieved and communication established with Ibadan.

The Otas are known to be an obstinate people, and in the defence of their homes every man amongst them was a hero ! The Egbas had nearly given up the campaign in despair ; a good many of the war-chiefs had returned home and others became rather listless, but for the shame of being baulked by such a small clan which kept them in the field, the whole undertaking would have collapsed. But the situation was improved by the diplomacy of one of the Egba chiefs ; he advised that unbounded licence be granted to the soldier}' in the field to gratify their passions in any manner they liked with impunity, himself setting the example : the amount of bravery displayed under fire, was to be the measure of indulgence in the camp. The device proved successful, the camp was refilled with characters of all sorts, and the campaign was prosecuted with renewed vigour. The small town was hemmed in on all sides and famine effected what the sword failed to accomplish.

When their Ibadan allies saw that the Otas were not likely to hold out much longer, and that it was with difficulty they could obtain supplies from home, they left Agerige secretlj' and hastened homewards.

Ota was at length taken by the Egbas and they wreaked their vengeance on the inhabitants so mercilessly, especially on the men for their obstinate resistance, that the clan was nearly extinguished altogether. From that time to this Ota has been subjected to the Egbas.

The Ibadan contingent under Elepo and Inakoju met Oluyole at Ipara. Whilst here, a most pernicious plot was hatched with consequences so far-reaching and so disastrous resulting in repeated civil fights at home, until nearly the whole of the important warchiefs perished one after another. Oluyole aspiring to the position of commander-in-chief planned a scheme by which Lakanlfe and Bankole his lieutenant should be wiped out, but the plot was discovered and it aroused great indignation at Ibadan. There was a determination that he should not be allowed to re-enter the town and steps were taken to prevent it. All the other chiefs returned one by one.

It was due to his friend Elepo alone that Oluyole re-entered Ibadan. He kept him informed of all that was taking place at home. Oluyole remained out but kept advancing by small stages, with the connivance of Elepo, till one night he entered by

the town gate from another direction. Once at home E16po prevailed on all the senior Chiefs to forbear with him and pardon him.

Then Oluyole's men began firing a feu de joie but with guns charged with bullets, directing them towards Lakanle's house, and Lakanle's men returning the compHment did the same towards Oluyole's, the houses of the principal war-chiefs ranging round the central market. This continued for several days, the chiefs of both sides taking no part, but leaving the skirmishing to their boys. The tension of affairs affected the whole town, all business was at a standstill, till Labosinde the Baba-Isale came forward with some elderly chiefs and put a stop to these proceedings.

This pacification however lasted but a short time, for soon afterwards there arose a complication between Oluwaiye, one of Lakanle's lieutenants and one of Oluyole's men. This developed into something approaching a civil fight, the town was soon in an uproar. Then Bankole unarmed approached Oluyole's men, and with soothing words was urging them to desist, and not to disturb the recently made peace, when one of Oluyole's men levelled his gun at him for interfering and shot him down dead ! This was a signal for a civil fight in the heat of which Oluwaiye fell. Thus Lakanle was deprived of both his lieutenants, and Oluyole's party gained the upper hand ; Lakanle had to take refuge with his old friend Agbeni at his quarters.

Oluyole now obtained the object of his ambition, and would not listen to any adjustment of affairs except the death or expulsion of Lakanle. The brave man hearing this put an end to his own life by ripping his bowels open with a jack-knife, and passing the entrails around his own neck. In a few minutes he expired in the arms of one of his men.

Thus Oluyole became supreme at Ibadan.

Chapter XIII

THE LAST OF KATUNGA THE GREAT METROPOLIS AND THE END OF A DYNASTY

§ I. Final Efforts to Throw off the Fulani Yoke

The Metropolis had long been left to herself whilst great and stirring events had been taking place all over the country. The outcome of the rebellion of the chiefs and the revolution Was the foundation of modern Ibadan, Abeokuta, Modakeke, the occupation of Ijaye, Abemg, the destruction of the city of Owu, and the fall of many ancient towns in the plain, and above all the ascendancy of Ilgrin under the ravaging foreigners.

That such important events as these should take place, one after another, altering the face of the country, and the King not be able to promote or retard the accomplishment of any — a King only in name, the direct descendant of absolute monarchs and deified heroes— could not but be a matter of pain and grief to the sovereign. Added to all this was a great calamity which befel him at home, one that distressed him sore and accelerated his death. A fire broke out in the palace and all efforts to arrest its ravages failed, and most of the accumulated treasures of his ancestors were consumed in the conflagration ! Great efforts were made to remove some to out-houses away from the direction of the flames, but unfortunately by a turn of the wind, those outhouses also caught fire and everything was lost !

Between the distress caused by the Ilorins now masters of the country, and the destructive fires the King died of a broken heart. Prince Oluewu was elected his successor with the general consent of the nobles and the King-makers.

Oluewu was said to be a prince comely in person, but all too conscious of his own dignity and importance ; haughty and irritable in temperament. His one aim and determination was to recover his dominions from the Fulanis first, and then subdue all his refractory chiefs.

Soon after Oluewu 's accession, Shitta the King of Ilgrin, required him to come to Ilgrin in person to pay homage to him as his vassal. But Oluewu was unwilling to go ; however, his great chiefs, and especially Prince Atiba of AggOja brought pressure and entreaties

to bear upon him, and he was prevailed upon to accede to the wishes of the conqueror in order to save the capital and the remnant of the towns that still paid their allegiance to Oyo.

Shitta received him with every mark of honour and distinction; but all the same, the shame and disgrace of it all, with unutterable resentment rankled in the breast of King Oluewu. The Gbedu drum was beaten before him as he went, and also on his returning. Shitta's attention was drawn to that particular drum and he asked some questions about it. When he was told it was a royal drum beaten before the ICing alone, he ordered it to be taken away, saying " There cannot be two Kings in my dominion but one only, and that is myself."

Oluewu felt his humiliation keenly and was resolved to resent it at all cost or die in the attempt. But that was not all ; the Emir of Ilorin sent Jimba one of his head slaves after Oluewu to ransack the palace at Oyo and to bring away anything of value he could lay his hands upon so that Oyo may not be said to have anything which Ilorin has not. This Jimba did, and among other things removed were the 100 brass posts in the long corridor of the palace erected by King Aganju.

Again, a short time after, Shitta required the Alafin of Oyo to come over to Ilorin to perform the ceremony known as " tapping the Koran," in order to become a true Moslem, but the AlAfin was resolved never to go to Ilorin a second time come what may. The chiefs urged him to do so in vain. However, Akioso the Basorun and Ailumg the Asipa went, against the express order of the King forbidding them to go ; and on account of this he was resolved to punish them, although they were too powerful for him to order their execution at once.

The AlAfin's refusal to go to Ilorin being considered an offence to Shitta, the latter sent an army with Lanloke the chief of Ogodo, which ravaged the suburbs of Oyo and the city itself was threatened. At this crisis the AlAfin invited the aid of the Baribas, to assist him in subduing his enemies " within and without." Those within were the Basorun and the Asipa who went to Ilorin against his commands.

On a fatal morning the Basorun and the Asipa went with the other noblemen to a council at the palace gate, for consultation about the impending Ilorin war, and the defence of the city. Whilst there, they heard that the Baribas were entering the city by the Modahade gate. Thinking that they were invited by the King merely to help to defend the city, the A§ipa rode to meet them and was according them a hearty welcome in the usual manner of men on horseback shaking the fist, when all of a sudden

a shower of darts came pouring down upon him, and the son of one Fagbayibi shot him dead on horseback!

The Baribas then pursued after the Basgrun who fled to the palace begging the King to spare his life. " Ah," said the King, " why should you beg me now, are you not the master and I the subordinate ? Why crave your life from your servant ? "

In the noise and confusion that ensued with the entrance of the Baribas, the Basorun managed to escape to his own house ; express messengers were thereupon sent to his relatives that he should be kept under strict surveillance whilst the King and his allies were engaged in the defence of the city, and that they would be held responsible for his escape. But a family council was held and in order to save him from a disgraceful death in public, his relatives put an end to his life by strangUng.

The forces of nature came to the defence of Oyo on this occasion. There was a great storm, and whether it was due to the great number of gUttering Swords and spears brandished, or whatever may have been the cause, hghtning was attracted and so Izirge a number of men were struck in the Ilorin host that their army was discomfited, and the men fled away in terror. Oyo was a great city, which could not be rushed by the Ilorins nor could it be invested and reduced by along siege, for there was always the fear that a prolonged siege of their metropoUs by aliens might rouse the great chiefs of the country to its aid. Thus failing to take the city, Shitta's next tactics were the subversion of the remaining large Yoruba towns that still showed any allegiance to Qyo, and hence Gbodo was besieged. He also succeeded in securing the alliance of some powerful Yoruba chiefs among whom were the Onikoyi, Chief Elebuof Ago Oja, and Prince Atibaof the same place. This last named having resided at Ilorin for some time was well known to the Fulanis.

The AlAfin again secured the help of the Baribas. Eleduwg the Bariba king promised to help him not only to conquer the Ilorins but also to subdue his rebel chiefs. Gbodo which was closely besieged by the Ilorins was well nigh taken when timely help arrived in the person of the Eleduwe and his Bariba hordes. Some of

the Yoruba chiefs were serving in the Ilorin army at the time, notably those of Ago Oja mentioned above, but be it said to the praise of Prince Atiba that he was acting merely out of policy, for his soldiers, from private instructions previously received, were firing only gunpowdei. This was suspected when in spite of the vigorous attacks of Atiba, his fire never killed or wounded anyone ; the guns of his men were thereupon examined, and the truth had to be confessed.

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The Baribas were good archers, the siege of Gbodo was raised and the defeated Ilorins and their alUes were hotly pursued.

It was about the month of June, when the rivers were swollen by rain, and thousands of Ilorin horse and foot were driven into the river Ogun and were drowned. Elebu the brother and successor of Oja the founder of Ago found here a watery grave. He would have escaped death but for the plot against his life. It is said that the late Oja was a dear friend to Prince Atiba and the friendship continued all through his life until he perished at the Kanla expedition ; but Elebu his brother begrudged that friendship : he always suspected the influence and good faith of the prince, regarding him as a potential usurper of his family rights ; and when he succeeded his brother as the Bale of Ago, there was always friction between them. Consequently on this occasion as Elebu plunged into the river during the flight and with great difficulty swam across he caught hold of a Gbingbin tree that stretched its branches far out into the river, but one Lohosa who had preceded him and got on to the tree, seeing Elebu in his exhausted condition, and in order to do good service to Prince Atiba, cut off that branch of the tree and Elebu was swept away and was drowned.

Prince Atiba himself nearly lost his life there also, had not Yesufu his uncle, carried him across on his back and given him his horse on the other side to ride home.

But the prince and many others owed their life really to Maje his balogun. The Baribas would have overtaken them at the banks of the river before they could cross had he not kept them at bay whilst horses and men were struggling across, and so he gave up his life to save theirs, for he fell there.

The wreck of the Ilorin army gathered at Bala and Iwo from which places they returned home.

But the Eleduwe was not satisfied with raising the seige of Gbodo, he was determined to free the country entirely of these foreigners, and hence he was resolved to conquer Ilorin. Oluewu the AlAfin, whose cause he was espousing was right glad and sent round to invite the co-operation of all his subjects including those who were alhes of the Ilorins, knowing that they were aUies only out of policy, but not wilhngly, and that they would be glad to be free from the foreign yoke.

But matters were complicated by the fact that most of the Oyo chief towns in the eastern and western provinces had been subjugated by the Ilorins and were vassals of that state. Hence at a council of war held by the two Kings it was decided that they should not march straight from Oyo to Ilorin, but make a detour

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by the western province, in order to secure the alliance and good faith of these vassal states, and thus to collect an overwhelming army against Ilgrin. Accordingly the Eleduwe sent Jankgrg one of his war-chiefs to garrison Ago Oja, whose chief was an Ilgrin ally, and Jegede another war-chief to garrison Otefan whilst he himself was following with his invincible army in their wake.

The Ilgrins hearing of the threatened invasion were not idle either, but were making full preparations offensive and defensive.

Jimba the head slave of the king of Ilgrin headed an expedition of horse and foot to the Otefan farms when they heard of the garrison there, and brought away several captives. Jimba's route in going was through the Esiele farms, but was so far from the town that his company was not seen. On his return he came through the town and halted at the gate to receive Fasgla the Bale, who came to pay him his respects. Jimba did not dismount as he was in a hurry to get away with his captives lest he be overtaken, for he was sure of a pursuit. On horseback he accepted the hospitality of a drink of cold water, and before hurrying away gave the following advice to Fasgla " You are between two fires and you would be wise to vacate this town at once. I am just returning as you see with captives from the Otefan farms. Although you were not aware of

my passing through your farms yet had I been detected, I would have suspected you as a traitor, and would have punished you on my return although you may be innocent. And now as I return through your town the Otefan pursuers will track me to this place and you may likely suffer for it and we have no means of protecting you, hence I advise you speedily to vacate this place."

The Esiele people after consultation together decided at once to follow his advice. Otefan being the nearest large town and wishing to cast in their lot mth the new conqueror, they decided to escape thither and accordingly despatched oneBankgle to apprise Idowu the Bale of Otefan of their intentions. At Bankole's instance they promised not to desert their home before his return as they treated him on a previous occasion ; but their cowardice got the better of them. On returning Bankgle met the fugitives by the way and this was the third and last time Esielg was deserted, and is to this day an uninhabited desert.

It was in the month of March 1830, that the Eleduwe accompam'ed by Prince Atiba of Agg Oja and Jatq, Eleduwe's general, joined the garrison at Otefan the rendezvous of the Oyo army. Kurumi of Ijaye, the Aseyin of Iseyin, the Sabigana of Igana, the Okere of Saki and others of the western province met them there. Here King Oluewu and the Eleduwe pledged the confidence

of all the Oyo war-chiefs save the Bale of Ogbomoso and the Onikoyi, both of whom were in secret alliance with the Ilorins, although they outwardly professed loyalty to their lawful sovereign.

Meanwhile, the Emir of Ilorin alarmed by this great host sent to the Sultan of Sokoto his suzerain for help. The Sultan sent 17 kings under Esugoyi of Rabbah to his aid, and they came with such an overwhelming force that those of the two kings were as a mere handful before them. The two kings were besieged at Otefan by the Ilorin and Niger hosts, several battles were fought, and they were nearly overwhelmed by numbers. At the last great battle, but for the courage, wisdom and experience of Eleduwe theBariba King, the fate of the whole expedition would have been decided on that day. He fought in the centre, the AlAfin and Oyo chiefs in the right and left wings. He sent aid to those fighting in both wings, so that thej, forced the enemy into the centre, and in one furious charge he bore down upon them and dispersed them. Esugoyi's army was routed with great slaughter and fled away in confusion. The victory however, was dearly bought, for Yenibini, King Eleduwe's first-born son fell in the battle.

The Oyos pursued their victory too far till they met with a disaster. They dearly learnt the lesson that in the pursuit of a foe footmen are no match for horsemen. The Ilorins having recovered from the panic of their defeat, a body of horsemen suddenly wheeled round and charged upon their pursuers and speared about 400 of them, thereby forcing them to desist from the pursuit. They were then able to retreat in good order, and made good their escape.

§ 2. Failure. The Eleduwe War

About the month of June, 1830, the two Kings left Otefan for Adeyi, and thence proceeded to Ogbomoso. Here King Oluewu sent round to the whole of the Yoruba chiefs to join him in the last effort to throw off the Fulani yoke. There responded to his call Oluyole of Ibadan with several Egba war-chiefs, Kurumi of Ijaye, Ayo of Abem6, Timi of Ede and others. This mighty host remained here for about six months wasting time. They were holding councils almost every day as to how best they might attack Ilorin with success. But here also the future of the expedition was foreshadowed and the doom of the allied Kings was sealed. There were two principal causes for this, viz., the rapacity of the Bariba soldiers, and the imprudence of the Kings.

The excesses of the Baribas made the Yoruba chiefs and

people fear lest they pass from one master to another and a worse. The Fulanis weie after all a superior race, but the Baribas, a race of bandits, as masters would be more intolerable. The country was literally being ravaged b^ them. They considered themselves licensed to all the goats in the country. Even when kept in the inner apartment of the houses, they would get at them and devour them. Sheep they did not care for, but goats, say they are traitors and must be devoured. For this reason the Yorubas termed them " Arun-eran " (cattle devourers) while the Ilorins termed them Ikoriko (wolves).

Their excesses consisted not only in devouring cattle, but also in stripping and depriving helpless ones of their cloths ; at length they spared not even men though they might be armed. Organized bands would attack and deprive men of all their valuables.

The Oyos could offer little or no resistance because the persons of the Baribas were held sacred, already being considered the deliverers of the country.

The following instance will show how sacred their persons were regarded. One of them attacked an Oyo man, who was not wilHng to give way Hghtly and the Bariba was shot dead by him. The Oyo man ran away. So much noise and hubbub were raised about this, that both Kings rode in person to the spot to see the corpse. The converse to this might have happened every day without provoking any comment. But the eyewitnesses of the affray were so much in sympathy with the murderer that he was not betrayed, so disgusted was everybody with the excesses of the Baribas. All this might have been avoided if instead of wasting time at Ogbomoso they had given the soldiers work to do by marching at once on Ilorin, half demoralized by two successive defeats. On the contrary they allowed them time to regain theii confidence and perfect their defences. Small blame indeed to the soldiers as each one had to provide for himself, however prolonged the campaign.

The two Kings were imprudent enough to betray their feelings. It leaked out that after the conquest of Ilorin all the refractory Yoruba chiefs who had usurped the King's prerogative would be murdered by the help of theBariba king ; and the kingdom would again be one under the Alafin.

One or two instances might be given of how the Kings betrayed themselves.

L. Timi Bamgbaiye of Ede on his arrival at the camp went straight to pay his homage to the King. Being a corpulent man the Eleduwe was heard to remark " See this corpulent fellow, one of those who have made themselves fat upon the King's

diverted revenues. Never mind, he also will be dealt with after the war as he deserves."

2. Above all the others the one who appeared the most offensive to the Bariba king was Prince Atiba of Ago Oja. He was all Fulani in his manners. He had resided at Ilorin for some time and adopted the Fulani custom of being lifted up and helped off his horse by his attendants, and one of his menials ready with his sandals so that he might not have to walk barefoot when his riding boots were off.

The two Kings were one day sitting at a pubUc meeting, and Prince Atiba arrived late with an august pageantry to the disgust of the kings and chiefs present, who could not afford as much. He was preceded by his Junior war-chiefs mounted on strong ponies, with their attendant footmen ; then those mounted on larger horses came after, then himself followed on a specially powerful animal richly caparisoned, with a large retinue. He was lifted off his horse his sandals being ready for him to put on, contrary to the etiquette of the country to be shod before a king. This was disgusting to both Kings and to many of the Oyo chiefs present, who, notwithstanding the rebellion and revolution still going on, have yet full respect for royalty.

Olurinde the chief of Sepeteri in the eastern province, could not bear to see this act of disrespect pass unreproved, so he went near and pulled off the sandals from Atiba's feet, and thus reprimanded him : " Know you not before whom you are ? How dare you be shod in the presence of our King ? " Atiba could not brook a reproof from a commoner and from wounded pride fiercely retorted; "And who are you ? And what is that to you ? The King is my father and, as a prince, I have privileges which the likes of you can never aspire to. I can even pass by him into the harem which none of you can dare do ; but who are you ?" The contention was so sharp that Kitoyi the Okere of Saki had to interpose begging Prince Atiba to have respect for the two Kings, to take off the sandals, and not to persist merely for the purpose of spiting the Sepeteri chief.

The Kings noticed all this and marked Prince Atiba out as one of those to be dealt with after the war.

Lastly the disaffection towards Oluewu was increased by the unreasoning stubbornness he displayed to whatever advice was given him, however good. The Oyo chiefs who were left to guard the city were kept informed of everything that transpired. They were very anxious as to the fate of the expedition ; their

own interests were chiefly involved in the fate of the capital. They were sure the offended chiefs would take revenge and wreck the army

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of which they formed a part. Consequently they sent message after message to advise the King not to advance on Ilgrin direct from Ogbomoso but to come by way of Ikoyi, Iwo, Gbogun, and Sah6 making the attack from the north so that having the capital and the Niger provinces behind him he might in case of defeat have safe places within easy reach to retire- upon. And in order to give strength and force to the advice, they represented it as the express advice of the god Ifa by divination. Knowing his haughtiness they sent their messages through the Bariba king, to whom alone he might perhaps listen ; but as they anticipated, not even from the Eleduwe would he brook any such advice. He was for marching straight on Ilorin from Ogbomoso.

Before the army marched out of Ogbomoso the disaffected Yoruba provincial kings and chiefs entered into a conspiracy to desert the King and his ally at a critical moment and therefore in order to apprise the Ilorins of their intentions they sent them- a parabolic message in soap, camwood, and karinkan (flesh brush) implying " We are attending the bride to the bridegroom's house." This was fully understood at Ilorin.

The huge host left Ogboragsg in December 1830 by slow stages encamping first at Aduin, where they were for nine days. (Ilorin is but one good day's walk from Ogbomoso). On the tenth day they advanced to Jayin, thence to Ogele, and from Ogele they encamped at the farm of one Ajiya of Ilorin. Never before was Ilorin threatened by so large a force, consequently the consternation there was great, and vast preparations were made for battle, offensive and defensive. The face of every man was marked by grim determination to do his best. The Moslem priests were very busy making charms and amulets not only for individual selfprotection but also in order to defeat the enemy completely. A crow, a cat, and a crown bird (the Agufan) with charms tied round their necks were sent by special messengers to be left in the camp of the allied armies. These messengers were caught and when threatened they boldly showed that they despised death and said to their captors " Take our advice and decamp at once for as for the yams you are now cooking in our farms it is a question whether you will be able to eat them before you are defeated, and even if you should, we are quite sure that the survivors will evacuate them at the Ogbomoso farms."

Shortly after this a company of Ilorin horse surprised a body of men who went foraging, and the Bariba troops who went out against them were repulsed, but Prince Atiba whose men were armed with guns came to their timely aid, drove back the horsemen and captured a horse.

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To show the wanton excesses of these Baribas, even after this skirmish in which they figured so badly, they went unceremoniously to Prince Atiba's tent and coolly loosed the horse that was captured and were taking it away ! They laid claim to it not because it was captured by them, but because they considered themselves now the masters as it was they who had the first brush with the enemy. But the Prince was not the man to forego his claims easily, he pointed out forcibly how, but for his timely succour there could not have been any question as to the ownership of the horse, for instead of capturing, they themselves would all have been killed, or captured. The contention was so fierce between them that the Alafin had to send a special message to Atiba to forego his claims and give up the horse for the sake of peace.

The following day being Friday the Kings did not take the field until 2 p.m., Fridays being considered unlucky up to that hour.

The Kings again fought in the centre in the highway called the Pakaba road, and located the Yoruba war-chiefs on the right and left wings of the army.

But Prince Atiba of AgQ and the Timi Bamgbaiye of Edg did not fire a shot or shoot an arrow before they gave way, affording the enemy an advantage to surround the two Kings. It was Oluyole of Ibadan alone who seemed not to have been apprised of the plot, for he fought for some time on the road leading to Oke Suna and pressed the florins hard towards the town wall. The camp was taken behind them and fired before the Kings were aware of the perfidy of the Yoruba chiefs. There was no alternative now for them but to fight desperately and sell their Uves as dearly as possible. The Eleduwe fought with his usual bravery and

exhausted all his skill to retrieve the position if possible, but he was overpowered by numbers and fell among the slain. His head was taken off and carried in triumph to the town and exposed upon the town WcQl.

King Oluewu's heir seeing that the day was lost rode up to his father and bade him farewell, to meet again in the other world. Putting spurs into his horse he galloped to meet the enemy and fought gallantly until he fell among those he had slain.

The Ilgrin horse and foot were in pursuit all night and unfortunately for the wreck of the Oyo army whilst escaping to Ogbomoso they missed the way taking one that led back to Ilorin ; they met the pursuers at a short distance and were all either captured or slain.

Thus was fulfilled the prophecy of the charm bearers who were caught, that the yams they were then cooking might be eaten at the Ilorin farms but would be evacuated in the Ogbomosg farms.

Lanloke the chief of Ogodo who had always been an inveterate enemy of Oyo and an active ally of Ilorin, taking advantage of the absence of the King and principal war-chiefs from the city, came and attacked Oyo, but he was repulsed by the Ohota nicknamed Ari-ibon-peji eyin, (one whose gun can create a gap in the upper front teeth) , who was left in charge.

When the news of the disaster reached Oyo and that both Kings had perished, Lanloke again attacked the city but was again repulsed. The citizen's fearing that he would receive re-inforcement from Ilorin did not wait to try any further conclusions ; the great metropolis was deserted, some fled to Kihisi, some to Igboho, and some even to Ilorin. As it was not a flight from an enemy in pursuit many who reached Kihisi and Igboho safely with their family returned a^ain and again for their household goods and chattels till one Agandangban went and told Lanloke that Oyo had been deserted, and the latter proceeded immediately to plunder, and carry away what was left by the citizens.

Thus failed the fourth and last campaign against Ilorin, and such was the fall of the great Metropohs " Eyeo or Katunga," the ancient Oyo, still in rains.

Chaptep XIV THE INTERREGNUM § I. Civil War at Abem6

Before the Eleduwe war broke out, a marked disaffection and rivalry was rife between the two leading chiefs of Abem6, Ayo the Bale and Okoyan alias Lahan the next man to him.

The latter claimed relationship to Oyabi the late Kakanfo at Ajase and hence to Kurumi of Ijaye also. This rivalry became apparent during the expedition, for Lahan out of spite to his chief Ayg, went over to Kurumi, encamped with him and fought under his standard as if he was an Ijaye rhan. The disaffection now became an open rupture and it was evident to all that Lahan was secretly abetted by chief Kurumi of Ijaye. It subsequently became known that Lahan and Kurumi were plotting to fall upon Ayo suddenly and despatch him after their retreat, before reaching home. Ayo apprised of this, suddenly broke up his encampment, and by forced marches reached home a considerable time before Lahan who followed hard after him.

But Ayo instead of entering his house remained squatting on a mat in the square in front of his compound, close by the spot where his women folk were dyeing cloths, his horse standing by his side, and his spear stuck in the ground close by him,

Lahan halted outside the town walls, afraid to enter. When Ayo heard of it he sent to invite him to return to his house in peace, but Lahan suspicious and afraid to enter by the main gate took a circuitous route and entered by the one nearest to his quarter of the town where he commanded about 200 compounds. Their designs having now failed Kurumi became very anxious about the safety of his friend Lahan, and not wishing to leave him thus at the mercy of Ayg he attempted to bring about a reconciliation between them before proceeding home to Ijaye ; but Ayo politely declined his interference saying that having just returned home from this great war it was too early to talk about such matters. Kurumi thus disappointed proceeded homewards but first despatched Amodu one of his distinguished captains on horseback to bid Ayo good bye and to say he would return in a short time to settle their difference.

Amodu met Ayg on the same spot his horse still unsaddled but all his men had dispersed, only about 5 attendants remained L 269

with him. Amodu having delivered his message returned to his master, and suggested to him that a better opportunity than this cannot be had of making short work of the whole affair ; Ayo's men having dispersed he could easily be surprised and killed.

Kuruni took the hint and made for Ayo ; the latter surprised to see an armed force coming on towards him, hastily jumped upon his horse and was ready for action. Kurumi perceiving it would not be an easy matter to accomplish his purpose, did not venture upon an attack but speedily wheeled round and left the town by another gate.

Ayo and his men thereupon became mad with rage and they fell upon Lahan, fired his quarter of the town, took his men with their wives and childien as captives of war ! Lahan himself was spared with but a few attendants, and allowed to shelter himself in a small house in that quarter which had escaped the conflagration. Here he spent a most miserable night of grief, remorse and disappointment, having lost all his family and all his property.

Chief Oluygle of Ibadan arrived at Abemg only a day too late to be of any service to his friends, and was very sorry that this had happened, especially at this crisis. He visited Lahan where he was to sympathize with him for his misfortunes having a reminiscence of his own troubles on his return from the Ota war. He went straight from Lahan to Ayo to effect a reconciliation between them and the release of those who were seized, contending that they cannot be regarded as prisoners of war but fellow townsmen and victims of a civil fight. He further showed the impolicy of having one part of the town desolate. He succeeded with Ayo and with some of his chiefs ; some had even set free their own captives. Thus, in order to assure Oluyole, one Oga appealed to Kukomi one of his followers in the presence of them all, "Have I not released mine ?" In the same way one Eku6debe appealed to one Bankole. The reply in both cases was in the affirmative. Thereupon one Akilapa and Agidi-ko-ko-iku who had not yet done so asked leave to go home and release theirs at once. Everything now seemed to make for a peaceful settlement, when one Ogungbade an Own man then residing at Abem^ raised a strong objection to the proceedings ; he declined to set his captives free and declared himself unconcerned as to the results even if it be the destruction of Abem6 and the loss of his own liberty. Said he " I am an Owu man by birth, my parents came from the ancient Owu Ipole to the city of Owu where I was born. The same fortune that smiled on my parents at Owu Ipole, smiled on them at the city of Owu, Here am I, fortune is smiling on me to-day although

I was taken captive at the fall of the city of Owu. Let Abem6 be destroyed to-day and let me lose all I have and be taken captive, I shall still be a great man wherever I may be. 'Tis enough, Abem^ may be destroyed in part or in whole ; it matters nothing. We shall not release our prisoners."

Unfortunately at such a crisis as this, Chief Ayo was in an inebriated condition, although he was conscious of what was going on and was able to signify his acquiescence to Chief Oluyole ; yet throughout all the proceedings and the wicked proposals of the Owu man he remained silent, and further, he displayed in the presence of Oluyole some of those disgusting habits customary with him of soiling himself while in that state.

Oluyole was indignant with Ayo and his councillors and looked upon them all as a number of fools ; he, however, concealed his anger, but the whole affair was terminated abruptly and unsatisfactorily.

About the time of Oluyole's departure however, Ayo was able to thank him for the interest he kindly took in the affairs of the town, and presented him with a young woman among the captives. Oluyole was dehghted with this acquisition to his harem. She was described as a young woman of great beauty, of a fair complexion and a slim figure. But the mother hastened forward with a tender appeal to Oluyole, and prostrating (after the manner of men) before him, said " She cannot be your wife, for she is your relative ; we also are of the Basgrun descent like yourself." Oluyole yielded to her entreaties but demanded 15 heads of cowries for her release; this was paid and the girl was handed to her mother.

Oluyole left Abemo for Ibadan by way of Ijaye where he spent 5 days with Kurumi, and both of them being offended at Ayo's conduct the fate of Abemo was thereupon settled and sealed.

§ 2. The Destruction of Abem^

According to the settled arrangement between Kurumi and Oluyole during the stay of the latter at Ijaye, their movements were to be kept private as much as possible. Abem6 was to be taken by surprise in order to avoid the necessity of a siege. The Ibadan forces were to join those of Ijaye and in order to do this without their objective being known, Oluyole gave it out that the Aseyin was paying a visit to Ibadan and that they should go out and escort him to the town.

As the head chief went outside the town wall, no war-chief dared remain behind ; hence, all went out according to custom.

They went as far as Ijaye but when they saw the Ijaye army

also marshalled forth then they knew that they were going against Abem6.

It was quite late before Ayg knew that evil was determined against him. He went out that morning to review his troops. Two of his generals Aruna and Ajadi being accused of treason were before him, and whilst he was enquiiing into the charge they were interrupted by the approach of the enemy. The intrepid warrior at once jumped upon his horse, and dashed into the ranks of the enemy. He performed feats of valour that day, he broke through their ranks, had his horse shot under him and himself wounded in the leg. But he was not dispirited ; he called for another horse and fought bravely at the head of his people. The men of Abemg, however were overpowered by numbers, for whilst fighting braveh' at one gate of the town, the Ibadans entered by another and set fire to the town. All hopes being now lost, Ayo escaped with a few horsemen and followers to Ago Oja (the present Oyo) being hotly pursued by Ijaye and Ibadan troops.

In order not to incur the displeasure of KurGmi and Oluyole the two leading chiefs of the country whom he hoped hereafter would be his back stay. Prince Atiba of Ago Oja told Ayo that he could not protect him and consequently he should leave the town before his pursuers arrived there. Ayo took the way to Ojomgbodu on his way to Ilorin, but after a while on considering the humiliation of it all and the grave probabilities that lay before him, he chose death rather than dishonour.

He dismounted at a certain spot and sat. under a tree, his horse standing by him. He sent away his little band of devoted followers in order to die alone like a soldier. Here he calmly awaited his pursuers.

According to one account, at the sight of them he sprang again upon his horse and made for them. He threw one Lakonu off his steed and brandishing his spear round and round him, exclaimed " But for Atiba you are a dead man," then the men opened fire upon him and he dropped down dead.

But another account says he sat with calm dignity under the tree and offered no resistance whilst they showered their deadly weapons upon him and he dropped down dead.

Thus perished one of the best and ablest of the Oyo or Yoruba generals. His remains were brought back to Ago Oja and interred there.

Ayg like the late Ojo Amepo was a good horseman and one of the best generals of the day, but drink was his greatest vice, and to that may be attributed the cause of his ruin as well as that of Abem^. His aide-de-camp was nick-named Am u-igba-legb§-giri,

i.e., one who grasps tight the sides of a drinking bowl ; because he himself was hardly inferior to his master in that respect as the name implies.

Although the ruler of the town yet he often spent as much as three days and nights out of home attending " wakes " at night wherever he was invited, and during daytime dancing to the bMa drum in various quarters of the town hke the commonest citizen. He offered the right hand of fellowship to anyone who could drink like himself.

He was by nature generous and merciful, in which respect he was most unlike his bloodthirsty peers of that age. As an instance of this a story was told of his favourite Amu-igba-legbe who on leaving the Bale's house quite late one night the worse for drink missed his way into his chief's harem, and slept by the side of one of his wives thinking he had got home ! When the woman awoke in the early hours of the morning, and saw a stranger by her side she cried out and roused the whole estabHshment.

Amugba starting from his sleep being now sober, took in the situation at once and resigned himself to the only fate he felt sure was awaiting him under the circumstances.

Overcome with fear he went home in great distress and when the matter was known in the house the whole compound was deserted for fear of the usual confiscation and punishment in such a case. Amugba expected nothing but death and when about noon he heard his chief's drum coming towards his house, he thought the fatal hour was come. Ayo entered and saw him trembling and attempting an apology ; he simply jeered at him and said : " Why are you looking so dejected ? Is it because you missed your way last night ? Never mind the mistake, let's go out and drink away yesterday's occurrence."

Amugba thought it was only a stratagem to get him out of his house to be arrested and executed ; he followed, however, but was still dejected. Whilst drinking in a friend's house Ayo observed him still in that mood, and said to him with surprise, " Are you still downcast on account of yesterday's affair ? Why that is past and gone ; it only proved I can beat you in drink, for I drank far more than you did on that occasion, but was not in the least affected, whilst you, could not find your way home." So the matter passed off in jokes.

Abemo and Ijaye were rival towns and the former had the sobriquet of " Abem6 siiru okg ilu bantatk " (Abemo small and compact, but the husband of a huge town) meaning Ijaye.

FOURTH PERIOD. — ARREST OF DISINTEGRATION — ILORINS CHECKMATED— ATTEMPTS AT RECONSTRUC- TION—INTERTRIBAL WARS— BRITISH PROTECTORATE.

Chaptek XV

THE NEW CITY AND NEW GOVERNMENT

§ I. Prince Atiba : His Early Life and History

Prince Atiba was the son of King Abiodun by an Akeitan woman. According to one account, he was born in the city of Oyo, his father died when he was but a child, and when Abiodun's children were being ill-treated by King Aole his mother fled with him to her own town in the country.

Bat another account was of a more romantic interest and is more probable, as being characteristic of that age. According to this account, his mother, a slave at Gudugbu, was given as a hostage to the Alafin of Oyo. She had an intimate friend who was much distressed by this separation. After 8 or lo weary months, she was resolved at all costs to go up to the city to visit her friend with whom she had been associated from childhood.

The Gudugbu hostage was too insignificant to be noticed among the crowd of women in the King's harem until- this strange visit of her friend drew the King's attention to her. The visitor from the country loitering within the precincts of the palace was asking all whom she saw coming from the women's quarters to call her Eni-Olufan one of the King's wives, but no one knew who that was. At length King Abiodun was told that a woman from the country was asking for one of his wives, and this unusual incident aroused the King's curiosity. The Gudugbu woman was called to his presence to state the object of her visit. She replied . — " May your majesty live long. The young woman from Gudugbu given as a hostage was my bosom friend, and for the past 8 months or more I have had no one to talk to, and hence I was resolved to visit her."

The King then said to her, " Are you not afraid to come here and to enquire for my wife ? Suppose I add yourself to the harem or kill you or sell you ? " Sherephed, " For my friend's sake I am prepared to undergo any treatment, and if your majesty make a wife of me I shall be happy as my friend and I will see each other every day."

The King greatly admired their friendship ; he gave permission for her to be lodged with her friend, and was by this led to pay some attention to the Gudugbu hostage.

For three months these two friends enjoyed each other's company and as the King's wife was now in the way of becoming a mother, he was graciously pleased to send them home. He sent for both of them one morning, and after a few approbatory remarks on their friendship, he loaded them with presents, and said to his wife's friend, "I am sending your friend home with you in order that you may not fail to have some one to unbosom your mind to as hitherto. I make you both my deputy for that part of the country. All matters to be referred to Oyo will henceforth be brought to you for decision, all the tribute monies will be paid to you also, and as my wife will be unable to undertake a journey, I expect your visit here as often as you can come." With this instruction he dismissed them and sent several Eunuchs and Ilaris with them as escort and to commend them formally to the care and protection of the Bale of Gudugbu. Both these women returned to Gudugbu in quite a different capacity from that in which they left it. The little town was all astir on their arrival, and many were the private murmurs against Eni-Olufan's friend for the heavy responsibilities she had brought upon them. Great deference, however, was paid to them both, and they became practically the supreme rulers and judges of that district. The King's wife in course of time gave birth to a son who was named Atibk ; her friend also (who was a married woman) gave birth to a son named Onipede. The intimacy existing between the two mothers re-appeared also in the boys from childhood up to manhood.

[This account is reconcilable with the first as it is possible that as an infant, Atiba may have been taken to Oyo to see his father, and may have been there till Aole's reign when the mother had to flee with him back to the country as stated above].

Atiba grew up a wild and reckless lad. When he was of age, his father ordered that the mother should apportion to him the tribute money of that district, this continued until the succeeding reign when the country was thrown into confusion and anarchy.

This circumstance probably led his mother to remove with him from Gudugbu to Akeitan her own home. Here Atiba was under the care of his maternal uncle who was now head of the house and the family estate.

Atiba was brought up as a tailor, but he preferred a wild and predatory life, for which the circumstances of the times afforded great opportunities. A story was told of him that once being very

hungry, he asked his uncle for a yam, and the uncle not only refused it him, but took the opportunity of reprimanding him sharply for living the idle life of a kidnapper. " If I had lived on manstealing like you," said he, " I could not have got any yam," But Yesufu the younger uncle felt sorry for his nephew and said to Atiba that whilst he (the uncle) was living, he (Atiba) would never suffer the pinch of hunger. This incident had its reward hereafter as will be noticed in its place.

From Akeitan Prince Atiba made several incursions into the Gudugbu farms, and was generally a pest to the country round about.

In order not to bring trouble on the Akeitan people, Atiba was urged to remove his residence to the town of Ago where he would find in Oja- the chief of that place a man of a like spirit to his own, of a warlike disposition, and he did so.

But when Atiba arrived at Ago, Oja was strongly advised not to let him settle down there, because a man like him would eventually become master of the town. Elebu, Oja's brother was the chief opponent. But Oja did not follow this advice. " How can I," said he "an ofhcer on the staff of the Kakanfo, and a titlebearer in the kingdom, turn away my prince ?" Oja continued friendly to him until his fall in the Kanla expedition.

Their kidnapping expeditions were at that time chiefly directed against the Egbas in the Oke Ogun districts near Sagaun. They found them so simple and unsophisticated in those days that when a kidnapper had captured several of them and was in quest for more he had only to leave his cap or his spear or any other personal property by the side of them, and bid them wait for him there, and should another kidnapper fall in with them he was to be shown the sign of prepossession, and thus they would be left untouched until their captor returned. These captives never made any effort to escape.

Atiba rose to importance by committing acts of violence and extortion with impunity, from the great deference paid to his high birth. In that age of anarchy and confusion he collected around himself all lawless men, insolvent debtors, slaves who had deserted their masters. His wealth was continually augmented by fresh marauding expeditions, his men behaving like the Jamas, himself at the head of them.

By his address and largess Atiba won to himself the following chiefs of Oyo, viz., Aderinko, Ladejobi, Olumole, Oluwajo, Lgsk Oluwaiye (the Alagba), Adefumi, Lakonu, Told Maje, Falade, and Gbenla.

His slaves who had horses and a large retinue each were : —

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Eni-d'Olgrun (who subsequently became the Apeka), Galajimg, Otelowo and Ogboinu his mounted trumpeter.

Elebu succeeded his brother as the Bale of Ago. As might be expected he was not on good terms with Atiba ; but the latter had already risen to such a height of greatness and popularity that Elebu could neither crush him nor turn him out of the town ; they remained antagonists till Elebu was drowned in the river during the Gbodo war, as related above.

Before Elebu's death, Ajanaku of Ilorin to whom Ago Oja paid tribute summoned them both to Ilorin and asked Shitta his sovereign to effect a reconciliation between them. The turban was given to both as a sign of brotherhood in the Moslem faith. This reconciliation was only on the surface, but by no means real. It was at this time that all children born at Ago had Moslem names given to them and many adults and aged people changed theirs in order to be in good favour with the Jamas of Ilorin, who then infested the country

Atiba had nearly lost his life in the Gbodo expedition; his horse was shot dead under him and theBaribas were pressing hard behind him in pursuit. His life-long friend Onipede galloped past him paying no heed to the despairing cry of his friend and master: " Onipede here am I, will you leave me behind to perish ? " Onipede notwithstanding this rushed on into the river Ogun and swam across safe to the other side. But when Atiba's uncle, Yesufu came up and saw him in such straits he dismounted and offered him his horse. Atiba declined to take it, but Yesufu forced him to accept it, saying " Even if I perish in this war I know that you will take care of my children." Yesufu was a powerful swimmer and he assisted both the horse and the rider safe to the other side. Adekidero the Lemomu also offered his own horse to be used alternately with Yesufu's until they reached home.

Onipede did not wait for him although he was riding on a horse bought for him by the very Prince he now deserted. It was even reported of him that after he had reached the other side of the river, he halted to watch with amusement the distress and danger of his friend battling with the swift current until Yesufu came to his assistance, and that on the Prince's reaching the other side Onipede came up with a smile and an untimely joke saying " The intrepid warrior that you are, I did not know that a riveF current could conquer you." The Prince said nothing, and showed no sign of resentment, but Onipede from that day became a marked man, because it was evident to Atiba that his death would have excited no feelings of sympathy and regret in Onipede.

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Up to this time Onipede enjoyed his entire confidence. Whatever he said or did was indisputable ; any criminal pardoned by him was free, and latterly he would not even take the trouble of acquainting the Prince with all that he did. He was known beyond the confines of the kingdom as the confidant of the Prince and all foreigners residing at Ago were under his protection. He was always attended by a large retinue of foot and of horsemen as a Prince, whenever he paid visits in town or in going to his farm. He was the greatest favourite at the Prince's palace ; no one was allowed to see the Prince or obtain favours from him except through Onipede. The love Atiba had for this companion of his childhood and youth made him bhnd to all his faults until his eyes were opened by the incident narrated above.

Onipede at the zenith of his popularity quite forgot himself and regarded the Prince rather as his equal or co-partner, although as a matter of fact he was in no way equal to one of his war-chiefs or his notable slaves enumerated above. Still all of them used to show him due respect and pay him marked deference as one

above them, so he came to set himself as a rival of his master ; but the incident of the Gbodo disaster was the means of his fall.

On their arrival home from the unsuccessful war, they hastened to fortify the town against an expected invasion. Atiba attended by all his great warriors was digging a trench right round the town, when Onipede rode up attended by a retinue of mounted servants. Atiba could no longer suppress his anger but ordered him to take up a digger and work like any of the common labourers. For one who had always lived an easy life Onipede's hands became blistered and sore. There are two accounts given of his death : one was that after this Atiba ordered him to be slain and buried in an upright posture when they returned home ; and that his slaves carried out his orders by showering darts upon Onipede, cut off his head and buried him in a house near the present Akesan market.

But a more probable account given of his death was as follows : The Prince and his servants began by slighting him, the latter losing no opportunity of showing him marks of disrespect. He now observed that he was no longer in favour but the exalted position he had already attained placed him above fear ; and indeed the Prince could not attack him in an open civil fight without dire results, for he was the commander of some of the greatest war-chiefs in the town. An opportunity at length was offered when he was unattended. He met Atiba where he was busy with his servants storing up hisBere grass, and there and then he

ordered his slaves to club him to death. Such was the end of Onipede.

By the death of Elebu, Oja's children lost their natural protector and guardian, and the people their chief. Prince Atiba who was aiming at the supreme power placed none of Oja's children who were capable as head of the house and chief of the town, but rather his younger brother Ailumo, whom he knew to be weak in intellect. He placed him over the house with the title of Mggaji till after the Eleduwe war, he should be formally installed as Bale of Ago. In the meantime Atiba constituted himself the administrator of the affairs of the town in the place of Oja's children and overshadowed even the Mogaji himself. Thus the fears of the late Elebu were fully realized and the town of Ago practically passed out of the hands of the children of Oja the founder.

§ 2. Atiba's Accession to the Throne

That Atiba was aspiring to the throne was evident to all when they were assembled for the Eleduwe war. He was even then far more powerful than the King and all eyes were turned upon him as the one who would eventually save the country from the Fulani yoke, In order to obtain the object of his ambition he plotted with others to bring about the downfall of the King. He bought the support of the two most powerful war-chiefs left in the land, viz., Oluyoleof Ibadan by promising him the title of Ibasorun, and KuriJmi of Ijaye by promising him that of Kakanfo.

After the fall of the ancient capital and the death of King Oluewu the crown was offered to Lagiiade, but he dechned it and advised that it should be offered to that powerful aspirant Prince Atiba, of Ago Oja; the only one with men and means, who seemed able to cope with the Ilorins and save the country from tyranny and oppression. This was done, and Atiba accepted it with the general consent and approval of all, but it was with the distinct understanding that he would lead the people home from Saki, Gboho, Kihisi, Ilorin and other places whither they had taken refuge. For this purpose Prince Lajide. son of Onsolu, and Fabiyi with 32 other messengers were sent by the Oyq Mesi at Kihisi and Igboho to invite him home to the ancient capital. They were his guests till the coronation, after which he detained them permanently at Ago and conferred on Prince Lajide the title of Ona'sokun.

After he was estabhshed on the throne, he sent Lakonu one of his powerful chiefs to Kihisi and Gboho for the remnant of the Kings' wives, and the eunuchs and other court officials that could be found in those regions.

Thus Ago passed out of the hands of Oja's family and became

the royal city of Yoruba and as such it was no longer called Ago-Oja but Oyo as the AlAfin now resides there. And hence it is often styled by way of disparagement Ago-d'Oyg (Ago which became Qyg). This is

the present city of Oyo.

§ 3. Conferring of Titles

At the conferring of titles and re-organization of the kingdom the AlAfin confirmed on those who came to him from Kihisi and Gboho the titles they had formerly borne. Those who did not care to leave the more salubrious north for forest lands were superseded in their offices. The following are those who were confirmed in their titles. Name. Title.

Makaaiye 0h6ta

Odusola Agbakin

Ariori SWu

The following were those newly conferred at the present Oyo.

Obagbolu Ona-modek^

Gbenla Lagunk

Aiyewun (from Ise5dn) Alapini

Ailes6 Tetu

Adefalu Olokuesin

Ailumg (Qja's brother) Asipa

Yesufu (Atiba's uncle) Parakoyi*

The following were titles conferred on members of the loyal family, not all of whom however were deserving. Olukokun (grandson of King Onisile) Atingisi

Telaokbki Magaji lyajin

Abioro (son of King Ajagbo) Arole Oba

Idowu (son of King Ojigi) Olusami

The following were commoners, but favourites and formerly companions-in-arms of Atiba, on whom were conferred titles usually borne by members of the Royal Family exclusively : — Falade Agunpopo

Lakonu Ogigimagi

Ladejobi Olosun

Toki La'dilu

Eniaiyewu the Alapini of the ancient city was still alive when Aiyewun was brought from Iseyin for the same office. The former remained and died at Saki.

^ In recognition of his kind services to him at the Gbodo Expedition.

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Ailgs^ had been created chief of the Tetus (they are 150 in number) before those from the ancient city arrived to claim their rights ; they had to be satisfied wth minor ranks.

Ancient Oyo was a very large city comprising the following wards : — Oke Eso, Modade, Molaba, Nsise-Ogan, Ntetu, Ondasa, On§e-awo, Aremu, Ile-Ologbo, Ajofa, Isale-Ogede.

Now, Ago d'Oyo was very small in comparison, and hence the AlAfin adopted forcible means to enlarge it. Several of the surrounding towns and villages were depopulated and the inhabitants transported to the new city e.g. Akeitan, Apara, Idod§, Ajagba Seke, Gudugbu, Jabktk, Ojomgbodu, Aguwo, Opapa and Ijoga. These places were all within lo or 20 miles from Ago. The King's army would surround each of them by night, and at break of day, the inhabitants were offered the choice of a peaceable migration to the new city

or (in case of resistance) the town would be destroyed. Thus they were transported with all their household effects and as they arrived the King assigned to each a quarter of the town for their residence. Thus Igaga was taken in the month of May during the Egugun festival.

Higher Titles

(a) The Basgrun. — Oluyole of Ibadan received the title of Ibasorun as was conditionally promised him at the Eleduwe war. He based his claim on his descent from Basorun Yamba whose cognomen was Ok61o Ogun. His father's name was Olokuoye, his mother was Agbonrin daughter of King Abiodun and thus he was the AlAfin 's nephew.

Oluyole now came to Ovo to have his title conferred upon him by the King.

This was a new departure from the old custom for the Basorun to reside in the country. His right place is in the city being the next man to the King, and the chief of the seven principal councillors of state comprising the Oyo Mesi. He, moreover, has distinct official duties to perform at the principal annual festivals especially at theBere at which he is the chief actor.

But this new departure must be allowed in order to meet the exigencies of the times. The King could not be secure on his throne if he were to cause a disaffection to arise between himself and the powerful war-chiefs of Ibadan and Ijaye by denying them the titles of their ancestors which they were so ambitious to obtain.

But a provision had already been made in the constitution for performing the state ceremonies in the absence of the Basorun : his place could be filled by either the Otun'wefa, the Qna Onse«

Awo, or the Ariwo. Thus what would have proved a serious constitutional difficulty had already been obviated by past experience, and adequately provided for.

(b) The Are-ona-Kakanfo or Yoruba Field Marshal. This title was now conferred upon Kurumi of Ijaye according to the conditional promise made to him also at the Eleduwe war by Prince Atiba. He was undoubtedly the greatest Yoruba general and tactician of the day in the Yoruba country. He was a great friend of the King and during his term of office he shielded the sovereign against the encroachment on his prerogatives of his nephew of Ibadan for he was by no means loyal to him. He also on this occasion went to Oyo to have the title conferred on him. Thus it came to pass that the two most distinguished titles next to the sovereign were held by the chiefs of the two largest towns in the south, viz. that of Basorun the head of all civil affairs, and that of Kakanfo the head of the military department.

State Policy. — In order that a collision may not take place between these two warlike towns, so contiguous to each other, a compact was now arrived at between the AlAfin a,nd his principal chiefs : —

1. That they should make it their primary aim to defend what was left of the Yoruba country, and gradually regain if they could their lost provinces under the Fulanis of Ilorin.
2. As the last King died in war, the sovereign should not be allowed to go to war any more, but conffiie himself to all religious, civil, and political matters (external relations) on behalf of the nation.
3. That the Ibadans were to protect all Yoruba towns to the north and north-east, and meet whatever danger might arise in those quarters, to have a free hand over all Ijesas and Ekitis, and the eastern provinces generally, to reduce them to subjection.
4. That the Ijayes should protect all Yoruba towns of the western provinces, and meet whatever danger appeared in that direction and carry on their operations against the Sabes and disloyal Popos.

Thus the disintegration of the country would be arrested.

But the ancient cities of Iluku, Saki, Gboho and Kihisi with their towns, containing the remnant of the citizens of the ancient Oyo and members of the royal family preferred not to be placed under the protection of either of these powers, but under the King direct ; and this was allowed. Thus it was hoped that in time the unity of the kingdom would be regained, and those who still longed for their old homes would be able to return thither.

In this way it appeared latterly that the province under the

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AlAfin is small, and foreigners ignorant of the history of the country are apt to consider Ibadan of more importance than Oyo especially when by the destruction of Ijaye the former claimed the overlordship of the territories formerly under Ijaye.

Provincial Affairs

The affairs of the new Metropohs having been settled both the Basgrun and the Kakanfo returned home to arrange their own local affairs.

Ibadan. At this time the war-chief next to the Iba himself who was head and shoulders above all his compeers at Ibadan was chief Elepo, consequently the title of Ibalogun was offered him ; but he declined it, for reasons which no one could tell. He was urged over and over again in pubhc as well as in private, both by the Basorun and his brother chiefs to accept it, but he declined, saying his name Elepo alone was enough for him. And yet he would submit to no one but the Basorun alone who was his old colleague. The title of Balogun was, therefore, conferred upon Oderinlg.

The following were the titles conferred upon distinguished war-chiefs : —

Names. Titles.

Od§rinlg Balogun or commander-in-chief.

Lajumgke Otun i.e. general commanding the right

Opeagbe Osi i.e. general commanding the left wing

Toki Seriki

Babalgla Asipa

Oyesile Abese

Ogunrenu Sarumi or chief of the cavalry

Yerombi Agbakin

Dele Areagoro

Ijaye. — The Are-ona-Kakanfo of Ijaye was a bloodthirsty tyrant. He put to death all the chiefs rising into power who might become his rivals. His Balogun's name was Olasilo alias Ogun-koroju, a Mohammedan, and the friend of Balogun Oderinle of Ibadan. He was the only man at Ijaye for whom Kurumi entertained any regard. One Ajayi was his Areagoro, and this was about all the titles given at Ijaye. Nevertheless there were other powerful men at Ijaye such as Lakusk, AgSlna Epo, Fanyaka, Akigla, Asegbe, Amgdu and Labudanu. Lahan after the destruction of Abemg came to reside at Ijaye.

Kurumi usurped all power both civil and religious ; all were centred on him or his family, and all the profits accruing from

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them flowed to his exchequer. His brother Popoola was the AlagbS, or Egugun high priest, himself the Mogba or head Sango priest. His chief executioner was one J6mgban. The Kakanfo was more dreaded at Ijaye than even the gods as the common sajnng shows " Are npe o o ndifa ? Bi If a fo rere ti Are fg ibi nko ? (You receive the Are's summons and you are divining with your Ifa ? What if Ifa is propitious and the Are is not ?) He did not value the life of a human being more than that of a dog. For the least offence he ordered the offender to execution and plundered his house. But he was more of a terror to rank and station, for to the poor, he granted liberty and redress.

The Agbamaja War

It has become the custom at Ibadan that a newly created Balogun should lead the army out on an expedition in order to prove his worth to the title and thereby commend himself to the respect of the soldiery. But no town at this time gave any cause of offence for an attack, all the same the Balogun was sent against Ede—a town under their own protection. But it would appear that Elepo vetoed the destruction of Ede and so they marched on towards Ilobu.

The people of Ilobu became alarmed. They had not committed any offence, but although they were assured of peaceful measures yet they brought a large amount of presents to the Ibadan camp to buy off their hostihty, and showed every sign of submission. All the same, the soldiery becoming restive from inaction would have sacked the town but for Elepo, especially when it happened that lightning struck a house in the town and the war boys became wild, and rushed to the spot under pretext of doing homage to Sango, while others were already scahng the walls when E16po and his men undertook to beat them off and save Ilobu. From that town and the surrounding villages presents came pouring into the Ibadan camp but instead of going to the Balogun all went to Elepo, before whose tents all the presents were piled up. He neither directed them to the commander-in-chief nor made use of them for himself. He ruled the army according to his will, and consequently the Balogun was indignant at this usurpation of his rights and the other chiefs sympathized with him. After frittering away their time doing nothing the men became disheartened and began to steal away home. Hence this expedition was termed " Agbamaja," i.e. fully armed but engaging in no fight.

The Basorun at home was kept informed of all that was going on at the seat of war and when they arrived at home a mass meeting was held of all the war-chiefs and men and the whole of

them complained bitterly against Elepo ; he was accused to his face of usurping the rights of the Balogun when he had himself declined the office, but on account of the love and respect they had for him they were prepared to let bygones be bygones, only he must prostrate before the Balogun and offer an apology and the matter would end there He apologised but would never bemean himself by prostrating before the Balogun. This last act therefore set a seal upon his downfall ; his humiliation was there and then decided upon.

The next step taken was to deprive him of his principal subordinate war-chiefs by conferring town titles on each of them, making them members of the town council with equal votes. Elepo's eyes were now open to his own folly, but almost too late. At the next public meeting, he apologized again but was too proud to prostrate before any one save the Basorun alone. He was told all round that his apology was accepted and the pardon granted. He went home glad at heart, but was soon to be undeceived, for when he went the following day to the houses of all the principal chiefs to thank them, not one of them would see him ; at every house he called he was told " The master is not at home." He understood the full import of this, and moreover none of his subordinate chiefs called at his house as before, and all matters in his quarter of the town were taken straight to the Balogun. Thus Elepo saw himself isolated.

§ 4. The Osogbo War. The Ilorins Checkmated

After a short pause that followed the Eleduwe war, the aggressive spirit of the Ilorins once more impelled them to the accomplishment of their aim, viz., the subversion of the entire Yoruba country, and hence for the third time they laid siege to Osogbo. The command this time was entrusted to their brave and experienced general AH, the Hausa Balogun of Ilorin.

Osogbo was closely besieged, and terrible battles were fought between the assailants and defenders to the advantage of the former. When the king of Osogbo found the Ilorins too strong for him he sent to Ibadan for help.

It now devolved upon the Ibadans as defenders of the north and north-east to meet the coming danger. They sent them some auxiliaries under the leadership of one Ob^le alias Mobitcin, and Alade Abinupagiin. As this force proved insufficient for the defence of the town, another contingent was sent under a more experienced leader. But still the Ilorins were gaining ground after every battle until the besieged and their auxiliaries were confined to the thickets surrounding the town which in all Yoruba

towns were reserved for the purposes of defence. The Ibadan contingent thereupon sent an express report home to theBasorun that they would soon be overpowered and the town taken if timely aid was not forthcoming.

The Basorun unwilling that the Fulanis and Jamas of Ilorin should be masters of the forest lands to which they had been driven from their homes in the plain, was resolved to raise the siege at all cost. It was with the Ibadans a matter of now or never and hence the Balogun was instructed to endeavour to deal a decisive blow to the Ilgrins once and for all, for should he fail now the Fulanis would be masters of the whole Yoruba country.

Balogun Oderinlg now marched out with the whole of the Ibadan mighty men save Elepo and the Basorun, the former having been rejected by the war-chiefs for his actions at the late Agbamaja expedition. TheBasorun approved of this resolve and therefore Elepo stayed at home, but he felt himself far too exalted to care for any of them.

When the Ibadan army arrived at the seat of war and saw the situation they had some misgivings as to the probabihty of success without the aid of Elepo their champion. They could not show their face in the open field for fear of the Ilorin horse, and for about 20 days after their arrival at Osogbo, they also could not fight outside the town thickets.

The Basorun himself having some doubts as to the hopes of success of his generals in the absence of Elepo was much depressed in mind on hearing the news from the seat of war, and he was minded to send Elepo to meet them ; he gave him a cow to worship his god On and told him to prepare to join his comrades in the field.

The Ibadan war-chiefs hearing this were fired with jealousy lest the honour of the victory might be his and hence were resolved to risk a battle at all cost. Again and again they held councils of war, and at length they fixed a day for the venture. Still they were afraid to attack the florins during the morning hours, Osogbo being practically in a plain, the Ilorin horse might have the advantage of them with disastrous results : from prudence therefore they resolved to make the attack in the afternoon, as they might be able to hold on until dusk when the florins would no longer be able to use their horses to advantage, or if defeated, the shades of night would assist them in their retreat.

About 2 p.m. the standard of the Ibadan army left the gate of Osogbo for the battlefield. Again, another council of war was held and it was finally resolved that they should not proceed until dark, as it was necessary that their movements be as private as possible. About sunset they were again on the move and the

vanguards were instructed to keep a strict watch and arrest anyone suspected as a spy on their movements.

About a mile from the Ilorin camp they halted and arranged the order of the attack. The Osogbo army and the earlier auxiliaries were to maintain the centre of the battle, Chiefs Abitiko and Lajubu to command the right wing, Balogun Oderinlo with the rest of the Ibadan war-chiefs to form the left wing of the army. About midnight the Ilorin camp was attacked on all sides. The watch word was Elo ni owo odo ? (The fare of the ferry ?) [The river Osun had to be crossed in entering Osogbo from the south. Any one who could not tell was known to be an enemy.] The first camp attacked was that of the Elese, and as soon as they rushed in, they set it on fire. The Elese himself was shot dead as soon as he showed his face at the tent door. A panic seized the whole Ilorin army thus startled from their beds ; they could not offer the slightest resistance, they simply melted away ! Those who fell by the hands of their own friends to make way for their hasty flight were probably more than those who fell by the hands of their enemies. Several who summed up courage enough to saddle their horses had not the presence of mind to loose them and were caught in the stables digging spurs into the poor beasts and wondering why they would not go, forgetting that they were still tethered by the feet.

But Ali the commander-in-chief was calm and resolute ; he ordered his horse to be saddled, and gathering around him a goodly portion of his cavalry they dashed through the ranks of the Ibadan army ; these quickly making a way for them to gallop through without daring to oppose them, especially as numbers of the men were scattered about on plundering bent.

The principal Ilorin war-chiefs captured in this defeat were : —

1. Jimba the head slave of the Emir of Ilorin.
2. One of the sons of Ah the commander-in-chief.
3. Chiet Lateju and
4. Ajikobi the Yoruba Balogun of Ilorin.

The first two were released and sent home privately by the Ibadan war-chiefs, a form of chivalrous etiquette among the war-chiefs. The latter two being Yorubas by .birth were regarded rather as traitors to their country, and were sent home to Ibadan as distinguished captives of war.

The Basorun sentenced Lateju to death alleging that it was in his house that King Oluewu, the last of the ancient Oyo, was fettered when taken at the Eleduwe war, before he was put to death. That was the ostensible charge but the chief reason really was because Oluyole's wives fell into Lat§ju's hands at

the collapse of that expedition, and he was not chivalrous enough to release them and send them to him as a brother chief.

Ajikobi being a more distinguished personage was sent to the AlAfin of Oyo for capital punishment.

The messengers with the illustrious captive met the King engaged in one of his annual festivals, and he ordered that the feti de joie his servants were then firing should be directed on Ajikobi. This was- accordingly done, and he was roasted to death with gunpowder.

Besides a large number ot captives the Ibadans captured numbers of horses but very few of them were brought home. These hardy people cared very little then for the luxury of riding on horseback : what they cared for more was the horses' tails upon which to tie amulets as preventives against bullets in war. These were always a part of their war kits. The only attention bestowed on the hundreds of tailless horses now roaming about the field was for replenishing their larder as occasion required !

This victory at Osogbo was a most important one and forms a turning point in Yoruba history. It saved the Yoruba country as such from total absorption by the Fulanis as a tributary state. From this time forth the power of the Ilorins for an independent aggressive warfare in Yoruba land was for ever broken and the Ibadans gained the ascendancy. The Ilorins without losing sight of their ultimate objective to '' dip the Koran in the sea," i.e. the subjugation of the entire Yoruba land, henceforth contented themselves with allying themselves now with one, and then- with the other of the contending tribes with the hope of ultimately weakening the whole, so that eventually the entire country might fall an easy prey into their hands.

That the AlAfin did not seize this opportunity to gather all the forces of the kingdom and strike a final blow at the enemy was a matter of surprise to many, but a great dread was still entertained of meeting the cavalry in the plain, in which case it would not be that of Ilgrin alone, but also those of Sokoto and Gando. Hence the return home to the ancient capital was fraught with danger, the probabihty of their being continually harassed and attacked and taken by surprise being very great.

Other reasons also have been advanced for remaining in their present position, among which was the comparative proximity to the coast and greater facilities for trade. As new generations sprang up who knew Httle or nothing of the old country they grew less and less disposed to abandon the comparative safety and advantages of the present position for the old cities with all the attendant risks, however fertile and salubrious they might be.

After the siege of Osogbo was raised, Ibokun an Ijesa town not far from Osogbo was taken by the Ibadans, being one of the tributary towns and allies of Ilorin. On the approach of the enemy, having heard of the defeat of the Ilorins at Osogbo, Kusi the Ilorin Resident of the town escaped to Ilorin leaving Ibokun to its fate.

§ 5. The Expulsion of Elepo from Ibadan

Chief Elepo not being allowed by his colleagues to go with them to the Osogbo expedition, and having heard of their success marched out with his own troops against Otefan, a Yoruba town in the western province, which he took, and returned home with many captives and much booty by which he satisfied the cravings of his war boys, whose loyalty to him prevented them from going with their comrades to a successful expedition.

After his return from Otefan, Elepo was told by the Basorun that the other war-chiefs in the field had sent home to say that he should leave the town, alleging that he was heard to have said that they could not achieve any victory without his leadership, and now that the Ilorins had received a crushing defeat at their hands without his presence, it was evident they could do without him. Whether this message was actually sent or whether it was an arrangement concocted between the Basorun and the war-chiefs is not certain, but as a matter of fact the whole of them stood in dread of him and he was also an object of envy and jealousy. It is evident that if the Basorun had been as true to him as he was loyal to the Basorun such a question could not have arisen at all. Elepo was said to have been the greatest general Ibadan ever produced ; before him and after him there has yet been none to be compared to him whose very name strikes terror and confusion in all around. Eyen the Basorun himself was secretly afraid of him, as with one breath he could upset him and his government, and yet there has never been a chief at Ibadan so humble, so loyal and devoted to his chief as Elepo was to the Basorun. But for him Oluyole could never have attained to his present position nor could have maintained it for a month, before his murder or expulsion would have ended his career.

Oluyole was blind to his own interests when he was arranging this plot against Elepo. Elepo on the other hand, unsuspicious of the intrigues of his chief, was negotiating through him with the other chiefs. He loved and trusted him too well for him to entertain the slightest doubt of his good faith.

As the war-chiefs were on their homeward march, threatening messages were said to have been sent to Elepo through the Basorun ;

the latter, in order that he might be able to accomphsh his design, ill-advised Elepo to leave his house a while, assuring him that all would be right in the end. He knew quite well that as long as Elepo was in his own house their plansmust fail, for no one would dare to face the lion in his den.

Atipo his brother at once suspected the intriguer by such advice, and asked, " Why should it be deemed necessary for the Mogaji (i.e. Elepo) to leave his house when you the chief were employing your good offices for him ? Which of the war-chiefs would be bold enough either to go against your declared wish or to attack Elepo backed by his chief the Basorun ? " But the Basorun evaded the question ; on the contrary he kept pressing the point with great urgency knowing that once Elepo left his house he would never be allowed to return to it.

Elepo disheartened by the bad faith of his hitherto trusted lord jdelded with pain' and disappointment only out of respect to him. He removed all his effects to the Basorun's house as well as all the captives and booty from the late Otefan expedition. Thus unmindful of the good Elepo had done him when he was somewhat similarly situated after the O^a expedition, Oluyole requited him with ingratitude out of sheer jealousy ; he desired to wield an absolute power and felt he could not safely do so with such a man under him, and thus he plotted to gain his end at the expense of a faithful and loyal friend and colleague.

When the war-chiefs were nearer home, Oluyole told Elepo that he had failed in his negotiations with them and that they threatened a civil war in case he sided with him, and consequently should Elepo leave the town he, the Basorun, would arrange matters with them so that he might return home in peace.

By this Elepo saw plainly the intrigues of his friend and master. Thrice he asked him pointedly " Do you really mean me to leave the town ? " Each time the reply was " Yes for the present but all will be right in the end." Then chiet Elepo uttered the following parable : — " Once upon a time the leopard was king of the beasts, and the god Orisa was the only object of his dread. The Orisa's house was built in the open fields, and he was protected with an earthenware pot. The beasts of the field had no respect for Orisa but used to walk and graze around the pot with which he was covered without incurring any harm. But at the yearly festival when king Leopard headed all the beasts to worship the Orisa, to their surprise, he used to

prostrate at a distance, and do homage by putting earth on his head, and never allowed any of the beasts to approach too near lest they give offence to the Orisa. The beasts used to say among themselves ' And why

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all this precaution ? We often grazed around that pot without experiencing any harm, can Oiisa kill at all as king Leopard would have us believe ? ' Now upon one such occasion when the Leopard and all the beasts in his train were prostrating at a distance, the Orisa said to the Leopard ' Why not allow these my children to draw near to me ? ' The Leopard rephed, ' O most adorable Orisa, the beasts you would have to approach your sacred presence are ignorant creatures that know not your worth ; were they allowed to do so they will tread on the mat on which you are seated and will soon after end by treading on yourself.' This parable is for you, 0 Basorun. The war-chiefs you are making so much of do not know your worth, they pay honours to you only on my account, and should I leave the town as you say, they will soon tread upon the mat on which you are seated and finally upon yourself."

After this Elepo left the town with about 1,000 followers and retired first to Ipara a town in Ijebu Remo and resided there for a while.

Civil War at Ibadan

Not long after the departure of El^po the truth of his parable became quite evident, the prophecy had all but obtained a terrible fulfilment.

Enriched by the treasures of the expelled chieftain, and his wealth further augmented by the portion allotted to him by his war-chiefs from the successful expedition of Osogbo, Oluyole became much elated, feeling himself now the sole and absolute master of the town of Ibadan without the fear of any possible rival. But it was not long before an insurrection was raised against him ; Chiefs Olubodun, Akiliyi, Atipo, Lajubu, Akinlabi and Ogidi took up arms against him and the whole town was soon in an uproar. Nothing but the mere chance of their leader Olubodun being killed before the action really commenced brought the rising to a sudden close.

One of OluyQle's men from the roof of his house espied Olubodun hastening to the scene of action and as he m.ust pass by the corner of his house to gain the main street, the man raised the thatch of his roof, levelled his gun at Olubodun at very close quarters and shot him dead on the spot ! The suddenness and unexpectedness with which this was accomplished created a panic among his followers and it spread instantly among the other chiefs and their men, and they fled precipitately pursued by Oluyole's men. Akiliyi and Ogidi were taken but the rest escaped to Ijaye. Akihyi was executed. Ogidi was pardoned, but was ordered out of his

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house and district at Isale Ijebu, the former being levelled to the ground and left in ruins, and he had to occupy a small house at Isale Osun under strict surveillance.

[The site of the house was subsequently given to the Rev. D. Hinderer the first missionary of the Church Missionary Society at Ibadan in 1851 and has since become the C.M.S. station at Oke Kudeti.]

IjAYE AND THE IbADAN REFUGEES

Of the three men who escaped to Ijaye after the tragic end of Olubgdun, Lajubu somehow effected a return home and was pardoned, but Atipo and Akinlabi did not return but made Ijaye their home permanently.

They occupied the house of one Akiola who was put to death by the Are of Ijaye under the following painful circumstances : — In one af their expeditions to the Sabe provinces Akiola captured a young maiden of whom he became enamoured ; he first shared his bed with her, and on the return home of the expedition this captive was among others he apportioned to their chief Kurumi the Are of Ijaye. But the Are also was captivated by the charms of this young woman and he at once included her in his harem. And so it happened that on finding afterwards that she had already been tampered with, he became enraged with Akiola and constituted this a crime for which he murdered him !

Atipo and Akinlabi retaining the spirit and energy of Ibadan were restless at Ijaye ; they made two expeditions to the banks of the Niger on their own account, captured Ogodo in the first and Gbajigbo in the second expedition, and brought home many captives and much booty.

After this Atipo went to Ipara to fetch his brother El^po to Ijaye by way of Ilugun. Elepo's followers had by this time dwindled to about 70 men, the rest having returned home to Ibadan weary of the inaction at Ipara.

Oluyole became very jealous of the success and the popularity of these men at Ijaye, and Kurumi ever suspicious of any brave and distinguished man, readily listened to the insinuations of the former that these men would one day prove a danger to the state, that they would sooner or later desert him for Ilorin (their common enemy) and that Kurumi should at once dispose of them.

Kurumi invited them both to a banquet and there, completely in his power, he murdered them both and seized all their property. Thus ended the career of these brave men of Ibadan and Ijaye.

Chapter XVI A SERIES OF FRATRICIDAL WARS

After the events narrated above, the history of the Yorubas centred largely at Ibadan which, down to the time of the British Protectorate continued to attract to itself ardent spirits from every tribe and family all over the country, who made it their home, so that while the rest of the country was quiet, Ibadan was making history.

An Episode. — The Osu War. — After the return of the Ibadans from the Ota war, and the civil war which placed Oluyole at the head of the government, Inakoju the Seriki died and was succeeded by one Ladanu. After his promotion, Ladanu led out an expedition to Osu which turned out disastrous. He was accompanied by most of Oluyole's men, e.g , Akinsowon, Abipa, Aijenku and Erinle S^nku.

Osu not being far from Ile§a the capital of the Ijesa country, the Ijesas, hearing of their approach, lay in ambush, and cut the Seriki's army in pieces. The Seriki himself in an attempt to rally his discomfited army was slain. Chiefs Akinsowon and Abipa were also slain leaving Aijenku and Erinle Sanku who escaped with difficulty alone to tell the tale.

The Eleduwe war which followed soon after, and the Abemo and Osogbo wars subsequently, fully engaged the attention of the Ibadans ; now they were at leisure they were resolved to avenge the loss of their late Seriki. Balogun Oderinlg led out the whole Ibadan army. Their route lay through the Ede farms and there they were encamped for many days foraging. The Ije.sas of the capital joined by the army of Osu met them at Iloba which was 4 hours to Osu eastward, and between 6 and 8 hours to Ile§a, Osu itself being about 6 hours to Ilesa. Here several battles were fought, and when the Ijesas could stand the fire of the Ibadans no longer, they evacuated the town, and the place was taken. The Ibadans followed up the victory to Osu their objective, but the town had been deserted ; they made no captives there but carried away booties, and returned home to Ibadan in triumph. After this there arose a series of neighbourly strifes all over the

§ I. A A YE AND OtUN

Whilst the revolutionary wars were raging all over the rest of the Yoruba country, the Fulanis devastating the Metropolitan province, the Oygs the Egba province, and the Ifes, Ijebus and Oygs striving for predominance in the south, the Ijesa and Ekiti provinces, save for the late Pole war, were enjoying the blessings of peace. Entrenched in their mountain fastnesses, they were safe from the Fulani horse and other foes.

But it seems they were not to be exempt from the ban that hung over the rest of the Yoruba nation, and hence they commenced an internal strife among themselves, which led to their inviting outside help and resulted in their final subjugation.

A^ye and Otun were two towns in the Efon and Ekiti districts contiguous to one another ; the people bear the same relationship to each other as the Egba bear towards the Oyos or Ijebus. They are all included under the term Ekiti.

A feud arose between these two towns about their boundaries which culminated in a war in which Otun was worsted, but so determined on revenge was the Olotun (king of Otun) that he sought help from abroad ; he sent to Ibadan for that purpose and Balogun Oderinlo was sent out with the whole of the Ibadan army, and Akye was besieged.

Finding that the Ibadans were too strong for them the Alaye (king of Aaye) sought help from Ilorin, and the Ilorin horse under their general Afunku appeared in the field in aid of Aciye. The choice fell on the Fulani Balogun as the Hausa and Yoruba Baloguns of the Ilorins had already failed at Osogbo.

The Ilorins did their best to raise the siege by attacking the Ibadans in the rear, but the Ibadans rounded on them and inflicted on them a severe defeat. Their leader general Afunku fell in the conflict, about lOO Ilorins were made prisoners, and the rest escaped home, leaving Aaye to its fate.

Such a turn of affairs was least expected at Aaye. The town was now closely invested, and when they were reduced to feeding on roots of trees, reptiles, and other loathsome objects they went about the streets bewailing their misfortunes and endeavouring to move the sympathy of their kinsmen of Otun, and sang " Olotun nje otito li o yio fi kini yi se ? " (O king of Otun, will you then make of this matter a stern reality ?)

But there were some men in the town who were encouraging them to hold out a Httle longer, saying that great as their distress was in the town, greater still was it in the Ibadan camp where they were reduced to pounding hay for food ; and if their allies could not raise the siege, famine would do it for them.

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Thus encouraged, the men of Aaye held out heroically, they built forts upon the town walls from which sharp shooters harassed the Ibadans continually, and among those killed by that means was a notable chief Toki Onibudo^ the Seriki of Ibadan. But when they could hold out no longer, when men, women, and children were dying in the stieets from starvation, Fagbefiro the Alaye with his mother were resolved to risk going in person to the Ibadan camp to sue for peace.

When they entered the camp and were being conducted to the Balogun's quarters, the Alaye was overcome with surprise on finding yam, corn, flour, and other articles of food exposed in the market for sale, " What do I see ? " exclaimed he " What about the famine we were told existed in the Ibadan camp so that men were reduced to feeding on pounded hay? " He there and then ordered some yam to be purchased for him, even before he got to the presence of the Balogun.

The Balogun received the Alaye in a friendly manner, and terms of peace were agreed upon, the Alaye promising to serve the Ibadans. But he was told that as they could not return home to Ibadan empty-handed, he should give them a small force and a guide to Isan the next town of importance ; and in order to allay the Alaye's apprehensions the Balogun ordered a chief named Lajubu to return with the Alaye to the town to protect the same against the wild soldiery until the whole army had passed on to Iskn. But this seems to have been a ruse, for Lajubu and the Alaye had scarcely reached the gate of the town when the whole Ibadan army was on the move, Lajubu himself rushed forward not to protect the place, but to be amongst the first in plundering and slave-catching. Very few however were the captives taken, as famine had done its worst with them ; most of the survivors were weak and sickly, with oedematous hands and feet, and only about 100 comparatively able-bodied were found amongst them, and even these nearly all soon perished from the indiscretion of their captors, who in hopes of restoring them speedily to sound health fed them immoderately after a long spell of starvation.

The Ibadan army pushed on and took Oro, Yapa, Isi and Isan. At the last mentioned place all the war-chiefs remained, but the war-boys followed up the conquest as far as to Itagi, where they suffered a disaster and were checked.

The people of Itagi left their town and hid themselves in the bush hard by. The Ibadan war-boys having rushed in, dispersed

1 This chief was succeeded by his nephew, Ibikunle, who became a famous Balogun.

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all over the town, intent on plundering ; when the Itagi armed men came out and hunted them down everywhere butchering them to pieces. Chief Lajubu was amongst those caught in the market place and there he ended his career.

This expedition opened the way for the Ibadan raids into the Ekiti country, which continued year by year until the whole of that province was brought under subjugation by them as will be seen hereafter, and they remained a subject people under the Ibadans until, united in one, they struck for freedom, which was won by the aid of the British government many years after.

§ 2. The Egbas and Egbados

About the same time as the events recorded in the previous section, the Egbas were waging war with some of the Egbado tribes. Ado was besieged, but held out for many years. All the Baloguns of Abeokuta were there present except their chief Sodeke ; but they spent their strength and skill to no purpose.

It was just about this time (A.D. 1843) that the Missionaries of the C.M.S. arrived at Abeokuta for inspection with a view to carrying on mission work in this country. The pioneer was the Rev. Henry Townsend a European missionary, with Mr. Andrew Wilhelm Desalu his interpreter, both from Sierra Leone. They met Chief Sodeke the Balogun of Itoku and leader of the Egbas to Abeokuta who received them with a cordial welcome. Mr. Townsend left Abeokuta after a short stay with a promise to return soon for a permanent stay amongst them tor missionary work.

Thus light began to dawn on the Yoruba country from the south, when there was nothing but darkness, idolatry, superstition, blood shedding and slave-hunting all over the rest of the country. There was an old tradition in the country of a prophecy that as ruin and desolation spread from the interior to the coast, so light and restoration will be from the coast interior-wards. This was a tradition of ages. Is not this event the beginning of its fulfilment ? Whilst the Egbas were encamped before Ado, the Dahomians led out an expedition, and were on the march for Ilaro. It was privately reported to the Egbas that the Dahomians would suddenly fall on them and raise the siege. Hearing this the Egbas first sent out spies to ascertain their situation ; they thereupon surprised the Dahomians one morning as they spread themselves about their camp airing and drying their accoutrements that had got wet from a drenching rain after a storm that took place on the previous evening. In the confusion of the flight the Egbas captured the standard of the Dahomian army, which was an umbrella made

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of the skins of different kinds of animals, and burnt it. It was said that the King of Dahomey negotiated for it, and would have redeemed it at any price, but as it had been destroyed, it could not be restored ; and this was the cause of the mortal enmity and s>vorn hatred that has existed between successive Kings of Dahomey and the Egbas of Abeokuta unto this day. By the intervention of the Rev. Hy. Townsend, the siege of Ado was raised after a duration of 5 or 6 years, and the Egbas returned

§ 3. Ibadan and Ijaye. The Batedo War, a.d. 1844

Inflated with the success of his intrigues at home and his arms abroad, the Basorun of Ibadan was aspiring to the throne of Oyo ! That this was so was evident from his style and manner at this time, and the insinuations his drummer was permitted to make when greeting him : —

" Iba, kuku joba, (Be the King at once, my lord,

Mase bi Oba mo." Cease acting like a King).

He, however, had his own misgivings ; he was the King's nephew but by the female line, and no such succession is possible in the Yoruba country. He would however make a venture trying might where he had no right, and in order to effect his purpose he was seeking occasion for a rupture with the AlAfin, and at the same time, by entreaty and bribery, endeavouring to secure the connivance if not the alliance of the Are of Ijaye, the only obstacle in his way. The latter refused to listen to him, and even remonstrated with him for his presumption and disloyalty to his lawful sovereign whose first minister he was. But as he would not be dissuaded from his projects, the Are finally sent word to say no one would venture to attack Oyo unless he the Are-ona-Kakanfo be first removed out of the way.

The Are kept the King well informed of all that was passing between himself and the Basorun. His Majesty also was well aware of the Basorun's intentions and of his power, hence he dealt wisely and patiently with him, never evincing any hostile spirit towards him, nor taking any notice of his insults. Thrice did Oluyole the Basorun send word to the King to say he should now fulfil the promise he made before his coronation to lead the people back home and remove the seat of government back to the ancient capital. The King knowing his intentions, thus replied to the messengers on the tliird and last time : " Tell your master that if he is ready let him come on, I am ready. As the present Oyo is on the high way to the ancient capital, he should start

first and meet me here." At the same time the AlAfin was fortifjang the town against a sudden attack, and employed a fetishman one Latubosun to bury charms at all the gates leading to the city as a preventive. As he was evincing much anxiety for the safetj' of the town both this fetishman and the Ondasa (the official fetishman) assured him that not a single shot would be fired against this place.

Oluyole on the other hand lost no opportunity of seeking an occasion for a rupture between himself and the King. He sent a body of troops to intercept Abudu Alelo and Kosija the Ilari whom the King sent to Porto Novo for a supply of ammunition. Abudu's teeth were shattered by the fire of one of Oluygle's men, for this the King neither remonstrated with Oluyole nor demanded a redress knowing it to be a deliberate casus belli ; he treated the matter as an accident.

With Kurumi the Are also Oluyole was provoking a rupture as he was the only obstacle in the way of his carrying out of his projects. He demanded that Kurumi as Kakanfo should acknowledge the seniority of himself as Basorun by coming in person to Ibadan to pay his respects to him, as he goes to Oyo to do homage. Kuriimi was too wide awake to venture his head into the lion's mouth, notwithstanding that Ogun-ko-roju his Balogun urged him to comply for the sake of peace. The Basorun constituted this refusal a casuf belli.

A circumstance, however, occurred which accelerated the war. One Asu the Areagoro of Ladejo, an Ijaye chief, was expelled the town for treason, and he escaped to Fiditi, a town mid-way between Ijaye and Oyo; he rebuilt the ruins and had the town re-inhabited. The Kakanfo sent a company of 100 men to surprise and disperse this Httle band, but they found Asu and his men ready, and proving too strong for them, they were defeated and driven back. Fearing therefore the resentment of the Are, Asu sent to Ibadan for help. TheBasor un who had long been seeking an opportunity for war against Ijaye hailed the present offer and sent out Balogun Oderinlo and Ibikunle the Seriki with instructions to confine their operations to kidnapping expeditions in Ijaye and Oyo farms, in order to harass them, and render farming both useless and unsafe so that famine might do half the work before a direct attack was made.

This continued for many months and several skirmishes took place on the Aregbe hills in the Ijaye farms with varying results. At length the Ibadans suffered a great disaster at Odogido in the Ijaye farms which put an end to the Fiditi campaign. On that eventful day the Balogun arranged to lead an expedition

to the Oyo farms and entrusted that to the Ijaye farms to the Seriki. At a place called Odogido the Ijayes lay in ambush and suddenly attacked the Seriki's army on all sides and routed it completely. About 140 masters of compounds " who went to war on horseback " were caught and slain exclusive of private soldiers. It was said that Ibikunle the Seriki himself only escaped by falling into some friendly hands and was quietly let off. The Ijayes pressed hard in pursuit until it was dark and the shadows of night saved the remnant ot the defeated. Hence this expedition was sometimes named " Oru gba mi 1^." (The night saved me.) One Lampejg was wounded in about 60 places all over his body„ and was left for dead, but at night he revived and found his way

The expedition to the Oyo farms under the Balogun was also unsuccessful, though not disastrous ; not a single captive was brought back with him for they met nobody in the farms.

The Are of Ijaye put to death all the captives that fell into his hands ; and made a platform on which he piled up the heads of the slain. For three months after this, the Ibadans remained inactive at Fiditi.

Oluyole received the news with great indignation. He was resolved upon a siege of Ijaye ; and at once declared war and ordered his army at Fidih to meet him on the way thither ; they met him at Ojoho his first encampment about six miles from Ibadan.

Thence they removed to Ika about midway between the two belligerent towns. From this place they began to clear the bush taking a north-easterly direction to the Ijaye farms which they reached on the 5th day and there encamped. Here the Ijayes met them and for two full years hard battles were fought with equal success on both sides ; but the war was very unpopular.

Also an incident reported from home contributed largely to the failure of the expedition on the part of the Ibadans. The warchiefs were told of the Basorun's boast when he heard of the disaster of Odogido that if there remained but himself alone and Oyainu (his favourite wife) he would take Ijaye. Oyainu herself, a lady of a masculine temperament and very popular was heard to swear by the Egugun gods (a thine; forbidden to women) that if the war was left to herself alone, she would take Ijaye.

The war-chiefs were naturally hurt by this impHed slur cast upon them by the Basorun and his wife. This, added to the unnaturalness of the conflict, rendered them perfectly indifferent to the issue of the war, they followed their chief and his wife halfheartedly, rather as spectators to see how far they could do without them ; it was even asserted that some of the chiefs fired only

blank ammunition. Whatever maybe the truth of these reports, it was qiiite certain that the war was unpopular, and that the Basgrun and his wife had to bear the brunt of the battle.

The war at length became a general one. Both sides sought the alliance of the Egbas ; the Egba chiefs were divided, Sodek§ and Anoba declared for Ijaye, but Apati being Oluyole's friend and relative declared for Ibadan. Sodeke himself never went beyond Arakanga, 3 miles from home, but sent his eldest son forward to Ijaye.

The alliance of Ogbomoso was also sought ; there was also a division here, the Bale declared for Ijaye but Ogurunbi a notable war-chief, for Ibadan. Oluygle further sought the alliance of the Emir of Ilorin and the aid of his powerful Balogun Ali. He also sent provisions for the Ilorin troops on account of the great scarcity of food then at Ilorin, and asked them to beseige Ogbomoso. He also sent a contingent force of infantry in aid of the Ilorins. The men of Ogbomoso defeated this army but could not pursue them far, for fear of the Ilorin horse.

The Oke Ogun districts also were divided in their allegiance Iseyin declared for both Ijaye and Ibadan. [The fact is that that town was practically situated between two fires]. But He Bioku Berekodo, Igbo Ora and Pako were for Ibadan.

In the Eastern districts Apomu, Ikire and Osogbo were vassals of Ibadan and had no choice, but Iwo and Ede revolted. The people of Ede were at first the allies of the Ibadans, and Folarin their prince was in the Ibadan camp from the beginning of the campaign, but when he received information that his people at home had revolted, he one day went over with all his men to Ijaye and was there received with open arms. The Are sent him home in peace under the escort of Chief Elepo late of Ibadan.

Lodifi an Iwo chief also went over and was similarly sent home. But Kolokg and Adepo two Ibadan war-chiefs were stationed at Ejigbo to raid the Ede farms ; when therefore Prince Folarin and Chief Elepo arrived at Ede, they went against Ejigbo to drive away these raiders. Elepo, confident in the terror his very name inspired thought they would not dare await his approach, but alas, that time for Elepo was past and gone ; Prince Folarin fell in an engagement and Elepo was seriously wounded in the arms. He was thus invalided at Ede for about a whole year before he was sufficiently recovered to return to Ijaye.

Thus the war between Ibadan and Ijaye involved nearly the whole country ; it lasted for two full years and during this period, the deadly conflict was chiefly between the Basorun and the Arg, for Odgrinlo the Balogun of Ibadan and Oguoroju the Balogun of

liaye had free though private communication with each other, and so all the minor chiefs and privates on both sides met each his kinsman and exchanged greetings and presents with one another.

The Alafin of Oyo held himself quite neutral and rendered no aid to either party and was thus able to come forward as an arbitrator between the contending parties. He sent the emblems of the god Sango with the high priest from Oyo to Ijaye, and thence to the Ibadan camp saying, " What the king on earth may not be able to effect, surely the King from the other world can do, and this unnatural conflict must now cease."

Sango's intervention was respected by both parties now tired of the war, and peace was immediately concluded. The Ibadans in the camp flocked to Ijaye and vice versa, ^dich. one to see his friends and relatives and to offer congratulations.

It was during this war that locusts were first seen in the Yoruba country. They swarmed through the land and devoured every blade of green grass, but there was no famine in consequence for providentially it occurred just before cereals were planted, and they did not pass over the same region again ; but there was agricultural depression in some parts of the country for the locusts did not altogether disappear from the land for about two years.

§ 4. Abeokut aand Abaka. The AbAka War, a.d. 1846

About a year after their return from the Ado war, and after the death of Sodeke the Egbas found a pretext for waging war against Abak^ a suburban village. It was at first considered an easy task, but the Abaka men defended theii town so vigorously that they compelled the Egbas to beat a hasty retreat. The war was, however, renewed and the small town closely invested for fully four months and was reduced by famine. The distinguished Egba war-chiefs then were ; Apati the Generalissimo, Anoba, Olufakun, Somoye, Ogunbgna of Ikija and others. On their return from this expedition about 150 captives were allotted to Anoba alone.

The Egbas being now fully settled in their new home, Abeokuta, deemed it necessary to organize themselves for complete civil duties and have a king over them ; and Okukenu one of their war-chiefs who bore the Oyo title of Sagbua (one of the junior Esos of Oyo) was unanimously elected the first king of Abeokuta.

§ 5, The Ile Bioku Expedition and End of Chief Elepo

At the same time the Abaka war was going on, Kuriimi the Are of liaye sent an expedition against Ile Bioku one of the Oke Ogun towns to punish them for having sided with the Ibadans

during the late Batedo war. This expedition was entrusted to Chief Elepo late of Ibadan. This chief was for carrying the place by a coup de main, but the men of Bioku having heard beforehand of the impending danger were on the alert, and were fully prepared to offer a determined resistance. Elepo arranged for a night attack and headed his men for the assault. The men of Bioku fought desperately, but so vigorous was the assault that they were compelled to retreat into the town and some captives were made among them.

But Elepo the leader of the expedition had been wounded with a poisoned arrow at the first onslaught, and as he stepped aside as was his wont, for his troops to rush forward, he expired soon after unknown to them.

But the men of Bioku rallied and repulsed the attack, and when at this moment Elepo was expected to re-appear on the scene to support his men he was not to be found. The repulsed assembled at the foot of the hill on which He Bioku was built waiting for their leader ; his drum was kept up beating and calling him if perchance he had missed his way, but alas he had fallen and they knew it not.

The Bioku men had not the courage to descend from their heights and attack them, nor could the Ijaye in vadeis venture on another assault without their leader. Thus both parties retired.

At dawn, the men of Bioku in removing their slain observed the corpse of Chief Elepo, and they called to the Ijaye men from their heights : "Examine among j'ourselves and see who is missing ; here is the corpse of a fallen soldier with striped trousers." Then the Ijaye men knew that they had lost their leader. Thus the expedition against He Bioku failed.

The Late Chief Elepo. — Chief Elepo was a native of Iwdgbk and was acknowledged to be one of the greatest generals Ibadan ever produced. In no other man was power ever seen so combined with hamiUty, loyalty, and devotion as was characteristic of Elepo. He was remarkable for simplicity of manners, and could not be distinguished among his common soldiers by dress or any futile accessories. At home or in the field he mingled freely with them all and carried a gun on his shoulders hke one of them. He was almost always victorious. Unhke the other generals of the day, he used to march at the head of his troops leading them to the fight, and when on the scene ot action he stepped aside with his attendants, for his men to rush forward, and if they were repulsed he would at once re-appear on the scene and repel the enemy.

The following anecdote told of him will serve to illustrate how

much was the dread which his very name inspired in people's breasts.

It was once rumoured at Iwo that Elepo was coming against them at the head of his army. There was a great consternation in the town and a Babalawo (Ifa priest) in consulting his god as to his safety and that of his family was so distracted with fear that he transposed the words of divination, substituting the name of Elepo for that of the god, and vice versa ; said he, " Elepo nkan kan, Orunmila li o gbe ogun de oke odo yi. Ngo ti se ku ti omo ti omg," i.e. O Elepo the ineffable, heie is Orunmila (the god Ifa) with his army at the banks of the river. ⌢ By what means shall I perish children and all ! Upon his son calhng his attention to the mistake saying " Father, you are saying it wrong, it is just the other way," he turned round and dealt him a blow on the head saying, "Bi mo ti nfe e ki fito da iya re nu u" (i.e. that is how I used to be engaged to it, before ever I divined with your mother), intending to say that was how he used to divine with it before he was ever engaged to the lad's mother. Such was the dread Elepo's name inspired.

He was generally loved and respected by his colleagues, but his oldest friend and chief to whom he was devoted proved false to him and contrived to bring about his ruin. Such is man !

When the corpse was recognised by the Bioku people his head was taken off and sent to the Basorun of Ibadan. What grim pleasure or delight that great intriguer took in it, tradition did not say, but such was the end of that great man.

§ 6. Sagaun and Igbo-Ora The fires of theBatedo war were still smouldering in the embers. The Basorun of Ibadan at the zenith of his glory, but unable to attain the height of his ambition became very oppressive at home. No one escaped the virulence of his tongue ; he had no regard for any, least of all for the Balogun who was the next man to him in the town. A general insurrection was therefore raised against him which involved nearly the whole town. The Balogun and Otun connived at it, but professed neutrality ; the Seriki and the Asipa alone were for restoring order in the town, and through their intervention, by remonstrating with the two senior chiefs, and addressing a strong appeal to the Basorun to check the excesses of his men, the insurrection was quelled. The Ibadans however soon found a vent for their overflowing energies by events transpiring elsewhere, as an outcome of the late Batedo war.

⌢ The River Obk near Iwo.

We have seen above how parties were divided in their allegiance in the Oke Ogim districts during the late Batedo war, how Sagaun declared for Ijaye, andBerekodo, Igbo Ora, and Pako for Ibadan. Agidi the chief of Sagaun found a pretext for declaring war against Igbo- Ora, and besieged it, but finding the place too strong for him, he appHed to Ijaye for help, and the Are sent out theBalogun to his aid. The Igbo Ora people on the other hand sent to Ibadan for help as their misfortunes were occasioned by their loyalty to Ibadan, The Basorun at first sent to their aid a war-chief named Akawo but Akawo soon sent home for a larger force ; then Ibikunle the Seriki, Opeagbe the Osi and others were sent as re-inforcement. The principal war-chiefs remained at Berekodo, but they sent all the Badas to Igbo-Ora. But the Ijaye army was still too strong for them and when they could hold out no longer they retreated with the whole of the Igbo-Ora people to Pako. The Balogun of Ijaye besieged them here also and would have crushed them had not timely aid come from Ibadan. The Basorun hearing of the straits in which his men were, ordered the Balogun to the rescue. But Oderinlo the Balogun of Ibadan and Lasilo theBalogun of Ijaye were sworn friends, and rather than prove

false to him, Oderinlo from his first rendezvous at Odo Ona sent to tell his friend that he was coming with an overwhelming force which the I j ayes could not possibly withstand, and therefore he would advise him to retire from Sagaun as soon as possible; nothing could be gained by the enormous loss of lives that must ensue, and the pangs of broken friendship ; and Sagaun must fall. Lasilo and his men accordingly letired from Sagaun, and on that very day the Ibadan hosts entered and Sagaun was taken.

Chief Agidi who originated the war fell from the heights of Oke Tapa and was killed. Within 13 days of their departure the Balogun of Ibadan with his armj' returned home but met the Basorun seriously ill. During their absence in the field the Basorun called at the houses of all the principal chiefs and respectable citizens to ask after the welfare of their households ; he was everywhere received with marks of honour. In one of these rounds he unfortunately met with an accident, by being thrown off his horse and he sustained an internal injury from which he was laid up and was unable to see or welcome home his army. Five days after their arrival, he breathed his last.

What the populace could not do during his lifetime they were determined to do now, viz., to pull down and plunder his house on account of the enormities perpetrated by him. But the Balogun prevented this, he posted the Agbakin with his men at the entrance of the palace to prevent any outrage or disorder.

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Thus passed away one of the most distinguished figures in the Yoruba countr5

The Late Oluyole Basorun of Ibadan. — Oluygle was the son of OlokQoye, grandson of Basorun Yamba, and Agbgnrin the daughter of King Abiodun the Alafin of Oyo. He was born during the period of the Fulani ascendancy and the ravages of the Jamas, and hence his parents were reduced to absolute poverty. As a lad, he was apprenticed to a metallurgist for whom he carried charcoal. It was during this period that he obtained the friendship of Oyainu (his favourite wife) whom he afterwards married ; but his first wife was Latofide. When he first asked for her hand she refused him on account of the idle life he was then leading as a dancer ; but his friends Lanose and others begged her to accept him, pledging their honour to see her taken care of and properly supported.

When Oluyole rose to power and eminence he took revenge on her for this circumstance which he never forgot.

Oyainu had no children but Latofide was the mother of his first born Akiola whom he loved very much ; so much so that when the lad was seriously ill, at the advice of an Ifa priest he offered a slave in sacrifice as a ransom for the life of his son. Akiola however died.

Oluyole joined at Ipara the band of marauders which subsequently settled at Ibadan. Fortune favoured him there and he rose to a position of some distinction in the army, first as an Areagoro, then the Osi of Ibadan, and lastly he became the Basorun of the kingdom.

He was the friend of Ologun I'Eko and of Kosoko of Lagos whose ally he was during the Ota war : he survived all his colleagues and after the Eleduwe war obtained the title of Basorun from the AlAfin Atiba.

As a ruler he was arbitrary and oppressive and that was the cause of several civil wars at Ibadan. As a commander he was almost always successful although he had many narrow escapes.

As an excuse for him, his was an age of anarchy and lawlessness, and a ruler who showed himself weak would soon be compelled to give place to another. He could endure no rival and was exceedingly ambitious, hence the two inexcusable flaws in his life history, the perfidy to his faithful friend Elepo, and the disloyalty to the AlAfin his uncle and sovereign.

He cannot be properly spoken of as a bloodthirsty tyrant because although sometimes inexorable, yet he was frequently merciful and forbearing. We may note for instance his treatment of those caught in the insurrection against him. In this respect

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he contrasted most favourably with his contemporary Kurumi of Ijaye.

Ogunmgla who subsequently rose to distinction was but a private during his early administration: he had only a single drummer as his attendant whom he used to mount on a tree in front of his house and himself sitting on an empty keg of powder challenging the Basgrun to a civil war ! His drummer used to beat : —

" Ogunmola, ija 'gboro ni yio pa a dan, dan, dan ! O nyi agba gbiri, gbiri, gbiri ! O mu agbori Igwg, o nwo ona Orun yan, yan, yan ! " (Ogunmola, of a civil fight he shall die for sure, sure, sure ! He keeps kegs of powder a rolling, rolling, rolling ! With a jack knife in hand he is looking heavenwards steadily, steadily, steadily !)

His Highness, amused at this imp, used to send him some presents, sa5ang " He is hungry hence he is challenging me to a fight."

His contemporary of Ijaye would have made short work of him for this.

Oluygle was fond of husbandry ; he had extensive plantations of okra, beans, vegetables, corn and yams, a separate farm for each, and whenever he had to take any to the market, no farmer was allowed to sell that particular article that day as he had sufiicient to supply all the traders in the town, and could undersell any farmer. He made an experiment in yam planting so that a single root should be large enough for a load. The soil was first prepared, and a hole dug about 3 or 4ft. deep, and as many in diameter ; this was filled with weeds and pieces of banana stalks, earth was raised upon it, and the yam planted therein ; as the underlying rubbish decayed room was made for the yam to extend in all directions until the hole was filled and the size of the yam large enough for a load.

The Basorun owned nearly all the kola trees in the town as well as the kola groves, and often offered human sacrifices in them in order to make the trees fruitful One of his wives, the mother of his son Owolabi, was for a trifling offence punished by being sacrificed in one of these groves.

Silk velvet was then very rare and of a high value ; he allowed no one but himself alone to use a velvet robe ; the chiefs might use velvet caps only, but this no common man dared to do. The argument for this was that when poor people begin to aspire to what they could not easily obtain, they neglect the more necessary things of every day life and thereby impoverish those dependent

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upon them. Moreover, it fosters the spirit of ambition and covetousness which may lead to robbery and other evils. It is better, therefore not to encourage such, and thus they were forbidden altogether.

Oluyole kept a large harem, for when he had become great his wives used to seize any good-looking maiden found in the street or market place, and bring her to him to become his wife. Hundreds of these he did not even know by sight, his palace being an enormous compound. On his death, the relatives and betrothed husbands of these maidens boldly entered his palace and took them away.

He had many children, the most distinguished among them were : Owolabi who perished in the Ara expedition (to be noticed hereafter) , after him Alade who became the head of the house, but he also died not long after, and Aborisade the next eldest who stood for many years the head of the house.

The central market at Ibadan known as " Oja Iba " was so named after him when he became Ibasorun ; fo merly it was Oja Labosinde after theBaba Isale of the early settlers.

By the death of the Basorun the government of the town devolved upon Oderinlg theBalogun, but as some of the important chiefs were then absent from home, he was not disposed to assume a higher title till their return, and a general re-arrangement of titles take place. But he survived his chief only a year, and Lajumgke the Otun and next in rank to him having died, the headship devolved upon Opeagbe the Osi, but he survived them only 11 months, and after his death, by a unanimous vote Olugbode an Owu man was elected Bale, but he was not properly installed into office until the war-chiefs returned from an expedition now to be noticed.

Chapter XVII

SUBJUGATION OF THE IJESAS AND EKITIS BY THE

IBADANS— SOME IMPORTANT EPISODES— SOCIAL

REFORM AT IBADAN

§ I. The Opin War

After the crushing defeat of the Ilorins at Osogbo and the Ibadan ascendancy, the Ilorins ventured no more into the Oyo provinces, except for the Httle help they endeavoured to give to the Ibadans during the Batedo war, by attempting to besiege Ogbomoso, which ended disastrously for them. They appeared now to have recovered somewhat from their military depression, at least sufficiently to essay an aggressive warfare into the Efon districts. A man called Esu, a native of lye, a town between Ilemoso and Eluku who had been a slave at Ilorin was redeemed by one Lai eye for 12 heads of cowries ; the latter also redeemed one Oni for 25 heads of cowries, and gave her to him to wife. Esu, however, turned out to be a ne'er do weel of a roving disposition, unfit for any trade. He left Ilorin and settled first at Egbe then at Itagi and finally at Isan, leading a predatory life in those regions, kidnapping peaceful traders, sparing none, and was particularly hard on the Ilorin traders. In that way he became a person of some importance in those parts ; hence the Ilorins were now resolved upon capturing him alive.

Finding himself obnoxious to the Ilorins he hastily declared his allegiance to the Ibadans their great antagonist. Through the assistance of Oluokun a distinguished Ibadan gentleman residing at Ila, he received an introduction to the Basorun of Ibadan (then living) who received him cordially, and in dismissing him, gave him a war standard and commended him to the care of Yemaja his tutelary deity, Oluyole being a very religious man in his own way. In his incursions Esu never forgot his patron, for during the Basorun's Ufetime, he continually sent him slaves and booty taken in his raids. After the death of Oluyole the Ilorins were resolved to besiege Esu at Opin where he then was.

Ali the braveBaloganof Ilorin was entrusted with this expedition. He sought the alUance of the Ibadan chiefs, as the relation between Esu and Ibadan was only a personal one with the late Baoruns; and besides, the Ibadans were somewhat under an obligation to

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Ilgrin for assisting them in the futile siege of Ogbomgso during the late Batedo war, but as a matter of fact in order to forestall his opponent. Although any pretext however small was quite sufficient as an excuse for the Ibadans to mobilize, yet in this case only a junior war-chief named Kgloko with a small force was sent to represent the Ibadans,

For three years Opin held out heroically and had nearly baffled the prowess of AH when a sudden accident occurred which extinguished their hopes. Aganga Adoja a noble citizen was the hero of the town ; one night Aganga was inspecting his magazine with a naked lamp in hand, when suddenly a terrific explosion was heard and the hopes of Opin with her heroic defender perished together in a moment.

Esu escaped to Isan, thence to Oye, and then to Ikole. These places were taken one after another as Esu was being pursued to be taken alive. He escaped finally to Omu Ijela, a place fortified by nature against primitive weapons of warfare. Situated on a high hill, and surrounded for a mile on all sides by a thorny hedge and thickets, it was impenetrable to the Ilorin horse. Ali died soon after Opin was taken and his body was conveyed to Ilorin for interment. The command of the army now devolved on Hinna-konu the Fulani Balogun, assisted by Alanamu the Yoruba Balogun of Ilorin.

After the capture of the above named towns the camp was broken up, and the Ilgrin army as well as the Ibadan contingent returned to their respective homes. Kglgkg of Ibadan, however, did not reach home, but fell sick by the way and died at Osogbo.

§ 2. Subjugation of the Ijesas

After th-e return home of the war-chiefs from the Opin expedition and all were now present at home. Chief Olugbode was regularly and formally installed into office as the Bale of Ibadan. It was now his turn to confer the principal titles on the war-chiefs. The important titles of Balogun, Otun, Osi, i.e., the commander-inchief, commander of the right and of the left, were vacant. As titles were sometimes given not to the most worthy but to the highest bidder, Ibikunle the Seriki was advised to bid for the title of Balogun ; but he refused to do so with words which have become memorable, showing the character and qualit}' of the man " A ki ifi

owo du oye alagbara," i.e. the title of the valiant should never be contested with mone}'. As the most worthy of his compeers, the title of Balogun was conferred upon him without a dissentient voice. The other titles followed in due course.

The Ibadan army as now constituted being the instrument of

raising the reputation of that military state to its highest pitch of fame, which was maintained for many years afterwards and has never been surpassed, the names of the principal leaders and their offices may here be given : —

Titles.	Names.
Bale — Olugbode	
Otun	Osi
Ibikunle	Ogunmola
Osundina	Seriki Asaju Otun Bale
Ajayi Jegede	Madarik^n
Sumala	Asipa
Ek§rin	Ekarun
Akere	Orowiisi
Oyasaw§	Osi Bale Ajiya Bale Areagoro Balogun
Tub6sun Abayomi Aij^iiku	

Of these the first three and last two were exceptionally brave men. There was at this time in the Yoruba country a great increase in the population, a marvellous agricultural prosperity, and an abundant energy not always directed to useful purposes.

It was always the custom after conferring of titles especially that of Balogun to seize the first opportunity that offered to prove one's fitness for the title ; an opportunity was soon afforded for the purpose.

The Ijebu ERg War

The Ijgsas of Ilase and Ibokun reinforced from Ilesa were at this time making incursions into the Osogbo farms. Osogbo being under the protection of Ibadan, the Bale of Ibadan therefore sent out his Balogun on his first expedition to punish Ilase for the raids.

On reaching Osogbo, the Ibadan army marched direct to the Ilas§ farms, clearing the bush, making wide paths and encamped by the Yawo stream.

But the expedition nearly collapsed before ever they came in sight of the enemy. A quarrel broke out between Orowilsi the Ekgrin and two of the Bale's war-chiefs Ojo Orona and Okunlk, which nearly involved the whole camp. There appeared to be an old grudge between them and they clashed with each other when choosing sites for their tents. The Bale's principal war-chiefs the Otun and the Osi took no part in the fight but their men did. Neither the Balogun nor Ogunmola the Otun could interfere without appearing to take sides and then the strife would be general.

Ogunmola who was distinguished for his tact and diplomacy therefore sent to the Balogun that he should give orders for battle as if the Ij§sas were coming upon them. This was done. They marched out in order of battle, crossed the Yawo stream and opened fire

upon an imaginary foe. They then sent a company of men to the camp to raise an alarm " The Ijesas in sight." When therefore those rival chiefs heard the sound of musketry they left off fighting among themselves. The matter was amicably adjusted on the next day.

The Bale at home was informed of everything that transpired by a special messenger Oni by name (afterwards Josiah Oni) and he sent to pacify both parties.

For a whole year Ilase withstood the attacks of the Ibadans. In order to raise the siege, the Ijesas of Ibokun attacked the Ibadan camp from the rear, but the Balogun had provided against this contingency. Ali the powerful Balogun of Iwo was always left in the camp with a reserve force whenever they were engaged in battle. The Ibokuns were routed, driven back, and pursued right home, and the town was taken. The Ibadans were now able to concentrate all their forces on Ilase. When Ilase could no longer hold out, their Ilesa auxiliaries withdrew and the town was taken. The Ibadans now left the camp at Yawo and pitched in a plain having the ruins of Ilase and Ibokun on one side, and on the other Esa Egure and Esa Olusopo. Olusopg and Mesin Oloja Oke surrendered through Oluokun of Ibadan, a resident in those parts, and peace was concluded with them. From thence they removed to Ijebu Ere.

A large number of the people of Ilase escaped to Ijebu Ere. This was a large town, and a large force from Ilesa the capital was sent to defend it. The Ibadan army was met at a considerable distance from the town. • Three severe engagements took place ; at the third the Ijesas were defeated and 160 of them made prisoners.

Ijebu Ere was now closely besieged. Being a large town, the Balogun divided the Ibadan army into three parts ; he encamped at Iwaye, and placed the Otun at the Erinmo road and the Seriki with all the Badas at the Efon Aye road. He intentionally left the Ilesa road free as if to suggest a way of escape for them.

The Ijesas made a desperate effort to carry the Iwaye camp, but found the Balogun too strong for them. Next they concentrated their attack on the camp at the Erinmo road ; thrice they attempted to carry it by assault, bat they were repulsed. The Balogun thereupon left a few of his war-chiefs in the Iwaye road, took the Seriki's place in the Efon Aye road, and sent him to reinforce the Otun where the fight was now strongest.

The Ibadans were then in the habit of using coloured or variegated umbrellas in the field as banner j, and the Ijesa war-chiefs having then no umbrellas raised their broad sun hats upon a pole covering them with a red cloth, to serve the double purpose.

Opejin the chief of Ibokun, was one of the bravest defenders of this place.

Finding that the defenders continued stubborn, the Ibadans began to kidnap on the only route left them, viz. the road to Ilesa. The Ijesas fearing that this also would be lost to them quietly deserted Ijebu Er^ and escaped with the people of the town.

After they had clean gone the information was conveyed to the besiegers by a man left in shackles ; not a soul was found in the town when they entered. The principal chiefs remained there, but the juniors went in

pursuit : they found many of the smaller towns had likewise been deserted.

At Erinmo a feeble resistance was made. About 200 men kept up fire from the forts ; this continued for some time, but they escaped, leaving two cripples who were good marksmen to keep up the show. When the town was attacked on all sides and the walls scaled then the Ibadans found to their amazement that the town had been wholly deserted, and that the fire was kept up by only two cripples. They were brutally dragged down from the fort and slain ; the gates were then thrown open for their comrades to rush in. The Ibadans continued their pursuit to Omo Erin where they found a few aged men and women, the able-bodied having fled away ; next to Erinta-dogun where a feeble resistance was made until night-fall when the men had an opportunit}' of making good their escape. Leaving Erinta-dogun they came to a place where three roads met, one leading to Ipindun, another to Akata, and the third to Ikeji. Those who took the way to Akata met all the women and children of the several towns and villages that were deserted, and they were all taken captives. But the section that took the way to Ikeji (which was four days distant from their base at Ijebu Ere) met with a disaster by an ambuscade and were nearly annihilated but for the timely aid of Ali of Iwo and Jefiriyin of Ibadan. This disaster was subsequently avenged by the Otun whom the Balogun sent to their assistance when the news reached him at the Ijebu Ere headquarters.

This expedition was termed Ijebu Ere because of the amount of mud and slush along the way from Ijebu to Ikeji the terminus of the present expedition.

The Ijesas of Ilesa the capital here surrendered to the Ibadans bringing them presents of cowries, beads, etc., and also hostages. The people of Og6tun put up a white flag at the approach of th pursuers and surrendered to Osundina the Osi. Igbara did the same and surrendered to Ajayi Jegede the Seriki. Some of the minor chiefs who were not satisfied with what they got asked leave to make incursions in other directions; they were allowed to do so.

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Some met with good fortune, others with privations and terrible disasters from ambuscades. The wreck of this subsidiary expedition reached the camp at Ijebu Ere. Nine days after this the standard of the Ibadan army wended its way homeward.

Before starting on this expedition the Ibadans sent presents to the Ilorins, requesting their co-operation. The Ilorin army marched out, but on reaching Otun it was reported to them that their old enemy Esu was encamped on a rock about a mile from Otun. Knowing that he was sure to be attacked there, the principal war-chiefs of Otun, against the protest of the Ow6rc their prince, admitted Esu into the town, and the Ilorins instead of joining their allies thereupon encamped against Otun. But Otun is a tributary town of Ibadan, the Balogun and Otun of Ibadan therefore sent to remonstrate with the Ilorins for fighting with their friends when they were asked against their enemies. The reply was, " Not Otun but Esu ; we find our old enemy here, and we must not pass him by." The Ilorins, however could not take Otun till the Ijebu Ere campaign was over. Ajayi Jegede the Seriki, therefore asked permission to go to the help of his friend Esu at Otun, and Lisibade the over-lord of Otun did the same. Not only was permission granted, bat the Balogun, Otun, and each of the principal war-chiefs also sent a small detachment with hira, about 3,000 strong to re-inforce the town. The rest of the Ibadan army now returned home. Thus the whole of the Ijesas were subdued by the Ibadans.

§ 3. The First Dahomian Invasion of Abeokuta, a.d. 1851

The first Dahomian invasion of Abeokuta took place on Monday the 3rd of March, 1851, during the absence of the Ibadans at the Ijebu Ere expedition. We have seen above Chap. XVI, § 2 what was the cause of their sworn hostility to Abeokuta.

Commander Forbes a British naval officer, and Mr. Beecroft, Her Britannic Majesty's consul for the Bights of Benin and Biafra were at Abomey (the capital of Dahomey) when preparations were being made for the invasion of Abeokuta, and they communicated a full account of the same to the English Missionaries there with a view to forewarning the Egba chiefs, while they themselves were exerting their good offices in dissuading the Dahomians from these periodic raids on their neighbours.

It was alleged by an eye-witness that as the troops were assembled in the market square, the leaders pledged

themselves to their sovereign not to shrink before the foe, and exhibited what prowess they would display in the coming struggle. The leader of the Amazons demanded for her regiment the honour of leading the

attack upon the ground that on previous expeditions they (the Amazons) had always carried the positions when the male regiments failed to do so. The arrangement was accordingly agreed upon.

But the Egba chiefs were rather indifferent to the representations of the missionaries urging them to a vigorous preparation, except Sagbua the Alake and Ogunbona the Balogun of Ikija, who repaired the walls of the town in the direction of the main gate to Aro : the rest were left in a dilapidated condition.

When the Dahomians reached Isaga, a small town about 17 miles from Abeokuta, the people tendered their submission to them and whilst concluding terms of amity and friendship with them, they despatched private messengers to Abeokuta to apprise the chiefs of the situation. It was now too late for the Egbas to begin to repair their walls. The whole town was seized with panic and consternation, some fleeing to Osiele, some to Atadi, others going where they knew not. The women everywhere raised the cry of alarm " Elel6 m'el6 " (every man to his matchet), and hurried the men to the walls to watch the approach of the enemy. Fortunately for Abeokuta the Isaga people had induced the Dahomians to alter their plan of attack from a night to a noon day assault, and from the north west where the walls were in a dilapidated condition to the western gate where repairs had recently been executed ; and to this circumstance alone Abeokuta owed her safety ; had they followed their original plan, nothing could have saved the town. Even as it was many eye-witnesses do aver that what contributed most to their safety was confidence in the presence of the missionaries in the town. " The God of the white man " said they "is on our side." From this they derived moral com age.

On that memorable Monday the Dahomians were descried advancing towards the Ar6 gate. Some of the Egba chiefs went out to arrest their progress, but they could not withstand the force of those brave warriors. They were said to be advancing in the order of battle, marching steadily and solidly onward, ignoring the fire of the Egbas and paying no attention to those among themselves who fell, but kept marching stolidly onward. They never fired, but at the word of command, and when they did, their volleys were demoralizing. By this we can see that the Dahomian soldiers were discipUned troops such as the Egbas had never faced before. Those who went to arrest their progress fled precipitately and would not even stay to man the walls ; some of them never halted till they reached the Abetu stream within the town. The general idea that the Dahomians cared more for skulls than for captives

and that the drinking cup each soldier carried in his knap-sack was a human skull added greatly to the dread entertained of them. But Ogunbona the Balogun of Ikija, and Sokenu the Seriki of Ab§okuta displayed undaunted courage and bravery, opposing, the enemy with all their might.

The courage and noble deeds of the Egba women on this occasion were beyond all praise, and demand our special notice. But for them some of the men who were cowardly would have fled before the enemy. In the thick of the tight, with bullets flying right and left the Egba women could be seen in the ranks of the fighting men with water, mashed eko (a cooling drink), refreshments and encouragements, so that they need not fall to the rear for anything but continue the fight. Some of the missionaries were also there encouraging them by their presence, and doing what they could for the wounded.

Notwithstanding all this the trench around the town wall being full of dead bodies, the Dahomians were actually scaling the walls. Some of them with one hand cut off would hold on with the other or with the stump with grim determination in their faces; they kept pressing on, and a few did actually get into the town.

Up to this time the Egbas did not know that they were fighting with women. Following the barbarous custom of the age, it was customary to send as a trophy to the chief ruler of the town, the head and the private parts of the first enemy caught in warfare ; when those who actually entered the town were caught and slain, and the trophy was to be sent, then the Egbas knew that these terrible fighters were the Amazons !

Immediately the news spread among all ranks that they have been fighting with women, and lor very shame

all the Egba men were exasperated beyond measure and rushed upon them with one accord and compelled them to retreat. The Dahomians left thousands dead behind the walls of Abeokata.

The Egbas thought they only retreated to prepare for a more vigorous attack the next day, and they also went to prepare for a more determined resistance; but the Dahomians were already on their homeward march, they were not accustomed to lay siege or repeat an assault ; if an assault failed they retreated altogether to renew it at another time. They were determined to punish the Isaga people for their treacherous conduct towards them. The Egbas, finding that the attack was not renewed the next day, followed in pursuit and met them at Isaga, the chiefs of which were just then apologizing and defending their conduct. The battle fought here was said to have been more fierce than that before the walls of Abgokuta. The Egbas contemned the idea of being

attacked by women hence the furious onslaught they made at them.

The Dahomians left more dead behind them than the captives they succeeded in taking away, including the skulls of the unfortunate victims caught in the farms.

Soon after the invasion, on the i6th of May, 1851, the Rev. D. Hinderer, a German missionary of the C.M.S., who was then labouring at Abeokuta and witnessed the attack, obtained permission from Sokenu and the other chiefs to carry the gospel to Ibadan. At this period, none of the surrounding tribes was at peace with Ibadan. The Ijebus especially were kidnapping on the roads, and one had to reach the town by a circuitous route of four instead of two days from Abeokuta. Caravans to Ijaye and Ibadan were under escorts up to a certain point, and the Rev, D. Hinderer was obliged to risk the rest of the journey by himself when the escorts could proceed no further for fear of Ijebu kidnappers.

The Rev. D. Hinderer was received kindly by the Balgandthe other leading chiefs of Ibadan. When he told them the object of his visit, the five leading chiefs, viz., the Bale, Balogun, Otun, Osi, and an elderly chief Lanoso by name, in whose house lie was lodged, held consultation whether they should receive the white man and the message he brought or not. Osundina the Osi a staunch Moslem raised great objections, evidently on religious grounds ; he stoutly opposed his stay amongst them. Said he " Awgn obaiye je ni iwonyi." (These are the world spoilers), " There is no country they enter but misfortune will follow for that place." Ogunmola the Otun said: "But white men are at Lagos, Badagry, and Abeokuta ; why should we refuse him ? We are not the first nor shall we be the last to receive them, and whatever be the consequence to others let the same be to us also." Ibikunle the Balogun suggested that the national god Ifa should be consulted, and if Ifa prognosticated evil let the white man be ordered out of the town at once ; but if favourable, let him be received. These five chiefs accordingly repaired to the Ogboni house at the Ibasorun market and consulted the brazen Ifa which is the national god. The omen was favourable and Mr. Hinderer was accorded a cordial welcome and well entertained. A place of residence was assigned to him, the house of the late Chief Ogidi, and he was placed under the special care of chief Abayomi the Ajiya Bale the head chief of that part of the town through whom he could always approach the chiefs in council ; and he in turn entrusted him to Olumiloj^o his Balogun whose house was not far from the mission premises.

Mr. Hinderer remained five months at Ibadan on this his first

visit, preaching and teaching and making general observation on the place as a field of missionary enterprise. He then returned to England to recruit his health and to prepare for a permanent stay there.

§ 4. The Ara War and Relief of Otun

Ara is a town of considerable importance in the Ekiti country. This expedition was named after it, although Ara was not the primary objective when the Ibadan standard left home, but it was the last important place taken before the Ibadans returned

We have seen above that the Ibadans invited the Ilorins to the Ijebu Ere expedition and that the Ilorins instead of joining them as allies encamped against Otun a tributary state of Ibadan because of Esu their

inveterate enemy ; and at the close of the campaign, certain Ibadan war-chiefs who were interested in Esu or the town of Otun obtained leave to go to the assistance of their friends.

Now, although the Ilorins failed to conquer the defenders, and they could not drive the Ilorins away, yet by overpowering numbers, Otun was closely invested and famine began to do its dreadful work within the town ; therefore the Ibadan contingent there sent home to ask for a larger relieving force, and " if possible, let the Balogun himself come."

The Ibadan army was once more on the march to the Ekiti country for the rehef of Otun, but other complications occurred which diverted their attention from Qtun.

Prior to this expedition the Alara (or king of Ara) had been deposed by his people for stealing and selling their children ; the poor victims were bound and conveyed out of the town in hampers of cotton. The Alara appealed to the Ibadan chiefs at Otun for their kind offices and they composed the difference between king and people and reinstated the former, the people yielding more from fear of the consequences a refusal might entail.

But about a year after, he was deposed again for his atrocities and he escaped again to the Ibadan chiefs at Otun. By this time the Balogun of Ibadan and his hosts were on the way to the relief of Otun, the chiefs therefore sent their messengers along with the Alara to meet the Balogun at Igbajg to tell his own tale Thence the Balogun and the principal war-chiefs sent special messengers with the Alara once more to compose the difference between him and his people and to reinstate him. He was accepted with very great reluctance, more from fear of the Ibadans than otherwise.

This ended the first act in the tragedy which sealed the fate of

Ara. up to this point there was not the slightest intention of destroying the town.

The Ibadan expedition left Igbajo for the Ila farms and everything having been eaten up far and near except the farms at Koro, the war chiefs after consultation sent special messengers to the Ajero of Ijero the paramount chief of Koro for permission to forage in the Koro farms. The Ajero replied " The Koros are wild boys : a yam may cost you a human head." The Ibadans felt insulted at this reply and sent back to the Ajero to say " We only applied out of courtesy, and if our peaceful overtures are not complied with, two ' wild boys ' will meet in the field within three days, and, therefore, all Yoruba (Oyo) residents at Ijero should leave the town at once."

The Ajero called together the Oyg residents in his town and had the message repeated in their ears, then he said to them " You may go now, but you need not go far, you can wait at Ara or Eriwo until the Koros have driven away this Ibadan army, then you can come back." So confident was he of the strength of the Koros. The Oyo residents accordingly left the town.

The Ibadans now wended their way to Koro and the Koros about 2,000 strong came out to meet them on their frontier at a place called Ita Oniyan. The Ibadans were marching according to their ranks, the Balogun and Agipa being in the rear, and the junior war-chiefs in front, but the Koros had lain in ambush and the Ibadans walked into it ; suddenly they fell upon theBalogun's and the A§ipa's ranks, but in both places they were utterly defeated with great slaughter. The Ibadans advanced to the river Oyi, the scene of the next fight ; the Koros met them here, and again they were defeated. The Ibadans advanced to Yawo a place not far from the town, and here the Koros made a stand. The Ajero their paramount chief now got alarmed and hastened to their assistance. He applied to the Ilorins before Otun, for help, and the Ilorins whose sole poUcy was to help one set of Pagans against another until they had weakened each and both fall a prey to them, lost no time in sending two war-chiefs Adedeji and Magobon with horse and men to help the Koros. The Ajero sent also to all the towns in his territory including Efon and Ara to come to their help and save Koro the strongest town in their district which now seemed doomed to destruction.

Ara alone refused to comply; the Alara said he had just been re-instated by the Ibadans, and he could not take up arms against them. But the men of Ara were angry with their king's decision, they were all for going to the help of their kinsmen against the " Qyos "

But there were two rebel chiefs of Ara who had been expelled the town and were living at Ohan ; they considered themselves free to join the coalition, and they defiantly came outside the walls of Ara inviting their townsmen to come along to the aid of their kinsmen. The Alara, unwilling that Ara should be represented in the coalition against his benefactors summoned his people to come out and drive these rebel chiefs back ; but his summons was not obeyed, and he went out himself unaided to intercept them ; there was a brief but sharp fight between them in which fell a stout and well-to-do citizen who exposed himself between them, trying to put an end to the fight, thinking that his person would be respected. So the rebel chiefs went on to the help of Koro.

Ara was not officially represented, as the Alara refused to go, and Lejofi the most powerful man in the town whom the people would rather follow remained sulky and neutral.

But when these rebel chiefs saw that there was little hope for Koro they sent a private message to apprise the Ard people that they would leave Koro at such and such a day and that they were to hold themselves in readiness that together they might fall upon the Alara and murder him before Koro was taken and his friends the Ibadans were free to avenge him.

The Alara having an intimation of this, summoned the Oyo residents at Ara, inviting them to be ready at once to leave the town with him, reminding them how on the former occasion Chief Ogunmola had reprimanded them for not leaving the town when he did, thereby casting their lot as it were with rebels.

The Alara and these Oyg residents quitted the town fortunately just a day before the rebel chiefs came, who together with the townsmen gave chase, and pursued after the fugitives and overtook them. These had to fight their way to Efgn Ah aye ; they lost nearly everything. At a place called Oke Ogbe they made a stand and offered a determined resistance to enable the women and children to escape safely to Ahky͡. This action sealed the fate of Ara as we shall see.

In the meantime the Ibadans were drawing a cordon round Koro, and the Ilorin contingent true to their characteristics were prepared to escape and abandon their friends. Magobon one of their leaders conceived the bold idea of marching right through the Ibadan lines, trusting that he would escape undetected. The Ibadans who never imagined any venture so foolhardy, at first mistook them for a company of their own men, as Magobon stood by the standard of chief Sumala the Otun Bale while his people were marching past. But as a chief on horseback rode past, a man eyed him closely and recognized in him an Ilorin man and

at once took his gun and shot him down dead on the spot. Being now discovered, they took to their heels and were pursued and many were caught, but a few swift-footed escaped. Another company which took another route hkewise was discovered and captured.

But Adedeji the other leader remained at Koro being afraid to run the risk : the Ibadans therefore offered him protection if he would commit himself unreservedly to their clemency ; he did so (there being no alternative) and was allowed to come to the Ibadan camp. He remained there a few hours ; he and his men were well entertained, and were sent away in peace. Even a hatchet one of them left behind at the Ibadan camp in their haste to get away the chiefs sent to them in the Otun camp.

This noble deed of the Ibadans so put the Ilgrin general to shame that he negotiated peace with the Ibadans and raised the siege of Otun.

The siege of Otun being raised, the Ibadan contingent there together with Esu whom they went to defend were now able to join the Ibadan army at Koro ; the " bad boys " were finally beaten and the town fell. Ijero the chief town of the district, and three other towns also which assisted them were taken, Oro surrendered and was placed under tribute but Ara held out for two years, being well defended by the powerful chief Lejofi.

Finding further resistance useless Ara now surrendered and brought presents to the camp, and an armistice was concluded. On account of their past conduct, and the useless waste of life occasioned, the Ibadans while accepting the presents imposed two conditions upon them : —

1. That they should recall their king from Ahaye.
2. That all the Ara chiefs with Lejofi at their head should come and meet him in the camp so that they might have the opportunity of hearing both sides, and adjust matters between them.

The Ara chiefs thought this was a stratagem to get them all into their power for capital punishment. They sent for the Alara into the camp but the chiefs declined to venture themselves there : they offered to pay whatever fines might be imposed on them.

Then another proposal was made, if they would not come then let them send them their fighting men and a guide to Igede in the Ado territory. Neither would they comply with this but they begged to be subjected to whatever fines they pleased and to be placed under tribute, and they would serve them.

The armistice was now declared at an end, and fighting resumed, till the Balogun at length forced his way into the town by an assault, and Ara was taken.

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The scene that followed showed how courageous and stouthearted the Ara people were. A band of about i,6oo young men choosing death rather than slavery put the muzzle of their loaded guns in their mouth, pulled the trigger with their great toe and shattered their brains to pieces.

The great and wealthy Lejofi, in order that the Ibadans might not profit at all by his wealth, destroyed all his valuables, with his store of provisions, cutting the yams into bits and strewing them all over the yard (provisions being so scarce for this great host). Then two of his wives were killed to be his attendants in the other world, and himself with his own jacknife cut his own throat. His eldest son met him weltering in his blood, life not extinct, being unable to complete the deed ; he, therefore put an end to his father's agonies, loaded the gun afresh and shattered his own brains !

A man from Oke Mesin, Ladojude by name, whose brother had been killed by Lejofi came to avenge his brother's death upon the corpse. He kindled a fire from wood obtained in Lejofi's own house, threw his body into it and burnt it.

Thus ended the Ara campaign, as it was called, in 1854 and the Ibadan army returned home triumphantly.

Esu who was relieved and was the indirect cause of this campaign, did not go home with them, neither stopped in the vicinity any longer, but penetrated further into the Yagba country and there established himself.

§ 5. Raids by the Minor Ibadan Chiefs

The subjugation of the Ekitis, including the Ijesas, Efons and others, may now be said to be complete, but the process seems to have reacted to the demoralization of the Ibadan war-chiefs and others. Slave-raiding now became a trade to many who would get rich speedily, and hence those who felt themselves unlucky in one expedition, and others who quickly spent their illgotten gains in debauchery and all excesses would band together for a raiding expedition on those minor places that have hitherto escaped the misfortunes of war. A brief notice will be taken of some of them.

Ayorinde. — Chief Ayorinde did not return home with the army after the destruction of Ara, but went on first to Isan with Esu ; thence they went against the Ades, whom they conquered, and then he returned with his hands full.

Intoxicated with pleasure at his own success, he was lavish in his enjoyments and out-stepped the bounds of moderation.

He offered a thanksgiving sacrifice to his Ori (god of good

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fortune). About the same time for an alleged offence he flogged one of his wives to death. For this he was brought under the power of the civil authorities, and was told to die. It must be remembered that a private

individual would be executed at once for murder, but a chief must commit suicide by any method he may prefer, for if executed pubhcly his house would be demoHshed and his family ruined.

But Aygrinde begged hard for his life. He surrendered nearly all he had to no purpose ; then Chief Ogunmgla his patron advised him privately to leave the town speedily and go into voluntary exile to those regions he lately came from, for even he could not save him from the penalties of the law.

Ayorinde left Ibadan secretly with only 12 followers out of all he brought back with him ! When his escape became known he was hotly pursued and narrowly escaped with his hfe. He went back to Esu with a tale of woe, and located him in a place called Irun, and there he remained and organized a band of marauders and ravaged all those regions till he encamped against a place of some importance named Ogb^gi. He was here for fully tei years with varied fortune. Adoyan Okorigi a great and powerful warrior came to the help of Ogbagi and Ayorinde was just on the point of being defeated when by a skilful move he took Okorigi in the rear and inflicted on him a crushing defeat and slew

Next the Ogbagis obtained help from Rabbah and Ilorin. Sinabu King Masaba's son and Hinakonu the Fulani Balogun of Ilorin came against him ; thrice was Ayorinde routed, and many of his fighting men speared, but he ralHed again and maintained his ground. Ogbagi was at length taken. Ayorinde became lord of the Akokos and Ido Ani. He opened a caravan way to Ow^ through which he obtained ammunition from Benin. He was kind to all Oyos, who flocked to his standard ; every one could enjoy himself to any extent he liked but he absolutely forbade the introduction of intoxicating liquor into that country. They might buy whatever they hked with their slaves and booty. He himself undertook to supply all ammunition required for their raids.' But no one must think of deserting him ; in order to ensure this, he posted men in all the exits of'his tenitory : any Oyg caught escaping lost all he had and returned home as he came ; but any Ekitisor Has similarly caught were seized with their slaves and sold to 0-

At last after many years as old age approached Ayorinde longed for home. But he knew that he would not be allowed by the people of Irun, who befriended him all these years, to depart

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with all his effects to Ibadan, so he manufactured a quarrel with them, and captured Irun the headquarters of all his expeditions and destroyed the place. In spite of all this precaution not one tenth of his slaves returned with him to Ibadan,

Ayorinde returned to Ibadan in 1872 after a very long absence. Nearly all the chiefs he left and the whole of his compeers had died out. He met at the head of the government subordinate chiefs, who had risen into power during his absence, and to his mortification he had to submit to them. He was, however, honoured with the title of Osi, but he did not holdit long; he died in the following year.

Abayomi. — Abayomi the Ajiya Bale with Olumiloyg hisBalogun got up an expedition to reheve Is^ a tributary town of his in the Ekiti country. He met Ayorinde at the siege of Ogbagi but he passed off and encamped against Agbad6. The town was soon taken and he had an immense number of captives and booty. From hence he was proceeding to the relief of Is^. But the captured town Agbado being in the territory of Ado, the Balogun of the king of Ado was sent to intercept him ; an ambush was laid for him, and he was hemmed in on every side. He had to fight his way to Is^, and lost all he had taken, and what was more he left behind him some of his best fighting men including two of his powerful slaves and Olumiloyo hisBalogun. He arrived at Ise with the wreck of his army and returned to Ibadan in a worse condition than he left. This was in the year 1857. It will be remembered that Olumiloyo was the chief who had direct supervision of the missionaries at Ibadan. Readers of " Seventeen years in the Yoruba country " (Life of Anna Hinderer) will find frequent mention of the name of this chief and how kind and friendly he was to the missionaries. He gave Mr. and Mrs. Hinderer two of his children a boy and a girl to train, in which he showed himself more enlightened than the sirperior cliiefs. The boy was trained first by these good missionaries themselves: subsequently at the C.M.S. Training Institution at Abeokuta, then he was employed as a schoolmaster, Mr. Hinderer himself continuing his education. Later he was employed as a catechist in 1885, and finally as an ordained missionary of the C.M.S. at Ogbomoso in 1892, where he is still labouring.

Ajobg and the Badas. — While the sieges of Ogbagi and of Agbado were going on, all the Badas of Ibadan

headed by Ajobg the senior Bada got up an expedition against Pakunde. All the Efon, Ijesa, and Akoko territories had now become a field for slave hunting for any number of men who could band themselves together for an expedition.

The Badas at first meant to take the place by stratagem, encamping outside the walls, professing friendship and asking for a guide to Ogbagi to meet Esu. But the men of Pakunde were too wideawake, and so when strategy failed, hard fighting was resorted to.

But it was reported at Ibadan that these Badas meant to establish themselves there after the capture of Pakunde and not to return home. This would eventually mean the loss of all the tributary towns t6 Ibadan ; consequently Chief Ogunmola of Ibadan sent to all the surrounding kings and chiefs subject to Ibadan not to let Pakunde be taken. The town was almost on the eve of faUing when tidings reached the camp that all the men sent to procure provisions at Ikolo, Ado, Oye, Odo Ijesa, Ikoyi had been seized and either slain or sold into slavery ! This was a blow to the Badas. In whatever direction they sent to procure food, they could not get any and no farms were near them for foraging. Being in a strait, the camp was broken up in the night and they made for home. Their guide took them by a way between Ikgle on the left and Omwo in the right ; the Ikoles waylaid them and they had to fight their way through. At Omu Ijelu whilst they were satisfying the cravings of hunger in the farms, the men of the town fell upon them and killed many with poisoned arrows. At Aiyede, a town built by Esu they were not allowed to forage in the farms. So by forced marches, and in a starved condition the wreck of Ajgbo's army arrived at Ibadan.

§ 6. Social Reforms.

The Present Condition of Slaves. — Ibadan had by this time been greatly augmented, not only by immigrants from the provinces and elsewhere who repaired there as affording a safer place of abode, but also by the thousands of slaves brought in annually. It had now become necessary to crystaUize into law a custom that had gradually grown amongst the chiefs and people generally, who had thousands of them in hand.

Except under especially pressing circumstances the chiefs do not now sell their slaves or rather captives of war excepting the old and infirm and that chiefly to procure arms and ammunition. The able-bodied men are kept and trained as soldiers, and it has become the law and custom that soldier-slaves are never to be sold under any circumstances ; they are to remain permanently as members of the house. The fair young women are added to the harems by the great, and young men save themselves the expenses of a dowry by making wives of any that come into their hands.

Any slave-woman taken as a wife becomes ipso facto a free woman. All the rest are sent into the farms, each to be employed in his or her own line of work. The chiefs had large farms and farm houses containing from a hundred to over a thousand souls. The men are engaged in clearing the bush, cultivating the soil, cutting palm nuts and doing other male work ; the women in making palm oil, nut oil, soap, weaving mats, rearing poultry and the smaller cattle, cultivating kitchen vegetables of all kinds for the weekly markets and the fairs ; older women in preparing and spinning cotton, sheUing palm nuts, etc. All are engaged as " hands " in time of harvest.

These extensive plantations not only support their huge establishments but also supply the markets, so that a miUtary state though Ibadan was, food was actually cheaper there than in many other towns.

The male slaves had wives given them by their masters from among the slave women, whomsoever they may choose, or if their choice lay elsewhere, the master would redeem any woman for them. Their offspring are home-born slaves, belonging to the master ; their condition is hardly different from that of the freeborn, all grow together as children of the house. Thus by slave-raiding and procreation the great houses are enlarged and the population of the town increased.

Well-to-do women in the town also buy slaves of both sexes, their offspring belong to them in the same way as the parents themselves, but barring exceptional cases of distress occasioning the ruin of the house they are never to be sold.

Of the slaves who are kept as soldiers, some are selected as bodyguards or personal attendants; these are provided for in every way by the master. The rest follow their own avocation and provide for themselves ; their services are only required in time of war. If the slave is successful in war and catches several slaves, he is to surrender them to his master ; a kind master will return him one or two fifths for his own purpose and keep the rest. An unkind master will keep all, as the service he has rendered him is his duty. Some masters would give money as consolation from the proceeds of any of the slaves he may sell. Any of these slaves is at liberty to procure his own freedom at any time. A wise one, who has captured one or two slaves in war, gives them back to his master in the presence of witnesses in lieu of himself, and thereby his ransom is paid ; he is free now to go any where he likes. Those who wish to remain permanently with the master nevertheless remove to a friend's house for a short time and in that way publicly make known their freedom;

and then they may return to the master's house, and serve under him in war as freeborn soldiers and in that case give to their master as any other freeborn does one or two captives as the case may be and appropriate the rest. They are protected by the law as any freeborn citizen.

Others who consider themselves free and safe under the protection of a great name, as slaves of a powerful chief, will squander whatever they may have in hope of replenishing their stock at the next opportunity.

Freeborn soldiers who are independent give to their captain a proportion of i or 2 out of 5 and appropriate the rest ; but if he is an idle fellow and dependent on his captain for everything, including his war accoutrements and his debts, he has to give up more than a half or nearly all of what he captured.

Highly Placed Servants. — At this period the chiefs were in the habit of installing favourite slaves into a position of trust and responsibility especially if they were brave and energetic and proved themselves worthy of trust. These keep horses of their own, farms and farm-houses, have harems, a drummer and lifer, etc. Young slaves and recruits are placed under them to be trained for war. At the return of every expedition a fourth or a fifth of the captives taken are given to the master; they appropriate the rest. They are generally more richly dressed and make more show than their lord. Whatever the misfortunes of the house these of course are never sold : they remain the guardians of the house and of their master's sons. Their children may be considered as home born slaves, but practically are indistinguishable from freeborn children. These servants are "slaves" only in name for want of a better term. These customs originating at Ibadan have been followed by all the Oyo states throughout. The more of these highly placed servants a chief has, the greater he is held to be.

The Law of Inheritance. — Hitherto when a man dies all his effects are inherited by his brother or brothers in succession until the turn of the eldest son comes, then he gets whatever may remain of what was once his father's, but in most cases, he gets nothing at all. It has happened within the experience of the chiefs that whilst one is toiling and saving, some brothers are idle and dissolute, and yet at his death, the idle and dissolute will step in and squander all he has saved, leaving his children to welter in poverty and want.

At a deliberative council held in the year 1858 it was proposed to alter this custom. For whom is a man toiling and saving? The answer comes naturally " For his children." Why then

should a brother displace one's children in the succession ? If the children are minors the uncle may act for them until they are of age, otherwise the eldest surviving issue of the founder of a house must succeed as the head of the house in rotation until it comes to the turn of the children of the next generation. This is not like the English law of primogeniture in which only the eldest sons succeed, but it is the eldest surviving issue of the founder of a house that succeeds, until the turn of the eldest son of the first successor comes round.

But the members of the family are not totally overlooked. At the time of the succession the personal effects are distributed amongst the nearest relatives, every one having a share of the clothes, slaves, money, etc., but the house, inalienable slaves, principal farms, in a word, the real property, and all that goes to make the house what it is, are never to be ahenated. These are assigned to the eldest surviving son and successor.

Every house is under the protection of a chief, a chief's house is under the protection of the paramount chief or the town council and these will see about the installation of the successor. In a great house, the highly placed servants will be in charge to train and direct their young master in the ways of his father.

These resolutions were communicated to the AlAfin of Oyo for his approval, and he not only approved but adopted the same for all Oyo states, and moreover he adopted the same for the Crown also. He ruled thereupon that the custom that has arisen during the degenerate times of Old Oyo that the Aremo (Crown Prince) die with his father should cease and the earlier custom reverted to. He wished his eldest son Adelu to succeed him, and after him the eldest surviving issue of the house as seems fit to the King Makers.

In the year 1858 Ibadan was so thickly populated that it was found necessary to extend the town walls. The new wall was known as Odi Ibikunle (Ibikunle's town wall) after the Balogun, as it was he who suggested, planned and superintended the carrying out of the work. This is the present town wall.

Ogunmola also suggested that Ibadan should have what is known as " Igbo He," i.e. home forest, the thick bush surrounding every town in the Yoruba country, which may be exposed to raids and sieges. But the Ibadans did not care for any such thing and it could not be carried into effect, for they had no one to fear. The annual bush fires were allowed to nullify Ogunmola's suggestion.

Chapter XVIII

A GLORIOUS END AND THE GORY DAWN OF TWO REIGNS— THE IJAYE WAR.

§ I. Death of King Atiba.

Atiba the AlAfin of Oyq lived to a good old age. Of few Kings do we know so much as we do of him ; he was a link with the past, and lived within the days of authentic history. He was the father of several princes and princesses whose names are the following : —

Princes.

Princesses.

Adelu {The

Crown Prince)

Boje

Adeweni

Adelabu

Adeleye

Atowurg

Ogboja III.

Adesiyen

Adesetan II.

Adedgja

Ade Oy6

Adeyemi

Adedgtun

Durokilu

Adeyimka

Adediran

Afonja

Ogboja I.

Ogboja IV.

Adejumo

Agbonrin

Ogboja II.

Siy6

Olawoyin

Tela Okiti papa

Akere I.

Ogboja V.

Tela Agboj

u Qgo

Akere II.

Popogla

I'ogun

c f Adeduntan f, Adewale

Lapemg

Aid

Momgdu

Ogboja" VI.

Adewusi

Adesokan

Akere III.

Adetgla

Adesetan I.

Adejojo

Of these the ist and the 4th succeeded to the throne.

A few remarks on some of the princes : —

Adelu was much older than his brothers or sisters, for he was born when his father was qiiite a young man, long before he entered into his career of a war-like prince. He was much beloved by his father because he was a very dutiful son and shared with him most of the dangers and privations of war in those turbulent days of his early career. By virtue of his birthright he became the Aremo when his father ascended the throne.

Ogo was the Aremg Oy^ i.e., the first born after the father's accession.

Adewusi was Adelu's brother, of the same mother, and was of a contrary disposition. He was wild, undutiful and cruel. Re once quarrelled with his father, and with a cutlass cut off all the mattings that enclosed the Aganju (throne room). He quarrelled with his half brother Ala by seizing from him a plot of land the latter had obtained for farming, containing many

palm and kola trees. Adewusi went and secured the same spot for himself by affixing thereon a symbol of the Egugun curse on any trespasser. When Ala went to remonstrate with him, he stabbed him to death with a knife ! The father thereupon sentenced him to be executed by strangling !

Aid was of the same mother with Adelabu.

Adeyemi who subsequently succeeded his brother on the throne was of the same mother as Olawoyin. He enjoyed the longest reign of modern times ; more of him hereafter.

Agbgnrin, nick-named Allah ni yio bo Asiri (God will hide secrets) was also a prince of a most cruel disposition. His favourite (?) wife was once preparing his Okra leaf sauce with strained ash, which was a milder form of the carbonate of potash used in such cases. He thereupon compelled her to drink a calabashful of caustic potash, and she died soon after from inflammation of the stomach and bowels. He once caught a young man in his farm cutting palm nuts. Upon his begging him to spare his Ufe Agbonrin said he would do so if the young man could climb up again and replace the nuts ; this being impossible he clubbed him to death !

The conduct of many of these princes brought great discredit on. royalty. Very few of the crimes they committed ever reached the ears of their father for who would undertake to report them. Hence the licence they allowed themselves without the father's knowledge for he never spared them.

King Atiba was now old and full of years. Early in the year 1858 he was resolved on celebrating the Bebe (the Bebe is akin to the Royal Jubilee, and only Kings who have had a long and peaceful reign celebrate it). Yorubaland is now free from the incursions of foreign foes, the Fulanis of Ilorin permanently checked. All now was peace ; the people were content and prosperous, and therefore the King thought a Bebe should be celebrated. But inasmuch as the few Kings who celebrated it died soon after doing so, that festival came to to be regarded as celebrating one s funeral rites, hence Beb§ is sometimes termed the " Iku " (death).

The Are of Ijaye and others who were attached to him strongly advised him not to doit, as it might portend his death. His Majesty replied " Well, I am old enough and do not care to live much longer."

Notification of this was sent round everywhere and delegates came from every part of the Yoruba country to observe this festival with the King. From Saki alone came about 200 Eguguns, and so from all other Oke Ogun towns for the ceremonies.

Booths were erected all over the palace street from the Abata

(frontage of the palace) to the Akesan market for the visitors. The Oyo noblemen also hved in tents, in front of their houses, until the ceremonies were over.

The ceremonies partook of the character partly of the coronation and partly of the funeral rites, the principal part of it being done privately, at dead of night.

On the eve of the Bebe the King paid a visit to the Bkrk to perform certain ceremonies there as a thank-offering sacrifice to his fathers. We have mentioned in Part I. that only on the coronation do the Kings ever enter there, and never afterwards till they are taken there for interment. This festival forms an exception.

Tents made of beautifully woven cloths were set up and enclosed with mattings at the Abata, the Akesan, the Apini, and near the Bkrk for the King as on the coronation. Attended by all the noblemen he issued from the palace and entered each of these tents in succession, the noblemen waiting outside and only one woman (probably a priestess) accompanied him into the tent. He remained half an hour or an hour in each performing certain ceremonies, and sent presents of kola nuts to those waiting outside and so on till he reached the Bkra. On his return, that very evening the general festivities began. All the Eguguns observed a vigil, the voice of the Agan being heard all night. The next day an Egugun confinement was proclaimed in which all women and children must remain indoors. The Egiiguns our readers will remember are the denizens of the other world, and are supposed to be our dead relatives on a visit to us.

For a limited space of time during the day, licence was granted to all the Eguguns' attendants to seize goats, sheep or fowl found in the streets : none was to exceed that fixed time, whoever did was arrested and made to pay a fine of 25 heads of cowries (equiv. to {,1 5s. then) for each animal. In the afternoon of this day the King came outside the palace attended again by a woman, the large gate being shut ; the whole area between the palace and the Akesan was full of Egiiguns. He sat on a hide, and rechned on a bolster, the wife sitting by his side was by special permission initiated into the Egiigun mysteries. Then appeared the supposed spirit of his father dressed in the skin of the red monkey ; the King prostrated before his father and the " monkey " rubbed him all over with its tail and blessed him.

It was supposed that Eru-if a one of his slaves was under the mask on this occasion. The King's " funeral " expenses on this occasion can only be imagined.

Not long after this celebration, the King's health which had

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not been very good lately, markedly declined. He was soon reported ill. Whether anything deleterious to health was applied on him with the tail of the red monkey or not, we cannot tell, but His Majesty succumbed under the ailment and was gathered unto his fathers, and the Bara was soon again the scene of a great ceremony sombre and sad.

Before the King's death, anticipating trouble for his eldest son Adelu. from sticklers after precedents, he reminded the Ibadans of the new law of succession he had sanctioned and begged them to stand by the Crown Prince and support his claim for he did not wish him to die with his father. And this they promised on oath. Thus passed away Atiba the first Alafin of the present Oyo and Adelu his son was proclaimed King in his stead.

§ 2. Circumstances that led to the Ijaye War.

Adelu the son and successor of Atiba was acknowledged King by all, except Kurumi the Are of Ijaye.

Towards the latter end of Atiba's reign, there was some disaffection between him and the Are ; this breach with the Crown widened by the succession of Adelu whom the Are refused to acknowledge as a lawful successor to his father. " It is contrary to custom " said he, " and the Aremg should die with his father." He never repaired to Oyo to do homage according to custom, nor even sent a congratulatory message. He was for seeking for another prince of the older hne, of the royal family at Igboho or Kihisi to succeed Atiba, but Adelu having been duly elected and accepted by the denizens of the palace and obtaining the support of the Ibadan chiefs, ascended the throne in due form, and the pretext for an open rupture which the Are had long been seeking was hereby afforded. The common people also catching the spirit of the times sang in their dances:

" Atiba ma ti ilg, (" Atiba don't go yet awhile,

Duro de Adelu O ! " Wait for your Adelu pray ! ")

The AlAfin was conciUatory towards the Are, who was the comrade of his father in their old warHke days, but the Are remained irreconcilable. Every means of averting war was resorted to, but the Are remained obdurate and insolent. Matters came to a crisis when a rich lady Abu by name, died intestate at Ijanna; she left no heirs, and as such the property reverted to the Crown. But Ijanna being directly under Ijaye, owing to the breach between the King and Kurumi, the townfolk were divided in their opinions as to the disposal of the property. They feared the power of Ijaye on the one hand and yet loyalty to the Crown dictated a contrary

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action ; so one party sent to Oyq to request that the King should send to take over the property, the other party sent a similar message to Ijaye. The King anticipating danger to those whom he sent for the treasure ordered a well equipped force under Akingbehin Aleyo the Ona-aka, and the Aremg's Balogun to escort them. But Kurumi sent a body of troops to waylay them, and the Oyo escorts with the messengers bringing the treasures were attacked by the Ijaye troops at Apata Miba near Oke 'ho and were dispersed some escaping

to Oke'ho others to Iseyin. Within four days they collected themselves together at Iseyin and met there with the Oyo traders who could not return home for fear of the Ijaye kidnappers but who now availed themselves of the protection of the escorts to return home.

The Ijaye troops under the command of Amodu intercepted them again between Iseyin and Oyo. The I j ayes encamped on a rock named afterwards Apata Jabata because there the Jabata of Oyo fell. When they met, the Oyo escorts asked, " And who are ye? " They repUed, " We are from Oyo sent by the AlAfin to escort you home," allowing them to come very near; when suddenly the Ijaye troops opened fire upon them and so dispersed the Oyo troops with the traders and all. About 240 of them were taken captive exclusive of some minor chiefs, e.g. Aridede, Algy6, Jigin, etc. The head priest of Sango lost 10 of his daughters caught in this raid.

The AlAfin sent again and again requesting the Are to release them but he obstinately refused to do so, saying unless they were redeemed for 10 bags of cowries each. [The price of slaves at that period being about half that amount.]

The AlAfin sent back to say " I have a claim on you to demand the release of these people, for besides being the King of YoRUBA to whom allegiance is due, remember what I did for you in the past. When you sent one Dayiro on an expedition and the people of Saki defeated him and made about 210 of his men prisoners, did I not use my authority and influence and obtain the release of them all and send them to you free of charge ? Why should you now detain my own people ? "

[The above incident relates to one of the acts of the King to concihate the Are's refractoriness]. Still the Are refused pointblank to release them. And further, in order to avert war with Ijaye, His Majesty sent the Samu (one of the Oyo Mesi) via Ijaye to Ibadan to ask the Ibadan Chiefs to second his remonstrance and prevail on the Are to release his people. The Are was inexorable, and even chased the Samu on his way to Ibadan ; the Samu escaped the pursuers and returned home via Iwo. The AlAfin

then gave orders that the Oyo people should go to Ijaye and redeem each one his relatives as soon as possible.

The Alafin was now determined to punish Ijaye by the help of the Ibadans ; he therefore sent to them 40 slaves, 8 demijohns of beads.with gowns and vests, saying he had declared war against Ijaye.

The matter was taken up warmly at Ibadan ; many remembered that the town was placed under a ban by the late Basorun Oluyole who failed to take it himself. The Balogun of Ibadan alone among the senior chiefs was for peaceful measures. " Kurumi is an old man " said he, " and will soon die, and the Ijayes are our kinsmen."

The other chiefs imposed a fine on him for thus " betraying cowardice." But they knew well enough his matchless valour and undaunted courage, and the real cause of his reluctance to rush into a war of this kind. Ijaye was a town of equal importance with Ibadan, equal in valour, courage, and skill, and both with vast connections between each other and all over the country ; for them to engage in war would mean deluging the whole of Yorubaland with blood. But when he could not prevail over his generals, and the common soldiers affixed a crow to his house at night implying that he was a coward (as cowardly as a crow is a common expression in this country) ; and also threw stones into his house, he yielded to public opinion and commenced his own preparations for war.

When the Are of Ijaye heard of the movement against him, being self-confident he was loud in his boastings : " On this post will I chain that imp of Ogunmola," " Ibikunle will have cause to remember the Odogido disaster," and so forth. He gave orders that all the youths of Ijaye should be trained to the use of bow and arrows, the older men superintending the practice. To those who succeeded as good marksmen he awarded prizes. This practice was termed " Se e " and was carried out daily without intermission.

Being fond of singing and dancing the Are kept amusing himself with parabolic songs and witty sayings e.g.

" A ta gpolo ni ipa, o sun ikaka,

Gbogbo wa ni yio ku bere." (A frog is kicked and lies on its back. We shall all die by myriads.)

The common people took up the same against the AlAfin and the Ibadans. Against the Ibadans they sang : — " Ibadan a k6 gba Ajele Ibadan we can accept no Resident,

Orogun li awa ise." For rivals are we.

This meant to say "We cannot serve or yield to you." N

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Against the AlAfin they sang : —

" L'aiye Onalu^ \i a ro okan le gkan

L'aiye Kurumi U a ro'gba ro'gba

L'aiye Adelu ni ipele di itele idi." (In Onalu's time we used changes of dress. In Kurumi's time we used cloths of the finest weaving In Adelu's time our best becomes our every day's.)

This last description of Adelu's time is a well-understood irony. It is a common saying in this country " Ibere otosi bi omg olor6 la iri " (When poverty begins, one appears like a rich man's son) which means that when one cannot afford to replace the everyday dress, one resorts to his best for every day use and thus appears like a rich man ; but the real condition soon becomes apparent when this cannot be replaced. This condition is what they would now apply to Adelu's regime.

The tocsin of war was now resounding from one end of the country to another. Kuriimi disallowed the exportation of foodstuffs to Ibadan, The Ibadans sought the aUiance or at least the neutraUty of Abeokuta and Ilorin and pressed into service the Oyo towns under her protection. Kurumi sent one Oje to conclude an alhance with the Egbas and to procure ammunition, but Ogunmola of Ibadan, who was entrusted with the negotiations with Abeokuta forestalled him, and they took an oath of friendship and neutrahty with Ibadan.

The populace of Ibadan were now singing in their dances : —

" Akope Ijaye ki o mk ko ti Ika mo, Onigbo da 'gbo meji." (Palm cutters of Ijaye do not venture to Ika, The lord of the forests divides it in two.)

By a transposition of names the Ijayes were singing the same ditty, Ika being just midway between the two towns. Intercommunication now ceased. On all hands were heard " Onile ki o gbe ile ko kan odi yiyan." (Let every man keep to his own house, that need not imply animosity.) The kidnappers soon began to infest the farms; thus the Ibadans kidnapped two American missionaries who hearing of the rumours of war and incursions of the kidnappers went in search of Mr. J. C. Vaughan at his farm at Ido. Mr. Vaughan had escaped back to Ijaye by another route, and the missionaries were caught and brought to Ibadan

^ Kurumi s other name.

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on the 20th of February i860. These war boys, not knowing what to do with white men, brought them with their horses mounted as they were, to the Rev. D. Hinderer, sa3ang " White man, we have brought you your brothers," Mr. Hinderer thanked them and gave them some cowries to procure refreshments. The gentlemen were sent on to Abeokuta the next day, communication with that town being then still free and uninterrupted.

All hopes of a pacific settlement were now given up, for private messages, advices, and remonstrances were without number to the Are ; but for all this Kurumi remained unyielding to the King, and defiant to Ibadan. War was now formally declared. When at the next meeting of the town council, the Balogun arose in his place and harangued the assembly ending with " Eyin omo Jama, Mo fi Ijaye jin o " (Young men, Ijaye is now given up to you) a loud and prolonged huzza of " Muso, Muso," greeted his astonished ears. He was painfully impressed with the knowledge of how popular the war was. Orafiyan was worshipped and the standard of war was borne out once more by the valiant and experienced commander-in-chief Ibikunle on the loth of April, i860. It was known to all that Balogun Ibikunle went forth to this war with great reluctance. He had seen many battles and known well the horrors of a siege, and of all sieges one against one's own blood relations was particularly horrid and heartrending to him. Inter-marriages and national festivals which they

had in common had made them one ; they were sharers together in times past of weal and woe ; supply of foodstuffs for overgrown Ibadan came largely from Ijaye where the soil was fertile and the people industrious. These considerations therefore made the bravest shrink from a war that might possibly be averted.

When starting for the expedition, as soon as his foot was on the stirrup, his Akewi (bard) gave utterance to the following pathetic strains.

" Baba mi fire igbo gdaju o ! o ! o ! Nibi ti olgmg meji yio ku okan, Nibi ti olomo kan yio p6h6ra, ' lya mi ni lima wa' — ki o pada lehin Baba mi, ' Baba mi ni fima wa' — ki o pada lehin Baba mi,

Kiniun Onibudo. ' lyawo mi to igbe " — ki o pada lehin Baba mi, i, i, Kiriniun Onibudo."

(My master is going to the field of the heartless ah ! ah 1 ah me 1 Where the parent of two will be left with but one. Where the parent of one will be left all forlorn.

Let him whose mother forbids him to come return from following my Lord, Let him whose father forbids him to come return from following my Lord.

The Lion of the Master of camps, Let him whose betrothed is of age to be wed return from following my Lord.

The Lion of the Master of camps).

As the expedition started the drummer struck up the war march " Kiriniun Onibudo."

[Toki surnamed Onibudo, master of camps, it will be remembered was a formidable war-chief, the Seriki of the Ibadan army and the uncle of this chief. He succeeded his uncle as Seriki from which post he rose to be Balogun. He is eulogized as the lion that rendered chief Toki to be so formidable.]

Ogunmola who had gone to intercept Oj^ did not return home, but awaited the Balogun at Orita Elepo a small resting place about four miles from Ibadan town, at the junction of the two roads leading from the Oyo gate and Inalende gate of Ibadan.

§ 3. When Greek meets Greek

The Ijayes were not idle either, and did not wait at home with folded arms for the Ibadans to come. The fu-st battle took place at Apata Ika — the Ika rock just midway between the two towns — and the Are soon found, too late, and to his cost the truth of the message sent him that he should yield and accept a compromise and not haughtily compare the Ibadans of the present day to those of yore. But he was truly a born warrior and never lost courage, notwithstanding that he had now to contend with a younger generation of Ibadans who were quite inured to the hardships of the field and whose trade was war.

But the Are's eyes were now open when too late to yet another folly of his. In order that he might secure for himself a safe and despotic position, he had killed so many brave men of Ijaye and had forbidden any chief to accumulate ammunitions of war, that only three hard battles were fought before he found his magazines exhausted. The Ijayes now resorted to bows and arrows and consequently they lost ground rapidly. But for this probably the war would have ended in a draw as before.

The Egbas were now resolved to take part in this war. The majority were for assisting Ijaye. Sokenu alone was against their taking this course " after the oath of alUance and friendship

taken with the Ibadans," said he, " it will be a serious breach of faith, and even the gods will be against us."

This opposition, it was said, was the cause of his early death. The altercation was sharp, and the other chiefs in going said to him " We must not meet you alive on our return," and he retorted " If at all you return alive." Shortly after this Sokenu became paralysed (from poison it was said) and died.

The expedition was commanded by Angba the Balogun of Oba as generalissimo — all the other Baloguns including Somoye " Basgrun " the Balogun of Iporo had to serve under him. They halted for a long while

at Atadi, 12 miles from home, undecided what course to take : then they proceeded to Olokemeji where, still of two opinions, they debated the matter afresh, whether to go to the help of the Ibadans with whom they had formed an alhance or to the assistance of Ijaye. (Olokemeji is a central and neutral ground for the Ijaye, Ibadan, andtheOke Ogun hunters). They finally decided to help the Ijayes, " to raise the siege, and drive away the Ibadans and dispossess them of those kola groves originally planted by our fathers and grandfathers." This last idea swayed them. Thus it was subsequently reported at Ibadan. But there is an Egba version of the reason why they decided to ally themselves with the Ijayes. Some one alleged that Ogunmgla was reported to have said that after shaving the crown of the head he would shave the occiput ! Meaning after taking Ijaye he would also take Abeokuta ! But there is no proof whatever of this assertion, especially as there was no occasion for any such thing. And again Ogunmgla the author of the treaty of friendship and alliance was not the man to utter such a threat, which he certainly was not in a position to carry out, being a subordinate officer. And if he did say it, there would not have been such a prolonged hesitation amongst the Egbas, and such divided counsel as to what course they should pursue. The former version therefore, is far more probable.

Thus they proceeded from Olokemeji to Ijaye. But the venerable Chief Ogunbgna, Balogun of Ikija did not proceed with them; he remained encamped at Olokemeji to be a protection and guard to caravans going and coming between that place and Ijaye.

The Ijebus also as kith and kin to a portion of the Egbas seemed to have entered into an agreement to be one with them for offensive and defensive purposes. Hence when the Egbas went to Ijaye against the Ibadans, they also for no other reason entered into a state of warfare against Ibadan.

Mele the Ibadan state messenger to the Ijebus in the days of Oluygle the late Ba§grun was again sent with Kobiowu the

Jagun to conclude a treaty of friendship with the Ijebus before their attitude was known. But the Ijebus sent a body of troops which attacked them at Odo Ona even before they had left the Ibadan farms, on their way to Ijebu ! With shield and spear Mele bravely defended himself and retreated with his party home with only slight wounds.

The Emir of Ilgrin also embraced this opportunity for declaring war against Ibadan. The " Kafiris " (infidels) said he, " are at war with one another, and we should combine against this Ibadan which has often baulked us of our prey ; we may yet carry the Koran to the sea." He sent some horsemen to Ijaye, who when they observed the starvation and distress that ensued, could not remain long ; however, they kept kidnapping in the Oyo farms.

The Owa of Ilesa not only revolted against Ibadan, but also took advantage of the coalition to take revenge upon Efon Ahkye and other towns which were allies of the Ibadans during the late Ijebu Er§ and Ar4 wars.

Thus practically all the principal states in Yorubaland were combined to crush the Ibadans who had rid the country of the great bug-bear of the Fulani subjugation, but in turn became so restless as to be a source of anxiety to them all.

But a section of the Ijebus viz. Ijebu Remo with Keher6 the Balogun of Ipara at their head was friendly to the Ibadans. They held that they were a commercial people, and Ibadan not only their best, but also their only customer, and one time their deliverer in the time of Lakanle ; and they could not see their way to join in a war that did not concern them. The periodic 9 days' market, therefore, was continued between them, and as we shall see hereafter the Ibadans had to fight their way there and back, escorting caravans.

Meanwhile the struggle between the combatants was proceeding. The third and last battle fought before the arrival of the Egbas had exhausted the Are's store of ammunition. The battle was fought in his own farm and was one of the bloodiest ever fought in this campaign. Nothing but the intrepid personal bravery of the Are saved him from being taken alive that day ; had he given ground an inch he would have irretrievably lost the day.

There were only two fierce battles fought afterwards that may be compared to this last ; on the last occasion

the Are at the head of his choicest troops charged the Ibadan centre with intrepidity and desperation, with a determination to break through, but the Ibadans remained firm and impregnable. The circumstances will be related below.

The Egbas arrived at Ijaye in the nick of time to replenish

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the exhausted stores of the Ijayes. The Are who from experience knew the strength of the Ibadans, forewarned them to be very cautious and not to encamp outside the walls of Ijaye. The Egbas fresh from home and buoyant in spirits spurned the idea of " sheltering " themselves within the walls of the town ; however, they encamped without but close by the walls of Ijaye.

The camp of the Ibadans was at this time at Olorisa Oko, about 3 hours' walk from Ijaye. The Balogun of Ibadan could not at first be made to beheve that the Egbas came as alHes to the Ijayes after the oaths they had taken with Ibadan. To those who brought the report he said " Yes, they may have come but it must be to negotiate peace between us." Over and over again he was assured that they have come with a mighty army. " Yes," he repHed, " it must be to put an end to the war." But at last, the Balogun was taken quite aback when a band of skirmishers returned and reported that they were driven back by the Egbas who came in overwhelming numbers against them. The Ibadans were alarmed and dismayed at the report. " In Kuriimi," said they, " we have an equal match already, and how to face the combined force with the overwhelming host of the Egbas ? "

But the principal chiefs encouraged one another and were determined to die rather than yield. " Death," said they " was preferable to the shame of a defeat, or the humiliation of being made a prisoner." " Here is his head is better than here is his face " said Ogunmola. " If we cannot resist them here, surely we shall not be able to do so at home if driven from this place." He then took out his jack knife and displaying it before all his colleagues he said " It must be victory or Death."

A council of war was held, and it was resolved that they should wait until the Egbas came and attacked them, and if they succeeded in repelling the attack then they would have hopes of being able to maintain their ground ; but if they went and offered battle first and were forced to retreat, it was certain the men would be disheartened and really demoralized, and there would be a poor chance for them — ^it would end for them in a total defeat. One Kujeiiyo a babalawo or If a priest was thereupon commissioned to make charms to provoke the Egbas to come forward to fight.

The Egbas on the other hand fresh from home were eager to offer battle, contrary to the advice of the Are of Ijaye. " Let them come first and attack you here," said the Are to the Egbas, " but never go after them," But the Egbas repHed that when they left home they meant business and were not afraid of the Ibadans. A period of about a fortnight elapsed in which there was inaction on both sides.

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At length the day arrived and to the field the Egbas led their troops with flying colours. The Ibadan outposts reported the advance of the Egbas in the order of battle. The Balogun of Ibadan issued orders that no one should fire a gun until the word of command was given. The Egbas came within a few yards of the entrenchments and their fire wounded several persons within the Ibadan camp before the command was given. The Balogun's voice rang out " Omo Ibadan, e gba e fi ti won " (Ibadan boys, up and at them). Then the Ibadans rushed out, and the struggle commenced.

At the first onslaught of the Ibadans, the Egbas retreated about a hundred yards and made a stand, and then ensued a most desperate fight on both sides. To the Ibadans it was a matter of life and death, and their one thought was whether they would be able to maintain their ground against the overwhelming odds of the Egbas, the I j ayes being now at a discount ; but it was not long before they became confident that they could certainly maintain their ground.

Ogunmola being a man of small stature was wont to be mounted on the tallest horse he could possibly obtain, and move from point to point in the field observing the men's behaviour, and singling out individuals for praise or blame. On this occasion, having observed for a while the methods of the Egbas, he rode up joyfully

to the Commander-in-Chief saying " Ibikunle, a o se won, a o se won, Egba ko mo ogun jija " (Ibikunle, we shall win, we shall win. The Egbas have no knowledge of the art of war).

What Ogunmola observed was as follows :— As the combatants on both sides came company by company to the firing line (what they call Tawusi), Ogunmola noticed in the first place that the Egba shooting was too high, and that the men under fire were rarely ever hit, whilst the Ibadans had been taught to shoot low, and consequently they scored several hits among their foes. Again the Egbas discharged all their muskets at once and all turned back together before the reheving company came up ; whereas the Ibadans kept a reserved fire with which they accompanied the retiring foe, so that the retiring was more or less a disorderly retreat, and again they kept their place until their own relieving company came up, and more often gained a few yards forward before those of the Egbas came up, and thus gradually were gaining more and more ground. Ogunmola noticing all this was sure that, according to their own method of fighting, when later on, the Balogun arose to fight, and all men and all arms must push forward in a general engagement, this disorderly retreat of the Egbas would be converted to a general rout. Hence he was confident in assuring the Balogun that they would win.

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But long before it was time for that, another officer, viz. Abayomi the Ajiya Bale planned out tactics of his own. As all the Bale's Jfighting men were disposed as strategy requires he seemed to know that the Egbas left their flank unguarded ; he left the main body of his men at their post, and chose out a number of brave fellows to cut through the bush a great way off and suddenly burst upon the Egbas at the rear with a shout, and away fled the whole host panic stricken, and the rout was complete. There was a morass a little way off called Alabata which many of them were driven into, and were either slaughtered or taken alive. Some never halted but fled from the battlefield into the camp and from the camp into the town of Ijaye, others at full speed homewards the Ibadan boys pursuing.

Ijaye would have been taken that day but for the Are. Watching the movements of the Egbas, he noticed their lack of skill in their manoeuvring and fighting, and anticipating a disaster he held his men in readiness for eventualities. As soon as the Egbas gave way and the Ibadans were in pursuit, he made a flank movement and intercepted the Ibadans ; and these, seeing there were no chiefs behind them to back them up, hastily retired from the pursuit. The chiefs did not give chase for fear of what the Are might do, but they kept an eye on him ; for he might take them in the rear and convert their victory into a defeat.

From that day the Ibadans were confident of ultimate success and the Ijaye chiefs despaired of driving back the enemy. The Egbas were much enraged and ashamed of this defeat which they attributed to the cowardice of their Generalissimo Anoba, and for this they ordered him to " go to sleep " (a euphemism for suicide). They said that instead of coming up to their assistance with the reserved forces, he himself gave way also !

The Ibadan boys ascribed this victory to Ajiya Abayomi in their songs and dances : —

" Ajiya nikan I'o le'gun, 'Twas Ajiya singly routed the foe,

Iwi I'a ko gbodg wi." But we must not say 'tis so.)

A very large number of captives fell into the hands of Ogunmola, and as the author of the treaty, which was so perfidiously broken he took vengeance on many of them, by ordering their faces to be branded with broad Tapa marks, and exultingly took a name on it " Emi a so Egba di Tapa " (the transformer of ?gbas into Tapas). He, moreover, ordered yam peels to be rubbed on the marks in order that the irritant may cause thick scars on them.

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In order to show what contempt the Ibadans now had for the 5gbas as fighters, they sang while they danced : —

" Kanakana Ajibade

Ohan, ghan ni ndun.

A ri Egba Igkankan a se bi ogun ni,

Ija suk§ suke ni ija Egba,

Ija Ule lile n'ija Qyo." (The crows of Ajibade

Ohan ghan they cry.

Egbas at a distance appear Hke men,

Nerveless and feeble Egbas are in fight,.

Strenuous and brave Oygs are in fight.)

Emboldened by this success, the Ibadans removed their camp further to a place called Ajibade (where the Egbas were defeated) and the battle ground was now at Alabata (where they were driven to) about two hours' walk from Ijaye.

Several hard battles were fought before they could establish themselves here, but at every fight the Ibadans gained ground, and so they again removed their camp from Ajibade to Alabata, and the battle ground was now at the River Ose not far from the walls of Ijaye.

By this time the ammunition of the Ibadans was exhausted, and but for Kehere the Balogun of Ipara the expedition would have ended in failure if not disaster to the Ibadans. K§h§re was faithful to them to the end.

The unfriendly Ijebus of Ode and Igbo were daily raiding the Ibadan farms. Flying columns had to be organized to protect the farmers and chase away the Ijebus. They also kidnapped from the caravans to Ijebu Remg (viz. Ipara, Iperu, Ode, Ikorodu) ; the Ibadans were obliged to send escorts from the camp from time to time to protect these traders to Ipara and back. The Ijebus more than once made a regular encampment and erected forts to block the way after the caravans had passed on to Ipara, the intention being to prevent their return ; but the Ibadans always succeeded in routing them, pulhng down the forts, and returning home safe with the caravans. In one of these defeats, one Kongo a well-known Ijebu, who was formerly a trader and a resident at Ibadan was caught with several others ; but Chief Ogunmgla lost two of his most vaHant men in this fight, Kukula and Erin. He showed his resentment by ordering Kongo to be killed on Kukula's grave, and the rest of the Ijebu captives they led to the camp at the river Ose, exhibited them to the Egbas and Ijayes, and then killed them under their eyes, to show that they had been victorious over their allies as well.

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But there was a memorable battle of this kind fought at the river Omi in the Ijebu Remo road which was terrible. The Ijgbus exasperated by the former defeats were determined to deal a crushing blow to the Ibadans the next time. For some weeks the caravans could not proceed, the road had become more unsafe than ever ; all who came from the provinces assembled at Ibadan. Then the chiefs sent powerful escorts from the camp under chiefs Abayomi, Tubosun, and Madarik^n, The name of Abayomi raised the hopes of the caravans, and an extra large number of them flocked together to take advantage of this opportunity.

After the caravans and escorts had passed on to Remo, a large Ijebu army was sent to prevent their return. They erected strong stockades right across the path in three places, and placed bodies of troops behind each, the main army and the encampment being behind the strongest stockade towards Ibadan, and there awaited the return of the caravan. Madarikan the leader of the van first came at them and fighting ensued ; the first stockade was won and they came up to the second. Madarikan was wounded in half-a-dozen places and driven back towards Remo, bleeding all over and was hors de combat. When Ajiya Abayomi came up, he dashed upon the Ijebus with great intrepidity and won the second stockade ; he then repelled the enemy until they came to the third and strongest stockade with the encampment behind it of the main Ijebu army. At the sight of the Ibadans, the Ij§bus raised a great shout of triumph and tauntingly asked " By what way will you get home now ? You had better try flying." From behind the stockade they wrought havoc among the Ibadans with impunity, being protected from the bullets of the latter by the stockade.

Chief Abayomi thereupon called some of his most trusty servants, and posted them with their men on the highway with orders not to yield an inch if all had to perish there. He then chose a band of trusty veterans,

cut a path through the forest and attacked the Ijebus in the rear. When the Ijebus driven to bay, saw the foe before and behind, they were furious and dashed upon the Ibadans with great intrepidity. At the first onslaught, Abayomi the Ibadan leader was shot off his horse, and when his veterans saw their master fall and their own fire languishing, they became exasperated, and with drawn swords they rushed upon the Ijebus with great fury and madness, broke through their ranks and put to the sword those that could not escape. They immediately pulled down the stockade and rejoined those of their comrades who had been posted in the highway and had come up. They pursued the Ijebus a little way and rescued as many as they could of the women and others of the caravans whom the Ijebus had

captured before the main body of escorts came up. Thus the Ibadans eventually won ; the victory though dearly bought was complete. Abayomi, however, ralhed, and was able to lead the people home. When reports of this victory reached the camp and the cost at which it was achieved the Balogun and other senior chiefs immediately sent congratulations to Abayomi, Madarikan and others, and allowed them to remain at home until their wounds were healed before rejoining their comrades in the camp before Ijaye.

From this and previous achievements Abayomi (through his bards) added to his other names " Death to traitors," " Terror to the Ijebus," " Maker of safe paths through tangled forests,"

There were further skirmishes on this road while the Ijaye war lasted, but none to be compared to the above two remarkable ones.

Meantime the war before Ijaye continued with undiminished vigour the invaders being now replenished with ammunition.

The Ijaye watchman was posted on the top of a tall tree near the River Ose, from whence he could command the view for several miles around, and announce the approach of the enemy.

For a long time the River Ose was the scene of action : whichever party arrived first at the stream gained the opposite bank and held it until repulsed. In course of time the Ibadans gained the river permanently, and the action thenceforth was on the Ijaye side of it.

At this time all the farms being in the hands of the Ibadans, the distress, starvation and consequent mortahty at Ijaye were indescribable. Hundreds, nay thousands died in the streets from starvation, whole families perished without anyone to bury them. All the livestock had been consumed, the garden, the streets, and the yards were all planted with corn, but the cornstalks were devoured when they could not wait for the corn to develop. The herb Gb6r6 a common creeper in the streets was planted in every available place and used for food.

It was generally said then that the advent of the Egbas replenished their magazines but exhausted their granaries. Now the Egbas procured food for themselves from home, but instead of succouring their allies, they took advantage of their distress to benefit themselves. A child who wandered longingly to an Egba tent and obtained a meal of beans (awuje) thereby became his slave ! The Egba man who could procure several loads of Awuje beans from home, covered all his expenses by securing so many Ijaye children as slaves for feeding them ! All these were sent home to Abeokuta.

But the good offices of the missionaries of the C.M.S. and American Baptists at Ijaye at this time were never to be forgotten. Sympathizing friends at home and abroad sent them supplies, and they received and maintained as many Ijaye children as they could. The parents also received some assistance and were glad and thankful to see their children provided for. The names of the Rev. Adolphus Mann, C.M.S. and Mr, J. T. Bowen, American Baptist, can never be forgotten by any Ijaye born.

Mr. Mann's skill in surgery also was in requisition ; he was of immense service in extracting bullets and binding up wounds. Thus in ministering to the wants of famished children, sheltering orphans and performing surgical operations he had his hands quite full.

The Ijaye people had also to oppose a war behind them from Oyo. a small force under Amodu was sent to

Iran, as he alone was quite enough to oppose the Oyo army which encamped at Ilora whence they issued for the fight.

The AlAfin whose battle Ibadan was fighting had to supply both the Ibadan and Ilgra camps with gunpowder and bullets and for the latter purpose the services of all Oyo smiths were in requisition.

The AlAfin also invited the Baribas, but their cavalry on which they solely depended were of little use in forest lands ; the I j ayes at Iran concealing themselves in the thickets surrounding the town had the advantage of them. Although Iran was a small village yet the men were able to repulse the attacks of the Oyos and Baribas.

But if they could not capture Iran these Baribas were a source of great annoyance to the I j ayes by kidnapping in their farms and thereby increasing the amount of distress and starvation in the town. This gave rise to the pathetic wail :

" Ibadan mu, Fiditi mu Ojojumo ni ara Ago iimu ni I'oko Ojojumo ni ara Ago fiyan mumusin l§hin odi Oran yi jo bi ala I'oju mi."

Ibadan kidnaps, Fiditi kidnaps.

Daily the men of Ago kidnap in our farms.

Daily the men of Ago capture for service behind our walls,

This matter to me is like a dream ! "

§ 4. Famine and the Sword

As we have already noticed, most of the Oke Ogun towns were under the rule of the Are of Ijaye ; at this crisis they became

the source of food supply to Ijaye, and both men and women frequented these regions for procuring provisions.

By this time the people of Ijaye had recovered from the first shock and horror of a siege, and as the town could not be carried by assault, and was now fairly supplied with food from the Oke Ogun regions, and with ammunition from Abeokuta, the hopes of taking the town soon became very small.

The Ibadans now tried to cut off their supplies by sending a small army to Oke Ogun. Isgyin was friendly to Ijaye and Ibadan, and both were admitted within her walls. A man called Ojelabi went to Iseyin and began to seize people's things in the market for " privilege " as an Ibadan man; Majaro the Aseyin ordered him out of the town, but he not only refused to go but was also setting houses on fire with a lighted torch. He was ultimately driven out under a shower of stones. The Ibadans hearing that Ojelabi was driven out and not knowing the cause, sent one Rogunto ask whether it wastheirintentiontorebel,or why had they expelled Oj elabi . B ut as Rogun and his party were likewise pillaging the town they did not fare any better but were driven out by force of arms. Before this happened however, the Isgyin people showed evident signs of impatience at the language and actions of these men, and sounded in their songs a note of an impending civil fight : —

" Ibadan ti o k^ ti ko lo Awowo a w6 o "

(The Ibadan who sticks and won't go. A great crash will crush him.)

The Ibadan boys on their part took up the challenge and retorted with

" A f'adamo da 'mo lekun Awowo." (The shot gun will shut up all crashes and crushings.)

The civil fight soon set in, and Rogun held out till the evening before he was finally expelled the town.

Iwawun, Erin, and Away^ were for Ijaye, but Bergkodo and other Ibarapa districts were for Ibadan. One AkSwo was sent from the camp to ask the Iwawun people why they were supplying food to Ijaye, the answer returned not being satisfactory the result was a little war here also. The Are hearing this sent Amodu, Arawgle, Adelakiin, Abese and Labudanu to reinforce Iwawun. When Akawo found them too strong for him,

he sent to the camp for re-inforcement, and Latosisa and other petty war-chiefs were sent to his help. Still they found the power of the I j ayes too much

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for them to withstand, so much so that instead of besieging Iwawun, they were on the defensive, being practically besieged in their camps.

Iwawun and Erin were advantageously situated for defensive purposes, being built on a high hill and surrounded by a mass of huge craggy rocks ; the town wall was built at the foot of the hill.

The Ibadan chiefs knowing that as long as Ijaye could draw supplies from these places the town could not be taken, Ogunmgla was resolved to go himself and deal a decisive blow to their power here. The Balogun alone with his men and some minor chiefs being left in charge of the camp, Ogunmola his Otun and Osundina the Osi headed the rest of the war-chiefs to Oke Ogun.

Passing by the Ijaye farms to Fiditi, they reached the Oyo camp at flora. The AlAfin sent one of the eunuchs to welcome them and take them presents of bullocks, sheep, goats, fowls, etc. Ogunmola respectfully dechned to accept them now : he sent to tell the King that he would receive them after his return from taking Iwawun within nine days.

Ogunmola spoke that day as an oracle. He ordered Ajayi Ogboriefon the captain of the Ibadan contingent there to march on before him and receive a shot in that well-fed stomach of his.

" You are leading an easy life here with our King under pretence of fighting against this little place," he said to him.

On reaching Iseyin Ogunmola went to pay his compHments to the Aseyin, and prostrated before him in salutation. The Aseyin forgetful of himself received him as a subject, but he had to pay dearly for it some years afterwards when Ogunmola became a Basorun of Ibadan, and consequently his official superior. The army passed on to Iwawun ; rumours of a large reinforcement to the Ibadan force there reached the ears of the I j ayes at Iwawun, and some of those among them suggested that they should withdraw entirely before the break of day, but Arawole and Amgdu said " Should we not see what is d^{i}^ng us before we run away ? Or what shall we say to the Ar§ at home ? " Up to this time they had no positive knowledge as to who the leader of the expedition was.

Early next morning the Ibadans took a hasty breakfast, and soon after they filed out for the attack on Iwawun instead of waiting for an attack as usual. Those of the I j ayes who had suspected an access of reinforcement were now positive, for otherwise the small Ibadan force could not have been so bold this morning. In order to keep the expedition as secret as possible, apart from his rapid movements, Ogunmola forbade his drummer

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to beat and those of the other chiefs Hkewise, lest his arrival be known to the enemy ; but when the hour for battle was come, he ordered all the drummers including those of the other chiefs to strike up his own battle cry. Consequently the I j ayes were all dismayed and panic stricken when they heard : —

" A f'oke, afi 'gbo (But the hills, but the woods,

Ko s'eni ti o le duro." There's no one to withstand me.)

Now they were forced to credit the report that Ogunmola himself was the leader of the expedition. It was thought most improbable that in the face of the Ijaye and Egba armies Ogunmola and staff with the other war-chiefs would venture to leave the camp.

But the I j ayes were men in the true sense of the word ; after the first shock of this discovery, they steeled their hearts and threw themselves on their assailants with great intrepidity but the odds were greatly against them. It is reported that the chief of Awaye was bribed or terrorized into disclosing a secret path by which an enemy might enter Iwawun, but this is very doubtful, because Awaye herself had to share the fate of Iwawun afterwards. Whatever it may be, Iwawun was taken by assault, and within an hour the town was

in flames ! The Ijaye heroes had an opportunity of escape but did not avail themselves of it. Amodu fought and died a hero's death. He had borne a distinguished part all through this war, and in him Ijaye sustained an irreparable loss.

Five of the Are's sons were caught and slain, including Arawole his eldest surviving son. The death of Arawole sent a thrill of horror and grief throughout the camp and town of Ibadan. Many were the ill-suppressed murmurs against Ogunmola for this heartless murder, for, although Kurumi was now a foe, he was still a name and a venerable figure in the history of Yoruba, a contemporary of the fathers of these Ibadan chiefs and the last surviving link between their past in the old homes desolated by the Fulanis, and these forest lands to which they have escaped. Now he was old and on the verge of the grave, to extinguish his light in his eldest son was an event no reflecting patriot could calmly contemplate. Ibikunle the Balogun was said to have shed a tear when he heard it, and none but that heartless diplomat Ogunmola could have killed Arawole thus. Of the Ijaye chiefs, the Abese, Labudanu and Adejumo alone escaped to tell the tale. About ten others perished there.

Erin also was taken very easily the same day, and numbers of the Ijaye caravans who went there to buy provisions fell into their hands but a great many escaped into the bush.

On the return march of the Ibadans Ogunmola had

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recourse to a ruse by which he entrapped hundreds of those who had escaped into the bush. Instead of his own battle cry, he ordered the drummers to strike up that of the Are of Ijaye, and when those who had escaped into the bush heard : — " Ija Orogun koro, Orogun." (Bitter is the quarrel of rivals, the rivals.)

they naturally thought their master had come to their help against Ogunmola, and as they issued one by one from their hiding places to flock to his standard, they fell an easy prey into the hands of the Ibadans.[1]

On the 9th day of his leaving the Ilgra camp, he arrived there again as he promised to do ; and singularly Ajayi Ogboriefon was also wounded in his " well-fed " stomach, even as Ogunmola said.

But during the absence of Ogunmola and the flower of the Ibadan army at Iwawun, brave deeds were done behind the walls of Ijaye. It was now or never with the alHes, and the Are was determined to take the Ibadan camp before their return. Had Ibikunle not been a particularly brave and experienced general, he could never have withstood the force of the impact made upon him.

Appraising the Egbas at their true valuation, notwithstanding numbers, the Balogun opposed to them his Areagoro Aijenku but himself withstood the more vigorous attack of the I j ayes.

It was on this occasion that the Are at the head of a choice body of veterans made a dash on the Ibadan centre with a determination to break through ; but he might as well have hurled himself upon an immovable rock ! Again and again he tried and failed, and not only so, but the young woman, a devotee, who carried before him into battle his covered calabash of charms for safety and success, was severely wounded and had to be carried away. An eye-witness who stood by him all through and who related the events to the writer, said seeing his non-success, all disconsolate and despairing he sat under fire in the midst of the battle saying " How can I go back, how can I ? I cannot, I cannot." His attendants and bodyguard had literally to carry him to the rear. The old general seemed to have forgotten that he was no longer young, and that for deeds of might and strength, age must give place to youth. Aijenku acquitted himself against the Egbas so well, that he had no need to ask for reinforcement from his chief. There can be

1 History repeats itself. It will be seen hereafter how by a singular act of retributive justice, Ogunmola lost his only son and heir in battle by the same trick being practised upon his son by the Ekitis.

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no doubt that the Balogun gained in prestige enormously by this action and fully justified the eulogies of his bard

" Odunbudere Okunrin A to ft ise ogun ran." (Odunbudere (an untranslatable word) a mighty man, Fit to be entrusted with the onus of war!)

On the return of the Ibadan expedition after the usual welcome the Balogun was said to have expressed himself bitterly to Ogunmola on the slaughter of the Are's sons especially that of Arawole. " Arawole," said he "is our own companion, and the Are, a contemporary of our fathers, how long further has he to live, and who is to uphold his house ?" Ogunmola was said to have justified his acts by saying " If we want the war to be over soon, sentiment must give way to something practical, a crushing blow was needed at Iwawun, and that is what I have dealt."

The cutting off of provisions by the destruction of the Oke Ogun towns gave a death blow to Ijaye. The Are on hearing the sad news was crushed entirely by it. It was as if he had received his death warrant; he saw clearly that all hopes for Ijaye were now gone, and with a dejected spirit he was often seen in his house wandering about abstractedly and muttering to himself " Nje emi ni mo jebi oran yi ? " (am I then in the wrong in this matter ?) He had hitherto been confident of success from the supposed justice of his cause, but now he was sadly disillusioned.

From this time the old general began to languish, and no more great deeds were recorded of him. He died of a broken heart in the month of June, 1861.

Thus passed away one of the most venerable and historic figures in Yoruba history.

Prior to his death occurred that of another notable figure, a friend, colleague, and brother in arms. The Olu-Ode or chief of the hunters of ancient Ikoyi with Kurumi were among the bravest defenders of the old country. After the Fulani destruction of their homes he retired hither with Kurumi and lived the rest of his life at Ijaye. During this war he wrought havoc amongst the Ibadans with his cross bow and arrows. He was never known to miss his aim. In one of their skirmishes he was caught by the Ibadans. When brought into the camp it was said that the Balogun met and saluted him, prostrating before him as to his own father, and there and then gave him his liberty on parole. This was against the wish of Ogunmola who would have him killed at once, but the Balogun overruled it.

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Another chief, a cavalry officer was also caught, one who had successfully crossed spears with the Fulanis in olden days. He, too, was set free on parole, and he wisely retired to Ibadan where he spent the rest of his days.

But the Olu-odg broke his parole, he was caught again trying to escape back to Ijaye. This time even the Balogun could not save him, much as he would like to do so ; the other war-chiefs threatened to mutiny if the Olu-ode was again spared, and the Balogun was obliged to give way. " Why are you going back to a doomed city ? " he asked of the old chief. His reply was direct and simple: " My children are there." " Alas sire, you die, but for a cause not unworthy, you are laying down your Ufe on account of your children." Thus did the Balogun address him before he was led away to execution by Ogunmgla's swordbearers.

After Kurumi's death, Abogunrin his head slave had the honour of burying him. This was done in secret, and the two slaves who dug the grave were slain also to accompany their master so that the spot might not be disclosed ; but the place was found out afterwards, and the skull taken over to the AlAfin as the custom was, for all who bore the title of Ar§-ona-Kakanfo.

The government of the town, and the conduct of the war now devolved upon Abogunrin the Are's head slave, who had been placed in power even before his master's death. His treasures and all his ammunition being under the charge of Abogunrin, implicit obedience was rendered to him by all, in all matters both civil and mihtary.

The only road left to the I j ayes by which they could obtain provisions and ammunition was the Ab§okuta road, and on this the Ibadans began now to kidnap regularly. The caravans had to be under miUtary escort, and the Egba outpost at Olokemeji was an immense service to them at this time.

The old chief Ogunbgna the Balogun of Ikija who was stationed there died of illness, but a small force was still kept there to assist the caravans half way ; the danger lay between Ijaye and Olokemeji, beyond this it was safe. One Oje was a notable escort, but he was caught in the Ijaye farms, and publicly executed.

Early in 1862 the Ibadans removed their camp once more from Alabata, and crossing the river Ose they pitched their tents in the battlefield ; three fierce battles were fought to prevent this but as the Ibadans were able to maintain their ground, the fate of Ijaye was sealed.

Leaving the Balogun to face the Ijayes, Ogunmgla now went to the Abeokuta road and besieged the Egbas in their camp. The Ijayes thereupon left the town and encamped in the field opposite

the Ibadan camp. The fighting now was both obstinate and frequent, for besides fighting in the da3', a special band of skirmishers was organized to keep it up all night.

On the 15th of March, 1862, Lieut. Dolbein, of H.M.S. Prometheus, accompanied by Mr, Edward Roper, a European missionary of the C.M.S, came up to Ijaye to the reUef of Mr, and Mrs. Mann.

A battle was fought on the i6th which he witnessed, and he was said to have expressed his opinion that the Ibadans were superior warriors judging from the manoeuvrings on both sides, and that the town was sure to be taken. But Mr. Mann was unwilUng to leave his post, the state of Mrs. Mann's health, however, rendered it imperative that he should take her down to the coast and he promised to return soon to his post. Mr. Edward Roper volunteered to hold the station until his return.

The Rev. A. and Mrs. Mann with Lieut. Dolbein left Ijaye early on the 17th March, 1862, and as soon as it was knowfi that the white man had left the town, it was regarded as an evil omen for that town. The Egbas said that the white man's God had shown them that evil was coming, and would not themselves wait for it either. Before night fail, there was a rush, fugitives overtook them even in the course of the day, and they had to redouble their speed both to avoid the crush of fugitives and also to escape the expected pursuers. Fortunately the Ibadans did not know in time that the town had been deserted or they might have met them by the way ; still some of the stragglers were met later on when pursuit was made.

Thus fell Ijaye, a town of ease and plenty, a town compact, and full of brave men, an industrious town, but too despotically governed, a town in which the citizens were marked by restlessness and daring.

Ijaye and Ibadan being sister towns and the people one, many wise heads in the former place made captives (as it were) of their wives and children, putting halters round, the necks of their own brothers and led them to Ibadan to the house of their relatives without being detected. Once there, they were free. But knowing each other so well, some were detected and captured. Some lost their bearings and missed their way in the town and were captured, some fell into the hands of acquaintances and were rescued. The Ijaye warriors in the camp with their chiefs escaped with the Egbas to Abeokuta, Abogunrin at their head.

The Egbas assigned them a portion of land where they pitched their tents, and there they subsequently built their houses. The spot is known as AgQ Ijaye to this day.

When the Rev. D. Hinderer of Ibadan heard of the capture of Mr. Edward Roper, he sent to negotiate for his release from Ogunmola in whose possession he was, but this hard-hearted soldier refused to give him up unless he was released for 200 bags of cowries (equivalent then to £200) 200 kegs of powder and 200 guns. Mr. Hinderer then went in person and remonstrated with Ogunmola. The latter grew more stern, refusing to abate any one of his terms, rather than that he would keep him, and if he was incapable of performing any material service for him, still he should be able to tend his poultry yard in his farm. " We have learnt that white men live on eggs and milk I will feed this one with parched corn." And he added " We know that this is not the actual white man of Ijaye, whom we often saw in the battlefield : this one only entered the town a few days ago, hence you have such easy terms, otherwise we should have killed him right out, for he fought us, and we had our eyes on him." Mr. Mann we know did not fight, but reHeved the wounded men; however, there were two " Afro American " sharp-shooters,^ who harassed the Ibadans a good deal with their rifles.

Mr. Hinderer then asked for the interference of the Balogun, of Aijenku and of Ajiya Abayomi ; they all interceded but in vain, he remained obdiu-ate. Mr. Hinderer then sent two of his agents to the Alafin of Oyo to appeal to His Majesty for his interference.

The King then sent the following message to Ogunmola : — " What your Balogun Ibikunle, and your colleagues Aijenku and Abayomi failed to obtain from you, I know you have reserved the honour for me, and now I ask you to give up the white man freely and without any charges." In obedience to the King Ogunmola gave Mr. Roper up to his friends, the latter being too glad to be once more among his countrymen.

Besides the Rev. Mr. and Mrs. Hinderer, Mr. Roper met also at Ibadan, Mr. George Jeffries a friend and college mate of his, and both of them resided together.

A few months- after Mr. Roper's arrival at Ibadan, his friend Jeffries was laid up from diarrhoea. Roper's presence here at this time cannot but be regarded otherwise than as providential, to comfort and cheer up his friend's dying hours. Jeffries passed quietly away and Roper undertook the charge of his station at Ogunpa, Ibadan. He remained there till he was able to return to England in 1865.

The good offices of His Majesty the AlAfin to the missionaries claim our special notice. This was the second of the kind during this war. Mr. Samuel Cole, a native schoolmaster, was once

» Messrs. Vaughan and Pettiford.

kidnapped between Ijaye and Iseyin in the early part of the conflict, (i860). Mr. Hinderer hearing this sent Mr. (now Rev.) D. Olubi to the AlAfin, who kindly ordered his release and sent him to Ibadan. Mr. Cole returned to Abeokuta by the Remo road. The Ijaye war was one of the bloodiest fought by the Ibadans, as may be expected " When Greek meets Greek." But the only chief of note that fell was Osundina the Osi (father of the wellknown Ibadan chief Apampa). He was shot in the knee, but he kept his post till the battle was over that day. He died a few days after. How many thousands upon thousands of common soldiers died on both sides it is impossible to say, but a faint idea could be had from the only authentic account kept.

At the commencement of the war Ogunmola ordered that a correct account of his soldier slaves who fell in battle should be kept. For that purpose a huge basket 5 or 6ft. high was kept and the cap of every slave of his who fell in battle was thrown into it. When Ijaye was taken Ogunmola counted the caps, they amounted to 1800, representing the soldier slaves of his who fell between April 10, i860, and March 17, 1862, exclusive of freeborn soldiers ; and that was for only one single chief ,* what then of the whole Ibadan army and those of the provinces; what of the Ijayes, the Egbas, the Oyos, and the Oke Ogun peoples, and Ijebus engaged in this war !

It shows the redoubtable courage of the assailants and the obstinate resistance of the defenders. It justifies Ibikunle's reluctance to declare war upon their kith and kin. But those who knew Ijaye best, and were acquainted with the details of the enormities being committed there in the years before the war, were satisfied that their judgment was from above ; the cup of their iniquities was full and not only the besiegers but also their very allies helped to bring about their ruin. This was evident from the significant song commonly sung in their dances in those days: —

" Onigbeja li o fo 'gun, Iwi I'a ko gbodo wi." ('Twas our alHes caused our rout, But we must not say 'tis so.) The Egb^s have always been ashamed of this defeat which did not admit of being explained away, but many regarded it as a just punishment for their perfidy. And singularly, scarcely any of the principal chiefs concerned survived the war, thus recalUng Sokenu's retort on them. Henceforth Oygs never have any fear in meeting any Egbas in the field, whatever the odds.

Ijaye was taken, but the war was not over, the bad blood left behind rankled for the next three years.

Chapter XIX.

SEQUELS OF THE IJAYE WAR

§ I. The Awaye War

The Ibadans being determined to punish Away^ for supplying Ijaye with provisions during the siege, now sent the Asipa and subordinate chiefs at the head of the army against it, leaving only the Balogun and the Otun in the Ijaye camp ; and so Away6 was besieged.

Away^ was a small but beautiful town situated on a plateau, the scenery from which is very picturesque, the Ado mount rising in lofty magnificence a few miles off, and the open country for miles around interspersed with the locust and the lya trees. The inhabitants were a very peaceful and agricultural people, and were faithful and loyal to Ijaye to the very last. In fact, Ijaye was the only town of importance to which they could sell their agricultural produce.

The men of that town had no guns, but they were very expert in the use of their bow and poisoned arrows, and for full seven months they obstinately defended the town. It was at last reduced by famine, being closely invested on every side, so that they could not get to their farms ; but the able-bodied men cut their way through the Ibadans and made good their escape. In fact the Ibadans hastily made way for these desperate men, when they saw them making a furious charge and were singing the wellknown song of desperadoes escaping life in hand : —

" Oyin su, Oyin Ig o Oyin a sii, Oyin a pgn roro." (Bees in a swarm, bees swarming away, Bees will swarm, the swarm, o how red.)

Thus these brave defenders deserted the town when famine and the sword rendered it no longer tenable.

The remnant of the Away6 people are now encamped at the foot of the Ado mount.

The Ibadan army returned from this expedition in the month of October, 1862. The latter rains were then incessant and the rivers much swollen ; the Ogun river in particular swept many away, both horses and men.

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§ 2. The Iperu War

During the siege of Awayd, the Egbas and the Ijaye refugees at Abeokuta went also to take revenge on the Remo towns that were friendly to the Ibadans during the siege of Ijaye.

On the 19th of June, 1862, the Egbas destroyed Makun, and advanced against Ode, Ogere, aiming specially at Ipara whose Balogun Rehire was a particularly active ally of Ibadan. The Rem OS therefore sent to Ibadan for help and Ogunmola went straight from the Ijaye camp to Remo, theBalogun himself although in ill health rejoining him soon after, until the army at Awayd could join them. Ogunmola in the meantime found his way to Ikorodu for a supply of ammunition.

Iperu easily surrendered to the Egbas and there the triple forces of the Egbas, Ijayes and Ijebus were concentrated to repel the Ibadans and overrun Remo.

The Ibadans retook several towns as Ipara, Ogere etc., sweeping all before them until they came up with their old antagonists again, re-inforced by the Ijebus at Iperu.

At home, the Ibadans at first made light of the combination, hence they sang in their'dances : —

" Ijebu ko pe okowo, Nitori eru I'a se nlo." (The Ijebus are not worth a sou [lit. 20 cowries] Only for booty are we going).

But the chiefs knew the difficulties that confronted them, especially as the foe blocked the route of their supply of ammunition. Moreover Ajiya Abaygmi pointed out that Remo being a non-agricultural country, could not supply an army with food : they must therefore be provisioned from home and would thus be far from their base ; besides Ijebu is proverbially destitute of water ; he therefore, suggested that they should attack them from Ijebu Igbo, which is not far from the Ibadan farms S.E. as opposition from that point would be almost m7, and in that way they would withdraw the coaUtion against their friends the Remos, and with their own farms as base, they would have a safe and easy task.

The other chiefs saw with him, but, said they, their aim was not to destroy the Ijebus but to protect their friends ; and it would be most ungracious to leave the Remos who had been so loyal to them in their hour of danger,.

Thus the encounter was again renewed between the old antagonists in a different battlefield. The Ibadans were again sweeping all before them, and Iperu was just nearly taken and the confederates crushed when Providence decreed the arrest of their

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progress. The tide turned dead against them ; a combination of causes created insurmountable difficulties.

1. The Egbas now introduced superior weapons. They were armed with breach-loading guns and rifles.
2. One Mr. Pettiford an American sharp-shooter was engaged to pick down the chiefs, thus Odunjo the Seriki, Madarikan the Asaju, Chief Adepo, and others fell. Ogunmola himself was nearly hit, his hat being knocked off his head.
3. The Ibadans having hemmed them up at Iperu were consequently near enough to be within the range of the rifles, and so from within the town walls and surrounding thickets they were constantly harassed in their camps.
4. The Balogun's illness grew worse, he could not leave his bed and several of the leading chiefs were killed.
5. The distance of their base, the difficulty of food supply and the scarcity of water told against them. The whole camp had to depend upon one single well which they dug when water could not be obtained otherwise ; a very deep well it was and the only one.
6. No scope to deploy their troops for manoeuvring against superior numbers and superior weapons ; and worst of all they ran short of powder for the old Dane guns they were using, so that instead of taking the offensive they were now on the defensive in their camps ; the Egbas could come out and cut down the corn they had planted and offer battle.

The direction of the war devolved upon Ogunmola alone in the absence of the sickBalogun, the Osi killed at Ijaye, the Seriki, Asaju and others shot down at Iperu. Matters came to such a pass one day, when Ogunmola was hard pressed that he sent to call the Balogun from his sick bed " to die if needs be like a soldier in the field."

Once more the " lion of the master of camps " aroused himself and appeared on the scene of action for the last time. He was literally helped and held on horse back, one desperate effort was made, and the Egbas were pushed a Httle way back. But the Balogun could not continue long, he left some of his men with Ogunmola, to hold the ground they had regained and he was borne back to his tent. His legs had become so cedematous when he was hfted off his horse, that his riding boots had to be ripped open with a knife in order to release his legs ! Thus the war dragged wearily on, Iperu could not be taken by assault or otherwise, nor could the Ibadans be dislodged from their entrenchments.

Towards the latter part of 1864 the Alafin intervened, as his father did in the late Bat§do war. His Majesty sent the high

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priest of Sango with the emblems of the deity, and a eunuch to represent himself, to the belligerents. They came first to the Ibadan camp, and then passed on to Iperu to the Egbas, Ijayes and Ijebus ; in each place, homage was paid to the god and fealty to the representative of the monarch. The " God Sango had enjoined a cessation of arms and the return of each one to his home." Peace was then declared between the belligerents.

Congratulatory messages were sent home by friends and relatives in opposite camps, mutual visitings took place and all went well for three or four days.

But the Ibadan principal chiefs had no great confidence in Egba good faith, having the perfidy of i860 before their eyes ; they, therefore, took certain precautions.

First, they ordered all the sick and wounded home (except the Balogun), together with the women and children by slow marches. Secondly, the bones of the fallen chiefs were exhumed and sent home for re-interment.

They were apprehensive of treachery from the Egbas immediately they turned their backs, but to prevent a panic they did not disclose their fears or suspicion, but Ogunmgla knowing himself to be the most invidious of the lot and a special object of hate hastened away in the night and before daybreak had reached Ipara. In his hurry his slaves on occasion made way for him with the sword, and seeing his only daughter Omosa in the company of women who had been sent on the day before, he lifted her on to his saddle and never halted until he reached Fawe in the Ibadan farms, there to await his comrades.

But the majority of the women lingered by the way, others in the camp, seeing no reason why they should be in a hurry as all was peace. The Balogun who was dropsical and could not ride was borne on a htter.

Now when the day arrived for the breaking up of the camp, and the Ibadans already on the move, the Egba nature asserted itself by justifying the worst apprehensions entertained of it. They had crowded the Ibadan camp in friendly intercourse, and exchanged greetings, but the prey was now eluding their grasp ; they pounced upon the unsuspicious and began to make prisoners and pressed forward in pursuit. Some of the chiefs who did not suspect treachery were caught. The venerable Sumala the Otun Bale who would have been made the Bale of Ibadan on their return home was caught and killed. Chief Abayomi was one of the unsuspicious, the Egbas had begun to make prisoners before he was aware of what was going on. Mounting his horse when it was tethered he forgot to unloose it till one of his slaves severed

the cord with his sword. He had to fight his way out and escaped.

Soderinde, although a native of Iperu but a resident at Ibadan, and a distinguished cavalry officer was then at home among his relatives enjoying himself ; he was there arrested and had to ransom himself by the payment of a heavy fine, and had to remain there at home for the time. At the stream Afidiwo the Egba pursuers overtook theBalogun and his guards ; these stood fighting whilst those who bore him were hastening on. But the Egbas were pressing closely endeavouring to take the Balogun alive. When they reached the river Omi the Balogun ordered his carriers to put him down and that the Egbas be driven back from that place Akere the Asipa was the only war-chief who waited to protect the Balogun besides his own men and bodyguards. Here, when they had rallied and arranged themselves in order of battle, they made a furious charge on the Egba pursuers and drove them clean away with a heavy loss. These soon finding it unprofitable to pursue armed men when hapless women and children were to be got, quickly gave up the pursuit.

All, as many as escaped, assembled at Fawe from which place they returned home one by one, mostly at night on account of the disastrous ending of the expedition. More women were lost than men. Kehere the Balogun of Ipara wisely came to Ibadan until peace had been completely restored.

For weeks and months, people were coming home by degrees, as numbers had escaped into the bush and lost their way ; some strayed to Ijebu farms and were captured, some found their way back to the road or to Ibadans farms and returned home, whilst some perished in the forests.

A small force of armed men was ordered to proceed as far as the river Omi with the hopes of rescuing them, following the directions in which those who had escaped located large bodies of them. A few were rescued by them, for guns fired to attract their notice unfortunately had the effect of driving them farther into the forests, as reported by the few which escaped.

The view taken of this disaster by the Ibadans was expressed thus in the song and dances of the day : —

" Sango I'o laja ti o d'obirin nu, Ogun ko le wa."

("Twas Sango's mediation that lost us our wives, We've suffered no defeat.)^

^It is only fair to mention that the Egbas atoned for this action in a very diplomatic way as we shall find in §5 following.

The experience gained from this circumstance was the reason for the caution displayed many years afterwards when peace was being arranged between the Ibadans and Ekitis at Kiriji by various parties. The Ibadans

refused to decamp in the face of their foes without a guarantee against a pursuit until the British Government intervened in 1886 and arranged for a simultaneous decampment.

§ 3. The Ikorodu War

The Egbas instead of returning home after this, led the conjoint army against Ikorodu. Ikorodu is a town situated on the Lagoon about 3 hours' steam from Lagos. Whether because as a Remo town she took no part in the late war, or because she was secretly in alHance with Ibadan is not certain. They were here for several months and some good fighting was done on both sides. But Ikorodu was hopelessly outnumbered. When she was nearly taken, the chiefs applied for the protection of the British Government at Lagos. The Lagos traders and merchants also suffering from the closing of the markets approved of the interference of the Governor. His Excellency John Hawley Glover, then governor of Lagos, therefore sent to the Egbas to raise the siege, as Ikorodu was a peaceful town on the Lagoon with a regular trade with Lagos, which was thus beingindirectly injured. On their refusing to do so, he sent them an ultimatum which was also disregarded. On the 29th March, 1865, the Governor sent about 100 men of the West Indian regiment then quartered at Lagos with a few shells and rockets.

Within an hour of the engagement the Egbas had taken to their heels, large numbers perished in the flight. It was ascertained afterwards that those who fell from bullets were very few indeed but the majority died from fright and thirst induced by exhaustion in the flight ; for as the rockets flew overhead with hideous noise and streaming fiery tails, a thing unseen before, they were panicstricken.

As soon as the report reached Iperu of the flight of the Egbas from Ikorodu, Soderinde in order to retrieve his losses and to avenge himself on the Egbas, collected^ his men and as many Ibadan boys, as he could collect who had come down for trade, and they fell upon those of the Egbas who had escaped from Ikorodu and were recovering their breath. He made many captives, and returning he stayed no longer at Iperu but passed on straight to Ibadan where he domiciled until his death in 1880 full of days and honour having attained to the rank of Balogun in the cavalry. Thus Ikorodu was saved.

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§ 4. The Second Dahomian Invasion of Abeokuta

During the Iperu war, the Dahomians taking advantage of the absence of the Egba war-chiefs made a second attack on Abeokuta on the 15th of March, 1864.

It was alleged by some that this was at the instigation of the Ibadans in order that the Egbas might withdraw from Iperu, and also that men were sent to teach them how to encamp and lay siege. How far this is true is not known, but it is certain that the Dahomians required no instigation for raiding Abeokuta nor did they at any time lay siege against her.

The Egbas had profited by the experience of 1851, the town wall was well repaired, and the trenches dug deep, two or three field guns were mounted on the ramparts and sentinels placed to prevent a surprise.

The Christian community, now a numerous body, formed a corps by themselves under John Okenla their Balogun, encamping apart during intervening Sundays, and having their religious services in the field.

False alarms of the approach of the enemy and the usual cry of the women " Ele le m'ele " were constant. The Christians gave the people a sign that when they heard the booming of the cannon, then they were to be sure of the approach of the enemy.

Early in the morning of the 15th of March, the booming of cannon in rapid succession, and the rattling of musketry told the town that the enemy was in sight ; the women resumed their cry, and the men hastened to man the walls.

About 7 a.m. the noise of fire-arms was quite deafening and for the space of half-an-hour without intermission, all on the side of the Egbas who wer€ well within the walls having learnt by experience never to attempt to meet them in the open field to arrest their progress.

The Dahomians without returning the fire, or breaking their ranks marched steadily onwards, the Amazons this time bringing up the rear. On they marched stolidly till they began to scale the walls. Cannon and

muskets were now of little use, it was a matter of hand-to-hand fighting. The Egbas well within the walls kept lopping off the hands of the Amazons as they attempted to scale the walls, and in that way hundreds of their advanced comrades were left in the trenches.

When they were repulsed, they fell back and took to their guns. The Egbas kept up a steady fire from the holes made in the walls. Finding it useless to renew their efforts of taking the town by assault, the Dahomian army retreated but in good order.

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The Egbas now came out, hovering in their rear until they saw them pass Ibara to Isaga. Many captives were made, of whom were Amazons so ferocious, that although chained, many found means of killing their captors, and were of course killed in turn. A male soldier penetrated as far as Igbein, being caught near the C.M.S. station there by the son of an old Ogboni man. He was put in stocks, but great care was bestowed upon him to soften his ferocity. He refused to eat, and was resolved to die. He was heard muttering something in his language, not understood by those around, his intention therefore was not known. But he managed to obtain and conceal a large bit of stone near him, and watching for an opportunity, he dealt a heavy blow with it on the face of the old Ogboni man, who, thereupon fell down and fainted away. The women-folk in the house set up a yell, and as the fellow could not possibly escape he was shot dead on the spot.

The subsequent Dahomian invasions never came up to the walls of Abeokuta, but almost every year their expedition would come as far as Ibara, 10 miles from the town, the inhabitants deserting the place for Abeokuta, and sometimes they would encamp on the Ata hills 5 or 6 miles distant, remaining for a couple of months, devastating the farms all around. The Egbas would remain day and night keeping watch by the walls till the beginning of May when the rainy season had fairly set in, and the rivers began to rise. The Ogun river at this time became a wall of protection for them, as the Dahomians could not ford it nor bridge it, and they had no canoes. The Yewa river also flowing between the Yoruba and Idahomian territories had to be forded. The Dahomians therefore invariably raised their sieges and returned home before the rains had fairly set in.

During these periods of what is called siege, there were some desperadoes among the Egbas who would venture across the river to within two miles of the Ata hills to spy out the enemy, and sometimes to scare them by letting off fire arms. In order to capture such men the Dahomians would come down unseen as near as possible to the river, dig trenches at intervals on either side of the path, and conceal men in them, setting scouts to apprise them of the approach of Egba spies. After these -had passed on towards the Dahomian camp, they would emerge from their hiding places and cut off their retreat, driving them onwards towards their camp. In this way several were caught, and some of those who escaped capture died of fright, or of exhaustion and thirst.

The panic and distress caused by these yearly raids became very great at Abeokuta, depression of trade and the arrest of all agricultural pursuits followed. The Egbas, although better armed,

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yet lacked the courage to leave the security of their walls and meet their enemy in the field. This national disgrace was subsequently wiped off by John Okenla the Christian Balogun, who in 1873 with a company of his men attacked and defeated a body of Dahomian raiders at Oba who went scouring the fields and pillaging the farms.

The Enghsh Government was now memorialized by the secretaries of the CM. Society on account of the Christians at Abeokuta, and, in response to this appeal, the King of Dahomey was warned against meddhng with Abeokuta any more.

The Dahomians now turned their attention to the Yorubas of the western province, and were actually devastating the Egbados and the Oke Ogun districts until a higher power decreed " Thus far shalt thou go, and no further."

§ 5. The Atonement

The Balogun of Ibadan died ten days after their return home, and was given a public funeral with full honours.

The government of Ibadan now devolved upon Ogunmola the Otun Balogun, and the first thing he did was to assemble the other chiefs in council with a view to arranging terms of peace with their neighbours. But the perfidy of the Egbas and the great loss sustained especially of the women must in some way be avenged at any rate.

The secret somehow leaked out that the Egba chiefs gave up Osiele to be taken by the Ibadans to satisfy their honour if it could be done by a coup before the news of it reached Abeokuta.

Ogunmola himself led out the expedition, but remained with the reserved forces in the forests, and entrusted the enterprise into the hands of Ajobo the newly made Seriki. He was to surprise Osiele, swoop down upon it, make a clean sweep of the place and retire ere help could come from Abeokuta.

Ajobo, however, lacked the courage to take it by an assault and hence the expedition failed. Ogunmola keenly regretted having stayed behind, but as the attempt could not be repeated without provoking a war with the Egbas he led the Ibadan forces home again. It was a diplomatic offer and should be done in one stroke.

A few weeks after this Ogunmola again led the Ibadan troops against Atadi another village of Abeokuta, this time entrusting it to no one, he went in person, and on the 9th of March, 1865, Atadi was taken by assault. The two powers now felt that honour has been satisfied on both sides.

It was said that the news of the Ibadan attempt on Osiele met the Abeokuta chiefs at a pubhc meeting, but in spite of the excite-

ment shown by the people, and the urgent requests for a pursuit, the chiefs gave no heed, but were coolly going on with the business in hand, which was quite an unimportant affair.

To the peoples' importunities they simply returned a derisive answer pointing out the impossibility of the thing, and when they knew the Ibadans must have gone then they bestirred themselves to find Osiele intact. Hence when the report of Atadi was given they were able to say " False alarm again, so they did in the case of Osiele the Ibadans would not dare to think of it"

This daring attack was not followed by a retaliation or by further kidnapping on either side which was a proof that it was a diplomatic affair secretly arranged by the authorities on both sides.

Ayawo the wife of Somoye the Basorun of Abeokuta, who was taken at Ijaye was now restored to her husband and on the 15th of July, of the same year, the Ibadan messengers arrived at Abeokuta for a formal negotiation about the re-opening of the roads for intercommunication and trade. A month after this peace was proclaimed, and the roads became free and open to all. The Egbas, however, forbade the sale of arms and gunpowder to the Ibadans, and these forbade the sale of horses to the Egbas.

The paths through the forests fields and farms having been overgrown and blocked by large trees falHng across during the period they were disused, had now to be cut and cleared on either side right on to the frontier.

This brings to a close the Ijaye war and its consequences.

Chapter XX

THE CLOSING AND THE OPENING CAREERS OF TWO HEROES

§ I. Ogunmola's Administration

The attention of the Ibadans was now turned to home affairs, vacancies among the chiefs had to be filled up, and new titles conferred. The first to be conferred was, of course, that of the head of the town as he it is who has to arrange for the others.

It was known that if the Balogun had returned home in good health, he would have negotiated for the title of Kakanfo, as he was the conqueror of the late Kakanfo, and being a native of Ogbomoso, was said to be related to a former Kakanfo of that place. But when his fatal illness supervened it is said that hopes were fixed on the venerable Sumala the Otun Bale for the title of Bale on their return home, but Sumala was caught and killed at the retreat from Iperu. Ogunmola now found himself the undisputed head of the town. He declined the title of Bale alleging it was an effeminate title, for Bales do not go to war, and so many brave men having perished at the war, Ibadan would lose her military prestige by his retiring so early from active life. But he might have negotiated for the title of Kakanfo now vacant. That is a miHtary title par excellence, but his vaulting ambition aimed higher than that, he usurped the title of Basorun notwithstanding that Gbenla the first Basorun of the present Oyo was still alive, and there can be but one Basorun of the kingdom.

The Basorun is a prince of Oyo and the title hereditary, but this impudent upstart who found himself temporarily entrusted with the great force of Ibadan was a native of an Iwo village a provincial of a rough type. He demanded that His Supernal Highness Gbenla should make way for him.

The Alafin, however, was up to the occasion. He agreed to confer on him the title of Basorun ^ro causa honoris in recognition of his services at the Ijaye war. He was firmly against the demand for the death of his aged Basorun. The times said he, demand that such should be the case, Gbenla must remain the Basorun of the kingdom with his official duties to perform at Oyo, but Ogunmola may be a provincial Basorun as a special reward for services done.

Ogunmola having been installed in office demanded His Highness o 365

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Gbenla's " chain of office " (represented by the beads round his neck), and his Wabi (a specially ornamented hide on which only the Basorun sits). The AlAfin sent him both and consoled his chief minister by giving him others and begged him not to mind the insult, nor commit suicide out of grief, as he was inclined to do. He further sent to tell Ogunmola that he might have all he wanted but he was not to demand the death of the Basorun any more, as he the King willed that there should be two Basoruns at this time, one in the city and the other in the province.

It may here be mentioned that 7 years before this event, that is before the Ijaye war, the town of Ibadan was one day startled by the report that Ogunmola (then Otun Balogun) whilst divining with his Ifa, was told by the priest that he would attain to the title of Basorun before his death ! What seemed then to be an utter improbabihty now became a reahzed fact.

The Basorun 's next duty was to confer titles on his chiefs, the more important of them were the following : —

Akere the Asipa became the Balogun.

Tubosun the Osi Bale his old colleague and supporter, the Otun-

Balogun. Abayomi the Ajiya Bale, who distinguished himself so much

before Ijaye and at the Ijebu road, the Osi. Or6wusi, who afterwards became better known, the Asipa. Ali Laluwoye, brother of the late Osundina, the Ekerin. Ajobo, the head of the Badas, the Seriki. Latosisk, who afterwards became famous, the Otun Seriki. Tahaj6, was made the Sarumi. Soderinde, a distinguished horseman, the Balogun Sarumi.

These names were given and we shall come across every one of them again in the course of this history.

Some Oyo titles were now introduced to satisfy distinguished men who were for some reason or other passed over, but who could not accept subordinate titles, in the same way as the Asipa had been introduced for one who failed to get the Otun or Osi. Aijenku negotiated for and obtained the title of F6w6k6.

Omoteji took the Eso title of Gbonka.

Ojokofo that of C)w6ta. These purely Oyo titles were for the first time introduced into Ibadan.

According to merit the man who by far was probably the fittest person for the title of Balogun was the redoubtable Aijenku the Areagoro or alter ego of the late Balogun Ibikunle — the man who alone withstood the whole force of the Egbas at Ijaye when he was left with the Balogun in charge of the camp at the

storming of Iwawun by Ogunmola and subordinate chiefs. But Aijenku failed in his duty to protect his chief at the retreat from Iperu. • Akere on that occasion performed the duty that was his and, therefore, obtained his reward. Ibikunle before his death was said to have bequeathed the title to him.

This offence might probably have been pardoned and an opportunity given him to retrieve his good name by prowess in the field for the public benefit ; but the secret underlying this treatment of him was, that after the death of Oluyole the first Basorun of Ibadan, who tyrannized over his chiefs so mercilessly, subjecting them to his cutting wit, the Ibadans were resolved never to give the higher titles to any Oyos of the pure type, i.e. one born in the ancient capital or in the Metropohtan province. They far excel the southerners in astuteness and diplomacy and rather look down on them, Ibolos and Epos being preferred. Aijenku moreover, was one of Oluyole's household officers and was said to be of an irritable disposition and inflammable temper. There was every probabiHty of his emulating his old master.

And besides this, he was one of the original settlers ; he was one of those who " entered the town on horseback " showing that unhke most of the present chiefs he was never at any time a common soldier, and he never ceased to rebuke or educate the men of another generation in the Hght of former day experience, which goes the wrong way with them. Having been passed over he negotiated for and obtained the title of Fow6k6 a lieutenant of the Kakanfo.

After enjoying a short period of rest, attending to home affairs, Ogunmola now turned his attention abroad. In communication with the Governor (Glover) of Lagos, he effected the opening of the road to Lagos via Remo for intercourse with the interior.

He now thought of avenging all the insults offered to the Ibadans, by some of the provincial kings, which could not have been done before this without unnecessarily multiplying enemies against themselves. Foremost amongst them was the Asejdn who was fond of extemporising epigrams and ditties directed against Ibadan in parabolic songs and dances, and who received him as a subject on his way to Iwawun. Now, as a Basorun takes precedence of all provincial kings, Ogunmola summoned the Aseyin to Ibadan. He came attended by his principal chiefs and Prince Okanlawgn. On their arrival they met all the Ibadan chiefs at the Basorun 's in full council. It was now the Basorun's turn to lord it over him. He at once ordered him to do homage ; this he did by running backwards and forwards to the street three times, putting earth on his head, and prostrating each time before the

Basorun, performing acts of humiliation. His life being also threatened, he had to beg hard for it, and some of the chiefs who were friendly to him interposed on his behalf and he was pardoned.

Ogunmola having thus satisfied his vanity afterwards treated him kindly, and sent him away loaded with presents. Being in part friendly to Kurumi of Ijaye, he could not have been sincere in his loyalty to the AlAfin his liege lord during the "war, but he would sooner entrust himself into the hands of the rough Ibadans, who would at any rate have some regard for the person of a king, than into the hands of his Suzerain at Oyo ; he, therefore, took a bush path to Ibadan and back, and on his return home he extemporized a ditty in his dances, congratulating himself on his safe return thus : —

" Kakk ki Aremu ba ti Oyo lo si Ibadan, Bi o je odun meta Aremu a sun igbe."

Rather than to go by Oyo to Ibadan,

If it takes Aremu three years, he will sleep in the bush.

§ 2. The Igbajo Campaign

About this time there was a civil commotion at Ilesa ; the then Odole, one of the ministers of the Owa being a man of power and influence was in great favour with his master, practically holding the reins of

government; without his fiat nothing could be done at Ilesa.

The Ijesa chiefs about this time were resolved to declare war against Igbajo, a frontier town of a composite nationality (as its name implies) not far from Ikirun, because of their sympathies with Ibadan ; but the Odole, a wise and far-seeing man, was opposed to that measure, fearing the consequences it may entail. The other chiefs said they were not going to stoop to him any longer, and in spite of him they declared war against Igbajo.

The Ijesa standard of war left the town with all their mighty men under the leadership of the Lokiran, Lejoka, Isihikin with the Loro at their head ; thus they laid siege against Igbajo.

The Ijesas of Ilesa were never on good terms with the Ibadans since the late Ijebu Ere and the Ara expeditions and their movements at this time were being closely watched at Ibadan. But several wild Ijesa boys had come of their own accord to reside at Ibadan being driven out of the town by chief Odole for their wild and lawless habits ; these preferring the unrestrained Hfe at Ibadan, distributed themselves under the principal chiefs Ibikunle, Ogunmola, Osundina and others, and fought for them in all their

expeditions. The most notable amongst them were Omole, Ayibiowu, Fayise, O^Q Edidi, Jege, Osogbo, and Ogedemgbe.^ Omgle was the chief of them all and knew the Ijesa farms and all the secret paths quite well. He often led the Ibadan kidnappers to kidnap his own people and bring them captive to Ibadan ; for this he acquired the nickname " A ni obara ojulum6 I'apd " (one who has in his sack a cord for binding an acquaintance). It was the services of these Ijesas driven out of the town that were successfully utiHzed by the Ibadans in the Ijebu Ere and the Ara expeditions. In this way they resented their expulsion from Ilesa by betrajdng their countrymen, and their exploits served but to increase the disaffection of the Ijesa chiefs against the Odole.

Just about this time (1866) Mr. Philhp Jose Meffre a wellknown Ijesa at Lagos with some other Ijesas, taking advantage of the opening of the roads went up for a short visit to their native land. On their returning to Lagos, they bought as curios several native mats, fans, etc., with other articles of merchandise for presents. On both journeys they stayed at the C.M.S. compound and premises at Kudeti, Ibadan.

But the Ijesas of Lagos being at variance with one another, sent secret intelligence to Ibadan, and a hint was given to the Basorun to watch the clandestine movements of Mr. Meffre against the interests of Ibadan.

In the afternoon of the 2nd of March, 1866, the Basorun sent for Mr. Meffre and all his countrymen who were with him and charged them with working secretly against the interests of Ibadan.

They, of course, denied it and declared their innocence. Most of them had been carried away as slaves to Brazil and other parts and having effected their ransom and returned to Lagos they now simply took advantage of the opening of the roads to revisit their native land ; with poHtical matters they had no concern whatever. But the Basorun detained them and cast them all into prison, and sent to the mission premises to confiscate all their goods. The Rev. J. T. Smith, missionary in charge of the station during the absence of Mr. Hinderer, interposed on their behalf, because they were all Christians from Lagos. In vain did he plead their cause, invoking the aid of some of the friendly chiefs. They were all put in chains, and there was no peace or rest at the mission compound on their account. Thus matters stood for nearly a fortnight.

On the morning of the 14th of March all at the Mission were glad to see Mr. Meffre and his countrymen released and sent back free

^The youngest and destined to be the most famous.

unconditionally ! What had happened ? On the previous night, there was a terrible conflagration in which the house of theBasorun had a very narrow escape. All the houses around that part of the building in which these men were chained were burnt to the ground but their prison house was intact ! The Basorun was so struck with this miraculous escape that he exclaimed " Surely these men are innocent persons, and this is

naught else but the interposition of their God, and I am not the man to defy the white man's God." So he hastily released them and sent them back to the mission.

In the meantime the siege of Igbajo was being vigorously prosecuted by the Ijesas, and Igbajo was nearly hemmed in on every side. In their extremity they sent to Ibadan for help. The Basorun sent to them Osuntoki the Maye with some minor war chiefs, but the Ijesas were too strong for them. The town was well nigh taken when the Ibadan contingents there sent home to the Basorun for theBalogun to come to their rescue as mere reinforcements were of no avail.

On the i6th of December, 1866, the war staff was propitiated, and on the 17th the standard was out under the command of the new Balogun Akere on its way to Igbajo. They arrived at Igbajo about the 14th of January, and they obtained. a victory as easy as it was complete.

On the first day the fight was to take place, while they were holding a council of war, the Ijesas marched out to give battle. Abayomi the Osi impatient of much talk left them all at the council, by a private arrangement he entered the forest, and through a secret path was led to the rear of the Ijesa army. All of a sudden he burst upon the principal chiefs where they were lounging without guards and without protection : the younger men were all in the battle field. Escape was impossible, he fell upon them and butchered them all to pieces, carr5ang the camp by assault. The Ijesas who had marched out to give battle were filled with consternation when they saw the camp in flames behind them, and the Ibadan army before and behind ! Panic stricken they were simply pounced upon as does a cat on a mouse. It was a matter of " veni, vidi, vici," the battle did not last an hour. The Ijesa camp was at the foot of a hill, neither chiefs nor men went on horseback, all were on foot and in the chase up the hill not a single chief escaped to tell the tale ! Those who escaped the sword died of exhaustion and thirst, many of them corpulent men. Here the power of the Ijesas was completely broken. Ilesa was partly deserted as they expected an immediate siege. Esa was taken on the 26th of January.

The news of this tragedy travelled swiftly to Lagos, and the Ijesas of Lagos approached the Governor (J. H. Glover) beseeching him to interpose on their behalf, that their capital city be not destroyed by war.

The Governor sent a messenger to the Basorun of Ibadan, deprecating the capture of Ilesa, and accordingly repeated messages one after another from the Basorun were sent to recall theBalogun who had advanced towards Ilesa.

At the same time also, the Owa had sent demijohns of beads and heavy presents to the Basorun at home tendering his submission. Thus Ilesa was spared. The Ibadan army returned home in triumph on the 17th of February, 1867.

§ 3. The Late Ogunmola Basorun of Ibadan

The Ibadan war-chiefs after their arrival at home paid the customary tribute in slaves to the AlAfin. The senior war-chiefs also contributed their share to the Basorun Ogunmola and the minor chiefs received their share from the subordinate chiefs according to custom.

After this the Basorun paid a visit of congratulation to each of the principal war-chiefs on their safe return. Each of them received him with every mark of honour and offered presents of a slave and some heads of cowries. They also paid a return visit according to custom.

A few days afterwards it was rumoured that the Basorun was sick: the rumour soon gained ground, and from the abundance of the sacrifices being offered the malady was known to be serious. It was said to be an attack of small pox, and the Babalawos (priests of Ifa) advised that a gun loaded with bullets be fired in the direction of the Isale Osun district ; this was done and more besides, but all to no purpose. On the morning of the 28th February, 1867, repeated rattling of musketry announced to the public that the august patient had passed away.

Not two months after, on the 12th of April, 1867, Abayomi the Osi died after a few days' illness. On the 30th of the same month died Tubosun the Otun Balogun also suddenly.

These important deaths in quick succession struck one as very remarkable, as if to atone for the wholesale butchery of the Ijesa chiefs at Igbajo. Thus of the five principal chiefs who held the council of war for the rehef of Igbajo within four months only the Balogun and Seriki remained alive.

The Cause of the Basorun's Death. — From the nature of the malady it was generally held that the death was not due to natural causes. During the absence of the war-chiefs at Igbajo, the

Basorun in the height of his glory was so elated that he sent to the AlAfin to send him Ahayan posts and here grass for his Kobi, As a nobleman he was entitled to a kobi (a bay projecting from the house with a conical top higher than the roof of the house). Ahayan is a rare tree found in certain parts of the country, and used by the great alone. It is neither affected by weather, termites, or ordinary fire. The here is a grass used for thatching that grows only in the plain. Annual contribution of this grass is made by subordinates to their chiefs between December and January in the country of the plain, so that a gift of bere has come to be regarded in the Hght of paying tribute ; it has thus passed into a proverb to illustrate anything most incongruous " Odi ori odi ki ara Oyo ki o pa bere fun ara Oko " (the height of incongruity for citizens of Oyo to contribute bere to country folks). This timehonoured maxim Ogunmola was bent on violating out of sheer vanity, not caring for the fact of its being an insult and great offence to his sovereign. The King ordered both to be sent to him, but it was noticed that the posts were wrapped in mats, and tied precisely the same way corpses are wrapped in this country for interment. Ogunmola did not enjoy his acquisition for two months. This can only be regarded as a paternal imprecation on an undutiful and disloyal son.

The more probable and direct cause of his death alleged by those who had access to his presence was the following : —

It was reported to him by one of his roaming followers that he had seen a cloth with one of the Ekiti Kings, the Hke of which could be found in the possession of his superiors. The cloth was so finely-woven that it could be folded up into so small a compass that it could bestowed away by stuffing it into a moderate sized conch shell, and yet unfolded was an ample covering for a man. [The cloth probably was silk, as the best kind of Samayan or rough silk, comes from that part of the country.]

Ogunmola did not adopt a course which one would have expected from so astute a man, viz. to ask the said Ekiti king to send him the weaver to weave one like it for him, or even one of a superior quality, and also to teach the art to his people. On the contrary he sent to take possession of the cloth. Here again we see the operation of that vanity that demanded the title of Basorun, that required Ahayan and Bere for his kobi, and which displayed a show of triumph over the Aseyin. The cloth was sent him. It was noticed that from the moment he unfolded the cloth and wrapped it around his body, he began to feel some inconvenience, this grew to a feverish heat which baffled every effort to cool down, nay not even when they resorted to pouring buckets of

cold water upon him ; it went on increasing in intensity, and in this agony of heat he writhed until he passed away. This gave colour to the bulletin issued that His Highness died of the fever of small pox.

Ogunmgla as a private man has been brought to our notice first during the time of Basorun Oluygle. He was as a soldier bold, hardy, fearless, and very astute. He rose rapidly to distinction by the aid of some of his colleagues who saw in him qualities of a great leader, viz., Awanibaku, who became his Balogun, Tub6sun, who became the Otun Balogun, Aruna, who afterwards became a distinguished cavalry officer, Kukoni who afterwards became a Christian and retired from their company, Odunjo the Seriki of Ibadan during the Ijaye war, and others. He led them on several slave-hunting expeditions, and, as their captain received a lion's share of the booty, so as to be able to fill his position with credit and provide them with arms and ammunition for another expedition. His fame brought him many more followers, and he soon obtained a title and a voice in the government, and thus lose from one post of distinction to another until he attained the head chieftaincy of Ibadan.

We may note here that this is the precise way most of the warchiefs of Ibadan rose to distinction.

As a general he was unsurpassed for boldness and courage, he knew not how to give his back to the enemy, and these qualities often saved him from many a critical position. Being a man of small stature, he always rode on the tallest horses he could find, with his eyes on all around, to single out the brave by name for praise and encouragement, and the coward for disgrace. His fame eclipsed that of Ibikunle his chief, who was his superior in every respect, so much so that those who knew little of Ibadan took him for the head of the town even when he was only the Otun Balogun. But he knew how to obey commands and yield implicit obedience to his superior officer. Of the three senior war-chiefs in the early sixties, Ibikunle, Ogunmola and Osundina, he was their bull dog, hence his name was universally known and his fame grew.

As an administrator he was very just, and was never influenced by bribes. On the contrary if money was brought to him to prejudice his mind in a case to be heard, after patiently hearing the case if it went against the man who attempted to bribe him, he would disgrace him openly for what he had attempted to do, bring out the bribe in public and the fine would be more than the bribe. The following story will serve to illustrate a case of this kind showing also his practical common sense : — A disagreeable man's goat broke through the fence of his neighbour and destroyed several stalks

of his standing corn ; the latter in driving it away inadvertently hit the goat on the head with a stone and killed it. The owner of the goat demanded redress, and charged an exorbitant price for his goat, refusing all entreaties, and when the money was not forthcoming, he summoned the poor man the next day before the Basorun.

The Basorun saw at once that the act was merely an accident and that the plaintiff was altogether spiteful; he was, therefore determined to teach him a lesson.

The case having been stated in open court, the next day the Basorun acted as if he were all in favour of the plaintiff. He rated the man, who killed the goat soundly for his clumsiness and want of caution etc. ; it served him right, he was to pay the price demanded by the owner of the goat, lo heads of cowries ; but as the man could not afford the money (on account of which the case came to court at all) he offered to lend him the amount, and the amount of 10 heads was brought out. Both parties now began to get confused before this extraordinary judge. As the poor man thanked the Basorun and was going away (the plaintiff being afraid to take the money) the Basorun called him back saying " Where are you going, you duffer? Why don't you bring a counter-charge for the destruction of your corn ? I suppose about 30 or 40 stalks were destroyed. As he has received 10 heads of cowries for one goat, supposing you demand 10 heads for each stalk of your corn destroyed ? That would be fair according to his own code, won't it ? " And there in open court he told how this disagreeable neighbour had come the previous evening with three heads of cowries to bribe him on this case. He had kept the money on one side and now ordered it to be brought out in open court saying, "After carelessly leaving your goat to stray out and destroy another man's property you have the heart to come here and charge about double the market price for the loss of it, when this was due to a pure accident." (The utmost amount for goats then was about 6 heads.) It was now the plaintiff's turn to beg trembhng where he lay prostrate before the Basorun. Thus His Highness dealt with the case, the plaintiff not only losing his bribe, but also had to pay about 30 or 40 bags for the corn destroyed. It was generally known that it was of no use bribing the Basorun, that would not affect the decision of the case.

Previously to Ogunmgla's regime, no young man or youth could be seen out of doors unarmed with some weapon or other ; it was considered effeminate to go about without any. Firearms of course were absolutely forbidden by the fundamental laws of the town but a young man did not consider himself fully dressed without

a short sword or knife girded to his side, a jack knife buckled to his left wrist, and wielding in his right hand a large-headed club or cudgel ringed or pegged with iron ; consequently street fighting was a common affair. To spend a good day out without wounds and bruises to show for it was not considered manly. Ogunmola put a stop to all that because thereby the innocent often suffered at the hands of brute strength.

To prevent fire accidents those whose occupation demands large fires like brewers and those who cook eko

or yam for sale were ordered to do so during the dry season in open spaces, preferably near wells or streams, and not under a shed, much less under a roof. The master of the compound was made answerable for every case of fire. In order not to escape justice the rough and ready method pursued was to seize some of the members of the house and the head of the house would be compelled to effect their redemption. When everyone in the compound is liable to suffer, every one will be concerned to see that no mischief arises from carelessness.

Warriors are honouied by him far more than farmers or traders. If, for instance, a warrior's wife is outraged by a farmer or a trader (which was considered one of the most serious offences) he usually imposed the heaviest fines, i.e. a dog, a goat, and 10 bags of cowries which in those days was equivalent to ;{io. But if the case was vice versa the fine is lighter, perhaps only 5 heads of cowries (onetwentieth of the above) and a goat ; but he was usually reminded that the rest of the fine would have to be paid with interest on the battlefield ; i.e. by showing courage and bravery. He was loved and trusted as a leader because he knew how to appreciate and reward valour. As an instance of this the following story may be told : — During the year 1866, one Samuel Peeler, alias Bioran, a Sierra Leone emigrant, who had distinguished himself in many a battlefield was summoned before him by certain hunters and charged with appropriating a deer they had shot, the blood and footprints of which they traced to his farm ; he did not give it up to them, on the contrary when it was demanded he offered them a share ! According to the customary laws of the country that was a serious offence (hunters are a privileged class of men, they are the national foresters, scouts, and bush detectives) and heavy fines were usually imposed on such offenders.

When Bioran was asked what he had to say, he repHed, " Kabiyesi " (may your highness live long) " When the Ibadan army was before Ijaye between the years i860 and 1862 on several occasions when such and such (naming them) important personages fell in the thick of the fight and a deadly struggle ensued with the

enemy for the appropriation of the body, when none could do it, it was IBioran, who went forward, Hfted the body on my shoulders, and brought it to the camp. Again before Iperu when certain important chiefs fell it was IBioran with bullets flying about my ears who went to the midUne of battle and rescued the body from the enemy. Now, in walking over my farm 2 days ago, I saw a dead deer in the border of my farm, so I said to myself. If Bioran can shoulder a dead man between two fires (lit K\k ijk) why should he be unable to shoulder a dead animal between two farms (Ut Alk oko) that was why I shouldered it. Kabiyesi."

The iSasorun who remembered the occasions very well laughed outright and exclaimed " Behe na ni wayi Bioran, behe ni tire ri " (and exactly so it was old Bioran, and that is just like you). The skilful way in which he touched theBasorun's sensitive parts and his witty play on the words " Ala ijk alk oko," between two fires, between two farms, amused the whole court, and there before the assembly theBasorun praised and honoured him for his valour, and calling for a head of cowries and a bottle of gin (instead of fining him), he said, "Take these Bioran, you can go home and enjoy your venison and wash it down with this bottle of gin. I see no reason why a valiant man should not enjoy a bit of venison." Turning round to the hunteis he said " That is not the sort of man to be fined, he is a valiant man." He then satisfied the hunters with some presents to console them and dismissed the case.

Ogunmola had only two sons Osun and Ilgri and one daughter Omosa. He kept a large harem ; his wives could be numbered by hundreds and having but three children by all these, the Ijayes during the war often taunted him in their songs : —

" Ogunmola ko bi'mo (Ogunmola without children

Omo Ibadan li o warun." Ibadan lads he would destroy.)

but he left several grandchildren to mourn his loss.

Ibadan lost in him a wise and just Administrator, and a veteran leader and successful soldier. He was a liberal minded man, who, instead of crushing delighted in lifting up the hands of a weaker comrade. For example, Osundina the Osi, his junior colleague was a powerful warrior but a poorer man than either himself or theBalogun. Thus in one of their expeditions one of his tributary towns gave up more than 200 refugees to him. As these were not captives of war, but refugees (termed £yg) they should be distributed among the

senior chiefs ; but Ogunmola suggested to the Balogun that they should let Osundina keep all in order to increase his means of keeping up his position with credit ; the

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Balogun accordingly agreed. Ogunmgla would never address him by name or title, always " Ekeji mi " my comrade.

§ 4. Ogedemgbe and the Fall of Ilesa

Ogedemgbe a young Ijesa warrior as we have noticed under §2 was one of those restless spirits of Ilesa who came to domicile at Ibadan, where they could find for their energies the scope which was denied them at home. He was placed under Bada Aki iko o a distinguished warrior, under whom he learnt the art of war. When the Ijesas rebelled against Ibadan, he was one of those who returned home to rejoin his compatriots to lay siege against Igbajo. When they were defeated he was caught and brought back to Ibadan and handed over to Ogunmola.

The fact of his having been at Ibadan before and then joined the rebels against the country of his adoption rendered his crime to be regarded as treason for which he should suffer the extreme penalty. He was ordered by Ogunmola to be executed. He was being led to the altar of Ogun (the god of war) for execution when his old colleagues Ayibiowu, Omgle, and O^Q ran to the Basgrun to plead for his life ; they went through Latosisa then the head of Ogunmgla's war boys and a favourite at court. Had Lat6sisa delayed a minute he would have been too late: the Basgrun granted his release, but to mark the gravity of his crime he disfigured his face with the A Bunu marks which he carried to his grave as a lesson for the future, and handed him over to Ayibiowu*.

After this was done, Ogunmgla as his custom was to divine daily with his Ifa, was told by the priest that the young man so disfigured was destined to become a great man hereafter, and that he would cause the Ibadans any amount of trouble. Immediately His Highness ordered a propitiation to be made on the spot where the blood from his face was spilt ; and this was done accordingly. He was the man destined by Providence to be the deliverer of his country from bondage as we shall see hereafter.

A short time after this, Ogedemgbe escaped back to Ilesa, and other young men also who had escaped at the defeat at Igbajg to Odo, Iperindo, and other places returned home one by one. Ogedemgbe now headed a conspiracy against the Odgle who had warned them against the siege of Igbajg, and who by his repressive

^This act of deliverance Ogedemgbe never forgot until the day of his death. Many Ibadan young men in after years that fell into his hands he spared and was often heard to say " They did not kill me when they might have done so, we must spare them! "

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measures caused many young men to flee from the city of Ilesa. A civil war ensued ; for seven days the Odole kept them at bay, but at last, overpowered by numbers, he was shut up in his house for three days, and when his boys grew weary and disheartened and began to disappear, the Odole fell by his own hands.

Immediately the news of the death of the Basorun of Ibadan reached them, Ilesa again rebelled openly against Ibadan and war was declared against them.

Balogun Akere was now the senior chief after the death of the Basorun, but he declined to assume the Baleship till after their return from the Ilesa war. It was alleged by some that the Basorun before his death left a charge that Ilesa should not be spared. Whether it was so or not, yet the Ibadan chiefs were not all unanimous about this expedition, not from any love for Ile§a or fear of its almost impregnable forts, but rather that titles should be re-arranged so that they might have promotions. The Balogun could obtain the assent and co-operation of Obembe alone, the son of the late Balogun Ibikunle ; having secured the confidence of this powerful chief he declared war in spite of the others.

The war-staff was propitiated on the 20th December, 1867 ; it had to be done at night on account of the disaffection among the chiefs. The Balogun left the town on the 22nd of December and as in duty bound,

the rest of the chiefs joined him on the 23rd. They marched straight via Oshogbo and encamped first at Ilase and marched thence to Ibala. Here the Ijesas began to oppose their advance, and the first battle fought.

Hitherto the war chiefs followed the Balogun just mechanically but would not fight for him ; but with the help of Obembe he felt he could dispense with their services and so he took no notice of them. But now a formal measure was adopted to put an end to the disaffection, the matter was talked over, the Balogun pacified them with large presents, and being satisfied they fought with a will, and dislodged the Ijesas from Ibala, forcing them to fall back on Afara Jegede. This was a trench about 30 or 40 feet deep with drawbridges, carried almost round Ilesa. Here the Ijesas made a long stand, but it was taken at last and the camp was removed forwards.

There was another entrenchment \vith forts beyond a stream which the Ibadans named Fejeboju (washing the face with blood), so named from the bloody battles fought there which caused the stream to flow with blood constantly from the wounded and the dying. In an attempt to take this second entrenchment an ambuscade headed by Ajdbiowu went to the Oke Esa road, but they were discovered and waylaid : they were dispersed and

Ayibiowu their leader was taken alive by his countrymen, and butchered to pieces.

The Ibadans were over a year in this place fighting but could not take it, and without that there was no hope of taking Ilesa. Notwithstanding this the Ijesas considered it prudent to surrender, as sooner or later Ilesa would surely be taken ; hence they began to negotiate for peace. There was an armistice ; during the negotiation, they brought over 400 bags of cowries into the Ibadan camp as submission money, but the chiefs feared to touch the gift, for it might have been poisoned ! But Ogboriefon who about this time began to make a name being a poor man, was wilhng to take all. " Let me die if poisoned," said he, " I do not mind." With this he entertained the fighting men, and made fresh preparations for the conflict. At this crisis Akere the commander-in-chief died. A council of war was held to consider the decision to be made under present circumstances. It was resolved to continue the war " lest the Ijesas would say we agreed to peace because we had lost our leader." So the next day they forestalled the Ijesas by telling them that they had killed their Balogun because he was inclined to peace, the armistice therefore was now at an end. A terrible battle ensued that day, they fought till sunset. This was done chiefly to inspire courage into those that might be faint-hearted amongst themselves and lose courage on account of the death of the Balogun. This battle was fought on February 15th, 1869.

The command of the army now devolved upon Orowusi the Asipa. Orowiisi was a powerful chief but very unpopular. He was disliked by all the senior war-chiefs of the day, he had no influence even with the men ; however, by virtue of his office as senior chief all agreed to submit to him.

What was denied him, however, was accorded to his eldest son Akeredolu. This young man had several friends among his companions, several left their masters and made him their captain, and at last the honour was his to capture this entrenchment which had baffled the whole army for over a year. The trench which continued as far as they could extend their lines to the right as well as to the left, they thought was carried right round the town but it was disclosed to Akeredolu that it terminated at the foot of a mighty rock several miles distant and that the terminus was concealed by a dense forest. Excepting on the day of battle very few men were generally left to guard the entrenchment and the fort which was considered impregnable, the majority being left at home for rest and enjoyment,

Akeredolu kept the secret to himself, he told not even his father. One afternoon he and his companions put on their arms, and it

was reported to his father that he was going to the battlefield. Not being the day of battle the father was alarmed that he was going single-handed to attempt what had baffled the whole army for more than one year ! He sent peremptory messages to call him back, faihng in that, he sent a pathetic remonstrance “Come 'back, oh, come back, tor so was I bereaved of your elder brother at the Iperu war, when he was attempting a feat of valour." Akeredolu heeded nothing, but went off in another direction. When out of sight of camp he

dismounted and carried a gun on his shoulder like the rest of his companions, and was led to the foot of the rock where the trench terminated. They chmbed.it to the other side and made for the battlefield, nothing preventing them.

The Ibadan chief being anxious about his son and not knowing his whereabouts, armed himself and went out to the battlefield, the whole army, of course, following him. Then all of a sudden Akeredolu and his companions appeared on the other side of the moat, fell upon the small guard left there and dispersed them ; the drawbridges were thrown over to admit his father with the whole Ibadan army, the walls of the fort were quickly beaten down.. In a few minutes the trench was filled up to a considerable distance, every one throwing in something, and with hoe and digger it was soon levelled up enough for a passage for the whole army. Thus Akeredolu won for his father and for himself a great reputation. The Ibadans were now able to remove to a third encampment by the walls of Ilesa.

Before Ilesa was taken two other chiefs signalized themselves, viz. Latosisa the Otun Seriki and Ajayi Ogboriefon. The latter rose into prominence by heading a band of young men for exploits, as most of the Ibadan chiefs did. He was always poor, because he spent lavishly, but he was a brave leader and smooth tongued, knowing well how to encourage soldiers and inspire courage into the faint-hearted. Thus in the thick of the fight with men faihng right and left, he used to produce beans from his satchel showing them to the men saying, "See, this is what they are filing now, they have no bullets, come let us get at them." Then he used to remind them of home and all its pleasures, telling them that it is the bravest that will be honoured, who can break the laws with impunity. " Remember the bazaars, the Iba market, what pleasures you often enjoy there, pleasures bordering on crime. Now is the time to atone for them if you will enjoy yourself again with impunity." With such words he often spurred them on to the fight.

The Ibadans now discovered that the Ijesas were well supplied with food and ammunition from Odd, and it was evident that unless this road was taken there was little hope of taking the town. The

arduous task of doing this devolved upon these two war-chiefs Latosisa and Ajayi Ogboriefon. This road being the hfe of Ilesa was heroically defended by two armies. A more desperate battle was never fought in this campaign than what took place here. Latosisa opposed the Ijesa army from the country, and Ogboriefon that from the city.

An Ijesa eye-witness reported that in the first day's fight a heap of 140 corpses was made, the corpses not being allowed to be removed home or lie about for fear of causing a panic ! The wounded were more in number, and these on the side of the Ijesas from the city alone. For five days the contest continued, fighting went on day and night till in the end the road was taken and the Ibadans under Latosisa and Ogboriefon made an encampment there. Ajgbo the Seriki encamped in the Oke Esa road, and the body of the army with the head war-chief at Ita Ogbogi in the main road. The walls of Ilesa were very thick, high and slippery, the moat very deep, and as long as Ogedemgbe was there to defend it. there was no telling how long the town could hold out. But the end was inevitable.

Added to the distress in the city were the ravages of the band of ruffians called Ipaiye. These were Ogedemgbe's war boys organized like the Jamas of the days of Afonja. They would enter houses and help themselves to food and whatever they could lay hands upon.

When the C)d6 road was taken and food supplies cut off, people died of starvation in the streets by hundreds ; the ravages of the Ipaiyes became more intolerable. Whole famiUes left the town and entered the Ibadan camp giving themselves up as slaves in order to save their lives. Ajobg the Seriki was largely benefited by these, for hearing of his unparalleled liberality, they entered the Ibadan camp and named him as the chief they gave themselves up to, and were conducted to his tent.

Ogedemgbe at length sent word to Ogboriefon to grant him an interview. This interview took place on the battlefield, the two generals leaving their armies in the rear met at the centre of the battlefield.

At the second interview they made a covenant of friendship and Ajayi promised to allow him a safe retreat. The fate of Ilesa being now a foregone conclusion, in order to prevent further unnecessary loss of lives by

the sword and by famine, they arranged that the Ibadan army should make a way for Ogedemgbe and his followers to go in peace leaving the town a prey to the besiegers.

On the appointed day Ogedemgbe brought valuable presents in beads and cloths to Ajayi, and the covenant was ratified.

Early in the morning of the 4th of June, 1870, Ogedemgbe with his Ipaiyes left Ilesa and threw the gates open. According to arrangement the Ibadans opened their ranks for them to pass, and closed them against stragglers, and then the town was taken.

The Owa came into the camp. The Ibadan chief gave him 10 of his wives and as many of his children as could be found, also 10 bags of cowries and a basket of kola nuts. They then left him in charge of the king of Ibokun (a neighbouring Ijesa tributary town) to be reinstated when the fugitives and all who escaped capture could have returned to their desolate homes.

The Ibadans pursuing their conquest as far as Odo and Iperindo, both places were taken. The a;rmy now divided into two parts, one part went against Igangan, the other to Ipetu ; the former made a long resistance but was at length taken.

The Ibadan army returned home in triumph on the loth of July 1870.

All the war-chiefs in procession escorted home the coffined bones of the late Balogun Akere. Before this coffin when fixed in state the leading chief prostrated and in a formal way told the result of the war as to the living Balogun, and then wept over his remains lamenting his loss !

The whole of them now accompanied Orowusi home, thereby acknowledging him their head, then they dispersed to their homes.

Ogedemgbe whose opening career we have now related disappeared from view for a time. We shall hear of him again.

Chapter XXI.

TWO ADMINISTRATIONS OF OPPOSITE POLICIES

§ I. Orowusi's Administration

Ibadan was the one place that loomed largely in people's eyes at this period (1870). To have taken liesa was regarded as a feat of extraordinary magnitude it being a town of great strength, both in its fortifications and in its able-bodied citizens ; and consequently the eyes of all surrounding tribes were fixed on the town situated on the hills.

The first duty of the Ibadans now was to fill up the vacancies among the ruling chiefs and to settle home affairs.

They had only been at home for less than two months when on the 1st of September the town had to lament the death of Osun, the first-born son of Ogunmola the late Basorun. It was a great loss to the community, as the late Basorun had only two sons and a daughter. The town went into mourning for a month, and then arrangements were made to confer the title of Bale on Orowusi. On the 30th September Agbaro the Ilari sent by the AlAfin for the purpose conferred the title on him in the presence of all the chiefs and a large assemblage of people.

On the 5th day after, the Bale began to confer the principal titles by batches ; the most important of which we need mention are : — Ajgbg who became the Balogun, Latosisa the Otun, Ajayi Ogboriefon the Osi, Ali Laluwoye the Asipa, Lawoyin the Seriki, Ojo Oronna the Otun Seriki, Tajo the Otun Bale.

All these men' played some important part more or less in the history of the country. By the end of October the affairs of the town had been settled.

On the 5th of November the old Chief Mele was again despatched to Ijebu to negotiate for an Agurin (consul) in order that peace and amity might once more be established between them. The last Agurin was recalled

when Ijebu declared war against Ibadan during the Ijaye war. Now peace and tranquility reigned over all the land.

This Bale encouraged agriculture himself setting the example. Under such peaceful rule the Christians of Ibadan numbering about 400 with their teachers thought it right to do honour to the Bale, who was well disposed to Christianity. They went in a body with the school children to his house, and he came out to receive them in

the square in front ot the house and a short service was held including the prayers for the King and all rulers. The Bale was immensely pleased and the Christian body enjoyed a pleasant day.

Civil commotion. — The next trouble started where the last ended. The Owa of Ilesa being dead, it devolved upon Ibadan as the Suzerain power to appoint another Owa. There were, however, two claimants, each with his rival party, and both parties were seeking for help among the Ibadan chiefs to promote their cause.

Prince Odigbadigba, backed by Ogedemgbe, sent about 50 slaves and a quantity of beads to Balogun Ajgbo to promote his cause. Ajgbo instead of bringing the matter before the council, with whatever backing he could bestow on his client, appropriated all the presents and gave orders that Odigbadigba be crowned.

When the Ibadan chiefs came to know about all this they were fired with rage and ordered both claimants to Ibadan. In the meantime Ogedemgbe's nominee had been crowned at Ilesa, but on their arrival he was set aside as being irregularly crowned, and the rival was crowned at Ibadan on the 22nd of May, 1871, and sent home in state. Prince Odigbadigba was detained at Ibadan, and lodged with Ogundepo the Bale's brother.

This action of Balogun Ajobo hurt not only the Bale whose rights he had often usurped, but also his brother chiefs, especially his principal lieutenants Latosisa and Ajayi, on whom fell the brunt of the task of taking Ilesa at the final stage.

Ajobo's popularity lay in his largess to the people, which gained him fame at home and abroad and secured for him a large following among whom were some brave men that could not be overlooked; this popularity turned his head, leading him to act as he did. As a leader he was much lacking in courage and ability as the fiasco at Osiele showed, and therefore he carried no weight or respect among the body of the people. He arrived at his post more by order of seniority than by merit and by the large number of men behind him which must be taken into account. But for such a grave political blunder his deposition was resolved upon.

Chief Ogedemgbe was very anxious about the safety of Prince Odigbadigba hence he was sending some slaves and presents to the Ibadan chiefs to effect his release. On this being known, the Ibadan chiefs sent to intercept the messengers out of spite to the Balogun to whom they were sent direct.

On the 23rd of June, the war-staff was demanded from him, — a sign that he was deprived of his title : there was consequently a great commotion in the town, the people apprehending a civil war, but Ajobo had not the courage to attempt one ; on the

contrary he spent largely to purchase his pardon. This pardon was granted on the 29th and all was quiet again, and he attended the weekly town council as before.

But the disaffection against him among some of the chiefs was as great as ever, and the desire to encompass his fall very strong, especially with Ajayi the Osi, and Lawoyin the Seriki, who were under great obligation to him for the means of attaining their present position. To them his fall would mean one hft upwards in their titles, and an obUteration of their feehng of obhgation to him, the shame and remorse of conscience for their ingratitude to him in his distress, being intolerable when he was pardoned. Consequently there was another explosion engineered by these two chiefs ; he was deprived of all his tributary towns, was forbidden to attend Council, and was rejected by the chiefs in council.

Ajobg now resolved to die, and ordered his cofhn to be made and the grave to be dug. On the evening of the 5th of July, he returned the war-staff to the Bale. But early on the 6th when everybody was expecting to hear of Ajobo's death, and his lying in state, he escaped from the town ; passing by the C.M.S. station

at Kudeti he took a by-path by which he regained the main road to Ijebu and escaped to the town of Ipara in the Remo district. Some of his ill-wishers actually gave chase when the news of his escape was heard but failed to overtake him.

Now his principal opponents Latosisa and Ajayi Ogboriefon came to congratulate the Bale on having got rid of the Balogun. But the Bale's reception of the news disappointed their expectations. The Bale's wish was that his pride be humbled for such a gross public offence, but that he be finally pardoned. With surprise and alarm he asked " Gone away .-* Who drove him away ? What message did you send him which obliged him to leave the town? " Latosisa and Ajayi repUed "Who drove him away but yourself ? Did you not send a messenger to us to say we should accept no terms of reconciUation ?" " What " replied the Bale " What is the name of the messenger I sent ? " In great anger the Bale retired within and shut the door against them leaving them where they prostrated before him.

He saw at once through the scheming of the war- chiefs who would get rid of a chicken-hearted Balogun ; but he the Bale had no need of a fire-eater for one, and hence he apprehended trouble from these younger war-chiefs.

That was the last time the Bale was seen in public, he never showed his face after this till his corpse was exposed in state before interment. The rumour of the Bale's death began on the 15th of August, but there was no pubhc announcement. On the 19th

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Prince Odigbadigba, who was the cause of all these troubles was sent away to his country, but private orders were given to his escorts, that as soon as they were a good way off from the town he should be murdered. On the 30th of August, Ijebu ambassadors arrived at Ibadan to plead for the restoration of Ajobo, but they were sent away with a negative reply. On the evening of the 19th September it was pubHcly announced that Orowusi the Bale was dead. The expulsion ot Ajobo being the cause of his death his people went that same evening and set Ajobo's house on fire.

Ibadan was once more without a head. Tajo the oldest among the war-chiefs declined the honour. When the other chiefs were going to assemble in his house, as the Otun Bale, he met them at the central market and there dechned the offer. No elderly chief agreed to accept the title from the unsettled state of the town due mainly to Latosisa and Ajayi. For some time their meetings were held in the central market till at last Latosisa agreed to undertake the responsibility though not as a Bale but as a Kakanfo. He alleged that he was a Moslem and none of his cieed had been Bale before, but Ojo Amepo who was a Moslem was a Kakanfo and he took his precedent from him.

The Ibadan chiefs did not Like the idea, and the AlAfin ot Oyo was reluctant to grant it knowing the national troubles usually caused by strong Kakanfos, but in the end Latosisa won all parties over and obtained the title.

The Late Bal§ Orowusi. — The late Bale was a native of Ogbdgbd a town about 6 miles from Iwo. He was originally an elephant hunter hence his name Orowiisi, super-deadly poison (from his poisoned arrows in hunting big game). He rose into power by his own merits, but he was unpopular among the other war-chiefs who were his seniors in the days of Ibikunle and Ogunmola. Notwithstanding instances of slights and indignities he endured in the earlier days, he lived to be the head of the town of Ibadan. His rule was short but was marked by a wise adminis tration and by peace with the surrounding tribes.

He was a far-seeing man, of sound judgment and strong determination. He once summoned a meeting of the chiefs and after addressing them on matters poUtical and inter-tribal, he laid down the following advice which he wished them to treasure up and act upon for the present and future.

" I. That on no account should Ibadan wage any aggressive warfare with any of their principal neighbours the Egbas, Ijebus and Ilorins.

2. That high and responsible positions should not be given to the Mogajis (heirs to large estates) because of the men and means at

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their command, on account of their inexperience, but rather to older men who were the companions of their fathers for the country will be the gainer by their experience.

3. That they should rely more on the children of the soil than on their slaves, as it has now become the fashion to make of their slaves high stewards and confidants ; for how can these who are slaves after all seek the permanent interests of the country that enslaved them and made their own country desolate ? The seed of bitterness towards ' Oygs ' must have sunk deep in their hearts. Their women also should not be made their principal or choice wives.

4. Never should the slaves be entrusted with messages of impoitance to the interior, for having nothing to lose, their conduct will not be marked by moderation or discretion."

These words were well received by the assembly and he set the example by refusing to grant the title of Seriki to lyapo the son of the late Balogun Ibikunle, although for wealth, power, and the highest war-like qualities he was unsurpassed by none at Ibadan, but his youth was against him. Hence the title was given to Lawoyin an old and experienced veteran who had seen many wars.

How these precepts were reversed by the succeeding administration and with what consequences to the country we shall see hereafter.

§ 2. Ibadan Under a Kakanfo

Latosisa usurped the title of Kakanfo by might over right, by displacing Ojo Aburumaku the Kakanfo at Ogbomosg, as Ogunmola attempted to do in the case of Gbenla the aged Basorun of Oyo. He sent to Ojo for all the insignia of the office, which he was obliged to resign to him, and on the 3rd of October, 1871, he was publicly installed. On the 9th he gave titles to his chiefs the most principal of which were to Ajayi Ogboriefon, Balogun the title he intrigued so much for, and to Ali Laluwoye the Otun. They were barely a year at home when the Ilesa complications cropped up again, but this time they appeared as defenders of that city.

We have seen in the preceding section that Odigbadigba was the man Ogedemgbe desired to be crowned as Owa, so when he heard that Odigbadigba was murdered at Ibadan he came with an army from his place of exile, captured Ilesa and drove away the Owa placed there by the Ibadans. Thus Ilesa was destroyed a second time within a short period. Ogedemgbe remained at Ilesa in defiance of Ibadan.

The Ogedemgbe Campaign. — The Ibadans accepted the

challenge by espousing the cause of the expelled Owa. The standard of war was propitiated on the 28th of December, 1872, and on the 30th Ajayi Ogboriefon as commander-in-chief marched out. His orders were simply to capture or drive away Ogedemgbe and restore the Owa.

But Ogedemgbe would not risk another war with the Ibadans so shortly within the walls of Ilesa, so he left the town at the approach of the Ibadan army.

These encamped near the walls of Ijeba Ere, and although their orders did not include seizures at Ilesa, yet, as individuals among them entered the city with the intention of buying provisions one and another among them seeing their run-away slaves of the previous campaign, seized them, others following their examples seized under false pretences, and in order not to go away empty handed, seizures became general, and so Ilesa was taken again as the people were just settling down.

The Are of Ibadan on hearing this was much displeased with the Balogun, and, although he pleaded his innocence in the matter, yet the fact remained a stigma on his character. He was sent to reheve Ilesa not to plunder it.

Passing from Ilesa in pursuit of Ogedemgbe, Odo was again taken. The commander-in-chief being somewhat in a state of destitution before he left home, did not abide by his orders, but was only intent upon slave catching and was always ready with excuses. Ogedemgbe was pursued from place to place until he lured them to a great forest called Igbo Alawun east of Ikere where he made a stand. Ogedemgbe encamped at

Ita Ogbolu and the Ibadans at Ogotun with the forest between them ; there they fought several battles. Ogedemgbe inflicting disasters upon them checked the restless ambitions of the Ibadans.

Ifthe Ijesa and Efon towns in the rear had had the courage to rebel, the Ibadans would have been cut off to a man.

The third battle fought here was simply disastrous to the Ibadans. Ogedemgbe and his aUies lay in ambush while a small body of men was sent forward to draw the Ibadans ; this was soon defeated and in the pursuit the flower of the Ibadan army was hemmed in and cut off from the main body at the base. Most of the young Mogajis were there such as Akeredolu heir of the late Bale Orowusi, Aderibigbe, heir of the late Bale Olugbode, also the A§aju with all the Badas, the Seriki with his Otun and Osi Seriki. These last sat on the very spot the ambuscade was laid their men all scattered in the pursuit for slave catching when all of a sudden the Ijesas opened fire upon them ! The Seriki was shot off his horse, seriously wounded, his Otun and Osi were killed on the spot and their heads

taken off (the Osi Seriki alone had 2,000 followers in this campaign not one of them being with him when this disaster occurred) When the pursuers knew that they were hemmed in, they began to fight their way back, and the pursued now became the pursuers. It was " save himself who can " with the Ibadans, the chiefs had only with them their bodyguards who must always be by their sides in weal or woe.

It was now that Balogun Ajayi began to redeem his honour. He was a man for any emergency. Unrespected hitherto because he was inferior in men and means to any of the Mogajis, but for presence of mind, courage and resources, he was unequalled by any. He came up at once with the reserve forces, bore down on the Ijesas, and in one tremendous charge he dispersed them and in that way he saved those who had been cut off. The news of this disaster was received with great mourning at Ibadan.

To mihtary skill, Ogedemgbe now added state craftiness ; he sent large presents to the Are at home and tendered his submission. The Are sent one messenger after another to recall the Balogun, but from shame the Balogun would not return till the third messenger reached him. A great deal is attached to a Balogim's first expedition, and to go home empty handed with nothing but tales of disaster was enough to make him afraid of falHng into disrepute, especially as there were murmurings against him already among the war boys.

He turned his steps homeward with a heavy heart. He spent a few days at Ikere. It was in his mind to surprise the town and capture it, but when it was privately intimated to him that they would be hemmed in, he left quite unexpectedly.

The army arrived home on the ist September, 1873.

The Are reprimanded the Balogun sharply for disobeying orders, and he wept in the pubUc meeting like a Httle child. He would have been deposed from his high olftce, but the Are knew his worth as a soldier, and that his misfortune lay in not having the wherewithal to command respect and that for that reason he was bent at all hazards on risking everything in order to secure the necessary means.

The war-chiefs now began to disrespect their commander-in-chief but conscious of his own capabiUties he took no notice of slights and insults knowing that occasions will arise when he was sure to command their respect. In order to quiet the restlessness and general dissatisfaction the Are promised to lead the next expedition in person when they would have an opportunity of retrieving their losses.

The Arg however, deposed the Seriki Lawoyin alleging that he

was too unlucky as a general to lose his two principal lieutenants in his very first campaign. But the underlying reason was that the principal chiefs felt he was a disgrace to them for the glaringly base ingratitude he displayed towards the deposed Ajobg who had helped him to defray the expenses incidental to his taking office by giving him 800 bags of cowries, a horse, a sword, gowns, etc., and this HberaHty he requited by pursuing the fallen chief with the very horse he had given him !

Lawoyin submitted calmly, relinquished public life altogether and retired to his farm.

The title was given to lyapo the Mogaji of the late Balogun Ibikunle who commanded all his late father's resources, and for men and means was unapproached by any of the other chiefs in the town. And Akeredolu son of the late Bale Orowusi the Otun Seriki. Thus the Are began to reverse the policy of the late Bale Orowusi in the advice not to exalt inexperienced young men over elderly men of ripe judgment although comparatively poor. His idea was that these young men should be advanced to responsible position in order that they might use the means at their command for the public benefit which they would otherwise not do. Subsequent events will prove which of these two poUcies was the right one.

§ 3. An Unprovoked War.— Ado

The Ibadans were not long at home before they found another pretext for marching oat. for .-ilave raiding. The Ifes, seeking an occasion against Modakeke, but mindful of the past were afraid to attack them direct, and secretly invited the Are and gave up the town to him. So the Ibadan army left home again, under the Are, on the 8th December, 1873.

He rendezvoused between lie Igbo and Kuta, villages of Iwp, and was just preparing to cross the Osun river and march against Modakeke when the Ifes thought better of their offer and regretted theii rashness. They now prayed the Are to leave Modakeke alone ; for it occurred to them that there was no wall separating the two towns, and what would prevent the wild soldiery of Ibadan from rushing from one to the other ? They would just be bringing disaster on their own heads.

So the Are desisted. The Ibadan army then marched to the Ekiti country with no express object in view. The Are now remembered that he had lost a brother in the Agbado war, when they were waylaid by the Balogun ot Ado ! He now made up his mind to destroy the Ado country.

The Ados met them at lyin a frontier town of theirs, and were

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routed in a single pitched battle on or about the i6th of January 1874. They could not rally, so the Ibadans made an easy conquest of the whole district. Men, women, and children were captured without the slightest attempt at resistance. So many were the captives and so much the booty, that the campaign appeared more like a promenade.

The king of Ado entered the Ibadan camp in full regal attire attended by a few followers who had nearly all stolen behind him ere he could get to the Are's tent.

The Are received him with every mark of honour and respect ; he now remembered that his second wife was a native of Ado and so he would do honour to her king. He obtained for him 41 of his wives, 21 of his children, 30 of his chiefs, and bought him a horse and caparison for 3 slaves, and re-instated him. The Ibadan army arrived behind their town wall on the 21st February and entered in a triumphant procession on the 22nd.

The conquest of Ado was so easy that not a chief was missing, but Akeredolu, the Otun Seriki, who signaUzed himself in the Ilesa and Ogedemgbe wars was taken ill, and remained two months at I la but growing worse was brought home to die on the 5th April, 1874. His brother Ajayi Osungbekun succeeded him both as head of their father's house, and in his office of Otun Seriki.

§ 4. The Are's Administration

Latosisa the Are-ona-kakanfo at the commencement of his administration ruled with great clemency, but after this successful expedition be began to show himself a Kakanfo with all the characteristics of a Kakanfo — obstinacy, recklessness, blood thirstiness.

The Are's first act after his return from Ado was directed against Efiisetan the lyalode or Ladies' Queen. The charges against her were : — i. That she did not accompany him to the war. 2. That she never sent him supplies during the campaign. 3. That she did not come in person to meet him outside the town wall to congratulate him on his safe return.

He was, therefore, resolved to depose her and this was done on the ist of May, 1874, and lya Ola her Otun (first Heutenant) was promoted to the office.

lya Ola was very reluctant to accept the office, but the Are sent a peremptory message to her to say, if she refused, she was to take a single cloth and a head tie, and leave the town immediately. She was obhged to accept the title. We may mention in passing that Ef usetan herself took the title from her chief a former lyalode,

who, from adverse circumstances lost her wealth, whilst fortane smiled on Efusetan. She lived to see Efusetan deprived both of the title and of her life.

When men or women of high rank and great social position are deposed, it means that their death is determined upon ; but if they have fallen into poverty and insignificance and so have lost influence before deposition, their death is not insisted upon.

In order to save her life, Efusetan with lavish gifts sought the aid and interposition of all the influential chiefs, paid the fines imposed upon her, but all to no purpose.

It must be remarked that many of the chiefs were against this treatment of the lyalode, but the Are at this time was haughty and unapproachable. She was summoned to the meeting of the Town Council on the 22nd of June and was pubHcly disgraced, after which she was told that she was pardoned ; but when a few days after the voice of the Agan was heard in the night (i.e. the Egugun that executes women) it was known that her death was resolved upon.

But the lyalode could not be openly attacked. It has been made one of the constitutional laws of the town that there was to be no civil war, that if any chief ventured on one, whether his case be right or wrong the whole town was to rise against him and crush him. All that could now be done was to effect her death by some means or other, either by poison, or by direct violence when unguarded.

Kumuyilo the lyalode's adopted son and her relatives were heavily bribed by the Are and his abettors, to murder her in cold blood ! The lyalode spent miserable days and nights suspicious of every sound and movement. She changed her sleeping place from night to night as she could not trust any of her domestics. She prepared her food herself, could not go out of doors, received no visitors, as she did not know from what quarter the fatal blow would fall. At length on the night of June 30th, 1874 knowing where she slept, two slaves instructed by Kumuyilo entered the room from the ceiUng and dashed out her brains. The next morning, when her death was reported, she was accorded a public funeral befitting her rank and having no son of her own the Are installed Kumuyilo her adopted son as head of the house.

The late Madam Efusetan was an Egba by birth but made Ibadan her home, where she grew to be very rich. The Egbas hearing of her death sent to ask the cause of it. This made the Ibadan chiefs, who were against the cruel deed, declare their innocence leaving the onus of it upon the Are. To show their displeasure in the matter they demanded of the Are at the public

meeting to prove his innocence by producing the murderers. He tried by one way or another to evade the question : they rejected his excuses, the meeting became stormy and they adjourned in a rage. The Are was ill at ease, fearing a general sedition against himself; hence he summoned a meeting daily to settle this matter, and to have a reply for the Egba messengers.

On the 8th of July the town was in a feverish excitement, for the chiefs demanded that Kumuyilo be summoned to the meeting. Kumuyilo although the son of a notable citizen was brought to the meeting bound with cords, and compelled to name his accomplices. He named the Oluwo, theBalogun, andtheSebaloju. This last was the Are's spokesman at public meetings. Of course, all present knew that he meant this for the Are himself whom he was afraid to name. Consequentlyitbecamecleartha the first two chiefs of the town, the Are and the Balogun, were the doers of the deed, and if due justice were to be done, it was they who should atone for the crime with their lives ; but such a course would mean the destruction of the town. The rest of the chiefs, finding that Kumuyilo only carried out the orders of the rulers had not the conscience to

order him to execution or rather to clamour for his life, they were content therefore to have him publicly disgraced, ordered out of the great lady's house to his own humble dwelling, and appointed a distant relative as head of the house. In this way the chiefs signified their displeasure at the action of their leaders, and these, conscious of guilt, could not oppose the verdict.

But as life must go for Ufe, they further demanded the actual perpetrators of the deed to be produced. On the loth of July, 1874 these two slaves were brought to the public meeting and the writer who saw them prostrating there before the chiefs saw them a few minutes later impaled at the Basgrun market. Thus ended the matter.

The Late Madam Efusetan as we have said was an Egba by birth but made her home at Ibadan. [There were several Egbas of note residing at Ibadan at this time. Chief Lisibade being the head of them and Lanisa an Egba was theBalogun of Lawgyin the Seriki]. She was very rich owning some 2,000 slaves in her farms alone exclusive of those at home. She had also her own captains of war and warboys. She had an only daughter who died in childbirth in i860 and since that sad event took place she became strangely cruel to all her female slaves found in an interesting condition, using all cruel means to cause forcible abortion, most of which ended in death. And these things were known to the chiefs. Her property at her death was regarded as belonging to the state.

Omoko a distant relative was placed over the estate as the responsible man but her sister was the chief manager.

§ 5. The EMURg War.

Chief Ogedemgbe being driven out of Ilesa gathered around himself a band of marauders infesting the Efon district. He also made himself obnoxious to the Ibadans by attacking their tributary towns being bent upon harassing them in every way possible. For that 'purpose he encamped against Ise an Ibadan tributary town, and it had to apply to Ibadan for help. On the 7th of December, 1874, the Are sent two of his powerful generals lyapo the Seriki and Ilgri the Osi to reUeve Ise.

The Are himself knowing the imprudence of such an appointment sent an elderly chief called 01up6yi to go with them as Baba Isale (chief adviser). The council of war was to be held in his tent, and he had to order the battle. He was their senior in age, but far inferior to the least of lyapo's or Ilori's captains.

A wise policy this as these young men refused to submit to each other, although they agreed to submit to this old chief. lyapo was the heir of the late Balogun Ibikunle, and was possessed of all his father's men and his means. Moreover a brave Seriki considers himself second to the Balogun alone as he could leap from the one title to the other as his late father did," occupying as he did the same relative position to the young warriors, as the Balogun to the veterans.

Ilori was the heir of the late Basorun Ogunmola, he also was possessed of his father's men and his prestige, and considered himself the senior in rank being the general commanding the commander-in-chief's left, and generally taken as senior in rank. What they would not yield to each other they agreed to concede to this old chief out of deference to his age. The wisdom of the advice of Bale Orowiisi may be indirectly noticed here also.

But the fame and prestige of lyapg far eclipsed that of Ilori, and he was virtually the leader of the expedition ; where he encamped there all encamped, and when he struck his tent all were bound to be on the move.

Ogedemgbe hearing of their approach < raised the siege of Ise and escaped again to his stronghold at Ita Ogbola. The Ibadan army not willing to return home empty-handed went against Emure which was giving supplies to Ogedemgbe at Is§. The town was taken the next day but all the fighting men escaped in a body.

The Seriki became ill after this, and it was with difficulty he could reach Ha the sanatorium of the Ibadans in all their

Ekiti and other wars in those parts : there he remained until he was well enough to come home.

As it would not be wise for all the army to remain at Ila until his recovery, they returned home on the 15th of February, 1875.

The Seriki was well enough to leave Ila about six weeks later ; he arrived outside the town wall of Ibadan on the 28th of March, and there most of the members of the expedition who had returned home joined him to grace his triumphal entry the next day. The joy, the excitement, and the enthusiasm attending the pageantry of this young man so moved the whole town that the like of it had scarcely ever been seen. Whilst it stirred the envy of some to its very depth, it excited the admiration of others. Thus a young man was heard to say " If I enjoy such a glory for only one day and I die the next, I shall be content."

On the 7th of April following died that distinguished veteran and commander-in-chief AH a former Balogun of Iwo who was expelled by a civil fight from Iwo to Ibadan.

Chapter XXII

A NEW REIGN AND EVIL PROGNOSTICATIONS

§ I. The End of Adelu the AlAfin of Oyo and Accession of Adeyemi

King Adelu did not attain to the age of his father. His accession was marked by confusion, wars, and rumours of war all over the country for about four years, due chiefly to the Ijaye war and its sequels; but after this peace and tranquility prevailed, except for the Ibadan raids and the subjugation of the Ijesa and Ekiti provinces.

Towards the end of his reign he met with an accident by being thrown off his horse, and as a consequence a prolonged illness ensued. After his convalescence he had an attack of paralysis which was probably due to internal injury sustained by the fall, but it was generally attributed to poison administered by the Crown Prince, who was impatient to come to the throne ; it was also said that his accomplice and agent was the King's favourite wife Alayoayo. Among all the denizens of the ro5'al harem she was the only one who could be termed Queen, for she had the whole village of Awe and half the city of Oyo serving her, and the whole of the King's treasures were at her disposal, so that one could scarcely imagine what could have so alienated her affections as to make her an accessory to such a crime. It was subsequently discovered, however, that the Crown Prince had an illicit intercourse with her. and that she was enceinte by him ! It was in order to cover her shame and disgrace, therefore, that she lent herself to the accompUshment of this double crime, and the more readily as the Crown Prince promised her the same position and influence when he came to the throne, as he fully expected he would.

As the King grew worse day bj' day ^nd had to keep his bed for about a month, the rumour of his death began to gain ground. Thereupon the Oyo Mesi repaired to the palace and requested to see his majesty even in his sick bed, in order to be assured of his condition. Accordingly, he was bolstered up in one of his apartments, and the curtain was drawn in order that the noblemen might see him and thus he held his reception for the last time. A few days after, the beating of the Koso drum and the blowing

of the ivory trumpet at midnight announced to the pubhc the death of their King.

Such an occasion was a time of dire distress in the palace, for apart from those who were bound by their special office to die with the King immolation was more or less indiscriminate in order to furnish the monarch with a large retinue in the other world. Hence every one tried to hide himself or herself in every nook and corner imaginable and in the ceilings of their apartments.

As an instance of the indiscriminate slaughter which occurred on this occasion we may mention the following : —

Kudefu the King's favourite Ilari and head of all his slaves on the morning of the death before it was officially announced went to know of his master's condition, and learning he was dead he was going home sad at heart to die of his own accord.

Alega the keeper of the gate seeing him coming from the inner apartments, being inquisitive, approached him to learn of their august master's condition. Kudefu at once unsheathed his sword saying " You go before,

I ani coming at your heels to be attendants on our master in the other world " and in one stroke he cut off his head and then coolly went home to die. Several who were too inquisitive lost their Lives in this way. In that vast compound those in one corner of it may not know what was taking place in another.

It was also a time of mourning for the relatives of those who have received the " death cloth " knowing that they must have to bury in the evening a relative strong and healthy in the morning and up to the time the fatal cup is taken.

Alayoayo was very reluctant to die, and begged hard that her life should be spared, relying probably on the Crown Prince's promise to her. But in this she was sadly disappointed ; for this reason she stayed much longer in the palace than she was expected to do, for according to custom she must die at home among her own people. When at last she knew that death was inevitable, she issued from the palace well-dressed in her " death cloth " with her drummer before and her maidens carrying large calabashes full of kola nuts, she trod her way homewards to the measures of the drum scattering kola nuts with a lavish hand right and left to the crowd of spectators thronging her way from the palace gates to hei home, to have a last glance at her.

In the meantime a great feast had been made at her home for all friends and relatives to partake with her for the last, during which time the grave was in digging and the coffin made. She distributed her property among her relatives and her only son. When the hour was come she bade all farewell and repaired to her P

chamber and the fatal cup was placed in her hands. But owing to the preventives she had fortified her system with, the effects were neutraUzed ; this was repeated again and again, with the same result. So towards sunset the disappointed relatives in order to prevent an indelible disgrace to the family had to strangle her, and then gave her a decent funeral. The same may be said more or less of all those who had received the '* death cloth."

The Aremo (Crown Prince) also was told to die, but not only did he refuse point blank to do so but was also determined to ascend the throne. His grandfather had abolished the custom of the Aremo dying with the father, his own father the monarch now deceased was his father's Aremo and he succeeded him on the throne, and why then should he die ? But the Oyg Mesi were not in favour of his ascending the throne because of his surpassing cruelties. One instance among many to illustrate this : —

A young man Folarin by name had a mistress of whom he was deprived by the Aremo. One day, seeing Folarin pass along the street he sent for him and with a heavy blacksmith's hammer smashed his knees and ankles rendering him a cripple for life, and then nicknamed himself " Alagbede Akesan ti itun Folarin I'ese ro " (the Akesan blacksmith who can recast Folarin 's limbs). By such deeds he forfeited his rights to the throne, which would have been indisputably his had he been as kind and humble as his father.

In the meantime he was bidding high for it, he secured the support of the King's slaves by feasting them" on a bullock and a donkey slaughtered every day. But the Oyo Mesi who rejected him put forward the Asipa (son of the founder of the town) to oppose him, and both parties were in arms. Not aware of the actual facts of the situation he distributed arms and ammunition to all the men of the Apara, Ajagba, and Sek§ wards and was determined to expel the Asipa from the city that day and demolish his house. The war drum was beating, and the Famif ami trumpet calling to arms and he was just ready to mount his horse when the Basgrun appeared on the scene with about 400 men behind him all unarmed like himself. Said he to him " Your royal highness, will you pull down the fabric your fathers have set up ? Will you destroy the city your father and grandfather helped to raise ? Be quiet, all will be right."

With such soothing words he dissuaded him from going forward. By this time the King's slaves had been won over. The Basorun had scarcely finished when the Apeka (the head slave) came on horseback with his men all unarmed. He began with " My lord, what is it ? Why is this ?' The Aremo in a rage retorted with

" Away with you. Are you not my club who ought to have been striking hard for me by this time ? Is it now to ask such a question when you ought to be acting ? "

The slaves took exception to this language of their master to their chief. We have noticed in Part I what influence these so-called " slaves," especially the titled ones, wield, as their goodwill and assent with those of the members of the harem must be obtained before any election can be considered valid. They now professed to be offended because their chief was metaphorically styled "kumo" i.e. a club, and they declared openly that they would have nothing more to do with the Aremo. They refused to enter his house from that day ; the cow and the ass were slaughtered as usual and the feast prepared but no one came to partake of it.

The Prince again sent for the men in the Apara, Ajagba, Sek§ and Akeitan wards, who were loyal to him ; their chiefs came as in duty bound but their men had been disbanded, and not a single armed man came with them !

The Prince was now at his wits' end, and greatly mortified by seeing himself deserted by all those who had promised him their support. At last Prince lyajin his father's uncle sent for him, and undeceived him of his hopes. " The Oyo Mesi have not elected you and there is the end of it. I would advise you to leave the city quietly or build a house at the outskirts, and live there in dignified retirement."

The Prince returned home much depressed and made preparation to leave the city. He entered the palace and denuded it of all its treasures. He sent several loads to the Bara to be kept there until sent for ; and whatsoever he did not or could not take away he smashed and made a bonfire of them in the palace courtyard, and the wells he filled with kegs of gunpowder and broken pieces of crockery. Some wives of his who had offended him he confined in a closed room with ceihngs, and had the entrance walled up. He then proceeded to his farm at Agodomgbo and unfettered a few hundreds of the slaves put in stocks there, and ordered them to carry all those loads with him to Ibadan. The Are of Ibadan received him with open arms and assigned him a portion of land to build on in the Yem§tu quarter.

The late King Adelu was the first born son of his father Atiba. He was born when his father was but a youth. He became a companion to his father in all his turmoils, especially when as a private man Atiba chose the career of a soldier of fortune.

Adelu was much older than his brothers, as they were born a very long time afterwards when their father was in better circumstances. As a son, he was very obedient and dutiful, always ready

to answei his father's calls whatever he may be doing, and many a time whilst at his meals. He was an absolutely just man, strict to a fault. He so abhorred stealing that with him robbers had no alternative but instantaneous execution. The following stories told of him will illustrate his strictness.

1. A certain young woman sold beads on credit to a buyer, but when the money was not forthcoming in time the creditor went to demand it. Not finding the debtor at home but seeing her beads hanging on a peg in her apartment being determined to have either the money or the beads, she went in and took her beads away until they should be paid for.

An imperfect report of this came to the hearing of the King representing her as having entered the rooms of another woman when she was out, and taken her beads away ! The King without further enquiries and proper investigation of the case ordered her execution at once ! He keenly regretted this afterwards, when the whole facts were brought to his knowledge.

2. He sent a few of his slaves for tall poles to build his K6bi. On their return he saw a yam tied to the load of one of them. He questioned the headman how he came by it, but not being satisfied with the plea that it was a gift of a farmer, and surmising that they had been taking undue advantage of poor farmers out of privilege , he was determined to put a stop to that custom.

The executioner was immediately at his service and he was instantly decapitated. This incident had the desired effect. All through his reign stealing or taking by violence out of sheer privilege, so common with the King's slaves, was utterly unknown, everybody's property was safe.

His public executioner was called K61oh6. A call at his name K61oh6 was usually sufficient. He was at his duty at a moment's notice.

He loved his people and would never allow any of the princes to distress the poor with impunity. An instance was given of a prince who fought with a commoner and cut off one of his fingers. This being reported to his father he severely reprimanded the prince, and was determined to exact a full retaliation of the deed. But the constitution of the country forbade him to disfigure a prince so he ordered someone to be brought from the family of his mother as a substitute. A young virgin was met in the house beating corn and she was summoned to the palace. The King ordered K61oh6 to lop off the same finger of the young woman as that which the prince cut off from the man's hand. This was done instantly. Then said the King to her "It is not my fault it is your cousin who deprived you of your finger."

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That was his rude idea of justice. As that young woman and all the relations of the prince's mother enjoy great advantages under his auspices, so they should be ready to suffer for his crimes. And again, the training of children devolves greatly on the mothers, therefore both herself and her relatives would learn to train their children to good behaviour. A misguided notion of doing what was right.

With his cliildren he was very strict and scarcely any one of them escaped punishment from him, and whoever among them he had occasion to lay his hands on, carried sore sides for weeks or months and would have to lie on cotton wool or banana leaves.

He was particular to see them all engaged in some industry, either weaving or farming. Even the Crown Prince, who has official duties to perform, must employ his spare moments in weaving or tailoring. The King was particularly strict with him for his many cruel acts ; and although above law many a time would the father surprise him in his house, and ere he could escape would lay heavily on him with a stick or the fiat of a cutlass.

His Majesty encouraged agriculture in every possible way. As he could not visit his farm by daylight he often did so on moonlight nights to examine the crops and advise the head farmer, who was often taken by surprise at his visits. His crops were usually stocked in huge barns until food was becoming dear, which was usually just before the next harvest ; then he would open his barns and flood the markets with food at a little below the market price, " My children must not starve," he used to say. Notice Wcis usually given and farmers warned before the King's stores came into the market, so that they might not run the risk of a loss by being undersold.

He was exceptionally kind to the thrifty and to those farmers and their wives who showed themselves industrious.

It is customary in this country to give goats to the womenfolk to rear for their own keep, the kids being shared with the owner. .But in his case, he would demand none from those who kept theirs well except a young billy occasionally. He would rather add to their store. But careless owners would get no encouragement from him.

He was a perfect organizer, a man of taste, he appreciated and rewarded excellencies wherever found.

If any man was accused before him and he understood the individual was then in his farm, he would never allow him to be sent for, and whenever the case was heard the defendant would have every consideration from the King : but if actually guilty he was let off with a light fine. " If a man is not idle " he used to say.

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" he must be a good man." He loved and respected the C.M.S. and American Baptist Missionaries at Oyo in his days. He was kind and Uberal to them during the Ijaye war when they were in straitened circumstances. He was universally mourned by his people.

The Accession of Adeyemi,

Prince Adeyemi the fourth son of Atiba was elected to the throne in succession to his eldest brother the late King Adelu. He at first declined it in favour of an elder brother Adesiyen who had a prior right, the eldest surviving Adelabu being at that time an exile at Ibadan, and from his character was on no account eligible. Adesiyen, however, urged his younger brother to accept it as he was in bad health, and for him to have to

go through all the ceremonies and wear the crown perhaps for only a few days would be inconvenient for all concerned, and for himself also. He was on a decUne from phthisis. He promised however to aid Adeyemi as much as he could with his advice and counsel, wishing him a long and prosperous reign. Then Adeyemi accepted the offer.

Adeyemi' s accession was acclaimed by the populace without a dissentient voice, he being very popular with all the people especially with foreigners and provincials. All the traders from Ibadan, Abeokuta, Ijebu and elsewhere used to lodge in his house, and all used to partake of his hospitality. As a prince, his weakness was drink ; not that he did it to excess, but he was in the habit of visiting the brewers of native malt liquor every day with numerous followers and would satisfy them all at his own expense. Hence his popularity and universal acceptance. High hopes were, therefore, entertained of a happy and prosperous reign for one who was a friend to all.

But no sooner had he ascended the throne than an evil reign was prognosticated for him. As usual the divination was sent from the sacred city He Ife. The " Igba Iwa " consisting of two covered calabashes identical in shape and size, similarly draped but the contents of which were different were brought before him. The one contained money (cowries), cloth, beads, etc., indicating a happy and prosperous reign, the other gunpowder, bullets, razor, knife, miniature spears and arrows, indicating wars and turmoils. He was to choose one and by his choice determine the fate of the Yoruba kingdom. Unfortunately he chose the latter and from that time evil days were held to be in store for the country. This was fulfilled by the troubles initiated by the Are of Ibadan, which culminated in the protracted i6 years' war which involved the whole of the

Yoruba country and ended by the British protectorate and the loss of the Yoruba People of their absolute independence.

The " sword of state " or rather of justice was also sent from He Ife which every sovereign must have before he can order an execution.

The following were the sons born to Adeyemi before he ascended the throne : — Adelakun (the Aremo) Ajuan, Akere I, Ak^re II, Tela Kunduke, Tela Kankansi, and Origade. Adelakun, however, was his natural son and consequently it was Ajuan's mother that was created an Ilari and raised to the title of lyalagbon.

§ 2. Ibadan Raids on the Confines of the Kingdom The Wokuti Expedition

At this time there was peace all over the Yoruba country, trade between the coast and interior was brisk, caravans went to Abeokuta from the interior every day, and to Ijebu via Ibadan once a month. These littoral tribes however, would not allow those from the interior to pass on to the coast, but traders from the coast can travel in safety right on to the Niger and Bida. The Ibadans were now at the zenith of their glory. All the Ijesa and Ekiti tribes and some Oke Ogun towns paid their tributes regularly, and from the easy victory of the Are's first expedition all the tribes dreaded the power of the Ibadans, and gave no cause of offence, and the Are himself was very much elated, being almost idolized by the war boys.

In the midst of this profound peace the Are and his chiefs on the 26th of November, 1875, started on his second expedition for slave-hunting. They proceeded to the Ekiti country direct via Ila and encamped at Yahapa. Seeing such a large hostile force menacing, a large number of the Ekitis concentrated their forces at Ijesa Ahaye for self protection. The place was taken without much opposition. But the expedition was intended against Aiyede the capital city of Esu the Ata, lord of the Yagba and Akoko tribes in the confines of the Yoruba country North-eastwards. But ere this large army reached Aiyede that city and its environs had been deserted. It is said that the Ata was rather their friend and not a foe, and nothing but plunder hunger took them there. Some of the Ibadan chiefs, therefore, had privately sent and apprized the Ata of the coming danger which he would never be able to oppose, and therefore he should at once seek safety in fhght. Some escaped to a distance of five days' journey knowing the ferocious way the Ibadans have of pursuing their prey. The Ata himself escaped to Omu IjMu, a town supposed then to be impregnable. Built on a high hill, strongly walled, and surrounded

by a thorny thicket, the pathway for entering the town being narrow and well guarded. It had successfully repulsed three attacks before and therefore was considered safe. Finding Aiyede deserted, the Ibadan Seriki who led the way tracked the fugitives to this place. He had a preliminary skirmish that evening and he encamped at the foot of the hill awaiting his chiefs. In course of the night, the Balogun, and afterwards the Are arrived, and next morning the Seriki went to pay his respects to them awaiting orders. But as he was returning to his tent and his drum was rolling " Kiriniun Onibudo " before him, the warboys thought he was going to the battlefield. "The Seriki is going, the Seriki is going" flew from mouth to mouth and immediately the great host not waiting any longer for orders from the leaders rushed after this young and intrepid general, himself being borne along with them, unable to reach his tent to put on his war-dress; these were brought to him in the field. In one assault the thorny thickets were crumbled like matchwood under the feet of myriads, ^nxHi was taken and Esu the Ata brought a prisoner before the Are.

The illustrious captive was kindly treated by the Ibadan chiefs, but the Ilorin arm}/ (which accompanied them) requested the Arg to hand him over to them as their mortal foe. This the Ibadans positively refused to do. " It is not our custom," said they " to put to death a fallen leader or hero." This refusal created a disaffection between the Ibadans and Ilorins which the latter were determined to avenge whenever an opportunity offered.

Omu was after all a very small town and the Ibadan host a large and insatiable one, the Are and the Balogun therefore returned to their base at Yahapa and allowed the Seriki to lead the young men further on in search of prey.

The next place attacked was Ikole. They had a preliminarj' skirmish in the evening of their arrival before retiring to prepare for a regular pitched battle the next day ; but at moonUght the Ikole people deserted the town and sought refuge by flight to various places. The Ilorins who were well acquainted with their haunts did very well for themselves in the pursuit, but the others who did not fare so well scattered themselves throughout the length and breadth of the Akoko country like hungry wolves seeking for prey. The people hid themselves in caves, ravines, and in dens, some escaped as far as to Egbe. The Ibadans pursued on and on until they reached the border of the Emir of Bida's territory. There they came up with some of the Bida cavalry who questioned the leading chiefs as to their authority for trespassing in King Imoru's territory. They apologized, and after an exchange

of presents and kola nuts, they parted as friends. These cavaliers were described as seated erect on powerful horses, their spears were of burnished brass which glittered in the noon-day sun.

Having reached the utmost hmits possible theSeriki nowretraced his steps to meet the Are at their base. But a great disaster befel a part of the Ibadan host on their way back. Some who lingered behind were hastening on to join the Seriki and took a shorter route to the left with a steep descent. The mass behind pressing on those before, hundreds were hurled down and trampled underfoot ; the clouds of dust raised by myriads suffocated many and left them no power of resistance, and so within the space of ,half-an-hour hundreds had lost their lives !

There the survivors, in order to find the bodies of relatives and friends to perform the last offices for them, piled corpses in heaps, presenting a gruesome sight ! A man on horseback rode up, and seeing he had lost there all his brothers and friends who came with him to the expedition groaned out " and what shall I say at home?" He drew out his pistol and discharged it in the ear of his horse. Reloading, he blew out his own brains ! So that not one out of that family returned home to tell the tale. This tragedy gave the name to that expedition, " Wgkuti," piling of corpses.

At Yahapa before the camp was broken up for the homeward march, the florins once more made a strenuous effort to get the Ata, but Chiefs Aijenku and lyapg the Seriki confronted them saying " If you were the leaders of this expedition and we followed you, you would have had a claim ; but as we are the leaders and you follow us, we have told you it is not our custom to kill a fallen king or general and that is the end of the matter." The Ilorin troops parted here in no pleasant mood.

The Ibadans returned home on the 19th of February, 1876. This was the last of the Ibadan raiding expeditions

in the Ekiti, and was, perhaps, the most powerful force that ever marched out of their gates. They were now confronted with the task of statesmanship, of consolidation and organization which turned out to be a more difficult affair.

§ 3. The New Policy

The power of the Ibadans being dreaded by all the interior tribes, their messengers to the provinces under them took undue advantage of the subject states and that to such an extent as to drive them to rebellion. The very name Ibadan stank in the nostrils of all the Ijesa and Ekiti tribes, so that they were only seeking for an opportunity for throwing off their yoke. And strange to say these messengers who were doing all the mischief were

not the Ibadan born, but the Ijesa and Ekiti slaves who were sent with messages to their own native towns !

As soon as each one gets outside the Ibadan town walls he secures to himself the services of a drummer and fifer and a bard to sing the praises of his master as if the latter were coming : he collects behind him idle fellows who follow no regular employment and he moves as a little chief aping the master who sent him. When he enters a town he asks for the Ibadan Ajele there and introduces himself as the messenger of such and such a chief, the Ajele is to introduce him to the authorities of the town who will assign him quarters for lodging. The landlord has to defray all expenses of the keep of this messenger and his followers who will remain there as long as they Hke, time being no object to them. The best local dishes with chicken or mutton must be provided every day with pots of local beer or palm wine. The master of the house has to levy on all the inmates for the contribution of their share, even to the old women who lived on spinning cotton for their keep, none is exempted, all are to contribute their quota. Nor is this all : cruelty, vanity, debauchery were more common with them than otherwise. A landlord would be compelled to wait on them at meals, at times holding the lamp in his hand for them and sometimes the lamp is placed on his head making him as it were a lamp post whilst they are partaking of his hospitality ! Forcing their women, raping their girls, rifling their valuables, are common causes of complaints, and they generally return to Ibadan with booty as from a raid. Who dares touch the messenger of a great Ibadan chief ? Thus all the Ibglos under their protection, the Ijesas, Ekitis, Yagbas, and Akokos were groaning under the yoke of Ibadan, not from paying tribute which was only nominal, but from the excesses of these messengers who wei e their own sons.

Thoughtful men at Ibadan hearing this, recalled the advice of the late Bale Orowusi and his policy now reversed by the Are.

It was found that the messengers of the Are and of the Balogun were the greatest offenders in this business leading the country into the vortex of a revolution. The other chiefs foreseeing the evil, remonstrated with their leading chiefs, but these, from what they profited by these messengers would not check them. Matters can>e to a crisis in October and November 1876 when the minor chiefs made matters too hot for the leading chiefs and compelled them to put a stop to these enormities. Three of these messengers were caught decoying people from the provinces to Ibadan to be sold. Being brought before the council and convicted, two were executed at the Basorun market (the usual place of

execution) and the third outside the north eastern (or Iwo) gate, the highway to their hunting grounds as a warning to other messengers. The effect however was only shght and transient, the feeUngs in the provinces were by no means allayed.

§ 4. The Civil Murder of Chief Aijenku the F6h6k6.

The Are now began to evince more and more the characteristics of a Kakanfo. Experience has shown us that a Kakanfo always caused trouble at home and abroad. Their paths were always marked with blood. We have only to recall the history of Afonja of Ilorin, Edun of Gbogun and Ojo Amepo who were rivals, of Kurumi of Ijaye among others ; and now Latosisa of Ibadan was on the same track. His primary object was to suppress all the leading chiefs who were his equals or superiors, and the first man to feel his power was Chief Aijenku that old and experienced war-chief, who had made a name in the field when the Are was

nowhere. He was the only check on him at the commencement of his administration. Aijenku was amongst the first settlers of Ibadan. He entered the town on horseback being then a httle chief. He was a powerful man as we saw that he alone opposed the whole forces of the Egbas before Ijaye, when Ogunmola and the other chiefs were absent at Iwawun (vide Chap, xviii) and, although fortune did not set him at the head of affairs yet he was, as he had always been, one who could not be overlooked. He was never a private man at Ibadan. He was the Asaju for Oluyole the first Basorun when the Are was only a palm tree dresser ! And, although fortune had now raised Latosisa the Are above him, yet Aijenku was like a king in his own quarter of the town, where he was acknowledged, loved, and venerated by all the Oke Asa people, a tribe in the Ekun Osi province now resident at Ibadan. Aijenku at the public meetings in course of debate often told the chiefs of the administrations of former distinguished rulers that made Ibadan what it was to-day. This the Are and others of grasping propensities like him never liked to hear, and the Are in particular was ever on the look out for an opportunity of putting an end to this " historian."

Aijenku on the other hand whenever he spoke did so boldly as one who by age, experience, and past services in many a bloody field was competent to give them advice. He had little sympathy even amongst the junior chiefs, who were all affected with the prevailing avarice ; for he was said to be of an irritable temper, too bold and pointed in his remarks, and when he reproved, did so without respect of person or rank ; and being so capable a warrior there was a latent fear that if this man was backed up and

eventually placed at the head of the government he woixld rule with rigour and become oppressive.

At length an opportunity afforded itself for taking revenge on this chief, and the Are and the other chiefs were not slow to make use of it. Igbajo was one of the tributary towns under him. The people of that town being dissatisfied with their ruling chief deposed him and appointed another Aregbajo. The deposed came to Ibadan to ask the aid of the Ibadan government to reinstate him. The Are and the other chiefs were for reinstating him, but Aijenku was opposed to that measure and gave his reasons. He spoke in his usual authoritative way which offended his brother chiefs and hence on the 13th of January, 1877, he was rejected by all the chiefs in the public meeting, and that declaration was confirmed by his being deprived of all the towns hitherto tributary to him, including this very Igbajo. He bore his humiliation patiently and the next day (14th) went to the adjourned meeting with a few slaves to offer to the assembly in payment of fines, and to ask to be pardoned. The chiefs refused to pardon him, they further disgraced him ; he had to return home disappointed and with a heavy heart. But what roused the old Lion to desperation was the attempt to deprive him of the tolls of the Abeokuta gate. This was on the 20th of January, when the chiefs sent other gatemen there, and drove his men away. He was exasperated beyond measure, and was resolved upon civil war, come what may. Said he : — " The Abeokuta road was opened at the peril of my life. The scars in my body and my disfigured hands were the result of that special conflict when none of the present chiefs was in existence, and while I am living no one will deprive me of this." He drove away those who had displaced his men and resorted to arms, defying anyone who would oppose him. He roused the town to action by permitting the women in his district to sing : — " O di ori odi, asa ko le wole ko gbe eiyele " (next to an impossibility, the hawk cannot enter into the house to take away a pigeon). Meaning that no one would dare face their chief in his own house.

The town was in commotion, the excitement in that part of the town was very great, but no one came forward to oppose him. The C.M.S. agents waited on the Are to express their regrets for the events of the day. The Are made only a cursory remark on the subject. He said "It is the public that is against him, not I, and we were surprised to hear that he was in arms, against whom, we know not."

Knowing his might, the chiefs moved cautiously to undermine his great power. Nothing was done till the following Monday the

22nd at the general meeting of the town council. There they won over all the chiefs who were his personal friends, and to his subordinate chiefs they offered titles and ranks and tributary towns, and then decided to attack him in a body.

Having thus deprived him of all his mainstays, word was sent to him to quit the town, or die, or to prepare for the worst. His slaves seeing their master in such a plight, and the impossibility of their being able to resist the whole town opposed to him sought each one his own safety by flight, some to one chief, some to another,

A private message was sent to him to seek refuge in old Tajo's house, who had received permission to shelter him, for if he resisted it would mean not only his own life, but also the lives of his wives and children.

As soon as it was known that he had left his house, the whole town in arms swooped down upon his quarter of the town, and sacked every house, removing everything, even to grinding stones, earthenware pots and dishes, doors, firewood, etc., leaving the whole place in desolation and ruin as a conquered town. The writer could not suppress his emotion when he saw the sight the next morning. It was heartrending, especially when on reaching Chief Tajo's house he met the chief quite besieged by scores of mothers wailing the loss of their children. Several interested friends called on him in Chief Tajo's house and even the Are himself called in the evening, disclaiming all responsibiUty. It was the doing of the town, said he, and not the work of an individual. He was said to have offered him the following cold comfort : " Take comfort and be thankful your hfe is spared you. Remember how many towns subverted by your arms have been made desolate, and how many kings have suffered as you now do. Be of good courage, be not cast down, all will be right."

At the pubUc meeting of the town council of the 25th January, 1877, at the Are's, it was decided that he should return to his house, and hence, each of the principal chiefs cent his sword bearer to accompany him home from Tajo's. Two days later the chiefs having heard that Tajo's people were taking advantage of the fallen chief s condition to pillage his farm, sent to warn the old chief to check his people ; the main object of the chiefs was to humiliate Aijenku and not to ruin him altogether.

On the 30th of January, 1877, the C.M.S. agents, by the permission of the Are, paid the fallen chief a visit in grateful recognition of his kindness and the protection he extended to the agent and the body of Christians in his quarter. After some expressions of sympathy and a few words of comfort addressed to him, he said

" I did not at first expect that matters would come to this crisis, but having come up to such a pass, I restrained my people from fighting as I was unwilhng to shed a drop of blood in a town of which I was among the foremost of the settlers, and where I built houses, and where I was blessed with wives and children. This is the third compound I have built at Ibadan. If I had chosen to go, I have friends at Abeokuta who might receive me with open arms ; and who will dare pursue me if I leave the town ? But I prefer to die here, and to have an honourable burial."

But alas, the chief's troubles were not over. The matter was revived again by some of the ill-disposed. At one of the public meetings of the council it was insinuated by some that, "if he is not finished up with, such a man like that, a turn of the wheel of fortune may one day place him at the top, and woe betide any one of us or our offspring then living."

His slaves who had sought the protection of other masters, seeing their master now at home, began to return one by one to him. So it was resolved by the chiefs in council that he should not receive them again but that each should return permanently to their temporary masters. The fallen chief submitted to this also. Yet still at a meeting of the 12th February, 1877, word was sent to him that it was resolved that he should die ! " WTiat else have I done ? " asked he of the messengers. They repUed, " We do not know, we are only sent to tell you to die." Aijenku went again to Tajo's house where he had taken refuge before, to ask for his interference again ; but this chief had been forewarned not to meddle in this matter again, and therefore he did not show his face to his doomed friend. " The Master is not at home " is a well understood phrase, and the veteran soldier, overpowered with grief went home, gave his last orders to his children and retired finally to rest, by blowing out his own brains. This was the second cold-blooded murder perpetrated by the Are.

§ 5, Plot Against the Seriki Iyapo

Strange as it may seem, yet so it was that the young and intrepid Seriki Iyapo was one of the principal agents in hounding the late chief to death. One would have supposed that the chief being the Areagoro or Alter Ego of his own father in his days, he would have looked up to him as a second father. But it seems Iyapo

felt that his own glory would not be complete while this old chief was alive, and that the house of Aijenku should look up to him as supreme in that quarter of the town as it did in the days of his father which could hardly be the case while the old chief was alive. But retributive justice soon overtook him also. The

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main object of the Are being to suppress all who could successfully oppose his designs, the Seriki lyapo was not exempt from his ban and he readily raked up charges and accusations against him.

lyapo was one of those engaged in the plunder of the house of the late Aijenku. He was now accused of having in his possession a basket of beads which had belonged to the late chief ; and, although it was given up on demand, yet the chiefs were resolved upon his overthrow, for his independent and defiant attitude.

It would seem as if the virtue of gratitude was at a discount at Ibadan in those days, for the Are himself was much beholden to this young and valorous chief, when there was an insurrection against him for his overthrow, on account of his atrocities ; but for lyapg he certainly would have put an end to his own life. Instead of succouring him now, he joined the others and turned against him.

Just a fortnight after the death of Aijenku, lyapo was impeached at the meeting of the chiefs, and was told either to quit the town or die. The young and brave general was determined not to pay any fines, but if needs be to fight it out. Fines only whet their appetites for greater demands, and they are never satisfied until they have seen the last of their victims. He had the cases of Ajobg, the Lady Efusetan, and the late Aijenku before him, he therefore " stood by his guns " and defied them all. Unfortunately for him, his own brothers joined in the plot against him, and on threatening them they fled to the Are for protection !

But the elders of the Are's house waited on him and reminded him of the good and loyal services lyapo had rendered him in the past, and they prevailed upon him to relent, and not to proceed to the extremity with him, for really he had done nothing unpardonable. He listened favourably to them, and the lyapo affair was lulled for a while.

But the intention was not given up, for within two months it was revived again, and again suppressed, each of the chiefs disclaiming any responsibility for the rumour. But still, they were only feeUng their way, for lyapo was too influential a man to be overpowered suddenly. The Are's chief grievance against him was that lyapo had usurped his rights, because he would allow no confiscation of houses in his quarter. Whoever offended he punished himself, for which purpose he always kept a bundle of atori whips in his house. Those great chiefs who enriched themselves by plundering and confiscating people's houses as a punishment for slight offences found they could not do so in lyapo's quarter. " The whole of my quarter consists of but one compound and I

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am the head of it," he used to say. No outside interference was allowed, and any head of a compound convicted of any offence he punished himself. The Are had cause to hate him for this.

The Balogun also eyed him suspiciously as potentially a usurper of his title, for the Are more than once threatened to depose him and transfer the title to lyapo. The Otun was not even taken to account, he was regarded as "white-feathered." The Osi and the Seriki were rivals, both equal in age, each the head of their father's house, and commanded their means and men ; the Osi's title was higher, but lyapo's influence was greater, and so it was that he was positively hated by the principal leading chiefs, but none had the courage to face him.

Chapter XXIII

THE COMMENCEMENT OF THE i6 YEARS' WAR

§ I. The Bokqfi Expedition

Since the Ijaye war (1860-62) the Ijebus and the Egbas had strictly forbidden ammunition to be sold to any of the interior tribes, notably Ibadan. On the restoration of peace in 1865 the trade between them consisted of foreign clothes, salt, rum and gin from the coast in exchange for produce, chiefly palm oil, kernels, cotton,

etc., from the interior. In order to obtain ammunition, the late Basorun Ogunmola opened the Oke Igbo road via Ifg to Benin solely for that purpose.

The late King Adelu, however, had purchased a large quantity of gunpowder at Porto Novo which was sent half way to Bokofi but no further for fear of the Egbas kidnapping the whole. On hearing this, the Are was resolved to send the youngest Mogajis for it, secretly wishing they might encounter the Egbas or the Dahomians who might probably help him to get rid of one or other of them. Ilori the Osi, arid lyapo the Seriki were sent on this expedition under the elderly chief Olupoyi as Baba IsMe.

The name of Ij'apo drew the whole of the young men of Ibadan to this expedition leaving only the Are, the Balogun and the Otun at home. Their simple instructions were : — " Molest no one, steer clear of Egba territory, go straight by Oke'ho, Igana to Meko ; but if any one molest or interfere with you, follow the party home, and we shall come and meet you outside their gates." The Are hurried the Seriki out of home the same day he gave him the order, the less prepared the better the chances of his fall in the Are's opinion.

The expedition left Ibadan on the 26th April, 1877, and returned safely on the 21st June, without encountering either Egbas or Dahomians. They brought with them about 800 kegs of gunpowder, a few Dane guns, and casks of rum, etc. On the next day the whole of the powder was forwarded to the AlAfin who took a few kegs and made a present of the rest to the Ibadan chiefs. During this expedition there was a great stir among the Egbas. They charged the Ibadans with seeking an occasion of quarrel with them by sending an army into their " backyard " as they styled it, but as the Ibadan government had sent formally to

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apprise the Egba chiefs of their movement and object before the expedition left, the responsible chiefs of Abeokuta hke Ogundipe, and others paid no heed to the hue and cry that was being made. But the great majority of them at a meeting at Sodeke street decided to close the roads against Ibadan and forbid especially the exportation of salt and foreign goods.

Ajagunjeun the Balogun of Itoko took the lead and went to the caravan town gate to turn the Ibadan traders back home and to see that those already in the town leave empty handed.

This was really the first hostile act that led up eventually to the 16 years' war, which involved practically the whole Yoruba country, and caused so much loss of lives, and much distress and misery, and destruction of towns, subjugation of the Ijebus by the British Government, reduction of the mihtary power of Ibadan, the placing of a British Resident in that town, and of District Commissioners in the principal towns of the Yoruba

§ 2. The First Act of War

The Are's avarice and ambition at this time were unbounded. His ambition was to eclipse the fame of the two greatest chiefs of undying memory at Ibadan viz Ibikunle and Ogunmola (his late master) who both left a name behind them, and sons who upheld the fame and greatness of their father. To this end he sought occasion first against Ilori Ogunmgla's son, and then against Seriki lyapg, Ibikunle's son. If he could reduce these men who eclipsed himself in all that made for feudal greatness and glory, his own star would then shine undimmed.

Further, he now undertook to organize a mihtary band for his own house, raising some of the principal slaves to power and greatness, some of them commanding from 400 to 1,000 soldiers each, horse and foot ; and accumulated also a vast store of ammunition in his own house. Also he put up his eldest son as a rival to the other Mggajis in the town, and organized a military band for him, and a guard consisting of the sons of the well-to-do men in the town.

These doings of the Are did not escape the observation of the chiefs. It seemed to them that the Are wanted to perpetuate the administration of Ibadan in his own family, and they were determined to resist this with all their might. The Are on the other hand was much elated with his mihtary organization, and he made it clear that he was bent on an enterprise which he was determined to prosecute to a successful issue with or without the help of his chiefs.

On the 25th of June, 1877, the Are declared at the meeting of the Town Council that as the Egbas first shut their gates against Ibadan since the 3rd of June they must now shut theirs against the Egbas, and 17 days hence commence hostilities.

The chiefs one and all remonstrated with him against this enterprise, but he was obdurate. Messengers were despatched to their neighbours the Ijebus, Ilorins, the Ijesas, Ekitis and Ifes telling them of the impending struggle and requesting their cooperation. The casus belli were stated as follows : —

1. That they only performed an act of loyalty towards the King by sending to Porto Novo to bring home ammunition he had bought there, when the Egbas refused to sell to them.
2. They never trespassed on Egba territory, nor gave any cause of offence to any, and yet the Egbas resented their action by closing their roads against Oyos forbidding all trade and intercourse with them.
3. Hundreds of their people who went to Abegkuta for trade had been stolen and sold into slavery which alone gave them the right to demand redress.

But before the return of the messengers the Egba chiefs sent their ambassadors headed by one Leasu to negotiate peace and on the I2th of July, 1877, a full meeting was convened to hear them. But Leasu proved himself most unfit to play the part entrusted to him ; he spoke disrespectfully and in an impertinent manner, addressing the Are by name, but his own head chief by his title Alatise. The chiefs were indignant at this and the Seriki lyapo at once confronted him with " You ought rather be gone as you are most unfit to discharge the duties of a messenger. Why did you not call your own chief Ogudipe by name but by his title Alatise, but our own chief you keep calling by name Latosisa ? That is his name true, but he has a title and he is the ruler of this town. If you cannot do him respect we will show you the gate."

Leasu had to leave the town the next day without a reply to his message.

Whilst the chiefs were for negotiation, the Are was bent on hostiUties. He found in this affair a plausible pretext for a thing he had long premeditated to carry out, viz., the subjugation of Abeokuta as the first step towards bringing the whole country again under one head.

Seeing the storm brewing the native missionaries in a body interviewed him and endeavoured to dissuade him from prosecuting his mad project. They pointed out to him that the thing could not be done, as the Egbas were well supphed with breach-loading guns which are terrible weapons of precision, whilst he had none. He

laughingly replied " And with muzzle-loading ones will I break them." They further remonstrated with him saying " Otg aladugbo ko dara " (warfare between neighbours is a great evil). He received them hitherto with his usual smiles and affabihty, extenuating his actions, etc., but now, all of a sudden (probably thinking they were moved thereto by the chiefs) he grew stern and resolute, not to say fierce (his Kakanfo blood seemingly flying into his head) and he said " I am going to perform a task which God has allotted to me to do, and those who say they shall see that I do not accomplish it will not live to see it done, as done it shall be, and when I have finished there shall be no more wars for ever in the Yoruba country." How truly prophetic his words turned out to be, but how differently from what he intended them to be.

Kidnapping Expedition to the Egba farms. — The Are was as determined to commence hostilities as the chiefs were against it. Hence at the meeting of the Town Council on the 31st July, he said to the chiefs, " There is no subject for discussion to-day but you should all go home and prepare for a kidnapping expedition to the Egba farms to-morrow morning." The Balogun and the other chiefs were against the proposal, they said they were not prepared for such a big undertaking. But the Are coolly returned this ironical answer, " Very well, as you are not prepared you can have as much time at home as you wish, meantime I go, and perhaps by the time I return you may then be ready." This sarcastic reply was felt, and each one went home for a hasty preparation for the morrow.

The Are led out the Ibadan host to the Egba farms on the ist August, and captured Atadi, and Alagbara, and pushed on as far as Arakanga behind the gates of Abeokuta, and captured a young bride there. The Egbas were not prepared for this. At the instance of Chief Ogundipe they were about to send another ambassador to undo the mischief done by Leasu, but this attack on their farms and villages put an end to their pacific intentions.

As it was now evident that war was inevitable, the Ijebus to show on which side their sympathy lay, recalled their Agurin at Ibadan, a sign of declaration of war.

The Are with reference to Abeokuta said " Too large for a close siege but for that reason the more vulnerable to famine." His plan was to swoop down on the farms now and again, cut off supplies, prevent cultivation, and thus reduce the place by famine. Hence in his expeditions, the main object was to destroy foodstuffs, fire the barns, cut down standing corn, chop in pieces yam and other tuberous foodstuffs.

The second expedition was known as " Igbe Igbin " (the Igbin expedition), because some of the Ibadan soldiers encountered Igbin an Egba war chief. But the Ibadan war-chiefs had made a compact among themselves not to fight, but leave the brunt of everything to the Are alone ; therefore when they reached the farms they located themselves at short distances from one another, leaving Aturu the Balogun's head slave to lead the men in search of prey. There was no chief with them when Igbin attacked them vigorously and pursued them a great distance until they reached the vicinity of the Seriki's location when he sent a body of men to drive back the pursuers. Aturu also ralHed those within his reach, and led them back safe.

This second expedition was less beneficial to them than the first.

§ 3. Insurrection Against the Are, and the Death OF Seriki Iyapo

The aversion of the chiefs to this war grew stronger every day, and so also did the obstinacy of the Are.

Being bound by a sense of duty to follow him wherever he went, the plot they had made, viz : to take advantage of whatever chance may bring within their reach, but to leave all the fighting to be done by the Are and his slaves, did not prevent the latter from prosecuting his mad resolve. So then the chiefs in order to put an end to this undesirable war were determined to rise against the Are, and make an end of him and with him of the war. For this purpose they met at a given signal in the dead of night on the ist October, 1877, in the Ogboni house at the Basorun's market. There they took a solemn oath of secrecy and mutual confidence and ratified the same by spUtting of kola nuts and the slaughter of a ram, each of them taking his portion home. But they were not all faithful to one another. Solalu the Osi Seriki a notorious tale-bearer went that very night and divulged the whole secret to the Are. Ilori the Osi also who but lately had incurred the Are's displeasure had not the courage to go the whole length with them, fearing the consequences to himself in case of failure ; he also went secretly and exposed the plot. The majority of the rest of them, knowing this, followed suit, each one to save himself, but the Balogun and the Seriki considered it infra dig., so to betray themselves.

At a general meeting on the 2nd of October, the Are told them what he had heard : they all denied it one after another. But the Are told them that he trusted none of them not even those who professed loyalty to him, he was sure that with a better prospect they would all kick against him.

The matter was suppressed for the time being, but in less than a month it broke out again. The insurrection was fixed for the ist of November but the secret was divulged again by the notorious Solalu.

The Arg was terribly ill at ease. Before the morning of the ist November he had left home for his farm with his slaves armed. Some surmised that it was his intention to escape from Ibadan, but where to go to ? He had offended all their great neighbours. Restless in the farm, he returned to town. He made little account of all the chiefs except theBalogun and the Seriki each of whom was a match for him. In his perplexity he resorted to Chief Mosaderin the brother of the Balogun, with two slaves and valuable presents, begging him to use his influence with the Balogun for good on his behalf. He succeeded. Chief Mosaderin called his brother and remonstrated with him, " What have you as compared with the Are in slaves or wealth to

satisfy the greedy appetite of Ibadan chiefs ? If he is overthrown to-day it will devolve upon you to-morrow to assume the reins of government, and it will not be long before the same measure is meted out to you. And the Seriki with whom you are in league, have you forgotten that he was the one aspiring to your title when the Are threatened lately to depose you ? Will you be able to manage him if you become the Bale and he the Balogun ? Remember that his father was a native of Ogbomgso and descended from an Esq. He will soon aspire to become a Kakanfo as by right, and what is to become of you then ? "

In this way Mosaderin won the Balogun over to the Are and on the latter 's return from his farm the Balogun called on him in the evening.

The Are, almost beside himself with joy, greeted him with " Aye my brother and companion in arms, you have almost done for me ! " Having won over the Balogun he was determined not to spare the Seriki. The latter hearing that the Balogun called on the Ar§ called also himself the next day, but the Are refused to see him. He returned home under a shower of stones from the Are's slaves.

Seeing that evil was determined against the Seriki the' other chiefs tried to interpose on his behalf, 'but the Are was resolute. He was determined to rid himself of one whose power and influence had always made him uneasy.

On the 4th of November the Are declared that he pardoned him, but this was a ruse to get him into his power, for he instructed his slaves to shoot him down, when he least expected danger. The Seriki who had friends amongst the Are's slaves heard of it and never committed himself into his hands. The Are could not

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treat him, however, as he treated the late Aijenku, and all measures adopted to get at him and kill him suddenly, failed. So he had recourse to depriving him of his brave men. He deposed him from his title conferring the same on Ajayi Osungbekun his Otun. The notorious Solalu the Osi Seriki he made the Otun. Amowo one of lyapo's brave men he made the Osi Seriki, lyapo's Bada he made his own, and so of all his principal fighting men, thereby weakening his hands if he meant to fight, and having done this he sent to him to die.

Ajaja, however, was reluctant to supersede his chief, so the Are sent to him to take with him One wife, one horse and one groom and leave the town.

On lyapo hearing this he sent at once to Ajayi advising him to accept the title. " I know that I afn a doomed man," said he " and I must not involve you in my ruin ; as for me, my father was an Eso and I was bom an Esg, and like an Eso I will die." He summoned his brothers together, and gave them his last charge, all being present excepting Akintola the next to him. He distributed his property to his sons and daughters, left directions about the family property (to which he added something) and how to keep up the glory of the house and their father's name, etc. In the meantime he ordered his grave and his coffin to be prepared, and having inspected and approved of both, and having thus set his house in order, on the evening of the 17th November, 1877, this young and brave general entered his bedroom, and put an end to his life I

When the news got abroad, the consternation and agitation in the town were indescribable. All the young Mogajis lyapo's comrades quaked and trembled. They combined and took a solemn oath of mortal hatred of the Are for the death ,of lyapo and a determination to avenge it. They agreed never to win for him a battle, or conquer a hamlet until he was dead and gone. Thus the Are by putting an end to the life of such brave men as Aijenku and lyapo started the decadence of Ibadan military power. His chief motive was a selfish one, to immortalize his own name and exalt his family never taking into account what providence may have decreed for him.

The Succession of Akintola

After the death of lyapo, Akintola his brother succeeded him as the head of the house but of course not to his title nor to any public title at all, as the Arg was determined to diminish if not extinguish the glory of Ibikunle's house. That quarter of the town of which that house was the centre was broken up, all the

strong chiefs therein being assigned to several petty chiefs so that Akintola was left with no following and had none to depend upon but his father's slaves. But all the same he felt that none was equal to him among all the chiefs in that quarter and that the prestige of his father's house was in no way obliterated, he knew that the " Lion of the Master of Camps" will one day arise and shake up himself in all his former power ; but for the present he had to bow to the inevitable.

§ 4. Further Raiding Expedition on Egba Farms.

On the 19th November, 1877, the Balogun was sent out to raid the Egba farms and he ravaged those that lay near the Ijebus. On the 28th December, he went northwards against those that lay in the direction of Iberekodo and an attempt was even made to capture a village called Ogatedo at the confluence of the Oyan and Ofiki rivers. But the rivers were swollen and the Ibadans having waded waist deep were compelled to retreat before the steady fire of the men of the place, who posted themselves behind the large trees growing along the side of the river, and prevented their gaining the opposite bank. The Balogun being ill in the camp they could not renew their efforts. The expedition returned home on the 17th of January, 1878, the Balogun being borne on a litter.

A Nine Days' Raiding Expedition

On the Balogun 's recovery from his illness the Are proposed another expedition and was determined to make a longer stay in the Egba farms this time and thus draw them out to a fight. Hitherto the raids lasted only three days each time and only the Ibadan war-chiefs were concerned, but now he proposed inviting outside help as well. For that purpose he sent the Otun to clear the road leading to Arawo, that is a place midway between Ibadan and Abeokuta on the caravan route. He also invited the warchiefs of Ife, Modakeke and other subject towns. He could not count upon the complete loyalty of the Ibadan war-chiefs because of their opposition to this enterprise, and because he knew how deeply he had offended most of them ; bjit he knew the courage and intrepidity of the Ifes and relied more on them. The expedition left Ibadan on the 24th of March, 1878 and encamped next day at Alakisa a few miles beyond Arawo. Having this for their base they ravaged the farms on the right as far as Iber§kodo, and on the left as far as they could go. They lived on the spoils of the farm and destroyed the rest, setting the barns on fire. The Egbas however, did not show their faces, but contented themselves

with bravely manning their walls against any attack. The Ife army arrived on the 28th and joined them in the field.

At the end of nine days the Are summoned a council and announced that as the Egbas did not take up the challenge and come out for a fight, they should take a roundabout course and capture Osiele before they returned home. He was opposed by the whole of the Ibadan war-chiefs without exception . They alleged :

1. That they were already exhausted by this 9 days useless exposure.
2. That Osiele not being taken into account before they left home, they had not first consulted the gods nor offered propitiatory sacrifices as they usually did before attacking a town.
3. That to go to Osiele from where they were was too risky and inadvisable, because they would leave rear and base exposed to attack by the Egbas should they undertake to attack them by way of Atadi. If Osiele is to be taken why not go home first and make a direct attack from home by a route shorter and safer ? The Are repHed " You had better go and reconsider what you intend to do, as for me, my mind is made up. I am decided, and if there remain only my slaves and Ayikiti the Ife General and the Modak§ke people with me, I shall take Osiele."

The chiefs retired, but to strengthen the plot against him. They agreed to follow but only to witness how he and his slaves with the Ife and Modakeke people would take Ogiele. In the meantime private messages had gone to apprise the Egbas of the impending assault on Osiele. The Ibadan war-chiefs also let their men know that they were not obliged to stand by their masters, nor to stay and fight in case of an attack, but as for themselves they were bound by their office not to desert the Are. Before daybreak on the 1st of April they had started for Osiele.

The Osiele army met them at a great distance from their home, and without firing a shot those who led the van of the Ibadan army melted away, bringing the Are himself and his principal war-chiefs face to face with the enemy. Only their bodyguards remained with the chiefs, their fighting men had all gone. The Are and his slaves threw themselves into the attack vigorously, and in the first attack, about 300 of them became hors de combat in dead and wounded. Nothing daunted, a second onslaught was made and about 200 became hors de combat. The Are's slaves now perceived that the brunt of the fighting was left for them alone to bear, and suspected it was a plot to annihilate them, therefore they also gave way. The Ife and Modakeke people quickly took in the situation and they themselves gave way, leaving only the Are and his principal war-chiefs with their bodyguards. None

of the war-chiefs deserted the Are so that no one could be accused of cowardice. The chiefs knew the risks they were running by thus exposing themselves to be enveloped and taken but they could not have done otherwise; that was the only way to accompUsh their plot and bring the Are to reason.

It is now evident the day was lost, and as the Are began to retreat the rush became general and the Egbas pressed hard in pursuit. The camp was a long way off, nearly a day's journey, and hundreds died of thirst. The Are and the veterans about him retreated in good order, or let us rather say were allowed to retreat in good order, for if Ogundipe and the Egba war-chiefs had determined to press hard in pursuit the Ibadan army would have been annihilated, but the war-chiefs on either side knew secretly the game they were playing. About 2 p.m. the Are expressed a desire to say his afternoon prayers. " By all means," said the Balogun " you can do so." The Balogun then dismounted and expanding his arms in the direction of the pursuers he said to them " Fire all your shots here." But Sanusi the Are's eldest son and Idagana one of his principal slaves threw themselves forward and kept' the Egba pursuers at bay until the Are had said his prayers ; and once on the saddle again they retreated hastily. The casualties on the whole were slight. Sanusi was wounded in the lip, the Balogun lost a favourite servant in this campaign, and the Mogaji of the late Chief Bioku was captured by the Egbas. The wreck of the expedition returned home on the 2nd of April, 1878.

The Are was greatly disappointed, especially in his own slaves. He said he had thought that come what might he could always count upon a thousand at least to stand by him for weal or woe, but alas he was deserted. However, he comforted himself with this reflection : " There is no one who may not suffer a defeat, for even the prophet of God (Mahomet) suffered a defeat."

After this all the interior war-chiefs returned to their homes but Ayikiti and the Ife war-chiefs. Several offices had to be filled among them. Also the office of the Owoni of Ife was vacant by the death of Ayikiti's father, and he was desirous of succeeding him. The Ifes, however, were for another prince and not Ayikiti, but he so pressed his claims that the Are had to give in, and so on the 8th April after titles had been arranged for all vacancies in the Ife chieftaincies, messengers from the Ibadan chiefs followed Ayikiti home to crown him the Owoni of Ife.

Another Raid. — The Are, however, was not dispirited by the defeat and failure to capture Osiele, he sent the Otun out again to clear the direct route via the Agangan hill. In the meantime he was carrying on a private negotiation with the Ijebus for

a treaty of friendship and commerce working chiefly through the Ijebus resident at Ibadan and the Ij§bu Remos. But the answer of the Awujale of the Ijebus was insolent, bidding the Ar§ first to be on friendly terms with the Egbas, the AlAfin, the Ijesas and the Ifes, and when he saw the messengers of the heads of these states he would reconsider his relations with Ibadan. The Ibadan chiefs hearing this reply were so enraged at its insolence that they were willing to yield to the Are's determination that the reply to the Awujale should take a practical form by sending the Balogun to ravage the Egba farms. Although they held a different view from their chief in this matter of Abeokuta yet they could not brook any insults to him from outside. They marched out on the 2oth of May, 1878.

§ 5. The Revolt of the Ekiti Tribes

The Ekiti tribes who had long been groaning under the yoke of the Ibadans, seized the opportunity of the

latter being involved in compHcations with the Egbas and Ijebus to rebel against them. Adey^a, prince of Ila, Fabunmi and Odeyale both of Mesin- Oloja-Oke, allied themselves together to commence hostilities against the Ibadans.

Their first act of rebellion was to seize all Oyos (Yorubas proper) residing peacefully amongst them with their famiUes. They killed some, and the rest they sold into slavery. Then they collected together a large number of hen coups, and skulls of cattle, set them up as fetish, and offered to them sacrifices of human beings, the victims being (i) The Ibadan messengers that oppressed them so much ; (2) and the Ajeles (pohtical residents) of the Ibadan chiefs among them ; fowls and cattle being the chief articles of diet these messengers generally demanded from them. The massacre at Ila alone was estimated at about 1,000 human beings !

The Ijesas of Ilesa who had more than once come into colHsion with the Ibadans before, were rather wary and felt very reluctant to join this coaUtion ; indeed they were frequently seized with panic from false rumours of the approach of the Ibadans, so that Ilesa itself was more than once deserted from this cause. There were good reasons for this however. One was the transport of ammunition from Ibadan to Mgsin Ipole, a town which had not then thrown off its cdlegiance, but this was in order to settle between two brothers a dispute which had risen to undue proportions and in which an armed intervention had become necessary.

The other was that Ayikiti the Owoni lately crowned by the Are for the Ifes captured some Ijesa towns, viz., Ipindun, Ife v/krk, and Osu in order to possess himself of the wherewith to

defray the expenses of his coronation. All these gave rise to the panic at Ilesa.

On the i6th June news reached Ibadan that the Ilgrins had joined the coalition against them, and the King of Ilorin was said to have sent the following message to the Are of Ibadan. " If a man's wife deserted him, and afterwards repented and came back to him, is not the husband justified in receiving her back " The Are's replj' was " Yes he is, but let the husband beware of what he may contract from the whore." The key to the parable is this : — When the Fulanis overran the northern Yoruba territories, the Ilorins became masters of the Ekiti provinces also ; but when the Ibadans rose to power the Ekitis transferred their allegiance to them. But now they are disposed to return to their " first love " and thus are compared to an erring wife returning to her former husband. The meaning of the Ibadan reply is obvious, the Ilorins may thereby involve themselves in a war of which they may have cause to regret. The Are took no heed of the rebellion, but was prosecuting his desultory warfare with the Egbas.

On the 23rd of June, there was a terrible conflagration at Ibadan; the Balogun and Seriki in whose quarters the fire broke out went to arrest its progress, but unfortunately, before they reached home, sparks from the flames had set their own houses on fire. Every preparation having been made for an expedition to the Egba farms, it was thought that it would be postponed, but early next morning (June 24th) whilst the embers were still smouldering, the Balogun 's drum was heard on its way to the Egba farms. This expedition returned on the evening of the 26th June bringing about 40 captives.

On the 14th of July another expedition went out under Ali the Otun, the Are sending Kupolu with him, but they were not as successful as the last.

The people of Ila afterwards got alarmed at their own acts, and began to be afraid of the consequences. They therefore sent on the i6th July ambassadors to Ibadan to make amends, and to sue for peace ; but these were roughly received and were sent back home to prepare for the worst. Upon this the Ekitis sent no more to Ibadan but took further steps to strengthen their alliances and put their defences in order.

The confederates now aimed at wresting from the Ibadans all their subject towns including Oyo towns under their protection from Ikirun to Iwo, and limit the Ibadan territories to the river Oba, that is the natural limits of their farms in that direction. It soon became evident that the Ifes had joined them, because their only safe route to Benin for ammunition via Oke Igbo became

unsafe from kidnappers ; but the people of Modakeke being Oyos and not Ifes refused to join the coalition knowing that the destruction of Ibadan would be their own ruin, as the Ifes were ever hostile to them, but

remained quiet for fear of the Ibadans.

On the 19th August news reached Ibadan that the Ekiti allies had marched against Igbajg. Igbajo is a border town and as its name implies contains a mixed population of Oygs, Ijesas, Ekitis and other clans. In its physical aspect it is like the rest of the Ekiti towns but the rulers and principal inhabitants were Oyos and cdl were Oyos in sympathy. They maintained their allegiance to Ibadan refusing to join the coalition. Hence the resolve to remove them out of the way before marching on the nearest genuine Oyo town — Ikirun.

Not even did this news move the Are. He sent the Balogun to ravage the Egba farms on the other side of the Ogun river, not only because those on this side had been utterly despoiled, but also because he meant further to straighten Abeokuta, and more especially to be in touch with Porto Novo in order to procure ammunition. He took Ogatedo by an assault, and from Meko he sent on the caravans that accompanied him to Porto Novo for ammunition and salt, and the Seriki to escort them beyond the danger zone, and there to await their return.

On hearing that the army of the Egbas was out to waylay his caravans, the Balogun formed links from his base at Mekg right on to the Seriki's post for mutual defence ; the Otun and Osi being placed within easy reach of the Seriki, and then his own division under Aderibigbe the Mogaji of the late Bale Olugbode, and a part under his own brother Mosaderin, and his eldest son Babalola and his head slave Jato.

This last division considered themselves practically secure ; hence they neglected all precautions, placed no sentinels and were completely off their guard. It was this division the Egbas surprised and attacked. They were dispersed, and Kurakura the Hausa slave of Chief Ogundeyi of Abeokuta hotly pursued after Aderibigbe and would have caught him, but that the latter was a splendid rider and was well mounted on a powerful steed. It was late in the afternoon when the Otun and his companions hearing the continuous report of musketry at their rear contrary to expectation came up with their forces, and drove the Egbas away and once more cleared the road.

The Balogun before leaving Meko sent a kidnapping expedition to the Ketu farms, a part of which was successful ; but the Ketus, being well acquainted with their country, took by-paths, attacked

the kidnappers and rescued their people. Several Ibadans were caught, but most of them escaped to Meko and Ibadan.

But whilst all this was going on in the South-west the scene in the North-east was one of dreadful carnage. The Igbajos defended themselves heroically and repelled the enemy more than once ; at the second instance the Egugun Chief Priest of Ila was caught and slain. But the allies were reinforced and returned to the attack.

On appeal to Ibadan for help Osuntoki the Maye of Ibadan was sent with a small force to assist Igbajo, but it was found that the Are underrated the strength of the coalition. Igbajo could hold out no longer, Maye was obliged to retreat with the Igbajos to Ikirun, with the allies at their heels, laying siege to Ikirun.

The King of Ilorin now sent out his forces under the command of Ajia to join the allies at the siege of Ikirun with instructions to sweep all Oyo towns, right on to the river Oba at the confines of the Ibadan farms, that is to say, to take Ikirun, Osogbo, Ed§ and I wo with their villages.

The Ilorins commenced operations at Otan a village near Ikirun, and at the onset met with an ominous disaster. The people of this village hearing of their approach deserted the place and hid themselves among the craggy rocks surrounding the village. The Ilorins finding no one to oppose them flew to the spoils, and thus engaged, the men of Otan came in and set on them sla5dng many ; only a few of those who entered the town made good their escape, and that with great difl&culty. The Ilorins receiving reinforcement from home laid siege also against Ikirun. Thus was Ikirun hemmed in nearly on all sides by the Ilorins, the Ekitis and Ila, with the Ijesas, and the inhabitants were obliged to defend themselves within their walls, and the thickets surrounding the

The small Ibadan contingent at Ikirun reported matters at home but no help was speedily forthcoming, as theBalogun, with the flower of the Ibadan army had not yet returned from Meko. On the 14th of October,

1878 the Ibadan expedition returned home. The Balogun was ordered to make a hasty preparation and march out in five days.

Chapter XXIV

CONFLICTS IN THE NORTH

§ I. The Celebrated Battle of Ikirun Otherwise Called — " The Jalumi War "

The Are of Ibadan at this crisis hastily filled up one or two gaps in the ranks of the chiefs. Oranyan was worshipped on the 20th October and the standard of war immediately marched northwards to the seat of carnage. It was a most unfavourable time for the army to march out, as it was the time of the latter rains. The rivers were unusually full, and unhappily many of the soldiers found a watery grave in the overswollen Oba and Osun rivers before ever they came in sight of the enemy.

The expedition was altogether a trying one for the Balogun, for the Are even in this hour of danger recklessly continued to practise those short-sighted, suicidal policies of his which tended to weaken the power of Ibadan, thus showing a great lack of statesmanship. He slyly tried to handicap the Balogxm by making the Osi his rival. To this young man already of considerable importance he assigned most of his own war-chiefs and his fighting slaves, and also all the fighting men of the late Seriki lyapo his old rival. Intoxicated with such honours conferred upon him, the Osi looked down upon the Balogun ; he not only refused to obey orders, but often dictated his wish to the Balogun. Happily the latter was a man of great experience, of consummate tact, and marvellous resources ; he would readily yield in minor points as of no great importance in order to maintain peace and harmony at this crisis. Twice before they reached Ikirun he claimed in advance from the Balogun a reward for the victory that he would achieve, for he was confident that the honour of the victory would be his. At each time the Balogun sent him 10 heads of cowries. It must be added, however, that he was scarcely ever sober during the expedition. The free use of spirituous liquors was considered at this time the acme of pleasure and mark of greatness ; spirits being at this period beyond the reach of poor men.

At Osogbo the Osi deeply offended the principal slaves that formed his body guard, and on whom he depended at the supreme hour of danger, by disfiguring two of them with facial marks for an offence of seizing things from people in the market by way of privilege. The big slaves interceded in vain. They pleaded for

any other punishment but that, but he gave them no heed, the culprits were marked with two gashes on either cheek from the top of the head to the chin. This action they were determined to revenge whenever opportunity offered.

At Osogbo, he also related to those about him a dream he had in which he saw his late father Ogunmola and his brother Osun. He felt rather uncomfortable thereat, and was. ad vised to offer sacrifices to them. This he did with a horse and a cow.

Meanwhile at Ikirun matters were growing from bad to worse. The last battle fought before the arrival of the Ibadans was on the 30th October, 1878, in which the Ikiruns were hemmed in on all sides, and they had to fight within the town walls. Balogun Ogboriefgn with the Ibadan forces at last entered Ikirun on Thursday the 31st October. It was said that the Akirun, Oyebode the chief ruler of Ikirun, when he saw the Ibadan forces marching into the town for his succour was so overcome with joy that he could only say to the Balogun " Ajayi, are you come ? I am almost done for." The Balogun replied, " Take courage, take courage, we are come, your deliverance is at hand."

The Balogun of Ibadan now learnt from the Ikiruns the situation of affairs. The allies were in three different camps. The Ilorins under the command of Ajia were encamped by themselves Northeastwards, near the Ikirun farms ; the Has and Ekitis together not very far off from the Ilorins under Prince Adeyala of Ila, and Fabunmi of Oke Mesin respectively, and the Ijesas under their generals Ayimoro and Ogunmodede eastwards. These last had in the meantime captured the small town of Iba near Ikirun and were encamped within its walls. Iba we may mention was the paternal town of Osuntoki the Maye of Ibadan (afterwards Bale) who headed the contingent for the relief of Igbajo.

From these three points the foes marched in the day of battle, and attacked Ikirun on all sides.

At a council of war held the very day of their arrival the Balogun of Ibadan proposed to give the men one or two days' rest, the journey from Ibadan being tedious on account of the incessant rains and the privations they endured, and then to march against the confederates. The Osi again opposed the Balogun. He was to march at once the next day " before the allies are aware of our arrival ; " and if the Balogun will not go, he will. " To-morrow," said the Balogun " will be Friday, and Fridays being unlucky days it is not likely the allies will attack us, and the men may as well have some rest."

The Osi again objected, and the Balogun yielded the point. Then again the Balogun in ordering the battle proposed to divide

the Ibadan army into two parts, one led by himself against the armies of the Ilorins and the Ekitis encamping not very far off from each other, especially as he had been told that was the strongest part ; and the other under the Osi to go against the Ijesas encamping eastwards at Iba. Again the Osi objected. " The Ilorins and the Ekitis lie to the left of us," said he, " and I am the commander of the left, to the left therefore I go." " Very good," replied the Balogun " You can have your own way."

As the Osi commanded nearly the half of the whole Ibadan forces, there was no reason why he should not accomplish successfully what he proposed to do, provided he acted with reason and judgment.

Those about him reported that he was restless and sleepless all night, he ate little but drank much, and it had been so since their arrival at Osogbo. He emptied a bottle of gin before ordering his horse to be saddled long before daybreak. He marched out of the town by the Northern (O^a) gate, long before his war-chiefs including Akintgla were ready. He dismounted and halted a while before dawn behind the town wall until some of his men came and then he proceeded ; the others had to hurry after him one after another as each was ready.

The Balogun at dawn with the Otun marched out by the eastern or Oba'gun gate leading past the ancient village of that name, along the fine road that leads to the town of Iba where the Ijesas were then encamped.

The Osi's route lay for about three miles along the highway to the north, then it verged towards the right nearly at right angles along a farm road,a high range of mountains parallel to this separating the forces of the Osi from those of the Balogun. About three miles along this farm road the Ilorin camp could be descried on the left hand side, situated on a hill on the other side of a morass, but approachable by a ford which lay about a mile further on, which point was more directly near the Ekiti camp. Those of Osi's men who had gone before went straight along to this ford, but the Osi wishing to take a short cut to the Ilorin camp left the road and went by a bush path and through farms with the intention of attacking the Ilorins on both sides at once. This after-thought he never communicated to those before. Many of his warchiefs coming on after him went straight on along the road not knowing that he had left it for a bush path straight for the Ilorin camp.

The Ekitis were surprised to see the Ikiruns out against them but the reason soon became evident, they had been reinforced. Those who went early to the stream were driven back at the sight Q

of the Ikiruns, and they reported to the camp the advance of the enemy.

Fabumi and his colleagues attacked them vigorously and overpowered them ; they were surprised at not seeing their chief and no reinforcement coming up to their aid, so they were driven back and dispersed. Fabumi pursued them till he came to the spot where Ilori the Osi took to the bush path, and this was pointed out to him. By that time Ilori had attacked the Ilorins and had repelled those out against him, and was pressing hard to capture the camp when he heard the sound of Akintola's drum coming up behind him " Kiriniun Onibudo," " Kiriniun Onihudo." He sent a mounted messenger to greet Akintola and to say "You are rather late in coming, I had almost entered the Ilorin camp, however, you are welcome."

But the messenger never returned, and Ilori 's men noticed that the rolling of the drum was not perfect in style, they therefore suspected treachery and communicated their fears to their master. But he rephed "Who else can it be ? Is not that Akintola's warcry Ki-ri-ni-un Oni-budo ?" When too late, he discovered

the treachery. Fabumi of Oke Mesin it was who was counterfeiting the war-cry of Akintola, who had been left behind.

It was at such a crisis like this that his guards would have stood by him to a man and kept the enemy at bay until relief should come from those he left behind ; but he had insulted those trusty servants and this was their time of revenge. He was helped to his horse, but at best he was not a good rider, and his head had become muddled by drink. The horse soon got entangled in a yam field and fell down, and the illustrious Ilori was taken alive and conducted to the Ilorin camp ! At the camp he was stripped of everything he had on, a rag being given him to wrap across himself and was kept in a room under close supervision. One Koiditan a renegade from Ibadan betrayed his personality to the Ilorins, and they in ecstasies of joy at the capture of so illustrious a prisoner gave themselves up to feasting and enjoyment for the day, apprehending no further trsuble. The Ikiruns sadly disappointed at this turn of events were ready to stone the Ibadans, they insulted them to their face saying to them " We could not drive them away indeed, but we never suffered so ignominious a defeat as this, and what is the good of you ? "

So the Osi's men were scattered, many of them fleeing back to the town met those just coming out, and together they fled back to Ikirun.

But some of them instead of retracing their steps to Ikirun went across the mountain range to the other side and told the Balogun

what had happened. They met him in the thick of the fight with the Ijesas, company after company on both sides marching to the fighting Hne, attacking each other furiously. As soon as the escaped arrived and reported " The Osi has been captured aUve and his army dispersed ! " The Balogun was startled ; but he was a man full of resources, and endued with remarkable presence

of mind " Sh " said he to the men, " say nothing of this to

any one as you value your lives." He quickly called about half-adozen of his slaves, and bade them roll themselves in the dust —they did so. He then bade one of his servants " bind them hand to neck as men captured in battle and take them to the Otun tvith my compHments, and say Ilgri has entered the Ilorin camp, here are captives that he sent us. What are we doing ? " He then sent a message to Babalola his eldest son saying " I can see what your younger brother is doing but goodness alone knows what you are doing ; be careful, lest I disinherit you in favour of him." Just then a company of Ijesas were coming to the attack, but instead of another company of Ibadans meeting them in the fighting Une, he threw his whole force suddenly upon them and overwhelmed them. He ordered that everyone be put to the sword, and they were all massacred. They had scarcely done this when another company was coming gaily on to relieve these. The Balogun ordered a feint retreat so as to allow the company to advance further before firing, so his men hastily retreated, and this retreat encouraged the Ijesas to advance forward. The Balogun meanwhile had his eyes on them to see the effect of the massacre. As soon as the Ijesa company came up suddenly on their massacred comrades, finding them wallowing in their blood, they stood stock still, panic stricken. The Balogun noting this at once ordered a general charge " Omo Ibadan, e gba efi ti won." (Ibadan boys, up and at them). " E ma je won o Ig — " (let not one escape) at once rang throughout the whole army, and the panic stricken Ijesas gave way, the panic spread throughout their army, and the Balogun followed them up foot to foot into the town of Iba where they were encamped, and Iba was retaken. The bulk of the Ijesas fell into his hands. He then issued that heartrending, never to be forgotten order " Let no one stay for booty or captive, all prisoners must be slain at once, both will hamper us, the latter may prove treacherous." And so all the Ij§sas captured were put to the sword. It was a heartrending sight, for many of them were formerly slaves at Ibadan who ran away to enhst under the flag of rebelUon or of Uberty (from whatever point we view it). Old comrades, calUng each other by name craved for mercy. But the Balogun's orders rang out " Whosoever will not

kill his captive, let him be killed with his captive." So all were massacred ! And then the Balogun immediately turned his face northwards towards the Ilorin camp without delay. As they marched along a body of Ekitis

about i.ooo strong appeared on their right flank to attack them, but the Balogun neither noticed nor regarded them, notwithstanding all their efforts at firing ; they had to cease firing of their own accord, amazed at such a spectacle. There was but one thought uppermost in the Balogun's mind, and in that of every Ibadan soldier, viz., how to rescue Ilori the Osi.

It was about 2 p.m., when the Ilorins heard the drum of the Balogun coming. " And who is that again ? " they asked, and were told " The Balogun." " Any other Balogun besides the one we captured this morning ? " they asked. They went out to meet the Ibadans, and within a short time, they were repulsed. The fine river that flowed by the town of Iba, flowed also along the foot of the hill where the Ekiti camp was situated, and from which they obtained water. That river loses itself in a morass here below the Ilorin camp, and the only spot where a ford was possible was along a winding stream breast deep at this season. The Ilorins having retreated to the other side held the Ibadans in check for a while on the other side of the morass. There they stood face to face, the attackers and the defenders.

Chief Akintola, who we may remember was attached to the Osi's army, was left behind as we saw when that unfortunate chief rushed on before daybreak to his own fate. By the time he came up to his chief, the tragedy had taken place, and he was met by the fugitives defeated by Fabumi. He therefore retraced his steps back to Ikirun, and took the other route to join the Balogun. By the time he reached Iba, the Balogun had finished with the Ijesas and had cleared out of the place, and he had to follow in his track to where the battle was now raging. The Ibadan boys all but exhausted after the morning's fight and the day's march, encouraged at the sight of fresh troops were exhilarated by the inspiriting air of Akintola's war cry, which the \yhole army took up with a swing " Kiriniun Onibudo Kiriniun Onibudo." Thus came up Akintola ; and stretching forth his hand across to the enemy, half turned on his saddle to his men he said " Awon ta nu ? Awon ta I'emba se ta nta ? " (and who are those ? Who are they with whom you are exchanging shots?) Immediately the Ibadan boys dashed into the morass, treading on one another they struggled across the quagmire and hurled themselves upon their foes. The Ilorins taken aback by this unexpected, this mad rush became completely demoralized and gave way. The Ibadans

entered the Ilorin camp, captured a large number, put some to the sword and demolished the camp. All those who were captured in the morning with the Osi, speedily rejoined their comrades and made captives among their captors. The Osi's men were among the foremost to seek out their master, but alas, the worst had befallen him. When he heard the noise and tramp of the Ibadans within the Ilorin camp, he tried to make his escape ; he rushed out of his confinement and hid himself in a clump of fignut trees not far from the tent. The Ilgrins in their hasty flight did not forget the illustrious captive, but he could not be found until betrayed by a woman who saw him in his hiding place ; then a man with drawn sword rushed upon him and put him to death before he made good his own escape. The same fate befel several of the minor chiefs, Ilori's fighting men who were caught with him that morning. Ijesas and Ekitis who had lived at Ibadan and knew all these chiefs at sight easily pointed them out to the Ilorins. Koiditan the renegade and betrayer of the Osi was caught, and taken to Ikirun where he was subsequently tried and publicly executed.

The Balogun then turned towards the Ekiti and Ila camp. It was evident that they had no longer any spirit of resistance left in them. By one assault that was taken also, and so the three camps were smashed on one and the same day by Balogun Ajayi Ogboriefgn. The victory was decisive and complete, and Ikirun was saved.

The Ofa people who had long been groaning under the yoke of Ilorin took this opportunity to throw off their yoke. They cut the bridge over the Otin river at the rear of the Ilorins, and when these in their flight came to the river now swollen, with the Ibadans at their heels, they rushed into it. Here thousands upon thousands of men, women and horses perished. The river at one point was said to be so choked with human bodies and carcases of horses that some fugitives who came later were able to escape upon corpses. Ajia the Ilorin commander-in-chief escaped with great difficulty with one of his favourite wives, but several Ilorin chiefs and well-to-do people were caught. Prince Adeyala of Ila fell among the slain but Fabumi of Oke Mesin managed to escape. The roads were said to be strewn all along with loads which the Ilorins could not carry in their

hasty flight. The Ibadans pursued their victory right up to Erin about 8 miles from Ofa ; the head chiefs however remained at Ikirun.

This event gave the name to this expedition " Ogun Jalumi," i.e. the rush-into-the-river war.

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Notable Events of the Day

1. Roti, Ilori's head slave and a very great favourite, with whom he was as a most intimate friend, eating out of the same dish and drinking out of the same cup, and from whom he was never parted, was in another part of the field that fatal morning when the disaster overtook his master. When he observed that something was wrong, he rode up hastily asking " Ilori da ? Ilori da ? " (And where is Ilori ?) The reply was " Ogun mu u lo " (taken by the enemy). He uttered one deep groan " O — h " He then bade his comrades farewell " Good-bye to you all, no home for me again." He drew his sword, put spurs to his horse and dashed into the midst of the Ilorins, slashing on the right and on the left, kilHng many before he fell among the slain.

2. Akintola's drum played a most notable part in the day's business ; it won and lost for the Ilorins, it lost and won for the Ibadans. And here let us note a most remarkable instance of retributive justice. The trick now played upon Ilori by Fabiimi by which Ilori was captured was the same played by Ilori's father the famous Ogunmola upon the Ijayes after the Iwawun war. It will be remembered how on his return march he counterfeited the war cry of KurQmi of Ijaye, and in that way all Ijayes who had escaped into the mountains thinking their master was come to their rescue came down from their hiding places and fell a prey into his hands (vide Chap, xviii, page 349). The same trick was now played by Fabiimi on his son with fatal results.

3. The Ife and Modakeke people who always joined the Ibadans in every expedition of theirs came up late this time after everything was over. The Ibadan boys taunted them to their face and accused them of intentional delay because of the formidable appearance of the war ; but said they " we have already shown that we can do without you."

The If es never uttered a word of excuse, nor resented the remarks but followed up the chase and took Ilofa. (The fact was that the Ifes had secretly wished the issue to be otherwise in order to cast off their own yoke also ; and the Modakekes having their eyes on them would not leave them behind). They also joined in taking Omu, Erinmope, Gogo, etc., and the conquest was pursued up to Ekan. This was a small town but the men of that place were mostly hunters and sharp-shooters. They manned their walls so that the Ibadan boys failed to take it by assault. The Balogun hearing this sent Ali Laluwoye the Otun to their help. He was nearly a month in this small place and was content to reduce it by famine. They negotiated peace, sending valuable presents by Aturu who was sent to conclude a treaty with them. The Bale

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andBalogun of the place were sent by Ali to Ikirun to theBalogun of Ibadan to ratify the treaty. The Otun was thereupon recalled from the siege, to the great disgust of the Ibadan warboys who grumbled much against their unlucky and inefficient chief.

The victory and its cost were reported at Ibadan simultaneously on the 5th of November, so that the joy was greatly tempered with the painful loss they had sustained by the death of Ilori and his brave comrades.

The Balogun received orders not to waste time to retaliate on the Ijesas or Ekitis as they would soon tender their submission. He was not to go beyond Ila, but rather to turn his face against Ilorin towns.

On the i8th November the Ilorins sent ambassadors to Ibadan to sue for peace. The Are took occasion to remind them of the parable of the whorish wife returning to her husband and what he predicted would Hkely be the result. Knowing that their overtures were only for the purpose of redeeming their chiefs who were captured in the war, and kept as state prisoners, and still smarting under the loss of Ilori the Osi and his brave comrades, the Are and chiefs sent them back home without an answer.

Whilst the Ibadans were rejoicing and mourning at the same time over the affairs in the north, the Egbas came to kidnap in their farms on the 22nd of December, and some farmers were carried off to Abeokuta.

The Balogun was at length recalled and the Ibadans returned home on the 23rd December, 1878, with the Balogun in an indifferent state of health.

§ 2. The Results of the Jalumi War. The results that followed this crushing defeat of the allies were totally different from what the Are of Ibadan had expected. In his opinion the disastrous results to the Ilorins were quite sufficient to make them hold aloof from the rebel states, and these he expected would tender unreserved submission, and that things would henceforth move as smoothly as before ; but, as we shall see matters took a totally different turn everywhere. The Are now saw the necessity of being on friendly terms with at least one of the neighbouring states. The Ijesas and Ekitis were subject states, he could never treat with them on terms of equality. The Ilorins lately defeated were characteristically untrustworthy, Ibadan could have nothing to gain from that quarter. The Egbas the Are was determined to subjugate so as to open a free route to the coast to all Oyos through the river Ogun. There remained only theljebus with whom Ibadans could possibly treat, and therefore

the Are sent large presents with some slaves to the Awujaleof Ijebu and craved for friendly relations, as there had never been any cause of quarrel between them. But the Ijebus refused a rapprochement and declined the presents. They openly declared themselves alHes of the Egbas and Ekitis, surmising that all this pretence of friendship was mainly for the purpose of procuring war materials from the coast through the Ijebus themselves.

The Are resented this rebuff by sending another raiding expedition to the Egba farms. The Balogun who returned home from Ikirun ill, was getting worse and worse every day, so he sent the Otun and the Seriki, but they returned on the 4th of January, without a single captive.

Meanwhile the storm was gathering thick in the north and north-east. The effect of the late defeat was to exasperate rather than dishearten the aUies, and they were determined more than ever not only to wipe off the disgrace but also to crush the Ibadan power if not destroy that town altogether.

Although the Ilgrin refugees were well treated at Ofa yet they were determined to take vengeance by destroying that town for their conduct in destroying the bridge over the river Otin which occasioned such tremendous losses to them.

Karkrk the Hausa Balogun of Ilorin, who, on account of his marked disloyalty to his King was denied the honour of conducting the battle which ended so disastrously, came out to succour the escaped. He came as far as Elehinjare, but when he heard of the Ibadans pursuing as far as Erin, he retreated to Ganmo as he was not then prepared to fight. Here he remained until he received orders to destroy the town of Ofa. This he meant to do by stratagem, and to make quick work of it. He asked leave of the Olgfa to allow him to pass through his town to Erin in order to punish that small town for intrigue. But the Olof a was wide awake ; he knew who the prime intriguer was, therefore, the reply he gave was " Not until I am removed out of the way." Karkrk now threw off the mask and openly declared war against Ofa ; leaving Ganmo he went forward and pitched his first camp.

This expedition was not popular at Ilorin, because King Alihu wished to be on good terms with the Ibadans, at least for the present, in order to ransom all the Ilorin chiefs caught in the last war. But Kar^ra it was said threatened to convert his camp into a town, and set up M6m6 the heir apparent to be king over it, in opposition to Ilorin, and so Alihu was obliged to let him have his own way.

The Ofas sent to Ibadan for help on the 20th of February, 1879 ; the Are sent Ali the Otun with all his forces, also Kanike one of

his own head slaves with some of his men, and the Otun, Osi, and Ekerin of the Seriki ; later on he sent Akintola.

This on the whole was a very weak force, for, although there were some very strong men in it, yet the leader of the expedition was held to be both unlucky and incompetent.

But King Alihu did not despair ; in order to conciliate the Ibadans he declared all the roads in his territory open for trade so that all Oyos immured in Bida and in Hausa towns were able to come down in safety. He then sent an embassy again to Ibadan to negotiate for peace between them, and to arrange for the ransom of the Ilgrins captured in war, but the Are declared he could not entertain the idea unless the siege of Ofa was raised.

The Are now endeavoured to fill up the gaps made in the late war by making some indispensable appointments. Akintaro the heir of the late Balogun Akere he made the Osi Balogun in place of the late Ilori. For the great house of Ogunmola there was none but the youthful Kongi son of the late Osun, Ilori's elder brother. He was now advanced to be the head of the house with the title of Areagoro. These two were the most important.

Death of the Balogun of Ibadan. — In the midst of this crisis the Ibadans suffered an irreparable loss by the death of their Balogun. On the 7th of April, 1879, the firing of musketry, volleys upon volleys announced to the public that Ajayi nick-named Ogboriefon had passed away ! The town went into deep mourning, as he was the last of those veteran generals of Ibadan, who had seen great fights and made a name, with the sole exception of the Are. Those who were now to the fore were not the old and experienced but the young and untried heirs of great houses according to the policy favoured by the Are. He was buried at about 10 p.m., with full pagan and military rites. An eye-witness thus described the interment. The grave was dug in his bedroom, the large coffin was first lowered, and the body wound up as usual was placed in it, and then nailed up. Four flint-lock guns, a naked sword, and strings of cowries were placed upon the cofifin, and a kid was immolated, the blood being poured on the lid of the coffin, and prayers offered to the gods for his soul.

Ajayi was a native of Ejigbo, he came to Ibadan for the love of a military career. He was nick-named Ogboriefon from the following circumstance : — At a battle in the Efon country, he noticed a man who posted himself behind a large tree doing havoc to the Ibadans. The man was using two guns giving an assistant the one he had discharged to be reloaded for him while he took his deadly aim with the loaded gun. Aja)^ then a common soldier quietly crept into the bush behind him, going on all fours till he came near

enough to this marksman, and then suddenly shot him down dead. The assistant bolted clean away. Ajayi then cut off the Efon's head held it by the ear between his teeth being besmeared all over with blood, and with the man's guns on his shoulders came again to his comrades who raised for him a shout of triumph and acclaimed him " Ogboriefon " i.e. a carrier of the Efon's head.

He was always a poor man, for he spent too lavishly, but he was a brave and hardy soldier. This characteristic cleaved to him all through Ufe from a private to the post of commander-inchief and was the cause of many errors in his procedure which all but marred his career. For a long time his favourite companions were his only slave Jato, a man with a fair complexion, and his horse ; then some friends associated together and made him their leader, and thus by degrees he rose to a responsible position. His first military appointment was when he was created an Abese and sent to Ilora during the Ijaye war to reinforce the Oyo army against Iran. He was marched off with Ogunmola to Iwawun where he received a wound which nearly proved fatal to him.

The next period where he made a name was the Ilesa war, when he and Latosisa were stationed at the Odo road where he had to oppose Ogedemgbe and the army from the city, and Latosisa that from the country ; and Ogedemgbe capitulated to him.

The blot on his character was serious. He intrigued to get rid of Ajobo who had helped him to bear the expenses incidental to his taking office on filling the post of Osi Balogun which was bestowed upon him after the Ilesa war. Also his withdrawal from the coaHtion in the insurrection against the Are and the betrayal of lyapo. Added to these was the wholesale massacre of the I jesa, captives in the taking of the camp at Iba, for which however, he pleaded military necessity.

But there were pleasing traits in his character. His Uberality and humility gained him the respect of the soldiers and made his memory lasting. He will always be remembered as the hero of the Jalumi war. His

eldest son Babalola was his heir, and became the head of his house.

§ 3. The Ekitiparapos

Instead of tendering their submission as the Are thought they would do, the Ijesas, Ekitis, Efons and other tribes hitherto subjected to the Ibadans formed an alUance which they termed Ekiti parapo i.e. the Ekiti confederation. They raised a formidable army and were determined not only to liberate themselves but also to overrun the Oyo tribes right on to the Ibadan farms at the river Oba.

They invited Ogedemgbe to come over to lead them ; but this hardy warrior, having crossed swords more than once with the Ibadans was loth to do so again, but rather tried to see what might be done by entreaties and remonstrance in order to ameliorate the condition of his people. The arrogance of the Are made him deaf to reason ; he simply snubbed Ogedemgbe for his pains ; but this simple hearted soldier regarding his oaths to the Ibadans kept to his promise and for a long time never moved from his retreat. Meanwhile Fabumi of Oke Mesin headed the confederates and was on the march again for Ikirun ; the news of the death of the Balogun of Ibadan seemed to put more spirit and courage into them.

When the news of this reached Ibadan the Are ordered the Seriki to arrest their progress. The Seriki was very reluctant to go for two reasons. Firstly, he wished to be present at the funeral obsequies of the late Balogun his chief, but the urgency of the affairs in the north-eastern frontier brooked no delay. Secondly, he had been dipt of his wings as it were, for his Otun, Osi, and Ekerin had been ordered to Ofa and he was left singlehanded.

But he must obey orders, and thus he started for Ikirun. On reaching Iwo, he was detained by the venerable King of Iwo.

" What do you intend to do," asked he, " with such a small handful of men ? The Are could never have had the slightest idea -of the nature and strength of the confederacy." His Highness thereupon sent to Ibadan and acquainted the Are with the formidable nature of the task before him.

The Are with enemies all around him was trying to behave cautiously and with prudence : he did not know what the Egbas and Ijebus might do if the town were denuded of men ; however, he sent a small force to reinforce the Seriki at Iwo. The allies at this time were using all their endeavours to isolate Ibadan by cutting off all communications from it. At this crisis the Lisa of Ode Ondo sent messengers to Ibadan to inform the Are how the allies had offered him large presents to induce him to join the alliance, and close against the Ibadans the only route by which they could now communicate with the coast, viz, that by Oke Igbo, but he wished to be neutral. He might send if he Hked to verify his statements, and let his messengers see the presents for themselves. The Are repUed by sending the Lisa large presents and begged him to keep strictly neutral, and to keep that road open.

The Ijebu Remos in the So«th who are simple traders were much annoyed by this closure of the roads, which put a dead stop to their occupation. Ibadan is their only customer, but

their Suzerain the Awujale of Ode having joined the alliance, they were helpless. They however conceived an idea of sending to their countryman resident at Ibadan, Chief Soderinde the Balogun of the cavalry, to induce the Are to send another embassy to the Awujale and that they would act as a go-between. The Are was glad to comply with this request, but the Awujale took the presents and the slaves sent, but rejected the Remos as intermediaries.

The fact of his accepting the presents sent a ray of hope into the Are to make one more effort. He therefore summoned to him all the natives of Ijebu Ode resident at Ibadan with Abinusawa, an Ijebu Prince, at their head, one who had some influence at home and begged them to act as plenipotentiaries for him in arranging terms of friendship with the Ijebus. These were glad to be of some service to their hosts, and were confident of success. But they were not even allowed to reach the town of Ode, they were stopped at Aha by an Agurin and sent back with the following message : —

"Why should the Ibadans now desire our friendship? Let them remember the scant courtesy with which they have treated us in the past. When they were going to the Ijaye war we remonstrated with them but to no purpose. When we entreated them to receive back Ajobo expelled, they utterly refused even to take home his dead body. When they had differences with Efu§etan, Aijenku, lyapo we interfered and offered our good offices but were hot listened to. If they are tired of the war and want peace, let them first arrange with the Egbas, recall their troops from Of a and from Ikirun, and let the Are go to sleep."

This was the end of all negotiations with the Ijebus, but the Ijebu residents still continued to make efforts to negotiate, but the Are would not expose himself to another rebuff.

Once more the Lisa of Ondo sent messengers to Ibadan on hearing of the Balogun's death ; they brought the Are some presents and performed funeral obsequies for the late Balogun, kiUing a ram and pouring its blood on his grave.

§ 4. The Beginning of the Actual Conflict

The Seriki's forces met the confederates near Ikirun, and once more the clash of arms resounded between Oyos and Ekitis. After several battles, the Ekitis began to retreat before the Ibadans towards Mesin Ipole via Igbajo ;' this town was deserted at the approach of the alUes. The Seriki drove them beyond Igbajo and pitched his camp about a mile beyond, and from thence cleared

the undergrowth in the forest for miles in the direction of Mesin Ipole. Another reinforcement from Ibadan met him here in the person of Akintaro the newly-made Osi, and chief Aderibigbe. Here was enough force now to crush those opposed to them. The Are's young Chiefs could fight, but they lacked the wisdom gotten by experience.

The Ibadans were surprised to see the allies advancing to attack them in their camp through the openings they had made in the forest, and concluded that they must have received reinforcement from Ogedemgbe, the rumour of whose approach then filled the country. They therefore took the precaution of guarding the camp and the rear by the Osi whilst the Seriki advanced to the attack. The Seriki had his father's veterans about him who instructed him in all his movements, where he was to sit, and when he was to charge. There was a dreadful carnage that day on both sides. When at the right moment the Seriki (through his advisers) ordered a general charge, they found the Ekitis immovably firm as a rock ! From repeated conflicts, and from their former slaves, the Ekitis had grown accustomed to the methods of the Ibadans, and were prepared against them. There was then no help for it but to maintain their ground vis a vis whilst a desperate struggle ensued. At length, the Ibadans a little while after made a sudden dash and secured a prisoner. From the obstinate resistance offered, the Ibadans thought they were opposing Ogedemgbe, but the prisoner told them it was Fabumi of Oke M§sin. " Where is Ogedemgbe then ? " they asked, and were told, " Not yet come." And further : " Who lay in ambush at our rear? " "No one." " Where is the remnant of your army ? " " This is all." With this assurance the Seriki now sent to the camp for reinforcements. It was about 4 p.m. that the drum of Akintaro the Osi was heard coming, and when the Ekitis saw fresh troops coming they gave way and fled. But it was too late to pursue them far. The Osi's men claimed the honour of the victory as theirs, as the enemy did not dare to await their approach. Those who bore the brunt of the fight since morning were naturally hurt at this, and trifling as this circumstance might appear, it altered the character of the whole campaign, and the larger issues that depended upon it. Jealousy and rivalry now take the place of judgment and discretion.

Disaster upon disaster followed on both sides in subsequent battles ; the allies again and again sent repeated messages to call Ogedemgbe to their help. " We will fight now," said they, " to the best advantage, the Ibadan army is divided into three parts, one part at home to guard the town against the Egbas and Ijebus,

one part at Ofa against the Ilorins, and it is but a third part we have to oppose."

Ogedemgbe was a very straight-forward man, he was always true to his word. Although a sworn enemy to the Ibadans, yet he wished to be faithful to his covenant with them, for he had sworn never to oppose

them. On making Ita Ogbolu his headquarters for excursion into the Igbo Ani country, he sent to Ibadan, and the Are gave him a war standard, and also sent him a contingent consisting of his slaves and volunteers among the restless and warHke youths of Ibadan. Hence Ogedemgbe was reluctant to enter upon this war rashly. But he received invitations from all the aUies, as well as from the Egbas and Ijebus, Ibadan being conconsidered a formidable neighbour whose power they all dreaded and were resolved to see it crushed this time.

Ogedemgbe at last issued from Ita Ogbolu his retreat, and took the field at the head of the Ekiti parapos against the Ibadans.

On hearing this, the Ibadan war chiefs sent home again for more reinforcements, and on the 3rd November, 1879, the Are sent the following chiefs, viz.. Babalola the son and heir of the late Balogun Ogboriefon, Ojo late Bale Opeagbe's son, and Ogundepo the uncle of the Seriki.

It was the belief of the war chiefs that the Are deUberately planned to weaken them all one by one, so as to make room for his own son to be supreme over them, for instead of sending an adequate force which could deal with the whole affair in one blow he kept sending them by dribblets, promising each batch that whichever came out victorious would take the lead of the others, thus creating a spirit of jealousy among them. Hence every newcomer had to fight singlehanded, and never received support from those already in the field.

Babalola had to oppose Ogedemgbe at Kiriji as his father opposed him many years ago at Ilesa. The combatants met about three miles from Mesin Ipole, and Babalola fresh from home and probably in order to make a name, fought three successive battles which established his fame as a worthy heir of the hero of the Jalumi war. He bore the brunt of the battle with the Ekitis alone, the Seriki and all he met before him just sat in the battlefield surrounded by their men, all looking on, ready to retrieve a disaster should any occur.

A custom initiated by the late Balogun Ibikunle and Ogunmola at the time of the Ijaye war was still kept up for the war chiefs to have about them pages in training called " Baba ni lima sa " (the Master says I must not run away). They were all dressed in red uniforms and were to sit around their master whatever may be

the condition of the fight : they may be beyond gunshot, or equally exposed with their master in a close fight. Babalgla had about 400 of these ; at the first fight he lost 140 in killed and wounded. At the second fight he lost more, at the third fight they were wiped oat !

Thus the Are began by wasting their strength, and those in the field, out of jealousy of each other, played his game until experience brought about a better judgment when too late.

§ 5. The Are to the Front

Such was the state of affairs at the seat of war whilst the Are's son and his slaves and household war-boys were enjoying themselves at home, till they became surfeit with pleasure and all excesses, the report of which reached the war chiefs from time to time at the seat of war. Whenever the Ijebus or Egbas were descried kidnapping in Ibadan farms, the war chiefs at home would be sent after these, but the Are's sons and slaves .would march out leisurely after these in blazing costumes, and instead of pursuing after the enemy would contentedly encamp in the Ibadan farms, feeding on the crops and cutting down standing corn as fodder for their horses !

The war chiefs in the field having wasted their strength in the manner indicated above, and finding themselves as it were being over-ridden by the Are's sons and slaves, were resolved to invite himself to the war, to take command of the army in person, and when there they were determined to take revenge on him and his menials for all their insolent acts at home. By virtue of his title as Kakanfo he was bound to respond to his people's call, and consequently he sent to the King at Oyo to ask leave to take the field, and to return home within 17 days. The King granted his consent reluctantly, knowing that he was determined to go.

The Ar§ at this time exhibited some of the worst phases of human nature. At such a pitch of glory his word being law to all Ibadan and its dependencies, he became the dupe of his flatterers ; he considered himself a god and that nothing was impossible for him to effect. He certainly thought he would make a short and

easy work of the task before him, but the chiefs who invited him to the war had a different plan in their head. Their resolve was to humble his pride, and to avenge the death of Aijenku and that of lyapo, the late Seriki in particular, both of whom he ordered to "go to sleep."

Sanusi, the Are's eldest son, further exasperated the war-chiefs

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by the impudent songs he permitted his bards to indulge in at

their expense ; thus :

The expedition that occupied Akere's son^ three years, The war over which Awarun's son* has spent six months in

vain, But one day will it take Alabi', son of lyanda Arc*, With silver-studded hands he'll extricate and bring them home.

Again they sang :

A club is thrown at a lime.

Both hme and club got entangled.

And the stick and the lime,

lyanda's son will disentangle and bring home.

But there were those even among his followers at home who dishked these proceedings. Many were the followers of Sumonu, the Are's nephew, who was a more affable and good-natured fellow and much preferred to Sanasi. The followers of the latter, noticing this, permitted his drummer to beat :

" Sanusi jgba na a gbg ni Kanu,

Iro, irg, Aremo ko pe meji." (That Sanusi is supreme is known up to Kanu, Nay, nay, two heirs there cannot be.)

The retort to this came from the populace in theii; dances :

" To prostrate to father, and then to the son, I cannot stoop to two at once. And where is such a thing ever done ? On the hilltop is such a thing done."

The Ar§'s house at Ibadan is on the top of a hill. All these sayings and doings were duly reported in the camp, and the war chiefs there were resolved to have these high-flown talkers in the camp, where only valour counts.

The Are, in order to strike a blow with effect, recalled Ali the Otun Balogun and Akintola the late lyapg's brother from Ofa to join him at the camp. Akintgla preceded Ali to the camp and, as a young Mggaji he also was allowed to fight a battle singlehanded as each of his predecessors had done. He distinguished himself above them all ; by a flank movement he bore down on Ogedemgbe suddenly with a vigorous onslaught, surprised and captured him, but he was let off. It was not the intention of these

iThe Osi. ^ xhe Seriki. » His own attributive. * His father's attributive and totem.

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war-chiefs to defeat their enemy to the Are's advantage, but each of them wished to show what he can do.

Ogedemgbe fell into the hands of one of Akintola's slaves who said to him, " Ologun, yara, Oyo nbo " (Captain be quick, Oyos are coming.) The hide on which he was sitting, the kegs of gunpowder all about him, his charms and amulets were all taken, the Ijesas were utterly discomfited, but Akintgla withdrew and there was no further fighting that day.

But the result of this fight was to drive the allies to a vigorous preparation for a more desperate resistance, especially as they heard that the Are was coming. It was reported that Ogedemgbe, on hearing the rumour

of the Are's coming, sent a messenger to ask him whether the report was true, and if so, in regard to the oath he had taken, and for past favours he had received from him, he was loth to meet in the field a chief who had given him the war standard he was using. He would therefore retire with half the Ekiti forces, leaving the rest for an easy conquest ; only he prayed for his clemency towards his countrymen. So faithful and honest was Ogedemgbe, But the Are, instead of returning courtesy for courtesy, proudly dared him to remain if he would share the fate of those he would soon crush under his heels !

But Ogedemgbe, out of deference to the Are, sent another private messenger to meet him at Osogbo on the same errand. The Are's answer was, " Is he still there and not gone away yet ? Well, he will have himself to thank for the consequences." Ogedemgbe and his countrymen were fighting for freedom ; courtesy and generosity he was prepared to yield to, but threats and defiance he was determined to meet with obstinate resistance.

The Are, on reaching Irehe went by Otan and intended to take the Ekitiparapos in the rear, thus placing them between two fires. But the Ibadan chiefs lest their plans should be defeated grew excited, sent urgent messages after messages entreating him to come to them to the camp and take no other course. Said they : " The veterans and the flower of your army are here in the camp, who are those about you with whom you would risk your safety by taking another course ? They are but slaves who will desert you at the sound of the first gun. Not so did Lakanle of old when our fathers called him to their help at Iperu in olden days. As he went straight to them so do you come to us now and lead us to victory."

In the meantime the Ijesas, hearing the Are was contemplating another route, were determined to checkmate him. Ogedemgbe left the command with one Olubayode, a great war -chief, and took with him his well-trained veterans to waylay the Are and if

possible to take him alive. He was rather disappointed at the Are's being dissuaded from carrying out his plan. He missed his game.

The war-chiefs' estimate of the value and fighting quahties of the Are's slaves and household officers was not from spite but from actual fact ; they had learnt to appraise them at their true valuation in the Ado and Aiyede wars and in the raids on Egba farms especially before Osiele. They were no longer the hardy and trusty veterans of the Ilesa and other wars when there was keen rivalry between them and the late Ajayi Ogboriefon. A hfe of ease and debauchery had since brought about degeneracy ; they were more distinguished for displaying red and showy uniforms, sitting round their master and boasting of past deeds.

The Ibadan war-chiefs entered into a secret compact before the Are's arrival never to achieve a conquest or capture a town while he was living, for, said they, "What is the use ? The lion's share of our achievements will go to him, and we shall only help to increase the number of his slaves who are now lording it over us."

The Are again on arriving at the camp did not call them all together and harangue them or praise them for what they had done. On the contrary his son Sanusi marched straight on through the camp and pitched his tent in a field of standing corn which the Ibadans had planted outside the camp. " Cut all down," said he "we do not need it, how long are we going to stay here ?" He had cause to regret this afterwards.

The Are led the host to the field the next day, the 4th of May, 1880. The war-chiefs fought with their accustomed bravery to show him what they could do, but no more. At the first onslaught the Ijesa chief Olubayode was caught and slain, the Ijesa army became demoralized, and gave way ; the Ibadan warboys pursued them right into the gates of Mesin Ipole. The Ibadan war-chiefs seeing this passed the word round from mouth to mouth, " Afaro, afaro," i.e., " Refrain, refrain " (or " halt, halt.")

The Ajero saved the situation for the Ekitis that day, for seeing all in full retreat he stood by the gate of the town, and the first Ibadan boy that entered he shot down dead ; the others, seeing no war-chief or leader of any kind behind them, retreated hastily. The Ibadan war-chiefs sat in groups, each under a tree here and there in the battlefield surrounded by their men as if resting for a while, but the Are could not get them to do anything more than skirmishing that day. He took in the situation at a glance, and was determined to sleep on the battlefield that day, and offer battle the next day, although it was pouring with rain, and there was no shelter. Cold and wet he was advised to return to the camp.

but he at first refused to do so ; then the chiefs and elders of his house approached him and remonstrated with him, sajdng, " It is folly to remain on the battlefield ; we are all wet, and it is still raining. Suppose the Ekitis were to fall upon us in the night, it will be all to their advantage, because they will come from home quite fresh, with ammunition dry," The Are was sore at heart, recalling the achievements of his old rival and comrade the hero of the Jalumi war. That he, the Kakanfo, should not be able to achieve as much and a great deal more was a mixture of shame, pain and grief to him. With great difficulty he was prevailed upon to return to the camp for the night, and the fight was resumed the next day.

The secret combination against the Are was divulged to him by Chief Aderibigbe, probably with the hope of his making amends to the war-chiefs, but the Arg, instead of calling these young men together and pacifying them, answered with some asperity, " I have fought in front of their fathers and it is now their turn to fight for me and they will not ; as we are all equally concerned, let us agree to remain indifferent."

The Ekitiparapos, on the other hand, fighting as they were for their independence, went on strengthening their forces by drawing recruits from the utmost bounds of the country behind them, throughout the Ijesa, Ekiti, Efon, Yagba and Akoko countries right on to Egbe. They further strengthened their alHance with the Ilorins by an exchange of troops. One Ogunmodede with a strong force of Ijesas, was sent to the Ilorin camp, and the Ilorins sent one Lasebikan with his men to the Ekiti camp. This arrangement, we should rather say, was an astute measure of the Ilorins by which they retained a firm hold on the Ekitis, so that they could not withdraw from the alliance even if they wished to do so, and this proved to be the case many years afterwards as we shall see in due course.

The allies had also the great advantage over the Ibadans, in that they had free access to Benin for ammunition whilst nearly all the roads were closed to the Ibadans. Long flintlock guns with large muzzles were imported from Benin ; these, when fully loaded and fired, gave a report which reverberating from hill to hill all around sounded like Ki-ri-ji-i, from which this war was named the Kiriji Campaign.

Famine soon broke out among the Ibadans, the provisions they brought from home were exhausted, and the standing corn around the camp had been cut down by Sanusi to make room for his tents. The common soldiers had now to live on palm nuts, certain edible roots, and whatever they could procure from the forests

to sustain life, whilst there was plenty in the town for the alhes.

The Are, to emphasize his determination to see that this business should at once come to a finish, removed the camp to the spot where he sat at his first battle, called Elebolo, from the abundance of the herb Ebolo in ^he place. The Ekitis, to show their determination to resist him, left the town of Mesin Ipole and encamped on the spot where Babalola fought his three celebrated battles ; and so both camps stood face to face to each other surrounded on all sides by high mountains, deep ravines and craggy rocks. It seemed Providence had brought both armies into this defile, to teach them a lesson. In the day of battle there was no room for them to deploy, the situation being worse for the Ibadans than for the Ekiti mountaineers in their native mountains. The battles now became more frequent and bloody, and at every fight the Ibadans lost one or more distinguished war-cTiiefs.

At a battle on the i8th May Kupolu, the Commander of the infantry of the Are's bodyguard, was killed, and Akintaro the Osi Balogun was mortally wounded.

On the ist of June died Opehinde, one of the chiefs left in charge of the town.

On the nth of June Ajenigbe the Ekerin was mortally wounded. He died the next day.

Chief Oluferegbe, Kongi's stepfather, also fell in battle.

On the 31st August a sanguinary battle was fought at Kiriji with heavy losses on both sides.

Thus for a long period of time a serious battle or a skirmish took place nearly every other day with heavy losses on both sides.

Chapter XXV

IBADAN AT ITS EXTREMITY— BLOODY STRIFES.

§ I. Home Defences

The preceding section has given us an idea of how matters were for the Ibadans at Kiriji. Now, whilst all this was going on at the seat of war, the Ijebu and Egba kidnappers were not inactive at home, raiding the Ibadan farms, sometimes successfully, but sometimes repulsed, but making farming risky and unsafe until a scheme was evolved of a complete organization for home defence. There are three main points from which the attacks may be expected (a) the farms contiguous to those of the Egbas ; (b) the route leading to Ijebu Igbo ; and (c) that leading to Ijebu Ode. Arrangements were perfected by building forts in a central point in each of these main routes, for the better protection of the farmers. Whilst the hunters were in the forests, hunting for game and on the look-out for kidnappers, the farmers could work in their farms with composure and confidence. They were instructed to hasten to the forts with their women and children at a given signal by the hunters. The men went to their farms well armed, and were ready for any emergency.

The fort in the direction of the Egbas was left in charge of some hunters, and a few old warriors left at home. But the Egbas once surprised the fort at Itosi and carried away much people ; some of them, however, were rescued by the hunters who pursued after the kidnappers.

In the direction of Ijebu Igbo, where the forest was thickest, the forts were in charge of the principal hunters, the chief of these were Ajiya, Obisesan, Odeyale. These kept the fort while the younger hunters were dispersed about in the forests. The fort was the rendezvous of the women and children. By this arrangement the defeat of the Ijebus became such a constant and regular thing that the vulgar people put it into a song :

Are de, are de. For the flight, for the flight,

Igbayi Tare ma de o. Now is the time to flee,

Oni yoyo-gb. Ye clothed in Yoygg5.

Yoyggb is a coarse and loosely woven sort of cloth which the Ijebus were accustomed to wear at this period.

The fort in the direction of Ijebu Ode was built at the point of

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divergence of the roads leading to Ijebu Ode and Ijebu Remo, the convergence of the roads being at the middle of the fort, enclosed with a wall all round. This was in charge of certain cavalrymen left in town, there being no scope for their services among the crags of Kiriji, Associated with these were the Sango chief priest and one Ogungbesan.

The only fight which took place in this direction was on Palm Sunday, the loth of April, i88r, and was far-reaching in its results. When the alarm was given, a mounted messenger was sent post haste to the town to call up those in charge of this direction. Solaja and Sonik^n, sons of Soderinde theBalogun of the Cavalry, performed feats of valour that day, and distinguished themselves. In the thick of the fight, Solaja with his horse dashed into the Ijebus, knocking down two or three, and returned with a captive on his horse. Seeing this, Sonikan the elder brother, not to be outdone by his younger brother, performed the like feat, and also returned with a captive. This was a signal for a general rout. The Ijebus, who scarcely ever saw a horse in their country and could not face a cavalry charge, gave way and were pursued as far as Odo Ona kekere in the Ijebu Ode route, and about 20 captives were taken among them. At Odo Ona kekere, the Ijebus met reinforcements and there they made a stand. The struggle here was fierce and obstinate, and the brave captain of the Ijebus, whilst leading and encouraging his men, was shot down dead : a general rout was the consequence, and in the pursuit, among other captives made, was Omitogun, the brother of the old Balogun of the Ijebus.

This distinguished captive was well treated at Ibadan. When the report of what had taken place reached the camp, the war chiefs sent back to say that Omitogun was to be allowed to go back home to arrange for his own ransom and on his own terms ; but that he was to exert his influence at home with the authorities there so that the roads may be opened for trade, remembering that they never had any quarrel with the

Ijebus, and never attacked their farms, and that the Egbas, whose cause they said they were espousing, had slyly opened a roundabout road for themselves via Eruwa to trade with the interior Yorubas.

Omitogun himself had another tale to tell. He bought and took home with him some corn, beans, etc., to show his people at home. Ibadan, which was reported to be on its last leg and on the verge of starvation, was actually revelling in plenty such as they never enjoyed at home ! The farmers had no outlet for their produce whilst the Ijebus, who are nearly all traders were sorely in need of foodstuffs.

This circumstance made a deep impression on the Ijebus, there was no more raiding in this direction. Its further development had a far-reaching effect which, bore fruit in the following year, as we shall see.

§ 2. Closure of Roads and the Results

The greatest needs of the Ibadans now were ammunition and salt, and the only route by which they could obtain them even in small quantities was- the roundabout way via Oke Igbo to Ondo and thus to the coast. Hence they endeavoured to keep on friendly terms with Derin Ologbenla, the Bale of Oke Igbo, and humoured him every now and then by sending him presents of slaves.

Derin was an Ife prince, and as to the Ifes themselves, although their army was in the Ibadan camp, yet their sympathies were all on the other side.

But it happened in March, 1881, that the Ibadans suspecting treachery in a town named Ogu, situated between He Ife and Ilesa, sent a small force secretly by Awo, son of the late Labosinde, against the place, to capture it by surprise in order to keep their rear clear of any trouble But all the towns in the neighbourhood were in the secret of the expedition and in sympathy with the Ekitis as men striking for freedom, therefore it leaked out. Osu was prepared and reinforced against a surprise, and hence the expedition failed.

The town of Osu not being far from the city of Ifg, to suspect Osu is to suspect Ife itself, and Derin of Oke Igbo, taking this as a cause of offence, openly declared tor the Ekitis and endeavoured to close even this road to all Oyos by allowing the Ijesas to kidnap caravans on the road. But the Ogunsua or Bale of Modakeke, knowing that the safety of his town is linked with that of Ibadan, by protecting caravans arid attacking kidnappers did not allow the road to be altogether closed. In vain the Ifes tried to win the Ogunsua over : the position of Modakeke to Ife is analogous to that of Belfast to the south of Ireland ; the. Modakekes are Oyos and of the same tribal affinity with Ibadan with which their own safety is linked.

The price of salt rose so high that a pound of salt could not be had for less than ten shillings when it could be obtained at all. Poor people therefore could not even think of preparing their meals with salt ; those who could obtain a few grains of it, ate their meals insipid, and then qualified the tastelessness in their mouths with the few grains of salt afterwards !

But the distress in the country was not all on one side. The Egbas also were indirectly affected by this closure of the roads

against the interior tribes. They were free to trade wdth Lagos indeed, but they wanted produce from the interior and slaves to work their farms. They therefore managed to open a circuitous route to Ketu and Ejio, where they and the Porto Novians estabhshed a market to trade with all Oyos from different parts of the country, but they still rigidly excluded the sale of ammunition, only cloth and salt were the articles of merchandise, and even this was considered a godsend by the interior folks, for their distress from want of salt was by this greatly aJleviated.

An anecdote from an actual occurrence will forcibly illustrate the point of desperation to which these people were driven at this time :

A man with his wife and daughter — a marriageable young woman — went to Ejio to trade. At the close of the fair, the woman was being taken away by an Egba man ; a hue and cry was immediately raised, and the Egba was arrested as a manstealer. He denied the charge and told his tale. The woman had been bartered to him for salt and cloth, he only claimed what was his by right. Upon investigation it was found that he

was quite right, the seller was the woman's own daughter ! She had bartered away her own mother for salt ! But the man could not allow his wife to be taken away, a compromise must be made. So after he and the woman had consulted together they agreed that this undutiful daughter was to be given to the Egba in exchange : they showed him that the mother was old and would be of little service to him, whereas the young woman might be taken by him for a wife and that they, the parents, would regard the cloths and salt as an adequate dowry given by him. The Egba man was highly pleased with the offer and went home delighted with having had the best of the bargain, and the parents on the other hand were satisfied that to all intents and purposes their daughter had been comfortably settled. This was by no means a solitary instance of desperate acts such as this.

The distress at the seat of war at this time was indescribable : the Oke Igbo road being closed there was a great dearth of ammunition. The Ekitis knowing this from escaped slaves often came as near as possible to the gate of the camp and assaulted them. The Ibadan army would be drawn up but they could not return the fire of the enemy. They could hardly muster 100 kegs of powder throughout the whole army, and this they reserved for an extreme case of emergency. The writer was present in the camp on one such occasion, when Chief Babalola sent a slave wife of his round to all the traders present in the camp for even a handful of powder if possible. From private soldiers who had not

exhausted their allowance, and others who did not use theirs in previous fights she collected a small quantity in exchange for food ! The writer being a friend of the Seriki's brother, asked him confidentially on that occasion, " Supposing the Ijesas and Ekitis were to come upon you suddenly one day to rush the camp, what will you do ? " He replied, " 'Tis true we have no ammunition, but there are not wanting among us about 5,000 accomplished swordsmen who will be more than a match for the Ekitis with their guns at close quarters, and they know it or they would have attempted to do so."

Further, the Ekitis often taunted them by appearing on tbp of a rock where they could well be seen by the Ibadans, and tantalized them by emptying kegs of gunpowder on the rock, throwing a lighted torch on the pile, and blazing all away.

The muster for battle at this time took place almost every day. The Ekitis came as near as possible to the camp, firing into it. The method adopted by the Ibadans to meet the present crisis was to assemble near the gate of the camp, and thence make a sudden and vigorous dash on the Ekitis driving them back to the battlefield : then the swordsmen would spread thernselves in the valley and trenches awaiting those who would venture near ; the Ekitis being on higher ground could be seen by them much sooner. Now and then as opportunity offered they would pounce upon them sword in hand, and often come back with captives. Thus they would hold out till about five or six in the evening before the main Ibadan army marched out, when they could not all fire more than one round before nightfall.

For months and months affairs dragged on in this way, each party being afraid of the other. The sentries at the camp gate were doubled for fear of a night attack.

On one occasion a few kegs of powder were obtained at Ejio at a very high price ; when these reached the camp such a shout of joy was raised as if they had won a victory ; a Feu de joie was fired that evening. The shout was heard at the Ekiti camp. But this joy was short lived, for a grave danger threatened the Yoruba country from another direction.

§ 3. Distressing Episodes

A. Dahomian Invasion. — The Dahomians, who had hitherto confined their depredations to the Egba and Egbado districts, now for the first time advanced into the western districts of Yoruba proper. The Ibadans, since the destruction of Ijaye, on whom it would have devolved to meet this threatened danger, heard this news with chagrin ; they could only chafe but could

render no help in that quarter. In fact it was their pre-occupation that rendered such unprovoked invasion possible. It was said that the Dahomian guide and counsellor in this enterprise was Afin the Chief of Ketu,

and in May, 1881, the following towns were taken : Ejio, Obaniiisunwa, Ilaji, Atasa, Oke'le, Iwere, Aiyetor6 and Igana.

Lawore the Asejdn marched out in defence of the district but he narrowly escaped with his life ; at Igana a young man who, kneeling before him, was shooting arrows on the enemy was suddenly approached by the Dahomians and his head taken off ! The Aseyin himself had to escape on horseback.

This conduct of Afin in introducing the Dahomians into this part of the country gave pain to all, but retributive justice soon overtook him, for at the next campaign of the Dahomians, his own town Ketu was taken and himself slain. The other towns taken with Ketu were Idikumo, Iselu, Dain, etc.

Ketu is an ancient town bordering on the Sabe and Oyo countries. It is a place badly watered, their drinking water being miles away from the town. They used deep underground tanks for storing rain water. The scarcity of water in Ketu has passed into a proverb. " Omi d'oyin ni Ketu " (" Water becomes honey in Ketu "). The destruction of Ketu was about the 17th of July, 1886.

In order to record all the ravages of the Dahomians together we shall have to anticipate the dates of events in the history.

Their third campaign was again in the western districts of Yoruba Proper — Ilesan, Ibise, Oke Amu, Ago, Iluku, Gbagba, Ago Sabe, Irawo, Owg, and for the second time Ilaji, were all destroyed. This was in 1887,

Their fourth campaign was against the towns bordering on Egba districts, and also on the western districts. Berekodo, Oke Tapa, Aiyete, Bako, Gangan, Igbo Osa, Idgfin, Idire, Papa, Gbunginu were all taken. Eruwa was deserted. This was about the year 1890.

Thus far they went, when a higher Power decreed their fall ; they were themselves subjugated by the French.

Travellers in the western districts will find all the towns enclosed in double walls. The city of Oyo was connected with the village of Awe by a wall. This outer wall was called " Odi Amol^," or by some, " Odi Amonu." The former term indicates " The Wall of Safety," used by those to whom it has proved a source of safety and the latter term, " The Wall of Loss," used by those to whom it has proved unavailing for security.

B. Destruction of He Bioku. — He Bioku was one of the Yoruba

towns in the Oke Ogun district between Eruwa and Is§yin, and consequently under the protection of the Ibadans.

The following is a short history of its foundation and destruction.

He Bioku was quite a modern town built by two friends, Bioku and Lebebi, Bioku being the Chief. It was one of the towns beautifully situated on a hill and easily defended against a hostile attack, and consequently, for the safety it afforded, it got peopled rapidly and soon became a prosperous town.

There were several men of note in this town besides the founders, e.g., Oguntaiye the Areagoro, Odunmbaku the Ikolaba, Ar§mu the Jagun, Alawo and his son Ladipo (both being men of note), also Oje, Adebawonpe, and Maborisaj§.

Bioku lived to a good old age, and the town prospered under him. At his death he was succeeded by Lebebi the co-founder. Oyedokun, son of Bioku, was the head of his house. But Lebebi did not outhve Bioku long, he also died and was succeeded by Ajadi as the head of his house. Oyedokun, son of Bioku, now became the head chief of the town, and so the succession would have continued in the two famihes alternately had all continued well.

Alawo also died about the same time and was succeeded by his son Ladipo. Oyedokun, son of Bioku, however, was a bad ruler ; he soon disgusted all the chief men in the town. When he could no longer be endured Ajadi, the next man to him as ruler, left the town with a large following and founded a settlement at the foot of the hill, leaving He Bioku to Oyedokun and his party.

In order to avenge himself for this defection Oyedokun sent to Ibadan to invite an army to destroy the new settlement ; but the Are Latosisa, then at the head of Ibadan, sent one Aiyeleru to reconcile the two parties, but he failed in bis efforts and returned to Ibadan.

Now, with the Ibadans away from home, Oyedokun sent a similar message to Chief Ogundipe at Abeokuta to come and destroy the new settlement. Ogundipe responded to the call with alacrity and came with an Egba army, as he had been seeking occasion to go against Itabg, a small suburb town of He Bioku.

The alleged cause of offence to Ogundipe was that when the Egbas fled from Ijaye in March, 1862, one of his wives (then in delicate state) fell into the hands of an Itabo man. Chief Ogundipe offered to redeem her, but the man refused to part with her. After t-ie child was born Ogundipe sent two slaves to the man in exchange for mother and child, but the man still declined the offer. For this reason Ogundipe now embraced this opportunity of going against the settlement of He Bioku hoping to recover his wife and

child at the suburb. His route lay through Eruwa, he invited the Bale of this town to join him, but he declined. But Ogundipe having gone forward, the Bale went with an army by a shorter route to assist the doomed town, their kith and kin.

The Egbas were actually repulsed by this handful of men of the new settlement, and were in full retreat when Omisina, Oyedokun's brother sent to tell Ogundipe not to lose such a splendid chance of victory by retreating so hastily as the ammunition of his foes was all but exhausted and the Egbas had victory close at hand. Ogundipe, hearing this, returned to the attack, and ammunition failing the men of the new settlement, the town was taken. Of the chiefs who escaped were : — Ajadi, Ladipo, Adewggba. Omisina the traitor was hunted down by the remnant of the people and was discovered in a cave at Itabo, thence he was brought back, slain, and his family sold into slavery.

In order to avenge themselves on Oyedokun the remnant that escaped sent to him a message of submission and offer of reconciliation. Negotiations followed and all the terms of peace settled, it only remained for him to come down from the hill to perfect the terms which could not be conveniently carried out by messengers. He did so, and as the men lay prostrate before him and pourparlers were going on, all of a sudden they rushed upon him and butchered him to pieces ; and in order to show their abhorrence of him they roasted his flesh in the fire and had a taste of it all round.

Thus the remnant that escaped gathered themselves together and formed another settlement in the plain opposite IleBioku, and they called it Lanlat^ and had Ajadi as their Bale.

The remnant of the old town of He Bioku soon joined them here. Like all other Oke Ogun towns, the people of this place are industrious, food is plentiful and they seem quite contented.

§4. New Developments, Clouds and Sunshine

After the Dahomian invasion and the destruction of the market towns of Ejio and Ketu distress prevailed again in the country. At this crisis the AlAfin of Oyo sent a special deputation to Abeokuta to negotiate through Chief Ogundipe foi the opening of the roads for salt. It was an open secret that the AlAfin connived at the combination against the Ibadans and the consequent closure of the roads ; but the want of salt touched even His Majesty himself as well as his people ; hence his action.

At this period the ruling chiefs of Abeokutu were four, viz., Ogundipe the Balogun of Ikija, Onlado of Kemta, Ogundeyi of Iporo, and the Jaguna of Igbein. Ogimdipe was the leading chief.

Onlado was at the head of all the Ogbonis, and Ogundeyi of the war party, the Alake being a nonentity. It was said that Ogundipe and Onlado were more in consort, the public meetings were generally convened either at Ogundipe's gate or in the front of Sodeke's house. Ogundipe was always the spokesman, queer in his ways but shrewd in his methods. He generally spoke in his own name. Public acts were said to be done by his order, but he was only carrying out the conclusions which himself and his colleagues had arrived at.

Thus it was given out that the Eruwa road to Oyo had been opened under the auspices of Chief Ogundipg. Eruwa now became the market town for the exchange of commodities with the further interior.

It was also shrewdly suspected that Ogundipe, as the friend of the Are of Ibadan, was doing his utmost to relieve the Ibadans at this time. He had always been against the closure of the roads, but he could not get his colleagues to see with him. Cloth, salt and spirits were the articles sent to the Eruwa market in exchange for slaves and produce from the interior, but all but one of the socalled demijohns of rum, and cases of gin sent up by Ogundipe, were gunpowder secretly being sent to the Are. , The gatemen at the tall gates were supposed to know nothing about them, a glass of rum or of gin was poured out of the genuine package for them and the whole passed free, especially as it was known to be Ogun-ˆ dipe's, and this particular road was under the charge of the Egba Oke Ona, of whom Ogundipe was the head, as the river route was under the immediate charge of the Egba Agbeyin. This favour of Ogundipe's was highly appreciated by the Ibadans.

This Eruwa market was called the Erebe market, only guns and gunpowder were prohibited as articles of trade.

But the road to Eruwa was now and again infested by two notable highway robbers, Kurakura, a Gambari slave of Chief Ogundeyi, and Gata, an Ilorin outcast, a notorious robber. Both of them were sharing the spoils with their masters, of whom Ogumefun was one. One-fourth of the booties went to them, the remaining three-fourths to the robbers themselves.

In spite of this, the Eruwa market and the secret supply of Ogundipe were a great boon to the Ibadans but for the supply of a whole army something more was required, hence all their efforts were bent on keeping the Oke Igbo route open.

Derin the Chief of Oke Igbo now the Oni elect of Ife, seemed at this time to have the key of the whole situation in his hands, and his favour and goodwill were sought by all. The Ibadans sent him slaves, and excellent native cloths and other valuables as presents that he might keep the road open. The Ilorins sent

him horses, the Ekiti kings sent him baskets of kola nuts and other valuable presents, and other costly presents came also from Ijebu and from Abeokuta that he might keep the road closed.

The Ogunsua of Modakeke refused to ally himself with the Ifes, and a well-to-do Ofa man resident at Oke Igbo was as a bone in Derin's throat, as the safety of their respective towns depended upon the safety of the Ibadans. So this road could not be altogether closed.

About this time the rumour spread that Derin of Oke Igbo with the confederates sent to tell the Ibadan chiefs that if they wished for peace they should send to beg the King for he also had his grievance. There was his nephew Lawani harboured at Ibadan, who, on leaving Oyo, emptied the palace of all the royal treasures so that he, the AlAfin, was practically a poor King. To this the Ibadans replied, " He is our prince, what can we do to him ? We cannot eject him out of the town, and we cannot touch his property, since he was allowed to leave Oyo with all he brought with him we cannot question his right to them." However, they sent accredited messengers to Oyo to beg the King to arrange matters for them, pledging their devotion and loyalty to him.

His Majesty, as was his wont, returned them a fair answer, and sent them a few Oyo fighting men and a Babalawo (Ifa priest) ostensibly to make charms for their success : but the Ibadans, having reason to believe that the action of the priest was just to the contrary, drove him out of the camp.

About this time Sneider rifles were introduced by the Ijesas. The Ijesas at Lagos purchased a large quantity with cartridges for their country people " for the defence of the fatherland." At first the Ibadans did not know what they were nor their deadly character ; they made a mock of them for the Ijesas did not know how to use them properly. Being short compared with their long Dane guns, and making but little noise when fired, they called out to the Ijesas in jest, " Are you reduced to using tobacco pipes now ? Do send me one " (O ku temi o). But the scene was soon changed when certain Ijesa young men who had learnt the use of these weapons at Abeokuta during the Dahomian invasions there came over to teach and to help their

people in the use of them, Labirinjo of Lagos, Gureje and Apara of Abeokuta being the principal leaders. Moreover they formed a rifle corps which they carefully instructed.

These new weapons of precision now struck terror into the Ibadans. " What is this ? " " What is this ? " they began to say when they saw their effects upon the body of the slain. To quote an instance: — In the battle fought on the 15th May, 1881,

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Chief Akintola was shot through the leg as he sat on horseback, the same bullet killed the horse and a page standing by ! To make matters worse for the Ibadans, their precarious supply of the coarse gunpowder for their Dane guns was exhausted. They were greatly perturbed by this new development, thinking that the British Government at Lagos must be supplying the Ekitis with new weapons, especially when they saw the rifle corps in uniform. From a great distance in the battlefield men, women and children were shot dead within the Ibadan camp, some mortallj' wounded, others crippled for life !

Ogedemgbe accorded these rifles a doubtful welcome. "Sooner or later," said he, "the Oyos will get possessed of similar weapons, and what is to become of us then, unless we can finish them up before they do, which is very doubtful ?"

It became a matter of great difficulty for the Ibadans to muster together and troop into the battlefield on the day of battle. When they assembled at the gate of exit the rifles wrought havoc amongst them, every man had to try and find his way through nooks and corners, crawljng along valleys, picking out shelters till they could approach near enough within the range of their Dane guns, to return the fire : others, sword or cutlass in hand, would crawl still nearer to pounce upon them. In this way some Ijesas were caught with rifles and cartridges which were examined with great curiosity. They were so perplexed in mind that they sent home for a native missionary — one of their sons — and laid this matter before him. "Why should the Lagos Government supply the Ekitis with such weapons to fight us ?" It was then explained to them that the Lagos Government had nothing to do with it ; the Ijesas at Lagos formed a committee which purchased these weapons, and sent them up via Aiyesan, Itebu, to Ondo, and thence to Ilesa to assist their countrymen.

" Can any of you chiefs be held responsible for whatever a man may buy at the Ibadan markets and bazaars for their friends at Oyo and Ogbomoso ? — No. — So then this matter stands."

Still, they were hardly satisfied, feehng that such strange weapons and men to teach the use of them could not have left Lagos without the Governor's knowledge.

At this crisis they sent again to the Awujale of Ij§bu on the 28th June, 1881, craving either for the opening of the roads or for his arbitration : but the Ijebus did not even allow the messengers to enter the town of Ijebu Ode ; they were refused a hearing.

Now, about the month of August, 1881, Derin of Oke Igbo as the Owoni elect of Ife came forward, professing to arrange terms of peace for the belligerents. His messengers met those of the

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Ibadans and the Ekitis on the battlefield and everything was arranged for the restoration of peace, but the whole thing broke down when it came to the last point, who was to decamp first. The Ijesas said, " We are in our country and you came from afar, how can you say we should leave our country ? " The Ibadans rephed, " Nobody said you were to leave your country, you are only asked to retire from the camp into the town of Mesin Ipole behind you, so as to give us the chance to extricate ourselves from the defile through which we must pass. Bitter experience has taught us never to decamp in the face of an enemy for thus it was in 1865 when decamping from Iperu after peace had been made between us and the Egbas and Ijebus, the Egbas pursued after us, and we bought our retreat dearly. Should we repeat the same thing here under the very eyes of the Ekitis it will mean annihilation for us in these ravines and precipices. Retire to the town and so put some distance between us, and we will then decamp."

As neither party would agree to decamp first the negotiations failed and the war was resumed.

At this failure of the negotiations the people began to murmur against the Are for bringing all these troubles

upon them ; matters came to such a pass that the Are, on the ist September, was going to take poison and put an end to his hfe, but his family and the chiefs begged him not to do so. “It is God’s will that things should be so,” said they. ” Such a thing has never happened to us before, but God wills it so.”

On the i8th September, 1881, they sent again to the Awujale, and again he would neither arbitrate nor open the roads, but sent them a taunting reply, ” If you are tired of the war, come home.” They returned the reply, ” How can we come? We are in a defile.”

The Ijesa rifle corps still continued to do havoc amongst the Ibadans. On the 26th December the Ibadans received a terrible blow by the death of Belo, the brave son of the late Osundina (whose younger brother became afterwards so well known as Chief Apampa). He was a born soldier, and second to none in the whole camp. The death produced such a shock that his body could not be taken to the camp for fear of causing a panic ; from the battlefield it was conveyed outside the camp walls to Ikirun for interment. The mourning for this chief was deep and universal, for he was a very good man. On the news reaching home, all markets and bazaars were broken up for the whole day and the town went into mourning. Thus bloody strife continued on both sides for months and years. R

Chapter XXVI

FAILURES AT RECONCILIATION

§ I. The AlAfin’s Efforts for Peace

After the failure of Derin’s efforts, circumstances compelled the AlAfin to make a genuine effort for the restoration of peace.

(a) The Dahomian ravages of the western district, and the threats to ” visit Oyo this coming dry season.”

(b) The men of the frontier towns sent to him to say that they will all desert their towns if the King could not send an army to protect them.

But the King’s most effective army are the Ibadans, and those with them and they are pre-occupied.

On the gth of October, 1881, he sent for the Rev. D. Olubi of Ibadan as head of the missionaries in the interior at the time, and with him ” any two of his sensible colleagues.” The order was obeyed on the 12th and the interview took place on the 13th.

There were present at the interview :

Two Oyg officials, viz., The-Olosi, who is the King’s vade mecum as it were, and the Apeka, who is the white men’s intermediary with the court.

Also Mr. Jonathan Ojelabi, the foremost Christian gentleman at Oyo at the time. These are of Oyo. The Rev. D. Olubi, Mr. J. Okusehinde, and the writer, both Catechists under Mr. Olubi at Ibadan. Also Mr. A. F. Foster, by whom the letter to Mr. Olubi was written for the King, being the C.M.S. Scripture Reader at Iseyin, and also the Aseyin’s messenger.

He consulted Mr. Olubi in particular as to the best way to reach the British Government to crave their assistance (i) to put an end to the fruitless war ravaging the country ; and (2) to offer a check to the Dahomian inroads into the Yoruba country.

He said that he was led to take this step as all his efforts to stop the war at its commencement failed, and also recently he fared no better. Also because the Egbas would intercept any messages of his to the coast.

It had happened more than once that when his messengers were at Abeokuta on peaceful errands then the Egbas would start an expedition against the Ibadans as if he egged them on to it. So it was at the time of the expedition against He Bioku, and also at a raiding expedition to the Ibadan farms, and twice in the

Oke Ogun districts. The Egbas would seize any letter that he wrote to the British Government, and he would be glad if Mr. Olubi could reach the British Government for him.

After some discussion it was finally arranged that a letter be written to the Lieut. -Governor W. Brandford Griffiths at Lagos, and another to the Rev. J. B. Wood, Secretary of the C.M.S., requesting him to second his efforts ; and as he knows the country very well, to explain matters to the Governor of Lagos on any point His Excellency may require further elucidation.

The Palace, Oyo.

October i^th, 1881. To His Excellency,

LIEUT.-GOVERNOR W. B. GRIFFITHS,

Sir — I hereby approach your Excellency and through you to the Imperial Government of England with this humble request : (i) My country has long been disturbed by a desultory war, which your Excellency well knows and which has put a stop to all trade and impoverished the country, and thousands of lives have perished by death or hopeless slavery.

I have several times undertaken to bring about the longdesired peace, but my ef^trts have from time to time been frustrated. Instead of terminating the war is extending, to threaten the utter extinction of the Yoruba race.

The Dahomians have taken advantage of this to ruin my kingdom. A few months ago seven towns have fallen a victim to their rapacities and Iseyin is now threatened. The next turn might be to my own royal city.

With all possible speed I beg that the Imperial Government — for which I have always a great respect — to come to my help. I crave your assistance both to come to settle this unfortunate war between the belligerent powers, and to stop the Dahomians who have made an inroad into my kingdom.

To assure your Excellency of my great anxiety I pledge myself to undergo any expenses if only peace be effected as the issue.

All my frontier towns are in great panic now, and if I make no stir to protect them they will all scatter and so I will undertake this in the coming dry season.

I mention this lest you may say after asking your help I make a movement.

I beg to remain,

Adeyemi, King of the Yorubas.

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The second letter, addressed to the Secretary of the C.M.S

The Palace, Oyo.

October i$th, 1881. The Rev. J. B. Wood- Dear Sir, — I beg to approach you with my humble request : You might have heard of the desultory war in my kingdom which has been wasting its thousands. I have undertaken several times to effect peace, but my authority was not respected by the belUgerent powers. And seeing that if this is not done in time, the extinction of the Yoruba race is inevitable I sent specially on the 9th inst. to call your representative here at Ibadan to consult with him how the Imperial Government might be reached that I might crave assistance to bring about the peace speedily.

Now, I humbly beg you to assist me in urging the Government to attend to this my request speedily. The letter addressed to the Government will be forwarded by you and please use your influence in this important matter for the sake of humanity to save my kingdom from extinction.

I am, etc., etc.,

Adeyemi, King of the Yorubas.

§ 2. The AlAfin's Messenger

The writer was the bearer of these letters via Oke Igbo, Ode Ondo, and the Mawen country to Lagos.

Simultaneous with the invitation by the Alafin to Oyg the Rev. D. Olubi received also a strange oral message from Derin of Oke Igbo by Solomon Olorunfumi the C.M.S. mailman to Lagos to the effect that as all the belligerents had appUed to him to settle their differences for them, he wished Mr. Olubi to give him authority to do so, and if he was backed by him, he would have the confidence to act.

The fact was, that Derin was over-elated with the regard paid to him by all the principal states in Yoruba-land. Mr. Olubi, being then the head of the missionaries in the interior came to be regarded as the representative of the white man, and Derin, in his vanity, wished for the recognition also of the white man ; hence the message.

In sending the writer with the AlAfin's letter to Lagos Mr. Olubi asked him to say to Derin that he had no power to authorize him, but that he was sending down to Lagos and that the messenger

would have an interview with the Governor of Lagos on the subject and would bring him word on his return.

The message was delivered to Derin and he said, " Yes, I might settle their differences but for the presumptions of the Ibadans, who wished the confederates who are in their own country to decamp first, which thing is impossible."

At this time the Mawen a piratical tribe in the eastern waters of Lagos, and the people of Epe — an Ijebu town on the Lagoon — were fighting with each other, thus rendering the passage to Lagos from Ondo most difficult. The Epes had rashly declared war against the Mahins on account of their piratical habits; they fitted out their large war canoes, and scoured the lagoon to the Mahin districts. The Mahins in their small canoes easily escaped into the jungles and had no difficulty in shouldering their canoes into places of safety. The Epes, not meeting with any Mahin, wished also to scour the Ofara River on the other side. They dragged their war canoes over the bit of land separating the lagoon from the Ofara River about a mile distant ; this gave opportunity to the Mahins who lay hid in the jungles and behind large trees to shoot down the Epes without being seen, and so the latter were utterly defeated, and those who survived escaped to Itebu, and burnt some of their war canoes with their own hands while the rest fell into the hands of their enemies. Itebu is in the Lagos protectorate and consequently Manuwa the head chief, himself a Mahin, held himself neutral. But the Mahins besieged them at Itebu for three months and they had to ransom theii lives for a large sum of money before they were allowed to return home to Epe. But the Epes commanded the lagoon and would allow no Mahin canoe to proceed to Lagos.

Several Lagos traders in this district suffered by this war, and the Governor of Lagos had to come to these waters to restore order and rescue some of the Lagos traders from the Mahins.

Such was the disturbed state of things when the bearer of the AlAfin's letter to Lagos reached Ode Ondo. He was twelve days at Ondo before he found it possible to proceed to Aiyesan, where he had to embark for Lagos, and eight days at Aiyesan before he could get a passage at all to Lagos.

His Excellency the Governor had several interviews with the AlAfin's messenger in order to learn from him particulars about the country, and the state of things there at present political and otherwise. He also interviewed the representative Oyos and Ijesas at Lagos separately, but these being ignorant of the real state of things in the interior at the time could do no more than display tribal jealousies of each other without conveying any useful

information. The Ij§sas thought that the opportunity of their countrymen had come, and that they should not be interfered with. The Oyos were indignant with the AlAfin's messenger and discredited his mission, alleging that the Oygs being the leading tribe should never be the first to ask for the Governor's interference. They questioned the genuineness of the letter, and asked where was the King's Ilari (state messenger) and where his staff as the messenger's credential.

Under the circumstances the Governor asked the messenger to put down in writing his opinion of the situation, the exact state of things, and his reasons for believing that the people wanted peace and that the Lagos

Government's interference would be acceptable. And this he did in a letter addressed to His Excellency on the 28th of November, 1881.

In the letter he showed that all parties would welcome peace but could not arrange it between themselves, being jealous and distrustful of one another. That the Ibadans and Ekitis wished for peace was evident from the fact that the messengers of both met those of Derin (the Owoni elect of Ife) in the battlefield for the purpose, the only hitch being who was to decamp first. Distrustful of each other, either party feared a treacherous pursuit by the other of the one to decamp first, hence the negotiations failed. With the representatives of a power respected by both between them there was no doubt that the war would at once come to an end.

As to the Egbas, he showed that they were never unanimous about the closing of the roads, one party being for it, the other against, hence they managed to find a circuitous route to Eruwa for trade. They also would welcome peace but would not take the initiative for fear of losing prestige. The same thing might be said of the Ijgbus. In fact, it was well known that the Awujale, their King, was the only one for hostilities, the Ijebus themselves would rather have peace, hence the strained relations existing between the people and their king. That at the time of his leaving Ibadan for Lagos, steps were being taken to renew their attempts at negotiation, the chances this time being more favourable from the fact of the capture by the Ibadans of the brother of the Balogun of Ijebu in a raiding expedition which he undertook to their farms, and his being sent home to arrange for his own ransom.

From these facts it seemed evident that they would gladly accept from a higher and neutral power what all wished for but could not effect themselves.

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§ 3. The Governor's Delegates

The Governor after due deliberation decided to send accredited messengers to sound the feehngs of the chiefs of the tribes most concerned as to how far they desired peace, and also to ascertain whether the Alafin's letter was genuine and if so that he should send an Ilari down with his staff. The delegates entrusted with this business were : For the Oygs — Messrs. Simeon D. Kester and Oderinlo Wilson ; for the Ijesas — Messrs. Phillippe Jose Meffre and Joseph Haastrup. These delegates with the Alafin's messenger left Lagos on their mission on the 5th January, 1882, bearing letters to the Alafin, the Ibadan war chiefs, and to the Ekitiparapos from the Governor. A copy of the Alafin's letter was sent back for confirmation if genuine or otherwise. The Governor himself, visiting the eastern waters of the Colony at the same time, conveyed them in his yacht to the landing place at Atijere.

In order to secure greater importance for the mission, his Excellency arranged that those interior chiefs who occupied a neutral position, such as the Chiefs of Ondo and Derin of Oke Igbo, should send their own messengers also to accompany either party. Accordingly the parties from Lagos proceeded first to Ode Ondo and then to Oke Igbo before directing their footsteps each to his destination with messengers from these two places. At Oke Igbo, when all from Lagos were being introduced, Derin flew into a rage with the AlAfin's messenger for not telling him the purport of his message to Lagos. He was inclined to doubt the genuineness of it. He said that the Alafin could not have sent him without first consulting him ; that it was his cause they were defending, that blockading ammunition from the Ibadans was done by his instructions, etc., etc. The messenger in reply reminded him of the message he brought him from the Rev. Mr. Olubi, which he admitted, and further said it was the same Olubi that sent him. He would not hear the messenger defend himself any further. Then Mr. Joseph Haastrup one of the delegates who was for fair play, and one Akitonde one of Derin's own men, interposed on his behalf, the former said the messenger was a man of God who was not likely to bear a false message. The latter said — He was but a messenger and is not supposed to know the contents of a sealed letter, how then was he to communicate the same to you ?

The fact was that Derin was elated by the honour and respect accorded him by all the powers, and also by the recognition of the Governor. He thought it was because he was an Ife, a city which tradition says was the cradle of mankind, and not because he happened to hold the key of the situation to lock against or to open for the Ibadans to obtain ammunition from the coast.

The delegates separated at Oke Igbo, those for Oyo proceeded to Isoya, Modakeke and Ibadan, those for the Ekitis returned to Ode Ondo, and went by Iperindo and Odo to Ilesa.

The Oyg delegates were well received at Ibadan, in fact they received such welcome as would be accorded to the actual peace messengers ; and also at Ijaye they were met at a distance of four miles from the town by the Balogun and about 100 followers drumming, fifing, and the firing o^ a feu de joie showing with what eagerness they were seeking after peace.

They arrived at the capital on the loth. His Majesty the AlAfin had two interviews with the delegates, he confirmed his letter to the Governor as genuine, briefly recounted the history of the war, adding : " Humanity forbids me to be indifferent to the hundreds of lives perishing daily. The whole Yoruba race is a gift from God to me, and hence every loss of life even to an untimely birth is a loss to the AlAfin of Oyo.

The antagonists are formidable, and without the intervention of a power stronger than both, peace will not be effected, hence I applied to the English Government for their intervention.

If I call upon the whole Yoruba country at large, they might respond to my call for enforced peace, but the issue will not be good, peace will be too dearly bought. What I desire is an intervention without any further loss of life."

The AlAfin also wrote, thanking the Governor for his letter, confirmed his former letter as genuine, and sent an Ilari, Obakosetan by name, with his staff, which was a fan. embroidered with red and green, as his credential.

From Oyo the delegates proceeded to the Ibadan camp. By this time those to the Ekiti camp having a shorter route to traverse had come to those of their own side and gone back.

The Ibadan war chiefs received the delegates well. According to custom they offered them cold water, and afterwards suitable presents, and lodged them.

At the interview Chief Maye was the spokesman. He recounted the history of the war and laid great stress on the desirability of having a safe route to the coast for trade which should not be subject to the whims of their littoral neighbours ; and of the different possible routes, they preferred the Ikorodu route to Lagos which was freely opened for their use in the time of Governor Glover, and said they were ready to subscribe any amount that may be required for opening the road on their side, provided the Lagos Government would guarantee its security from the molestations of the Egbas and Ijebus.

The delegates were the bearers of a letter also from the Ibadan

war chiefs to the Governor of Lagos. In their letter they pointed out strongly that they were there not as aggressors, but as defenders of their frontier towns. That the commencement of hostilities was not on their side but on the side of the Ekitis, who perpetrated a most horrible massacre at Ila of all Oyos on peaceful avocation in their midst. The reason alleged for this was the cruel and oppressive measures of our messengers among them but of which they never made any formal complaint.

And this brutal massacre the Ekitis followed up by the invasion of their frontier towns. They have been defeated before but they renewed the invasion of Ikirun, and that was what brought them where they now are.

With the Egbas they had their complications : the Egbas kidnapped Oyos and they retahated. They expelled all their people trading at Abeokuta, and they (the Ibadans) remonstrated ; the Egbas sent an impertinent messenger to them whose conduct was openly outrageous, and they replied by raiding the Egba farms. All this they admitted, but with the Ijebus and Ilorins they had no case whatever, nor could they understand why these should join any hostile coalition against them. They remonstrated with the Ilorin King but in vain. The Ibadan war chiefs sent two messengers down, the one Ojeniran representing the Are with his staff, and the other Oderinde representing the rest of the war chiefs. The writer, who was formerly the AlAfin's messenger, had again to accompany them with the Ilari Obakosetan to Lagos.

By the hands of their messengers the Ibadan war chiefs sent specimens of the cartridges taken from the Ijesas to the Governor of Lagos, and asked whether it was the Lagos Government that supplied the Ekitis with such ammunition to fight them.

By a strange coincidence the messengers of the different kings and war chiefs each with his staff met at Ode Ondo, with them Derin of Oke Igbo sent his son to represent him, and the Osimowe and chiefs of Ondo appointed their own messengers to accompany them to Lagos. They were also fortunate enough to meet his Excellency the Governor of Lagos in the eastern waters, who, when he heard of their arrival at Aiyesan, steamed up and conveyed them £ill in his yacht to Lagos on the loth February, 1882.

The Governor had several interviews with the messengers, and at the same time communicated with the Governor-General, Sir Samuel Rowe at the Gold Coast. The latter ordered that the messengers should wait for him. They were two months at Lagos waiting for the Governor-General, who when he arrived in his gunboat, summoned the messengers to an interview the next day. He

heard them all round and reserved his decision until further deliberation.

The failure of the mission was evident from what transpired at the meeting. At the Governor's instance the messengers related their messages in turn :

Oba-ko-setan the AlAfin's Ilari said, " My Master presents his compliments to your Excellency. He has sent me to invite your kind interference in the protracted war that has been going on these several years in the interior, in which thousands of lives are being sacrificed yearly. His own effort for the purpose proving abortive he has been constrained to apply to you as representing a higher power, to enable us to effect peace throughout the land."

The messenger of the Are of Ibadan had nothing else to say, " The AlAfin," said he, " is our King, and where his representative speaks the Ibadans cannot say otherwise. We abide by what he says."

Ape-ni-di-agba the Owa's messenger said, " We have the Ibadans in our clutches now, and they should not be plucked off." The Governor replied, " Why then did you not eat them up before this time ? And why come here to ask this Government for their interference ? "

The Ijesa messenger further stipulated as their condition that unless the Ibadans would give a guarantee that they will never make war in future with either the Ijebus, Egbas, Ilorins, Ijesas and Ekitis, they would not agree to peace.

The Seriki Ogedemgbe's messenger agreed with what the Owa's messenger said.

The Ondo messengers wished for peace all round.

The Governor-General a fortnight later dismissed the messengers with a copy of an identical letter to each of the different kings and chiefs that sent them. The letter reads as follows :

" I have carefully thought over the message you gave to me a fortnight ago, and I have heard from the Lieut. -Governor all that passed in this matter before I came to Lagos.

I appreciate the action of the King of Oyg in sending to the Governor of Lagos to ask him to send an officer to make peace between the Ibadans and Ijesas.

I thank the King of Oyo for the compliment he has paid to the English Government in doing this, showing that he believes in the honour of the English Government, and that he feels confident that an officer from the English Government will deal justly in this matter.

The great Queen whom I serve, Her Most Gracious Majesty the Queen of England and Empress of India, has no other

wishes than good wishes towards the entire African people. Her Majesty's instructions to her officers whom she sends to govern this colony are to promote by all proper means friendly intercourse between the people under theii rule and the native tribes li\ang near them.

In doing this from time to time her Majesty has approved the visits of her officers to many of the tribes neighbouring Lagos.

But Her Majesty has no desire to bring the inland tribes neighbouring Lagos under British rule, and though wicked people have said that if the white man comes to the interior he will take the country, I tell you pubhcly that my Queen has no wish to take your country.

As to sending the messenger asked for by the King of Oyo, I am quite aware that in sending to ask the Governor to send a messenger to the Ibadan and Ijesa camps to make peace, the King of Oyo has done a great thing. He has made a request that is not to be lightly answered.

I have thought over it patiently and very anxiously and what I have to say is this : the message given by the Ijesas was not a clear message. They said they wanted the Ibadans to go away and they would agree to make peace on certain conditions, and a part of this condition was — that the Ibadans should sign a promise that they would never again make war on any of the alHed tribes whether Egba, Ijebu, Ijesa, Ekiti, or Ilorin.

I cannot send an officer to your camp to dictate to you what you shall do there, but I will report all the circumstances to Her Majesty's principal officer, and if hereafter the Ibadans and Ijesas should wish to cease from fighting, and to agree to such a condition as one of the Queen's officers may think right, and if Her Majesty should direct that one of her officers should visit you to try to find out their conditions, then I will do all in my power to carry out your wishes ; and although I have found fault with the difficulties in the road, I would even come wilUngly myself if I were directed to do so.

The Queen is very much interested in yovu* welfare and she wishes her officers to use every right endeavour to increase your prosperity."

Government House, Lagos. April 14th, 1882.

Each of the messengers was sent back with presents for themselves and for their respective masters. To the Ibadans the Governor sent two specimens of the cartridges used for the regulation

Martini-Henry rifle which were quite different from those of the Sneider, showing that what the Ijesas were using were not Government property.

In the meantime, news had come to Lagos of the unsafety of the road between Oke Igbo and Modakeke. It was given out that a body of Ijebu kidnappers were stationed at Isoya to blockade the traffic in ammunition only, but what proved to be the fact was that at the instance of Derin the Ijebus were concentrating their forces at Isoya with the object of attacking Modakeke in the rear, whilst the Ifes attacked them in front. The Ogunsua (Bde of Modakeke) and a distinguished Modakeke Chief Ajarawa by name, died suddenly and rather mysteriously, it was said by poison, and further that Derin distributed arms and ammunition to the neighbouring towns of Ikire Gbangan, Ipetumodu and Oduabon to join in the attack on Modakeke, which being removed out of the way Ede would be besieged and thus the Ibadans in the camp would be taken in front and in the rear. But these towns not only refused to take part in such coalition, but also forwarded all the ammunition to the Are in the camp.

This news meant a great peril for the Ibadan and Oyo messengers. The Governor-General, hearing this, sent a special message to Derin by his son that he should see to it that no harm came to the messengers between his town and Modakeke. But notwithstanding this Derin arranged with the Ijebus to meet his own men halfway in the forest, and that the AlAfin's first messenger with the letter {i.e., the writer) should be killed. It was in the presence of the writer that Derin's men were sharpening their matchets ; they went out early before dawn to waylay the messengers but it happened that for want of carriers they could not go that day: and when the kidnappers saw some traders coming with their loads wrapped with tarpaulin they mistook them for the messengers from Lagos and fell on them. The news of this disaster reached the messengers in the afternoon of that day and it caused great consternation at Oke Igbo. Derin was approached again, and

reminded of the Governor's orders and an escort was demanded from him. After much trouble he sent one Asaju with five men, three with old and useless Dane guns, one with a revolver, and the fifth carried a native bell ! That was all. The escort demanded presents from them at once before leaving home for the services he was about to render. In mid forest he demanded more or he would leave them at the mercy of the Ijebus. Much trouble was experienced so that they could not reach Isoya that day ; they were soaked by a drenching rain, but this rain proved the providential means of clearing the road of kidnappers who betook themselves to shelter

when we passed. On reaching Isoya there was another detention. The Ijebus were loth to let them all go safe, the AlAfin's fiist messenger being the principal person they wished to kill ; but Asaju the escort interposed with, " If that had been done in the forest, it could not have been helped, but you cannot do that here now, my master will put the blame on me." So with much reluctance they were all let off. At Isoya they heard of the party that went to waylay them the previous day, about a hundred men armed with muskets ! It was a merciful deliverance.

At the gate of exit from Isoya, and at the He Ife gate they experienced further troubles before reaching Modakeke.

On the arrival of the messengers at Oyo the AlAfin was much disappointed at the failure of the mission. When the Governor's letter was read to him he said, " Let us say in a word the whole thing has collapsed ! "

At the camp the war chiefs were very glad to see back their men of whom they had heard nothing for over two months. The failure of the mission did not seem to move them much, as they had expected it.

On hearing the letter read they said — "We expected as much. Such has been the action of the Ijesas on a previous occasion when attempts at peace-making were undertaken by the AlAfin and by Derin of Oke Igbo." Thus ended the mission in a total failure.

§ 4. The Lion at Bay

Resumption of Hostilities. — On the morrow of the return of the Ibadan messengers, the Ibadan war chiefs announced to the Ekiti confederation the end of the truce which they had observed while negotiation was going on, and gave notice of battle.

The war was resumed and vigorously prosecuted in all its horrors and with desperation. During the stay of the AlAfin's messenger (the writer) in the camp, fighting went on almost every day with varied success on either side. The Ibadans often scored over their opponents, but from the lack of ammunition on their side, and owing to the arms of precision on the other side, they could not dislodge the Ekitis from their strongholds.

The Ijesas dug trenches in the battlefield in which they sheltered themselves from the Ibadan fire ; two of the Ibadan war chiefs viz., Fijabi and Sumgnu Apampa, and one of the Are's big slaves, Idagana by name, intrepid horsemen all, distinguished themselves at this time by plunging into these trenches and dislodging the Ijesas and Ekitis from them. This daring act they styled " Tengba," or " Ajapa," i.e., a speedily accomphshed job: it was always done at a tremendous risk of their hves, for whilst they were exposed

to the steady fire of their foes, their own men behind them could not return the fire for fear of wounding them and those who accompanied them on horseback, until all had jumped into the trenches and dispersed the foes.

The Ibadans were now determined to possess themselves of breach-loading guns and cartridges at whatever cost. Letters were written to the Oygs of Lagos, individually to distinguished men among them and collectively to the whole, stating their own case for the war, and calling for help as those on the other side had been helped by their own people, but for political reasons they received no response, as we shall see hereafter.

Hostilities by the Egbas. — Not only at Kiriji was the war being vigorously prosecuted, but the Egbas also resumed activities in kidnapping in the Ibadan farms at home. About the 15th of June, 1882, the Egbas closed the Berekodo and Eruwa roads ; the Are had not ceased carrying on some negotiations with them all this time, for it was by his goodwill and connivance markets were opened formerly at Ketu and Ejio, and afterwards at Eruwa and Berekodo for trade, to the mutual advantage of both sides. Now they professed at this time to be displeased with the message brought by Ok6 the Are's principal messenger, hence they recalled all their traders who were as far as Berekodo and Iseyin and expelled all Oyos from Abeokuta before closing the roads.

Lawore the Aseyin did his best to pacify the Egbas, and bring about a good understanding to keep the roads open, but all in vain. At a public meeting held at Iseyin on the 19th he took from a certain man an Egba slave who had escaped to Iseyin and sent him back to Abeokuta as a mark of goodwill ; but his messenger was not even allowed to enter the town. This act was repaid on the 31st by another raiding expedition on the Ibadan farms, but the Ibadan hunters gave chase, overtook them and rescued all the captives.

The Dahomians again. — On the i8th August, about 200 Meko refugees arrived at Iseyin who escaped the second invasion by the Dahomians. They were well received, and a portion of land allotted to them to build on, with ample room for more of their friends who might escape to this place.

A Bogus Peace Negotiation. — About this time the Ilorins sent some messengers to the Ibadan camp to negotiate for peace between them. The Ibadans had good reasons for suspecting their sincerity and therefore they sent them back with the message that if they are sincere in their overtures for peace, let them raise the siege of Ofa and return home, and if they are loth to return home empty they may take the town of Otun. This place was offered

to the Ilorins to be taken because of the mortal hatred they knew the Ilorins had harboured against it. It had hitherto been secure under the protection of Ibadan, but now Otun had joined the confederates against them. She, however, had already subm.itted to Ilorin and accepted an Ilorin political Resident. As this overture was only a ruse to lead the Ibadans to withdraw their contingent at Ofa so that they might capture that city and advance to their rear, the negotiation fell through.

About the 14th September, 1882, a comet appeared in the heavens, which to the Yorubas is a very ominous sign. They are always on the look out for the demise of a great king or a mighty chief or the destruction of a great city ; consequently at such a time every important king or chief in the country usually consults his Ifa and offers a propitiatory sacrifice for the preservation of his life. The last seen before this was in 1859, when King Atiba of Oyo died.

The Revolt of the Ifes. — Although the Ife auxiliary army was with the Ibadans in the camp at Kiriji, yet it was known that the Ifgs at home sympathized rather with the Ekitis than with their overlords and would long ago have attacked the Ibadans from the rear but for the presence of the Modakekes near them. There might be other reasons for their hostility against the Ibadans but the chief one alleged was the forcing on them of Ayikiti, the son of a tyrant, as their Owoni (or king) in 1877.

It will be remembered that the Are engaged the services of the Ifes and Modakekes in his raids on the Egba farms in 1877, and after the retreat from Osiele Ayikiti the Ife general requested as the greatest favour he could show him that he should place him on his father's throne in order to preserve his seed from utter destruction, which he was sure would happen in revenge for the great mischief his father had done during his reign.

The Are demurred, being unwilling to force upon the Ifes a king not in consonance with their desire, but Ayikiti brought great pressure to bear, and the Arg felt bound not only to reward his services, but to secure at least the loyalty and friendship of one leading provincial king. But he very soon after turned against the Ibadans. Ayikiti however did not survive long but the Ifes all the same harboured a feeling of spite and resentment against the Ibadans on that account, and that they were seeking an opportunity to give effect to. The Modakekes at their doors rendered this impossible, they refused to join in any coalition against Ibadan and hence the Ife hostility was directed in the first instance to the Modakekes themselves ; they

began kidnapping in their farms at first. Living in such contiguity to each other

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intermarriages of course were frequent and social intercourse unrestricted, but at this time several Modakekes who went to their relatives at lie Ife were heard of no more, some the Modakekes had to redeem back.

A distinguished Ife chief, Akingbade by name, and the Agaju of Derin of Oke Igbo went and joined the Ijebu camp at Isgya to kidnap Yoruba caravans, and they made no exception of Modak§kes their neighbours.

The Are hearing this sent over and again to conciliate them, and urged on Derin rather to come over to He Ife and be crowned the Owoni and restore peace to at least that part of the country ; but Derin refused to comply unless the Ibadans would first cede to him the following towns which once may have belonged to Ifg but had ceased to be so for at least 50 years, viz., Ipetumodu, Odiiabon, Gbangan, Ikire, Apomu, and the villages in their vicinity. Otherwise (said he) he would not go until the close of the war which he thought could only end in one way, which would indubitably place these towns in his hands.

To concihate the Ifes the Are sent one Told to -mediate between the two parties, which done, they were to take a mutual oath of amity and to ratify the same with the blood of a sheep he took with him.

But matters in the meantime had come to a crisis. The Ifes raided the Modakeke farms, caught and maltreated a woman by cutting off her breasts, the Modakekes in turn resented the affront, they retaliated by raiding Ife farms, caught four persons and also sent to the camp at Kiriji to recall Oyebade their Balogun, for it was evident that war has now become inevitable.

The Are did not hke the look of things. In permitting Oyebade to go home he sent also an influential Ife chief, charging each of them to go and quell the faction, put the ringleaders to death on either side and restore peace at home.

These chiefs went by forced marches and took the precaution that the news of their coming should not precede them. They reached home together. Oyebade and Adepoju, his second in command, marched straight to the house of one Obalaiye, a known intriguer who was carrying on secret correspondence with the Ilorins and had obtained a horse from them, and stood before his gate. Hearing that the war chiefs were come, he came out to welcome them ; whilst these war chiefs lay prostrate to receive the greetings of this venerable man, a swordsman who had been instructed walked round to his back and, ere he was aware, by one sweep of the sword his head fell off from his shoulders ! His house was immediately confiscated and levelled with the ground. The

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war chiefs saw this accompUshed before they went to their own homes.

But the Ifes not only did not punish but condoned the action of the ringleaders on their side, and were prepared to give battle the following morning. Oyebade nearly lost his life by trusting himself too far among the Ifes tr5ang to explain that they were not sent home to fight but to punish the ringleaders and respect the oaths ; he was luckily pulled back in time. On account of the oath the first shot fired by the Ifes was by a man who climbed up a tree to do so ; the idea being that to break the oath standing on the earth on which the oath was taken would surely result in disaster. But notwithstanding this, when they joined battle the Ifes were defeated and driven away out of the city and many of them were taken captives.

He Ife and Modakeke being practically one town with only a small stream separating the two, they had not to go outside their walls to fight, the battle took place at the Akogun market. It was practically a civil war.

The Are and Ibadan chiefs hearing this ordered that the Ife captives be released, and Toki was sent again with a sheep and a cat to worship at the tomb of Orafiyan, and to bring both parties together again into a covenant ratifying the same with an oath on the blood of these victims.

But ere this could be done the Ife young men had collected another force and made a determined attack on Modakeke. This was on the ist December, 1882. Victory was again on the side of Modakeke, but the victory was dearly bought ; Oyebade their commander-in-chief was mortally wounded and he died a short time afterwards leaving the command of the army to Adepoju.

While all this was going on at home the Ife war chiefs were in the Ibadan camp at Kiriji fighting against the Ekitiparapos but one night before daybreak they left the camp in a body with their wives and children and went over through the battlefield to the Ekitis. They were received with open arms and sent home to join their comrades to make efforts to destroy Modakeke.

Modakeke now became the third seat of war.

Reinforcements came to the Ifes from the Ijesas and Ij§bus. An Ijesa force under their war chief Ayimoro encamped on the north-east and the Ijebus under their Seriki Ogunsigun of Igbo crossed the Osun river and encamped in the south. The If§s themselves were encamped in a village eastward of Modakekg. From these three points Modakeke was attacked at one and the same time. The fall of Modakeke would mean an attack in the rear for the Ibadans at Kiriji and consequently they were obhged

to send as reinforcement the following chiefs on the 4th December, viz., Akintola, Sanusi, Bamgbegbin and Aturu.

At this new development the Ekitis redoubled their energies to overwhelm the Ibadans in the camp the battle raged at Kiriji with unabated fury and many valuable lives were lost on both sides. Of the men of note on the Ibadan side were : Ali Laluwoye the Otun (from illness) Aderibigbe son of the late Bale Olugbode (from wounds previously received) Awo the son of the late Labosinde, the Baba Isale, Ogunrinde son of the late Agbakiu.

Some of the reinforcement at Modakeke had to be recalled when the fighting at Kiriji was becoming too strong leaving Akintola alone and subsequently Sumgnu Apamp'a was sent to join him.

Thus stood the Ibadan lion at bay facing fiive fronts, with ammunition spent, yet flinching from none, at Ofa, at Kiriji, at Modakgke and against the Egbas as well as the Ijebus at home.

Chapter XXVII

A RIFT IN THE CLOUDS

§ r. A Turning Point

When everything was thus dark and gloomy for the Ibadans, quite unexpectedly, on the 17th December, 1882, Ijebu messengers arrived in the town to negotiate for peace between the two countries !

The messengers were received at the Are's gate at Ibadan. They were hooted at in the streets and called all sorts of names, being taken for spies. Their message was however conveyed to the war chiefs in the camp and the home authorities were instructed to send a messenger back along with them to ascertain the truth of their statements.

The hearts of all were made glad on the return of the messengers when they heard that the Ijebus were sincere in their overtures for peace. Ajako the messenger sent reported that about 800 of the Ogbonis met at Oru and without a dissentient voice all agreed to make peace. Ten kegs of powder and ten bags of salt were the presents sent to the Are and war chiefs as a token of their goodwill. These sent as return presents slaves, gowns, and sheep. Thus peace was concluded with the Ijebus and trading relations resumed. Provisions which were scarce at Ijebu were taken down and bartered for salt, and cheap foreign made cloths and cutlery, the Ijgbus for the present forbidding the exportation of powder and firearms. What led to this negotiation for peace has been told in a previous chapter {vide p. 451). And again, the Ijgbus, being essentially a commercial people, their only market for interior products and for disposing of their wares from the coast was closed to them since the commencement of the war, and scarcity of foodstuffs caused much distress among them also, and yet the Egbas, whose cause they were espousing — having no grievance of their own — had managed to open markets for themselves, first at Ketu and Ejio, subsequently nearer home at Eruwa by which their own wants were reheved. The Ijebus had no such outlet ; they were therefore inclined towards peace with Ibadan, but the Awujale their king was for prosecuting the war vigorously for which purpose he ordered the Balogun put to encamp at Oru, from whence he might send raiding expeditions out to the Ibadan farms. We have seen the disaster that befel them on the loth of April, 1881, and the

capture of the Balogun of Ijebu's brother, who was sent back by the Ibadans to effect a good understanding between them and the Ijebus. That episode made a deep impression on the Ijebus, and ever since they had been working for peace against the wish of the Awujale, and a small clique about him ; but a quiet revolution had been going on towards this end. The people were now determined to have the road open in spite of the Awujale, and this led to something like a civil war as will be seen below.

Another Ilorin Episode. — Simultaneously with this event was the arrival of a peace embassy from the Sultan of Gando to the Ilorin and Ibadan camps. The Ibadan chiefs, who would not listen to any overtures from the Ilorins, knowing their treachery, paid more regard to these messengers, gave them a cordial welcome, treated them respectfully, beUeving them to be sincere. To show their wilUngness to accept peace with IJorin the Are sent home for about 60 of the Ilorin captives at Ibadan, who were men of influence, and sent them all home on horseback. Moreover they accepted all the terms offered by the Ilorins. Peace was so far concluded that the opposing armies at Ofa exchanged visits with each other. Several Ibadan and Ofa people even passed on to Ilorin and traders on both sides who had been shut up in other towns hailed the opportunity of returning home, and others did a good trade as far as Bida in potash and salt while the opportunity lasted.

But still the Ilorins refused to raise the siege of Ofa, on the contrary they insisted on the Ibadan contingent going away. The Ibadans on the other hand promised that not only would they leave Ofa, but also that they would not claim the overlordship of that city, they would hand it over to Ilorin, but only on one condition, namely, that the town be not destroyed ; but as they were there to defend that town they could not retire except the siege was first raised. This test of the sincerity of motives of the Ilorins being insisted on, the negotiations failed and hostihties were resumed.

§ 2. Rambling Talks of Peace

The Rev. David Hinderer, a retired missionary of the C.M.S., who for many years had laboured in Yoruba land and who continued to take a lively interest in the country and its people, addressed a letter to the representatives of the tribes residing at Lagos on the difficulties present in the interior, well knowing the tribal feelings and jealousies existing at Lagos which were fanning the flames of the hostilities in the hinterland. He invoked them as patriots and especially as Christians to see that all tribal feelings and jealousies be set aside in the interests of peace to their father-

land, and that they should act in concert in order to restore good understanding among their fellowmen, and prosperity to their unhappy country.

This led to a representative gathering at Lagos of the elders of the different tribes, in which it was resolved that a deputation should wait upon the Lieut. -Governor Alfred Moloney, on the subject of peace between the interior tribes. Those appointed for the purpose were : The Rev. Jas. Johnson, Pastor of St. Paul's Breadfruit, Messrs. Henry Robbin and L H. Willoughby, native merchants. They waited on the Governor on the 8th of December, 1882, and presented the following resolution :

" At a meeting of the representative elders of the different tribes, Yorubas, Egbas, Ijebus, Ijesas Ifes and Ondos, held at the Breadfruit parsonage on the 7th of December, 1882, in reference to the long-standing warfare in the interior, from which both the interior countries and Lagos have suffered, the following resolution was after a full consideration of the subject unanimously adopted :

' That this meeting, convinced of the ex-king Dosumu's influence with the kings and chiefs of the interior, though he no more exercise regal power in Lagos, and this is known everywhere in the interior, decides that a deputation composed of nominated representatives of the different tribes be appointed to wait upon him, and respectfully solicit his interference with the King of Jebu and the other kings and chiefs in the interior for the peaceable settlement of the interior difficulty. His Excellency the Governor of Lagos having been first respectfully informed of it, and the countenance and support of his influence had.' (Sgd.) Jas. Johnson."

His Excellency the Governor replied that no one was more desirous than Her Majesty to see peace restored among the people of the interior, and with such an object so far as counsel, advice and moral influence

went, he would not hesitate to do all he could in Lagos. Giving the deputation distinctly to understand that neither Dosumu nor his chiefs were allowed to exercise any rule in the settlement ; yet the Governor considered that he would best suit the interest of the Government and meet the aim of the community by having a meeting of the ex-king and his chiefs, at which he would allow to be introduced the members of the deputation who could then repeat the resolution on which he would then for himself hear the views of Dosumu and his chiefs.

The meeting accordingly took place on the nth, at which, after some introductory remarks by the Governor, the Rev. Mr. Johnson

repeated the resolution, explained the desire of the community and advanced his hopes.

King Dosumu next spoke but said nothing of importance.

HeS was followed by the Apena, who acted as spokesman for the king and the remaining chiefs, conveying that they would like the matter reported to the Queen, and if they were then asked to exercise their influence with the king and chiefs of I jebu they would willingly do so.

One and all they' expressed their desire for peace. In support of the aim of the community Messrs. Robbin and Willoughby also spoke forcibly.

We may remark that the Apena evinced such caution and reluctance in the matter of action as desired because of the trouble he fell into in 1875 during the administration of Governor Dumaresq when he was personally forbidden by the Lieut. -Governor Lees to interfere in Ijebu matters.

The Governor said that if Dosumu and the chiefs would put to loyal advantage their influence in the matter of the restoration of peace to the country lie was confident that Her Majesty's Government would be appreciative of any such effort ; and that a general move for good in the way of an honest endeavour to restore peace was very different to direct and meddlesome interference in the interior economy of a government such as Ijebu.

This movement was the first of a series of fruitless meetings held at Lagos between the years 1882 and 1892 which had for their object the restoration of peace in the hinterland by the exercise of " influence." The subsequent meetings however were not under the aegis of the Government but among the tribal representatives themselves.

The AlAfin's letter to Lieut. -Governor Griffiths in 1881 made it clear that it required a higher power which commanded, the respect of the combatants on both sides to make them lay down their arms.

The AlAfin's messenger emphasised the fact over and over that nothing less than an armed intervention could prevail upon the belligerents to decamp.

But then the interior at that time was so little known that people living at ease and security at Lagos had no idea of those arduous circumstances of hfe that moved men resolute and brave to protect their interests by the sinews of their own right arms. Probably there were not half a dozen men in all Lagos, certainly not among the " influential " personages — so-called — who knew the exact state of things prevailing in the interior, or we would have heard less of the " influence " which the ex-king of Lagos or the Awujale of Ijebu Ode was able to exert with the heroes of

a Homeric struggle, incapable as they were to intervene with a force or to guarantee safety for an hour ; nor was it apparent by what means they could sheath the sword of men who meant business.

What was happening at Ijebu at that very moment furnishes an amusing commentary on the resolution read before the Governor, and affords incontestible proofs of how little Lagosians knew about up country affairs, not even of what was going on, so to speak, at their very doors and also of what value the Awujale would be in the matter of peace.

The tribal parties at Lagos evidently missed the point of Mr. Hinderer's letter. The idea expressed in their resolution and their procedure seemed rather far-fetched, and roundabout, except the object had been to

show that the Awujale of Ijebu was an important personage.

The remarks of Apelidiagba to the Governor General, Sir Samuel Rowe, which served to wreck the peace embassy initiated by the AlAfin were dictated at Lagos ; the same expression had been used before by the Ijesa representatives to the Lieut. -Governor W. B, Griffiths. As the tribal antagonism of compatriots at Lagos served to inflame and excite the belligerents, so unanimity amongst them might serve to soothe their feehngs and dispose them to yield even at a mere message — say — of the Governor, behind whom there was known to be a force of incalculable weight. Such was the intention of Mr. Hinderer.

On the 26th of December, 1882, the Apena waited on the Governor to intimate to His Excellency that he was the person deputed by the ex-king and council to proceed to Ijebu on the above mission.

The Apena's Report

The Report makes long and tedious reading, but the following extract is the gist of the same.

The Apena of Lagos who was sent up on a mission to the Awujale of Ijebu with the object of adopting measures for putting an end to the war in the interior, left Lagos on the 28th December, 1882, and landing at the first Ijebu port at Itg Ike, he learnt of the civil commotion at Ijebu Ode the chief town, and instead of sleeping there for the night he left at midnight, went through bush paths with lighted torches and by forced march reached Ijebu Ode by daybreak. He lost no time, but was announced by the Apena of Ijebu Ode to the Awujale, who granted him an audience at once.

The Apena told in few words the object of his visit and what gave rise to it, viz., a letter written by a retired missionary to the representatives of all the interior tribes at Lagos in the interest of

peace ; and that his mission was at the instance of the ex-King Dosumu and his council, with the approval of the Governor of Lagos.

The Awujale, after hearing the Apena's mission, requested him to proceed to the Ijebu camp at Oru to deliver the same to the war chiefs there. But the Apena would like to know the King's mind, as it was most likely the war chiefs would ask, " What did he say to your message ? " The King then said he could not give an authoritative reply to a poUtical message without the advice of his councillors, and that they were all disaffected now, and were deserting the town. The Apena might be able to find out why they were leaving the town. But he might mention that the object of the Apena's mission, strange to say, bears strongly on the present condition of things at Ijebu, viz., the restoration of peace in the interior. That it was with the advice of all his councillors, the Osugbos, Ipampas, Ilamurins, and the Ogboni Odis, that he embarked on hostilities against Ibadan, and that he sent messengers to the sixteen kings of the Ekiti confederates, also to the king of Ilorin, to the AlAfin of Oyo and others before he commenced hostilities, and he promised the Ijesas and Ekitis his support in breaking off the Ibadan yoke ; and now after entering into an agreement with all these kings his own people turned round and said they desired peace with Ibadan, and he was to break his word to the other kings !

The war chiefs by his commands are at Orii as a base of operation against the Ibadan farms, but why were the civil chiefs deserting the town for the village of Imowo ? The Apena might be able to ascertain the reason when he got there. The Apena of Ijebu Ode told him that the civil chiefs were having a meeting that day at Imowo and that he was to be quick so that he might meet them all together.

Accordingly, the Apena on his way to the Ij§bu camp at Oru passed through the village of Imowo, where he met about 320 of the Ogbonis and others. He told them his mission and three times they asked him, "Is it customary with you at Lagos to settle a quarrel or not ?" He rephed in the affirmative. " Then," said they, " we are of the same mind." They said, moreover, that they had been there seven days since, under great personal discomforts, to interpose between the Awujale and the war chiefs at Orvl who were bent on a civil fight, as the Awujale would not listen to any arrangement to terminate hostilities and bring peace and prosperity to the country. He was to hasten at once to Oru as the war chiefs were holding a council there " today " and the result might be some strenuous measures. He did so,

and met them just dispersing from the meeting, but they resumed their seats when they saw him. He related to them the object of his mission and the Balogun asked him, " Is it customary with you at Lagos to settle a quarrel or not ? " He rephed in the affirmative ; the Balogun then turned to the chiefs and people asking them what they thought of the message of the community of Lagos by the Apena about the restoration of peace in the interior and resumption of friendly relations ? The answer was one loud shout of joy.

The Balogun thereupon told his own story. For the last seven years (said he) they had been stationed at Orii to carry on hostilities against the Ibadans, they had spent their all, their money and their goods gone, and they were now impoverished. ' ' You may have heard of the fame of Ibadan," said he. " Do you think anyone in his senses can go against such a people with a pouchful of parched corn ? " — No. — Then as the King has made his statements, by the leave of the war chiefs the Apena should patiently hear their own verison.

The Balogun then proceeded to say that they had no cause of quarrel with the Ibadans but were drawn to one by the Egbas. That the same thing was done in 1860-62 during the Ijaye war, the Egbas sent to them to say two Oyos were fighting, and they were going to flog them both ; but on the contrary it was the Ibadans that flogged both the Egbas and I j ayes. The scene of battle was changed from Ijaye to Oke kere in the Remo district, and there was an appalling amount of bloodshed before they succeeded in driving the Ibadans home : but that they, the Ijebus, were then impressed with the irony of the whole situation : the Ibadans were there to defend Ijebu towns against the Egbas, " and we joined the Egbas in fighting them ! After all, we were the losers because the result was the destruction of so many towns in the R§mg districts. And with all their pretensions the Egbas were no men. Akodudu was the only brave man we saw amongst them in those days."

Then the Egbas needlessly went and interfered with the Ibadans in their new road to Porto Novo which was the origin of the present imbroglio, and sold 1,460 persons of those who went to trade amongst them, and they had involved them (the Ijebus) in the quarrel. Some distinguished and influential Ijebu chiefs who disapproved of the war had been ruined by the Awujale and would have been killed but that they escaped from the country.

" We attacked the Ibadan farms and caught three men, but the home garrison chased us and caught 143 of us ! The Ar§ of Ibadan not only released them, but sent them back by one Dawodu, with

emblematic messages, viz., a ^fan, Osin feather, and a white sash. But the Awujale kept listening to the advice of ill-disposed persons who were against peace, representing the message from the Are as a false message, originating from the Balogun, who, knowing salt to be dear at Ibadan, wished to drive a lucrative trade therefrom ! After a while Oluguna the Awujale's own slave, who was caught by the Ibadans in our raids, was sent back with a present of twelve slaves to the Balogun with a message that he should assist him to beg the Awujale. The Awujale approved of his receiving the presents, but arranged that future messengers should come to himself direct by a new road, and not by the old route through Oru where the Balogun was stationed. This of course they did not mind, thinking he might thereby be amenable to peace.

" After this, the Are of Ibadan sent messengers to the Awujale several times, and each time with presents, 72 slaves in all, valuable cloths, a demijohn of segi beads and a crown ! All which he appropriated but still would not declare the roads open for commerce so that we here might return home. On the contrary, he sent an army to Isoya to aid the Ifes in destroying Modakeke. We are suffering, and the Egbas on whose account we embarked on this suicidal policy are trading on their own account at Erebu. But the Awujale entered into all sorts of intrigues with the men of I wo, Ed§, Modakeke, Ife, and the Ijesas, and all Ijebus were scandaHzed at this after receiving so much from the Ibadans ! " They attributed it to the fact t-hat since his accession he never removed to the palace of the kings but remained in his mother's house, where he was accessible to everybody, and he followed other advices than those of the official councillors. Hence they were determined he should reside in the palace if needs be with their guns, or he must be deposed. They told the Apena he was free to inform the Awujale of their determination, nobody else would tell him. He promised them he would.

He thereupon went back to the king and remonstrated with him. The determination of his people was that

he should remove to the palace, demolish his present residence, send away his sons from him, as by custom they were to visit him only once a year, and that he was to execute all his bad advisers.

The King demurred. He said that kings should reside in the

1 A fan in Yoruba is Abebe the root b6 means to beg. Osin is a water bird. Sin in Yoruba means to serve A white sash — white is an emblem of peace.

The message means, we beg you, we will serve you, let there be peace between us.

palace true, but he declined to receive orders from the people, and he could not be compelled to do so.

After much remonstrance, showing him the evils of life in exile, reminding him of Akitoye's case at Lagos, etc., he prevailed upon him to yield. He asked him to take a retrospective view of his life and try to meet the wants of his people : that there was a time when he commanded and his people obeyed ; now they command and he must obey. He had been fed by God hitherto with honey but now He gave him a taste of bitter herbs : the King would not refuse that.

After much difficulty he obtained for the Awujale five days' grace in which to carry out the demands of the people, viz., to demolish his present residence, send his sons away, and execute Jiis bad advisers. (These marked victims, however, escaped to Epe, an Ijebu town in the Lagos protectorate.)

There was a great deal more of compUcations attending this business, but he (the Apena) should not meddle with Ijebu internal affairs.

The King reluctantly took leave of him and wished there were many like hirn for the sake of affairs of the country : he gave him two bags of cowries, and he left Ijebu Ode on the gth inst. via Epe for Lagos. On the loth the King's " ill advisers " who were marked for destruction met him at Epe, he advised Agbaje, the chief ruler of Epe, not to deliver them up for death but rather refer the case to the Governor of Lagos through Dosumu. The mat whereon he sat at Epe, valued about 20 heads of cowries, was given him as a present, and they expressed high appreciation of his services in bringing the affairs in Ijebu to such a peaceful issue. He arrived at Lagos early on the 12th of January, 1883.

The following letters marked A, B and C from Agbaje, the Balogun of Epe (an Ijebu port subject to Lagos), to the Governor of Lagos, will show us the condition of the Ijebus at that time and the sequel to the Apena's visit.

Letter A.

Sir, — I have the honour of informing your Excellency that I have had the mind of laying before your Excellency's information the other day when here in H.M.S. Gertrude the quarrel between the King of Ijebu and His Majesty's subjects who compose His Majesty's war camp at a place called Oru in the Ijebu territory.

The King's subjects said that they would not fight against the Ibadans any more : they having made three subsequent raids on the Ibadan's farms but were not successful, therefore

they are tired of fighting ; they are threfore desirous of making peace with the Ibadans and then resume trade.

The King not agreeing to peace-making but determined to carry his purpose in fighting with the Ibadans. He does not want any thing else but war. His Majesty's subjects said in charges against him that since he has been proclaimed the King of Ijebu he was never seen to sit on the king's throne, he resides in his mother's house. He was requested by his subjects to sit on the throne as were his predecessors and to yield to the peace-making with the Ibadans. These the King refused to accept but determines to fight with the Ibadans and no peace. His Majesty's subjects are being prepared to fight a civil war with their king and to have him dethroned while the King is being prepared also to resist their purpose !

The King and the subjects are now ready to fight the civil war. I have however, sent three messengers to the King at different times towards peace-making, but he would not permit me and my chiefs. Notwithstanding my further effort in sending the fourth message to the camp at Oru, but I am afraid they will not accept my offer. In a plain word, war is imminent. Your Excellency may say I have not given you a due notice. If I am successful all right otherwise I could not help. I have the honour, etc.,

Agbaje, Balogun of Epe. December 25/^, 1882.

[Note that this letter was written three days before the Apena left Lagos, but the news it contained was not known before he left.]

Letter B. The Balogun of Epe's second letter to the Governor of Lagos.

January 12th, 1883.

Sir, — I have the honour to asknowledge the receipt of your Excellency's letter of the 27th December and noted its contents.

As per my promise in my last letter that I have sent message to the Ijebus at Oru in the way of mediation — mediation between them and their King — and as I also promised to you the result of such message, the messenger has returned saying that it is a quarrel between a father and his son, we have no hand in it and that in a few days after that I heard that the Apena from Lagos has arrived in the camp thinking that he would settle the rhatter, but sorry he could not do it, it is still continued.

Since the Apena has left the camp and Ijebu Ode to this

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place and proceeded to Lagos, the King's sons have been driven away together with four of his notable slaves with their men. When they left the country (? town) Ode they did not stop in any of the Ijebu districts but came right off to Epe. I am hearing that the fugitives will be pursued by their opponents, and that wherever they are met with the country (? town) will be destroyed. And now, acting to the advice of your Excellency's, viz., that I should be neutral in the matter, so I do but in considerating I am determined not to give up the fugitives to their pursuers. I will not do it to please anyone.

Your Excellency's obedient servant,

Agbaje, Balogun of Epe.

[Note this letter was written on the very day the Apena reached Lagos.]

Letter C. The Balogun of Epe's third letter to the Governor of Lagos.

January 15th, 1883.

Sir, — Since mine of four days ago, things here have continued in the zigzag manner. To-day the King of Ijebu Awujale has left his town Ijebu Ode and has arrived at this place (Epe). His Majesty's complaints are that he was requested by his subjects to reside in his father's house, he has done so. To drive away his sons, and to accept the opening of the roads to Ibadan, and these he has yielded to. Not satisfying with these, they further requested him to go to sleep — meaning that he should die. This he will not do as he is not ready to leave the world when it does not please God to take him away yet from the world he will not force it. Seeing that Epe is his country and he had had a house there before, therefore he returned to his home.

I remain your obedient servant,

Agbaje, Balogun of J^pe.

[Note that the above was written only three days after the return of the Apena to Lagos, when he was supposed to have settled everything.]

Thus ended the movement at Lagos which had for its object the termination of the deadly struggle going on at Kiriji by means of the " influence " of Dosumu the ex- King of Lagos, and Afidip^te, now the ex-King of the Ij§bus.

§ 3. Desperate Movements

The following letter, addressed to some gentlemen at Lagos, will show how straitened the Ibadans now were, from the use of the rifles against them.

To I. H. WiLLOUGHBY, Esq., D. C. Taiwo, Esq., SuMONU Animasawun, Esq., Shitta, Esq., And all Lagos Oyqs or Yorubas,

Sirs, — We, the Are and Chiefs of Ibadan, send you our greetings.

We have written and sent a special messenger to you and that letter was our first to you, on the subject of the present war. We there mentioned that the Ijesas of Lagos have supplied their brethren with superior weapons of war, and that we beheve the Lagos Government had no hands in it. Our grounds for believing so was this. We have sent a specimen of the rifle shots that they have been fighting us with to the Lieut. - Governor W. B. Griffiths by the hands of his messengers, Messrs. Kester and Wilson, asking at the same time whether it was the Government who was supplying them with the same. Our messengers who accompanied them down returned with two different kinds of cartridges, one for the Henry Martini, and the other for the Government rifles, and word was sent by our messengers that their ammunitions of war were quite different from the specimens sent. We beheve them so far and have agreed that they should act the part of a peace-maker.

But soon after our letter was written we were informed from good authority that influential people of Lagos, who could not have left the colony without the Government's notice, have actually left Lagos, and have been fighting with us with superior weapons of war, viz., with the GattUng gun, and with plenty Sneiders.

We undertake to mention the names given to us, viz., T. F. Cole, Esq., Labirinjo, Esq., F. Astrope, Esq., Messrs. Campbell and 0§ifila, and that Mr. Vaughan was hired as the artillery man. How is it that such eminent men should leave the colony without the Governor's notice ?

The Ijesas may truly plead that they are fighting for their country, but we have written to the Lagos Government telling them the cause of this war. It was they who first originated the war by encamping against Ikirun and their watchword was " Odo Ohk ni Ala." The Qhk river will be the boundary ;

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that is to say Iwo at a day's journey from us will be annexed to their own territory ! They were once defeated and this is a second confederation ; and we have said, and do say now, that we are in our frontier protecting the Oyg provinces from their inroads.

Trusting you would give the matter your serious consideration for the interest of your country and people. We submit the matter to you, our kinsmen, that you bring the matter before the Government, that an enquiry be made if the above-mentioned persons could be found in the settlement.

We have the honour, etc.,

Latosisa, A.O.K. and the Ibadan Chiefs.

The above letter was read by the Yorubas of Lagos and was published anonymously. Mr. F. Astrope was at that time farming at Aiyesan, although all the same he and the other Lagos Ijesas were there in the interest of trade, or rather for easy transport to their country, but did not actually go to Ilesa, much less to the Ekiti camp to fight. He now brought pressure to bear upon the editor of the newspaper which published the letter, and L H. Willoughby was disclosed as responsible for its publication.

Mr. Astrope then took legal proceedings against Mr. Willoughby for libel and was awarded damages of £50.

The Ibadan war chiefs did not content themselves with the letter to the Oyo descendants at Lagos alone in general but wrote also two other letters, one to Mr. D. C. Taiwo, on May 26th, 1884, by one Joseph Osunrinde, and the other to Sumonu Animasawun on the 6th of June, 1884, by one Otesile. Both letters bearing the same contents, viz. :

" As the Ij§§as are determined to spoil the Yoruba country, and their countrymen at Lagos are supplying them with European weapons of war, we send (here the messenger's name) to you for a supply of Sneider rifles with cartridges, and we promise to pay in palm oil and palm kernels which we are collecting for the purpose. We wish you to arrange with the Balogun of Ijebu in order that our produce might reach you," etc., etc.

" We are,

" Latosisa, A. O.K.," Etc., etc.

Warned by what happened to Mr. Willoughby, great caution was displayed. The following was the reply sent by one who styles himself — A Yoruba.

Shitta Street, Lagos. June i6th, 1884. The Are-Qna-Kakanfo,

Dear Gentlemen,

I hope this to meet you in a good health as I am at present. Your message has been dehvered to us and we note your saying. Doubtless whatever thing you are wanting, if you give Ijebu goods they will supply it to you. May God let this war settle sooner.

If you want to send here again, you must send to Government directly with King's token, either walking-stick, or other instrument, but if you want to send to Yorubas, you can send it separately. You must beUeve all what your messenger will tell, and receive from them advice, for they have seen here and yonder. You must not send such person as foohsh as Apara, for he is thoughtless person. If you want to send here again, you must elect clever and wise person in order that your wishes may be attended to ; and you must not send verbal message, all that you have to do must be written in letters.

With kind regards and best wishes.

Yours very faithfully and affectionately,

A Yoruba.

Thus the Ibadans received no help whatever from their compatriots at Lagos. However, with the deposition and expulsion of the Awujale from his capital, the strain between Ibadan and the Ij§bus became relaxed. Through Chief Kuku of Ijebu Ode, who had resided at Ibadan for many years, as well as through the Balogun of Ijebu, and from private traders through the Ij§bu country, the Ibadans were now able to obtain at very high prices some rifles and ammunition, just sufficient to render their position more secure at Kiriji. The guns were sold to them at the rate of ;ˆio to £1$ a piece, and the cartridges at 6d. each — prices which (considering the scarcity of money and the general impoverishment induced by this prolonged war) only men in desperate condition would care to pay. Sanusi, the Are's eldest son, was the first to purchase a few, then Lady Omosa, the daughter of the late Basorun Ogunmola, procured a few for her nephew Kongi, who was now the head of the house. After this the possession of a rifle became a general thing, every war chief trying to get a few for himself. For this purpose many had to sell their slaves and slave wives, a matter of pain and grief to them, as altogether contrary to their custom, but the body politic must be preserved at all costs.

Now and then contributions had to be made at home from those in easier circumstances. To assist those at the seat of war the chiefs in council ordered that those who are well-to-do, and every large compound, should give an equivalent of a slave each, and smaller compounds should combine and do the same. But the messengers often exacted much more than they were authorised to receive, and were rather indiscriminate in their exactions : the distress in the country in consequence can well be imagined, with practically the closure of the roads for trade and the restriction of farming through the kidnappers.

Bad as things were on the Ibadan side latterly it was almost worse on the Ekiti side where Ogedemgbe's Ipayes (war-boys) helped to impoverish the country by a sort of licensed robbery. The town of Ilesa was all but deserted through their rapacities before a peremptory stop was put to their excesses. Even the more

important Ekiti kings, e.g., the Ajero of Ijero, the Owor^ of Otiin and the Olojudo of Ido had to be present at the seat of war ; not however in the camp, but in the town of Mesin Ipole. The Owa of Ilesa did not actually go to the field, but he had to leave home to reside at Ijebu Ere halfway to the town of Mesin Ipole.

Notwithstanding his expulsion, the ex-Awujale of Ijebu was not quiet in his place of exile, he kept moving those favourable to him to start a revolution in his favour : but as all were tired of the war nothing of consequence was done. He however sent his big slaves to Isgya to help Ogungigun against the town of Modak§kg.

Chapter XXVIII

THE REV. J. B. WOOD AND THE A.O.K.

§ I. The Visits of the Rev. J. B. Wood to the Camps

Such was the condition of the country as related above when the Rev. J. B. Wood, then the oldest missionary of the C.M.S. in the Yoruba country residing at Abgokuta, obtained permission from the Egbas to go on his round of visits to the Mission stations in the interior, chiefly Isejrin, Oyo and Ibadan. He arrived at Ibadan on the 24th August, 1884. The Ibadan war chiefs, hearing of the arrival at Ibadan of the white man through whom the AlAfin lately communicated with the Lagos Government, sent to him a special messenger with a letter written in the Yoruba language, once more asking for his kind interference in the interest of peace. They thought that, as a white man, and one who knew the country well„ he could so represent matters to the British Government who alone could interpose with effect.

The reverend gentleman was highly desirous of doing something in that direction, but he felt that nothing could be done without fuller knowledge of all the facts obtainable only from the spot. He was therefore determined to proceed to the seat of war, taking with him the Rev. D. Olubi of Ibadan, Mr. Abraham F. Foster, C.M.S. Catechist at Ise5rin who accompanied him from Iseyin to Ibadan, and the writer, then C.M.S. Catechist at Ibadan.

They left Ibadan on the i6th of September and got to the camp on the 24th. It was the period of the latter rains when it poured incessantly, the roads were in their worst condition, and the rivers much swollen.

That a white man should brave it all and visit them in the craggy heights of Mesin, at such a distance and under such conditions filled the Ibadan chiefs with surprise and gratitude.

The first interview with the chiefs was held on the following morning, when the principal war chiefs met the Rev. Mr. Wood and his colleagues in the Are's reception room. He opened by telhng them the object of his visit to the camp, that he was moved to do so by their letter to him, and that his wish was to visit both camps if possible in order to know how to proceed about the matter.

Chief Maye was the Ibadan spokesman. He gave a full history of the origin of the relations between themselves and the Ekitis,

and how they became masters of the Ijesa and Ekiti countries. That in most cases they were invited over by the Ekitis themselves, who placed themselves under their protection after throwing off the yoke of the Ilorins ; and that they never had any war with any of the Ekiti towns unless invited by one or other of themselves. He ended his statements by telling briefly the cause of quarrel between themselves and the Egbas, and how while thus engaged there followed the rebellion and aggression of the Ekiti confederates into the Oyg territory. He concluded by sajnng, " We are here now in the interests of the Oyo tribes fighting their battles and safe-guarding our frontiers from aggression, and the country from being overrun by the enemy as they seem determined to do."

The Rev. J. B. Wood offered no remarks or comments but asked to be allowed to visit the other side, and thus alternately going and coming till he could bring both parties to understand each other.

The Ibadans at first demurred to this proposal saying that the Ijesas will pubUsh it far and wide that they were so hard pressed that they were obhged to sue for help from the white man. But after some talk over the matter they agreed only out of deference to Mr. Wood, that he should pass from their camp to that of

the other side. But how to reach the other side ? It was agreed that Mr. Foster and the writer should go to the Ekiti side with a flag of truce, bearing a message from Mr. Wood to Chief Ogedemgbe, asking for an interview. They proceeded therefore unarmed, each with his boy, Mr. Foster's boy carrying the flag of truce before them. The Ibadan skirmishers in the field were withdrawn in order to disarm suspicion, thus they crossed the Eleriko or Fejeboju stream. The events which followed were thus described :

" The Ekiti soldiers seeing us coming towards them advanced to meet us, levelhng their guns at us ; the flag of truce was waved vigorously and we shouted, ' Do not fire, do not fire, we are peaceful messengers sent to your Commander-in-Chief.' With that they desisted, but walked on towards us, and we towards them, when all of a sudden one of them levelled his gun at Mr. Johnson, saying, ' Ma si yin eyi na ' (I must first discharge this anyhow). With that he let off ! The flag of truce was thrown away and we all fled precipitately back : Messrs. Johnson and Foster, who had their boots on, fell down at the top of Fejeboju hill and rolled down the stream. The Ibadan skirmishers who were watching from the Elebolo hill hastened to our rescue and drove back the Ijesas, recovering the flag and personal articles dropped in the flight. The whole camp was astir at this incident, and

sympathizers poured in on all sides, congratulating Mr, Wood on our providential escape. We offered our thanksgiving to God for this merciful deliverance."

But the Ekitis reported this incident at home, describing what sort of men they fired on, thereupon Messrs. Gureje and Apara, Ijesa Christians from Abeokuta who formed and led the rifle corps, came to the field the next day and desired the sentinel to ask those men fired at yesterday to come again. As they came unarmed, we also approached them unarmed, and when we met we recognised old faces well known years ago at Abeokuta. They were surprised to hear that Mr. Wood was in the camp.

These men reported the matter to the Ekiti kings and leaders and a deputation was sent to meet Mr. Wood on the battlefield to hear what he wanted. There Mr. Wood repeated the same words as to the Ibadan chiefs. The Ijesas demurred to any proposal of peace, they said their determination was " to fight it out to the last drop of blood." But Labirinjo of Lagos, who was amongst them, spoke most sensibly till he won them over ; he dilated on the vicissitudes and uncertainties of war, and the desirability of peace. He begged Mr. Wood to do all in his power to bring about the desired peace ; but they could not ask him over to their camp without first obtaining the consent of their kings and leaders.

The object was gained at last on the 29th September, 1884, when Mr. Wood and his colleagues passed over to the Ekiti camp and stated his mission of peace. There was a good deal of highflown talk, and a show of fierce determination not to yield ; at the end there was an adjournment till the next day.

That day, September 30th, happened to be the Moslem festival of Beiram, no meeting was held in the morning. The Moslems on both sides had to repair to the battlefield for their prayers and sacrifice. On such days on previous occasions the most sanguinary battle used to be fought the Ekitis being determined that Qyos should not worship on their soil : great preparations for the strife was usually made, and human blood often mingled with that of rams offered in sacrifice ! But on this occasion, out of respect to Mr. Wood's presence in the camp, there was no battle. Mr. A. F. Foster and the writer were sent with the flag of truce to post themselves between the two parties and . thus their worship was performed in peace, each party returning quietly to the camp.

In the afternoon of the same day there was another meeting of the chiefs, after which an elaborately written document was placed in Mr. Wood's hands, stating the terms on which they would agree to make peace. This was with some difficulty deciphered to read thus :

1. That they claimed their independence and would no longer serve the Ibadans.
2. That the Owa, being the AlAfin's younger brother, would still acknowledge him by a yearly gift, which is not to be taken for tribute but as a token of respect.
3. That they would not carry war into Oyg territories provided their own territories were respected.

4. That they would claim Igbajo, Ada, Otan and Iresi for the Owa of Ilesa, those places being his originally.
5. That the Ibadans should withdraw from Of a, handing Of a over to the Ilorins.
6. That the Modakekes, being Oyos, should remove from If§ soil. That it had been their purpose after defeating and driving away the Ibadans from their territory to fall upon Modakeke and destroy it, selling the captives to defray the expenses of the war, but out of respect for Mr. Wood they would give up the idea, but Modakeke must be removed.
7. That the exile Awujale be re-instated.
8. That there be a general and lasting peace throughout the

The Rev. Mr. Wood and party returned to the Ibadan camp the next day with these conditions of peace, and delivered them verbatim to the Ibadan chiefs in council without any comment. After a private consultation among themselves they gave the following replies to each :

1. That out of deference to the white man, and in order to peace, they agreed to grant the Ekitis their independence.
2. That the brotherly relationship between the AlAfin and the Owa should by all means be revived ; they could have no objection whatever to that, as the AlAfin is their own lord and master.
3. That they agreed to respect Ije§a territories provided the Ijesas respected theirs.
4. As to Otan, Ada, Iresi, Igbajo, the Owa's claim to these places belongs to a remote antiquity, and that by tradition only, at present they are not subject to the Owa if even they ever were ; and note that the inhabitants are not generally Ijesas, but Qyos. It should be left to the people themselves to decide under whom they would be.
5. They objected to remove Modakeke now, being the key to their own situation, but when the war was over they would require at least two years respite for preparation to remove the town to another site.
6. That if the King of Of a choose to return to his former allegiance to the Ilgrins, that is his own affair, they were protecting

him only as a friend, he had never been nor is he now under their allegiance. They are defending Ofa because they v/ould not hke to see an Oyo city so historic to be destroyed.

7. As to the King of Ijebu, they had no hands in his dethronement. They only heard the report of it in their camp : they were for years begging the Ijebus to open the road for trade and they refused : they were only too glad to accept their offer for trade now : how it came about they are not supposed to know, but they could not hold themselves responsible for the Awujale's reinstatement.

On the next day Mr. Wood and party returned again to the Ekiti camp with the Ibadan rephes. This the Ekiti chiefs met to consider on that and the following day, and then they formulated their resolutions :

1. That the four above-mentioned towns be removed at once and go with the Ibadans, the Owa desiring them no longer as his subjects.
2. That Ofa should be evacuated at once and go with the Ibadans.
3. The same with Modakeke.

The Rev. Mr. Wood for once broke through his reserve and put in a kind word for Modakeke in consideration of the sick, the infirm, women and children. On account of these time ought necessarily to be allowed for their removal, Modakeke being a large town.

The Ekiti chiefs then said they would grant them 18 days and no longer, after which they should fall a prey.

With these demands Mr. Wood and party returned to the Ibadan camp in the afternoon, and reported to the Ibadan chiefs. The chiefs were rather indignant at the Ekitis dictating terms to them as to a conquered

people, they only submitted to these indignities out of deference to Mr. Wood : but they refused point blank to remove any of these towns until they had returned home to Ibadan,

Mr. Wood returned the next day to the Ekitis and reported to them the resolution of the Ibadans. The Ekitis now agreed to extend the 18 days to 120 days, " after which they should fall a prey if not removed."

This ultimatum was conveyed to the Ibadans the next day by the Rev. Mr. Wood. It aroused a great deal of indignation among the Ibadan chiefs that the Ijesas should be dictating terms of peace to them ! Somehard words were used which threw a damper on Mr. Wood's spirit. Finally the chiefs met the next day to speak out their own minds. They said to Mr. Wood, " Hitherto the Ekitis have been dictating to us, and we have practically

accepted all their terms ; but now we have only one request to make : as nothing can be done until we reach home, in order to expedite matters let the Ekitis retire from their camp into the town of Mesin behind them — only a mile distant — on that same evening we shall be ready to leave.

And again, why stipulate about the removal of these towns when they said they wanted universal peace ? Is it an essential of peace to bring such distress upon thousands ? However, if such be necessary to a lasting peace all over the country, we require 15 months at least in which to remove Modakeke, Igbajo, Otan, Iresi, and Ada.

On the 8th of October Mr. Wood returned again to the Ekiti camp with the requests of the Ibadans, which were duly considered.

Whilst the Ekitis would be prepared to grant the 15 months respite they would on no account remove from their camp into the town. They assured Mr. Wood they would never pursue after the Ibadans. Their Commander-in-Chief Ogedemgbe exclaimed, " Aja ki ilepa Ekun, Ekun ni won, Aja I'awa, Oyinbo maha mu won lo " (" The dog cannot pursue after a leopard, they are leopards, and we but dogs. White man, do take them away.")

As an assurance of their sincerity the Ekiti chiefs said they were ready to build a temporary house for Mr. Wood and his party on the battlefield and leave with him all the Ijesa Christians to stay there as a witness until the Ibadans were clean gone.

Mr. Wood returned to the Ibadans on the next day with these proposals.

To these the Ibadan chiefs replied, " We have no objection to the temporary house being built, and the Ijesa Christians remaining there with the white man (though what effectual guarantee that will prove we fail to see), but we do certainly object to entrap ourselves in a defile under their very eyes. What the chiefs may desire is one thing ; what the uncontrollable war-boys may do is another. If they are sincere let them put a mile between us and themselves, Mesin Ipole is not far. We have accepted all their terms, that is the only stipulation we have to make, and that is reasonable enough."

No argument could prevail upon the Ibadan chiefs to yield this one point, and they asked Mr. Wood to try his utmost to get the Ekitis to agree to this, then all would be right, and the honour of putting an end to this war would be his. With a trembling heart Mr. Wood made this last effort, and the result justified his fears. The Ekitis would not hear of it. They grew wild at the very idea.

Thus ended in failure Mr. Wood's effort at peace negotiation.

On that very night the Ijesas came to the battlefield and fired three rockets into the Ibadan camp which, however, did no harm. Before Mr. Wood left the Ibadans wrote him a letter of thanks for his efforts, and addressed letters also to Chief Ogundipe of Abeokuta, who had shown much interest in their affairs, and also to the Governor of Lagos, lauding Mr. Wood's efforts.

The Rev. Mr. Wood and party left the Ibadan camp on the 17th October, 1884, and hostiUties were resumed with much vigour during the remaining months and during the whole of the following year.

Early in 1885 Mr. Wood, in order to complete his tour of inspection, left Lagos to visit the C.M.S. stations at Ondo and Ilesa via Leke, Itebu and Aiyesan. On reaching Ondo the Rev. C. Phillips, the pastor of those parts, accompanied him to Ilesa, and thence to the seat of war again, from the Ijesa side, and he repeated his efforts of the preceding year between the two camps, asking the same questions whether it was not time for a cessation of hostiUties. He had to face the same objections as before : and this second effort also, Hke the first, ended in failure.

§ 2. Death of Latosisa the Are-Ona-Kakanfo

In the year 1885, not long after the Rev. J. B. Wood left the camp the second time, Latosisa, the GeneraHssimo of the Ibadan army, died. His death being wholly unexpected, various reasons have been assigned as the cause of it : (i) That he had forfeited his title as A. O.K., having exceeded the traditional 60 days in the campaign. But this could hardly have weighed much with him considering that times had greatly changed and many ancient customs with them. (2) That he had lost his influence among the war chiefs, and therefore he committed suicide.

There is not the sUghtest doubt about this loss of influence. It was he himself who, by reversing the policy of his immediate predecessor, and advancing to high position many of the young men heirs to great houses in preference to older and more experienced men but with less means at their command, brought it about. The few older chiefs formerly his companions in arms having died out, he now found himself surrounded by much younger folks, the companions of his son. There is a certain camaraderie amongst these young men, nearly all of the same age, and sons of distinguished bygone chiefs, bred in the same atmosphere, and naturally of a common sympathy with one another. These young men have never ceased to lament those of their number whose deaths were due directly or indirectly to the intrigues of the Are, especially of lyapo the Seriki, son of the late Balogun Ibikunle,

whom he sent " to sleep," of Aderibigbe, son of the late Bale Olugbode, Belo, son of the late Osi Osundina, and Awo, son of the late Baba Isale Labgsinde, all of whom perished in this war which the Are had brought about. And even of Ilori, son of the late Basorun Ogunmola, who met his death at the Jdumi war by the Are's bad statesmanship ; not to speak of men of lesser note. They felt sure that his object in bringing about these deaths was to make room for his ow-n son to outshine the rest, so that he might perpetuate the headship of Ibadan in his own family. But the proximate cause of his death seemed to be due to the action of one of his slaves towards Ajayi Osungbekun, the senior chief among the young men, and next to himself in command.

The actions of the Are's slaves at this time beggar description, both at the seat of war, especially in the provinces, and at home, they carried on their excesses regardless of age, rank or sex. Robbery, seizing by violence, rape, etc., were of daily practice. The knowledge that these slaves were captives led to the town by the very people of whom they had now become masters through the indulgence of the Master, made their crime less pardonable.

The Seriki having sent home for a ram and other things to offer sacrifice, the time for which was drawing near, his mother sent him also some Eko, home-made, with her love. The messenger came all the way quite safely with his charge. Leaving Irehe, he was making for Igbajo and was within a few hours from the camp when he came up with some of the Are's slaves who had gone out looting ! One of them in particular wrested the ram from him, and seized the Eko, devouring the latter there in the messenger's presence, who kept crying out, " It is the Seriki's ! It is the Seriki's ! " " And who is the Seriki ? " retorted the slave. Both of them got into the camp together, and the messenger related to his master all that happened to him and his charge all within sight, as it were, of the camp. The Seriki called together his comrades and poured his tale into S3anpathetic ears. They were mad with rage. They assured him of their support in whatever measure he might adopt, but the slave must never go with impunity (for they knew that as usual the Are would never deal condignly with him), for the same thing might occur to any one of themselves to-morrow.

Together they accompanied him to the Are to complain of the action of his slave and to demand redress. Unfortunately the Are took the matter hghtly : instead of dealing out sharp punishment to the slave he left

him to dispute the matter with the Seriki. He even attempted to shield him, before the culprit was forcibly brought forward. The Seriki then asked him, " Did not the

messenger tell you the things were mine ? " He answered, " Yes, he did, but how am I to know that he was speaking the truth when he said, ' It is the Seriki's ' ? I thought he was deceiving me." There was no apology made, his master looked on amused. The Seriki thereupon arose, unsheathed his sword, and with one sweep severed his head from his shoulders in the very presence of his master !

All the war chiefs present neither moved nor said a word. The Are, imperturbable as usual, but comprehending at once what it all meant, said nothing. The meeting was immediately adjourned.

It was said that the Are afterwards sent the Seriki ii heads of cowries. (This being the amount usually paid to the head chief for unsheathing his sword.) This the Seriki was said to have accepted without any apology. It is a metaphorical way of asking, "Are you prepared to take the headship?" His acceptance of the money was an answer in the affirmative.

Not one of the chiefs called on the Are or sympathized with him on this direct affront offered him, and this grieved him most, being a clear evidence that their sympathy was all on the other side. He then knew that this was but the beginning of the end, and it became him to die an honourable death. He was not laid up for long, the fact of his ailment was not known throughout the camp before the rumour of his death followed. Just before the end he sent for Sanusi, his eldest son, and gave him his last charge. Sanusi left him smoking his pipe, his courtiers sitting all around him. He was heard to cough gently as if suffocated by the fumes of his pipe, and putting down the pipe he lay quietly on his mat and adjusted his cloth over himself and thus passed away gently. Those sitting about him and looking on scarcely beheved he was dead !

Thus passed away one whose narrie will ever be remembered in Yoruba history as the man who raised the fame of Ibadan to its highest pitch of glory and by his bad statesmanship brought it down to its lowest level, and there left it.

The late Latosisa was the son of a private man, a native of Ilora, a suburb of Oyo. He joined the marauders at Ibadan as a private soldier, and in early life he was a very unfortunate man ; although he never missed any predatory excursions, he never did well for himself in any. He lived to be an old bachelor because he could not afford the means of marrying a wife. He was a palm dresser and from his own statement he could tell the nature of all the palm trees for miles around Ibadan. His turn of fortune began when in a civil war at Ibadan he was fortunate enough to have caught a woman with some children. It was then he had a wife ! And he sold the children to start life with.

Being inured and accustomed to poverty he continued to the end of his days to be thrifty, to feed sparingly and mostly on dry food, as in early life when he could afford nothing else.

He was one of the faithful followers of Ogunmola, the late Basorun of Ibadan, the captain of whose guards he was when Ogunmola was the Otun Balogun of Ibadan. He was a man of a genial disposition and of winning manners.

His first military command as a captain was when he was sent to take over charge of the army under Akawo before Iwawun, but both were hard-pressed and even besieged in their camp by the Ijayes that came to the succour of Iwawun, before Ogunmola and Osundina came to their aid and defeated the Ijayes {vide Chap." XVIII, p. 346).

He was originally a pagan, and thrice was he taken to an Ifa grove for purification in order to have children (for he had none for many years after the firstborn, who was killed at the Ijaye war), but to no purpose. He then embraced the Moslem faith, and became confirmed in the faith by the birth of a son whom he named Sanusi. This was during the I jebu Ere war. He signaHzed himself at the late Ilesa war when, in taking the last road to the city, he had to oppose the army from the country whilst Ajayi Ogboriefon opposed that from the city. Together with his colleague he rose rapidly ; owing to political changes at Ibadan he soon found himself at the head of affairs. He wrested from Ojo Aburu-maku of Ogbomoso the title of A. O.K. He

obtained the Ojiko {vide p. 74) from the King with two slaves; he never wore it himself but his favourite slave Idagana used to wear it in front of him as Abogunrin that of the late Are Kurunmi of Ijaye.

He was the hero of the Ado and Aiyede wars when he took the field in person. The wars were unprovoked, they were simply for the love of slave hunting. Elated by the easy victories won, he declared war against the Egbas, against the expressed wishes of the King and his own war chiefs ; this compUcation with the Egbas gave room for the rebellion of the Ijesa and Ekiti provinces which culminated in this war.

He was undoubtedly an ambitious man, and envied the glory of the two foremost houses at Ibadan, viz., those of Ibikunle and of Ogunmola. He strove to efface the fame and glory of both houses and to exalt his own over all, but in this he failed. His death was rather inglorious. His bones were preserved and taken home to Ibadan for interment.

§ 3. The Vicissitudes of War

After the death of the Are, Ajayi Osungbekun, the Seriki, became the leading General of the Ibadan army. In fact he was

the only titled war chief, the older men having all died, and the Are did not fill up several important vacancies before this war began.

But the Ibadans were loth to retain a Seriki as their leader, they had always been led to victory (said they) by a Balogun and not by a Seriki. It was unanimously agreed that he should assume the title of Balogun.

As the leading chief the title that really devolved upon him was that of Bale, but that is a non-combatant title, and for him to take it would mean that he should retire from the seat of war and go home — which was impracticable at this crisis.

And again, after the death of the late Balogun Ajayi Ogboriefon, when the national god Ifa was consulted as to his successor the oracle declared for Akintola, son of the late Balogun Ibikunle, and brother of Seriki lyapo. Akintola then was an untitled chief, only an Are-agor6, and the Are was not prepared to grant so high a title to the head of a house he was then determined to see degraded, consequently he left the title open, and was not going to fill up this and other vacancies till after the war. In conferring the title on Osungbekun now, it was understood that he was merely to hold it in trust for Akintola, as Akintola could not rightly be placed over him, but after the close of the war, when he entered upon his rightful title of Bale, Akintola would then come to his own.

But there are many amongst the Ibadans who attributed their failure in this war to disobedience to the voice of the oracle in not making Akintola the Balogun, and that they were not Ukely to win under any other against the voice of the oracle. And again it is to be noted that when Akintola first arrived at Kiriji and had to fight single-handed, then Ogedemgbe was caught and let off, because of the secret combination against the Are, which pointed to the fact that the oracle divined correctly. But his advancement now would be most inexpedient, and the present arrangement seemed fair enough.

The War under the Leadership of Ajayi. — The young war chiefs who had resolved to win no victories which would redound to the praise and glory of the Are, had been greatly seconded in their resolve by circumstances they never dreamt of, and now that they would wish to do so, events which had transpired were too much for them. Very few battles were fought during the years 1885 and 1886, as the Ibadans had now been able to secure some rifles, and were not slow to learn the use of them (though nothing to be compared to those of the Ekitis in point of number). The Ekitis could no longer approach the Ibadan camp to shoot into it with

impunity and to offer battle. But still they had the advantage of position. While the Ibadans were filing out of camp in the day of battle their rifle corps could always make a target of them, but when they had all spread themselves on the battlefield the chances were somewhat even, both sides had to seek cover and shelter from the sharpshooters. They then did more of skirmishing than of real battle.

The War at 0/a.— But the war at Ofa was raging with unabated fury. The men of Ofa and the Ibadan contingent there encamped outside the city, and erected double walls connecting the city with the camp. Behind the outermost wall they engaged the enemy. The Ilorins, trusting more to their cavalry, had but few infantry men, besides those supplied them by the Ekitis, and they were' armed with swords. The method of the cavalry men was to gallop round and round beyond the range of bullets, and then watch the opportunity for seizing a weak point or take their enemies unawares and endeavour to pull down the walls or spear the foe. When they were pressing too hard upon the defenders, the Balogun of Ibadan sent over one of his slaves, Babare by name, a sharpshooter, with a rifle and a good supply of cartridges. His presence was always in demand at whatever point the battle was hottest, and by dropping two or three horsemen he always caused the Ilorins to decamp.

The War at Modakeke. — Here the battle was fiercest, as the Ifes, Ekitis and Ijebus who were pressing hard to destroy the town, were better supphed with arms of precision. Akintgla, who was sent to reinforce the place twice, suffered disasters by ambuscade which nearly proved fatal to his life. At the first instance the Ifgs came to provoke a fight after having placed ambuscades in several places in the ruins of the city. As the Modakeke war chiefs and the Ibadan contingent joined battle with them at the Akogun market, the Ifes retreated as if defeated, and they were being pursued until the pursuers were drawn off to a considerable distance from the town, then the ambuscades opened fire behind them. They were completely hemmed in on every side, and had to fight their way back. In the rush, Akintola's horse slipped and fell, and he was fortunate enough to escape being trodden to death as many others were, horse and foot ! As soon as they had fought their way through one set of ambush men, and were walking slowly to take breath, another set would open fire upon them ; thus they went from one to the other, the Ifes and Ijesas pressing hard in pursuit, determined to take Modakeke that day. But Adepoju, the Balogun of Modakgke, at the expense of his life saved the situation : with a band of a faithful few he barred the way

against the pursuers and fought desperately like a hero, against great odds until he fell among the slain. It was instantly reported in the town that both Akintola and the Balogun had fallen, and many had already begun to pack up to flee when Akintola's drum was heard approaching. He himself by this time was completely exhausted, panting and thirsty. He owed his safety to his cousin Latunji, an intrepid horseman. Latunji it was said, woke up, that morning feeling sad and depressed, and on consulting his Tfa he was advised not to go out that day, and consequently he kept at home ; but when he heard of the disaster he immediately saddled his war horse and went to the succour of his cousin. He met him at the Akogun market, being hotly pursued and almost taken alive. He dashed upon the pursuers, spearing them right and left, then cantering round and round his cousin said "Are agoro maha rin pele pele" (Are agoro, do walk on gently, gently) and kept the pursuers at bay until they reached the town of Modakeke.

In this disaster Akintola lost his favourite charger, his Dane guns were thrown away in the flight, and what he prized most of all, his father's war dress, an heirloom in the family. It had descended in due order through his elder brothers Ko-ejo, Babayemi, Obembe, and lyapo to himself ; being a garment studded with charms, it was too heavy for him to carry in the flight so he entrusted it to one of his men who in the rush fell down and lost the garment. It was picked up by the Ifes and carried away in triumph, together with his horse as a trophy of war.

The second disaster was at an engagement with the Ijebus at Isoya. The Ibadans and Modakekes were enticed into a distance in the forest in the direction of Isgya, and there the ambush attacked them on every side. Akintola had to fight his way back and lost several of his guns, his men throwing them away in their flight. The brave son of Chief Olubode fell in this disaster.

Having failed to dislodge the Ibadans from Kiriji, the confederates were determined to take Modakeke at all costs, so that Kiriji might be taken at the rear. They now reinforced the Ifes strongly from the Ijesas and Ekitis, Prince Fabumi at their head. He was determined to take Modakeke at his first fight, but in this he failed. In the same way he had determined to defeat the Ibadan army at Kiriji before Ogedemgbe came to take over the command, but in a fair fight he met with intrepid warriors like himself in Akintola and Apampa. He left several of his veterans dead on the battlefield, and many more — like himself— wounded in several places. Ogunsigun the leader of the Ijebus was also reinforced by the ex-Awujale's party from Epe.

The Modakekes now took great pains to fortify their town.

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They repaired the walls thoroughly and built forts upon them in several places, placing in them sharp shooters with rifles. But they never shielded themselves behind these walls, they always engaged the enemy outside.

Akintola also replaced his lost Dane guns with rifles, mainly at the expense of his tributary town of Ipetumodu ; Apampa also acquired some rifles but was far more lenient with his tributary town of Eduabon. (Edun-j'abon.)

The houses of the two most powerful war-chiefs at Modakeke in the 'sixties, Ojo Akitikori the Balogun and Ajombadi the Otun, were duly upheld by their worthy sons and successors, Oyebade and Adepoju respectively, both of whom fell in the defence of their town. They were duly succeeded by their brothers, Detomi of the the latter and Oke (nicknamed pupa, i.e., yellow, from his hght complexion) of the former. Oke also fell in an engagement and was succeeded by his half-brother Oke, surnamed Dudu (the dark) from his complexion.

Detomi became lame in both his feet, but still directed the battle on horseback.

With the command of a few rifles by the Ibadans the ardour of their foes cooled, and the war here, as at Kiriji, became less frequent than formerly and might practically be said to be at a standstill.

Chapter XXIX

THE INTERVENTION OF THE BRITISH GOVERNMENT

§ I. Measures by Governor Moloney

About the end of January, 1886, the Government of Lagos was severed from that of the Gold Coast, and Lagos was constituted a separate colony with Capt. A. C. Moloney as its first Governor. One of his first public acts was to feel his way towards the settlement of the interior difficulties.

In an interview the writer (who happened to be at Lagos at the time) had with his Excellency on the 23rd of January the topic of conversation turned mainly on the state of things in the interior and he asked the writer to put down in writing an account of the interview, stating all he knew about the complications from the commencement, and what prospect there was of peace ; also to give the names of the principal chiefs of Ijebu, Abeokuta, Ibadan, Ekiti, and Ilorin concerned in this war, and an account of the visits of the Rev. J. B. Wood to both camps in 1884, and also to state his opinion as to how they might receive some one like himself coming among them to settle their difference for them. This the writer did in a long letter to H. E. the Governor.

The Governor was then resolved to make use of the writer as a messenger to the Ibadan camp, and of the Rev. C. Phillips to the Ekiti camp.

Having obtained the consent of the local secretary of the C.M.S. for making use of their services (both being C.M.S. agents) the Governor issued the following instructions :

Government House,

March 1st, 1886.

Sir, — The Venble. Archdeacon Hamilton has most considerately placed your services at my disposal in connection with satisfying to the latest date on the feehng in the direction of peace that obtains between the Ibadans and the Ekiti parapos. You have in a most praiseworthy and philanthropic manner come forward to carry out on the subject of my wishes. They are embodied in the accompanying letter addressed to the Baloguns, chiefs, elders and people of Ibadan with whom you say you are on the most intimate and friendly terms.

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You will be good enough accordingly to consider the contents

of such letter as your instructions, and in view of the interviews

I have had with you I will hope to find success as far as it can

will attend your endeavours to act as my instructions dictated.

I have, etc.,

Alfred Moloney, Governor.

The instructions to Rev. PhiUips are the same, only substituting for " Balogun, chiefs, elders and people of Ibadan, with whom you say you are on the most intimate," etc., to " Owa, Balogun, elders, chiefs and people of Ijesa whom you at times visited."

The following is a. copy of the letter addressed to the chiefs by Governor Moloney :

Government House.

February 2yth, 1886.

Governor Moloney to the Balogun s. Chiefs, Elders and People of Ibadan,

Gentlemen, — I have the honour to convey that I take this opportunity to announce to you my return on the 8th ult., and my assumption as Governor of the administration of the Government of the Queen's Colony of Lagos.

2. It is a pleasure for me to come again amongst people whom I know and who know me, and it is almost needless for me to assure you that, as it has been in the past so it will be in the future, my aim and object to promote in every legitimate way I can, the general interest and development of West Africa and the peace of the country.

3. I attach, as I am informed you do, much importance to the restoration of peace between you and the countries with which you have unfortunate differences.

4. Entertaining as I have always such a feeling and a due appreciation of the value of a general good understanding and friendly relationship in our surroundings, I sincerely invite the entertainment by our neighbours of like sentiment.

5. I am pained to learn that the unfortunate differences which have fruitlessly, as regards the country's good, struggled on for years between you and the Ijesas, and others still continue. The country and people are, I gather, tired generally of the miserable and obstructive state of things, which has done so much mischief, and has been productive of no general benefit ; on the contrary, there have followed bloodshed, loss of hfe, devastation, desolation, and other miseries.

6. Good kindly feelings have always existed between you and

this colony, may they long continue so ; knowing this, I feel it due to inform you of my return.

7. As regards restoration of tranquility once more to the country, and the desire of the contending parties for mediation to be undertaken by this Government, it may be convenient I should remark that, as a matter of course, distinct and unconditional overtures for peace must be made to this Government by all the parties concerned ; then I may feel myself in a position of being enabled to send an offtcer into the interior with a view to attempt to effect a peace based upon conditions which are Ukely to render it a lasting one. Each side should but know what conditions as far as he is concerned he has to offer, and would be most likely to prove of duration. On this part I should like to be clearly informed.

8. Then it would be well I should be clearly enhghtened by each on the nature of the terms of responsibility, as such must rest entirely with the parties craving peace, for the fulfilment of their engagements, if peace be restored each is prepared to offer and accept.

9. What are the guarantees each will give for his sincerity and earnestness in his appeal for peace.

10. Each side may, for instance, suggest or voluntarily offer that he will enter into an agreement binding on him to suspend hostilities for, say, six months or any other duration deemed advisable, then there should be no need for fresh supplies of guns and ammunitions for such a time. Such an agreement as to cessation of hostilities, and of armament should be entered into not only at the camps but also at all other places concerned within the territories of the opposing parties.

ir. Each side may, for all I know to the contrary, be prepared to give as hostages influential persons to any arbitrator, appointed by the Government, against treachery during period of withdrawal of encampment to home, so that neither side may have cause to continue the entertainment of any doubt as to security of retreat. Each side may be ready to engage to withdraw his army at a given time, to subsequently disembody it, and to allow component parts to return to their respective towns, homes, and families, and to the resumption once more of peaceful avocations.

12. From past experience there must be prominent in the minds of contending parties a desire of the Government to befriend them, and to bring about a reconciliation amongst them if they will only place themselves to abide by the settlement the Governor may make.

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13. I shall be glad to heai* from you soon, and to receive any representative messengers you may be pleased to send to me, who can faithfully give me your mind on your interior troubles, and satisfy me on the sincerity of your desire for the restoration of peace.

14. It should not any longer be viewed or allowed that the present disordered state of things in the interior should be subservient merely as I fear has been the case to the advantage of the few. Peace should be established for the common good of all.

15. The bearer of this letter, the Rev. Samuel Johnson is well known to you all, let me commend him to your kind care and consideration.

16. I have sent a like communication to the other side.

17. Both of my messengers may, with the desire and concurrence of parties concerned, meet on the encamping ground.

Wishing you and your people peace, and to your country an early resumption of peaceful occupation on the part of its inhabitants.

I have the honour, etc.,

Alfred Moloney, Governor.

The Rev. C. PhilHps is the bearer of a similar letter to the Ekiti chiefs, with the exception that " the Rev. C. Phillips " is the messenger named in paragraph 15,

The writer left Lagos on the 2nd March, 1886, via Ijebu, with an oral message from the Governor to the Balogun of Ijebu to the effect that the Governor being his old friend, desired to announce to him his return to administer the government of Lagos, and that during his administration he wanted peace all over the country. That the bearer of this message was a messenger from him to the interior kings and chiefs for that purpose and that he wished him to convey this to the Awujale.

This message was delivered to the Balogun in his camp at Orii on the 6th, when the messenger got there. He was so pleased to hear that the Governor saw his way to interfere in the interior difficulties that he at once sent for the other war chiefs to hear the joyful news from the mouth of the Governor's own messenger.

He at once despatched a messenger to the new Awujale asking him to send one of his trusty Agurins to come and hear the good news delivered to him.

The Awujale felt rather hurt that he was ignored by not hearing the message first before the Balogun. He said that it was for him to inform the Balogun, and not the Balogun him. However, he

would not let his feelings stand in the way of so important a message. He sent an Agurin as desired, who spoke out the King's mind on this (what he considered) breach of order ; but he was immediately pacified when told that it was just otherwise, but that the Governor only wished to approach his highness through his old friend the Balogun. The Agurin then said, " The Governor and the Awujale are of the same mind, wishing nothing else but peace."

The Ibadan home authorities were much pleased at the prospect of peace, and Tahajo, the senior chief, assured the messenger that the war chiefs would not hesitate to accept the terms of peace with the Governor as arbitrator.

From Ibadan, the Governor's messenger proceeded to Oyo. The Rev. D. Olubi of Ibadan, then the Superintendent of the C.M.S. Missions of that district, and who was equally interested in the subject of peace, embraced this opportunity of going with the Governor's messenger, to pay his usual pastoral visits to Oyo, Iseyin and Ogbomoso, and to see what influence he could exert with the King to induce him to send one of his Ilaris and His Majesty's staff, with the Governor's messenger.

On the 19th March they had an audience with the King and the following letter from the Governor of Lagos to His Majesty was read to him :

Governor Moloney, C.M.G., to His Majesty King Adeyemi OF Qyq.

February 2yth, 1886. King, — I have the honour to convey that I take this opportunity to announce to you my return to Lagos on the 8th ult. and my assumption as Governor of the administration of the Queen's Colony under that name.

2. It is a pleasure for me to come among people whom I know, and who know me, and it is almost needless for me to assure you that as it has been in the past so it will be in the future, my aim and object to promote in every legitimate and peaceful way I can the general interest and development of West Africans.

3. I attach as I am confident you do, knowing how long you have longed for the restoration of peace to the Yoruba and other interior countries, much importance to the promotion of good relationship, between this colony and our interesting and friendly neighbours, among whom stands prominently yourself.

4. Entertaining as I have always such a feehng and a due appreciation of the value of general good understanding and

friendly relationship in our surroundings, I sincerely invite the entertainment of our neighbours of like sentiment.

5. I am pained to learn that the unfortunate differences which have fruitlessly as regards the country's good struggled on for years between the Ibadans and the Ijesas still continue. The country and people are generally tired of the miserable and obstructive state of things which has done so much mischief and been productive of no general good. On the contrary there have followed desolation, bloodshed, and other miseries.

6. I shall be glad to hear from you soon and to receive any representative messengers you may be pleased to send to me, who can give me your mind on the interior troubles, an end to which should be brought about as soon as possible ; such is the cry and desire of every right-minded African having at heart his country's interest.

7. I hear both sides are tired of the war. I should be glad to be satisfied that such was the case.

8. Wishing you and your people every good wish.

I have the honour, etc.,

Alfred Moloney, Governor. His Majesty King Adeyemi, The AlAfin of Oyo.

After hearing the letter read he said that he was glad that the Governor after all saw his way to interfere and that he was prepared to bear the expenses of whatever it would cost to restore peace to his dominions. He further said that the news was too good to be true, however, he would let the Oyo Mesi know about it.

The last sentence cast a damper on the enthusiasm of the messengers. The control of foreign relations is vested in the King and for him to say he would consult the Qyq Mesi in this matter made it evident that he had ceased to take active interest in the matter. And so it turned out to be. Having sent twice to Lagos (in 1881 and 1882, Mr. A. F. Foster being sent by the Abeokuta road) on the same subject, one would have expected his active interest and co-operation on this occasion, but it turned out to be otherwise ; the failure of the measures initiated by him must have pained His Majesty, and he did not care to compromise his dignity any more by furthering measures doomed to failure. He did not take into consideration the difference in the personaUty of the new Governor of Lagos.

After repeated messages to the palace on the following day, the King at last sent two private gentlemen, and without his staff,

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as his messengers to Lagos ! Taught by the experience of 1881, the Governor's messenger dedined to proceed with these men except with an Ilari and the King's staff. Three times he was waited upon the third day, before he at last granted an Ilari, with his staff, and the Ilari was none other but the same Oba-ko-se-tan as before !

The Governor's messenger with the King's Dari and his staff left Oyo on the 22nd March and reached the Ibadan camp on the 26thr

The war chiefs were glad to see the former but the presence of the latter — with his significant name — cast a damper on their spirits. After hearing the Governor's letter read they were very reluctant to accede to the Governor's request of sending down a messenger, saying, " It will all end in failure as before," thinking that an embassy headed by an Ilari, " The King is not ready," can scarcely ever be successful. Consequently they raised one objection after another, alleging the absence of the messenger of the King and the Balogun of Ijebu, that they could not afford to ignore those to whom they were indebted for being able to keep their position at Kiriji to that day, etc. However, after further deliberation better counsel prevailed, and they agreed to send their messengers down with the Governor's messenger.

By a happy coincidence, the Governor's messenger to the other side reached the Ekiti camp on the same day, and almost at the same hour, and on the following morning both messengers met on the battlefield with their flags of truce and each had good news to tell of the pacific tone of the respective chiefs they were sent to. On the following day they exchanged visits to the opposite camps and both were well received, and were much pleased to know that the chiefs of the opposite camp agreed to the Governor's interference.

A proposal emanating from the Elciti chiefs pleased the Ibadans very much as showing the sincerity of their motives, viz., that both the messengers of the Governor should visit the Ilorin camp and induce the Ilorins to agree to the truce, as the hostihties going on at Ofa were part and parcel of those at Kiriji and Modak§ke, only that they had no control over the independent Ilorin chiefs.

The Ibadan chiefs also proposed that both flags of truce should be set up, and kept flying at the battlefield until the terms of peace were definitely signed. This also was accepted by the Ekitis, and it was accordingly done the next day.

Both messengers read to the chiefs of the opposite camps the letters with which they were entrusted, in order to show that they were identical, the better to secure their confidence.

The messengers then took leave of each other to meet again at the Ofa and the Ilorin camps, each by his own route.

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§ 2. The Ilorins and the Peace Proposals

The Ijesa chiefs were not wiUing to allow the messenger of their side (the Rev. C. Phillips) to pass through the Ibadan and Ofa camps to that of Ilorin, although a shorter route of a day and a half's journey, lest it prejudice the minds of the Ilorin chiefs at the outset ; he had therefore to take a circuitous route of five days with the messengers of the Owa and the Ow6re through the Ekiti and Igbomina provinces to Karara's camp near Ofa.

The Governor's Ibadan messenger, who went by the direct route, arrived at Ofa on the ist of April and met the belligerents on the battlefield fighting, and was not lodged till the battle was over. Similarly the Governor's Ekiti messenger who arrived at the Ilorin camp on the 3rd met them on the battlefield, but as Kkrara, their Generahssimo, did not take the fielH in person that day, he had the opportunity of a preliminary talk with him on the subject of his mission. The battle lasted till 3 p.m. and he lost no time in obtaining permission from the Ilorin chiefs to come over to the battlefield to meet his colleague who he was sure would have reached Ofa. The messenger at Ofa had instructed the sentinels that as soon as they saw a white flag com.ing towards them they should send for him, and this they accordingly did, by despatching two men on horseback to apprize him of the same.

Both messengers welcomed each other on the Ofa battlefield as they did at Kiriji ; they arranged to rest the next day (being the Lord's day) and to commence work on the Monday as they did at Kiriji.

Although Chief Kkikik received the Rev. C. PhilHps well, yet he showed plainly by his conduct that he was not agreeable to the mission ; he appeared rather indifferent and his repUes were evasive. When he heard the Governor's letter read, he said, " The Ibadans are so treacherous that we cannot agree to an armistice, and again I cannot act without the orders of my King and therefore I cannot say anything good or bad."

At a second interview the Rev. PhiUips had with him he repeated the same thing and laid so much stress on " the King's orders " that the messenger asked whether he wished him to go to Ilorin to obtain the King's consent. The General was glad of the proposal, which he said he could not have made, but he wished that he should be accompanied by his colleague of the other side, and that they together visit the King at Ilorin.

This was perhaps to test the sincerity of the Governor's messenger. The latter objected, but the General insisted upon it that he should not go to Ilorin alone without his colleague at Ofa, adding that as tFie GoveiTior did not send to them direct, and that

this visit to his camp was an afterthought, it was but giving King Ahhu the respect due to him that both messengers should go together to deUver the Governor's message to him.

The Rev. C. PhiUips came over the next day to inform his colleague of Karkrk's proposal. Although they were not sent as far as to Ilorin yet they were resolved to leave no stone unturned in order to bring about the desired peace, even at their own risk.

Accordingly both of them went, accompanied by Adu the General's swordbeafer, and the messengers of the Owa, Ow6r6 and Ogedemgbe. It was but a day's journey, Ilorin was reached the same evening. The King did not lodge them, but sent them back with Kkrkra's messengers to Kkrkrk's house, which augured ill for their mission.

At Kkrark's house the accommodation given them was a room in which the smallpox epidemic had destroyed all the inmates thereof, the rags and rubbish of the deceased being still left in it uncleared away ; they had therefore to sleep in the open air and fortunately for them the weather was fair during the few days they spent at Ilorin.

The next thing which augured the failure of the mission was the reception the King gave the messengers. He had no private interview with them, they were sent for to dehver their message in open court amid the assembly of men, women and children, with a few of the chiefs. After reading to them the Governor's letter to the belligerents, King Alihu asked whether the Ibadan and Ekiti kings had heard it read, and whether it was acceptable to them. We replied in the affirmative. He then asked, " Why then did the Ibadans give battle to the Ekitis after the arrival of the Governor's messenger among them ? " He was told that the last battle fought took place five days before the arrival of the messengers to the camps. After a pause he asked,

" When are you returning ? " " As soon as Your Majesty sends us back, even if it be to-morrow," was the reply. " You shall wait three days more," continued he, " and I believe the Governor will not take it ill when he knows that it was I who detained you."

With this reply the messengers were sent back to their lodgings, amid the jeers and scorn of these Mohammedan fanatics who were calling them names, styUng them " Anasaras " {i.e., Nazarenes) etc. There was no doubt but that communications passed between Ilorin and the camp in the meantime.

The King dismissed the messengers the third day with these words :

" I have not much to say. Who should be entreated to give up a struggle, the assailant or the assailed ? I want peace myself

therefore my words will be few. The stronger should be entreated to let go the weaker." Turning to the Governor's Ibadan messenger he asked, " How many days it took you from Ibadan to the camp ? " " Five days." " And from the Ibadan camp to Ofa? " " One day." " And how many from Ofa to Ilorin ? " " Only one day." " Well," continued His Majesty, " the fact that the distance from Ibadan to our camp being six days and from the camp to Ilorin but one day shows that I am not the aggressor ; we are the weaker party and are only on the defensive. Our camp may be described as a shield raised to defend our country against reckless invaders. I am thankful to the Governor for his message and I will instruct my Balogun to send you back with a good message."

On asking the King if he would send a messenger to accompany "US back to the Governor he replied," If the Governor had sent to me direct I might do so." Being asked further whether he would comply with the Governor's wish in suspending hostilities for six months and accept him as an Arbitrator, he replied, " That is not my business, that is the Balogun's business." Then turning to theBalogun'? messenger the King said, " Tell your master to agree to whatever the Governor's messengers tell him." With these words the Governor's messengers left Ilorin for Kcirkrci's camp, where they arrived on the morning of April loth, 1886.

Kkvkrk congratulated them on their safe return and told the Governor's Ibadan messenger to send his boys over to Ofa at once in order to allay their apprehensions, but that he should himself wait till the afternoon when he would convene a meeting of the war chiefs to hear the Governor's message and to reply to the same. Soon after the Governor's messenger returned from the battlefield whither he had accompanied his boys on their way to Ofa, the Balogun Karkrk sent for him and his colleague and told them that one of his slaves had just escaped to Ofa, and that if he had not suspended hostilities since their arrival the slave would not have had the chance of doing so ; and that was one reason why he could not agree to the armistice of six months according to the Governor's wish.

The messengers replied that they had nothing to do with the escaping of slaves, and objected to his connecting it with the suspension of hostiUties, for slaves could always manage to escape at any time.

He then began to brag and boast of his prowess, detailing the number of successful battles he had fought with the Ibadans in this place. He gave an account of the origin and progress of this war from the time of the defeat of the Ilorins before Ikirun at the

Jalumi war. This, he said, was his third camp before Ofa, and from here that city would be taken. He stated how he had fought with and killed in one day the Balogun and Otun of OgbomgsQ, and had tried conclusions with every one of the Ibadan chiefs except the Are himself. They the Ilorins had been masters of several towns in the Oyo and Ekiti provinces and had their Ajeles (political Residents) in them ; but the Ibadans had ousted them from every one of them and would like to oust them from Ofa also ! That he would agree to the armistice of six months only on condition that the Ibadans withdrew their contingents from Ofa. He said, moreover, that the Ibadans were remarkable for their treachery " but could they equal the Fulanis for wiliness and cunning ? The Fulanis have seven different tricks, they have only used one as yet against Ofa and Ibadan, before they have made use of the remaining six Ofa will be taken."

" Two years ago the Sultan of Gando sent his envoy here to mediate between us. We observed the armistice for five months. Not only did we suspend hostilities, but also allowed traders on both sides to carry on between Ofa and Ilorin and even beyond. Unexpectedly the Ibadans shut their gates upon our traders, they refused to release them though we sent back their people to them."

He went on to say that the Ibadans were the common enemy of all, for even the AlAfin their King was on friendly terms with Ilorin and had exchanged presents with the King of Ilorin. " If the Governor would interfere at all let him bid the Ibadans retire from the Ekiti and Ilorin territories."

He went on further to dilate on his own prowess, and what his horses could do, and as a proof thereof he sent for the son of the King of Erin, captured a few days before the arrival of the messengers, heavily-laden with a couple of chains, for them to see him and hear from his own mouth. " Whose son are you ? " " The son of the King of Erin." " How came you to be here ? " " I was captured by the Ilorin horse." " Go back to your prison."

After all this talk the messengers were dismissed to prepare for the afternoon meeting.

About 3 p.m. a full meeting was convened in Karkra's reception room, all the war chiefs being present before he sent for the Governor's messengers. The General opened the meeting by introducing to them those who were present thus :

" Sitting on my left are the Balogun of the Fulanis, Ajikobi the Balogun of the Yorubas, and the last in order the Balogun of the 4th Standard of the Ilorin army, I myself being the Balogun of the Gambaris. Sitting before me are Agidiako the Balogun of Ofa

who deserted to me at the rebeUion of the King of Ofa ; next to him is Ogunmodede the head of the Ijesa contingents here. Sitting on my right are the Princes, the King's brothers. Now go on to deUver your message."

The Rev. C. Phillips read to them the Governor's letter to the beUigerents, after which Karkrci threw the subject open for discussion. The Balogun of the Fulanis began and was followed by each of the others, giving vent to their feelings in bitter invectives. One of them exclaimed, " A new era is come for us and Ahnu's Jehad has had a fresh start, we shall carry the koran to the sea."

Kkrark himself spoke last in the same strain. One and all of them evinced bitter feelings against the Governor's Ibadan messenger in particular, now and then caUing him " You Ofa man," and further, " If you choose to remain at Ofa you shall see what we can do." Another said, " In a few days we shall take Ofa, and you, if you remain there, will be taken." And another, " If you loiter on your way back to Ofa the horsemen will be upon you." and so on to that effect.

The Governor's messenger replied, " I am not an Ofa man, but the Governor's messenger." " Yes, we know that," repUed one of them. " Did you not go three days ago when at Ilorin to see your grandmother's grave ? But you have come to us through Ofa and anyone who did we call an Ofa man and is our enemy and worthy of death."

The messengers were thereupon dismissed. Seeing the excited feelings of the mob, a kind-hearted man standing by suggested to the Governor's Ibadan messenger, " Had you not better ask Karark for some one to escort you across, otherwise the mob will have torn your dress from your body ere you get to the gate of the camp. This friendly advice was followed, and the General told off his sword-bearer to escort the Governor's messenger as far as the locust tree in the battlefield where he used to take his seat on the day of battle. His colleague also was permitted to accompany him as far, and they stood there till they saw the messenger safely at Ofa.

The Ofa people were quite prepared for the failure of the mission ; they said they expected as much, and would never have allowed the effort to be made, but that they thought that probably the respect due to messengers from the Governor of Lagos might carry some weight with the Ilorins.

The Ilorins, true to their word and to show to both messengers that they were determined to take Ofa,

attacked the city furiously on the next day. The battle raged from the morning till the afternoon when both sides returned to their respective camps.

The Olgfa's Statements. — ^Before the Governor's messenger left Ofa, he had an interview with the Olofa, who made the following statements as to the true cause of the war :

" We are pure Yorubas by descent, and as such the subjects of the AlAfin of Oyo. It was after the fall of the ancient capital and the ascendancy of the Fulanis at Ilorin that we became subjected to the conquerors. We have been loyal to them ever since, we paid our tributes regularly, performed every menial work for them and submitted to all indignities without any complaints. We built their houses, worked their farms, and at every confinement in the King's harem we are to give tributes in money called ' soap money ' meaning soap to wash the babies with. Such was the menial servitude to which we were compelled to submit. Besides all these we served in all their wars. To all these we submitted in order to avoid such a crisis as this.

"But nine years ago the King of Ilorin sent to inform my late father, the then Olofa, of his intentions to wage war with the Ibadans. My father warned him against embarking on such an enterprise, so unnecessary and so risky, the Ibadans having given no cause of offence ; on the contrary their influence on the whole had been for good, for the whole of the Yoruba country in general, and the Ilorins also, had derived much benefit from the same.

" This advice offended the Ilorin king and chiefs and they had ever since regarded us as traitors and rebels. My father had to pay heavy fines for his advice, so heavy that all Ofa and her dependent towns had to subscribe to it, and yet they were not appeased. Again and again my father sent to assure the King of our loyalty and each time he used to utter smooth words and evasive replies.

" In spite of the warnings the Ilorins joined the Ekiti confederates and besieged Igbajo which they destroyed, and proceeded to Ikirun, and there the Ibadans dealt them a crushing blow in the Jalumi war. Those of them who escaped here naked and destitute we clothed and fed, the well-to-do we sent home on horseback. All this we did to please our masters, but all in vain. Three days later they intended to resent the shame and disgrace of their defeat upon us by taking Ofa by stratagem. A large army was collected and war was ostensibly declared against Erin, a suburb town of ours, my father being apprized of this so-called expedition replied that Erin could not be taken except Ofa be removed out of the way. Then war was openly declared against Ofa.

" Such was the cause of the present war. We had done nothing really to provoke it

" Three years ago the Sultan of Gando sent Potun one of his officers to mediate between us and to effect peace ; for four months there was an armistice after which the war was resumed. The Ilorins accused us of breaking the truce, which was a false charge, for while the negotiation was going on, instead of breaking up the camp they were removing it nearer and nearer, swelling their numbers by fresh recruits from home, and strengthening their position. Secret intelligence reached us from the Ilorin camp that we should be taken by surprise. The Are of Ibadan hearing this sent at once to put a stop to communications. This order was given not a minute too soon, for the report came on that very day that the Ilorins had seized all the Ibadan and Ofa people at Ilorin and in the camp. All the Ilorin people shut up at Ofa I collected and sent home, and Karara released also those of ours they had seized in their camp. If anything is said to the contrary it is absolutely false, we neither broke the truce nor was the initiative in releasing captives theirs. We shall be thankful if the Governor will interfere and save us and our people from undeserved ruin."

The Governor's messenger left Ofa on the 12th of April and arrived next day at the Kiriji camp to await his colleague.

§ 3. The Messengers and Preliminary Arrangements at Kiriji and Modakeke

On the third day (April 15th) after the arrival of the Governor's messenger at the Ibadan camp, an incident worth recording occurred which nearly marred the success of this mission entirely.

A young man in the Ibadan camp who was out of his mind went to the Elebolo camp, where an advanced column of the Ibadan army was stationed under Chief Enimowu. He had in his hand a bow without an arrow and roaming all over the camp at night, he kept shouting, " In heaven it was decreed that the war should come to an end, but you Elebolo soldiers are obstinate. The Balogun, the Maye, Agbakin, Timi of Ede, Atawgja of Osogbo, and the Olobu of Ilobu have all agreed that peace should be restored, but ye refuse, and yet at the day of battle, you prove yourselves cowards and cannot fight. I am just from the rock in the battlefield where I found this arrowless bow, a sure sign of the decree of heaven that hostilities should cease."

The man was taken to Enimowu that night, to whom he repeated the same words. Early next morning Enimowu went to the Balogun to report the incident, and it was surmised that the Governor's messenger must have sent one of his boys to proclcdm these words ! The Balogun then sent for the messenger to come

with his boy, he then questioned them as to the message the boy was sent to proclaim at the Elebolo camp last night.

Of course they denied all knowledge of any such thing. Enimowii thereupon confronted them, describing how the boy came with a bow in his hand, and how clad, and what he said. But the messenger's boy said he went nowhere last night, whilst Enimowu insisted that he did for he saw him himself. At this stage it dawned on 0&9. orie of the Balogun's young m.en, that there is a lunatic abroad, answering to the description of Enimowu, and who was accustomed to roam about the camp at night. It was suggested therefore that he should be sent for. Ogungbenro, the master of the lunatic, was reluctant to allow him out by day, but as the Balogun insisted that he should be brought, the lunatic himself sent a message to the Balogun to say if he wanted to see him he should come himself to him, as inferiors must always go to their superiors. Then the whole incident became a matter of laughter as a huge joke. Ogungbenro was, however, ordered to remove him from the camp at once, lest he might one day take it into his head to set the camp on fire.

The Governor's Ekiti messenger arrived on the other side on the i6th and hastened early on the 17th to his colleague at the Ibadan camp to announce his arrival.

The Ijesa chieftains were much disappointed at the failure of the negotiation with the florins ; but the Ibadans did not expect otherwise. Ogedemgbe, the Ekiti Generalissimo, however, said " If the florins would not agree to peace there was no reason why he should not on his part accept it." The Ibadan chiefs hearing this urged on Ogedemgbe to act the part of a plenipotentiary to the Ilorins and to do his best to bring them to reason, and this he did by sending a special messenger at once, but the Ilorins would not yield. The astute Ilorins, as we have mentioned above {vide p. 448), had taken the precaution of holding the Ekitis fast to the alliance by placing a contingent force among them, whilst retaining an Ekiti auxiliary force among themselves which they held more or less as a hostage.

The belligerents at Kiriji now proceeded with preliminary arrangements between themselves, through the Governor's messengers of both sides. Chief Ogedemgbe sent to the Ibadan chiefs to say, that whilst both parties had agreed to an armistice, and that hostilities should cease between them for at least six months until the Governor or his deputy should arrive among them they should not avail themselves of the opportunity for reinforcing their contingents at Ofa and at Modakeke. The Ibadans could not promise that because the safety of their position here depended upon

defensive measures in both places, unless the Ekitis would pledge themselves not to reinforce both places against them ; for if they heard that the fighting was getting unusually strong, and that their men were likely to be overpowered, they could not help sending reinforcement. Next, the Ibadan chiefs considering that the interval of six months' truce being so long, and the possibiUty of some misunderstanding arising which in the absence of the Governor's messengers, might undo the work now begun proposed that a special messenger on either side be appointed to meet in the battlefield every morning with the compHments of their respective masters, and if any untoward incident should occur, that they should have the power of arranging matters amicably. This proposal pleased the Ekitis so well that at their suggestion two were appointed on either side as a provision against illness or any disabihty, and a third from the Ibadan Elebolo camp

who was to report on the approach of the messengers on either side. The principal messenger appointed by the Balogun was Osun and the Agbakin appointed another to represent the other war chiefs. The principalmessengerappointedbyOgedemgbewasLupon,andanother was appointed to represent the rest of the Ekiti war chiefs, and all met with the Governor's messengers at the battlefield under the flags of truce, first on one side, and then on the other side, a little ceremony being performed by this small party. The hands of the special messengers of both sides were joined by the Governor's messengers in friendship, and by the AlAfin's Ilari and the Owa's messenger in the name of their respective masters. They were enjoined to have a friendly intercourse with each other to help to preserve peace until the arrival of the Governor or his Deputy. The ceremony was concluded by a ratification of the promises made, by the spHtting of kola nuts.

The Governor's messengers, and those of the King and the Owa thereupon bade each other adieu to meet again at the Ife and Modakek§ battlefield each by his own route.

The war chiefs on either side were grateful to the Governor for his disinterested interposition, and this they showed by sending some valuable presents to him by the hands of the accredited messengers of either side. The Ibadan chiefs sent him a horse and an alari cloth, the Balogun an ivory tusk, the Owa and Ekiti kings also sent valuable presents. Certain messengers whose names will be found below were deputed to accompany the Governor's messengers to Lagos according to his wishes expressed in Clause 13 of the " Instructions."

At Modakeke. — The Governor's Ekiti messenger had this time a shorter route than his Ibadan colleague, who did not reach Moda-

kek§ till the 24th of April. The latter, however, lost no time in setting up his flag, and going to the battlefield to meet his colleague who he was sure must have arrived at the Ife camp some days previously ; but he had to wait till 6 p.m. before the colleague made his appearance, and explained the difficulties in their way. The Ifes would not listen to any pourparlers whatever until the Modakekes should explain the reason for their being in arms and prepared for a battle the previous day ; they regarded that action as a challenge they must take up. But the explanation was soon made, for the Governor's Ibadan messenger had heard the story as soon as he arrived. The Modakekes having heard a shout in the Ife camp on the night previous, similar to what usually took place when the Ifes were worshipping the god of war previously to a battle, consequently put themselves in readiness against a sudden attack ; it is this precaution of theirs the Ifes construed into a challenge. This explanation satisfied the Ifes who came with the Governor's Ekiti messenger ; the latter had had great difficulty with the Ifes in preventing them from giving battle that day under the plea of taking up the " challenge."

The Ife chiefs being satisfied with the explanation of the so-called challenge agreed to confer with the Governor's Ekiti messenger, and subsequently allowed him to visit his colleague at Modakeke, the same methods being pursued in this place as at Kiriji. The meetings took place on the 25th and 26th, after which interchange of visits were allowed the Governor's messengers both at Modakekg and at the Ife camp.

During the conference at Modakeke the report of a gun was heard which startled them all ; upon enquiry, however, it was found to have been fired at the Ijebu camp at Isoya.

The Modakeke chiefs readily assented to the armistice as their overlords at the Kiriji camp had done ; they however stipulated that the Ifes should refrain from kidnapping them in their farms.

Both the Governor's messengers then went over to the Ifes with the result of the conference on this side, and the requests of the Modakeke chiefs. Before listening to what they had to say, the Ifes first wanted to know the meaning of the firing of a gun on the previous day. That was explained to j;hem. It was done at Isoya. On hearing of the requests of the Modakekes they repUed that they themselves had one request to make, viz., that they should be allowed to go and rebuild their city. But the Governor's messenger pointed out that that was too advanced a step to take, which would surely bring about a colHsion. The Ifes moreover objected not to the armistice but to the hoisting of the flag of truce on their soil, which was " sacred to Oduduwa, who was a

King." But they agreed that two " heaps of witness " be raised on either side, and that two messengers, on either side be appointed to meet each other in the battlefield every morning as was arranged at Kiriji. This being done, both the messengers of the Governor and the Alafin's Ilari and the Owa's messenger joined the hands of the appointed deputies of both sides as was done at Kiriji. Both parties now shook hands and parted, each by his own route, to meet again at Lagos.

The Apology of Modakeke. — Before the Governor's messenger left Modakeke, the principal chiefs had a meeting to state for the benefit of the Governor their own version of the present war between themselves and the Ifes. An old man of probably about 100 years of age was sent for, and he came, leaning upon a staff ; he was a boy when Modakeke was settled. The main object in giving the history of the foundation of Modakeke was to rebut the oft-repeated story that they were slaves to the Ifes. He stated (as we have learnt above) that they were originally refugees from the Ancient Oyo Provinces, who escaped south when the Fulanis became masters of the country. They were well received at first at Ife, and treated with much sympathy and cordiality, but the turning point of the cordial relations came when Maye the Ife general was expelled from Ibadan, and the Oygs gained the ascendancy in that town. Then a systematic method of cruelty began to be practised on the Oyos of the city of Ife, they were treated more as slaves than as freemen till a favourable Owoni (or king of Ife) assigned them this settlement of Modakeke.

Qdunle was the Owoni they met who treated them well, the disaffection began towards the close of his reign.

Ghanlare succeeded him. He was more friendly disposed.

Ghegbaaje, who succeeded, revived the animosity ; some of them were even sold into slavery, no one questioning.

Winmolaje, who succeeded, was kind to them as he appreciated their services in assisting to suppress Ijesa kidnappers who were committing depredations in Ife territory.

Ab'eweila, who succeeded, made the Ifes swear, before he accepted office, that they would not find a pretext to murder him as they did so many of his predecessors. By this time the Oyos had become very important in the state, having one Wingbolu as their chief. The Ifes soon broke their faith and wanted to kill the Owoni. A civil war ensued but the Owoni was too strong for them ; he defeated them. The Oyos were neutral. The Owoni then questioned Wingbolu why the Oyos were neutral. He boldly repUed that if the Oyos had been invited by his enemies he could not have thus gained the upper hand, or if the Owoni himself had T

invited them, his victory would have been more complete. Tliis answer the Owoni pondered over, and as a result assigned them this settlement so that all Oyos should remove from the City of Ife to this place, and he had a strong guard of Oyos in his palace. Soon their numbers rapidly increased in the settlement. This favouring of Oyos irritated the Ifes the more against him.

After his death, which was due to poison by the Ifes, the Modakekes met and repelled two attacks of the Ifes on their settlement ; at the first of which they captured 12,070 of them but subsequently released them because they had not the heart to enslave their quondam benefactors.

But thirty days after when one Chief Ogumakin received reinforcement from Oke Igbo the Ifes attacked them again, and were defeated again. At this second time they followed up the victory, captured the City of Ife and ventured to sell the Ifes caught.

The city was however rebuilt in 1854 by the advice of Ognumola, the Ibadan general. Under the Ibadans they had Hved amicably together until the present war, which had largely divided the interests of the country, the Ifes sympathizing with the Ekitis, and the Modakekes whose safety and interests were intertwined with those of Ibadan cast their lots with the Ibadans. He further related all that took place between them during the war up to the present time.

Chief Tahajo of Ibadan, who was twice sent to reconcile the Ifes and Modakekes together, also made his own statement showing the efforts at reconciliation that were put forth and the implacabihty of the Ifes, who broke faith and fired the first shot from a tree.

All these statements, as they have been noted in full, above, were duly recorded to be placed before the Governor.

The Governor's messenger left Modakeke on the 28th of April, and after a short stay at Ibadan proceeded to Lagos via Ijebu.

The new Awujale of Ijebu, who was all for peace, was very glad to hear of the armistice at the seat of war. He assembled his chiefs to hear the report from the mouth of the messenger himself, and at their advice he wilhngly sent his messengers down with the Governor's messenger to show that he was at one with those who wished for peace.

The following is the hst of messengers who accompanied those of the Governor down : —

In the Oyo and Ibadan district : — The Rev. S. Johnson, the Governor's messenger to the Oyos. j'Obakosetan, envoy of the AlAfin, Feudal head of the

Oyo j Yoruba country.

VBelewu, representing the Oyo nobiUty.

THE INTERVENTION OF THE BRITISH GOVERNMENT

Ibadan

Ijebu

'Arinde, messenger of the Balogun of Ibadan.

Atere, from the Maye, representing the Ibadan war

chiefs. Elegbede, from Tahajo, representing the Ibadan home

authorities. /Awonimesin, messenger of the Awujale of Ijebu. JOgundeko, also messenger of the Awujale of Ijebu. jOdusajo, confidential messenger of the Balogun of ⌒ Ijebu.

Those of the other side : — Rev. C. PhilHps, the Governor's messenger to the Ekiti parapos J- f Apelidiagba, messenger of the Owa of Ilesa.

lOlukoni, also messenger of the Owa of Ilesa. Fatiye, messenger of the Owore of Otun. Orisalusi, messenger of the Ajero of Ijero. Oba§a, messenger of the Olojudo of Ido. Dawudu, messenger of Ogedemgbe, Ekiti Commanderin-Chief. Lomi, messenger of King Manuwa of Itebu. jAkinlamu, messenger of the Osimowe of Ondo. Is aba, messenger of the Elders of Ondo.

Ekiti

Itebu Ondo

§ 4. The Treaty of Peace

The Governor of Lagos had several interviews with the different envoys and messengers from the interior kings and chiefs, from which he gathered much information ; His Excellency thereupon drew up a treaty which was read and interpreted to them and which obtained their assent on the whole.

Obakosetan, the AlAfin's envoy, however objected to Clause 5 of the treaty which refers to the removal of Modakek§ from its present site, but he was told that as he had already agreed to the Governor's arbitration he could not object to any article of the treaty. The treaty was accordingly signed by all the envoys and messengers on behalf of their masters.

The following is the text of the treaty :

Treaty of peace, friendship and commerce between the AlAfin of Oyo, the Balogun, the Maye, the Abese, the Agbakin, the Otun Bal§ of Ibadan; the Owa of Ilesa, the Owore of Otun, the Ajero of Ijero, the Olojudo of Ido, the Seriki of Ilesa, the Owoni of Ife, the Obalufe, the Obajiwo, the Obaloran, the Ajaruwa, the Arode, the Arisanre, the Balogun of Ife ; the Ogunsuwa of Modakeke, the Balogun and Otun of Modakekc, the Awujale of Ijebu and the Balogun of Ijebu.

Whereas the Kings, Chiefs, Baloguns and Chiefs above enumerated, parties to this Treaty, and to the conditions and articles of agreement hereinafter set forth, profess to be earnestly desirous to put a stop to the devastating war which has for years been waged in their own and adjoining countries, and to secure the blessings of lasting peace to themselves and their peoples, and have appealed by their envoys and messengers duly accredited to His Excellency the Governor of the Colony of Lagos as representing Her Most Gracious Majesty the Queen to mediate between them, and to arbitrate, and determine such terms and conditions as shall secure a just and honourable peace to the contending parties, and have each and all of them agreed to abide by such arbitration and determination, and to do his and their utmost endeavour to carry into effect the terms and conditions so arranged and determined. And whereas the envoys and messengers duly accredited by the aforesaid Kings, Bales, Baloguns and Chiefs have been received in audience by His Excellency the Governor, and have themselves assented both verbally and in writing to the terms and conditions of peace hereinafter specified, and have agreed to be bound thereby, and faithfully to observe the same.

Now this is to testify that the Kings, Bales, Baloguns and Chiefs aforesaid hereby ratify and confirm the said agreement made and entered into by their envoys and messengers for them and on their behalf and solemnly pledge themselves faithfully, loyally and strictly to observe and carry out the following terms and conditions so far as they are individually or collectively concerned : —

1. There shall be peace and friendship between the Kings, Bales, Baloguns and Chiefs, the signatories to this Treaty and their peoples respectively and the Kings, Bales, Baloguns and Chiefs aforesaid hereby engage for themselves and their peoples that they will cease from fighting and will remain within or retire to their own territories as herein provided, and will in all things submit themselves to such directions as may seem necessary or expedient to the Governor of Lagos for better and more effectually securing the object of this Treaty.

2. The Kings, Chiefs and peoples comprising the Ekitiparapo alliance or confederation on the one hand, and the Bale, Balogun, Chiefs and people of Ibadan on the other shall respectively retain their independence.

3. The AlAfin and Owa shall stand to each other in the relationship of the elder brother to the younger as before when the Ekiti countries were independent.

4. The towns of Otan, Iresi, Ada, and Igbajg shall form part of the territories of Ibadan, and be subject to the Bal§, Balogun and Chiefs of Ibadan. Such of the inhabitants of the towns aforesaid as desire to leave shall be permitted to do so at such time and in such manner as the Governor, his envoy, or messenger shall direct after conference with the governments of the parties principally concerned, and such people shall not be molested by the signatories their peoples or allies.

5. In order to preserve peace the town of Modakeke shall be reconstructed on the land lying between the Osun and the Oba rivers to the north of its present situation, and such of the people of Modakeke as desire to live under the rule of the Bale and Balogun of Ibadan shall withdraw from the present town to the land mentioned, at such times and in such manner as the Governor his envoy or messenger shall direct after conference with the governments of the parties principally concerned, and such of the people as desire to live with the Ifes shall be permitted to do so but shall not remain in the present town of Modakeke, which shall remain the territory and under the rule of the king and chiefs of Ife, who may deal with the same as they may think expedient.

6. Except as herein provided the boundaries of the territories of the respective parties and signatories shall remain as at present and shall not be interfered with.

7. The Kiri ji camp shall be broken up and the contending parties agree quietly and peaceably and without any demonstration to withdraw their armies and their peoples at such time or times in such manner, and by such routes as shall be directed by the Governor, his envoy or messenger after conference with the governments of the parties principally concerned.

8. The signatories engage themselves at or immediately after the signature of this treaty or at such times as may be directed by the Governor, his envoy or messenger after conference with the parties principally concerned, to withdraw their peoples and warriors and allies employed or associated with the contending peoples or armies at Modakeke, Isoya, or elsewhere, and wherever such allies or people or warriors may be employed in war, or likely to foster or promote war, and further when their peoples, warriors, and allies have been withdrawn, and the camp of Kiriji broken up and dispersed to do their utmost by peaceful and friendly means to bring about peace at O^a.

9. The signatories bind themselves to endeavour in every legitimate way to promote trade and commerce, and to abstain from dissension and acts likely to promote strife.

10. The signatories agree if any cause of strife or dissension should still exist after the ratification and carrying out of these conditions which is not dealt with herein, to refer such cause or matter unreservedly to the arbitration of the Governor of the Lagos Colony and peaceably and without resorting to strife or provocation to await his determination thereof and abide by it, testifying their gratitude to Her Majesty's Government for efforts already made and undertaken in their interest and their sincerity and earnestness in the cause of general peace and goodwill.

11. The armistice now existing oetween the hostile forces in the camps of Kiriji and Isoya shall be promoted, and the signatories bind themselves to cease from all warlike operations or acts of provocation, and to do their utmost to promote friendly relations until the Governor, his envoy or messenger shall be able to, and shall communicate with the signatories hereto.

12. As a guarantee of good faith, and for the further and better securing the objects of this treaty and the faithful and strict observance of the terms and conditions thereof, the signatories agree to place in the hands of the Governor his envoy or messenger as and when he may determine, such of their leading chiefs as he may require as hostages, who will continue and remain with him on the battlefield of Kiriji, whilst the armies and peoples of the respective signatories are dispersing therefrom, and for and during such time or period as the circumstances or necessities of the case may require, or to give such other or further guarantees as may seem just or expedient to the Governor, his envoy or messenger.

In witness thereof we have hereunto put our hands and seals the days and dates specified.

Title.

Country.

Mk.

Seal.

Date.

1. Adeyemi. .

The Alafin

of Oyo

June 25th, 1886.

2. Ajayi

3. Osuntoki

Maye

4. Fijabi

Abese

5. Fajinmi . .

Agbakin

6. Tahajo . .

Otun Bale . .

June I4th,i886

7. Agunloye

Owa

Ilesa

July 7th, 1886.

8. Okinbaloye

Owore

Otun

July 3rd, 1886.

9. Oyiyosoye

Ajero

Ijero

July 3rd, 1886.

10. Odundun

Olojudo

Ido

July 3rd, 1886.

II. Ogedemgbe

Seriki

Ilesa

July 2nd, i886.

12. Derin

Owoni-elect

July i8th, 1886.

13. Awotionde

Obalufe

14. Oramuyiwa

Obajiwo

15. Akintola . .

Obaloran

July 1 6th, 1886.

THE INTERVENTION OF THE BRITISH GOVERNMENT

Title.

Country.

Mk.

Seal.

Date.

t6. Osundulu

Ajaniwa

y.

17- JoJo

Arode

18. Aworinlo

Arisaure

Ite

ig. 0,?;a

20. Ogunwole

Ogunsua

Modakcke

2 1 . Sowo

For Balogun

Modakeke

22. Ayanleye

For Otun . .

Modakeke

23. Aboki

Awujale

Ijebu

June 9th, 1886.

24. Nofowokan

Ijebu

June loth, 1886

Signed, sealed, and delivered in the presence of the undersigned after the terms and condition therein contained had been interpreted and explained by us, or one of us to the respective signatories.

(Signed) Samuel Johnson, Cld.rk in Holy Orders,

Messenger and Interpreter for the Governor.

(Signed) Charles Phillips, Clerk in Holy Orders,

Messenger and Interpreter for the Governor.

Affix to Treaty, dated 4th day of June, 1886,

The undersigned envoys and messengers duly accredited to His Excellency the Governor of Lagos to convey to the Governor the terms and conditions which they and the Kings, Bales, Baloguns and Chiefs who have despatched them duly accredited as aforesaid are willing to observe, abide by, and carry into effect in order to secure peace to their respective peoples and countries, having heard the foregoing treaty and the terms and conditions thereof read over and the same having been interpreted, and fully explained to them, solemnly agree themselves to abide thereby and faithfully and loyally to observe the same on testimony whereof they have hereunto set their hands and seals this 4th day of June, 1886.

Their marks.

Obakosetan

accredited

by

the AlAfin of Oyo.

Belewu

»> »> »

Arinde

„ Balogun of Ibadan

Atere

„ Maye of Ibadan

Elegbede

„ Otun Bale of Ibadan

Apelidiagba

„ Owa of Ilesa,

Olukoni

„ Owa of Ilesa.

Fatuye

„ Owore of Otun

Orisalusi

„ Ajero of Ijero.

Obasa

„ Olojudo of Ido.

THE HISTORY OF THE YORUBAS

Their Marks.

Dawudu

X accre

Apelidiagba

Olukoni

Arinde

Awonimesin

Ogundeko

Odusajo

o • 1 1 _ _

_ ! _1 1 •

X accredited by the Ogedemgbe, Seriki of Ilesa. the Owoni of Ife.

Ogunsua of Modakeke. Awujale of Ijebu Ode.

a 9 9 99

Balogun of Ijebu Ode.

Signed, sealed, and deUvered in the presence of

Alfred Moloney, the Governor.

Smalm AN Smith, Judge.

H. HiGGiNS, Assi. Col. Secy, and Private Secretary.

Chas. Phillips, Governor's messengers to the Interior S. Johnson, i and Interpreters on this occasion.

§ 5. The Reception of the Treaty by the Interior Kings and

Chiefs

His Excellency, A. C. Moloney, the Governor took the envoys and messengers with him in the colonial steamer on his visit to the eastern waters of Lagos on the 7th of June, 1886. Instructions were also given to his special messengers to have the Treaty read and interpreted to the different kings and chiefs concerned, and to obtain their signatures to it, and then to forward it down to Lagos ; and then, not till then, would he see his way clear to go personally or to send to complete the arbitration.

The Oyq messengers with the Governor's special messenger were landed at Ejirin, and the Ekiti messengers with the Governor's special messenger to the Ekitis were landed at Atijere.

The Treaty in the Qyo Division. — On the 9th of June the Awujale signed the Treaty in the presence of his chiefs. Nofgwokan, the Balogun, also signed it the next day at Orii in the presence of all the war chiefs, not being concerned they had nothing to say against it. The messenger passed on to Ibadan, and Tahajo, the head chief at home, who was represented at Lagos by his messenger Elegbede, also heard the Treaty read and interpreted ; after some consideration he subscribed to it in the presence of the Home authorities. The Governor's messenger with the rest of the messengers passed on to Oyo.

At Oyo the AlAfin expressed his surprise at the way matters were hurrying on to a crisis in the following parable : —

" The Governor is like an Egugun enchanter who is about

to perform a transformation trick. The mortar is ready, the drummers already at their posts drumming with all their might and the eyes of the whole world are now fixed upon the enchanter to see what he would become before they shout hurrah, hurrah ! If success attends his efforts the Governor will then know that there are humble Africans here who know how to appreciate kindness." He also signed the Treaty on the 25th of June, 1886. As soon as the Governor's messenger got him to sign the Treaty, he lost no time, but with the rest of the messengers left the next day for the Ibadan camp which they reached on the 30th of June.

The interview with the Ibadan chiefs was on the istof July when the Treaty was read to them and fully interpreted. Of course they are the ones who were most concerned in this division. They brooded a bit over clause 5 of the Treaty ; but the leading chiefs whose names were affixed to the Treaty signed it without

raising any objection. They said that they had qo alternative since the Awujale and the Balogun of Ijebu had signed it, as well as the AlAfin : and on the whole they considered the Treaty just and fair.

The Treaty in the Ekiti Division. — The Ekiti kings and chiefs did not sign the Treaty so readily, having a strong objection to paragraph 4 of the Treaty which left Otan, Iresi, Ada, and Igbajo in the hands of the Ibadans.

The report of the Rev. C. Phillips the Governor's messenger relative to it, will show the difficulty he met with in getting them to sign the Treaty.

Extract from the Report of the Rev. C. PhilHps.

2. The Ijesas and Ekitis.

" I reached £sa where the Owa was stationed on the 28th June. After the Owa had called his chiefs together I read the Treaty to them and gave them an oral account of our interviews with the Governor of Lagos. The Owa hesitated a little to set his hands to his seal on account of some objections he made with respect to the fourth article. But after I had made some remarks, showing him the impartiality of the Governor's decision, he set his hands to the seal. From Esa I proceeded on the 29th with all the messengers to the camp. At Oke Mesin I met a messenger telling me that it is the Seriki's wish that I should not stop to see the kings, but that I should come straight on to him in the camp. I did so. The Seriki seemed to have the chief authority in these matters, but I cannot say whether it is an authority delegated to him by the gratitude of the kings,

who regarded him as their deliverer, or whether it is arrogated on the principle of 'might over right.' However, as this may be, the fact stands that the Seriki is invested with much authority, and all state business must be done with him. Therefore I gave him a full account of our interviews with the Governor of Lagos and read to him the Treaty in the presence of his comrades. He said he would not sign the Treaty on account of the fourth article which transfers (? retains) Igbajg, Iresi, Ada, and Otan to the Ibadans wholesale. I was sorry to find that the Seriki was instigated to this obstinacy by the Ijesa emigrants from Lagos and Abeokuta who seemed to have gained much influence over him. There is a section of them in the camp under the leadership of one James Thompson Gureje who came from Abeokuta, arid I also found that a special messenger from the ' Lagos Ekitiparapo Society ' had preceded me to the camp. He is a Brazillian Creole, a carpenter by trade, his name is Abek. The opposition which I had from these emigrants was greater than that of the Seriki himself. They were very clamorous. Not only did they set up the Seriki but they also tried to influence the Ekiti kings not to sign the Treaty. Their objections to the fourth article were principally two. First, that the cession of those towns to Ibadan was an infringement upon Ijesa territory ; secondly, that the position of those places was too contiguous for the Ijesa and Ekiti people to be safe in future from Ibadan invasions or surprises. In vain did I advise the Seriki to confer with the Balogun of Ibadan on the subject. In vain did I represent the impartiality of the Governor's decisions. In vain did I remind them of his former promise of unconditional submission to the Governor's arbitration. Still the Seriki continued refractory until Thursday afternoon, July ist.

" On that morning Mr. Johnson wrote to me to announce his arrival at the Ibadan camp, and I went out immediately to have a interview with him on the battlefield. At this interview he informed me that the Ibadan chiefs had signed the Treaty though the fifth article was galling to them, and that they would not yield any further upon the Igbajo question. However, I asked him to tell the Balogun of the difficulty I met with. When I returned to the Ekiti camp, I told the Seriki that the Ibadans had signed the Treaty, and he would be responsible for the continuation of the war if he persisted in his refusal. I should state that nobody stood by me except Mr. G. A. Vincent^ the C.M.S. agent at Ilesa. The Ekiti war chiefs were entirely

^Latterly known as " Daddy Agbebi."

silent. Apelidiagba and his comrades with Mr. G. W. Johnson the Lagos book-binder, hid themselves.

" When I found that remonstrances were of no avail I retired to my lodgings, and was on the point of leaving the camp to appeal to the Kings Owor^, Ajero, and Olojudo, when the Seriki sent for me and signed the

treaty.

" Whether he shrank from the responsibility of the continuation of the war or whether his former violence and stubbornness was only a ruse to disconcert the Ijesa emigrants whom he was unwilling to displease (because he had been much indebted to them for the supplies of breech-loading guns and cartridges) I could not tell. But since he signed the Treaty I was astonished to find that his language was changed and he openly avowed his indifference about the Igbajo question, even in Mr. Johnson and the Ibadan messengers' presence. This could not be a mere capriciousness, it seemed to me a deeply contrived artifice. He told me afterwards that if he had signed the Treaty at once his countrymen would afterwards reproach him and his children with having handed a portion of their land to the Yorubas. . . .

" Lugbosun, the head Ekiti war chief, in the Mesin camp, told Mr. Johnson and me afterwards that the Ijesa emigrants who made much gain by importing the breech-loading guns and cartridges desired the prolongation of the war, but he and his colleagues who had nearly spent all their possessions did not approve of the opposition to the Treaty. They were anxious to decamp, and were impatiently expecting the Governor.

" The Ajero asked Mr. G. A. Vincent to tell me in confidence that they (the Ekitis) do not make much of the Igbajo question.

" When I returned to £sa the Owa thanked me very much for the patience with which I endured the opposition I met with, and begged me not to make much of it, for it was only unruly people who resort to the camp. He gave me some historical account of the defection of Igbajo, in which he acknowledged that it was due to the ill-treatment that the Igbajo people suffered from some Ijesa head chiefs (who then tried to keep the Owa in the dark as to the real state of matters) that they were obliged to surrender themselves to the Ibadans. He begged me to urge the Governor to come or send at once to put an end to the war."

The Ibadan chiefs commenting upon the objection of the Ekitis to paragraph 4 of the Treaty remarked that " their request for the removal of Igbajo was unreasonable, not to say dictatorial and presumptuous. For if, according to the terms of the Treaty, we are to live in peace and amity, why should Igbajo be left a

desolate wilderness and a rendezvous for highway robbers and menstealers ? And again, Igbajo is not nearer their town of Oke Mgsin than their towns of Ibokun, Ilase, Oke Bode are to our towns of Ikirun and Osogbo. Should we then ask that these places be removed from our vicinity ? This seems to us to be promoting unnecessary complications and difficulties."

After the signing of the Treaty at both camps at Kiriji the messengers left by their respective routes to meet again at Modak§ke.

At Modakeke the state of affairs was different from that at Kiriji. The latter place is a battlefield, and no personal animosity existed between the Balogun of the Ibadans and the Seriki of the Ijesas, only that they were unwilling to sacrifice public good for their own private interests, hence the efforts made to obtain as much as they could. Not so, however, at Modakeke. But for Fabumi the Ekiti General who was the mollifier, hostiUties would have been resumed. No sooner had the Governor's messengers left them on the former occasion when the truce was arranged, than the road between Modakeke and the If§ camp was thrown open, and not only the messengers of both parties met, but also parents, children and friends and relatives long separated rushed into each other's arms, the Ifes flocked to Modakeke, some spending three to five days there, and the Ife women and children who were captured at the fall of He Ife were allowed to go and see their kindred at the Ife camp. Some of them never returned again and the Ifes refused to give them up, thus abusing the privileges granted them Therefore the Modakekes resolved never to allow any of the rest to go over to the Ife camp any more till peace was actually restored, but they allowed the Ife women to come into the town to buy pots and' utensils or whatever necessaries they were in need of.

As to the signing of the Treaty, the Ifes were of course very glad to do so, because their wishes had been gratified in the matter of Modakeke ; they would now get rid of them altogether. The Modakeke chiefs on their part, pained though they were by the terms of Clause 5 which stipulates for their leaving a spot sacred to them as containing the graves of their ancestors, yet signed without demur, hoping to ask the Governor

when the time comes, for an amendment providing for the separation of the two towns by a wall as there is none existing hitherto.

The Awujale of Ijebu in complying with the articles of the Treaty, sent his Agurins (state messengers) to accompany the Governor's messenger to tell Ogunsigun the Seriki of Ijebu Igbo at the Isoya camp to return home in peace with the forces under him. Scarcely did the messengers expect any opposition from that

quarter. When Chief Ogedemgbe, during the negotiations at Kiriji, asked the Ijebu messengers whether the Epe refugees and the Isoya band were reconciled to their new Awujale, he was told that the latter had sent a friendly message to the Epe refugees, inviting them to return home, with nothing to fear from him ; and to Ogunsigun and the forces under him at Isoya he was favourably disposed, and was sending a friendly message to them.

The Rev. C. Phillips and his party who went by a shorter route, had seen the Ijebu Seriki before the arrival of his colleagues on the other side, and was good enough to prepare their minds against the reception they might likely meet with : it was as much as he could do to prevail upon Ogunsigun to receive the messengers at all, and he finally agreed to see them not in his camp but in the battlefield. The interview was a hot one. But for Fabumi there would at least have been a damper cast on the whole affair, if not a collapse of the embassy. He and the Governor's messengers had great difficulty in restraining the Seriki and his war chiefs from doing violence to the person of the Chief Agurin sent by the Awujale : they vented their feelings in bitter invectives and curses on their countrymen the Ijebu messengers.

The Seriki said that the Ijebus having been bribed to take up arms causelessly against the Ibadans who had done them no wrong, the late Awujale was prevailed upon to declare war against them, and so was himself forced to engage in it. For full seven months he hid himself in his farm to avoid it, and five times was his house confiscated till he was obliged to come forward to this war. Their king having been led to this, why was he driven away to die at Epe? (Turning to the Agurin, he said) "And you, Awonimesin, have you the audacity to come on an errand to me ? Were you not sent with us to this war ? Were you not encamped with us at the river Osun ? Who made you an Agurin ? Was it not the late king whom you helped to dethrone ? deserting us here and going home for that foul purpose, you put your own master to death and raised up another ! You are the wrong man for this peace embassy, and this will be your last."

At last, turning to the messengers the Ijebu Seriki said, " I agree to all the terms of the Treaty, but I cannot acknowledge the present Awujale as king, because he was installed not by the general consent of all the Ijebus : and besides, the funeral obsequies of the late king have not yet been performed."

Chapter XXX

DISPERSAL OF THE COMBATANTS BY SPECIAL COMMISSIONERS

§ I. Special Commissioners Sent up.

The Treaty duly signed was forwarded to the Governor of Lagos by his special messengers, themselves awaiting further orders at their respective posts at Ode Ondo and Ibadan.

By this time the Governor's furlough was due, but, with the sanction of the Secretary of State for the Colonies, he had arranged everything for the accomplishment of this work, and matters were left in the hands of the Acting-Governor, F. Evans, Esq., the Colonial Secretary, to carry out. Mr. Henry Higgins, the Asst. Col. Secretary and Mr. Oliver Smith, Queen's Advocate, were appointed Special Commissioners for this business. They were to be attended by an escort of 50 Hausa soldiers, each provided with 50 rounds of ball cartridges for their Martini Henry rifles. They had also with them a 7-pounder gun, and a rocket trough with necessary ammunition.

Capt. W. Speeding, the Harbour Master, also accompanied the expedition, with instructions to make geographical observations all along the route from Ejirin on the lagoon — the point of disembarkation— through Ijebu Ode, Ibadan, to Osogbo and Kiriji, to return to Lagos if possible via Ile§a, Ode Ondo, Aiyesan, Itebu, and Atijere. He was also to make as far as possible a survey map of the route and to fix the positions of the principal towns, the number of houses and inhabitants in each village, names of chiefs, depth, width, and

courses of rivers crossed, heights of hills, nature of roads, and all other useful and statistical information to be carefully obtained and recorded. The Commissioners were the bearers of the following letter : —

August 14/A, 1886. To Kings, Bal^s, Baloguns and Chiefs,

I send you greeting.

2. Your good friend. Governor Moloney, has beeri obliged to go to England for health and rest. But before leaving Lagos he put you all in my hands ; he told me how you had all said you were tired of war and wanted peace. He told me how you

DISPERSAL OF THE COMBATANTS 539

had all sent your most trusted messengers, to beg him to assist you, and how you had signed treaties promising to be faithful. He told me all he had done for you, and how sorry he was he could not be present when you broke up your armies and camps according to your promises.

3. If I could have come to you myself I would have done so.

4. You would, I am sure, have received me with welcome, but my people in Lagos wanted me, and I regret to say I cannot arrange to leave them.

5. I send you, however, two of my officers in whom I have much confidence ; they are next in rank to myself.

6. I ask you to receive them as my envoys and to accord to them the same cordial welcome you would have given to me.

7. They have my full powers to act for me in helping you to fulfil the engagements you made in your Treaty, and I ask you to treat with them as if they were myself.

8. You have promised to place hostages in the hands of my envoys while your camps are being dispersed and while you are settling the difficulties between yourselves.

9. I rely upon you to fulfil your promises and now call upon you to do so.

10. It is hardly necessary for me to remind you of the advantages to be derived from a lasting peace, you who have been unfortunately so long at strife must know the troubles a war entails ; you must feel when you see your people decreasing in numbers, your children fatherless, your women without husbands, your trade dechning, and your villages decaying, that the time has arrived when you should fight no more.

11. Let that time be now, as you have promised it shall be ; let there be peace and friendship among you all ; go home to your villages, and make your women glad, and see your children grow around you, and let me have the pleasure of telling my Queen, the great and good Queen of England, that 3'our troubles are now at an end.

I am. Kings, Bales, Baloguns and Chiefs,

Your good friend and well wisher,

Fred Evans, Acting-Governor.

[Governor Evans' letter seems very remarkable in its own way. To us it reads like an admonition to a number of truant schoolboys rather than an address to commanders of about half a million men who for over ten years had been engaged in a death struggle with one another, pouring out their life blood unflinchingly for honour, power and freedom — worthier objects than those which often

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The expedition left Lagos on the i6th August via Itg Ike the first Ijebu port. Great difficulties were experienced with regard to the transmission of their loads ; the Ijebus are by nature averse to carrying loads, they depend more on their slaves for such purposes. Besides they also considered it derogatory to the dignity of

a free people to " ru asingba," i.e., transmitting state loads from point to point which in this country is a compulsory duty and regarded as a sort of taxpaying.

The Commissioners arrived at Ijebu Ode on the 19th and were well received. The Lisa (prime minister) called on them immediately after their arrival with a message of welcome and presents from the Awujale, and conducted them to the quarters prepared for them. On the same day the Governor's Ibadan messenger arrived at Oru where he was ordered to meet the Commissioners.

A public interview took place on the 21st at which about 3,000 people were present.

What was uppermost in the Awuj ale's mind was the case of Ogunsigun the Seriki of Igbo who had been sent to Isoya and his refractory behaviour in refusing to decamp. This the Awujale considered a difficulty in the way ; the Commissioners, however, treated the matter lightly, saying they did not anticipate any difficulty in his case.

The Awujalg, not satisfied with this reply, sent word to the Governor's Ibadan messenger (the writer) at Orii to this effect. " When you reach Modakeke, if the Commissioners could not prevail upon Ogunsigun to decamp at once, tell them to kill him, he

stained the swords of mightier nations — ambition, jealousy and greed ! "Go home to your villages," says the Governor, " and make your women glad," etc. Those " villages " are towns with 50,000 to 250,000 souls ! And is there any reason why their " women " should be denied the right and dignity of being termed their wives ?

Men who can control such huge masses of humanity, capacities which can guide, control, and direct all the intricacies of municipal and political machineries of a government, and can wage honourable wars for years without external aid or a national debt bequeathed to posterity might at least be considered as possessing some serious qualities beyond those of children, as they appear to be regarded, and deserving some honourable consideration due to men although they be Negroes. But happily the patronizing language of the letter which discloses so much thinly-veiled contempt, will be lost in the translation, and in other respects interpreters may be trusted to make up in tone and expression for what is wanting in style and diction. — Ed.]

is my slave, and let his followers return home in peace." Such was the autocracy and the rude form of government that prevailed in the Ijebu state. The Awujale being ignorant of British methods, thought this order would be carried out as a most ordinary and insignificant matter ; its non-execution nearly cost the writer his life subsequently, the Awujale noting him down as a personal enemy in league with Ogunsigun, and gave orders that he should be hunted down and murdered should he be seen in any of the Ijebu provinces !

Carriers were supplied the Commissioners from Ijebu Ode to Oru at the border of the forests a few hours distant, beyond which the Ijebus refused to go, unless carriers came down from Ibadan ! But the Ibadans were very reluctant to adopt this unusual course ; the custom was for the Ijebus to transmit to Ibadan, and they to the next town on the route, and so on to the terminus, hence a considerable delay ensued until the Balogun of Ijebu sent word to the Ibadan Home authorities, and the Governor's Ibadan me.ssenger also sent to the Rev. D. Olubi to move the chiefs to send down the needed carriers. In consequence of this delay the carriers never turned up till the 27th of August, and the Commissioners left for Ibadan on the 28th, leaving 17 loads behind for want of a sufficient number of carriers.

The Ibadan carriers did not wait, but went forward with great speed with the bed and bedding as well as the provisions, so that at their sleeping place at Olowa the Commissioners had to pass the night in their hammocks suspended on trees ! The carriers were overtaken the next morning at Odo Ona nla in the Ibadan farms where they halted and there the Commissioners breakfasted before proceeding to Ibadan, where they arrived in the afternoon and were lodged with the Otun Bale, who received them very kindly.

From Ibadan, the Commissioners would have proceeded direct via Iwo, Ede, Osogbo to the Kiriji camp, but the Governor's Ibadan messenger made them to understand that the Ibadan chiefs would never act without their King having a voice in the matter, as they were not constitutionally competent to treat with a foreign

power without the King, whose prerogative it was. They were only his army. Consequently the expedition started for Oyo on the 2nd of September, 1886.

This affair the Commissioners remarked in a letter to the Acting- Governor thus : " We have been induced to visit Oyo on the representation of the Rev. S. Johnson that we should be imable to carry out our mission without having an interview with the Alafin previous to visiting the Kiriji camp."

Hearing of their approach, the AlAfin sent an escort consisting

of a few of his big Ilaris to meet them at the village of Fiditi, a distance of about 14 miles from the city. As soon as they appeared the escorts ordered their men to fire a feu de joie, which they kept up till they reached the city of Oyo. The leader of the expedition was rather unsettled by these demonstrations, he immediately ordered his Hausas to form around him and to fix bayonets, and told the Ilaris to go on before with their men.

At Oyo they were lodged at the house of the Apeka, one of the chief Ilaris, who lodges white men.

On the 4th September the AlAfin accorded them a formal state reception as a special honour due to them. He was enthroned full-robed at the Kobi Aganju with all the princes and the Oyo nobles about him, and the usual state umbrellas and all the paraphernalia of royalty displayed on the right and on the left, the trumpeters also sounding lustily the praises of the King and the welcome to the white men.ˆ

The usual ceremonies over, the King presented them with two bullocks, ten sheep, four goats, 20 bags of cowries, and eighty baskets of yams.

On the next day they had a private interview in which the AlAfin sat with them and discussed affairs in a friendly and famihar manner. His Majesty advised them not to visit Ilorin, as Karara the Ilorin Generalissimo at Ofa was both obstinate and treacherous. He gave them a horse and two bags of cowries and wished them God-speed.

On the 6th of September the King having supplied the necessary number of carriers, the Commissioners left Oyo with the King's Ilari, en route for the Ibadan camp via lie Odan. Masifa, Ejigbo, Ilobu, Ikirun. They arrived at Kiriji on the loth of September, 1886.

ˆ The ceremonies on this occasion were nearly marred by the leader of the expedition who, against the remonstrance of the writer of the untimehness of such a course insisted on going straight to the throne to " shake hands," saying, that as he represented the Governor of Lagos who is the representative of the Queen, he considered himself superior to any African Monarch — which may or may not be true of such a delegated superior rank, but the writer fails to see how it confers the right to commit a gross breach of etiquette at the moment special honours were being done to him. But ere he was half way along the avenue formed by the princes on the one side and the courtiers on the other, two or three big Ilaris rushed forward, and with expanded arms barred the way saying " Oyinbo, mase, mase " (white man please don't, please don't). Then he desisted and was shown to the seat prepared for

The Ibadan chiefs wished to detain the Commissioners as their guests for a day or two before they passed on to the tents built for them on the battlefield by both belligerents, but they rightly declined, and marched on straight to the neutral ground.

Soon after their arrival, Ogedemgbe called on the Commissioners, the Balogun of Ibadan did the same later on at dusk : presents in cowries and provisions flowed in from both camps day by day, and from the Kings Ajero, Owore, and the Olojudo at Mesin town.

The Commissioners returned the visits to both camps on the lith at 10 a.m. to the Ibadan camp and to the Ekiti's at 4 p.m.

§ 2. The Commissioners at Kiriji

The interviews to arrange matters began on the 13th, the Ibadan chiefs coming to the Commissioners' camp for the purpose at 10 a.m. No difficulties lay in their way except in the case of Ofa, for whilst the Ibadan chiefs lay no claim to Ofa, yet they were loth to see the town destroyed, because it is one of the principal Yoruba towns, and the birthplace of some of their chiefs.

When asked when it will be convenient for them to decamp they replied, as soon as they had informed their contingents at Modakeke and at Ofa, lest the news coming upon them suddenly and probably in a distorted form, there may be a rush in both places with disastrous results. Seven days may be allowed for this, but they cannot send as yet until they shall have known the result of the Commissioners' interview with the belligerents of the other side.

The interview with the Ekitis took place at 4 p.m. of the same day but the results were not so satisfactory ; the Ekitis insisted on the Ibadans decamping first, but the Commissioners were for both camps to be broken up together on the same day and hour. As they could not arrive at an understanding also in the matter of the Ilorins, whom they were supporting at Ofa, the meeting was adjourned till the next day.

At the next interview after much talk the Ekitis agreed to the Commissioners' proposals.

On the r5th the Commissioners proceeded to the town of Mesin Ipole to see the Ekiti kings, the Ajero, the Owore and the Olojudo. The Owore was prolix and pointless in his remarks but the Ajero was more sensible ; his statements were few and to the point. The Olojudo said but little; his words were, "We want our independence, and not to be molested any more in future."

On the i6th the question of the boundaries engaged the attention of the Commissioners : the elders of Mesin and Igbajo said it was the stream Eleriko that divided them. On the 17th at another interview defining the boundaries between Mesin, Otan, Ada,

Esuvvii and Ipetu, they all agreed that the boundaries of each of these towns met at a place called Ata where also was a river called Omi Ad^. The last interview was on the i8th September, when the elders of these towns were to sign the document defining the boundaries. On this day the If§ chiefs arrived at the Ekiti camp about their own part of the Treaty. On the 19th the Ibadans sent to build the hoiise for their hostage, the Ijesas and Ekitis having done their own two days before.

The interview between the Commissioners and the Ife chiefs took place on the 20th. The latter with Ogedemgbe previously in council had agreed to allow the Modakek§s ten months' respite in which they were to remove to a new spot on the other side of the Osun river, but meantime they might be allowed to remain in the small towns of Ipetumodu, Odiiabon, Moro, etc.

The interview between the Commissioners and the Modakeke chiefs took place on the 21st. In vain did they plead that peace and reconciliation be made between the Ifes and themselves. In vain did they plead that there should be a town wall separating the two towns from each other. The Commissioners were for carrying out the letter of the Treaty, which was also the resolution arrived at by the Ifes and Ekitis. The Modakekes thought it strange indeed that as a result of peace the vanquished should dictate terms to the victors, and worse still for those terms to include the evacuation of their hearths and homes, and spots sacred to them by a thousand ties and considerations. If that must be, then they prayed that the time be extended to the following dry season which would allow sui!icient time to build a new town, and cultivate new fields so that they might not perish from starvation and exposure. Even this was not allowed them, they were to evacuate the present town of Modakeke at once, and in ten months' time build a new town and destroy the old ! To this the messengers were obhged to yield.

Hitherto the Commissioners interviewed the Chiefs of each of the camps by themselves, but on this day September 21st they were asked to meet each other in the Commissioners' camp in the afternoon. The whole of the fighting men of either side were drawn up on the battlefield but they were not allowed to come near except the leading chief of both sides. The fifty Hausa soldiers accompanying the expedition were drawn up in two rows at the two ends of the Commissioners' camp facing those of both belligerents, and only the leading chiefs were allowed to pass through to the Commissioners' tents, and there the Balogun

of Ibadan, the Maye, Agbakin, Adejumo and others met and shook hands with Ogedemgbe, Lugbgsun and other leading chiefs of the

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Ekiti army. Chief Maye opened conversation, asking after several persons, some still living and some dead, all of them being acquainted with one another. Ogedemgbe was silent, and never uttered a word, probably overcome with emotion : he was finally prevailed upon to speak, but his words were very few. Being late in the day the meeting was adjourned again till Thursday, the 23rd, for the purpose of taking the oaths that there would be peace between them.

The Commissioners also proposed Tuesday the 28th for the evacuation of both camps. But both GeneraHssimos proposed ten days from date {i.e., October 2nd). This the Commissioners refused ; they also refused the proposal of eight days (September 30th) and the chiefs were obliged finally to agree to the 28th.

[We may remark that the Commissioners did not believe that the Ibadans would really decamp, the assurance of the Governor's Ibadan messenger notwithstanding ; because, said they, the Ibadan camp consisted of substantially built swish houses, which they would be loth to desert, whereas the Ekiti's were only frail huts of bamboo and brushwood, but the events proved that the messenger was right.]

At length Thursday the 23rd arrived, a very memorable day. The Commissioners in their respective uniforms received the leading chiefs of both sides under the canopy of heaven in the space between the two houses built for them by the beUigerents.

The final interview can best be told in the words of the Commissioners : —

Extract from the Report of the Commissioners published in the Blue Book :

". . . Thursday, 23rd September.— Early in the morning, although there was drizzling rain, and a mist, yet people began to come from the camps and took up their places at a short distance from either end of our camp, the Ibadans remaining on their side of the Eleriko stream. By nine o'clock there was a crowd of several thousand persons on horseback and foot collected on either side, and the variegated dresses, turbans and umbrellas of the sable warriors, and the showy horse trappings presented a picturesque mass of colouring. We had a hne of sentries posted at each end of our camp, to keep off the crowd in case the multitude should endeavour to follow the chiefs to the meeting, as it was not deemed advisable that a large force from either side should be present or come in contact with each other.

" A marquee was pitched in the centre of the camp under which our chair was placed, and a guard of Hausas being placed

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on either side of it. Chairs, stools, and mats were placed for the accommodation of the chiefs and representatives of signatories of the Treaty in lines from either side of the marquee so as -to form a semicircle with it, leaving an open space in front.

" About ten o'clock the Balogun of Ibadan arrived accompanied by the principal chiefs in the Ibadan camp, and the Ijebu, Oyo and Modakeke signatories of the Treaty or their representatives, in all some 200 people. They took their seats on the chairs to the right of the marquee. A few minutes later the Seriki of Ijesa (Ogedemgbe) with the principal chiefs of the Ekitiparapo army, and the Ijesa, Ife and Ekiti signatories of the Treaty or their representatives arrived. The Seriki and his party, about the same number as the Ibadans, took their seats on the left of the marquee. All being ready we came out of our hut and accompanied by Capt. Speeding, the Rev. C. Phillips, Rev. S. Johnson and Mr. Willoughby proceeded to our seats tmder the marquee.

" It was then discovered that the Modakeke representatives were not present, and ⌒. mounted messenger was despatched to fetch them. They arrived shortly afterwards and were present when the Treaty, and the ratification of it, were read and translated.

" We expressed our pleasure at seeing all those present and said, ' After the Balogun of Ibadan and Seriki of Ijesa had sworn friendship to each other, as we understood they wished to do, we would say what we had to

say.'

" The Balogun and the Seriki then swore eternal friendship to each other by their respective fetishes.

" The Governor's proclamation was then read and interpreted. The Treaty was next read and interpreted ; and after a few remarks from us, the ratification of the Treaty was read and interpreted. Each signatory then came to the table as his name was called and affixed his mark and seal to the document. We then congratulated all in the name of the Queen of England, and the Governor of Lagos, upon the peace which they had concluded and ratified and said we sincerely trusted that they would observe the peace as faithfully as they had observed the Armistice.

" The proclamation of peace was then read and interpreted after which the bugles played and a salute of seven guns was fired (first gun 12.20 p.m.). The Balogun, Seriki and others came and shook hands with us heartily thanking us for what we had done for them. Even the Ijebu representatives.

generally undemonstrative and even supercilious in manner, were effusive in their thanks and congratulations.

" The rains ceased before the meeting took place and the mist clearing away the sun shone brilliantly on the scene. Thousands of people were to be seen posted on the huge boulders of rock which were scattered through the Kiriji Camp, and crowned the summit of the mountain (the Oke Mgsin Camp was not visible from the place of meeting there being a slight rising in the ground between) and as we learned afterwards the sound of the gim which was to announce that peace had been concluded, and that people could go to their homes, was most anxiously awaited in both camps, and received when heard with cheers and hurrahs."

§ 3. The Proclamation of Peace and Firing of the Camps

The following is the Proclamation of Peace between the Ibadans and the Ekitiparapgs at Kiriji- Mesin battlefield on the 23rd September, i886.

Whereas through the friendly mediation of His Excellency the Governor of Lagos an understanding has been brought about, and a treaty of peace, friendship, and commerce concluded between the AlAfin of Oyq, the Balogun, the Abese, the May§, the Agbakin, and the Otun Bale of IJjadan ; the Owa of Ilesa, the Ow6re of Otun, the Ajero of Ijero, the Olojudo of Ido, the Seriki of Ijesa, the Owoni, the Balogun, the Obaluf§, the Obaloran, the Obajio, the Ajaruwa, the Arode, and the Orisanire of Ife ; the Ogunsua, the Balogun, and the Otun of Modakeke, and the Awujale and Balogun of Ijebu.

And whereas due provision has been made by us after conference with the heads of the governments principally concerned, or their representatives duly accredited to us, for the complete fulfilment of the conditions of the said treaty.

Now therefore we, Special Commissioners appointed by His Excellency the Governor of Lagos for the purpose of executing the said treaty in accordance with the provisions thereof, do hereby proclaim, in the name of the signatories of the said treaty, that peace has this day been established and shall henceforth continue for ever between the signatories of the said treaty and between their respective peoples.

Dated at Kiriji-Mesin battlefield this 23rd day of September, 1886.

(Signed) Henry Higgins) cx • * ^

Oliver Smith ''' Comtmsstoners.

Ratification of the Treaty of Peace, Friendship, and Commerce between the Ibadans and Ekitiparapos.

We, the undersigned signatories, and duly authorised representatives of signatories of the Treaty of Peace, Friendship, and Commerce signed in the months of June and July in the current year, by the AlAfin of Oyo; the Balogun, the Abes§, the Maye, the Agbakin, and the Otun Bale of Ibadan, the Owa of Ilesa, the 0w6re of Otun, the Ajero of Ijero, the Olojudo of Ido, the Seriki of Ijesa, the Owgni, the Balogun, the Obalufe, the Obaloran, the' Obajio, the Ajaruwa, the Arode, and the Orisanire of Ife, the Ogunsua, the Balogun, and the

Otun of Modakeke, and the Awujale and Balogun of Ijebu, and having for its object the termination of the war between the Ibadans and their allies, on the one hand, and the Ekitiparapo confederacy on the other hand, hereby ratify and confirm the said treaty, and all and singular the conditions and stipulations thereof, and do further agree to, and approve of the following provisions, for the more perfect fulfilment of the same, made after conference with the governments of the parties principally concerned or their representatives by the Special Commissioners appointed by the Governor of Lagos as representing Her Most Gracious Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland to carry the said treaty into effect.

1. Peace between the signatories of the treaty and their peoples shall be proclaimed by the Commissioners immediately after the signing hereof.
2. Immediately after the proclamation of peace the breaking up of the camps at Kiriji and Oke Mesin respectively shall begin, and upon the signal being given by gunfire in the Commissioners' camp the Ibadans encamped in the Kiriji camp and the Ekitiparapos encamped in the Oke Mesin camp shall simultaneously begin quietly and peacefully and without any demonstration to withdraw from their said respective camps.
3. The Ibadans encamped in the Kiriji camp shall return to their homes by way of Ikirun, Osogbo, Ede, and Iwo, and by Ikirun, Ilobu, Ejigbo, and Oyo, and the Ekitiparapos encamped in the Oke Mesin camp shall return to, their homes by way of Mesin Ip61e, and Mesin Igbo Odo, and Esa Oke, and Esa Egure.
4. The evacuation of the said Kiriji and Oke Mesin camps shall be completed by 12 o'clock noon on Tuesday next the 28th inst. when a signal gun shall be fired in the Commissioners'

camp after which, without further warning, the said Kiriji and Oke Mesin camps shall be destroyed by fire, at such time and in such manner as the Commissioners shall deem expedient.

5. The camps at Modakeke, Isoya, and' elsewhere shall be broken up on such day, and in such manner as the Commissioners after their arrival at the quarters prepared for them by the Modakekes and the Ifes, on their battlefield shall determine, and thereupon the Ifes shall be re-instated in their town of He Ife, and the Modakekes shall forthwith withdraw provisionally to the towns of Ipetumodu, Moro and Oduabon to the land between the Osun and Oba rivers, and north of the present town of Modakeke, before the end of the month of March in the year 1888, and for their faithful compHance with the provisions of this article the authorities of Ibadan undertake to be responsible.
6. During the time that the Modakgkes shall inhabit the said towns of Ipetumodu, Moro, and Oduabon, they shall be at hberty to cultivate and carry away the produce of their present farm of Modakeke, without. molestation from the Ifes. They on their part shall not in any way molest the Ifes.
7. Such of the Modakgkes as shall desire to live with the Ifes shall give notice of such desire to the Commissioners for the brealdng up of the said camps at Modakeke, Isoya, and elsewhere, and any Modakeke who shall not have given such notice shall be conclusively deemed to have elected not to Uve with the Ifes.
8. Those of the inhabitants of the towns of Otan, Ires^, Ada, and Igbajo, who shall desire to remove from those towns, shall be permitted to do so with all their movable property and without molestation at any time before the end of the month of January
9.

Any inhabitant of any of the said towns who shall not have left such towns before the expiration of the said term shall be conclusively deemed to have elected to become a subject of the authorities of Ibadan.

9. The hostages given to the Commissioners by way of security for the due observance of the article of the said treaty relating to the breaking up of the Kiriji and Oke Mesin camps shall remain with the Commissioners so long as the Commissioners shall deem expedient.

In witness whereof we have hereunto affixed our hands and seals the 23rd day of September, 1886.

Obakosetan

Belewu

Ajayi

Adejumo

Osuntoki

Fajinmi

Elegbede

Apelidiagba

Fatuye

Orisalusi

Qbasa

Ogedemgbe

Osundulu

To jo

Akinpe

Sow5

Ayanleye

Awonimesin

Ogundeke

Okunlaja

representing the AlAfin of Oyo

Balogun of Ibadan . .

representing the Abese of Ibadan . .

The Maye of Ibadan

The Agbakin of Ibadan

representing the Otun Bale of Ibadan „ „ Owa of Ilesa

„ „ Owore of Otun

„ „ Ajero of Ijero

„ „ Olojudo of Ido

Seriki of Ijesa

(the Ajaruwa) for the Ife Signatories

(the Arode of Ife)

representing the Ogunsua of Modakeke

Acting Balogun of Modakeke

Acting Otun for Modakeke

representing the Awujale of Ijebu „ „ Balogun of Ijebu

Their marks

Signed, sealed, and delivered in the presence of

Seal O O

(Signed) Henry Higgins,

Acting Col, Secretary! „, . , „ . . ,.,. j^ r c- [Special Commissioners.

(signed) Oliver Smith, ^

Queen's Advocate"^

(Signed) Charles Phillips,

Clerk in Holy Orders [Interpreters on this (Signed) Samuel Johnson, | occasion.

Clerk in Holy Orders^

As it was evident that the camps must be evacuated, all the women with their movable effects and live stock cleared off to Ikirun within three days.

The Ibadan slaves who did not wish to return home with their masters took this opportunity to escape to their country. In order to effect this with safety, without drawing attention, they set fire to some houses, and during the confusion and bustle attending the conflagration hundreds of them made good their escape to the Ekiti camp which overlooked the Ibadan camp. The houses of the Maye of Ibadan, and the Timi of Ede and those of several men of lesser note, were consumed in this conflagration.

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This was on Friday, the 24th September. One chief alone (Sanusi the son of the Are) lost about 400 slaves.*

The Ibadan chiefs, fearing they would lose all their slaves in this manner, thought they ought rather to go at once and wait no longer for the 28th or they might have to do so with grief and gloom. By the 25th the camp was all but deserted. On the 26th the Balogun with the rest of the war chiefs left for Ikirun. Ogedemgbe hearing that the Ibadan chiefs had gone, left also with his men for Mesin Ipole. The Commissioners, however, were determined to keep to the letter of the treaty and to fire both camps on the 28th. The hostages. Chief Mosaderin and Fakeye of the Ibadan?, and Asipa of the Ekitiparapgs, were detained still by the Commissioners until the camps were fired.

The following extract from the Commissioners' report will describe the proceedings of the 28th when the camps were fired : —

'. . . Tuesday, September 28th. — There was heavy rain during the night, and the thermometer registered 66 degrees, the lowest temperature we had experienced. The morning was fine though cloudy, and there was a shght breeze.

Mr. Johnson left for Ikirun with presents from us to the kings and chiefs whose sudden departure from Kiriji had not allowed us the opportunity of giving them prior to their leaving the camp.

We sent 50 of our carriers to either camp to be in readiness to fire them on the signal gun being fired from our camp. Two guns were fired at 12 o'clock, and three minutes later both camps were in flames.

The breeze being slight the smoke did not clear away but hung in dense clouds over the camps.

By half-past one o'clock both camps were almost completely burned, but the lire smouldered during the day and night. The houses in the Ibadan camps were not so completely destroyed, as those in the Oke Mesin camp, the former being mud with thatch roofs, while the latter were chiefly constructed of bamboo with leaf roofs.

Immediately the camps were fired. Chief Mosaderin and the Oyo hostage came to say good-bye to us. . . . He was a fine old man, with very courteous manners, and he was in a desperate hurry to get away, always fearing that something had happened

ˆ Many of them finding their old homes quite different from what they had expected, and conditions of life more arduous, returned to their former masters at Ibadan.

to his wives and belongings at Ikirun, or that we might take him to Lagos.

The Ijesa and Ekiti hostage also came to say good-bye, and to express their gratification at the sight of the burning camps. The Asipa was very anxious for us to allow him and his party to walk to the gates of the Ibadan camp. For obvious reasons we would not grant his request."

We may remark- that Ogedemgbe, the Seriki of the Ijesas, showed much anxiety about the camps at Ofa, wishing this offshoot of the war to come to an end also ; but the Ilorin Generalissimo would not give in as we shall see later on, nor allow the Ijesa contingent with him to come away.

§ 4. The Commissioners at Modakeke : Failure.

The Commissioners left their camp on the 29th September, 1886. They thus described the ruins of both camps in their report : —

" The rain which fell heavily during the night turned into a drizzle in the early morning, and the mountains and country enveloped in a thick cloudy mist for some hours after sunrise, when the weather cleared up somewhat.

About 150 carriers all Ekitis furnished by Chief Ogedemgbe had come to our camp the preceding evening, and so facihtated our making an early start. However, notwithstanding the fact of these carriers being on the spot, it was a quarter past ten o'clock before they could all be got off and we ourselves able to start. . . .

As the dense mist cleared under the rays of the sun we could discern the still smoking ruins of the Kiriji (Ibadan) camp, the downpour of rain during the night not having cornpletely put out the conflagration.

Passing through the Oke Mesin camp (Ekitiparapg) a complete ruin, the leaf roofs and bamboo sides of the huts having burned more rapidly than the mud walls and thatch roof of the huts in the Ibadan camp, we reached the town of Mesin Ipole at ten minutes past eleven o'clock."

The Commissioners halted here awhile to have an interview with the kings for the signing of the enactment for the abohtion of human sacrifice. The Seriki's speech on the occasion shows the amount of power and influence he had over the Ekiti kings. His speech to the Owore embodied in the Commissioners' report of the occasion is as follows : "I command you to sign it,

in the name of the white man, and when I command no king dare disobey. I will send word to all the Ekiti kings."

Leaving Mesin Ipole at one o'clock the Commissioners had to travel through a difficult path under a heavy shower of rain which drenched them to the skin. The path in some places was steep and rugged, and in consequence of the rain quite overflooded. Hare was reached at 3.30, and Esa Egure at 6 p.m. where they peissed the night.

Here they had an opportunity of an interview with the Owa of Ilesa who also signed the enactment for the abolition of human sacrifice.

At 11.30 the next morning the Commissioners started on their onward march, reached Ijebu Ere at 2 p.m. and passing through a very bad and shppery road where most of the carriers had . numerous falls, and the horses floundered, and had occasional falls with the rider, all which rendered the journey an unpleasant one, they at length arrived at Ilesa about 6 p.m.

The accident at Ilesa was that of a fierce bull which attacked the chief Commissioner's horse, but was driven away by the sentry. The bull went next to the Queen's Advocate's horse when it was tied up, and gored it so badly that next morning it had to be shot.

Leaving Ilesa on Saturday, October 2nd, Ibodi was reached at 11.20, Gunmodi at 2 p.m., and after resting here one hour the Ife- Modakeke battlefield was reached quite late on the same day. On the next morning the following Ijesa, Ekiti, and Ife chiefs came to welcome the Commissioners : Fabumi (Ekiti), Lodifi (Ijesa), Oluyo, the Balogun, and Bambe, the Seriki of Ife. Also the civil chiefs Obalufe, Obaloran, Obajio, Ajaruwa, Arode, and the Orisanire.

In the afternoon the chiefs of the Ibadan contingent defending Modakeke, viz : — Aldntola, Sumonu Apampa, Ojo Wanwanmasi the Ekarun paid them also a friendly visit of welcome. Of the Modak§ke chiefs Sowo the Ogunsua's respresentative, the Agbakin, Oyeleye the Otun Agbakin, Detomi and Oke the two powerful war chiefs also came to pay their respects. The conference at the Ife-Modakeke battlefield lasted about 30 days without any result till the Commissioners left them. It was thus summarized in the Commissioners' report : —

We arrived at Ife-Modakeke on the evening of the 2nd of October, and on the 5th inst we had an interview with the Ibadan chiefs, and impressed upon them the necessity for the Modakek§s removing from their town as soon as. possible.

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The Ibadan chiefs promised to see the Modakeke authorities and return on the following morning.

On the 6th the Ibadan chiefs' messengers and one Modakek§ chief's messenger came to say their masters could not come as it was an unlucky day. We said we should expect to see their masters on the following day.

On the 7th the Ibadan and Modekeke chiefs came together and the latter asked lor five months in which to remove to Ipetumodu, etc.

In the afternoon of the same day we saw the Ife chiefs and their allies and informed them of the Modakekes' request. The Ifes would not hear of five months being granted, saying it was only a ruse to get rid of us, and that the Modakekes would never leave if they did not remove in our presence from their

On the 8th inst. we saw the Ibadan and Modakeke chiefs, and told them that we had decided upon careful consideration that the Modakekes must remove from their town to Ipetumodu within ten days from that day, and that the Ibadans on the one side and the allies of the Ifes on their side should decamp also within that time. The Agbakin said he would tell the Ogunsua what we had decided.

In the afternoon we informed the Ifes and their allies of our decision. On the gth the Ijebu, Ibadan, and Oyo representatives came to tell us that the previous afternoon, on our decision becoming known, there was an uproar at Modakeke, the people saying they would die rather than leave their town. The representatives considered matters serious and therefore came to ask us if some other arrangement could be made as the Modakekes seemed very determined.

We told the representatives that they had better go and see the Ibadan chiefs and Modakeke authorities and try to learn from them the true state of affairs and let us know.

In the afternoon the representatives returned and said the Ibadan chiefs told them that the uproar had been directed against them the previous day, the Modakekes alleging that the Ibadan chiefs had betrayed them and saying they would not leave their town. The representatives said the -Ibadan chiefs had sent a messenger to the Balogun at Ikirun asking for instructions as to how to act and expected an answer in about five days' time.

On the nth the Agbakin and representatives of the Ogunsua and Otun Agbakin and the Ibadan chiefs came to see us : they said they wished us to reconcile the Modakekes and Ifes, that the former never had intended to leave their present town, and

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that their proposition of five months' grace being granted meant nothing. We told them that the Agbakin was the only chief present, and that if the chiefs had any proposals to make they must make them in person.

On the I2th the junior commissioner had an interview with the Ibadan and Modakeke chiefs, and impressed upon them that if the Modakekes persisted in their refusal to quit their present town within the time given, the Ifes and their allies would not be bound to break up their camps, while the Ibadans would have to retire from Modakeke if we so ordered them, they having made peace with the Ifes and their allies.

The Ibadans appeared to side with the Modakekes at this interview, and two of the chiefs were somewhat insolent.*

No progress with affairs under consideration was made. We had subsequent interviews with the Ifes on the 13th and with the Modakekes on the 14th, and at the request of both parties agreed to the chiefs on either side meeting in a shed by our house with a view to their possibly being able to come to an understanding.

We gave them distinctly to understand, however, that any scheme they might agree upon must be submitted to us by noon on Monday the i8th of October.

Several meetings of the Ife and Modakeke chiefs were held, and at one time it almost seemed that they might be able to come to an understanding ; the Ifes offering to allow all the Modakekes to hve with them in He Ife* provided the present town of Modakeke was destroyed.

On Monday the i8th both parties appeared before us and asked for an extension of 24 hours which was granted to them.

ˆ These were Akintola and Sumonu Apampa the latter being the spokesman. The chief commissioner being indisposed on this occasion, the Queen's Advocate conducted the negotiations in his own way. Foiled and silenced at every turn by his dialectic skill, the young war-chief fiercely broke out " You were sent here to make peace not to destroy lives. When you ordered a population like that of Modakeke to remove at once and go and live in a forest what is to become of the women and children, the aged and infirm, how and where are they to live ? How to be sheltered and how fed ? If anything should happen to them, at your hands will God enquire their lives. They and the Ifes had lived in peace between themselves before, and they can do so again if only you would reconcile them together." — Ed.

ˆ Modakeke contained a far larger population than He Ife and more powerful war-chiefs. — Ed.

The chiefs then resumed their meetings, which shortly afterwards became very stormy and ended by both parties leaving without having come to any agreement. No proposal was submitted to us by the authorities on either side at all.

On the i8th we had an interview with the Ibadan chiefs and pointed out to them that we might have to call upon them to retire from Modakeke if- the Modakekes did not abide by the treaty. They begged us not to send them away before the allies on the Ife side, but gave no hint that they would not obey cmr orders.

On the 20th we saw the Ibadan chiefs and told them that the Modakekes having broken the treaty, we called upon the Ibadans to retire from the town of Modakeke they being at peace with the Ifes and their allies.

The Ibadan chiefs replied that they had sent all their things away, but would not leave Modakeke unless the Ifes' allies also decamped, without orders from the Balogun.

We warned them that in remaining in Modakeke after we had ordered them to leave, they were breaking the treaty. They said they had not signed the treaty and therefore were not responsible. We said we should send direct to the Balogun.

On the 2 1st October we despatched the Rev. S. Johnson to Ikirun with a letter to the Balogun of Ibadan informing him of the state of affairs, and requesting him to withdraw the Ibadan contingent in Modakeke without delay, and also to let us know what measures he intended taking to carry into effect the obligations undertaken by him and the other Ibadan authorities in clause 5 of the ratification of the treaty.

On the same day we despatched the Rev. C. Phillips to Mesin Ipole with a letter to Chief Ogedemgbe and with orders to proceed on and meet Mr. Johnson at Ikirun. Mr. Philhps returned to us on the 26th bringing a letter from Chief Ogedemgbe asking us not to allow the Modakekes to remain in their present town.

Mr. Phillips reported that the news he took to Mesin Ipole about the Modakekes caused much indignation.

On the 27th Mr. Johnson arrived with a messenger from the Balogun of Ibadan who delivered the following message to us :

Qdejayi [the messenger] : " The Balogun salutes you. He had heard of all your trouble with his people who are here. He begs you to pass it over. He has sent them word that they are all to clear out at once. He salutes you for being hungry on his account. He least expected that the Modakeke people would be so obstinate. He thought it would be a thread but

it has passed a twine. He thought with one word he would tell the Modakekes to clear out, and they would obey him ; but now they are so obstinate, and disobedient. He would beg the Ifes to come home, and the Modakekes as many of them as are his friends or relations or belong to him he will tell them to clear out to Ipetumodu, and those who remain will have their choice whether to clear out or live with the Ifes.

" He says as to the Of a case, they are negotiating with the Ilorins therefore the Modakeke case will take time. Now you are settling things here there will be no firing of guns ; he will try to settle everything peaceably. He will never break the treaty in any way."

The Commissioners : " Are you charged with any message to the Modakekes ? "

Odejayi : " No,"

The Commissioners : ".Is there any other messenger going to them ?"

Qdejayi : " The only message I have for the Modak§kes is that the Balogun is withdrawing his army in compliance with the treaty. I am sent with a message to Fabumi."

The Commissioners : " What is that message ? "

Odejayi : " That the Balogun has sent to the Seriki as well as the Owa to beg the Ifes, and he asks Fabiimi also to beg the Ifes, and that he will put matters straight. All their forefathers came from Ife and so Ife must not be a desolate place."

The messenger said he would deUver his message to the Ibadan chiefs that afternoon, and let us know their intentions as soon as possible.

The nex.t morning the messenger came to teU us that he had delivered the message to the Ibadan chiefs at a meeting the previous evening, and they had said they were ready to go when the allies on the other side went, but not before.

The messenger said he had seen one of the Ibadan chiefs that morning who had said they were going to have another meeting to consider again the Balogun's message.

On the 29th a messenger arrived from Chief Ogedemgbe with a letter in which he said, if the Modakekes did not leave their town he would attack the Ibadans at Ikirun.

It seems Chief Ogdemgbe sent the messenger whom the Balogun had sent to him back to Ikirun, with a message that he could not agree to the Balogun's proposal to reconcile the Ifes and Modakekes and let the latter remain in their town, and asking the Balogun to send any answer he might have to make direct to us so as to save time.

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On the 30th we sent for the Balogun's messenger who came with Mr. Johnson, and learnt from him that the Ibadan Chiefs said they could not leave until matters were settled, or in other words, that they had decided to disobey the Balogim's order to quit Modakeke at once.

We now came to the conclusion that it was useless our wasting any more time in endeavouring to see the treaty carried out, and accordingly addressed a letter to the Modakeke authorities which was read to them by Mr. Johnson on the ist of November charging them with having broken the treaty and holding them primarily responsible for any compUcation which might arise through their default.

We had twice since our arrival at Ife-Modakeke sent word to the Ogunsua through Mr. Johnson that we proposed to visit him, but each time he had begged to be excused from receiving us.^

We had a final interview with the Ifes on the ist November and impressed upon them that neither they nor their aUies should do anything to provoke a renewal of hostilities but await the action of the BaJogun of Ibadan to whom and also to Chief Ogedemgbe, we were sending particulars of the situation. They all said they had no wish to recommence the war, and would do what they could to keep the peace.

Mr. Johnson told us that the Modakekes and Ibadans had also expressed themselves as most strongly averse to more fighting.

We addressed letters to Chief Ogedemgbe and the Owa, and the Ekiti kings, teUing them of our intention to return to Lagos, and pointing out to them that every effort should yet be made to have matters settled peaceably, and that they should afford the Ibadan authorities every opportunity of carrying out their part of the treaty. We also addressed a letter to the Balogun of Ibadan impressing upon him that if the Ibadan authorities did not at once actually withdraw their contingents from Modakeke, and fulfil their obligations under the 5th clause of the ratification of the treaty, they would be equally guilty with the Modakekes of a breach of faith with the Governor of Lagos, and all the signatories of the treaty, and be held responsible

^ Which is a great pity ; for had the commissioners done so, they would possibly have been impressed with the size of Modakeke, a town ot over 60,000 inhabitants and the practical difficulties in the carrying out of their proposals. Ipetumodu did not contain more than 10,000 ; and how can 10,000 accommodate 60,000? — Ed.

should war ensue in consequence of their failure to abide by their pledges.

This letter we entrusted to the Rev. S. Johnson to take to Ikirun, and he was to leave Modakeke on the 3rd November, and should reach the Balogun at latest in four days after.

We left Ife-Modakeke on the morning of the 2nd November for Ode Ondo.

While we were at IferModakeke, and especially towards the end of the time, there were constant communications between the opposite camps, and we were asked by Akintola the leading Ibadan chief, and by FabQmi to allow them to meet in our presence with a view to the withdrawal of the respective alHes of the Ifes and Modakekes.

This we declined to do, as we did not consider it consistent with the object of our mission : but we informed Fabumi that if he and Akintola choose to meet, we had no objection to their doing so, and if they came to an arrangement between themselves, that was their concern.

H. HiGGINS lex • 7^

Oliver SmithP ^ Commxsswners.

After the Commissioners had gone, Fabiimi said to the envoys from the AlAfin of Oyq, the Awujale of Ijebu, and the Balogun of Ibadan, that if the white men could not wait to settle their differences, they should wait to accomplish what they had begun, and to bring matters to a final issue. He asked them to summon the Ibadan chiefs with Akintola at their head for a conference. This was done, and all the Ibadan chiefs went out but had not the confidence to go unarmed as far as the Commissioners' camp, where they used to meet the Ife chiefs when the Commissioners were there. They went half-way and sent word to Fabiimi to say they

had come. Fabumi however could not prevail upon the If§ chiefs to meet them for a conference, hence he sent word to say that he would meet with the Ife chiefs at a conference and would let them know the result.

On the 3rd November Fabiimi went to Ayimoro's camp and brought pressure to bear upon him that under no circumstance should they provoke a fight and recommence hostihties with the Ibadans and Modakekes. On his return, he told Oba-kosetan that he had secured the promise of Ayimoro upon good faith that the Modakekes should not be kidnapped or provoked to a fight and that the armistice should continue.

The Ibadan chiefs sent a message to Fabiimi that a sensible messenger should be sent from each of the three camps to them.

viz., the Ife's, A5dmgro's and Ogunsigun's camps, and they would tell them their minds.

Fabumi alone took the initiative, and he sent back to say that unless he visited each of these camps in person and prevailed upon the chiefs to send each a messenger, they would never do so. He also suggested that the free intercommunication between them should continue, for if communication be interrupted there would soon be another difficulty.

The envoys were not allowed to leave Modakeke for about a month after the Commissioners had gone, and as the result of their negotiations, the Ibadan contingent at Modakeke, as well as Fabumi and the Ijesa contingents with the exception of Ayimorg (Ijesa) and Ogunsigun (Ijebu) left their respective aUies the same day ; the Ibadan contingent leaving for Ikirun to join their brethren and Fabumi for Mesin Ipole to join Ogedemgbe, and subsequently for Mesin-Oloja-Oke his home.

The Ifes however remained in their camp, refusing to go home (as yet) and rebuild their city, but there was no resumption of hostiUties.

Chapter XXXI

DISTURBANCE IN EVERY PART OF THE COUNTRY

§ I. Ilorin Intrigues and the Fall of Ofa

We have seen above how anxious Ogedemgbe was about the war going on at Ofa, how he wished the Commissioners to include this in their efforts, being as it were a part of the same war. He tried to induce them to send a messenger with his own, and one from the Balogun of Ibadan to prevail. upon KsLrkrk the Ilorin Generahssimo to accept terms of peace ; but the Commissioners dechned to do so. They however appro ved of their sending their own messengers if they so wished. Seriki Ogedemgbe and the Balogun of Ibadan agreed to ask Lasebikan the head of the Ilorin contingent with the Ekitis to send also with them, but he backed out of this obligation. It appeared that Seriki Ogedemgbe had some communications with Kkvkrk, urging him to the acceptance of peace, and had not succeeded. He was also very anxious about the Ijesa contingent in the Ilorin camp. He sent to tell Karkr^ that matters had been settled at Kiriji, and that if he would let the Ekitis with him leave his camp, he would let the Ilorins with him leave Oke Mesin. The following was the reply returned by the wily Kkrkrk : " Let my men perish with you, and let your men perish with me." Showing that the astute Gambari knew what he was about when he made the arrangement. The fact was that the Ilorins had no grievance which could be settled like that of the Ekitis, they were simply on conquest bent.

K^ark had good reasons to be so haughty and implacable. He was on bad terms with his king at home, and embarked on this war against his strong behest, and to return to Ilorin otherwise than as a victor might cost him his Hfe. Hence all negotiations with him proved abortive ; he was determined to take Ofa either by force of arms or by stratagem.

Shortly after the firing of the camp at Kiriji, the Seriki Ogedemgbe sent to assure the Balogun of Ibadan that they wished peace to be made at Ofa also, so that they might withdrav/ their contingent from the Ilorin camp, and that the Ibadans should do nothing to prevent this being done. The Balogun sent back to say he also wished for peace there so that he might recall his men, Ofa would be restored to the Ilorins provided they might promise not to sack the city. They (the Ibadans) would await the result of the efforts

of the Ijesa and Ekiti kings' mediation with the Ilorins, and should Kkrkrk refuse to let the men quit his camp, the Ibadans would be quite ready to let them pass safely through their ranks to Ofa, and thence safely to their homes without a calabash or a pot being broken. Having sworn friendship to him he would never go back on his word. As the result of the messages sent to him by Seriki Ogedemgbe Kkrkrk sent to the Ibadan war chiefs to say that the Ibadans should withdraw their contingent from Ofa, and must not fear any molestation from the Ilorins.

The messengers arrived at Ikirun on the 9th of November, 1886. The Ibadans considered it puerile to demand that the defensive should withdraw from a beleaguered city before the offensive, and therefore rephed as follows: "Before we remove a single man Karara should decamp first, and if he refuse to do so, let him await us. And why should he ask us to withdraw our forces when he is still encamped against Ofa ? When Ali his father encamped against Otun, and we sent Ajayi Jegede to defend that city some years ago and peace was made between us, was it not Ali his father that decamped first ? So it should be in this case also."

The messengers however were well treated ; the Balogun entertained them with two large calabashes full of lyan (pounded yam), a potful of meat, and also gave them ten heads of cowries and a goat.

When this strong message was delivered to Kkrkrk he opened a secret communication with one Lagbeja, one of the powerful chiefs who re-inforced Ofa. Lagbeja was carrying on this communication without informing his brother chiefs in the camp, and when this was found out they all set against him, and the quarrel was so hot that Lagbeja had to escape from the camp over the walls and took refuge in the town of Ofa.

The news of this disunion among the re-inforcement alarmed the Balogun and the other war chiefs at Ikirun ; they immediately despatched one Oyesunle to reconcile them, and Lagbeja returned to his post.

On the very night of his return, two messengers from the Ilorin camp came to ask for an interview with him. He declined the interview for obvious reasons, but the other chiefs hearing this, advised him to grant the interview, and let them hear what the envoys had to say. He was invited to the Ilorin camp for peace negotiation.

Oyesunle the Balogun's messenger was deputed to conduct the negotiation. He was the chief envoy, and each of the principal war chiefs sent a man with him. Thus he visited the Ilorin camp, and proceeded to Ilorin city for an interview with the Emir.

The Emir of Ilorin received the messengers graciously, and before granting an interview he treated them with cold water, bananas, honey, and sugar ; saying " As sweet and refreshing as these are, so I wish the country to be."

The following was the message sent by the Emir to the Ibadan chiefs : " Of a has always been mine, the royal gift of my father to me, and hence I do not wish it to be destroyed. My request is that the Ibadans should treat me as a King, and to let my words come to pass. They should recall their army first, and I shall recall mine." He presented the messengers with 13 gowns (one to each man), fed them sumptuously, and gave them some cowries.

The Ilorin Emir also sent his own messengers to the Balogun, about 17 of them, all on horseback : and he also treated them with similar generosity ; they were sent back with a similar message as the one they brought, asking the Emir to withdraw his attacking force, and they would withdraw the defending one.

The Ibadans were quite ahve to the Ilorin intrigues.

Karara in the meantime never ceased to breathe out vengeance against Ofa, and to speak disparagingly of the Balogun of Ibadan : he was often heard to say, " And who else is called Balogun besides myself ? " However, there was an armistice till the month of June, 1887, when the AlAfin as a part of his engagement in the Treaty, and at the request of his subjects, took the negotiation in hand. His Majesty sent Obajuwon, one of his chief Ilaris, who went to the Ilorin camp in a style befitting his rank. A tumult arose in the Ilorin camp when he entered there with his drum. He was set upon by the Gambari faction, and his drum was

ripped with a knife ! The Yoruba element in the camp immediately rushed around him to prevent violence being done to his person, and effected his safe return to Ofa. Obajuwon arrived home on the 30th June, 1887. Thus failed the negotiation of peace at Ofa, and hostilities were recommenced afresh.

All prospects of peace appeared very dark and cloudy once more, the war being vigorously prosecuted at Ofa, and it was under consideration at Ikirun whether the army at Ofa should be re-inforced or not. The Ibadan senior chiefs were reluctant to do so, lest the conflict between themselves and Ogedemgbe be renewed, and the scene of war be but changed from Kiriji to Ofa and Ikirun, for Ogedemgbe had not disbanded his forces.

The war chiefs had once a stormy meeting at Ikirun on this subject, when Chief Enimowu (son-in-law to the famous Basorun Ogunmola) in the heat of passion volunteered to go to the relief of Ofa if the leaders would not move. Without obtaining any

sanction he left the meeting in a rage to prepare for Ofa. Kongi his nephew and heir to the house of Ogunmgla being then but a youth volunteered to go with him, as all the members of the house must go. Enimowu encamped at Erin, a small town a few miles from Ofa where he was of great help in provisioning the beleaguered city.

Unfortunately this new re-inforcement suffered a disaster so great as to be compared to none but that in which his brother-inlaw the late Ilori the Osi was taken alive at the Jalumi war.

The Ilorin horsemen were in the habit of kidnapping the caravans between Ofa and Erin bringing in provisions. On this occasion Enimowu attacked the kidnappers, and in a short time put them to flight, and pursued them rather too far. One notable Ilorin horseman, Nasamu by name, but surnamed " Gata-ikoko " {i.e., a devouring M'olf, from his great fondness for meat) in the chase easily out-distanced his pursuers, and with a few choice horsemen he made a wide detour and re-appeared at the rear of their pursuers ! The alarm was soon given at the rear. The pursued had now become the pursuers. Great was the havoc wrought by the Ilgrins with their spears on the panic-stricken pursuers now taken in the rear. Enimowu, the leader of the expedition, was found sitting on a keg of powder fanning himself after the chase, his horse led to be watered, and he congratulating hirriself that he had given a good account of the enemy, when suddenly the enemy burst upon him from the rear, and there he was taken alive with other illustrious war chiefs, viz., Salako, the heir and successor of the late Aijgnku, Winkunle, late Tubosun's son, Malade, son of the late Seriki Odunjo, and others of lesser note. Salako refused to to go with them as a prisoner of war, and was killed on the spot ; the rest were taken to Ilorin and were there treated as respectable prisoners of war.

Young Kongi was so terrified at the news of this disaster that he waited no longer at Erin but fled precipitately back to Ikirun. For this abject cowardice he was cold-shouldered by everyone of the chiefs and forbidden to attend their councils. He was fined heavily for this before he was allowed to re-occupy his former position, but all the same he subsequently lost the title that would have been his on their return home.

No sympathy was expressed for Enimowu because of the arrogant manner he volunteered for the war, as if all the rest were cowards.

Whilst all this was going on, reports from time to time reached the Ibadans of the disaffection existing at Ofa itself, a portion of the people were in league with the Ilorins, and their messengers

had several times been caught. These belonged to the party who would not have Adegboye the present Olofa as their king, for the only reason that he was the son of the last king. They held that the son should not succeed the father at once, an uncle or elderly cousin should come between. Adegboye did not insist on his right, but was determined to retire from the scene with all his belongings. The case was reported to the Ibadan chiefs and the Are — then living — said to the opposing party, " With an enemy at your gates can you afford to ignore this young prince ? Wliose are the guns, the kegs of powder, and other ammunition you are using to fight the foe ? If he should retire with arms and ammunition belonging to him what will be your prospects ? " Then they reluctantly yielded to Adegboye succeeding his father. They were now unremitting in their intrigues against him.

The Ibadan chiefs being apprehensive of a great act of treachery which might overwhelm their men were, for this reason, no longer disposed to sacrifice the lives of any more of their men after the loss of Enimowu. They were determined therefore to withdraw their army from Ofa.

Apparently going to re-inforce Ofa in strength and avenge Enimowu, the whole of the war chiefs except the Balogun marched out for Ofa with orders secretly to withdraw the Ibadan contingent, the Olgfa, and those in sympathy with the Ibadans. They halted near Erin and sent for those to be rescued at dead of night.

The Olofa on leaving home, in order to ward off suspicion, and prevent a panic, ordered his horse to be saddled and left in charge of a page outside in front of the palace, some of his wives also were left sitting there and there was a bright light burning, while he escaped by a back door with the rest of his wives, children, and favourite servants. Till he was clean gone none but his bodyguard knew of it. He joined the Ibadan reHef party and all ai'rived safely at Ikirun.

The Olofa was the head of all the provincial kings of the Ibolo district between Ilgrin and Iwo. He was assigned a portion of land between Osogbo and Ede, where he founded a new town called Ofa-tedo, and there he resided till the end of the war.

Next morning when it was known all over the city that the Ibadans had gone and the Olofa with them, those hitherto in favour of the Ilorins put leaves on their heads, and went dancing to the Ilorin camp and singing :

" Awa ko se ti Ibadan mo o, T'onirugbon I'a o se." (" No more are we for the Ibadans,

With the long-bearded our lot we've cast,")

Thus they came and prostrated before Karkrk. It was said that he asked them, " Have the Ibadans gone ? " — " Yes, they have gone." He then added, " Very well, you can go home, I will pay you a visit shortly."

After breakfast Kkrkrk rode up to Ofa with his army, and took his seat at the palace gates. His first act was to despatch a body of horsemen to occupy each of the gates of the city so as to allow no exit from any. He next summoned him all the remaining Ofa chiefs and the influential men of the city to be brought before him ; they came with leaves on their heads as a token of submission. He then said to them, " You now say you are all on my side, if that be so, why is it you held out so long against me, and did not open your gates secretly for my troops to enter ? You know now that the Ibadans have gone then you say you declare yourselves for me." And when they lay prostrate before him he coolly gave the order, " E maha dumbu^ won " (" Slaughter them away.") Thereupon followed the process; a man appeared with a butcher's knife in hand, and another with a basin of water. Seizing these prostrate forms one by one, they were forcibly held down, with head and neck raised and the throat coolly cut, and the blood thoroughly drained and the corpse thrown down. This done, the knife was washed in the basin of water — after the manner of slaughtering animals, and then they proceeded to the second, and third, and so on till they had slaughtered the whole of them ! Then he ordered the shade trees of the market place to be cut down as a sign of victory, and the city to be sacked, the inhabitants (such as were left) to be made prisoners. Thus Ofa was taken.

The Consequences of the Fall of Ofa. — When all the towns in the vicinity heard that the Ibadans were gone, and a part of Ofa with them, knowing what the consequences would be, they all were deserted, and the people went with the Ibadans to Ikirun, viz., Erin, Ijabe, Okuku, Igbayi, Oyan, Iba, Ekusa, Okuwk, Agboye, Ori, and Asi.

Inisa alone was not deserted, not being far from Ikirun but within a short time the Ilorin horse was at its gates.

The Ilgrins, who promised so faithfully that if the Ibadan contingent were withdrawn from Ofa they would decamp, now sent word to the Ibadans to say, " Qru yin nmu wa ni Ikirun " (" We are feeling the inconvenience of your body-heat at Ikirun "). Meaning that they should withdraw from Ikirun also. Inisa had to be strongly re-inforced, and for a long time a desultory warfare between the Ibadans and Ilgrins was carried on there. The

^Dumbu is the word used for slaughtering animals for sacrifice.

Ilorins could not leave their camp at Yanayo to encamp against Inisa or Ikirun as before, and the Ibadans did not consider it safe to go against them at Yanayo, where they would be exposed on all sides to the cavalry attack. The strength of the Ilorins lay in their horses, and they could come from a day's journey to attack Inisa or Ikirun, usually by breaking their journey halfway overnight and give battle next morning. If defeated, they were able to retreat in good order : taught by former experience, the Ibadans did not venture to pursue horsemen far from their base. This continued for a good while.

In course of time the Ilgrin horse kept hovering constantly between Ikirun and Inisa as if to cut off communication between the two places, about six or eight miles apart ; the war chiefs therefore considered it more prudent to concentrate their forces at Ikirun in order to prevent a surprise, and therefore they withdrew Babalola who was stationed there. Ikirun once more became the scene of conflict, the Ilorins with their horses paying surprise visits now and then. The Ibadan scouts and outposts being ever on the alert to report their approach the so-called battles now dwindled into occasional skirmishes for half a day, and these few and far between. Taught by Jalumi, the Ilorins would not encamp against Ikirun, and from the experience of Enimowu the Ibadans would not go after them in the plain at Yanayo.

§ 2. Revolutionary Movements at Ijebu

The Ijebus at this time were alarmed at the quiet changes going on in the country. Traders and others from the interior were finding their way down to the coast through their country and vice versa. The traditional saying, " Ijebu Ode, Ajeji ko wo " (Ijebu Ode, no aHen to enter) was in danger of being abohshed, and they were determined to put a stop to it. The blame for this was laid upon the Awujale and on Ngfowgkan the Balogun for entering into friendship with the white men and befriending Oyos (that is for the part they had taken hitherto towards the restoration of peace in the interior). They begrudged the Balogun his influence with the Oyos, and therefore recalled him home from Oru and a civil title was given him. They forced the king to pass a law forbidding Oyos to reach Ijebu Ode, much less to pass through it to Lagos ; all intercourse for merchandise was to be carried on at Orii.

The younger Ijebus were instigated to take the enforcement of the law in hand, and some of them went further and even clamoured for the death of the king.

Their King exonerated himself from their charges by arguing with them thus : " Since we have had a closer intercourse with the Oyos during the late negotiations for peace — a peace clamoured for and desired by yourselves — you Ijebus have had many of their daughters to be your wives, and they have had children for you. Is it not natural for the parents of these women to visit their daughters and grandchildren ? How can you sever the ties of relationship by preventing brothers from visiting their sisters, and parents their children ? If you will be just and fair, send these women back home with the children born to you, then there will be no occasion for any outsiders to enter your country." The law was made so stringent that Prince Adekoya, the Awuj ale's eldest son went to the Remo district which had hitherto been free to caravans both ways and took up his station at Ode seizing all Lagos traders passing up or going down. The writer, together with the Rev. D. Olubi of Ibadan, on their way to Lagos met him there on Easter Tuesday, 1887, but just escaped him on their return, having visited other villages for the same purpose.

Previously to their passing down, a son of the reverend gentleman on his way from Lagos to Ibadan had no end of trouble with him ; he had in his custody a goodly number of traders from the interior and from the coast whose goods had been seized and forwarded to Ijebu Ode and themselves loaded with chains ! This young man was needlessly detained by the prince, and when he grew desperate he got into a rage and frightened the prince by firing a walking-stick gun into the air, just to show what he could do. This novel sight disposed the prince to let him pass on homewards.

His father when passing down took the opportunity to speak to Prince Adekoya, explaining to him the difference between missionaries and traders, and thus paved a way for the mission's mail-man between Lagos and Ibadan by that route.

Soon after their return home from Lagos, news reached the writer at Oyo by one of Balogun Nof owokan's

sons that the writer had been declared by the Awuj ale an outlaw in any of the Ijebu provinces, whether of Ode, Igbo, or Remo. He could be killed by anyone if found in any of these provinces. The crimes alleged against him were these : —

1. That he was no longer on the side of peace, but for the continuation of the war.
2. That he was building a house for the AlAfin, whom he knew to be not favourable to peace.
3. That he was supplying the AlAfin with arms of precision and ammunition for the Ilgrins in order to enable them to wage a successful war against the Ibadans.

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The apparent foundation of these baseless charges was the appointment of the writer by the C.M.S. to take charge of their mission at Oyo and of his building a church and a vicarage there.

The Awujale gave a ready credence to this report because of the maUcious feehng existing in him already against the writer because the Commissioners of 1886 were not prevailed upon by him to kill Ogunsigun the Seriki of Ijebu Igbo, and to disperse his troops at Isoya according to his order.

The writer seized the first opportunity that presented itself of the Rev. W. B. George, Wesleyan minister going down to Lagos via Ijebu to request him to deny these reports both to the Balogun and to the Awujale as utterly false and unfounded.

Early in March, 1888, having another occasion to visit Lagos instead of avoiding the Awujale by finding another route, he thought it best to face the difficulty at once and clear himself of these false charges. Accordingly on his arrival at Oru, by the advice of Tunubi, son of the Balogun and grandson of the Awujale by his eldest daughter, the writer sent to apprise the Balogun of his arrival at Oru, and of his intention to proceed forward. The Balogun sent to say he could come on to Ijebu Ode, but not untildusk.

Meanwhile the Balogun was pleading his cause with the Awujale, after sending to him about six times to no good effect he had to go in person and urge the claims of the writer, reminding him of all he had undergone as the Governor's messenger on behalf of peace since 1886, and begged the King to see him and hear from his own mouth a true explanation of the charges alleged against him. After two days the Awujale relented and agreed to see him. The interview however was not in the day but about 8 p.m. " Ajose " {i.e., Johnson) said the Awujale, " Is that you ? I heard that you are no more for peace but have joined the Alafin in his intrigues." " No, sir," was the reply. " My going to Oyg to reside was not of my own choice, but as an obedient servant I went where I was sent. I am like a rod in the hands of my masters, and wherever I am flung there I must be. Who am I to have a voice of my own in these great political matters ? My calling is of a different kind and not political." The King replied, " Don't you say so ; your words have gained the ears of kings and mighty warriors lately, so you cannot think so meanly of yourself. I was so angry with you that I never intended to see your face any more, but thanks to the Balogun who vigorously pleaded your cause." The writer was allowed to proceed to Lagos, but he had to be accompanied by two escorts from the Balogun.

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That the King was not quite satisfied with the above explanation was evident by his remonstrance with the writer on his returning from Lagos on the 26th of May following. " Ajose," said he, " the whole Ijebu nation love and respect you, but you will lose that love and respect if you do not reconsider your appointment to Qyo."

Prince Adekoya continued his blockade of the Remo district for a long time, and many valuable lives perished and much property was confiscated in that district ; both persons and effects were transferred to Ijebu Ode and nothing more heard of them, most of the persons being killed or sold far away. A Brazihan freedman who had acquired some substance in his land of exile was returning to his native town of I wo. He happened to meet with Adekoya here, and was seized by him with all his goods and personal belongings, and sent to Ijebu Ode. The goods were said to be worth over ;{8oo, including cash : among them was a large red silk damask umbrella with tassels all round intended for his King, the Oluiwo. The Ijebu King in council in consideration of his heavy losses, granted the man his freedom. • They told him he could go. But the

unfortunate man, overcome with grief and despair groaned and said, " What is life worth to me now? I have committed no crime, I have been utterly ruined. No prospect before me now but utter destitution and beggary ! Death is preferable." "All right," said the Awujale, " we will oblige you in this." He then gave the order " E lo ipo o " (Go and kill him). In a few minutes his head was off his shoulders !

Not content with watching his own country the Awujale also sent an Agurin to the Ibadans with strict orders to arrest anyone in European dress, white or black, and if he is such as cannot be dealt with they should at any rate send him back to Lagos. An attempt was made thus to turn the writer back to Lagos from the very gate of Ibadan, but he left his luggage with them at the town gate and galloped into the town to Awonimesin, the Chief Agurin, his former colleague in his travelling up and down on the peace negotiations in 1886 : he on seeing him' sent orders that he should be allowed to enter the town in peace. The Rev. T. Harding, the European Superintendent of the C.M.S. Missions, had to pass through Ijebu to the interior, and was compelled to pay the sum of £4 before he was allowed to pass in 1889, and that was only because he at that time had his home in the interior.

Thus the Ijebus were trying to prevent the opening up of the

It should be made clear, however, that the motives actuating the Ijebus to these proceedings, mistaken though they be, were

not only the determination of being the middle men between the coast and the interior, but also (as they thought) in order to prevent the country from being taken by white men. A report of what was called, " The scramble for Africa," then going on reached them in one form or another, and they were but safe-guarding the national interests.

§2. "A Mild Treaty"

About the month of May, 1888, all Lagos was startled by the report that the emissaries of the French from Porto Novo had reached Abegkuta, and that they concluded a treaty with the three leading chiefs, Ogundejd, Onlado, and the Jaguna of Igbein (Ogundipe being dead) giving them large presents, and promising them a profitable trade, and the construction of a line of railway from Porto Novo to Abeokuta. Advantage was taken of the constant misunderstandings and frictions between the Lagos Government and the Egbas shown by the frequent blockading of the river and land route by the Egbas, and the stopping of all trade with Lagos.

The situation was saved for the British Government by the Egba educated natives {i.e. Sierra Leoneans whose fathers were of Egba origin) of Lagos, who, as soon as they heard the report, held a meeting among themselves without delay, and sent a deputation to Abeokuta to enquire from the chiefs how far the report was true. The deputation returned to Lagos on Whit Tuesday, May 22nd, 1888, with a confirmation of the rumour; however, the chiefs were said to have denied signing any treaty. Their language, which was regarded as not quite satisfactory, was to this effect : —

" We thank you for the solicitations you have manifested for your fatherland. You have done well in that, though living out of home, you have not forgotten the homeland and its interests. You call yourselves our children, but what have we, your parents, ever received from you ? But immediately you heard that others have made us a few presents, you hastened to show us the danger lurking in their gifts. Some of you were born abroad and never made our acquaintance until now, very singular way indeed of showing love and interest towards one's fatherland.

' ' Have you not observed the short weights and the short lengths in the folded cloths ? Have you not noticed that the English cloths contain increasingly more chalk than cotton fibres, the liquor diluted, the price of our produce always falling and never rising ? What have you done to help us in these things to make

our labour more remunerative ? Nothing. It strikes us that you only concerned yourselves in competing with the white men to make your own profits out of us. We have been trading with the English for years, and the result is like an operation on the treadmill, always on the move but remaining where we were with

a tendency to a backward motion in spite of efforts continually put forth. But no sooner we attempt to try for a profitable trade with another people than you hasten to warn us of the danger that lies therein. We thank you for your anxious care, but neither to the French nor to the English are we giving our country."

Not satisfied with the character of the report of the deputation, the leading members of the educated Egbas of Lagos themselves went up to interview the chiefs, and warned them of the danger they were running of placing themselves between the upper and nether millstones of two European powers. What really passed between them in this interview was not made known, but the chiefs were said to have received them well, and assured them that they were not giving the country to anyone. Nothing further was heard of the movement, and thus the situation was saved.

When it was known that the Egbas claimed as far as Ebute Meta as their territory, surely no British officer at Lagos could view this movement with indifference. The very existence of Lagos would be at the mercy of the power predominant at Abeokuta.

Baulked at Abeokuta, rumour had it that the French emissaries were proceeding to Oyo to establish friendly relations with the AlAfin.

As it was about this time the overlapping of interests in the scrambling had begun, and it was said to be laid down by the French that he who possessed the capital had the right to the rest of the country, the Governor of Lagos thereupon sent the writer — who happened to be at Lagos at the time — ^with a letter and a Treaty to the AlAfin of Oyo as the Suzerain of Yoruba-land, which he termed " A Mild Treaty."

May 23rd, i<S88.

No. 115/77-

King, — I received with much pleasure your letter of the 20th February last, and beg to thank you for the present of two cloths of the country, any manufacture of which interests me indeed.

2. To show my esteem to you and my appreciation of the position you occupy I have asked the Rev. S. Johnson, who

returns to his ministerial duties, to salute you and your people with my compliments and respect ; and to wish well to you and yours.

3. As you know, and every Yoruba knows, people to the west and to the north are not Yoruba ; they differ in feehngs and object from Yorubas. You will have doubtless learnt I always aim at making all Yoruba-speaking peoples one in heart as they are in tongue. Towards such unity I attach much importance to a definite and permanent understanding between these Yoruba-speaking peoples, and this colony which is mainly inhabited by Yorubas. And where should I look first for sympathy and support but to Adeyemi, the AlAfin of Oyo the titular King of all Yoruba ?

4. Between you and the Governor of the Queen's Colony of Lagos there should be ever friendship, goodwill which no foreign interference should be allowed to influence or disturb.

5. Yoruba-land was comprised traditionally as regards its corners a few years ago of Yoruba proper, Egba, Ketu and Ijebu. Where is Ketu now ? And from what direction was it destroyed ?

6. Without the entertainment of the least desire to meddle with the government of such kingdoms as Yoruba, Egba, or Ijebu, and with the assurance that not one yard of land is coveted by me, in feehng and sympathy for Yoruba union I desire that Lagos take the place of Ketu as the fourth comer.

7. If the accompanying document be agreeable to you, and embodies your wishes, sign it and return it to me. If your relations with the country to the north of yours be such as to admit of your persuading them what is to their interest, I would be glad to find you can get its people to sign a paper similar to the one I propose to yourself.

8. Look what has been done with considerable expense already by Her Majesty's Government for the Yoruba-speaking countries in connection with the settlement among them in i886 of what had been

known as the Interior War, in which you took such action as should when you look back upon it swell your heart with pride, and your country with gratitude.

9. I am anxious to hear of large markets re-established between Oyg Ogbomosg, Ilorin, Abeokuta and Ijebu as they existed in the past, and safe roads. How this can best be done I will be glad to hear from you.

ID. You will be at liberty to send your accredited messengers to me should you desire to have a longer conversation than can well be put within the compass of an ordinary letter,

II. I venture to send you five pounds as a small present. Wishing you and all your people every good wish. I am, King,

Your good friend,

Alfred C. Moloney, Governor.

The Treaty.

Treaty between Adeyemi, AlAfin of Oyo, and Head of Yoruba-land, and Her Majesty, Queen of Great Britain and Ireland.

I, Adeyemi, AlAfin of Oyo, and Head of Yoruba-land, the four corners of which are and have been from time immemorial known as Egba, Ketu, Jebu, and Oyo, embracing within its area that inhabited by all Yoruba-speaking peoples, being desirous of entering into, and maintaining for ever, friendly relations with the subjects of Her Majesty, the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, and of developing the resources of Yoruba by means of legitimate trade with the subjects of Her Majesty and those under her protection or who may hereafter come under her protection, and in gratitude for what the Queen has at so much expense and risk to life done from time to time for my country, have this day at the city of Oyo in the presence of those who have hereunto subscribed their names as witnesses declared my intention of abiding by the following articles : —

1. From henceforth there should be peace and friendship between the subjects of Her Majesty the Queen, and those under her protection, and the AlAfin of Oyo and King of Yorubaland and his people, and all other peoples over whom he has authority and influence.

2. The subjects of the Queen may always trade freely with the people of Oyo, and the Yoruba-speaking countries in every article they may wish to buy and sell, in all towns, rivers, creeks, waters, markets and places within territories known as Yoruba : and I, Adeyemi, pledge myself to show no favour and to give no privilege to the traders or people of other countries which I do not give or show to those of the Queen.

3. British subjects and others under the Queen's protection

are to have the first consideration in all trade transactions with my peoples.

4. No tolls, duties, fees, imposts, or charges shall be charged or levied upon the person or property of any British subject or other person under Her Majesty's protection other than and beyond that or those which are customary and reasonable, or may from time to time be agreed upon to be so levied or charged by the Governor of Lagos and myself.

5. I will not allow any disputes that may arise between people frequenting or visiting the markets in my territory to interfere with or stop the markets ; and all differences or disputes that may arise other than trade disputes between my peoples and those of other nations and tribes visiting the markets shall be adjusted by me or referred for adjustment and settlement to the decision of an arbitrator appointed by the Governor of Lagos, and the decision and award of such arbitrator shall be finally conclusive.

6. I engage as far as in me lies to bring about new markets between the Oyos and the other Yoruba-speaking peoples, to promote the enlargement of existing ones, and to keep open all the roads through my kingdom to the Niger, and towards the coast.

7. It is hereby further agreed that no cession of territory and no other Treaty or Agreement shall be made by me other than the one I have now made without the full understanding and consent of the Governor for the time being of the said Colony of Lagos.

8. In consideration of the faithful observance of the foregoing Articles of the Agreement the Government of Lagos will make unto me a yearly dash to the. value of 200 (two hundred) bags of cowries, but such dash may upon breach or neglect of all or any one or more of the provisions of the Agreement and at the discretion of the Governor of the Colony of Lagos be altogether withdrawn or suspended.

9. Provided always that the terms of this Agreement be subject to the approval of Her Majesty.

Signed and sealed at Oyo this 23rd day of July, 1888.

Adeyemi, AlAfin of Oyo x (his mark).

In the presence of

Samuel Johnson, Clerk in Holy Orders. William Moseri, Scripture Reader.

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Ratification of the above Treaty.

June i6th, 1890. No. 255/142.

King, — I have the pleasure of informing you that Her Majesty the Queen of England has been graciously pleased to ratify and confirm the Treaty between yourself and Her Majesty which you signed on the 23rd July, 1888, and which subject to Her Majesty's approval I subsequently signed on Her Majesty's behalf.

2. I am glad to think that the Treaty will tend to draw the people of this Colony and your subjects closer together. Both belong to the Yoruba race, and it is but natural that there should be peace, friendship and commerce between them.

3. It will be my duty in future under the Treaty to continue to pay to you as opportunities offer an annual present of 200 bags of cowries, subject always to the performance by you of your own obligations under the Treaty.

4. I forward to you £^1 5s. in cash which represents what will become due to you by the 23rd prox.

5. I write to you in the full hope and expectation that you will not only remember, but faithfully and zealously fulfil all your engagements under the Treaty, and especially those relating to the increasing of the markets and the opening of new roads.

I am, King,

Your friend,

Alfred Moloney, Governor and Commander-in-Chief of the Colony of Lagos.

§4. The Exploits of Esan and the Controversy thereupon.

In the year 1888 negotiation was set on foot through the instrumentality of the Oluiwo, one of the oldest and most venerable of the provincial kings in the Epo division, who was very much anxious for the restoration of peace in the country.

He prevailed upon the AlAfin to appoint a messenger to head those of the principal provincial kings of Yoruba forming a deputation to negotiate peace with Ilorin. The AlAfin did not object but his appointee was a private man and not an Ilari which augured ill for the embassy, and betrayed the actual feelings of His Majesty on the subject.

These messengers went by Ogbomosg. On reaching Obanifisunwa, the last tollgate to Ilorin, they were met by the

Emir of Ilorin's messenger who bade them halt there till further orders.

They were detained there for a week whilst private messages passed between Ilorin and the Ilorin camp.

Counting much upon the floating report of an august embassy like this, hundreds of traders went with them, seizing the opportunity of trading with Ilorin, owing to the distress which this protracted war had caused all over the country.

A few days after their arrival at Ilorin some mischievous persons in K^rcirk's camp went privately and kidnapped on the road between the camp and the city of Ilorin, and a report was manufactured and circulated, attributing this deed to the Ibadans while negotiation of peace was going on ! This so exasperated the Emir of Ilorin that when he was returning from the mosque on the Friday he rode direct to the Dongari's house where these messengers were lodged and ordered them to leave the town before sunset ! The truth, however, was soon found out, and the order was countermanded.

The negotiation however proved a failure as was anticipated, and when the messengers were returning home they were detained at Obaniiisunwa for three daj'S until the Emir sent an escort of horsemen to conduct them to the Ogbomoso farms, it having been known that a party of kidnappers from Karkrk's camp lay in wait for them.

The Ibadans it need hardly be said, were exceedingly annoyed, by these repeated disappointments. It had become evident now to all fair-minded persons that the protraction of this war was due entirely to the AlAfin and the Ilorins, the Ibadans therefore were resolved to renew hostilities with Ilorin in right earnest.

It may here be remarked that at this time traders from all parts of the country were finding their way to Ilorin, and the Ogbomoso route was utihzed to a large extent. This the Ibadans knew and hitherto connived at, but now they took measures to stop it at once. Another trade route was via Iseyin, Papa, Saki, Igboho and Igbeti to Ilorin and from Iseyin on the other side to Abeokuta. Practically therefore peaceful intercourse was going on in one part of the country, whilst war was going on in another, and it was known to the Ibadans that the Ilorins were importing rifles by this route to fight them at Ofa ; they weie therefore resolved to put a stop to this also. For this purpose they utihzed the services of one Esan, an expert in organizing kidnapping expeditions, and sent him to the Oke Ogun districts with a free hand against Ilorin traders. Twice did Esan kidnap caravans along this route ; several Egba traders were kidnapped, and they

suffered an immense loss of their merchandise. This exasperated the Egbas and they complained of it both to the AlAfin of Oyo and to the Governor of Lagos whilst at the same time they themselves kidnapped in the Ibadan farms, as well as the caravans to Ijebu.

The letter to the AlAfin on the subject :

Iporo Abeokuta,

February Sth, 1889. His Majesty Adeyemi, King of Oyo. Your Majesty,

We, the undersigned and authorities of Abeokuta, have the opportunity of writing to you on a subject we have lately heard from your territories. We learnt that the Ibadan people came to stop or blockade the peaceable traffic road at the town Lanlate, which was freely opened to all free traders, even from interior to Lagos, by catching the Ilorin and Egba peaceful traders. They even proceeded their attempts to Eruwa close to our country simply on account of the war they are still fighting. We beg to request and show you that if this bad practice is just and right ? for we know certainly that it will soon create an uneasiness betwixt us and the neighbouring tribes which will cause a great war. Kindly try and put a stop to this bad practice at once, for the road to Ilorin was freely opened for the Egbas,' Oyos, florins, Baribas, and all these peaceable traders, and even the Ibadan people themselves are trading all along our surrounding countries, even to

our countries. We beg you to drive out from your neighbouring countries these rascals, and vagabonds riot Ibadan people.

We await your favourable reply to the succession of our request. Wishing you health and prosperity. We are your true friends,

Onlado X (their marks)

Jaguna X

Ogundeyi X

Ali Balogun X

The following is a copy of the reply to the above letter from the AlAfin.

The Palace, Oyo,

February igth, i88g. To the Onlado, Jaguna, Ogundeyi and Ali Balogun. My Good Friends,

I have the pleasure to convey that I have received your kind letter of the 4th inst. and have perused its contents with

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the diligence it requires and I beg to return my sincere thanks to you for the honour and good faith conferred on me by referring the matter of the raid committed in my territory to me.

I beg to express my regret for the action done by the Ibadan ruffians, and you are worthy of thanks for making this known to me, and I shall take a prompt and decisive step in redressing this evil. I will lose no time in sending to my subjects about the matter. It is well that the peace of the country be preserved that trade should flourish and war to cease, and all my efforts will be to this end. Will you bear with me until matters are rectified ?

I have the honour to remain, Your true friend,

Adeyemi X (his mark)

King of Yoruba.

The following letter from the Acting- Governor of Lagos, G. C. Denton, to the Ibadan chiefs on the same subject.

October gth, 1889. No. 310/167.

Gentlemen, — In connection with my letter No. 273/145 of the 30th August last, to which I have as yet received no reply, I have the honour to inform you that in a communication which I have received from the Abeokuta authorities, it is alleged that some four months ago the Ibadan soldiers attacked and plundered by night caravans of traders belonging to Abeokuta, and amongst the people killed were Egbas, Ilgrins, Hausas and Baribas. Horses, cattle, asses, kola nuts and cotton goods were carried off by your countrymen, and a number of people were captured. Some of the persons seized and a portion of the plunder were sent to you, to the AlAfin of Oyo and to the Aseyin, the remainder you conveyed to your camp at Ikirun.

2. On hearing of this raid on your part the Egbas at once sent messengers to the AlAfin and the Aseyin to enquire into the truth of the report which had reached them. They discovered the rumour to be well-founded and they therefore recalled their people and the caravans pending the adjustment of the disturbances.

3. Again a few weeks after the occurrence to which I refer it is stated by the Egbas that yoa suddenly descended on their farms and plundered them.

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The Egbas admit that in revenge for what you had done to them they after this attacked the Ibadan farms.

4. It is further alleged that you carried your depredations into the Ijebu country and plundered some farms at Ipara.

5. I am very reluctant to beheve that the acts with which you are charged have been committed by you ; but in the face of the statement which I now convey to you it is hard for me to exonerate you from blame.

6. When I ren:iember too the part which you took in the Treaty of 23rd September, 1886, and the protestation ot the desire for peace which have been made by your messengers in my presence, I am at a loss to understand your action, unless there be some explanation for it, which I am not in possession of and it is to give you an opportunity of exculpating yourselves from blame in this matter that I now address this letter to you.

7. In the letter to which I refer in the first part of this communication, I endeavoured to remind you of the sad and bitter disasters which attend on war, and to impress on you that the prosperity of your country is best served by your peaceful intercourse with your neighbours.

Let me again put this before you and with the assurance of my goodwill, and of the great interest which I take in the affairs of Yoruba-land. Allow me to be. Your good friend,

G. C. Denton, Acting-Governor.

The reply of the Ibadans to the above letter.

Ikirun, November 20th, 1889.

To His Excellency, Capt. G. C. Denton. Your Excellency,

We hereby acknowledge the receipt of your kind letter which is a sort of supplement to that of the 30th August. It got to our hands yesterday and it has received our due consideration.

2. We thank Your Excellency for requiring a clear statement from us after the receipt of the communication from the Egbas. We trust that ere this reaches you oar reply to Your Excellency's former letter will have got into your hands, wherein you will find but a part of the reply to their charges.

3. It was true we kidnapped the caravans to and from Ilgrin but allow us to say that they were no Egba traders but Hausas

and Ilorin people, and we are glad Your Excellency has given us an opportunity of explaining ourselves.

4. Your Excellency knew very well that the difference between us and the Egbas and the Ilorins has not yet been adjusted and yet the road has been opened through our territory, and that we have long permitted this undisturbed. It was for the interest of trade with a view to the final settlement of the war that we have permitted this. But when we found that it will eventually end in our ruin we put a stop to it.

5. Since the late Ijaye war of i860 the Egbas would not allow any ammunition to pass from their town to us, but those socalled traders were returning with Sneiders and cartridges from Abeokuta to strengthen the hands of. the Ilorins against us, and having a timely intimation of it we took steps to prevent the ruin of our country, and could we be blamed for preventing our own ruin especially when the ammunitions are to pass through our own territory ?

Egba traders were at Iseyin, Oyq and in all our Oke Ogun towns and they are not wanting till to-day. Did we touch any of them ? If the traders we kidnapped had not traded in ammunition we would not have troubled them.

6. From our last letter Your Excellency will find that it was the Egbas who were the aggressors, having first kidnapped on the Ipara and Oru roads and have committed raids in our farms before we retaliated. We had ceased escorting caravans to Ijebu but we were obhged to do so since they were kidnapping on the roads. This was even before the Oke Ogun affair,

7. Why should the Egbas complain of our raids in the Ijebu farms ? They should let the Ijebus complain themselves. The fact of the case is this — The Ijebus and the Egbas were not on terms and the Egbas have succeeded in stopping the trade between Ipara and Ibadan by kidnapping and blockading that road. In retahation the Ijebu Remg at Ipara have obtained re-inforcement in the idle ones at home to harass them in their farms, and why should they saddle this on us here at Ikirun ?

Your Excellency must take our word. We beg to affirm once more that if the Egbas cease kidnappping in our farms and the Ijebu roads we will not kidnap in their farms. Your Excellency must not doubt our sincerity in whatever we say, and if anything happens to the contrary it must have a reason and we are ready to explain ourselves.

8. It is our wish to be sending our messengers down frequently to keep the Governor well-informed of all the incidents which may be occurring here, but we beg to say we have not the oppor-

tunity of a free communication with Lagos. We say this in confidence to the Governor as we do not mean to complain of the Ijebus who have done so much for us. If this get to their hearing they will take it as a complaint against them and we shall smart for it. Hence we say this is private and in confidence. We had to buy the road as it were before our messenger went down also even this we do not mind.

But they are still never pleased and they must know why we send down. We beg to suggest to the Governor that whenever the Governor wishes to see our messenger to let the Awujale know of it, as we are ready to send at any time. Wishing Your Excellency good health.

Your good friends their marks,

AjAYi, Balogun of Ibadan X

OsuNTOKi, Maye of Ibadan X FijABi, Abese of Ibadan X

Fajinmi, Agbakin of Ibadan X

In consequence of the remonstrance of the Egba chiefs, the Iseyin chiefs, with the exception of the Aseyin himself, were against further raids being committed at least within their territory, but they could not prevent it.

Towards the end of June, 1889, hearing of caravans going again to Ilorin, Esan came and met them at Iseyin. It was generally believed that he was invited by Lawore the Aseyin, but the chiefs insisted that Esan shall not capture these Hausa and Egba traders in their town of Iseyin. Esan with his small body of troops therefore left the town and encamped at a place called Boiboi over against Iseyin spoiling their farms. The AlAfin hearing this sent kegs of powder and bowls of bullets to Esan, not because he favoured Esan's raids, but because he felt that the Asejrin's authority should be upheld against his chiefs.

The Iseyin people dared not attack Esan, because that would amount to attacking an Ibadan army, and consequently there was nothing to be done but to have a conference on the subject. Esan would not agree to any terms but the expulsion of the Hausa traders from the town. This was done on the 29th of June, 1889.

Esan hearing of this expulsion, gave chase and overtook them at the brook Odo Onko and plundered them, carrying away much booty.

This was the last of Esan's successful exploits, for early in the following year he led an expedition to the Sabe country, and besieged Danikan, their chief town. Here he was attacked by the Sabes in overwhelming numbers, and hemmed in on every side,

his little band of troops was dispersed, and he was taken ahve and slain.

The late Esan was a native of Modakeke ; he came suddenly into notice in the years 1887 to 1889. He was a first-rate swordsman, and specially skilful in the use of the cutlass called Oya. He led several kidnapping expeditions to the Egba farms, attacked and defeated several Egba kidnapping expeditions to the Ibadan

farms. We have noticed above his exploits in the Oke Ogun districts, three times in succession did he attack and plunder Ilorin, Hausa and Egba traders. He now lost his Uf e in attempting with a handful of men to take Danikan in the Sabe country on the 5th of February, 1890.

Chapter XXXII

ABORTIVE MEASURES TO TERMINATE THE WAR

§ I. The Mission of Alvan Millson

We have seen that by the terms of the Kiriji Treaty, the AlAfin was made responsible for the settlement of the Ibadan-Ilorin war, and that Chief Ogedemgbe failed in 1886 to induce the Commissioners to send messengers to the Ilorin camp, because they were not commissioned thither.

The AlAfin however was suspected of duplicity by his people, for several of his private messengers to Karark had been caught, and instead of making a move, he had to be moved by the Awujale of Ijebu, and the Oluiwo of Iwo to undertake measures towards the restoration of peace. Whenever he was as it were forced to send a peace embassy to Ilorin, he would send a private man for that purpose instead of an Ilari ; if pressed for an Ilari, he sent Oba-ko-se-tan ! Showing he was not ready. It became evident that although he wanted peace in the abstract, yet he wished to keep the Ibadans fully engaged at a distance from home.

The Governor received several communications from the interior kings and chiefs, notably the Oluiwo of Iwo, praying His Excellency to bring to a finish the good work commenced in 1886, by sending up again special Commissioners for the purpose, as it has proved to be that the seat of war had but changed from Kiriji-Mesin to Yanayo-Ikirun.

Unfortunately His Excellency did not consider the matter of so much importance as to send up a strong embassy direct to Oyo and Ilorin. He sent a single European officer, Mr. Alvan Millson, the Asst. Col. Secretary, and a native officer, Mr. F. Colley-Green, a subintendant of police with instructions to gather representatives from both the Ilorin and Ibadan camps for a " palaver " and to endeavour to mediate between them and get them to decamp and return to their homes !

The Commissioners left Lagos on the 14th January, 1890, arrived at Ijebu Ode on the 15th, left on the 17th and arrived at Ibadan on the 19th. Leaving Ibadan on the 24th, they arrived at Oyo on the 25th. They had an interview with the AlAfin on the 26th when His Majesty was informed of the object of their mission.

Obtaining two messengers from him they left Oyo on the 29th

January and arrived at Ikirun on the 3rd February. It must be remarked that the messengers sent by the Alafin for this important business were both private men, and no Ilari, which is very significant.

The interview between the Commissioners and the authorities of Ibadan took place on the 4th of February, the Commissioners dehvered to them the compHments of His Excellency the Governor, and their message and instructions were to this effect : —

That the authorities of Ibadan should assist or second the Governor's effort in obtaining a permanent peace in the Yoruba country. In order to do this they should facihtate their proceeding to Ilorin for an interview with the Emir, and negotiate with him terms of peace and the withdrawal of his troops under his Commander-in-Chief K^rara, now at Of a. They were also to gather representative people from both powers for a " palaver " and to disperse both camps.

This seemed to the war chiefs like trifling with the affair, as if a fierce race of warriors like the Ilgrins bent on conquest could be induced to leave their camps on such conditions !

The Commissioners found it impracticable to proceed either to the Ilorin camp or to Ilorin ; the direct route was the scene of the conflict. Not only so, but the Commissioners also witnessed two attacks on Ikirun by the Ilorin army from Ofa, and were convinced of the risk of venturing to the Ilorin camp with an escort of only eight Hausa soldiers ! The Ibadan chiefs would not even allow it.

The Commissioners were resolved to try the Ijesa route. The way to Mesin Ipole by the old Kiriji route had been closed when the Ijesas kidnapped about 150 Oyo traders, who, taking advantage of the peace now existing between them after the breaking up of the Kiriji-Mesin camps were utihsing that way for trade with the Ekiti countries.^ This serious breach of the Treaty by the Ijesas excited no comment at Lagos at the time, because it was not followed by a retaliation : the Ibadans simply protested against such actions, and closed the road.

The Commissioners were resolved to try the Ilesa route via Osogbo and Oke Bode. At the latter place armed men barred the way, preventing further progress. For three hours they were under the blazing mid-day sun, after which better counsel pre-

^The Commissioner had occasion afterwards to question Ogedemgbe about this action. He confirmed the report but justified himself by saying that they were considerate enough to sell the parties to Modakeke so that their friends might have the chance of ransoming them. But why do it at all ? He replied — Because the Ibadans remained still at Ikirun.

vailed, and they were allowed to go under shelter but not to proceed an inch further on their journey ; in the meantime they were communicating with the authorities at headquarters. The Commissioners had to write to the Owa and the Seriki of their detention, and the reply they received was from one G. W. Johnson, a bookbinder of Lagos, acting as secretary and writing in the name of the Kings of the Ekiti parapos. …" Who are you ? We do not know you ; are you a Missionary ? Why do you trespass on Ijesa soil without first notif3ang the i6 kings of the Ekitiparapos ? " The Commissioneis wrote back to say who they were and requested permission to visit the Owa. The reply came that the Oke Bode people should allow them to proceed ; this they did, but refused to supply them with a guide ; they had to write again to the Owa for a guide which they obtained before they could proceed, after full ten days' detention. The Owa and Ogedemgbe subsequently apologised to them for this action of the Oke Bode people.

They spent three days at Ilesa before proceeding to Esa Egure where they met with the Owa of the Ijesas, and spent four days with him, discussing with him the object of their mission.

At Mesin Ipole they interviewed the Seriki and the three principal Ekiti kings : but Ogedemgbe the Seriki objected to their going to Ilorin by way of Mesin. " No road," said he, " the path is full of ditches." On Mr. Millson persisting and offering to go with only his cook if possible he told him plainly he could not be allowed to go as it would involve the loss of their lives. He even dechned to take a letter from him to Kkrkrk the Ilorin Generahssimo, telUng him that it would get him in hot water with the Ilorins as was the case when the former Commissioners came in 1886 to disperse the camps at Kiriji.

The Commissioners had to go back to Ikirun by the way they came, and told the Ibadan chiefs of the failiue of their mission.

Thus ended in failure this ill-conceived, unstatesmanlike mission which sought to intervene between two fierce armies in a conflict that had lasted 14 years by means which could scarcely have separated two excited parties in a village riot.

§ 2. Subsidiary Efforts of the Rev. S. Johnson Whilst the above episode was being enacted, the writer who was then at Lagos was invited to an interview with the Governor. His Excellency wishing him to join the above mission, obtained permission from the local C.M.S. Secretary to send him up. He was to be the bearer of letters to the Awujale, the AlAfin, the Aseyin and to receive accredited messengers from the first two as well as

from the Oluiwo of Iwo and the Bale of Ogbomgso, and with these, as representatives of their masters join the Commissioners at Ikirun for a conference which was to put an end to the war ! The writer was also to render assistance to the Commissioners as he did in 1886.

Whilst the Governor was interesting himself in the affairs of the interior, and doing his best to restore peace to the country, some ill-informed persons at Lagos, under the plea of patriotism, were trying to undermine

his efforts. After the Commissioners had gone up, private messages were sent to the Awujale of Ijebu that they should not let the white man terminate this war for them, lest they rob them of their country, deprive them of their wives, give freedom to their slaves, and that eventually they would be reduced to the condition of having to hoe their own farms for themselves, and to perform other menial work.

This was speedily communicated to all the kings and chiefs of the interior. The Ijebu authorities went one step further, resolving not to allow any Lagos trader or any foreigner to pass through their country to the interior and vice versa. The law was so stringently enforced that the writer, although so well known at Ijebu during the peace negotiations of 1886, found it hard to proceed up country ; he had to leave his luggage at the port Ito Ike and to enter Ijebu Ode in the night to obtain permission from the king to pass through his country. His being also the bearer of a letter from the Governor of Lagos to the Awujale emboldened him to proceed to that capital.

Even the Awujde himself was careful not to infringe the law. He refused to see the writer when he was announced to him ; he sent word to say that whatever message he brought for him from the Governor, should be deHvered to the Balogun Ngf owgkan who would dehver the same to him. It was in the dead of night at last, that the Awujale arranged for a private interview with the writer, and that was owing to the influence of the Balogun. He was very careful to have this nocturnal visit in order that he might not offend the Ijebus, although personally he did not approve of these measures.

The writer was detained at Ijebu Ode for another day. At the suggestion of the Balogun, with the approval of the Awujale, all the Ijebu authorities were summoned together to hear the Governor's message from the mouth of the messenger himself. After hearing the letter read, and after consultation with one another, their spokesman came forward and said : " We have already sent our messengers to the interior for peace negotiations with Ilgrin, the King his Agurin, the Osugbos, the Lamurins, and

the Ipampas their messengers, they are probably now at Ibadan, and we are decided not to send up fresh messengers ; those already sent, the Governor's messenger will meet there, and they will go with him together with the messengers of the Ase5dn and of Oluiwo to the AlAfin who will appoint his messenger with them to meet the Commissioner.

The Awujale, as one interested in the peace of the country, moreover told the writer in confidence that he had been in communication with the Alafin, and that His Majesty complained bitterly of the Ibadans, but he had begged him to overlook his grievances at present in the interest of peace to the country at large, and after this he would exert his influence with the Ibadans, and that His Majesty would find in the end that the Ibadans would be more loyal to him.

But, as the sequel will show, it was evident that the insinuations of the so-called patriots of Lagos had poisoned the minds not only of the Awujale, but of all the interior kings and chiefs also, and the Governor's messenger was duped throughout whereever he went.

Arriving at Ibadan on the 21st March, he lost no time in looking up the Ijebu messengers, and informed them of the resolution arrived at by the Awujale in council, and asked when they would be ready to proceed to Oyo. They excused themselves by saying that they had a special message for the war chiefs at Ikirun from home, and that they were expecting the answer on Monday, the 24th, after which they would be ready to proceed ; if the 26th suited him they might start together on that date. To this he readily consented.

On the 25th the Governor's messenger sent to ascertain from these Ijebus whether they would be ready to start on the morrow accoiding to arrangement: they told his messenger he should wait for them at the town gate early in the morning, and there they would join him. But this they never meant to do. The Governor's messenger waited for hours at the gate, but thej' never turned up. He had to proceed alone.

These Ijebu messengers subsequently arrived at Oyo after the Governor's messenger had proceeded to Iseyin on his errand ; it was after his return from Iseyin that he learnt indirectly from them, that they had not the intention of going with him to join the Commissioner, that was not part of their instructions from home, they were instructed to remain at Oyo and from thence conduct all negotiations with the messengers from

the important chiefs of every part of the country, and never to return home until the war should end. The Governor's messenger had no alternative

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but to leave them, but before going away he suggested to them that they should send a special messenger home to ascertain whether the information he conveyed to them from the Awujale in council was true or not, promising to call again to hear the result.

The Governor's messenger proceeded to Ogbomoso on his errand on the 5th April, 1890. The authorities of Ogbomoso felt flattered that they should have been so recognized by the Governor as to be required to take part in the peace negotiations ; they readily sent two messengers, one from the Bale the other from the Ompetu on Easter Tuesday, April 8th, 1890. These repaired to Oyo with the Governor's messenger.

The Ijebu messengers were again interviewed to learn whether they had heard from home. The Governor's messenger was taken aback to hear them giving vent to their pent-up feelings in these words :

" Why should the Governor of Lagos request the Ijebu king to send messengers along with his own ? A year ago did not the Awujale send to the Governor to soUcit his aid to bring to a successful issue the good work the Enghsh Government had so kindly begun, and was not the Acting Governor indignant at the Ibadans, calling them thieves and robbers., and asking why they remained still at Ikirun, and whether that was their home ? And were not the Ilorins in their farms ? ' Leave me alone,' said he, " I will only interest myself in the affairs of the Colony. Let the Awujale and the AlAfin, who are rulers in the interior, settle their interior difficulties themselves."

" Hereupon " — the' continued — " the Awujale at the instance, of the Oluiwo, sent an embassy through Iwo to Oyg to negotiate peace. Although the AlAfin was prevailed upon to send his messenger, yet he felt the proceedings irregular and his dignity affronted, hence everything promised failure at the start. The messengers had to wait nine days at Ogbomoso before proceeding to Ilgrin, and the result proved a failure. Profiting by past experience, we are now instructed to come straight to the AlAfin, and to act according to his orders, to go backwards and forwards as he should direct. And why should the Governor now require our king to send delegates with his own after his locum tenens had told us to see after the interior difficulties ourselves ? "

This ended the efforts of the Governor's messenger with the Ijebus. It was plain now that he could not get them to go with

His Majesty the AlAfin was waited upon by the Governor's messenger on his arrival from Lagos, and he delivered the Governor's letter and message to him.

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The Governor's letter to the AlAfin.

No. 3/51, March i^th, 1890.

To THE AlAfin of Oyo.

King, — I have the pleasure of announcing to you my return in good health to my Government.

2. Since my departure to my country last year, many things have happened.some of which have caused me joy and others regret.

3. It is a source of gratification to me to reflect that my own colony remains prosperous.

4. Unfortunately the war between the Ilgrins and Ibadans continues, and the Ibadans are still at Ikirun.

5. Happily, however, both sides appear to be tired of hostilities^ and I hope that my Commissioner, who is charged with mediating between them, will induce them to make a lasting peace.

6. You have seen my Commissioner, and been courteous and hospitable towards him. I thank you, and I remember that my Commissioners who made a settlement between the Ibadans and the Ekitiparapos four years ago retain a pleasant recollection of their intercourse with you.

7. My Commissioner is about to proceed by way of Ikirun to Oke Mesin or some more northerly or easterly spot where the final negotiations can most conveniently take place.

8. I think it due to Yoruba-land and desirable that he be accompanied thither, or joined there by accredited representatives of the parties principally interested in the restoration of peace ; and I therefore invite you to send with him or after him messengers who will possess your mind and who will have fuU authority to enter into engagements on behalf of yourself and your people.

9. My sorrow and astonishment were not small when I heard that the Ibadans had stopped the trade route which leads through your pro\dnce of Iseyin.

10. The prosperity of Yoruba-land which I have at heart depends largely as it seems to me upon its trade routes being kept open ; and I shall be glad to consider any suggestions or proposals that you may be prepared to make, with a view to the opening and keeping open of the trade routes of all Yoruba, or at any rate of as many of them as possible.

I am. King, Your true friend,

Alfred Moloney, Governor and Commander-in-Chief of the Colony of Lagos.

ˆ Here the governor was mistaken. The Ilorins were not. — Ed.

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§ 3. The AlAfin's Diplomacy

The above letter being read and interpreted to the King, he expressed his willingness to second the Governor's proposals.

On hearing afterwards what the Ijebu messengers said, he was not surprised, but simply said, " I fully expected they would act thus, but being most concerned in the matter, I shall appoint my own delegates. But the Aseyin's messenger should not be left out, the Ase5rin being equally interested in the matter." The Governor's messenger replied that although his instructions did not include the Aseyin, he did not think that the Governor would have any objection if the AlAfin saw fit to include a messenger from the Aseyin. Who could have doubted His Majesty's sincerity in such a reply ? But the sequel shows that he was a past master in diplomacy : he resented the Governor's treating with his subordinate chiefs as on an equality with himself and was determined to show it.

He actually appointed his Oba-ko-setan to go with the Governor's messenger, and sent to the Basorun to appoint another to accompany his own : but as the Governor's messenger was on the point of starting (Friday, nth April) he told him that Friday was an inauspicious day when they should never send messages abroad, but that the messengers would join him the next day at Iwo.

The Oluiwo appointed his own man on the Saturday against the arrival of the AlAfin's messenger who was to bring with him those from Ogbomgso and Ise5an. But they waited in vain ! On the evening of Sunday the 13th a private messenger came from the AlAfin to the Oluiwo and the Governor's messenger to say that since the departure of the latter from Oyo he had been informed that the Ibadans had sent an expedition to Hero, and as a goodly number of Oyo princes and princesses reside there, and the Ibadans were going to enslave them, he must wait to redeem them all, before he thought of helping them ! This of course was a made-up story purely invented as an excuse for not sending anyone ; moreover, the Ogbomgso messengers he sent back home.

The disappointment of the Governor's messenger can well be imagined. He had to return at once at his call, but to tell the AlAfin that if he could not carry out that part of his instructions, hfe must at all events proceed to meet the Commissioners. He returned for this purpose the next day via Iwo again, and met the Commissioners at Ede on their return journey after the failure of their mission. Together with them he returned to Oyo.

A few days after the happening of the above events, the writer in conversation with a highly respectable Oyo gentleman, complained bitterly of the disappointments and rebuffs he lately met

with, not only from the Ijebus but also by the action of the AlAfin, to which also the action of the I j ebus could be traced. The AlAfin was always fair, courteous, and pohte, but no reliance could be placed upon his words. The writer recalled the incident of the messengers, how he would send private gentlemen instead of an Ilari on important state business when he knew the matter would thereby end in failure, etc. The following dialogue which passed between them will show the Oyo official view of the matter. To the messenger's complaints the citizen replied : —

at. : Ah yes, but see what treatment the Governor has offered our Master !

Mess. : What treatment ?

Cit. : Suppose the Queen of the Geh^si (the English) is at war with the King of the Aguda (the Portugese) and the King of Franse (the French) offered to mediate between them, and suppose he sent his messenger to the Queen, and to the Bales (Mayors) of those great Enghsh towns we have heard of such as the ship-building town (Liverpool) the cloth-weaving town (Manchester), and the town where iron goods come from (Birmingham), asking them to send their own messengers with that of the Queen for a conference, putting them as it were on an equality with the Queen, how would she like it ? Although a woman I believe she would resent it. Yet that is precisely what the Governor has done, sending to the Bale of Ogbomgso, and the Oluiwo to send their messengers along with that of the AlAfin with you to meet the Commissioner for a conference !

Mess. : Did not the AlAfin himself suggest the Aseyin, how could it have displeased him when he himself suggested a messenger from the Aseyin ?

Cit. (laughing he said) : But can't you see that that is ironical ? Did you not come with a letter from the Governor to the Aseyin ? And yet in the matter of delegates you left him out. The AlAfin simply meant to point out to you your inconsistency in leaving him out, for he is higher in rank than either the Bale of Ogbomgso or the Oluiwo. But don't you see that no messenger from any of them joined you after all ?

Mess. : Well, if we made a mistake we are quite willing to be corrected but why did he not tell us so ? Why adopt measures which will serve to wreck the whole scheme ?

Cit. : That is not Oyo etiquette. You know it is never considered pohte with Yorubas to tell one to whom respect is due that he is wrong in his methods, but when he meets with failure then he will reconsider his methods. It is not for the AlAfin

bluntly to correct the Governor, but when he fails in his movements then he must know that his measures were wrong.

Mess. : But the Governor cannot be expected to know these tortuous Yoruba methods, the EngUshman prefers straight dealing.

at. : But he ought at any rate to know what is due to a Sovereign or he would not have been selected to represent one. You are just looking at the matter from the standpoint of the Governor's messenger that you are, but the AlAfin must consider how your message affects him with his chiefs.

Before the Commissioners left Ikirun, they got the Ibadans to sign a declaration that they would in future be more loyal to the AlAfin and that the Governor in consultation with the AlAfin should delimit the boundaries of the territories immediately under them and that any such dehmitation which has the AlAfin's signature they would accept.

On the Commissioners reaching Oyo they induced the AlAfin to agree to this proposal, and further that His Majesty should pledge himself and subjects not to disturb the peace of the country ; should any disturbance arise, before any hostile action is resorted to, that he would communicate at once with the Governor as to what measures would be taken and how the offender would be dealt with. The Commissioners scarcely saw that in this they were asking the AlAfin to surrender his sovereign rights to the Governor. This latter

declaration was to be signed also by the Oluiwo, the Timi of Ede, the Bale of Ogbomoso and the Aseyin of Iseyin.

On the loth of May the writer accompanied by Oba-ko-se-tan, started with a copy of this declaration. The Oluiwo signed it on the same day, the Ibadan chiefs at Ikirun signed it on the i6th, the Timi of Ede's signature the Ibadan chiefs thought was not necessary, being a subordinate chief to Ibadan, and what the Balogun of Ibadan signed was enough for him ; but that the Bale of Ogbomoso may. For this purpose, and to expedite matters, they sent a messenger along with the Governor's messenger to assure him of their conclusions.

But the Bale of Ogbomoso in consultation with his chiefs refused to sign the paper although they agreed with everything it contained. No argument could shake them from their determination. "What His Majesty the AlAfin signed," said they, " as well as the Ibadan chiefs, was good enough for us, we are their subjects." This was no doubt due to the rebuff they met with at Oyo when sending their messenger to go with the Governor's.

The Aseyin, amidst the excitement of the Dahomian invasion, signed the declaration on the 2nd of June, 1890.

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§ 4. Correspondence and a Treaty

The following letter was sent to the AlAfin with a copy of a Treaty by Taniafisara, the AlAfin's messenger, who returned to Lagos with Mr, Alvan Millson, M.A. : —

May igth, 1890. No. 214/115.

Sir, — On the 13th March last I had the honour to inform you of my return, and I express my sorrow and astonishment to find that the Ibadans had stopped the trade route through Iseyin.

2. I now hasten to thank you for sending me your messenger Taniafisara. He was accompanied by representatives of the Balogun of Ibadan, of the Abese of Ibadan, and the Oluiwo of Iwo.

3. It pained me much, I must admit, to find closed on my return one of the commercial roads to the interior viz., by Eruwa, by which this Colony, the Egbas and Yorubas are benefited ; and another to Remg, Ipara-Ibadan route rendered insecure from raids. Here you have an example of cause and effect ; because Eruwa road was plundered, the Ipara route was raided.

4. The Ibadan action was a breach by them unwillingly, perhaps, of the provisions, of the Treaty of peace, friendship and commerce existing between this colony and your kingdom ; further, it was an unfriendly act towards this Government which has done so much for them and the country.

5. I must disapprove of the Ibadan raids upon the Abeokuta, Eruwa, Iseyin road, and as I feel bound to hold the Ibadans responsible for the cessation of communication between Abeokuta and Iseyin I must look to the Ibadans to effect promptly by negotiation the opening of the Abeokuta-Iseyin road and also the opening up of the Abeokuta-Ibadan road which has been closed since 1877.

6. Draft of a Treaty in furtherance of the object I enclose. A copy has been furnished to the Ibadans and to the Egbas. The Ijebus will also be supplied.

7. Such closures and raids cannot be viewed with unconcern, and from such hindrances to trade, there can only result a block to the general prosperity of the country and universal discontent.

8. At an interview I have had with your representative and those of the Ijebus and Egbas, I have advised mutual forbearance and compromise and the substitution instead of the jealous suspicion and hatred of the past, of healthy and friendly emulation and intercourse.

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9. The importance of completing the Treaty now forwarded and the necessity for promptitude should be manifest to you, and I venture to urge that you open up communication without delay with Iseyin, Ogbomgsg, Iwo, Ibadan, and Abeokuta. The Egbas have been similarly advised.

10. To help you to bring about a bettej understanding and to secure with all the despatch I can recommend for an end so generally desired, I have taken the liberty to send you the draft Treaty which practically embodies in a formal shape all the Yorubas, Egbas, and Ijebus professed they desire.

11. In any further way I can help j^'ou pray let me know. My advice and assistance in promoting your interests and those of the country generally are at your service,

12. It remains for me to convey to you my sincere thanks for your courteous and hospitable treatment of Mr. Millson during his stay in your kingdom.

13. This letter and those addressed to the Balogun and authorities of Ibadan to the Oluiwo of Iwo and to the As§yin are entrusted to the Egba messengers who have kindly undertaken their dehvery.

14. I wish you and your people every good wish, and an early restoration of friendly intercourse between Yorubas and Egbas.

I am, sir, your good friend,

Alfred Moloney, Governor and Commander-in-Chief .

Draft copy of the Treaty accompanying the above letter. Treaty of Peace, Friendship and Commerce between the Egbas, the Ibadans, and the Ijebus.

Whereas the relations of the Egbas, the Ibadans, and the Ijebus have in the past been frequently disturbed by misunderstandings which have only too often resulted in raids upon one another's territory and other hostile acts.

And whereas the said peoples are desirous of living for the future in peace and amity with each other

Now therefore we, the undersigned authorities of the said peoples, having power to bind our respective peoples solemnly and sincerely promise each other and declare as follows : —

1. The Egbas, the Ibadans, and the Ijebus (hereinafter called the signatories) shall henceforth wholly desist from making raids each upon the territory of either of the others.

2. The signatories will respectively within three months from these presents coming into force restore to each other or make

compensation for or in respect of all captives whom they may respectively have made during any such raid as aforesaid, within the two years immediately preceding the first day of January, 1890.

3. There shall henceforth be peace, friendship and commerce between the signatories.

4. The signatories shall henceforth keep open their roads each to and for the benefit of the others.

5. In particular the Egbas shall keep open so far as in them lies the road from Abeokuta to Iseyin by way of Eruwa, and the Ibadans and the Ijebus shall so far as in them respectively lies keep open the road from Ibadan to Ikorodu by way of Ipara and Sagamu, and the road from Ibadan to Itg Ike by way of Oru and Ijebu Ode.

6. The last preceding article hereof shall in no way be construed as limiting the provisions of the fourth article hereof.

7. The Egbas and the Ibadans will forthwith open the direct road between Abeokuta and Ibadan which was closed in the year 1877.

8. The signatories will henceforth only levy and allow to be levied reasonable duties and tolls upon goods imported into or conveyed through their respective territories and will in no case levy or allow to be levied upon any such goods any duties and tolls amounting in the aggregate to more than double the duties and tolls to which similar goods shall be for the time being liable in the territory of either of the others of the signatories or to more than one-tenth of the value of the goods so imported or conveyed,

provided that none of the signatories shall be bound to their tariffs of duties and tolls more than once in every year.

9. These presents shall come into force when executed by the Ijebus.

ID. In case any question shall arise upon the construction of any of the provisions hereof or otherwise in relation hereto, or in connection herewith, such question may be referred by any of the signatories to the arbitrament of the Governor for the time being of Her Britannic Majesty's Colony of Lagos whose decision thereon shall be binding and conclusive upon all the signatories.

In witness thereof we have hereunto set our hands and seals on the days below set opposite to our respective names and titles.

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The following is from the Governor to the Ibadan authorities : —

Government House, Lagos. No. 217/115. ^ '9th. 1890.

Gentlemen, — My Commissioner to Ijebu, Yoruba, and Ekiti Mr. Millson, has returned to Lagos, and has informed me fully on the affairs of the interior. During his absence I collected important facts.

2. During his presence among you he conveyed that I have returned from England and how pained I was to find closed one of the commercial roads via Eruwa which connects this Colony with Yoruba-land and another the Remo-Ipara route raided, and confidence withdrawn therefrom in consequence.

3. I have looked carefully into the situation and find myself unable to approve of the Ibadan raids upon the Eruwa-Iseyin road of communication between Abeokuta and Iseyin. I must look to the Ibadans to effect promptly by negotiation the opening of that route as also now the opening of the Abeokuta-Ibadan road which has been closed since 1877.

4. In the difficulties that have arisen since I left the Colony you have an example of " cause and effect." First the owner of a house is responsible for its order. And whether Esan acted with or without your authority you are responsible : and further I find that the Ibadans, Iseyins, Oyos and Ogbomosos shared the unfortunate captives and plunder, and should now be ready to make good the losses they inflicted.

5. The action was a breach of the Treaty of peace, friendship and commerce existing between this colony and the Yoruba kingdom, and as it interrupted the trade, it was an unfriendly act towards this Government which has done so much for you and the country.

6. Such closures and raids cannot be viewed with unconcern, and from such hindrances to trade there can only result a block to the general prosperity of the country and universal discontent.

7. Again, Esan's outrageous conduct was openly defiant and hostile to Ilorin at the very time when in your interest and in those of Yoruba generally and on your representations Her Majesty's Government had allowed peace negotiations to be opened through Major Macdonald with that city. This is a very serious aspect of that affair.

8. At the interviews I have had v/ith your representatives and those of Ijebu and Egba, I have advised mutual forbearance and compromise and the substitution instead of the jealous suspicion and hatred of the past, of healthy emulation and intercourse.

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9. A copy of a Draft Treaty in furtherance of objects desired in paragraph 3 of this letter I append.

The Draft Treaty has been sent to the AlAfin of Oyo.

10. I have explained to the AlAfin the importance of completing this Treaty and the necessity for promptitude and I must look much to the Ibadans for the success of the undertaking.

11. I now turn to another act in the interior drama. Taking up the negotiations for peace between you and the Ilorins where they were left by Major Macdonald I have addressed a letter to the Emir of Ilorin. I wish you to know this and to exhort you to avoid adding to the difficulties of the situation as between you and them.

12. In the restoration of freedom to the roads between the Egbas and yourselves you must in no way forget your obligations to Jebu in the past. With the Ijebus also, remember I desire you to continue to maintain the 'best relations.

13. It remains for me to convey my appreciative acknowledgment of the courtesy and hospitality you were good enough to extend to Mr. Millson during his stay in your country.

14. Finally, let me wish you and your people every good wish and the early resumption between you and the Egbas of friendly and commercial intercourse, and the continuance of like relations with the Ijebus.

I am, gentlemen, your good friend,

A. C. Moloney. To the Balogun and Ibadan Authorities.

The tone of the Governor's letter did not please the Ibadan chiefs ; they complained that it showed a want of sympathy with them in their trying position. They were struggUng for existence as it were, but he was only concerned about trade with Lagos at whatever cost to others.

What they took exception to were the charges brought against them of breaking the Treaty, and of ingratitude to the Government " which has done so much for them." Whatever their character may be, they were certainly not an ungrateful people, and no one had paid more deference to the wishes of the Governor of Lagos than they had done.

A Treaty (said they) was made between them and the Ekitis, but none whatever with the Egbas, and when the Ekitis broke the Treaty by kidnapping their traders the Governor said nothing. They yielded to none in their desire for peace and commerce. If proofs of this were required, it might be found in the patience with which they were enduring their sufferings and trials at the

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hands of the Ijebus at that moment, with the same Egbas kidnapping on the route. Again the very fact of the existence of the trade by Eruwa the interruption of which was now the subject of complaint, was another proof in their favour, for although this war commenced with the Egbas, and no formal peace had been arranged between them, yet they (the Ibadans) had hitherto allowed this trade, but certainly not to make it operate to their detriment.

That for twenty years the Egbas had refused to sell them ammunition, but they would sell to the Ilorins and utiHse their territory to convey the same ; would it not be folly and suicidal on their part to carry the pretence of a desire for trade so far as to allow that, at a time the Ilorins were la5dng siege against their frontier towns ?

One of them remarked, " We cannot blame the Governor, the Egbas have gained his ears, and it depends upon how they represented matters to him. It is all the fault of the Egbas. They are hke spoilt children who in a fit of temper will hurl a knife at you, but if you in turn flourish a whip at them they will yell out before ever they are touched."

They concluded that as they agreed with the Governor's sentiments in the main they would only protest to the one objectionable point, viz., the trade with Ilorin through their territory before the establishment of peace.

The following letter was then addressed to the Governor in reply.

Ikirun, July i6th, 1890.

To His Excellency, Sir A. C. Moloney, K.C.M.G.

Your Excellency,

We were glad to receive Your Excellency's letter on the arrival of our messengers from you and have given it deep consideration.

2. We have noticed the expression of Your Excellency's feehngs respecting the closed roads.

Our reason for cutting off communication or trade with the Ilorins we have given to the Acting-Governor in your absence in a letter under date November 20th, 1889.

We regret the Governor did not see with us in the reasons we have given to the Acting-Governor for kidnapping the Gambaris off Iseyin, and not the Egba traders, which the Egbas retaliated in closing of the Eruwa- Iseyin road and kidnapping on the Ipara road.

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However, that has passed ; and now that Your Excellency is come, we feel assured that there will be nothing to fear in what you undertake to do or see carried out. We are ready for the opening of the Eruwa road to Abeokuta and of the Ibadan road to Abeokuta and will see to it.

3. The appended copy of draft of a Treaty has been read to us, and we have considered it duly.

4. We are glad to learn that negotiations for peace between us and the Ilorins have been resumed by Your Excellency and have no inclination to add to the difficulties of it.

5. Although we agree with the letter of the Treaty in the main, yet we wish to give our protest against the Ilgrin traders utilizing that road as long as we are at war with each other. We are here on the defensive and earnestly wish to return to our homes as soon as possible. If the Ilorins are allowed to utilize that road is there any possibiHty of their agreeing to any terms of peace and cessation of hostihties since they have free trade ? Hence we feel ourselves bound to open our minds to the Governor in sending our protest until peace is made.

We have no personal ill-will against their trading with us, but there must be cessation of hostihties. " Ota dig, Ore die ni ipani " ("A little enmity and a little friendship is always fatal to life"), says a Yoruba proverb.

6. We are thankful for Your Excellency reminding us of our obligation to the Ijebus.

Since Ogunsigun has commenced his troubles the Awujale has sent to inform us, and we feel it our duty to help him in case he should be distressed, but we trust Your Excellency will do your best to avert the impending war there.

7. We have to thank Your Excellency for the kind reception of our messengers, the kind present of money sent, and of the valuable seeds sent to us. They will receive our best care and attention.

8. Wishing Your Excellency good health and prosperity, and hope before long you shall hear that the Abeokuta roads are opened.

We remain to be.

Your Excellency's faithful friends, their Marks AjAYi X Balogun of Ibadan.

0§UNTOKi X The Maye of Ibadan. FijABi X The Abese of Ibadan.

Fajinmi X The Agbakin of Ibadan.

ABORTIVE MEASURES TO TERMINATE THE WAR 6oi

§ 5. The AlAfin's Measures for Peace and the Issues

We have mentioned above that the Ijebu messengers were at Oyq waiting the pleasure of the AlAfin for making a move towards the negotiations for peace with the Ilgrins, in which they were to take a part. But as His Majesty would not make any move, they were obliged to return home from disappointment ; but after the invasion of Berekodo by the Dahomians, and both Iseyin and Oyo lay exposed to their inroads, the whole country began to murmur against their King as the author of all their troubles, by keeping the national force tied down at Ikirun. His Majesty now saw sufficient cause to make a move. He collected messengers again from Ibadan, Iwo, Iseyin and Ogbomoso and sent them on peace embassy to Ilorin. This

he did in accordance with the wishes of the Governor, and to make a demonstration of his desire for peace ; otherwise provincial embassies are wholly unnecessary. It was an open secret that the AlAfin always had a regular correspondence with Ilorin all through these wars, but his private messenger Alebiosu by name, usually went by the bush paths escorted by hunters. The present effort being apparently sincere, everything seemed favourable this time, the Emir of Ilorin (perhaps plajdng the same game of dupHcity as the AlAfin) received the messengers cordially, saying to the AlAfin's messenger that his master was rather too long in making this move towards peace, and why so ? For his part (said he) he quite agreed to peace-making but he would wish the messengers to go back to their master and let him ascertain assuredly from the Ibadans whether they were really prepared this time to make peace, and when were they prepared to go home ? Then if the answer was favourable the messengers should come again and encamp between the two armies, and let both decamp on the same day, the AlAfin's messengers accompanying each home.

[This stipulation of the Ibadans " going home" throws a doubt on his sincerity as the Ibadans were there to defend Ikirun against his forces.]

The messengers returned to Oyo on the 20th July, 1890. There was a universal rejoicing at the bright prospects of peace, the eyes of all being turned to Oyo for the next move.

After some delay of over a month the AlAfin sent to tell the Ibadan chiefs at Ikirun the result of the embassy, and meanwhile addressed the following letter to the Governor of Lagos.

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From the AlAfin of Oyo to the Governor of Lagos.

The Palace, Oyo, July 2-^rd, 1890. To His Excellency, Sir A. C. Moloney, K.C.M.G. Governor,

Your Excellency's letters of the 19th May and i6th June have been duly received with the amount of money forwarded with the letter for which please receive my sincere thanks.

2. I hope my last of the i8th June has reached Your Excellency.
3. In that letter I told the Governor that we were about sending our messengers to Ilorin to negotiate peace, and promised to let him know the result.
4. I am happy to say that my messenger with messengers from Oluiwo of Iwo, Asejan of Iseyin and the messenger of the Bale of Ogbomgso left Oyo on the 25th of June, and they arrived here again on the 20th inst, I am glad to say with favourable results. Both parties have placed themselves in my hands, agreeing to decamp when I send my messengers again.
5. Considering the great interest and kind assistance Your Excellency has rendered us in this matter it would be very disrespectful and a base ingratitude on my part to send to disperse them without Your Excellency's knowledge and approval. I therefore earnestly beg that Your Excellency lose no time in forwarding me a letter of approval so that my messengers should go in time, as both parties are eager to return to their respective homes.

My messenger is also leaving for Ijebu to-morrow, the 24th inst., to inform the Awujale of the same as he also has great interest in the peace negotiation.

6. I am expecting Your Excellency's reply within a fortnight from date. I feel I ought not to make a final move without your knowledge as we have a proverb which says, " He that planteth should reap the harvest."
7. When the Ibadans are returned home then the Treaty, a copy of which is affixed to Your Excellency's letter to me of the 19th May will be enforced.

Wishing Your Excellency a good health. I have the honour to remain.

Your Excellency's good friend,

Adeyemi X (his mark), Receipt. The Aldfin of Oyg.

Received per bearer Taniafisara the sum of ;^3i 5s. by order of the Governor of Lagos on the 21st June, 1890.

Adeyemi x (his mark), The Aldfin of Oyo.

ABORTIVE MEASURES TO TERMINATE THE WAR 603

Before the return of these messengers from Ikirun, the Ilorin horse raided the Ikirun farms and kidnapped some people. A party of horsemen raided the Ilobu farms also and were equally successful as no one expected a raid whilst peace negotiation was going on ; but a third party which raided the Ogbomoso farms were worsted, four horsemen being killed, their horses taken and the raiders dispersed.

After this the Ilorins sent again to the Ibadan camp to negotiate peace independent of the AlAfin : the Emir of Ilorin went so far as to send presents to the Balogun of Ibadan ; but since their last perfidy the Ibadan chiefs would never trust them. Terms of peace were being arranged when a fire broke out at Ikirun. The people took advantage of the peace negotiation which was going on to go out far (to the Ila farms) for sticks and leaves for roofing, all unarmed : suddenly a party of Ilorin horsemen appeared but, suspecting no mischief, the Ibadans allowed them to pass on Ikirun-wards ; but the horsemen later on wheeled round and captured every one of them, and among the captured were two of the Balogun of Ibadan 's nephews, the sons of his late brother Akirimisa.

This put an end to the negotiation, and although the Ilorins sent twice afterwards to renew the negotiation, and repudiated the charge of sending a kidnapping expedition while they were negotiating peace, yet as they did not send back the captives, especially the Balogun's nephews, they did not obtain a hearing : the second set of messengers were even forbidden to see the Balogun's face lest they lose their heads.

FaiUng to negotiate with the Ibadans the Ilorins opened communication with the Oluiwo of Iwo, but when the Ibadans heard of i t, knowing it to be an intrigue they sent to put a stop to it at once.

Thus ended all negotiations with Ilorin.

§ 6. The Ilorins at Ilobu

We have related above that after the taking of Ofa and the desertion of several towns in the neighbourhood, including Inisa near Ikirun, the Ilorins still kept to their camp at Yanayo, a full day's journey from Ikirun. Depending on their horses they could come all the way to give battle to the Ibadans at Ikirun, but the Ibadans, without the skill or means to meet a vigorous cavalry charge, were unable to go after them in the plain in which Ofa is situated. After one or two stifi battles the Ilorins were convinced that they could not dislodge the Ibadans by direct attack except by stratagem. They therefore left their women and the infirm at the Yanayo camp and came forward to make a new camp at

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a place called Toribol^ between Erin and Ijabe, from which they may carry on surprise attacks on the small towns between Ikirun and Ilobu, cut off supplies, threaten the rear of Ikirun and thus induce the Ibadans to retreat from their present position. The Ibadans therefore appointed Chief Akintgla to Ilobu to guard these strategic points.

A small town behind Ilobu called He Aro was surprised and taken by the Ilorins. When the news reached Akintola at Ilobu he quickly marched out, gave chase, and intercepted them as they were returning with captives and booty. It was on this occasion that a single combat was fought between the champion lancers of the two armies which recalled similar warfare of ancient times. The two famous horsemen of both armies here met for the first time. Nasamu, nick-named " Gata-Ikoko " of whom we have heard as the captor of Enimowu at Erin, the most famous of the Ilorin horsemen on his famous war steed named from its colour " Arasi," here met with Latunji, surnamed " Okiti kan," of whom we have heard as the rescuer of his cousin Chief Akintola at He Ife when entrapped in an ambuscade, on his favourite war steed named " Nasankore." Both of them had heard of each other's fame and exploits on various battlefields, and had been longing to meet each other in a trial of valour. They now accosted each other, " Is that you ? " "Is that you ?" and then the single combat began according to their accepted rules, with spear on either side, and the hosts on both sides stood holding their breath, and watching these two chiefs of strength. The combat lasted for

some time, which shows they were equally matched ; but by a skilful turn Nasamu with his spear knocked Latunji's spear off his hand, and then went about to throw him off his horse and spear him on the ground, when Latunji hastily whipped out his revolver from his side and wounded Nasamu in the right hand, causing his spear to fall off his hand. With the left Nasamu gathered up his reins, put spurs to his hoise and escaped : the Ilorins with one accord gave way and were hotly pursued and badly beaten, all their captives and booty being recovered.

Nasamu's spear was picked up and carried as a trophy before Akintola ; he returned with great triumph to Ilobu, waiting outside the gate with the spear stuck on the ground before him, the war boys drumming and dancing around it till the pursuers had all come, and so he entered Ilobu in triumph.

The victory was so decisive, the Ilorins lost so many in dead, wounded and captives, that they waited no longer in their new camp at Toribola, but retreated to the former camp at Yanayo.

The Ilorin plan, if successful at He Aro, was to attack Ofa-tedo

and Ede next, and thereby dislodge the Ibadans from Ikirun. For a considerable time after this the Ilorins neither attacked the Ibadans at Ikirun, nor at Ilobu, but contented themselves with kidnapping expeditions in the Ogbomosg farms.

§ 7. The Conduct of the Chiefs at Ikirun

As it had become evident that under present conditions the Ibadans and Ilorins were not likely to come into closer contact so that the issue might be decided one way or another, and the temper of both remained the same, the Ibadan war chiefs were content to make a home of Ikirun at least for the present, whilst the Ilorins made a home of their camp at Yanayo.

The Balogun of Ibadan gave himself up to a reckless life of wantonness and cruelty, and the other leading chiefs were no better. Moreover the Balogun took to drinking to excess, and his slaves overran the countr}' to an extent hitherto unknown, not even in the days of the late Are with his numerous slaves. The people were literally groaning under fines and confiscations from trumped-up charges ; the Balogun appropriated whatever his slaves brought him, asking no questions as to how they came by it. Cases brought before him were never investigated before he ordered the confiscation of defendants' houses, seizing the women and children to be shared by the three leading chiefs, himself, the Maye and the Agbakin; these were sold to the Ijebus if not speedily redeemed. Knowing this to be the case, old grievances were raked up by some men who wished to take revenge upon others, and inflict unjust punishment upon them. Slaves who had redeemed themselves with wives and family were seized, their family shared by the leading chiefs and sold unless speedily redeemed.

Freemen invited to Ibadan by their fathers or grandfathers were seized as slaves, but cases of this sort the other chiefs would have nothing to do with, because nearly all of them came that way to live at Ibadan.

Latterly a house to be confiscated was surrounded very early in the morning before the inmates were up from their beds, but the master of the house was never caught so that he might arrange for the ransom of his household.

Bad as things were at Ibadan they were worse in the provinces.

Chief Akintgla practised the same at Ilobu. Sumonu Apampa alone, to his praise be it said, was exempt from such practices, and he would not allow anyone in his quarter of the town to be accused or distressed in this way.

The Balogun was determined to enrich himself before they returned home, whenever that might be.

Such was life at Ikirun latterly.

Chapter XXXIII

THE DARK BEFORE THE DAWN

§ I. Liberation of the Egbados

We have related in previous chapters how the Egbados were among the most peaceful tribes and most loyal to the AlAfin of Oyq, from the earhest times down to the period when the provinces became disorganized by the rebellion of the nobles ; and how the revolution fomented by the Fulanis spreading south involved the Egbas who in their turn conquered the Egbados at the battle of Owiwi ; and how up to 1888 they were under a succession of Egba rulers to whom they paid tribute. Ilaro the chief town was about this time under Chief Ogundeyi of Iporo Abeokuta. They were now to change masters.

The Egbados were groaning under the oppression of the Egbas on the one hand, and were much harassed by the Dahomians on the other, their masters being unable to free them from the annual raids of the latter. They were therefore determined to place themselves under the protection of the British Government. Chief Falgla of Oke Odan, who at this time appeared to be the greatest of the Egbado chiefs, went to Lagos in person and represented their case to the British Government, whereby the various branches of the Egbado tribes should come under the British protectorate. Prince Tela of Ilaro, son-in-law of Falola, was deputed by the combined Egbado chiefs to carry out the Treaty at Lagos. The British flag, however, was not hoisted at once in those places, but subsequently when to the oppression of the Egbas was added the encroachment of the French Government from Porto Novo, the flag was hoisted at once at Ilaro in 1891 and at Oke Odan.

The following towns which had suffered more or less from the Dahomians, were included in the Egbado protectorate : —

Ilaro, Oke Odan, 0w6, Ijako, Isagbo, Ajilete, Isalu, Onfo, Ipokia Sahasa Ilagbe, Itakete, Isiyan, lyakoto, Iwoye, Idogo, Igbeji, Isoto, Itolu, Pahajn, Pokoto, Ijado, Ibese, Ilobi, Erinja, etc.

The annexation of Ilaro caused great consternation and indignation at Abeokuta ; several indignation meetings were held to protest against it. They went so far as to threaten Ilaro with war if the flag was not hauled down. On an appeal to Lagos a

small force of Hausas was sent to protect the place. But the Egbas did not attempt to carry out their threat.

The Egbas at length wrote to the Governor of Lagos attesting their rights and protesting against the taking of Ilaro without their consent.

The Governor of Lagos replied to their letter of protest and sent Mr. F. Colley Green a native subintendant of police up, who induced the Egba authorities to send with him a deputation down to Lagos, The Egbas not satisfied with the explanation of the Governor of Lagos, blockaded the land and river route to Lagos.

With the Ijebus and Egbas hostile, Lagos at this time appeared like a deserted village. Canoes were drawn up, markets were extremely poor, shop-keepers sat gazing on their goods, there being no buyers, and the streets seemed to have put on a mournful appearance. Lagos then was but a small town. But it would appear that the Egbas suffered equally with Lagos, having nowhere else to dispose of their produce. Moreover the Egba authorities had not the means of making their blockade effective either by land or by the river, the blockade only benefited certain enterprising individuals at the expense of the community ; the object of it was not gained, therefore the matter ended in negotiation.

§ 2. Troubles at Ijebu

Whilst the interior and the Egbados were in an unsettled condition fresh troubles broke out at Ijebu. Ogunsigun the Serikiof Ijebu Igbo, who was sent by the exiled King Afidipote to reinforce the Ifes against the Modakekes and who refused to decamp when the camps were broken up in 1886, now returned home to Igbo. Being declared an outlaw by the present Awujale for refusing to acknowledge him as his sovereign he returned at the head of an army composed of Ijebus, Ifes and Ijesas to fight and dethrone the present Awujale. The Baiogun of Ijebu having been recalled home [vide p. 567) Kuku the Seriki of Ijebu Ode alone remained at Oru as an outpost and he was attacked by Ogunsigun 's army. Kuku received a gashing wound in the abdomen, the scar of which he bore to his grave ; but he was well repaid for his liberality and largess to the Ibadan boys, many of whom were with him at this time. Many came down for the markets at Orii where, in the absence of the Baiogun, Kuku dispensed justice to them and fair treatment against the grasping and

greedy Ijebus taking undue advantage. He furnished them with arms and ammunition, and they promised to repay his kindness, and with the rifles he possessed in abundance they were able to repulse Ogunsigun and his army from Oru.

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The Ijebus were for asking for re-inforcement from Ibadan to prosecute the war with Ogunsigun and crush him, but the elderly Ijebus counselled otherwise, lest the Oygs {i.e., the Ibadan boys) gained an insight into their country. The matter ended in negotiation. Ogunsigun was said to be fined 300 bags of cowries and II slaves. Of these slaves, the Awujale took five, the Ijebu authorities five, and one, if report be true, was executed in lieu of Ogunsigun the outlaw, and peace was restored with the Igbo division of the Ijebus.

§ 3. Strained Relations with the Ibadans

No sooner was the internecine war of the Ijebus over than they picked up a quarrel with the Ibadans. The first thing they did was to prohibit the sale of arms and ammunition to the Ibadans, because (as they alleged) they heard that the Ibadans had written to the Governor of Lagos to say that the Ijebus were snags by the way, and that the Governor should assist them to remove these snags in order that they might be able to supply the Lagos markets with produce of every description.

But the truth of the matter was because they heard that on the 22nd of August, 1890, the Ibadans rebuilt their toll-gate leading to Abeokuta with the intention of opening the Abeokuta road. But this was in accordance with the wish of the Governor of Lagos in his letter to them of the 19th May on the subject.

The friendly relations of Kuku the Seriki of Ijebu Ode with the Ibadans at this crisis led to his expulsion from Ijebu ; there was a great disaffection between the younger Ijebus and their King because he and Kuku were not pleased with their attitude towards the Ibadans. The charge against Kuku was that he was befriending the Ibadans and the white men. On his expulsion he came to reside at Ibadan and built a splendid house in Madam Efuduiike's compound near the Are egbe omo market.

Strict Blockade. — The Ijebus at this time were more resolved than ever to keep their position as middlemen between the interior and the Lagos traders. The Governor of Lagos on the other hand was continually receiving communications both from the AlAfin of Oyo and from the Ibadan chiefs relative to a road to the coast independent of the Egbas and Ijebus, preferably the Remo route opened for them in the 'sixties by the late Sir John Hawley Glover, then Governor of Lagos ; especially as the Remos were never in a hostile attitude towards the interior tribes even when there was war between them and the Ijebus.

The Governor of Lagos had from time to time communicated with the Awujale of Ijebu on the subject, reporting the same to

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the authorities in Downing Street. It was decided at last to give an open road to the interior tribes at all cost and this was communicated to Her Majesty's Representative at Lagos.

The Ijebu authorities knowing the mind of the British Government, were equally determined on their part to keep their country closed to all " foreigners " to or from the interior.

The Governor of Lagos, vSir Alfred Moloney, having come to the end of his term of service on the coast, was reluctant to close his career with a war among those with whom he had been on terms of friendship since the time of Governor Glover. He therefore sent a warning to the Egbas and the Ijebus through their sons at Lagos, advising them to change their attitude towards the interior tribes ; that Her Majesty's Government had resolved upon an open road from the interior to the coast, that his long residence among them on friendly relations made him feel reluctant to close his career with war, but that another administration would not be bound by such consideration. But this communication was not accepted in the spirit in which it was tendered, but rather in a hostile way ; a strict blockade was resolved upon both by the Ijebus and the Egbas.

§ 4. Death of Alihu, the Emir of Ilorin

About the end of November, 1891, the report of the death of Alihu, the Emir of Ilorin, gained ground, and spread all over the country ; the precise date of his demise was not known, probably it was in the earlier

part of the month. Prince Momd the rightful successor, whom Karirk had regarded as his rightful sovereign, was unanimously chosen by all to the throne of Ilorin. It was said that about 20,000 horsemen and 20,000 footmen escorted him home from the camp to take possession of the throne of his fathers.

As soon as Mom6 ascended the throne the scene was changed altogether. Being partly of Yoruba descent, his mother being a native of Ipapo a town near Iseyin, he was for peace with the Yorubas. Communications between him and the AlAfin of Oyo were open and frequent, the latter sending him some heavy presents for his coronation : the return presents from the Emir were beautiful horses richly capansoned. He also sent a horse to the Bale of Ipapo, his mother's town. Some of the princes of Oyo also exchanged presents with Ilorin princes.

Not long after the accession of M6m6 the renowned Karkra, the Hausa Balogun of Ilorin, died in the camp and was succeeded by his son Adamu who inherited not only his father's property but also his warlike spirit and his office.

The road to Ilorin was now partially and informally open to enterprising traders. No active measures were taken any longer on either side, each remaining in his camp, Adamu only barking as a chained dog.

Madam Omosa of Ibadan, whose husband Enimowu had been captured since 1887, and who had been spending largely for his release but all in vain, now sent again to the AlAfin praying His Majesty to renew his efforts on her behalf at the present favourable turn of affairs. Success attended their efforts this time, and not only Enimowu but also Malade and the two nephews of the Balogun of Ibadan were released, Winkunle, Tubosun's son, having died in captivity at Ilorin. The released arrived at Oyo on the 2nd of June, 1892, and after paying their respects to the AlAfin rejoined the war chiefs at Ikirun.

§ 5. IjEBU Excesses and Infatuation between the Years

1884 and 1892

As middlemen, between Lagos and the interior of Yoruba, the Ijebus enjoyed great advantages which were as greatly abused. Ibadan especially was at their mercy for supplying them with arms and ammunition, in which Ijebus themselves profited enormously ; and on this account they held themselves practically as their masters, knowing that the Ibadans depended upon them in order to be able to defend their frontiers against the Ilorins, and must perforce submit to any affront offered them.

An Ijebu, whatever his social standing — only because he is an Ijebu — considers himself superior to any Oyo man. The following will suffice for an illustration : —

The son of the Balogun. of Ijebu once said in conversation with the writer : " Afi Oyinbo afi Ijebu, dede aiye dede eru ni won. Ko si oja ti a ita Oyinbo, ko si oja ti a ita Ijebu " {i.e., " Except the white man and the Ijebus the whole world besides are slaves : there is no market in which a white man may be sold and none where Ijebus may be sold.") Can conceit go any further ?

An educated African, an Oyo by birth, resident at Lagos, had occasion to reside at Ijebu for some time, where he made some friends. On one occasion he was about-to pay a flying visit to the interior and one of his young Ijebu friends, trying to dissuade him from going, said to him : " Are you going Ibadan way ? Mark you there are no Ijebus there for you to associate with, they are all Oygs there! " This innocent effort at persuasion but provoked a smile, but it showed what the Ijebus thought of themselves.

As the only market for trade at this time, thousands of Oygs

came down once a month from the eastern and western provinces, assembled at Ibadan, and proceeded under escort to Ijebu, for salt especially and other necessaries. The market was held at Orii, an Ijebu frontier town. The treatment they generally received at the hands of the Ijebus beggars description, and can hardly be credited at this distance of time and change of circumstances. For a load of produce worth thirty shillings an Ijebu once offered a bag of something tied up. " And what is in your bag? " asked the Oyo man. The Ijebu replied, " A jo d'ale " (" Something to make one dance till eventide "). As he was about to examine

the contents of the bag offered him in lieu of his produce, the Ijebu went away with the produce, and the unhappy man found nothing but snail-shells left in lieu of his merchandise, and redress could not be obtained !

Another offering a bag of something for a load of produce was similarly asked what the contents were, andreplied, " Kieiye luwe," a newly-coined word — To make birds swim. As their dialects differed the seller would look at the contents of the bag offered him to know what went by that name, and the Ijebu immediately went off with the produce. The contents were wooden emblems of Sango ! No redress. The Ijebu insisted that once the man had taken the bag, he had accepted his offer !

If an Oyo man or woman was seUing his wares for 7s. 6d. and the Ijebu offered 5s. the former dared not refuse. If he attempted to take back his merchandise from the intending purchaser, there was sure to be a scuffle in which the seller would be overpowered by other Ijebus coming to the aid of the buyer, some beating him, others pricking him with their hairpins and so forth.

The caravan route at that time was notoriously unsafe from brigands and Egba kidnappers ; any Oyo carrier for an Ijebu who suffered any losses of his package in part or in whole was made to pay double the price or become the slave of the Ijebu. Accidents from slippery paths, highway robbers, thorns and thickets of the bush paths were of frequent occurrence ; whatever the losses an Oyo carrier for an Ijebu might suffer from any of these causes, must be made good at double the price by the carrier and members of his compound or he was claimed as slave by the Ij ebu.

The action of Ijebu men towards Oyo maidens need not be referred to : rapes and seizures for trumped-up charges were of revolting frequency. A shocking instance occurred of an Ijebu who alleged he had contracted venereal disease from a woman he had ravished, and thereupon claimed heavy damages from her husband !

Whatever the price the Ijebus are pleased to offer for any article,

the Oyg man is obliged to accept as it may end in a total loss of his merchandise and what was offered.

As to flogging at the toll gates — that was so common and indiscriminate that Ijebu youths were frequently found to come up to the gates on market days with whips, ready to find exercise for their arms with or without any cause.

The only court to which appeal lay was to the Balogun Nofowokan when he was stationed at Orii, and latterly to Chief Kukii. About a dozen applicants would be found before him at once ; hundreds had no chance to approach him before the return of the caravan was due.

The sufferings of these people impressed these chiefs who were dealing out justice to them, and hence they were charged with befriending Oyos. This is but a poor description of the kind of treatment Oyo3 had at the hands of the Ijebus during this period.

Deference and respect to age and station is a marked characteristic of Yorubas everywhere ; but at this period an Ijebu man even on Oyo soil would pay no respect to any chief or elderly person. Their indignities and impertinences had to be borne.

There were not wanting venturesome and enterprising persons who would risk the way down the coast with an Ijebu friend ; several of these were discovered between Ijebu Ode and the coast, and were sold into hopeless slavery.

Chief Kukii the Seriki of Ijebu Ode had done much for the Oyo war chiefs and for his own pocket, by seUing them rifles and cartridges at very high prices. Scores of Oyo beauties of whatever town they may be, were seized by him for debts alleged to be owing him by an Oyg, it might be by a man of another town unknown to her, as long as the niaiden seized was an Oyo by birth as the supposed debtor was ! Once in his harem he would never consent to their parents coming to redeem them ! This example was followed by several other well-to-do traders.

These are the causes that led the Ibadan chiefs in their letters to the Governor of Lagos, as mentioned above, to ask for a road to the coast which should not be disturbed and preferably the Remo route.

Added to all this was the unsafety of the road from Egba kidnappers. The caravans had to be protected by armed escorts every month as they trooped down and back. The first station was Odo-Ona-nla in the Ibadan farms. Here Adio the head priest of the Sango worshippers, was stationed with some elderly warriors. Next at Onipe. Here was the camp named Budo-Ode (hunters' camp). Here were stationed the hunters and reserved forces. Next at Olowa. Here lay the main body of the army,

" lya Ogun " as it was called. Here such brave men like Solaja and Bada Agidi were posted. Further on at Alabata and at Mamu were the advanced forces consisting of men from the Ibadan town districts of Oja Igbo, Ofa, and Oje.

There were frequent brushes with the Egbas at one point or another, but the most serious engagement in this route occurred in November, 1884, when the Egbas came with a large army and attacked the caravans at Alabata, overwhelming the guards and sweeping away a large number of traders. The report soon reached Olgwa and a strong body of men pursued after and overtook them. A sanguinary engagement took place in which the leaders Solaja and Bada Agidi signahzed themselves. The Egbas weie defeated with heavy losses. They rescued many of those captured, and captured also many of the Egbas. Among the captured were several Christians who formed the rifle corps of Abeokuta, with Moses Sasegbon, the Seriki of the Christians, their captain. Luckily for him he fell into friendly hands. He was caught by one of the boys of his old friend Solaja, who seeing him bleeding from wounds he had received, peremptorily ordered his captor to go for some water for the captive lest he lose him altogether. With a v.ink he then indicated to Sasegbon a way of escape, and then turned his back on him, pretending not to see him as he slipped into the bush and escaped. He reached home on the 19th of November, 1884, a wiser man, never more to engage in any kidnapping expedition. He was for months on a sick bed from his wounds.

Moses Sasegbon was well known at Ibadan, especially at the Ijebu quarters in the early seventies. He spent a long time there ; he had a factory with several hands ginning cotton till the war broke out in 1877. He was one of the sufferers when Egba properties and slaves were confiscated at the beginning of the war. This was the second time he had a brush with the Ibadans. In an affray the Egbas had with Ogboriefon the Balogun of Ibadan in the Ogun district he took an active part. When the Egbas were routed he was three days in the bush ere he could find his way home to Abeokuta.

When the Commissioners went up in 1886 to disperse the camps at Kiriji they met the Ibadan warriors as. above described.

§ 6. Causes That Led to the Ijebu War

(a) Affront to the Acting Governor

Governor Moloney was not a man of action. It was said that

he was too fond of writing letters to and drafting treaties for

men who hardly appreciated the one or comprehended the other

or knew the force or value of their marks of signature.

During his five years of administration he never once visited the people and the scene of which he writes so much : a single visit from him would have cleared up many difficulties in his way and enabled him to understand much, and he would have acted more to the purpose. No wonder then that matters remained in statu quo.

After his departure the Colonial Secretary, Capt. George Chardin Denton, now Acting Governor, in pursuance of the peaceful policy of the Governor proposed to visit the Awujale of Ijebu, talk matters over with him in a friendly way, and point out the advantages that would accrue to the Ij§bu nation by a free intercourse throughout the country under the auspices of Her Majesty's Government, of Lagos. He received permission from Downing Street to carry out his object.

Having communicated his intentions to the Awujale and obtained his assent, the Acting Governor started for Ijebu Ode accompanied by Oliver Smith, Queen's Advocate, Thomas Welsh, Esq., a member of the Legislative Council, and a mercantile representative. Dr. J. W. Rowland, the Colonial Surgeon, Capt. A. F. Tarbet and Mr. F. Colley-Green of the Hausa force, Mr. Jacob Alesinloye, an Ijebu merchant resident at Lagos, and Mr. A. L. Hethersett, Government Interpreter, with a guard of honour including the Hausa band to give eclat to the occasion. He took with him also large presents for the Awujale and his chiefs.

The Ijebus hearing of the Governor's approach sent to stop him at the landing at Ito Ike ; he was wilfully misrepresented as coming with hostile intentions. The Governor, however, sent to remind the Awujale that the visit had been agreed upon between them, and that it had received the sanction of Her Majesty's Government, and the travelling expenses granted : what explanaation was he now to give for not being able to reach him ? He was quite ready to dispense with his guard of honour and visit Ijebu with his attendants only if they conceived any fears and apprehensions.

It was not without much trouble and annoyance that the Governor's messengers with the above errand could reach Ijebu Ode being stopped repeatedly by the way. On reaching the town none of the Ijebu Authorities would lodge them ; they were sent from one chief to another till at length they had to return to the towngate to await the morrow. They managed to get audience of the king the next day and they returned with a message approving of the Governor's visiting Ijebu Ode bat not with a mihtary escort.

The Governor, who was all the time in the Colonial steamer, the Margaret, now proceeded, to Ijebu Ode with his civil attendants

only. At Ode they were kept under strict surveillance, none of the party being allowed to leave the compound. They had audience of the Awujale on the fourth day of their arrival when the Governor impressed upon them the determination of the British Government that the interior peoples should have free access to the coast like themselves. The Governor reasoned with the Ijebu authorities, showing them the advantages of opening up the country for trade, and that the result would be a general increase in trade which would bring more money into the country and that the Ijgbus themselves would enjoy a large share of the same.

He also promised them that the Lagos Government would pay to them a sum equivalent to what they were receiving in tolls.

The Ijebu chiefs received the Governor's words with displeasure and with every sign of anger against him and against their own king, putting the blame of the Governor coming up to " dictate " to them (as they call it) upon the Awujale who granted him the permission to come. They would listen to nothing else but that the interior Yorubas should meet them at Oru for trade, and that the white man's people {i.e., Lagos traders) meet the Ijebus at Ejirin.

The Governor proceeded to give the presents he brought for them. The king accepted his own, but the chiefs unceremoniously refused theirs. This of course the Governor considered an insult, and he therefore told them he would return what had been given him. As they made no objection to this he returned their presents of sheep and cowries he had received, and left Ijebu Ode the next morning. Thus the Lagos Government received an unceremonious rebuff in the person of its Chief of the Executive.

The Home Government being informed of the attitude of the Ijebus and their action towards the Acting-Governor, the Secretary of State for the Colonies, after consulting with the late Governor, Sir Alfred Moloney, resolved upon coercive measures, and hence gave full power to the new Governor to deal with the Ijebus.

§ 7. Causes that led to the Ijebu War {b) Treaty Made and Broken

On the arrival of Governor Gilbert Thomas Carter in the latter part of 189 1, communication was re-opened with the Ijebus. Special messengers were sent down to greet the new Governor. He received them in state in the presence of the principal Government officials and heads of departments, members of councils, and principal merchants.

The first thing the Governor required of them was to apologise for their conduct to Acting Governor Denton. This they had to do. Then they were required to sign a treaty, which among other provisions, aboHshed human sacrifices and enjoined the free opening of the road through their country between Lagos and the interior for all, the Governor of Lagos stipulating to pay the Awujale ;r5oo annually in lieu of tolls hitherto received from caravans. The delegates objected and required authority from home to sign a treaty. They were detained at Lagos until they received authority to do so or, if needs be, men capable of signing the treaty should be sent down. This was duly effected.

After this, there was a small measure of freedom to and from the interior for a few months, to enlightened people who knew of the treaty, but caravans were still not allowed a foot beyond Oru. But the Ijebus were incensed with their king and were determined on a revolution. They showed their resentment in moving the Awujale to several intolerant acts. They picked up a quarrel with the Ibadans, threatened to stop all arms and ammunition if Kuku was not expelled out of Ibadan. Kuku was accordingly expelled, and his fine house at Ibadan was demolished by the Ijebus there. Kuku returned to Ijebu, but was obUged to take refuge at Ijebu Ife which to all Ijebus is a city of refuge, by which he escaped death. Kuku remained there till after the taking of Ijebu in May, 1892.

Next the Awujale also raked up a quarrel against Solaja that intrepid Ijebu horseman at Ibadan. A beautiful cushion he had presented to the king a few years before was sent back : that meant heavy fines which had to be paid or he would demand his life. Solaja certainly was not expected to keep the returned article which had been in the possession of his king. Along with this, frivolous charges were brought against the Rev. D. Olubi, the C.M.S. agent at Ibadan, by the Awujale.

(i) That one of his sons took up some corrugated iron sheets for the C.M.S. house at Ibadan through Ijebu when they had forbidden all intercourse with white men.

(2) That he was instrumental in bringing Europeans up country. He sent to the Ibadans that he should be expelled the town. The Ibadan chiefs were reluctant to do so as they had no fault to find with him since he had been amongst them over 40 years. Mr. Olubi hearing this sent Mr. W. S. Allen a colleague to ascertain what the real cause of offence was, and that he was to pass on to Lagos and to procure some presents to appease him. This was done and the C.M.S. granted ;^5 for the presents in the interest of their interior agents, that route being the only one available to

the interior at present. The presents were accepted but unfortunately they seemed but to serve to whet the appetite of the Ijebu king for more.

The Awujale next sent to demand his head, and that of the white man (the Rev. T. Harding) at Ibadan. Mr. Olubi then opened negotiation for his life with the Awujale. He demanded more presents, and the reverend gentleman sent 12 sheep by Mr. (now Rev.) F. L. Akiyele, a C.M.S. Catechist under him. These were accepted but the ban was not removed, only matters were quiet for some time.

After a while, the Awujale sent to the Ibadan war chiefs threatening to stop trade, with all arms and ammunition if his orders were not carried out. The Ibadans commissioned one Fade, an Ijebu long resident at Ibadan to negotiate with him, and point out the unfairness of this order against one who came amongst them as a youth, grew to manhood, married and begat children and not once offending against their laws. On Fade's return he reported that the Awujale was inexorable that he demanded not the head of Mr. Olubi alone but also that of the European Mr. Harding, and that the houses and property of all the Christians should be confiscated and that 200 young men and women should be sent to appease his wrath.

The war chiefs saw no alternative but to yield to this extraordinary demand. A deputation of Christians was sent to the camp to remonstrate with the war chiefs but all in vain. They said " rather sacrifice the head of one man than risk the safety of the whole country." The home authorities sent back to the camp to ask whether the order was really meant to be carried out. A peremptory message was sent back to say if the order was not carried out the heads of the home authorities themselves should be taken off !

The messengers with this order arrived at Ibadan on Saturday the 2ist May and the home authorities felt extremely reluctant to carry it odt. Action was postponed till after the assembhng of the town council on

Monday and the matter discussed afresh. But on the Sunday, the sound of cannon was said to be heard at a distance, a conflagration was descried as that of the burning of a town. Towards the afternoon the rumour grew stronger and stronger that the phenomenon descried was at Ijebu, and at last the rumour was confirmed that Ijebu was taken by the British forces from Lagos ! The Home authorities withheld their hand on the Monday and reported matters to the camp. The war chiefs were so alarmed that they sent special messengers from Ikirun to ask pardon of Revs. Olubi and Harding and

expressed their regret that they ever yielded so as to issue such an order against the lives of men with whom they had hitherto Hved in the closest bond of fellowship from childhood. In this there is no doubt that we can see the interposition of divine Providence.

The treaty signed by the Ijebu plenipotentiaries was accepted with bad grace by the young Ijebus at home who kept goading the king to such intolerant acts as the one related above. To see people passing up and down through their country was galhng to them. A treaty so badly received evidently could not last long. It was soon broken. Now and then it became known at Lagos that individuals going up or coming down were sent back. The caravans were not allowed to proceed to the Ejirin markets. The Rev. T. E. Williams a Wesleyan minister who had gone to Lagos for the annual Synod of that denomination returning to his post was driven back to Lagos. That the Ijebus never meant to observe the spirit or letter of the treaty was evident from the events related above towards Revs. Olubi and Harding, the while unknown at Lagos.

What stirred their hostility most deeply was said to be the action of a foreign missionary going up country, who was received with hostile demonstrations by the Ijebus. Whilst waiting to pay his call on the Awujale, a crowd assembled and he, it was said, was going to preach to them against their wish : they would hear nothing from him ; on his persisting this inflamed them and both he and his party were literally driven back to Lagos. This matter was duly reported to the Governor. An ultimatum was sent to the Ijebus which they ignoied. The Egbas especially since the Ilaro affair were in sympathy with them, and both began to prepare for the fight. The Governor of Lagos sent a letter to the Egba Government by the Inspector of pohce, Mr. Adolphus Pratt, which they refused to receive and ordered the bearer to leave the town before sunset that very day with his letter. A council was held the same day at Abeokuta and it was known that emissaries of the Ijebus were in the town to take part in it. It was reported that the Egbas offered their services to the Ijebus, but that the Ijebus averred they could hold their own, and that if they could not drive back the white man in three njonths, then the Egbas may come to their aid. Meanwhile the Egbas strictly enforced the blockade of both land and river routes to Lagos. War was now declared against the Ijebus.

§ 8. The Ijebu Campaign The officers and men who took part in the Ijebu campaign were :

Colonel Francis C. Scott, C.B. Inspector-General of the Gold Coast Forces, the Commander of the Expedition.

Officers from England, 20. 4. 92 : Capt. The Hon. A. S. Hardinge, ist Battalion Scots Fusiliers. Capt. E. R. Owen, ist Batt. Lancashire Fusiliers. Capt. A. V. Ussher, ist Batt. Scottish Rifles. Capt. R. L. Bower, 7th Batt. King's Royal Rifles. Capt. J. R. V. Gordon, 15th Hussars. Lieut. C. E. Laurie, Royal Artillery. Lieut. J. F. Davies, ist Batt. Grenadier Guards.

From the Gold Coast, 20. 4. 92. Capt. F. M. Bayley, Asst. -Inspector, Gold Coast Colony. Capt. H. D. Larymore, Asst.-Inspector, Gold Coast Colony. Native Officer Ali, Gold Coast Colony. Native Officer Akero, Gold Coast Colony. Mr. Henry Plange, Quartermaster (Acting), Gold Coast Colony. 2 Sergt. -Majors, 4 Sergts., 146 N.C.O.'s and men Hausas.

From Sierra Leone, 9. 5. 92.

Major G. C. Madden.

Lieut. C. V. R. Wright.

Lieut. E. L. Cowrie.

Surgeon C^pt. R. Croft.

99 N.C.O.s and men, 2nd Batt., W.I. Regiment. Lagos Hausas.

Capt. A. F. Tarbet, Asst.-Inspector, Lagos Constabulary.

Capt. G. B. Haddon-Smith, Asst.-Inspector, Lagos Constabulary.

Capt. R. E. D. Campbell, Asst.-Inspector, Lagos Constabulary.

Sergt. -Majors Dangana and Dankafi.

Asst.-Supdts. F. Colley-Green, A. Claud Willoughby.

Pay and Quartermaster W. R. Harding.

158 men, rank and file.

With 100 Ibadan Irregulars under their own Captain Toyan.

The expedition left Lagos on the 13th of May, 1892, and arrived at Epe early on the 14th.

The Ij§bus had expected the expedition to come by Ito Ike, the shortest route to the capital, and had therefore spread their army ready at the Eluju grassfields not far from the town of Ibefun. Previously, they had offered in sacrifice a man and a woman, goats, fowls and pigeons at Itg Ike, and charms of imprecation for which they were famous were uttered over the creek that the vessels might founder and the expedition might end in failure. But they

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heard to their surprise that the transports had proceeded to Epe and the troops landed there ! They hastily broke up the camp and proceeded to the Epe road. Of the three routes generally taken, Itoike, Ejirin, and Epe, the last is the longest but the best. It has the best and easiest landing, and a village of some considerable size to be used as the base, one-half of the population of which consists of Lagos people. The way to the capital from here was mostly through farms. The other routes had no such advantages, they were for the greater part through bush paths : that through Ejirin especially at that time of the year was worse, the road for the most part v-shaped paths. The forward march from Epe after every preparation had been made was on the i6th May. Arriving at Pobo after a short march, an Ijebu ambuscade opened fire about 10.30 a.m., and a smart brush took place, the Ijgbus hastily retreating. The village and hamlets surrounding were immediately burnt down. In this engagement one of the Ibadan Irregulars was wounded and died from the wound at Ijebu Ode a few days after. Leaving Pobo on the 17th a larger force was encountered at Erebo ; here the Ijebus made a furious attack but were repulsed with heavy losses, and here fell A. Claud Willoughby of the Lagos force, ventaring too far in pursuit. The engagement lasted from 8 a.m. till 11 a.m., when the village of Majoda was taken.

No traces of the Ijebus were found on the i8th except the deserted camp. On the morning of the 19th the order of march was — the Ibadan Irregulars first under their captain Toyan, then the Lagos Hausas led by Capt. Bower, then the W. I. Regiment under their Major, the Gold Coast Hausas bringing up the rear under Capts. Campbell, and Haddon Smith of the English Militia Force.

The report of the day's event given by an officer who took an active part in the fight was as follows : —

"As we marched along a few men from the hills at the left fired at us, but soon ran away ; probably this was intended as a signal to the main force. We continued our march and all of a sudden, the Ibadan Irregulars halted, and began drumming and fixing on their war charms ; Capt. Bower ordered them to move on, but their Captain replied, ' The Ijebus are near, we have smelt them.' They had not advanced twenty paces when at a bend in the road the Ijebus opened fire at us. Here their main army was concentrated. They chose their spot well. The River Yemoji flowed across the path at this time overflowing its banks breast deep for the tallest man. The river flowed through marshes except at the ford through which we must pass and this the Ijebus rendered dangerous by snags thrown

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into it. As they opened fire the Ibadans were first at them, then Capt. Bower rushed forward with the Lagos Hausas, and the engagement began. It lasted full three hours. The Ijebus retreated to the other bank and raised a shout, as much as to say, ' We will see how you will cross,' but the Maxim gun soon cleared the opposite bank. The Lagos Hausas were ordered forward into the river, but they wavered and hesitated. In a moment the Colonel thundered out, ' 2nd West, advance ! ' The West Indian Regiment at once rushed into the stream, stumbling on the snags but kept going at the enemy, the Colonel himself amid stream giving his orders. The Hausas now came rushing in whilst Capt. Owen with the 7-pounder fired over their heads and quite cleared the landing for our men. Inspector F. C. Green shouldered the 7-pounder across the stream, shells and shrapnel doing their deadly work. At the right bank of the river Capt. Owen was wounded in the head and leg. The Ijebus fled in confusion. Their camp was at the village of Magbon but they never stayed to defend it. Rockets were fired into the forest and thick bush surrounding the place, and thousands of Ijebus hidden therein were dislodged and fled away in terror. The Ibadan Irregulars seeing the rockets for the first time with their horrid noises and streaming fiery tails, bursting into the forest, dislodging ambuscades and others conceahng themselves, fancied the whole forest on fire, they thereupon shouted and acclaimed Colonel Scott, 'Adana sun igbo '1 (one who set the forest on fire). The village of Magbon was occupied that afternoon and there the expedition passed the night."

He went on to say : —

" Next morning, thinking the Ijebus would make their last stand to defend the capital at all cost, the Colonel arranged his troops accordingly with every precaution. The Imperial troops being more steady led the way under Capt. Bower to his great delight. From Magbon right on to Ijebu Ode the capital was one broad path, the bush on either side the road was trodden down, and articles strewn about the whole way. The Ijebus after their defeat at Magbon thought they were being pursued, so they fled precipitately home. The town was entered on the 20th of May.

" On reaching Ijebu Ode we found that the town had been deserted, the poor old King was left with only two or three men, and a few of the chiefs trembling. He came forward to

ˆ That is the origin of the word, now commonly applied at Lagos to all raw up-countrymen as the irregulars then were. Y

Col. Scott and said he thanked him for teaching a sharp lesson to those disobedient young fellows whom he had warned, and warned in vain, not to venture to fight the white man. The Colonel replied, ' I see you cannot manage your disobedient boys, so I have come to help you to do so.' The King was kept as a State prisoner in his own house, and only allowed to take a stroll about in the evenings with orderHes behind him. He felt himself safer with the conquerors than with his own refractory subjects.

" Less than an hour after we entered the town, we saw an old man staggering on towards us, saying, ' I want my skin ; he has taken my skin ; I want it.' It was the aged Balogun Nofowokan. The Hausas looting, one of them entered the Balogun's house and saw him sitting on a large leopard skin ; he drove him off from it and took the skin, and this he came to the Colonel about. Enquiry was made, his skin was restored to him, and a strict order was given that the old man was not to be molested."

The Governor of Lagos went up immediately after. The Queen's birthday was celebrated on the 24th with imposing miUtary ceremonies. Chief Kuku came from his place of exile and welcomed the Governor.

It appeared that the Governor had written to the Ibadans to attack the Ijebus on the north at the same time that the troops from Lagos attacked them on the south. Nothing was seen of the Ibadans, and the Governor was inclined to doubt their good faith ; but when Ijebu was taken, a large batch of letters was found in the King's quarters, letters that had been sent some up country and some to Lagos, the bearers of which had disappeared ; among them was found the Governor's letter to the Ibadans. The bearer had been made away with by the Ijebus ! The postal work of distributing these letters to their respective owners was the first duty of civilization performed at Ijebu.

The expedition left Ijebu Ode on the 30th May, leaving Capt. Campbell as head of the district and Capt. Bower with 100 Hausas to keep order. The Ipebi or the king's private residence was converted

into a fort and there all were quartered, the king occupying a separate quarter within the compound. The disused royal palace at Iporogun, and the famous Ogboni house wherein were several men kept in stocks and tortured, were levelled with the ground, the victims being released. The king was allowed ;f200 a year and Chief Kuku £100 p.a. to assist the king in the management of purely native affairs, and the aged Balogun £50 p.a. out of regard to his age and position.

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§ 9. Effects of the Campaign

The taking of Ijebu Ode sent a shock of surprise and alarm throughout the whole land. The people felt instinctively that a new era was about to dawn on them. A new and foreign power had entered into the arena of active politics in the country, and everyone was exercised in mind as to how the country would be affected by it. Combatants suspended hostilities and all of them together turned their faces coastwards.

At the Seat of War. — The belligerents felt that their operations must soon come to an end, engagements therefore ceased.

In the Country at Large. — To the vast majority of the common people it was like the opening of a prison door : and no one who witnessed the patient, long-suffering, and toiling mass of humanity that week by week streamed to and from the coast with their produce, their manufactures and other articles of trade and returned with their purchases, could refrain from heaving a sigh of gratification on the magnitude of the beneficial results of the short and sharp conflict.

The first night in which, after the fall of Ijebu Ode, the troop of the first set of caravans slept at the Kanakana toll gate beyond Aka, large fires were Hghted, and all the men and women sitting round, spent the hours in recounting their sufferings and losses for years, in this very place, and the great change that has taken place. They continued thus far into the night, and occasionally raised loud huzzahs for the merciful deliverance, and the prospect of freedom of trade, and the discharge of their debts which the long period of 16 years' war had imposed upon every individual in the interior countries, giving thanks to God and invoking blessings ori the head of the good Queen of England.

They brought cloths of native manufacture, cotton, indigo, palm oil, palm kernels, beads, cattle, poultry, yam flour, pots and plates of native manufacture, calabashes in large quantities, turkeys and pigeons, rubber, etc., etc., and took back mostly salt, cloths and other articles of European manufacture, trade rum, gin, matchets, etc., etc.

On the Ijebus. — Even among the Ijebus themselves, very few if any outside the high officials of the capital who had hitherto maintained the iron system of inexorable exclusiveness and rigour suffered much from the change: the Ijebus were exclusively traders and they benefited by the increased trade. But the escape of slaves which was inevitable was their greatest cry. Slavery as an institution, however, was doomed to disappear.

The door was open to the preaching of the gospel. There was

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already a small congregation of Christians, the work of Ijebu citizens who had been converted at Lagos and Abeokuta, and who had learnt to read the Scriptures in their own tongue. These, who hitherto dared not show their faces or profess their religion openly were now released from fear, and when a few months later delegates from Lagos were sent formally to introduce Christianity amongst them — in an assembly of the King and his chiefs — these Christians came in a body, and in a humble but fervent address assured the King and chiefs of their loyalty and patriotic devotion, that the religion they professed enjoined both, and that they would never be found wanting in every duty appertaining to loyal citizens.

Permission was then given for the teaching of Christianity publicly, and grants of land were made for churches, schools, and mission stations.

On the Egbas. — It was generally known that a large section of the Egbas was disposed to render the Ijebus assistance, but as the community of Abeokuta included a large number of intelligent citizens mostly

Christians, who knew the magnitude of the power they had to deal with, their hands were held back by them. But there is no doubt that if the Ijebus had succeeded in repeUing the invasion even but temporarily, there would not be wanting a large force of Egbas which would have volunteered to lend their aid and might even attack Ilaro,

As it was, a few months after this event, when it appeared probable that Abeokuta might also come in for a share of attention from the Lagos Government, a diplomatic niove was made by the chiefs through one of their intelligent citizens, and overtures were made to the Lagos Government, accompanied by carefully-worded apologies for their late actions, especially towards the messenger of the Government whom they drove away without even accepting the letter he brought. He apologized for the Egbas in these terms. The letter was addressed " To the Chief of Abeokuta." Now there was no one to lay claim to that title. The Alake was but a figurehead and had no authority. Ogundeyi of Iparo, Onlado of Kunta and the Jaguna of Igbein, who together managed the affairs of the town, were co-partners, so that not one of the three could by himself lay claim to that title, and the Ogbonis whose voices are supreme in important political crises could not claim the title either. And again, for aught they could tell the letter may have contained certain orders they were not in a position to carry out. It was better therefore that they did not know the contents thereof, than to know and not be able to carry them out. Consequently their action in not accepting the letter was dictated by the high esteem they had for the British Government.

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And that the messenger might not hnger when he was unable to fulfil the object of his mission — for the letter might have contained urgent matters — they therefore respectfully asked him not to stay or loiter, but to proceed to Lagos at once.

Such was the tenor of the apologies they made, and thus they endeavoured to explain away what was a gross insult to be but a cautious deference. Their explanation was accepted, and the result was a free and uninterrupted opening of the roads by land as well as by the river.

On Lagos. — An abundant supply of produce, a large and steadily increasing volume of trade was the result, not unaccompanied by some disappointment due entirely to over-exaggerated hopes and keen competition, and glutting of the markets. But as the old condition of things was for ever gone, men soon adapted themselves to the new.

Chapter XXXIV

THE END OF THE WAR

§1. Governor Carter's Progress up Country

Governor Carter was not the man to leave his work half done. The refractory and irreconcilable Ijebus had been subjugated ; the Egbas had submitted and their apologies accepted. He now proceeded to the further interior to put an end to the protracted war, fraught with so much evil to the country. The measure adopted for this purpose was the only one capable of dispersing such fierce combatants, viz., an armed intervention advocated for by the writer all through these wearisome years. Although it might not be necessary to pull a trigger, yet a display of force offered a far more convincing weight of argument than volumes of treaties, faultless though these may be in aim and purpose. The presence of the Governor himself gave additional weight and importance to the Mission.

Governor Carter left Lagos on the 3rd January, 1893, for his tour. He was accompanied by a posse of Hausa soldiers, with Captain Bower, one of the officers who came out for the Ijebu war. The Maxim gun was en Evidence throughout the whole way. The Governor went via Abeokuta. He there had a long conference with the Egba chiefs and a treaty was signed on the i8th of January, 1893 {vide App. A). Face to face with the conqueror of Ijebu, and knowing the unsatisfactory relations that had always existed between Abeokuta and Lagos since the time of Governor Glover in 1867, and the part they played recently in conjunction with the Ijebus, they were certainly apprehensive of subjugation or annexation : and when the Governor assured them that he would do neither provided they mend their manners in future, they respectfully requested that that assurance should be specifically stated in the treaty ; hence the clause.

[Clause 5. … So long as the provisions of this treaty are strictly kept, no annexation of any portion of the Egba country shall be made by Her Majesty's Government without the consent of the lawful authorities of the country. No aggressive action shall be taken against the said country and its independence shall be fully recognized.]

This should be particularly noted because in after years other

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parts of the country, whose independence was never even threatened {e.g., Oyo and Ibadan) there being no need for any such thing, were held by some to occupy less favourable positions because a specific guarantee of their independence was not stated in the treaties signed with them. They were taken to be open to annexation.

The expedition leaving Abeokuta proceeded to Oyo, the capital of YoRUBA via Iseyin.

The Governor was well received by the Alafin of Ovg and His Excellency's tent was pitched in the Asipa's market, hard by the King's garden. This was a concession due to the owner of the town, the Asipa being the son of the late Oja the founder of Ago d'Oyo. His Majesty had several private interviews with His Excellency besides the public reception accorded him, and a treaty was concluded between the AlAfin and the Governor. {Vide, App. A.) From Oyo the Governor was now about to proceed to Ikirun via Ilorin. The Alafin was asked for an Ilari to go with him to the former place for the dispersal of the Ibadan camp by authority. He once more told off the Ilari Oba-k6-se-tan to go with His Excellency ; but the Governor would have nothing to do with that name of evil omen, " The King is not ready." His Majesty was told plainly that it was time the King was ready, for this war must now come to an end. Seeing the Governor was not a man to be shuffled or trifled with the King at once yielded, and ordered Oba I'olu (The King is the Chief) to go instead. The short and sharp lesson taught the Ijebus made an impression on the whole country not soon to be effaced.

From Oyo the Governor proceeded to Ilorin via Ogbomgso. He was cordially received by the Bale of Ogbomosg, who ever afterwards often referred to the pleasant and pleasurable time he. spent with the Governor. He was apprehensive about his proposed visit to Ilorin, and he did all he could to dissuade him from going there as he greatly feared the perfidy of the Ilorins and their hostility to Christians generally.

From all accounts the Governor on the other hand unfortunately left with the impression that the Bale's seeming anxiety on his account was not due to disinterested motives but to the sight of the large amount of presents he saw going forward to Ilorin ! The reflective reader of these pages, however, will see that the Bale had good and ample reasons for distrusting the good faith of the Ilorins.

At Ilorin the Governor had several interviews with the Emir and they parted with an assurance of mutual friendship. But it was generally reported that from the moment the Governor's

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proposed visit to Ilorin was known, the Mullahs and others waited upon the Emir and requested him to give them bullocks and money to make charms in order that the Anasaras (Christians) might not enter their town. The Emir, although not in accord with them in this purpose, nevertheless granted them their request.

He had occasion to throw this in their face and reproach them for it afterwards. He was reported to have said that he knew the futiUty of their attempts, and that they would have been more candid if they had averred that they wanted something to feast upon. For why should not the Governor visit him ? He liked to see the Governor. The Governor is a European, and himself a Foulah by descent, and they know that the European and the Foulah were brothers, and why should the Mullahs interpose between the meeting of two cousins ? Had he not granted their requests, they would have charged him with niggardUness and would have made the world believe that their charms would have kept the Governor back if the Emir had granted their requests. He concluded in this way, " But the Governor has come and is gone and what about the charms now ? You may now retire and be more honest in future." One thing that struck all the visitors to Ilorin forcibly at this period was the almost total absence of the fair complexion and straight hair of the original Foulahs. By intermarriages and miscegenation the Negro element had absorbed the Semitic. The

Emir himself was of a purely dark complexion, being partly of Yoruba descent, which accounted for his disposition to peace with the rest of the Yoruba country.

From Ilorin the Governor proceeded to a station between the two camps near the River Otin ; there he had several meetings with the war chiefs on both sides. The case for the Ibadans was easy enough, they were there to defend the country against the Ilorins, as soon then as they decamp they (the Ibadans) would go home. The Ilorins averred that they were in their own farms and should not be asked to go home. The Ibadans came from full four days' journey, it is they who should be asked to go home.

But the Governor repUed that he knew all that, he knew how the Ilorins came to be there, he even knew how Fulanis and Gambaris came at all to be in Ilorin, but he did not come there to discuss ancient history. He fixed a day in which both camps should be broken up together ; he appointed those who were to see the Ilorins home, and those who were to see the Ibadans home. The Awere stream near Erin was appointed as a boundary between the two States. And so the camps were broken up on the same day. The Ibadans had wanted to stop a day or two at Ede to compose

the difference between the people and the Tinii Lagunju, who had been deposed by them, but they were hurried homewards so that they could not do so. Thus ended the sixteen years' war.

We might call attention to the fact that all the towns serving the Ibadans in the Ibolo district asked the Governor for a flag each as a protection against Ibadan oppression. The Governor did not accede to their wish but promised to give attention to their request. The Ibadan army arrived behind their town wall on the 22nd March, 1893.

§ 2. The Return Home of the Ibadans

The usual mode of a triumphal entry into the town after every successful campaign was followed on this occasion also, because whatever it was, they had not suffered a defeat, their army was still intact. Hence they slept one night outside the town wall, preparatory to a triumphal procession into the town the next day. Here friends and relatives visited them, and every preparation made for a grand procession.

Very early, at the dawn of the 23rd, Sanusi, the late Are's eldest son, first entered the town with the bones of his late father in a coffin borne before him. • He set it up in state at the gate of his house awaiting the war chiefs.

Before entering the town the majority of the senior chiefs thought of having a private meeting among themselves to settle their own differences, or they might find it difficult to govern the town peaceably. Enormous wrongs had been perpetrated upon individuals, houses had been wrongfully confiscated, properties and people stolen and sold and any amount of mischief had been done whilst they were at war, so that most of them thought that those at home would be justified if they should close the gates against them so that they might not enter, and if they did, there was sure to be a civil war. No one committed greater wrongs than the Balogun's slaves, and the Agbakin his chief adviser. Moreover, the war chiefs had long been ashamed of the Balogun as their commander-in-chief, because he was so given up to liquor and was scarcely ever found sober all the time they were at Ikirun. They once approached him there to remonstrate with him for it, and his reply to them was, " Does my drink cost you anything ? Am I not buying it with my own money ? " At the seat of war the Balogun was supreme and absolute, nothing therefore could be done ; but at home it was otherwise.

Approaching him therefore to talk matters of so great importance over before entering the town, they found him as usual in his inebriate condition. He answered them roughly ; and he said that

he had no time for a council, and that if any one had anything to say to him, let him come to him in his father's house. Thus did the Balogun stifle all overtures intended for his own benefit. The chiefs were all stung by this remark, and there and then agreed to reject him as head of the town. They however suppressed their feelings and followed the order of proceeding. The Balogun led the way and the others in the strict order of their ranks followed ; every man as soon as he entered the town gate fired a gun, and there was a

regular feu de joie the whole time as the procession wended its way to the Are's house on the hill, and before his gate to give account of the war as they would have done if he had been alive. Thousands upon thousands of spectators lined the route the whole way, shouting welcome to some of the chiefs and hooting others. The Balogun was received with a rigid silence by the crowd, whom his slaves had wronged. Thus they came to the front of the Are's house. The Balogun in front, the other war chiefs behind him prostrated before the coffin and wept ; then he began to give his account : —

" 'Twas ye who sent us to the war. We met the enemy on our soil and we repelled them, and carried the war into their own country. We fought to the utmost of our powers, and finding the battle too strong for us, we invited you to come to our aid. Ye will remember how ye led us to the fight and how many hard battles we fought in your presence. Then ye took ill. .and. .then, .it came to pass., ye were transformed [E paradk]. And after that we fought several hard battles, and did all we could to keep up the Ibadan prestige : we were not able to conquer the enemy, and they were unable to drive us back, till the white men came and separated us.

We have since then been at Ikirun defending our frontier against the Ilorins. They were unable to come near to encamp against Ikirim, and we were unable to go and meet them at Yanayo, until the Governor of Lagos came and ordered both of us to decamp."

They wept once more, and thereupon Sanusi brought out the customary presents his father would have given them had he been alive. The ceremonies over, the next thing was for the whole of them to accompany the Balogun home, and thus to acknowledge him the head, but they had rejected him. Akintola was the first to mount his horse and say to the others, " Haven't ye your father's house to go to ? I am going to mine." Each of the younger war chiefs took it up, " I am going to mine," " I am going to mine," and mounting his horse each of them went home direct, leaving the Balogun and his own people to go home by themselves 1

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It needed no prophetic eye to see that a storm was gathering which would burst at no distant date.

The usual presents and refreshments theBalogun had ordered to entertain the chiefs with were all ready, but no one came to partake of them. The Balogun at first treated the matter lightly, affecting to care nothing for their plots ; but when he received no message of congratulation from any of them, and no secret message from any to disclose the nature of the plot, then he began to reahze the danger of his position. He was severely isolated.

At dusk the next day he went to the Agbakin to ask him to beg for him. But the Agbakin was his chief adviser, aider and abettor all the while at Ikirun ; he was by many considered as guilty if not more so and should be dealt with along with the Balogun ; therefore the Agbakin for the sake of self-preservation, speedily dissociated himself entirely from the Balogun, trying his utmost to secure himself whilst receiving from the Balogun large presents intended to mollify his brother chiefs. But as the Balogun 's fate was already sealed what he had thus received he kept for himself.

Governor Carter, following slowly behind, arrived at Ibadan on the 26th of March, 1893, and encamped at the Basorun market where booths and enclosures had been prepared against the arrival of His Excellency and his party.

The Ibadans in the meantime suppressed their feelings against the Balogun, and His Excellency, not knowing what was going on underneath, had dealings with none else but the Balogun, taking him for the head of the town.

The Governor unfortunately left Ibadan highly disappointed with the conduct of the chiefs because they declined to sign an agreement he drew up for them, and the idea of a European Resident he broached was repugnant to them.

They objected that they had been absent from home about seventeen years ; they had only just arrived, the town was as yet without a head ; they were not yet settled down for civil administration and hence there was no one authorized to act in an official position. These essentials must first be seen to before they could consider any treaty or agreement. The Balogun then said to him, " You have said you were sent from

home to separate us, then you go home again and tell your masters you have carried out your mission." The Governor's last words to them were, whether they were wiUing or unwilling they would have to do it.

At a banquet given at Lagos in honour of the Governor's successful mission. His Excellency in his after-dinner speech referred bitterly to this incident. He said that he met with

success all along his tour in his going and coming, till he got to the last stage where it was least expected ; there he met with a rebuff and he believed they were instigated to it by one in his own train but he hoped all would be right in the end.

To anyone with an open mind the Governor's words sounded very strange indeed ; it could only be attributed to an imperfect knowledge of the people. His Excellency might have allowed to such men as could govern a town like Ibadan and all its dependencies some credit of knowing their own minds and not be swayed by a mere clerk in his office.

But what people anywhere in Africa, nay, in the whole world, would readily and speedily fall in with the view of a foreign garrison in their midst if they could help it ? Besides, the argument advanced by the chiefs seemed reasonable enough.

As soon as the Governor left Ibadan the Balogun's troubles began afresh. He paid heavily in slaves, cowries and goods to beg for his life. After all had been received the chiefs sent for Osb, the chief officer of Orowusi's house, to come and represent his master's house in the council held at the big market (always the place of meeting when there was no head of the town). The Balogun was charged with all the enormities perpetrated by his slaves, the confiscation of so many houses for little or no cause, rapes and robberies all unpunished, etc., etc., they ended by saying that they had rejected him, and that he should honourably go to sleep.

We may remark that all these charges are such as would have been condoned but for his personal unfitness, which in the eyes of the Ibadans were unpardonable, viz., (i) His great indulgence in hquor (2) his failure to lead them to victory as a Balogun.

A Balogun who has won no victory has a small chance with the Ibadans. The Balogun received the message with much indignation ; he was determined not to die but to fight it out. When his determination was known, the people were also determined to meet him ; already his quarter of the town was being deserted, for they had begun to seize people about his quarters. Private messages were sent quickly to his brothers. " You know the consequences : will you allow your father's house to be wiped off at Ibadan ? " They knew very well that when the people assailed a house, it is to level it with the ground, and make it a dunghill, and the family — such as remain alive — dispersed for ever : no member thereof ever to hold a pubHc position in the town, for fear of his rising to power hereafter and taking revenge on the children of the perpetrators.

The Balogun's brothers stayed their hands and held a consul-

tation in the family, the elders thus addressing the Balogun's sons :

" We must all die sooner or later, and the death of a man advanced in life, with numerous grown-up children, is no early death. Which is better, for such a man who has already made his name and has nothing more to achieve to anticipate the inevitable by a short period at most, and the house remain, or for the said man with his house, family and posterity to be wiped off at once and for ever ? Your father was not the first heir to our father's house, let him not be the last : and so it will be if the citizens lay violent hands on him, and ye yourselves will not escape. It is left for you his children to save your own Uves and the honour, dignity and fame of your father's house."

The rest was left with his sons. No one could be accused of parricide for no one could say positively who did it, or how it was done, The Balogun himself scarcely knew what was going on, for he had now a plausible excuse for drowning his grief in liquor ! Rumour says his sons persuaded him to take the fatal cup himself. Others say they took advantage of a time he was the worse for liquor and discharged fire-arms on him, which

threw him off his seat but otherwise had no effect on him, and in his inebriate condition he muttered, " Who is throwing stones at me ? "

Warriors like him with system fortified against bullets can hardly be hurt by a musket. Then, it is said that they had recourse to clubs with which he was clubbed to death.

However it be, he was dead, and report was conveyed to the infuriated mob assembled at the market ready for action. Some one was sent to verify the fact, and when it was confirmed, information was conveyed to the principal war chiefs that the Balogun was dead. The mob dispersed. Lamentations were duly set up, funeral dirges sung, and he was buried with full miUtary honours as befits a Balogun of Ibadan, and his next brother Ola was appointed head of the house of Orowiisi.

§ 3. The Return of Governor Carter to Lagos

The Governor's mission to the interior was a complete success from every point of view, and he deserved all the ovation given him with one accord by the Colony.

He had a right royal progress through the town from one end to another. The whole of the streets along which he was to pass from Ebute Ero, the northern landing place to Government House, were decorated with flags and bunting, with palms and triumphal arches ; they were also lined with troops — Hausas and the Constabulary— the mass of the crowd was hke a moving sea of humanity shouting welcome at the top of their voices.

Mr. Ademuyiwa Haastrup, a prominent citizen, on a markedly big and powerful horse and in a gorgeous native robe, kept on cantering backwards and forwards round the Governor all the way along. The Governor was visibly affected at the sight of these signs of joyful appreciation of his efforts, and the success attending what he had accompUshed.

The work was so thoroughly well done that from that time to this the roads have been completely opened from one end to the other, and never has there been any obstruction to trade, and all this without firing a shot !

As a matter of course (as things were at Lagos in those days) a banquet by the " eUte of Lagos " followed a few days after at which His Excellency was the principal guest ; and he recounted amidst plaudits the principal incidents of his mission from beginning to end.

If Governor Carter did nothing more for the Colony, his name will be entitled to an undying fame in the Yoruba country. But we have to place also to his credit the initiation of the system of good roads which now stretches all over the country, being much developed by Governor Egerton. Carter's first road was from Ijebu Ode to Ejirin where the weekly caravan was the thickest, next the Epe road, then the Ibadan Ijebu road. These were the roads most used for the principal markets.

He built a proper Government House at Lagos. Then he started the railway between Lagos and Ibadan, which, under Governor Egerton, was continued to Kano.^ All this with the small revenue of Lagos at the time.

Two traits in Governor Carter impressed the chiefs and people of this country. One was the unfailing deference usually paid to native rulers, and the non-encroachment upon their rights. The result of this was the almost entire absence of bullying and belittling by subordinate officers which generally brought about disorganization of Native Governments, and other evils consequent thereupon. The other was the Governor's intuitive and almost unerring judgment of character and his sense of justice. The country was

^ Carter's successor was Governor M'Callum whose term was only 12 months spent chiefly over the question of our northern boundary with the French. He secured to the Yoruba country the ancient Yoruba cities to the N.W. of ancient Oyo. Next to him was Governor MacGregor under whom the system of sanitation was perfected. Under Egerton his successor the work of his predecessors was far advanced in roads and bridges, and filling swamps by dredgers, and further started on his own initiative the opening of the bar by which ocean hners might enter Lagos harbour.

prosperous in those days. Several causes might have contributed to this but the mass of the people set it down to the fair rule and government of Governor Carter.

§ 4. Local Opinions About the War

As was inevitable, opinions were freely exchanged and conjectures made in those days as to what would have happened had the British Government not interfered in the interior wars, but had left the native states to fight out their own battles. Naturally opinion was divided. Some thought the Ibadans would have been driven from Kiriji, for the Ekitiparapos were all animated with a determination to break their yoke for ever ; they were fighting for life, home and liberty.

Against this the Ibadans maintained that the force which could dislodge them from Kiriji would also be able to conquer Ibadan itself, for if they were unable to hold their ground where they were with all the provincial towns on their side, neither would they be able to do so at home with these towns hostile or neutral, and all their Ekiti fighting slaves escaped ; therefore in holding their own there they were not merely fighting to maintain honour and prestige, but also they were doing it with all the desperation of men guarding hearth and home. As to determination therefore, both sides were even.

But to the unbiassed observer the prospects of the Ibadans seemed much better for the following reasons : —

(i) If the Eldtis could have driven them, they had the best chance of doing so when they were furnished with thousands of rifles, and the roads being closed, the Ibadans had not even ammunition for their old flint-lock guns. When they used to fire into the Ibadan camp with fatal results and these could not reply : when the Ibadans had to go against them in the battlefield crawhng on the ground, seeking cover till they were near enough to spring upon them with swords, cutlasses, and the butt end of their Dane guns, capturing men and rifles. But latterly when the Ijebus were compelled by circumstances to open their roads for traffic and the Ibadans were able to acquire a few scores of rifles, their chances became more even, and the Ekitis were no longer able to assume the offensive. It was only a matter of time ; the Ibadans would eventually have increased their stock of rifles, and then the Ekitis would have had no chance against them,

(2) The Ibadans moreover were inspired with hopes of a future success by the following circumstance derived from experience. In all their previous wars, whenever in a difficult campaign, while holding their foes in check they were able to send out a

detachment for a subsidiary punitive expedition which proved successful, victory ultimately rested with them. So it was in the case of Iwawun during the Ijaye war, of Ibokun during the Ilesa war, etc. The victory at He Ife showed it would be the same in the Kiriji campaign.

(3) The next ground of hope was of a more solid nature. Ogedemgbe was the only leader in whom the Ekitiparapos relied to hold their different sections together ; he had to expose himself in every battle as any of the meanest soldiers in order to get his countrymen to follow him. His body was covered with scars from wounds. It was not unlikely that the Ibadans, having acquired rifles, a stray bullet might one day put him out of action, and with him the hopes of the Ekitis would be extinguished.

The Ibadans on the other hand could count upon scores of men wilHng and able to take the lead. In fact they attributed their non-success to the disobedience to the voice of their national oracle which bestowed the office of Balogim on Akintola, but which the Are was not inclined to follow, consequently the fall of their own leader was not likely to have a bad effect upon them but probably just the contrary ; and the Ekitiparapos driven from the field, the Ilorins were not likely to remain any longer to continue the struggle, as they were unable to take the field against a strong army without an infantry support.

§ 5. Constitution of the Ibadan Town Council

We consider it important to note how the titles were distributed at this time at Ibadan, because these men

formed the Town Council and were officially responsible for the Agreement which practically made not only Ibadan but also all Yoruba country a British Protectorate.

Bale. — There were two aspirants to the title of Bale, and each was backed by the two most powerful junior war chiefs, viz. :

(i) Osuntoki the Maye, backed by Akintola, and (2) Fijabi, the Abese, backed by Sumonu Apampa. The latter was determined to carry out his wish at all cost : he eventually succeeded, and Fijabi was elected Bale. A special messenger was thereupon sent to Oyo to place his name before the King. An Ilari was sent by His Majesty to confer the title of Bale on him. The act was known as placing the leaves of title upon his head because it is the plum leaves (Ewe lyey^) that are used on these occasions, " lyeye " from the root ye, to live, which rendered the act to mean, " May you live long."

Bale Fijabi now appointed his rival to the post of honour. The title of Otun Bale was conferred on Osuntoki the Maye, and that of Osi Bale on Fajinmi the Agbakin.

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The titles of the war chiefs are the most important at Ibadan. That of Balogun happily was indisputable, the National Oracle had declared it for Akintola after the death of Ogboriefgn : the late Balogun it was generally understood held it in trust for him while the late war continued. Akintola now by common consent came to his own as the Balogun of Ibadan. There were two aspirants to the next position of Otun Balogun, viz., Kongi the grandson of Ogunmgla, and the brave Babalola the son of the late Ajayi Ogboriefon.

Kongi based his claim upon the fact that his grandfather was the Otun to Akintola's father when Balogun, and so it was right that he be the Otun to Akintola as Balogun. But the bravery of Babalola could not be overlooked ; he too was the son of the hero of the Jalumi war and was second to none. Babalola therefore obtained the title of Otun.

That of Osi was offered to Kongi, but he sulkily declined to have it ; he was told either to accept it or receive none at all and was reminded of the cowardice displayed by him at Erin when Enimowu was captured by the Ilorins. Moreover, Sumgnu Apampa laid claim to the very title of Osi. His father was the Osi of Akintola's father as Balogun, and so also he would be the Osi to Balogun Akintola. Although in every respect he was deserving of it, yet to accede to Apampa's request would mean to degrade the house of Ogunmgla further, which they did not think it right to do, for the heroes of that house were equal to any albeit the head of the house was a cowardly youth. And to Apampa they said that they sympathized with him, he was worthy of it, but as he had been yielded to and had obtained his wish in the matter of the Bal§ Fijabi, he must not press his claim in this instance. So Kongi was made the Osi Balogun and to Apampa was given the title of Asipa.

The principal titles were as follows, civil and military : —

Fijabi

Tiile.

Akintola

Title.

Osuntoki

Otun Bale

Babalgla

Otun Balogun

Fajinmi

Osi Bale

Kongi

Osi Balogun

Mosaderin . .

Ekerin Bale

Sumgnu Apampa

Asipa

Bamgbegbin

Areagoro Bale

Suberu

Ekerin Balogun

Salakg

Are Alasa

Ogungbesan

Ekarun Balogun

Lanlatu

lyalode

Akintunde

Ekefa Balogun

Olaifa

Asaj u

Ogundepo . .

Seriki

Obisesan

Agbakin

Mgsanya

Otun Seriki

Tanpe

Maye

Aina Fagbemi

Osi Seriki

Enimowu

Abgse

Dada Ojo . .

Ek§rin Seriki

Eweje

Sarumi

Chapter XXXV.

THE ESTABLISHMENT OF THE BRITISH PROTECTORATE

After the titles and ofl&ces had been distributed, and the town settled down once more to the duties of civil Ufe, the chiefs held a consultation about the Agreement Governor Carter had called upon them to sign, and which they were not then in a position to consider. After the pros and cons had been dul}' weighed it was agreed that with proper safeguards they might agree to it, provided the Governor gave due consideration to their objections.

A letter was then addressed to the Governor asking him to send up the document for them to reconsider in a regularly constituted assembly.

Governor Carter having in the meantime left for England, on his furlough, this request was cabled to Downing Street and the Acting-Governor, G. C. Denton, Colonial Secretary, was ordered in reply to visit Ibadan in person and present the Agreement. Accordingly in August, 1893, the Acting-Governor visited Ibadan for that purpose.

The document was again read and interpreted to them, and after due consideration the following letter was addressed to the Acting-Governor stating clearly the objections in their way to signing the Agreement.

Ibadan, August 14th, 1893.

Your Excellency, — We are not unmindful of all the kindness done to us by Her Majesty the Queen, nor are we unappreciative of it : and, in order to be frank we desire to state to you our fears in objecting to a Resident European which we trust Your Excellency will see to.

First, we fear the authority and respect of the Bale and chiefs will suffer deterioration, as there may be two courts of appeal.

2. We fear our slaves will assert their freedom by running to the Resident.

3. We fear our wives will be taken by the soldiers which will be a source of great offence to us.

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4. We consider our land as our inalienable property inherited from our forefathers, and never subject to sale. We consider it also our greatest wealth bestowed upon us by the Almighty and we do not desire it to go out of our hands.

If the Governor will see that our rights are not trespassed we make no scruple to sign all the terms of the Treaty. We are your good friends,

FijABi THE Bale x (his mark). And OTHER Ibadan Authorities.

G. C. Denton, Acting Governor.

The following was the reply to the above letter by the Acting- Governor : —

Ibadan,

August 14th, 1893.

Gentlemen, — In reply to the letter of this date which was handed to me by you this morning, I have the honour to inform you that the conditions of the Agreement you tell me you are prepared to sign, do not contemplate interference with the Native Government of Ibadan in any way.

2. I may also say that the officer in charge will not as at present proposed hold any court or take any action opposed to local customs and observances so long as they do not conflict with the ordinary principles of humanity.

3. The officer placed in charge at Ibadan will be instructed that it is not the intention of the Lagos Government to interfere with the domestic slavery so long as it is conducted on humane principles, as the country will still remain vested in the Ibadan authorities.

I fail to see that slaves will obtain their freedom by running to the Resident.

4. Any Hausa who takes a woman of the country away from her home, against her will, will be severely punished.

5. With regard to the question of land, the Agreement only deals with a place for the erection of quarters for an officer and men, and sufficient grounds for a construction of a line of railway should it be deemed advisable to undertake such a v/ork.

6. In neither case can it be said that alienation of the land is contemplated. And that there may be no mistake on this point, I am quite prepared to guarantee that in recognition of your right, rent be paid to you for what land is utilized under the Agreement.

7. I can with safety promise you that your rights will not be infringed by the Lagos Government, the only object aimed at being to preserve peace, to secure open roads and reasonable freedom of action to the inhabitants generally.

I am, gentlemen.

Your good friend,

G. C. Denton, Acting-Governor.

After the receipt of this letter and after further consideration the Agreement was signed the next day by the Chiefs, {vide App. A). But before signing the Agreement, and in consideration of the Treaty signed by them at Kiriji in which the removal of Modakeke was made binding on them, and in order to speak their minds with regard to the same, they submitted the following document to His Excellency, the Acting-Governor.

A brief statement of the Modakek§ affair.

Ibadan, August i^ih, 1893.

Your Excellency, — We beg to say that the real intent of the article respecting the Modak§ke affair in tha former treaty was not understood before signature : but when the first Commissioners (headed by Mr. Higgins) came up and were at Modakeke and insisted upon the removal, then the late Agbakin of Modakeke who was one of the signatories was surprised and said, that he did not understand it so, and our contingents there then, viz., the present Balogun and Asipa, sent to us and we expressed our concurrence with the then Agbakin of Modakeke as to our understanding of the article. It obliged the Rev. S. Johnson to come to us at Ikirun and we told him the same thing.

When the Commissioners still insisted then the late Agbakin told them that it was one of the late Ife kings, Degunle by name, also known as Abi-ewe-ila, who gave their fathers the land out of pity, as the Ifes illtreated them by making sacrifices with them : and since then they lived and flourished there, and served them as landowners ; and the several times they fell out the Ifes were the aggressors, or were the first to fire at them, but God usually gave them the victory. They know no other

When the Commissioners still insisted on their removal then the Agbakin said that the place beyond the river Osun mentioned by the Commissioners was a forest without a house to accommodate them and no cultivation to supply them with

food, he then asked them to look at the town and think of the probable number of old and infirm men and women, with the infants and sucklings that may perish by exposure to the weather and then asked whether they would be able to stand responsible before God for the loss of their lives. This made them desist to press further the point, and matters remain as they are.

2. By right of conquest we have had our Ajeles in the Ijesa, Ekiti, Yagba and Eton countries right up to Otun and now that the Ijesas, etc., have rebelled. Your Excellency, is it right for any one of the rebellious towns to dictate to us as the Ijesas have done in asking us to remove our Ajele from a town which does not rebel as they have done ? It is because we are conscious of the Queen's power and goodwill that we have accepted a Resident, paying Her Majesty due deference. Ought not the Ijesas

to pay us some deference ?- In the first article of the Treaty the whole of the Ekun Otun and Ekun Osi are put under us, the Ife and Modakeke people form a part of the Ekun Osi. We think they and the Ijesas need being informed of this.

We leave the subject to Your Excellency's wise consideration.

We are, Your Excellency's,

FijABi, the Bale, x (his mark).

With the other Authorities of Ibadan.

After Governor Carter's return from England, Capt. R. L. Bower, with a force of about 100 Hausas, was sent up to be the first Resident and Travelling Commissioner of the Interior Yoruba having his headquarters at Ibadan. The Ibadan authorities were prepared to assign him a place in the town for residence, but he marched through and took up his quarters outside the town walls, in the space between the town and the ancient city of Owu.

With the establishment of the British Protectorate a new era dawned upon the country. It marked the close of the fourth and the beginning of the fifth period.

What the distinguishing feature of this new era will be, and how long it will last, are questions which only the future can answer.

When we have allowed for all the difficulties of a transition stage, the disadvantages that must of necessity arise by the appUcation of rules and ideas of a highly civilized people to one of another race, degree of civilization, and of different ideas, we

should hope the net result will be a distinct gain to the country. But that peace should reign universally, with prosperity and advancement, and that the disjointed units should all be once more welded into one under one head from the Niger to the coast as in the happy days of Abiodun, so dear to our fathers, that clannish spirit disappear, and above all that Christianity should be the principal religion in the land — paganism and Mohammedanism having had their full trial — ^should be the wish and prayer of every true son of Yoruba.

THE SEQUEL.

The Protectorate has been established and everything has settled down : but this end has not been easily attained as may ,Yery well be imagined. The country had to be convinced that a new regime had dawned upon it, and that the people must conform to it. This was not unaccompanied at first by a method high-handed and somewhat violent under successive Residents, but that was not unexpected.

We shsJl here but briefly indicate how the new order of things affects each unit, and incidentally we shall discover who were the real disturbers of the peace of the country.

§ I. Abeokuta

The Egbas rigidly kept to the Treaty, so that the Lagos Government could find no fault with them. The intelligent portion of the community was admitted to a share in the Government, and they strove to conduct everything after the model of a civihzed state. In fact it was the general opinion that in many things they ignored the rule, " Make haste slowly." The early career of the Alake and the new Government Secretary was highly beneficial to the well-being and progress of the Egba community.

§ 2. Ibadan

It took the Ibadan rank and file some time to realize the fact that intertribal wars are for ever at an end in this country. It was customary with them, after the conferring of new titles that they should go to a war, for each chief and especially for the Balogun to recommend himself thereby to the people as fit for the title he holds. The Ilorins remained the only power they had not come to any definite terms with, so we were not surprised to hear on all hands, " Nje Bower k6ni si ogun Ilorin yi fun wa " (" Will not Capt. Bower then open for us an Ilorin campaign ? ") To be at home with nothing definite to do was rather irksome to those

whose trade was war. Happily most of the important chiefs had huge farms wherein were engaged many of their domestics, and the majority of the men also were farmers, but a good many were warriors pure and simple. No wonder then that for some time burglaries, arson, etc., were rife in the community.

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Again, there soon followed a series of blunders which startled the community not only of Ibadan but also all the Yoruba country, e.g., the threat to arrest the Bale of Ibadan upon the ground of a supposed intrigue with Ilorin ! But this charge which had no foundation in fact, was easily disposed' of : all the same it seemed necessary in high quarters to do something which would strike terror into the whole country " in order to keep order " ! The Osi Bale therefore offered himself to be arrested instead, for the Bale's person he said was sacred, and that to arrest him would mean the break up of the town.

This was followed by the arrest of the Balogun of Ibadan

" until the man was found who had insulted Captain ". But

there was no such man. The salutation usually accorded to a gentleman on horseback by shaking the fist towards him was mistaken for a threat ; and how was the Balogun to know who thus saluted the Captairi out of doors some days after the event, in a huge town like Ibadan some miles away from his residence ? But this was speedily atoned for, and the Balogun honourably returned to his house. Then came the clash with Oyo over the case of Lagunju the ex-Timi of Ede, who appealed to his Suzerain to exert his good offices to restore him to his post. And again over the case of a man sent from Iseyin to be emasculated for the usual offence for which that was the form of punishment. This resulted in what was known as " the bombardment of Oyo," during which a ricochet shot hit the AlAfin on the knee. This was however admitted to be a blunder, and the matter was speedily adjusted by the Governor on his return from furlough. After a short time the people and the energetic Resident got to know each other better, and there was not only harmony, but even friendship between them, especially at Oyo : for it was subsequently found out that the mistakes and misunderstandings were all due to imperfect information in which the part played by the interpreter was not only dishonourable but highly reprehensible, and he was condignly dealt with.

But Ibadan never really settled down till after about eighteen months, when the Government of Lagos enlisted two battaHons of men for mihtary service in Northern Nigeria. This opening afforded relief to all those ardent spirits whose profession was arms, and with a wonderful celerity they imbibed and assimilated the new method of drill and discipUne, by which they were led to a successful campaign. Again, the railway undertaking absorbed the energies of many. Since then, Ibadan has had varied experience under various Residents.

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§ 3- IJESA

It was hardly recognised that the Ijesas under Ogedemgbe were given to warfare as much as the Ibadans, only that the scene of their operations was distant from Lagos but nearer Benin. Chief Ogedemgbe's war boys were known as Ipayes, and much mischief was done by them to the country people during the war. This habit they found hard to give up now that wars were over. All warhke spirits, including princes who thought they could do anything with impunity were among the number of his warboys. Molestations of their country people, robberies, brigandage, and violence of every kind were of frequent occurrence, and he of course always shared the booty or plunder with them.

Matters were from time to time reported to the Resident at Ibadan. Capt. Bower wrote twice to warn Ogedemgbe to keep his men in check ; the old chief regarded this warning as a huge joke. That the soldiery should be given to violence was a matter of course to him, he simply laughed over the matter. The offence was repeated and that in an aggravated form on the men of Ara, and was duly reported. Capt. Bower, after due notice, went over to Ilesa,. and according to arrangement, summoned at the King's palace a meeting of all the chiefs. Ogedemgbe, after a delay of about forty minutes, met him there, and the Captain after relating the cases and the warnings he had given their chief, there arrested him in the presence of them all. Ogedemgbe had the good sense to warn his boys to refrain from any violent act in order to rescue him, and thus he prevented bloodshed — but by forced marches ere the news became generally known he was far

distant. He was interned at Iwo instead of being brought to Ibadan the headquarters, " lest his old enemies might exalt over him." This, however was a mistake, for Ogedemgbe would simply have come back to his old home. The actual perpetrators of the crime were also seized and cast into prison at Ibadan. Capt. Bower also seized those rifles now in Ogedemgbe's possession which were used against the Ibadans at Kiriji. They were said to be an alarming number of perfect weapons of precision.

Ogedemgbe remained at Iwo for a httle over a year. When in 1896 Mr. Haastrup (generally known as Daddy Kumoku) was elected the Owa of Ilesa, he pleaded for him with the Governor and Ogedemgbe was released and restored to Ilesa. He was given the title of Oba'la, the next in rank to the Owa himself. The war-boys have since been suppressed and dispersed.

§ 4. The Ekitis The Ekitis are mostly farmers and traders ; there was only

one chief amongst them who was devoted to wars. This was Fabumi of Imesi Oloja Oke. He also had war-boys given to violence as those of Ogedemgbe. Reports had from time to time to be made of him to the officer stationed at the River Otin of violence to peaceful traders, capturing and selling them as slaves to Benin, and other acts of brigandage. The captain usually sent to warn the King of Oke Mesi, till on one occasion even the King himself sent his son to complain of Fabumi : then it was that the situation dawned upon Captain Tucker. Then he knew that Fabumi was the culprit and not the King, who was powerless, being a man of about 120 years of age ! Next he found a list drawn up by Captain Bower in which the name of Fabumi appeared as one of the troublesome spirits of the country, next after Ogedemgbe, and one to be arrested. He consequently went up with about twenty Hausa soldiers and arrested him, and brought him bound to the River Otin camp, and the next day he sent him on to the Resident, Captain Hawtayne, at Ibadan. The Captain gave him a good warning and set him at liberty. He was henceforth quiet, and subsequently became King of Mesi Ipole. It will be remembered that it was he who effected the capture of Ilori the Osi, by simulating Akintola's war cry ; it was he who decoyed the Ibadan army to the clefts of Mesi Ipole ; but he failed to take Modakeke. He was an honourable warrior.

§ 5. Ife and Modakeke

According to the Treaty of 1886, Modakeke was to be removed from Ife soil, and rebuilt in a place between the Rivers Osun and Oba, and the Ibadans were to see that this was carried out.

That portion of the Treaty was galling to the Ibadans, the Modakekes simply would not hear of it, but the Ifes were jubilant, and were determined to see it carried out.

Modakeke was a large town, and the immediate removal was simply impracticable. In vain did they ask that a reconciliation be made between themselves and the Ifes so that they might remain on the spot dear to them, containing as it did the ashes of their fathers ; the present generation knew no other home. But the Lagos authorities would not stultify themselves by going behind the Treaty, as it were, although they took no steps to enforce it, nor would the Ifes yield to anything except removal. Thus they remained together for years.

Subsequent Governors, who actually knew the towns, had their hands tied by the Treaty, much though they would have Uked to see things effected differently. In course of time, however, the Ifes were practically indifferent about it, as intermarriages

between them had all but made them one people, and the hope was being entertained that the matter would die away, and that Modakeke would remain. But Adelekan, the newly-created Owoni of Ife, a man as austere as he was uncompromising, was unremitting in his efforts to see Modakeke removed. He went so far as to conciUate Governor Carter in 1896 by giving him three of those national and ancestral works of art known as the " If§ Marbles." But since the general peace was kept, and th6 Modakekes were as industrious as they were loyal to the Ifes, and both populations seemed to Uve together in amity except for the Owoni, neither he nor his successors renewed the proposal to remove Modakeke.

Sir WiUiam MacGregor, during his regime as Governor, among other places visited He Ife. He granted the Owoni an annual subsidy on account of his position. Thinking he had secured his man in this Governor, the Owoni with plausible excuses, but chiefly for this purpose, undertook the unusual course of visiting Lagos in person. He did so but without effect, for Sir WiHiam had seen the towns himself. But still, Adelekan was unremitting in his hostilities towards the Modakekes, causing them repeated annoyance, fomenting disorders, and by false reports and unsubstantiated charges, got the two most powerful chiefs — the Balogun and the Otun — transported to Ibadan under charges of disturbing the peace. Then, later on, during the regime of Sir Walter Egerton (himself being on furlough at the time) the Owoni, armed with a copy of the old Treaty, got round the officer stationed at He Ife, and it would seem secured his connivance. The Ifes thereupon took it upon themselves to molest and annoy the Modakekes in every possible way, even to the extent of entering their houses and seizing anything they took a fancy to, doing violence to men and women in a way they dared not do without provoking a war, before the Pax Britannica was imposed. The Owoni knew what he was about when he got the Balogun and the Otun removed to Ibadan. The officer located at He Ife saw all this but said and did nothing, which was very significant. The Modakekes saw that a higher power was now behind the Ifes and that they would have no redress. Thus it came to pass that on the 27th day of March, 1909, twenty-three years after the imposition of the Treaty, the town was broken up. Those of them who were descended from the Owus removed to their ancestral homes to Owu Ipole, between Ife and Ijebu, others to Gbangan, some to Oduabon, others to Ede ; the bulk of the people, however, with the Ogunsua or Bale of Modakeke removed to a place called Odekomu somewhere midway between Ede, Ife and the Ijesas,

about ten miles from Ife, just beyond the river Sasa which after the war was made the boundary of Ife territory.

Adelekan seems to have been raised up for the purpose of breaking up Modakeke, for he commenced his hostihties against the town soon after he was raised to the stool of the Owoni, and he died the year after the breaking up of the town. " They drove us twice from our home," he used to say, " and we must see that they are driven permanently from theirs."

Want of sufficient land for farming prevented the people from concentrating in a spot as at Modakeke. Unfortunately Odekomu is not on a caravan route, and that has restricted its population ; but it is a small, compact and flourishing town, the people happy, contented and progressive as usual.

Providence, who ordereth and controlleth all things, saw that it was time Modakeke should cease to exist after they had nobly done their part in shaping the history of the Yoruba country.

§ 6. Ilorin

The Ilorins quickly showed themselves as the real disturbers of the peace of the country, and the real cause of the protracted war : for whereas the disturbances in the other provinces were more or less domestic and local, it was left for them to engage in poUtical disturbances which under the old regime would have drawn forth the Ibadan army out of home.

No sooner had the Ibadans gone home from Ikirun, and Governor Carter and his party had left them, than they broke the agreement arrived at with them and placed Ajeles (poUtical Residents) at Ikirun and Osogbo.

The boundary between the Ibadan and Ilorin territory had been fixed at the A were stream, to the south of Erin, leaving Erin and Ofa to the Ilorins, but the towns and villages hitherto under Ibadan protection were definitely excluded from Ilorin interference.

For this encroachment therefore Captain Bower had to go to Ilorin to remonstrate with the Emir for disregarding the compact made with the Ilorins by Sir Gilbert Carter. The Ilorin chiefs took great exception to the manner Captain Bower was addressing their King, but partly from fear, and partly from the intervention of the Emir, they were restrained from laying violent hands on him. They called Captain Bower "Bawa" (pronounced Bahwah) ; that in Hausa is the name of a slave. All their great men have each one a Bawa — their principal slave — and hence Captain Bower was taken for Sir Gilbert Carter's slave ! For a slave to be talking after that manner to, and threatening their King, was

intolerable ; as it was, he was said to have been literally hustled out of Ilorin.

Captain Bower, having driven the Ilorin political Residents out of Ikirun and Osogbo, encamped with his handful of Hausa soldiers at the banks of the River Otin — a river of ill-omen to the Ilorins since the Jalumi War — about five miles north of Ikirun. He sent to Lagos for re-inforcement, and he was granted a force of about 200 men with which he effectually protected the northern provinces of Yoruba from Ilorin encroachments.

All was apparently well after this, the weekly caravans from Ilorin and beyond went to and returned from the coast, the messengers of the Emir of Ilorin frequently camieto the camp and as the Hausa soldiers were all Gambaris, mostly from beyond Ilorin, the intercourse between them and Hausas from Ilorin was frequent and natural, not knowing they were all spies ! All of a sudden at the end of March, 1896, — Captain Bower being then at Ibadan — the Ilorins came in force one morning, swooped down upon this small garrison and nearly overwhelmed it. With shell and shrapnel, and by the use of rockets, the noise of which they called Sango, the garrison succeeded in driving them back. The force was naturally strengthened, and wisely so, for within three months the same thing was repeated ; however, the Ilorins then made but a poor show.

Towards the end of 1896 the Ilorin army came out for a regular campaign. It was a very large army, and they carried all before them till they came within a few miles of the camp. The reception they had twice received on previous occasions ill-disposed them to make a third trial of a frontal attack. For the present they swept along their old haunts to the Northern Ekiti laying siege to Otun and Orimope, both within the Lagos protectorate, with the intention of getting round to Ikirun and Osogbo and taking the camp at Odo Otin in the rear.

From private information received of there being spies in the camp who would set fire to it immediately the Ilorins came and the fight commenced. Captain Shaw, the officer then in command drew up the whole of the men on parade and then with a sergeant and two privates entered each tent and turned out about twentythree men in all who had no business to be there ! They were ” on a visit to their countrymen,” they said. Strict precautions were then enforced about admitting strangers into the camp.

From messages received from the Owore of Otun, about twenty men of the Hausa force were sent under Asani, a sergeant, to observe the movements and intentions of the Ilorin hosts ; and these reported an overwhelming force, and that Otun was sure to be

taken unless they received timely assistance. For this reason Sergeant-Major Dangana was sent with about eighty men with some rockets. The Sergeant-Major was a skilful and rehable leader : he dared not expose his small force to the overwhelming hosts of the Ilorins, but he hid some in a bush commanding a bypath to their rear, and the rest he posted on a rock in full view of the Ilorins. At the sight of them the Ilorins gave a shout and made for them, led by their Balogun Adamu, son of the late Karara and leader of the expedition. But the horses could not go on the craggy rocks, and the Lagos troops were therefore safe from their lances. Dangana then ordered volleys to be fired on them, the rockets also rent the air about them and frightened many away. Adamu was fatally hit on the neck, and in their presence he divested himself of his war-dress, and entrusted it to one of his men with orders not to stop till he reached home with it, for that he himself might not reach home. The dress was an heirloom in the family, from his grandfather AH.

Their leader wounded, the Ilorins gave way and the Lagos troops followed them cautiously till they came within striking distance of the camp. There they discharged two or three rockets which set the camp on fire, and the host gave way ! A large portion of them had gone a-pillaging in the morning, and these, returning to find their leader dead and the camp fired and broken up, made the best of their way home, being pursued only a httle way by the Ekitis of Otun and neighbourhood. Here the Ilorins lost hundreds of riderless horses.

Thus the camp at the River Otin was again saved from the determined attack of these intrepid horsemen.

By these repeated attacks on the Lagos troops and the disturbance of the peace, the hopes of the Ibadans were for a while raised for an Ilorin campaign. But in February, 1897, the forces of the Royal Niger Company

having its headquarters at Lokoja, with the two battaUons raised at Ibadan, entered Ilorin from the north after a single pitched battle before the gate of that city. Thus Ilorin has been subjugated and a Resident placed there to this day.

The disappointment of the Ibadans was shared by those who had hopes of seeing the Yoruba country once more united under the AlAfin of Oyo by the subjugation of Ilorin by the Ibadan forces backed by a force of British troops. But it seemed this was not to be. The Ilorin power has thus been thoroughly broken, and the garrison was removed from the River Otin.

APPENDIX A TREATIES

§ I. ABgOKUTA

Treaty of friendship and commerce made at Abeokuta in the Egba country this i8th (eighteenth) day of January in the year 1893.

Between His Excellency Gilbert Thomas Carter, Esq., Companion of the Most Distinguished Order of Saint Michael and Saint George, Governor and Commander-in-Chief of the Colony of Lagos, for and on behalf of Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, etc., her heirs and successors on the one part, and the undersigned king (Alake) and Authorities of Abeokuta representing the Egba Kingdom, for and on behalf of their heirs and successors on the other part. We the undersigned King and Authorities do, in the presence of the Elders, Headmen, and people assembled at this place hereby promise : —

ist. That there shall be peace and friendship between the subjects of the Queen and Egba subjects, and should any difference or dispute accidentally arise between us and the said subjects of the Queen, it shall be referred to the Governor of Lagos for settlement as may be deemed expedient.

2nd. That there shall be complete freedom of Trade between the Egba country and Lagos, and in view of the injury to Commerce arising from the arbitrary closing of roads, we the said King and Authorities hereby declare that no roads shall in future be closed without the consent and approval of the Governor of Lagos.

3rd. That we the said King and Authorities pledge ourselves to use every means in our power to foster and promote trade with the countries adjoining Egba and with Lagos.

4th. That we the said King and Authorities will, as heretofore, afford complete protection and every assistance and encouragement to all ministers of the Christian rehgion.

5th. It is further agreed and stipulated by the said Gilbert Thomas Carter, on behalf of Her Majesty the Queen of England, that so long as the provisions of this Treaty are strictly kept, no annexation of any portion of the Egba country shall be made by Her Majesty's Government without the consent of the lawful Authorities of the country, no aggressive action shall be taken

against the said country and its independence shall be fully recognised.

6th. The said King and Authorities having promised that the practice of offering human sacrifices shall be abolished in the one township where it at present exists^ and having explained that British subjects have already freedom to occupy land, build houses, and carry on trade and manufacture in any part of the Egba country, and likewise that there is no possibility of a cession of any portion of the Egba country to a Foreign Power without the consent of Her Majesty's Government, it is desired that no special provision be made in regard to these subjects in this Treaty.

Done at Abeokuta this eighteenth day of January, 1893.

OsoKALU X (his mark) King Alake. OsuNDARE Onlado X Representatives of King. SoRUNKE Jaguna X j Alake and Egba United Ogundeyi Magaji X ^ Government.

G. T. Carter, Governor and Commander in Chief, Colony Lagos.

Witnessed at Abeokuta this i8th day of January, 1893.

G. B. Haddon -Smith, Political Officer.

R. L, Bower, Captain, Asst. Inspector, Lagos Constabulary.

J. B. Wood, Missionary of the Church Missionary Society,

A. L. Hethersett, Clerk and Interpreter, Governor's Office.

E. R. Bickersteth, Trader.

W. F. Tinney Somoye, Clerk to the Egba Authorities.

I, the undersigned, do swear that I have truly and honestly interpreted the terms of the foregoing Treaty to the contracting parties in the Yoruba language.

A L. Hethersett. Witness to signature :

E. R. Bickersteth, Trader.

§ 2. Oyo.

Treaty made at Oyo in the Yoruba country, this 3rd day of February, in the year 1893, between His Excellency Gilbert Thomas Carter, Esq., Companion of the Most Distinguished Order of Saint Michael and Saint George, Governor and Commanderin-Chief of Lagos, for and on behalf of Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, etc.. Her Heirs and Successors on the one part, and the undersigned King AlAfin of Oyo and Head of Yoruba-land, for and on behalf of his Heirs cind Successors, on the other part.

I the undersigned AlAfin of Oyo do hereby promise : —

APPENDIX A 653

1st. That there shall be peace between the subjects of the Queen of England and Yoruba subjects, and should any difference or dispute accidentally arise between us and the said subjects of the Queen, it shall be referred to the Governor of Lagos for the time being, whose decision shall be final and binding upon us all.

2nd. That British subjects shall have free access to all parts of Yoruba-land, and shall have the right to build houses and possess property according to the laws in force in this country. They shall further have fall liberty to carry on such trade and manufacture as may be approved by the Governor of Lagos.

3rd. That I, the said AlAfin of Oyo, agree to allow a right of way to Lagos to all persons wishing to go there.

4th. That I, the said AlAfin of Oyo, pledge myself to use every means in my power to foster and promote trade with the countries adjoining Yoruba-land and with Lagos.

5th. That I, the said AlAfin of Ovo, will afford complete protection and every assistance and encouragement to all ministers of the Christian religion.

6th. That I, the said AlAfin of Ovy, solemnly promise to prohibit the practice of offering human sacrifices, and to prohibit it throughout the country under my control.

7th. That I, the said AlAfin of Oyo, will not enter into any war, or commit any act of aggression, on any of the chiefs bordering on Lagos, by which the trade of the country with Lagos shall be interrupted, or the safety of the persons and property of the subjects of the Queen of England shall be lost, compromised, or endangered.

8th. That I, the said AlAfin of Oyo, will at no time whatever cede any of my territory to any other power, or enter into any agreement, treaty, or arrangement with any foreign Government except through and with the consent of the Government of Her Majesty the Queen of England, etc.

9th. It is hereby agreed that all disputes that may arise between the parties to this Treaty shall be inquired into and adjusted by two arbitrators, the one appointed by the Governor of Lagos, the other by the AlAfin of Oyo, and in any case, when the arbitrators so appointed shall not agree, the matter in dispute shall be referred to the Governor of Lagos, whose decision shall be final.

loth. In consideration of the faithful observance of all the foregoing articles of this Treaty, the Governor of Lagos will make from ist January next ensuing unto the King of Oyo a yearly present of one hundred pounds

; but such present may, upon breach of all or any one or more of the provisions of this agreement, and at the discretion of the Governor of Lagos for the time being, be altogether withdrawn or suspended.

iith. I likewise pledge myself to obtain the consent and cooperation of all the subordinate kings and authorities of representative towns in Yoruba-land to the provisions of this Treaty.

Adeyemi, Aldfin of Oyo and Head of Yoruba-land x (his mark) .

G. T. Carter, Governor and Commander-in-Chief, Colony of Lagos.

Done at Oyq this 3rd day of February, 1893.

Signed in the presence of,

G. B. Haddon-Smith, Political Officer.

I, the undersigned, do swear that I have truly and honestly interpreted the terms of the foregoing agreement to the contracting party in the Yoruba language.

A. L, Hethersett. Witness to signature,

G. B. Haddon-Smith, Political Officer.

§ 3. Ibadan

Agreement made at Ibadan this 15th day of August, 1893, between His Excellency George Chardin Denton, Esq., Companion of the Most Distinguished Order of Saint Michael and Saint George, Acting-Governor and Commander-in-Chief of the Colony of Lagos, for and on behalf of Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, her heirs and successors of the one part, and the undersigned Bale and Authorities of Ibadan, for and on behalf of their heirs arid of the people of Ibadan of the other part.

We, the undersigned Bale and Authorities of Ibadan on behalf of ourselves and of the people of Ibadan, do hereby agree and declare as follows : —

1. That the general administration of the internal affairs of the following Yoruba towns, viz. : Iwo, Ede, Osogbo, Ikirun, Ogbomoso, Ejigbo and Iseyin and in all countries in the so-called Ekun Otun, Ekun Osi, is vested in the general government of Ibadan and the local authorities of the said towns act in harmony with and are subject to Ibadan notwithstanding that the Alafin is recognised as the King and Head of Yoruba-land.
2. That we fully recognise all the provisions of the Treaty dated the 3rd February, 1893, made at Oyo between His Excellency Sir Gilbert Thomas Carter, Knight Commander of the Most Distinguished Order of Saint Michael and Saint George, then Companion of the Most Distiguished Order, on behalf of Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, and the Alafin of Oyo as Head of Yoruba-land.

3. That we fully agree to carry out within the territory of Ibadan all the provisions of the said Treaty.
4. That we further agree in ampUfication of the said Treaty on our own behalf to the following terms and conditions : —

First. That we will use every effort to secure the free passage of all persons coming through Ibadan either from the interior to Lagos, or from Lagos to the interior, and we promise to afford protection to persons and property so passing.

Second. That for the purpose of better securing the performance of the said Treaty of the 3rd February, 1893, and of this agreement, we do hereby agree to receive at Ibadan such European officers and such a force of the Lagos constabulary as the Governor shall from time to time deem necessary for the said purpose and for securing to us the benefits of the said Treaty and Agreement ; and we also agree to provide land for the occupation of such officers and force.

Third. We further agree, upon the request of the Government of Lagos, to provide land for the construction and maintenance of a railway through our territory, should the construction of such a railway be determined upon, and to accept for such land such compensation, if any, as shall be agreed upon between the parties hereto or between the authorities of Ibadan and the persons undertaking the construction of such railway.

5. And we do finally agree that all disputes which may arise under or in reference to this Agreement shall be enquired into and adjusted by two arbitrators, the one to be appointed by the Governor of Lagos for the time being, the other by the Bale and authorities of Ibadan, and in any case where the arbitrators so appointed shall not agree the matter in dispute shall be referred to the Governor of Lagos whose decision shall be final.

Done at Ibadan this fifteenth day of August, one thousand eight hundred and ninety three.

George Chardin Denton, C.M.G., Acting Governor.

FijABi, the Bale X

OsuNTOKi, the Otun Bale X

Fajinmi, the Osi Bale X Akintola, the Balogun, by his

representative, Oyeniyi x

Babalola, the Otun Balogun x

KoNGi, the Osi Balogun x

Sumonu Apampa, the Asipa x

Ogundipo, the Seriki X (their marks)

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Signed in the presence of :

G.B. Haddon-Smith, Acting Inspector General, Lagos Constabulary.

W. R. Henderson, Acting Travelling Commissioner.

D. W. Stewart, Capt., Asst. Inspector, Lagos Constabulary.

We, the undersigned, do swear that we have truly and honestly interpreted the terms of the foregoing Agreement to the contracting parties in the Yoruba language,

John A. Williams, Clerk to Travelling Commissioner. C. J. P. Boyle, Clerk and Interpreter.

Participators in and witnesses to the Agreement :

Lanlatu, the tyalode x

MoSADERiN, the Ekerin x

Ogungbesan the Ekarun x

Obisesan the Agbakin x

Tanipeyi the Maye X

Akintunde, the ^kefa x

Salako, the Are Alasa x

Bamgbegbin, the Areagoro x

Enimowu, the Abese x

Olaifa , the Asaju x

Omqsanya, the Qtun Seriki x

Aina Fagbemi, the Osi Seriki x

EWEJE, the Sarumi, by his representative Alawo x

Dad A Ojo, the Ekerin Seriki x (their marks). Signed in our presence,

John A, Williams, Clerk to Travelling Commissioner. C. J. P. Boyle, Clerk and Interpreter.

§ 4. Egba (Boundaries)

Agreement entered into at Abeokuta between His Excellency Sir Gilbert Thomas Carter, Knight Commander of the Most Distinguished Order of Saint Michael and Saint George, Governor and Commander-in-Chief of the Colony of Lagos, and the King and Authorities of the Egba nation.

Whereas it is expedient to define the boundaries between the Egba country and the territories bordering on, or under the British Protectorate of Lagos, we, the undersigned Governor of Lagos and the King and Authorities of the Egba Nation residing at Abeokuta, agree as follows, viz. :

I. The Hne of demarcation between the two countries shall commence on the eastward at the town of Ori§i on the left bank

of the River Ogun, which shall be considered as falling within the Lagos sphere of influence ; the boundary hne shall then cross the river at right-angles, and take the most direct established road to the town of 6ta, which as at present shall be considered as under Egba jurisdiction. From Ota the boundary hne shall follow the main road leading through Ilogbo, Ilogboro and Epoto to Ilaro.

2. All towns which may be actually on the said main road leading from Ota to the protected town of Ilaro shall be considered to be outside the sphere of Egba influence, but any Egbas who may have farms on the southern or lagoon side of the said road may continue in their occupation without molestation from the Lagos government, and similarly all Lagos subjects who may have farms on the north of the said boundary shall be accorded the same privilege by the Egba Authorities. With this proviso all towns to the north of the said road shall be considered as belonging to Egba territory, and all towns to the south shaU be liable to be included in the British protectorate of Lagos.

3. The boundaries between the Ilaro kingdom and Egba must be determined by the position of the towns and farms held under the king of Ilaro, which kingdom was formerly tributary to Egba, but all Egbas who may have farms in the territory now known as the Ilaro kingdom may continue to work them as heretofore, any complaints upon either side being made to the TravelHng Commissioner for the District, through the officer in charge of Ilaro.

4. It is understood that this Agreement is subject to the strict fulfilment of the provisions of the Treaty signed at Abeokuta on the i8th January, 1893, and may be subject to modification in the event of the position of any towns enumerated being wrongly placed in the Intelhgence Map of 1888 by the aid of which this Agreement has been drawn up.

Signed at Abeokuta this fifth day of January, 1894.

G. T. Carter, Governor of Lagos.

OsnoKALU, Alake of Abeokuta x (hi*- mark)

OsuNDARE, Onlado X

SoRiNKE, Jaguna X

Ogundeyi, Magaji X (their marks)

Witnesses to Agreement :

Alex. F. Tarbet, Capt., Private Secretary.

E. R. BicKERSTETH, Trader.

Wm. R. Tinney Somoye, Sec. to the ^gba Government.

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We, the undersigned, declare that we have truly and honestly, interpreted the terms of this Agreement to the contracting parties in the Yoruba language.

C. J. P. Boyle, Governor's Clerk and Interpreter. E. R. BicKERSTETH, Trader. Witness to the signature : Wm. R. Tinney Somoye, Sec. to the Egba Government.

§ 5. Abeokuta (Railway)

Agreement made this 21st day of February, 1899, between His Excellency George Chardin Denton, Esq., Companion of the Most Distinguished Order of Saint Michael and Saint George, Acting-Governor and Commander-in-Chief of the Colony of Lagos, for and on behalf of Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, her heirs and successors, of the one part, and the Alake and Authorities of the Egba nation for and on behalf of themselves, their heirs and successors, and the Egba nation of the other part.

Whereas the Alake and Authorities of the Egba nation, for and on behalf of themselves, their heirs and successors and the Egba nation, have granted (as they hereby acknowledge) to Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland Ein press of India, her heirs and successors, the right to construct, estabUsh and maintain a railway with the proper works and conveniences for the conveyance of passengers, animals and goods through and on the Egba territories. And whereas it is deemed expedient to make provision for the protection of the said railway works and conveniences and for the purposes hereinafter appearing.

Now therefore the Alake and Authorities of the Egba nation, for and on behalf of themselves, their heirs and successors and the Egba nation, hereby grant to Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, her heirs and successors, for a period of ninety-nine years from the date hereof the following rights : —

1. To enter upon and occupy land to a distance of 100 yards on both sides of the railway.
2. To exercise upon such land all the powers for making, maintaining, altering, repairing and using the railway conferred upon the Government of Lagos by the law for the time being of the Colony of Lagos relating to railways.
3. To apprehend in any part of the Egba territories and to try and, if found guilty, to punish any person, whether a British subject or not, accused or suspected of having committed upon

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the land aforesaid any offence of whatsoever nature against the Law for the time being of the Colony of Lagos relating to railways, or against any regulation or bye-law made in accordance with such law.

To apprehend in any part of the Egba territories and to try and, if found guilty, to punish :

(a) Any British subject and any officer or servant, whether British subject or not, employed by the Government of Lagos on or in connection with the railway, accused, or suspected of having committed upon the land aforesaid any offence of whatsoever nature against the person or property of any British subject or other person ; and

(6) Any person other than a British subject accused or suspected of having committed upon the land aforesaid any offence of whatsoever nature against the person or property of any British subject or any ofiicer or servant aforesaid.

And the Alake and Authorities of the Egba nation for and on behalf of themselves, their heirs and successors and the Egba nation, hereby undertake —

To apprehend and to deliver up to the Government of Lagos, and to aid and assist in apprehending, any of the persons above specified accused or suspected of having committed any offence as aforesaid.

And His Excellency the said George Chardin Denton, for and on behalf of Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, her heirs and successors, in consideration of the rights hereinbefore granted, and the undertaking hereinbefore given, hereby promise —

To pay to the Alake and Authorities of the Egba nation, their heirs and successors during the continuance of this Agreement, the annual sum of two hundred pounds by four quarterly payments, payable on the 25th»day of March, the 24th day of June, the 29th day of September, and the 25th day of December in every year, the first of such payments to be made on the 25th March, 1899.

Arid it is hereby agreed that if, owing to unforeseen circumstances, it shall be considered by Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, her heirs and successors, that the provisions of this Agreement or any of them, require alteration, amendment or revocation. Her Majesty, her heirs and successors shall be entitled by giving three months' previous notice in writing to the Alake and Authorities of the Egba nation, their heirs and successors, to determine the Agreement at any itme, and negotiations shall thereupon be entered into for the purpose of making a new Agreement in lieu thereof.

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In witness whereof the said parties have set their hands and seals the day and year first above written.

(Signed) George C. Denton, (L.S.), Acting Governor, Gbadebo, a lake X

Adepagba, Olowu X

Olubumi, Agura X

SuLE, Mohammedan Chief X Ali Delokun, Balogun x

Ali Ijeun, Seriki x

Idowu, Apena tporo x

C SoRUNTUN, Head Parakoyi x (their mark).

Signed and sealed at Abeokuta by the said Alake and Authorities of the Sgba nation in the presence of :

(Sgd.) Frank Rohrweger. George Anderson. D. O. Williams.

I do hereby certify that I have truly and honestly interpreted and explained in the Yoruba language the terms of the foregoing Agreement to the Alake and authorities of the Egba nation.

(Signed) Wm. Alfred Allen. Signed by the said W. A. Allen in the presence of

Ladapo Ademola.

§ 6. Ibadan (Railway)

This Indenture, made the 14th day of December, 1900, between His Excellency Sir George Chardin Denton, Knight Commander of the Most Distinguished Order of Saint Michael and Saint George, Lieutenant-Governor of the Colony of Lagos, for and on behalf of Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, her heirs and successors of the one part, and theBasorun and Authorities of Ibadan for and on behalf of themselves, their heirs and successors, and the people of Ibadan of the other part.

Whereas by an Agreement made at Ibadan on the 15th day of August, 1893, between His Excellency George Chardin Denton, Esq., Companion of the Most Distinguished Order of Saint Michael and Saint George, Acting-Governor and Commander-in-Chief of the Colony of Lagos, for and on behalf of Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, her heirs and successors, of the one part, and the Bale and Authorities of Ibadan for and on behalf of themselves and the people of Ibadan on the other part, the said Bale and Authorities agreed among other things to provide land for the construction and maintenance of a

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railway through Ibadan territory. And whereas the said railway is in course of construction through the said territory, and it is deemed expedient to make provision for the protection of the said railway works and conveniences and for the purposes hereinafter mentioned.

And whereas the Basorun and Authorities of Ibadan for and on behalf of themselves, their heirs and successors and the people of Ibadan, have agreed to grant, subject to the conditions hereinafter mentioned, to Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, her heirs and successors, for a period of ninety-nine years, certain lands hereinafter described.

Now this INDENTURE WITNESSETH that, in consideration of the above premises, they, the said Basorun and Authorities of Ibadan do hereby grant to Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britciin and Ireland, Empress of India, her heirs and successors, all the land to a distance of lOO yards on both sides .of the said railway and have also agreed to grant for a like period to Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, her heirs and successors, all that piece of land near the Iddo Gate at Ibadan which, as to its position, dimensions, and boundaries, is particularly shown in the plan hereto attached, marked A, and coloured red thereon, and have also agreed to grant for a like period to Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, her heirs and successors, all that piece of land on the right bank of the River Ogun at Olokemeji which, as to its position, dimensions, and boimdaries, is particularly shown in the plan hereto attached, marked B, and thereon coloured red. To the use of the said Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland Empress of India, her heirs and successors, for a period of ninetynine years from the date hereof, and the said Basorun and Authorities of Ibadan do hereby agree that the said Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, her heirs and successors, shall have and exercise the following rights : —

(i) To enter upon and occupy and use the said land in any manner and for any purpose that may seem desirable to the said Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, her heirs and successors.

(2) To exercise upon such lands all the power for making, maintaining, altering, repairing, and using the railway conferred on the Government of Lagos by the law for the time being of the Colony of Lagos relating to Railways.

(3) To apprehend in any part of the Ibadan territories and to try and, if found guilty, to punish any person whether a British subject or not, accused or suspected of having committed upon

the land aforesaid any offence of whatsoever nature against the law for the time being of the Colony of Lagos relating to railways, or against any regulation or bye-law made in accordance with such law.

(4) To apprehend in any part of the Ibadan territories, and to try, and, if found guilty, to punish —

(a) Any British subject and any officer or servant, whether British subject or not, employed by the Government of Lagos, accused or suspected of having committed upon the land aforesaid any offence of whatsoever nature against the law for the time being of the Colony of Lagos ; and

(b) Any person other than a British subject accused or suspected of having committed upon the land aforesaid any offence of whatsoever nature against the person or property of any British subject, or subject of a civiUsed power, or any officer or servant aforesaid.

And the Basorun and Authorities of Ibadan, for and on behalf of themselves, their heirs and successors and the Ibadan people hereby undertake —

To apprehend and to deUver up to the Government of Lagos, and to aid and assist in apprehending any of the persons above specified accused or suspected of having committed ahy offence as aforesaid.

And His Excellency the said George Chardin Denton, for and on behalf of Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, her heirs and successors, in consideration of the rights hereinbefore granted and the undertaking hereinbefore given, hereby promise —

To pay to the Basorun and Authorities of Ibadan, their heirs and successors, during the continuance of this Agreement, the annual sum of twenty pounds by four quarterly payments, payable on the 25th day of March, the 24th day of June, the 29th day of September, and the 25th day of December in every year, the first of such payments to be made on the 25th day of December, 1900.

And it is hereby agreed that if owing to unforeseen circumstances, it shall be considered by Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland, Empress of India, her heirs and successors, that the provisions of this Agreement or any of them require alteration, amendment, or revocation, Her Majesty, her heirs and successors shall be entitled, by giving three months' previous notice in writing to the Basorun and Authorities of Ibadan, their heirs and successors, to determine the Agreement at any time, and negotiations shall thereupon be entered into for the purpose of making a new Agreement in lieu thereof.

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In witness whereof the said parties have hereunto set their hands and seals the day and year first above written.

(Signed) George C. Denton (L.S.), Lieut.-Governor.

Fajinma, Basgrun of Ibadan X

Ogundbesan, Osi Ba§orun X

Dada, Ekerin Basorun X

Olaifa, Maye Basorun X

Sumonu, Otun Balogun X

Bamgbegbin, Osi Balogun X

Shitu, Asipa X

Suberu, Ekerin Balogun X (their marks).

Signed in the presence of

(Signed) F. C. Fuller, President, Ibadan.

C. E. Johnstone, Private Secretary.

I, the undersigned, do swear that I have truly and honestly interpreted the terms of the foregoing Agreement to the contracting parties in the Yoruba language.

(Signed) Henry Libert, Clerk and Interpreter. C. A. Sodipe, Clerk and Interpreter, Witness to signature.

§ 7. IjESA

Enactment for the Abolition of Human Sacrifices in the IjESA Countries

Whereas the practice of immolating human beings is cruel, barbarous, futile and unjust in the eyes of all civihsed nations and right-minded persons ; and whereas the said practice has fallen into disuse amongst the Ijesas, and the present time appears opportune for its total abolition in the Ijesa country ; and whereas the Ijesas are under a deep and lasting obhgation to His Excellency the Governor of Lagos for having established peace between them and their late enemies, the Ibadans, and for having thereby secured the independence of the Ijesa country ; and whereas His Excellency the Governor of Lagos desires no other proof of gratitude of the Ijesas for what he has done for them than that they should aboHsh the abominable practice ; and whereas the Ijesas have resolved to abohsh the said practice accordingly : Now, therefore, we the undersigned, as representing the Ijesa nation, do hereby enact, ordain, and declare as follows, viz. : —

I. The practice of immolating human beings, whether at the festival of any deity or before, at, or after the funeral of any king or subject, or on any other pubUc or private occasion, shall be and hereby is aboHshed for ever.

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2. It shall be and is hereby constituted a criminal offence for any one in the kingdom of Ijesa or for any subject of the Ijesa king to perform or participate in, or to aid and abet others in performing or participating in any human sacrifice.

3. Every such criminal offence shall be punished by the infliction of a heavy fine, imprisonment, or forced labour.

4. No person condemned to death for a crime punishable with death under the laws of the Ijesa country shall be utiHsed for the purpose of sacrifice.

Given under our hands and seals this 29th day of September, 1886.

Agunloye, Owa of llesa x

Ogedemgbe, Seriki of Ijesa X (their marks).

Signed and sealed in our presence after the contents had been read and interpreted to the signatories by the Rev. Charles Phillips.

H. HiGGINS 1 cj. • 7 ⌒

Oliver Smith S Speaal Comtmsstoners.

§ 8. Ekiti

Enactment for the Abolition of Human Sacrifices in the Ekiti Countries

Whereas the practice of immolating human beings is cruel, barbarous, futile and unjust in the e57es of all civilised nations and right-minded persons, and whereas the said practice has fallen into disuse in the Ekiti coimtries, and the present time appears opportune for its total aboUtion in those countries ; and whereas the Ekitis are under a deep and lasting obligation to His Excellency the Governor of Lagos for having estabUshed peace between them and their late enemies the Ibadans, and for having thereby secured the independence of the said Ekiti countries ; and whereas His Excellency the Governor of Lagos desires no other proof of the gratitude of the Ekitis for what he has done for them than that they should abohsh the said abominable practice ; and whereas the Ekitis have resolved to abohsh the said practice accordingly : Now therefore we, the undersigned, representing all the Eldti kings and countries, and being duly authorised to speak in their name, and on their behalf, do hereby enact, ordain, and declare as follows, viz. : —

1. The practice of immolating human beings, whether at the festival of any deity, or before, at, or after the funeral of any king or subject or on any other public or private occasion, shall be and hereby is abohshed for ever.

2. It shall be and hereby is constituted a criminal offence for

J- special Commissioners.

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anyone in any Ekiti country, or for any subject of any Ekiti king to perform or participate in or to aid or abet others in performing or participating in any human sacrifice.

3. Every such criminal offence shall be punished by the infliction of a heavy fine, imprisonment, or forced labour.

4. No person condemned to death for a crime shall be utiUsed for the purpose of human sacrifice.

Given under our hands and seals this 29th day of September, 1886.

Okinbaloye, Owore of Qtun x

Oyiyosoje, Ajero of Ijero X

Odundun, Olojudo of Ido X (their marks).

I guarantee the enactment of the above-written promise.

Ogedemgbe, Seriki of Ijesa x (his mark). Signed and sealed in our presence after the contents had been read and interpreted to the signatories by the Rev. Charles Phillips.

H. HiGGINS

Oliver Smith

§9. Ife Abolition of the Custom of Human Sacrifice by the Council

OF Ife Whereas the practice of immolating human beings is cruel, barbarous, futile and unjust ; and whereas His Excellency the Governor of Lagos, to whom the Ife nation is greatly indebted for having magnanimously mediated between them and their enemies, will be pleased to hear that the Ife nation has abohshed the said detestable practice ; and whereas the Council of Ife has already undertaken through its representatives at Kiriji to aboUsh the said abominable practice : Now therefore we, the undersigned members of the Council of Ife, hereby declare and promise that the practice of immolating human beings is and henceforth for ever shall remain abolished in the Ife country.

In witness whereof we have hereunto affixed our hands and seals on the date hereunder written opposite our names.

AwoTUNDE, Olalufe of Ife x Nov. 2nd, 1886.

Oramuiyon, Ohaji of Ife x

Awonrile, Orisamile of Ife X „ „

Tojo, Asoje of Ife x „ „

(their marks). Signed and sealed in our presence, after the contents had been read and interpreted to the signatories by the Rev. Chas. Phillips.

H. HiGGINS o^ 1 n

Oliver Smith I "« Commissioners.

§10. France

Arrangement concerning the delimitation of the English and French possessions on the West Coast of Africa. Signed at Paris, August loth, 1889. (Annex B.)

The undersigned, selected by the Government of Her Majesty the Queen of Great Britain and Ireland and by the Government of the French Republic for the purpose of preparing a general understanding with a view to settle all the questions at issue, between England and France, with regard to their respective possessions on the West Coast of Africa, have agreed on the following provisions : —

Article IV

Sect. I. On the slave coast the line of demarcation between the spheres of influence of the two powers shall be identical with the meridian which intersects the territory of Porto Novo at the Ajara Creek, leaving Ipokia to the Enghsh Colony of Lagos. It shall follow the above-mentioned meridian as far as the ninth degree of north latitude, where it shall stop. To the south it shall terminate on the seashore after having passed through the territory of Appah, the capital of which shall continue to belong to England.

The navigation of the Ajara and of the River Ado shall be free and open to the inhabitants and boats of both protectorates.

Sect. 2. French traders shall be guaranteed full liberty of trade with such districts as shall not be included in the French sphere of influence, and especially as regards the Egbas.

English traders shall likewise be guaranteed full liberty of trade with such districts as shall not be included in the English sphere of influence.

Sect. 3. Guarantees shall also be given in favour of the inhabitants of Ketonu and of the French portion of the territory of Appah. These inhabitants shall be free to leave the country should they so desire, and those who remain shall be protected by the French authorities against any act of aggression on their person, their position, or their property, on the part of the king of Porto Novo or of his people.

Similar guarantees shall be given in favour of the inhabitants of the territory of Ipokia.

Sect. 4. It is furthermore agreed that (i) the English Government shall have full liberty of political action to the east of the frontier

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line ; and that (ii) the French Government shall have full liberty of political action to the west of the frontier line.

Sect. 5. In consequence of the understanding defined as above, and with a view to obviate any conflict to which the daily relations of the inhabitants of the Porto Novo country with those of Ipokia might give rise if a Custom-house were to be established by one or other of the contracting parties on the Ajara Creek, the English and French Delegates agree in recommending to their respective Governments the neutralization, from a Customs point of view, of that portion of the territory of Ipokia, which is comprised between the Ajara Creek and the Ado until such time as a definitive Customs Agreement can be arrived at between the French establishments of Porto Novo and the Colony of Lagos

Article V

The two Governments reserve to themselves the right of nominating Special Commissioners of Delimitation to trace upon the spot, wherever they may consider it necessary, the line of demarcation between the English and French possessions in conformity with the general provisions which are set forth above.

In witness thereof the undersigned delegates have drawn up and signed the present Agreement, subject to the approval of their respective Governments.

Done at Paris in duphcate the loth day of August, 1889.

(Signed) Edwin H. Egerton.

Augustus W. L. Hemming.

A. NiSARD.

Jean Bayol.

§ II. Porto Novo

Sect. I. " The meridian which intersects the territory of Porto Novo at the Ajara Creek " shall be taken to mean —

1. (To the north of the Porto Novo lagoon) the middle of the stream of the Ajara River to the point where the said riverceases to separate the kingdom of Porto Novo from that of Ipokia and from thence the meridian thereof as far as the ninth parallel of north latitude.
2. (To the south of the Porto Novo lagoon) the meridian of the middle of the Ajara River, where it flows into the Porto Novo lagoon.
3. The frontier Une has been based in this Convention upon the

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Sketch Survey of the Inland Water Communication in the Colony of Lagos by Harbour Master Speeding, 1886.

§ 12. Proclamation of 13TH August, 1891

By His Excellency George Chardin Denton, Esq., C.M.G., Acting Governor of Lagos, etc., etc.

George C. Denton, (L.S.), Acting Governor.

Whereas Her Majesty has been advised that it is for the best interests of the people of the Colony and protectorate of Lagos, and also of the people of the kingdom of Ilaro that the said kingdom should be transferred to the Government of Her Majesty and that Her Majesty should assume the Protectorate thereof :

And whereas the King, Chiefs, Elders, and people of the kingdom of Ilaro have expressed their desire that the said kingdom should be so transferred and that Her Majesty should assume the Protectorate thereof :

And whereas it is Her Majesty's pleasure that the kingdom of Ilaro be attached to the Colony of Lagos and form part of the protectorate thereof :

Now therefore I, George Chardin Denton, Esquire, Companion of the Most Distinguished Order of Saint Michael and Saint George, Acting Governor of the Colony of Lagos, do publish, make known and proclaim as follows : —

1. The kingdom of Ilaro is now under the Sovereignty and

protection of Her Majesty.

2. The kingdom of Ilaro is attached to the Colony of Lagos and

forms part of the Protectorate thereof.

Given under my hand and the Great Seal of the Colony of Lagos this thirteenth day of August in the year of our Lord one thousand eight hundred and ninety one.

A. F. Tarbet, Acting Asst. Colonial Secretary.

APPENDIX B

§ I. YoRUBA Kings, Ba§oruns, and Notable Events.

Kings.

1. Oduduwa
2. Oranyan
3. Ajaka
4. Sango
5. Ajaka
6. Aganju Regent lyayun
7. Kori
8. Oluaso
9. Onigbogi
10. Ofiran
11. Eguoju
12. Qrompgto
13. Ajiboyede
14. Abipa
15. Obalokun
16. Ajagbo
17. Odarawu

18. Kanran
19. Jayin

Interregnum

20. Ayibi
21. Osiyago
22. Ojigi
23. Gberu
24. Amuniwaiye
25. Onisi'le
26. Labisi
27. Awonbioju
28. Agboluaje
29. Majeogbe
30. Abiodun
31. Aole 32 Ade"b5
32. Maku

Interregnum

BasQruns. Olorun-fun-mi Ef iifu ko-fe-ori Erindinlogun-Agbou Salg ku odi

» >

Banija

Eran-k6-gbina

E§ugbiri-elu

Aiyagbaro

Sokia

Obalohun

Asamu

Ibate

Iba Magaji Akidayin

Woruda Iba-Biri

Olu aja and Yabi

Apala

Yamba

Jainbu

Kogbou and Kokiki

Soyiki alias Esuogbo

Gahk

Gahk

Gdha and Kangidi Asamu alias Agbakolekcin

Events. Capital — He Ife Ancient Oyo built

Ed§ and 0§ogbo built

Said built by this King Igboho built

The Bebe celebrated Oyo rebuilt Salt introduced

The first Awujale of Ijebu appointed

Circumnavigation of the Niger and the Lagoon

The Bebg celebrated

THE HISTORY OF THE YORUBAS

Kings

Basgruns.

Events.

34-

Majotu

Ojo and Akioso

Seizure of Ilorin by the Fulanis

35-

Amodo

I' I j aye and Modakeke

36.

Oluewu

occupied. Ibadan and Abeokuta founded.

Interregnum

Fall of Ancient Oyg

^1-

Atiba

Oluyole and Gbenla

Ago became Oyo of the present day. Bebe celebrated

38-

Adelu

Gbenla and Ogunsoro

39-

Adeyemi

Ogunsoro,Iye,Layode

§ 2. Ibadan Chief Rulers and their Baloguns from its Occupation to the beginning of the British Protectorate.

I. Ibadan as a MiUtary Camp.

Maye

Generalissimo

Labosinde Baba Isale

Lakanle

Leader of the Oyos

2. Transition Stage.

Oluyedun Kakanfo (honorary)

Lakanle

Otun Kakanfo

Oluyole

Osi Kakanfo

3. As a Settlement.

Rulers.

Titles. Baloguns'.

Oluyole

Basorun

Oderinlg

Opeagbe

vacant

1855 Olugbode

”

Ibikunle

1866 Ogunmola

Basorun

Akere

1870 Orowusi

Ajgbo

1872 Latosisa

Kakanfo

Aja5d Ogboriefgu

vacant

Osungbekun

1892 Fijabi

Akintgla

§ 3. The Leading Chiefs of Abeokuta from its Foundation TO the Beginning of the British Protectorate

Sodeke, Leader of the Egbas to Abeokuta

ApatiS Balogun of Kemta jHis associates in the Govern- Agbunrin, Balogun of Ilugun i ment.

⁀ Apati bought the title of Basgrun from Oluygle of Ibadan but never lived to enjoy it. It passed on to Somoye.

APPENDIX B

Okukenu, alias Sagbua, King

Ogunbona, Balogun of Ikija ' Sokenu, Balogun of Ijeun Associates who

Anoba, Balogun of Ika helped to rule

Somoye, Balogun of Iporo, the town,

afterwards Basorun J

., . … -3. /Ogundipe, Balogun of Ikija

Ademola, Alake or Pnmus ⁀ ⁀

Oyekan. ⁀ „ „ jsolanke, Jaguna of Igbein

01uwa]in „ „ VOgundeyi, Balogun of Iporo

The Quadrumvirate who actually ruled. Osokalu, Alake or Primus Ogundeyi*

Other distinguished Baloguns more or less independent each in his own township. Ege of Oko Obirinti of Ijaye Kukudi

Agbadu of Ijemo Ajagunjeun of Itoko

Atambala of Ikereku Ogunsgla of Ijeja

Anoba of Ika Olumloye of Ilugun

§ 4. The Emirs of Ilorin.

AUmi the Fulani priest of Afonja who headed the mutiny of the Jamas and murdered their lord paved the way for his eldest son to become the first king or Emir of Ilorin under the Sultan of Sokoto.

At his death he left four sons, the succession in the Emirate being confined to the descendants of the first two.

Ahmi

the

Priest

I. Abudusalami

2 Shitta

3. Suberu
4. Alihu
5. Abudusalami II
6. Sule

^ Oluwajin was a wealthy Itoku man who bought the title of Alake.

2 Ogundeyi having out-Uved his rivals assumed the title of Basorun (being nephew to Somoye) and ruled the town singly, the Alake being only a figure head.

Akye, 294 Abaja, 106 Abaka war, 301 Abata, 44 Abayomi, 366, 371 Abebi, 85 Abem6, 269, 271 Abeokuta, 643 ; under

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